

In the name of God most Gracious, ever Merciful!

# *The Beloved and I*

Volume 7: Gospels

Thomas McElwain

New Jubilees Version of Sacred Scripture in  
Verse

With Verse Commentaries

Revised Edition

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## Preface

The ten commandments give my view  
Of everything I taint in pew.  
That's just because they are the only  
Thing in the sacred books postponely  
That claim to be sermon concise  
Spoken by God in terms not nice,  
But public before all the crowd,  
And directly, spoken aloud.  
What recognizes divine plot  
In that great message that we've got  
Is useful to be read in church  
Or in the synagoguely perch  
Or in the mosque for plenitude.  
The Qur'an joins in deathly feud  
To recognize the big ten are  
Criterion and guiding star.  
See chapter two, verse fifty-three.  
The Qur'an's no difficulty.  
It's harder to make sensibly  
What the New Testament might mean  
With words conflicting with the scene  
Found in the Torah and the Psalms,  
The Tanach, in words without qualms.  
The Qur'an strikes against the roost  
Of Jewish rejection to boost  
Without Jesus of Nazareth.  
By the same token and same breath  
It strikes at Christians who would take  
The sent one of God for the sake  
Of God Himself in Trinity:  
It invokes that insanity.  
But what of the New Testament?  
Can it be reconciled, though bent,  
With the best of God's commandment?  
I trow it can, though not without  
Relinquishing the Christian shout.  
Jesus was simply not a god,  
But a man sent upon the sod  
To criticize the Jewish way  
Of soothing Roman fears the day  
That Messianic expectation  
Would threaten the imperial station.  
So Pharisee and Sadducee  
Found ways to read judiciously:  
The one dispensed with need of leader  
By piling scholarly impeder  
Upon the law and in the sum  
Of wisdom found verdicts to hum  
Without the need of Jewish king  
Or prophet, patriarch or wing

Of judge. The fact that many ways  
Arose in the past to God's praise  
Seemed to suggest accommodation  
To Roman rule was the best ration.  
The Sadducees dispensed also  
With any Messiahs in tow  
By limiting the legal show  
To what was literal to know.  
Jesus appears beneath the text  
As a grand sage for the perplexed,  
Who simply rejected the path  
Accommodating to the wrath  
Of Caesar. But the text is full  
Of expectations at the pull  
Of Greek and Jewish hopes and views.  
A Messianic layer accrues  
Upon the sayings of the wise,  
And after that the reader's eyes  
See sops thrown out to Gentile guys  
Who cannot think in other terms  
But that god-men come from the sperms  
Of the Olympianite powers.  
And so the book three-tiered in towers  
Addresses expectations set  
By the folk of its time when met.  
The Gnostic force beyond the will  
Of Philo to read Torah's bill  
In terms of Greek philosophy  
Goes on apace in what we see  
In the writings of Paul and Peter,  
And John besides the pumpkin-eater.  
The church councils would limit it  
To those writings that they saw fit,  
The ones of lesser allegory  
In spirit or in legends' story,  
Although they did not attempt to  
Relinquish the pagan to-do  
Of gods in spring in human form  
Who dying rise to make it warm.  
Bultmann and Barth were two not torn  
With any regrets to relieve  
The story of mythic reprieve,  
Before the two came out to warn,  
And to reject kerygma's sleeve  
After their liberal deceive.  
I set aside my own will and  
My own thoughts for God's own command  
And take as truth only what's set  
To complement Decalogue met.  
The human sacrifice, the way  
That miracles appear to sway  
To the same tempo of the day

Dionysos rose up to play,  
 I set aside as what it is,  
 A ploy to make the Grecian fizz  
 Take note of what they would not read  
 Unless it fed the heathen greed.  
 If I am wrong to concentrate  
 Obeying God's will soon or late,  
 Then let the Father of lights come  
 Down on Sinai again to hum,  
 And if He tells me loud and clear  
 He is a Trinity to fear,  
 And that the Sabbath is no more  
 The gauge that rest is for the poor,  
 Then I will submit to His word,  
 But until then I'll eat no turd  
 Nor drink no piss of human teaching,  
 No matter what the priests are preaching.

### The Gospel of James

If James was written Anno Domini  
 One fifty that is good enough for me  
 To take it with the swell of Matthew and  
 Of Mark and Luke along with ampersand  
 Of John, not to mention the other books  
 Apocryphal that swelter in the nooks  
 Of such a fateful century of crooks.  
 I have no trouble with virginity  
 Or with the idea of new Eve and tree.  
 And yet the thought that James the Just  
 could not  
 Write such a thing without a Jewish plot  
 Does not convince. First century's complex  
 With many views of government and sex  
 Both Jewish and Hellenic as well sought.

### Gospel of James 1

1 In the record of the twelve tribes  
 Of Israel we read the scribes  
 Say there was one called Joachim,  
 Who being wealthy, *it would seem*,  
 Pledged double offerings to YHWH  
 Alohim, saying "My substance  
 Shall be for all people's advance,  
 So I'll find from YHWH Alohim  
 The mercy to forgive my scheme."  
 2 But at a certain great feast of  
 YHWH, when Israel's folk came *with love*  
 Gifts and Joachim also offered  
 His own, Reuben, High Priest *preferred*  
 Opposed him saying it was not

Lawful for any who begot  
 No children in Israel to bring  
 An offering to YHWH *or to sing*.  
 3 At this Joachim greatly perturbed  
 Went to consult *and undisturbed*  
 The records of the twelve tribes to  
 See whether he alone would do  
 Having no children *or a few*.  
 4 He found on his investigation  
 That all the righteous of the nation  
 Had raised up seed in Israel.  
 5 Then he remembered how it fell  
 On Abraham, near his life's end  
 That Alohim gave a godsend,  
 His son Isaac, upon which he  
 Was greatly distressed and would be  
 Not seen by his wife, 6 but retired  
 Into the wilderness, desired  
 To pitch his tent there and to fast  
 Forty days and forty nights past,  
 Saying 7 "I shall not go down hence  
 Nor eat nor drink *for my defence*  
 Until the Lord look on my case,  
 But prayer alone sustain my face."

The forty days of fasting Enoch taught  
 To Moses, to which Joachim fell lot,  
 Bless my ways also, my Beloved, until  
 Divine wisdom gives birth in me Your will.  
 The ninth month of fasting is doubly  
 blessed  
 With ten days from Muharrem as the rest.  
 No food or drink in daylight hours may  
 pass  
 My lips as I seek by my prayers true mass  
 Before Your face, Beloved, in wilderness  
 Where only beast and bird come to caress  
 My timid heart with fear and love. The  
 trees  
 Shed needles soft where I kneel under seas  
 Of green. Let me produce a righteous seed  
 Of divine wisdom, and so, Loved, take  
 heed.

### Gospel of James 2

1 During this time Anna his wife,  
 Doubly distressed *upon her life*  
 Said "I will mourn both widowhood  
 And barrenness *that I've withstood*."  
 2 Then YHWH's great feast drew near, and  
 said  
 Judith her maid, "How long *with dread*

Will you afflict yourself? The feast  
 Of YHWH's when all *from great to least*  
 Must not by law mourn, *man nor beast*.  
 3 "So take this hood well made by one  
 Craftsman in such, for it's not done  
 That such as I, who am a maid,  
 Should wear the thing, while you evade,  
 Whose status is greater than mine."  
 4 And Anna answered "Leave that line,  
 I'm not used to such things so fine,  
 Besides, YHWH's humbled me *and mine*.  
 5 "I fear evil design in this  
 Come to spoil me with sin, *not bliss*."  
 6 And Judith her maid answered, "What  
 Evil should I wish on you, but  
 You will not listen to my *word*?  
 7 "I cannot lay a curse preferred  
 Beyond what you are under *now*  
 In what Alohim will allow  
 In shutting your womb, that you should  
 Not take in Israel motherhood."  
 8 So Anna was greatly distressed  
 And in her wedding garment dressed  
 Went out to pace her garden way  
 Mid-afternoon *that troubling day*.  
 9 She saw a laurel tree and sat  
 Beneath it to pray YHWH *for that*,  
 And said 10 "O Alohim of my  
 Fathers, bless me and hear my sigh  
 As You did once bless Sarah's womb  
 And gave her Isaac, son *and room*."

I kneel beneath the desert laura now  
 And beg of You that You will hear  
 somehow  
 The voice of the lone soul who cries to You  
 That I might have child of the wisdom few  
 Find and fewer embrace, the grace divine  
 That costs more than the crown, the jewel  
 and wine.  
 My soul meets sophia on the golden stair  
 That climbs the laura tower to find the bare  
 And blackened sky of night still holds a  
 star  
 To guide to where the dawning gleams  
 afar.  
 My soul meets sophia bent in humble task  
 And hidden by the veils that women ask,  
 And yet I apprehend Your love that shines  
 Unrecognized beyond religions' wines.

### Gospel of James 3

1 And as she looked toward the sky,  
 She saw a sparrow's nest up high  
 In the laurel, 2 and mourning she  
 Said to herself then "Woe is me  
 And who sired me and who gave birth,  
 That I should be so little worth  
 In Israel's folk, that they reproach  
 Deriding me and so encroach  
 On my God's temple, woe is me,  
 There's none like me so mournfully!  
 3 "Compared to even *beast and bird*,  
 In fruitfulness they are preferred  
 By You, O YHWH, and woe is me,  
 There's none like me so mournfully!  
 4 "Compared to even *beast and bird*,  
 In fruitfulness they are preferred  
 By You, O YHWH, and woe is me,  
 There's none like me so mournfully!  
 5 "Compared to waters *of the ground*  
 I cannot reach their fruitful *sound*  
 Before You, YHWH, and woe is me,  
 There's none like me so mournfully!  
 6 "I'm not compared to the sea waves,  
 For they, though calm or moved with raves,  
 The very fish in them give praise,  
*Throughout their days and in their ways*,  
 To You, O YHWH, and woe is me,  
 There's none like me so mournfully!  
 7 "I'm not worthy of earth's compare,  
 That sends up fruit to grace the air  
 With praises daily to Your name,  
 O YHWH, proclaiming still Your fame!"

Fruitful or no, the human soul aspires  
 To be compared to all created fires,  
 As though conformity were the best lift  
 Of heaven's abode and the divinest gift.  
 Fruitful indeed, the human soul would be  
 Like bird and beast, like waters of the sea,  
 And like the laden boughs of apple tree,  
 Fruitful no matter what the weight and  
 shift.  
 Beloved, the fire of blossom, stem and fruit  
 I have already caught in hand and boot.  
 I look now to the joy of being just,  
 And of just being on the earthly dust.  
 And as I come back to maternal root,  
 I come back also to the divine trust.

### Gospel of James 4

1 And then the angel of YHWH stood  
 Beside her and said, "Anna, good

Anna, YHWH's heard your prayer, you shall

Conceive and bring forth epical  
Progeny whose fame shall be spoken  
In all the world *and go unbroken.*

2 Anna said "As YHWH Alohim  
Lives, if I bear true not in dream  
Either male or female, I will  
Bring it for a gift to fulfil  
My vow to YHWH Alohim still,  
And it shall minister to Him  
Until its days of life grow dim."

3 And behold there came messengers  
Saying to her, "Behold Joachim  
Your husband comes *as it occurs*  
With his flocks, 4 for an angel *stirs*  
From YHWH come out to say to him  
'Joachim, Joachim, YHWH Alohim  
Has heard your prayer. Get down from  
here,

For your wife Anna *shall appear*  
And has conceived.'" 5 And Joachim sat  
Down, called his herdsmen where he sat  
And said, "Bring me ten lambs without  
Blemish and without spot *or doubt*,  
They shall be for YHWH Alohim.

6 "And bring me twelve tender young  
calves,

And they shall be *as it best seem*  
For the priests and *not done by halves*  
For the assembly of elders;

7 "An hundred kids for all the fers."

8 And so Joachim came with his flocks,  
And Anna stood at the gate *stocks*  
And saw Joachim coming, 9 and ran  
And hung upon his neck *full span*,  
Saying "Now know I that the Lord

God has greatly blessed me *implored*:

10 "For behold the widow's no more  
A widow, and the one who bore  
No children shall conceive." That way  
At home Joachim rested a day.

Beloved, look on the faith of Anna now  
And see her husband's frank and happy  
brow.

No evidence of action did You give,  
But only spoke the word that made them  
live.

My doubting heart would wait until the  
birth

Of Mary before I would shout Your worth.

But these among the fair and true combine  
To praise You for the promise of the wine.  
Beloved, make me like Anna born of old,  
And like the sweet Joachim, who was so  
bold

To give a hundred sheep in thanks that You  
Just whispered hope to him among the few.  
Then I shall sing upon the desert sand,  
Upon the tundra, on the frozen land.

### Gospel of James 5

1 And the next day he offered gifts,  
Said to himself, 2 "If Lord God lifts  
His favour unto me, the plate  
That's on the priest's forehead will state  
It to me." 3 Joachim offered gifts  
And earnestly looked *in his shifts*  
Upon the plate of the priest when  
He went to the Lord's altar then,  
And he in himself did no sin.

4 And Joachim said "Now do I know  
That the Lord to me's come to show  
His favour and forgives my sin."

5 And justified he went down in  
His house from the Lord's temple *thrilled*.  
6 And so her months were then fulfilled,  
In the ninth month Anna gave birth.

To the midwife for all her worth  
She said, "What have I got?" 7 And she  
Answered "A female" 8 And so she  
"This day my soul is magnified,"  
She laid herself down *on her side*.

9 And when the days were all fulfilled,  
Anna purified herself *stilled*,  
And gave the child to suck and called  
Her name Mary *before she crawled*.

The Jewish faith is patriarchal in  
The eyes of those who stand around in sin,  
Despite the fact the sacred trust runs down  
From mother and to daughter on the town.  
Whether a Jew or not, the most of men  
Today as yesterday come back again  
To hope for sons instead of daughters'  
frown.

Such hopes are futile and a wicked wen.  
But Anna is not such a soul, oh no.  
She takes delight in even female glow.  
I too have just a daughter, but the grace  
Seemed well enough in every sort of place.  
No son is needed where the daughter bides,



No son is heeded where the daughter  
glides.

### Gospel of James 6

1 And day by day the child waxed strong,  
And when she was six months along  
Her mother stood her on the ground  
To try and see if she would stand;  
And she walked seven steps, she found,  
And came back to her mother's hand.  
2 She caught her up, saying "As lives  
The Lord my God, so my heart gives  
You no more chance to walk on ground  
Until I bring you to be found  
Within the temple of the Lord.  
3 She made a holy place adored  
In her bed chamber, did not let  
Common or unclean pass its net.  
And she called for the daughters of  
The Hebrews undefiled *in love*,  
And they carried her to and fro.

The common and unclean are words of law,  
Expressions of tradition in the craw  
Of the Semitic sort of faith and paw.  
So those who see no knowledge of the suite  
In James's gospel ought to come and eat  
Their kippah and return the staff and meat.  
I do not claim this word proves that the  
book

Was written in the first century and took  
Its flaws and blessings from that day and  
stone.

I only point out that the guess alone  
Is never to suffice upon the shore  
Of human vice and wisdom out of door.  
Beloved, it's clear that love and knowledge  
reign  
Upon these pages without sin or stain.

4 And the first year the child did grow,  
And Joachim made a great feast and  
Bade the priests and the scribes at hand  
And the elders' assembly and  
The whole folk of Israel *to stand*.  
5 And Joachim brought the child before  
The priests, and they blessed her galore,  
Saying "Our fathers' God, now bless  
This child and give her name's address  
Renowned for ever among all  
The generations *to recall*."  
And all the people said "So be,

So be it then. Amen." 6 And he  
Brought her to the high priests, and they  
Blessed her, saying "O God whose sway  
Is on high, look upon this child,  
And bless her with the *undefiled*,  
A blessing unsurpassed, *full styled*."  
7 And her mother caught her up in  
The safety of her chamber's gin  
And gave her suck. And Anna made  
A song to the Lord God, and said  
8 "I'll sing an hymn to Lord my God,  
Because He visited with rod  
And took away from me reproach  
Of all my enemies *in coach*,  
And the Lord's given me a fruit  
Of his righteousness *and to boot*,  
Single and manifold to Him.  
Who shall declare unto the *grim*  
Sons of Reuben Anna gives suck?  
Hearken, hearken you to the rack,  
Twelve Israel's tribes, Anna gives suck."  
9 And she laid the child down to rest  
In the bed chamber of her nest,  
And went forth and served them the best.  
10 And when the feast was ended, they  
Went down rejoicing *in the way*,  
And glorifying Israel's God  
*For what He did upon the sod*.

The woman was in luck to set the child  
Down to sleep and then join the party wild  
Without the bother to come in and change  
A diaper to sing back to sleep with strange  
And wonton melodies of greater range.  
Most babies I know fail to sleep when they  
Would best be out of parents' help and  
way.

But Anna was in luck on that first day,  
And had a gay time with the neighbours'  
hay.

Beloved, the child of wisdom in my breast  
Is also one to sleep before the nest.  
I might need her to waken when the crowd  
Comes pressing all around me speaking  
loud.  
But rarely does Your wisdom touch my  
vest.

### Gospel of James 7

1 And to the child her months were added:  
And the child was two years engladdened.  
And Joachim said "Let's bring her up

To the Lord's temple *where to sup*  
 That we may pay the vow of which  
 We vowed, lest the Lord send us stitch,  
 And our gift be a vain oblation.  
 And Anna said "Let's wait *a ration*  
 Until the third year, that the child  
 May not long after father *styled*  
 Or mother." And Joachim said  
 "Let's wait." 2 And the child as was led  
 Turned three years old, and Joachim said  
 "Call for the Hebrew daughters that  
 Are undefiled *in what they're at*,  
 And let them take each one a lamp,  
 And let them be burning *for damp*,  
 That the child turn not backward and  
 Her heart be taken captive and  
 Away from the Lord's temple house.  
 And they did so, *the man and spouse*,  
 Until they went to the Lord's house.  
 And the priest received her and kissed  
 Her and blessed her and said to list,  
 "The Lord has magnified your name  
 Among all generations' *fame*:  
 In you in the latter days shall  
 The Lord make appear general  
 His redemption unto the folk  
 Of Israel *down to the last bloke*.  
 And he made her to sit upon  
 The third step of the altar *drawn*.  
 And the Lord put grace on her too  
 And she danced on her feet to do,  
 And all Israel's house loved her too.

Attributing the vestal virgin state  
 To Jewish temple seems unlawful rate.  
 The mix of Hellenistic thought that's found  
 In this gospel upon the fertile ground  
 Of Hebrew is amazing, I am bound.  
 And yet as long ago as Maccabee  
 The hopeless mix has never been set free.  
 Beloved, my heart too is a morass of  
 The many nations that fit in my glove.  
 But sanctify me, too, as You did then  
 When Joachim and Anna came again  
 To bring their own like Samuel to the den  
 Of holiness in hope, in pride and joy.  
 A girl is just as holy as a boy.

### Gospel of James 8

1 And marvelling her parents went  
 Down praising the Lord God who sent  
 The child to follow the right way.

Mary was in the temple's sway  
 Of the Lord as a dove that's fed:  
 And she had nourishment and bread  
 From the hand of an angel led.

No doubt it's true an angel fed the mite.  
 There is no trusting in established wight  
 Of any faith or temple to give care  
 And nourishment to helpless ones found  
 there.

The first role of a public thing should be  
 Assuring bread and water to the wee.  
 But church and government today I find  
 Spend more on gross aggression than the  
 kind.

Beloved, feed me too where I sit and wait  
 Beneath the walls of synagogue and state,  
 A forest bird, a beast of field, to win  
 A grain and drop to nourish me from sin.  
 And I shall praise sweet Mary's while a  
 way  
 And hope to see her visions on a day.

2 And when she was twelve years old, there  
 Was a council of priests to share,  
 Saying "Behold Mary's become  
 Twelve years old in Lord's temple *hum*.  
 What then shall we do with her now?  
 Lest she pollute the holy how  
 Of YHWH." And they told the high priest,  
 You stand over YHWH's altar *feast*.  
 Go in and pray concerning her:  
 And what the Lord shall show and stir,  
 Let us do so. 3 And the high priest  
 Took the vestment twelve bells increased  
 And then he went into Holy  
 Of Holies and prayed about her.  
 Behold the Lord's angel to stir  
 Saying to him: O Zacharias,  
 Go out and summon the pariahs  
 Who are the widowers of all  
 The folk, and let them each in thrall  
 Bring a rod and the one to whom  
 The Lord shows a sign not in doom  
 He shall take her for wife in room.  
 And the heralds went out to all  
 The country of Judea tall,  
 And sounded the Lord's trumpet call,  
 And everyone came back to stall.

Unless it was the Day of Atonement  
 The priest could not go in that place unsent.

Either the text is wrong in what it meant  
Or means the great day came in to prevent.  
No worry touched the priesthood, as I said,  
For Mary in her drink and in her bread,  
But soon as she threatened her monthly  
rate,

The priesthood took note of uncleanly state.  
Solution to the problem she might soil  
The holy precincts by her bloody foil  
Was simply to marry her off as soon  
As Aaron's rod might bud and bloom  
aboon.

What would the folk do if no trickery  
Showed miracle among Jewish gentry?

### **Gospel of James 9**

1 And Joseph threw down adze and ran  
To meet them, and when they in span  
Were gathered, they went to high priest  
And took their rods with them at least.  
And he took the rods of them all  
And went into the temple stall  
And prayed. And when he'd finished  
prayer

He took the rods and gave their share.

And there was no sign anywhere.

But Joseph received the last rod,

And see, a dove came from the pod  
And flew around Joseph's fair head.

And to Joseph the high priest said

"The lot has fallen on your spread

To take the virgin of the Lord

And keep her for yourself adored."

2 And Joseph refused, as he said

"I have sons, and I'm old and led,

But she is just a girl: lest I

Became a laughing-stock in sty

To the children of Israel by."

And the priest said to Joseph, "Hear

The Lord your God, and keep in ear

What God did to Dathan and yet

To Abiram and Korah set,

How the earth opened up and took

Them because of what they would brook.

And so have care, Joseph, lest it

Be so in the house where you sit."

And Joseph was afraid, and took

Her to keep for himself in nook.

And Joseph said to Mary, "See,

I have received you from the fee

Of YHWH's temple, and now I leave

You in my house and for reprieve

Go to my building, and I'll come  
Again to you, God keep your sum."

Instead of almond flowers and fruit the rod  
Of Joseph blossomed dove above the sod.  
The dove that flew about Joseph's bald  
head

May have been the same that was later led  
To light upon the Saviour at the stream  
Of Jordan in baptisms of his dream.  
But here we find how Mary could remain  
A virgin and Jesus still have for pain  
Some brothers. They were Joseph's from  
the time

Before even Mary was born to climb.

Apocrypha's tie up the many ends

Of loose strings in the canons of our  
friends.

Beloved, though I'm a doubter in my way,  
I do not doubt You and Your love astray.

### **Gospel of James 10**

1 Now there was a meeting of priests,  
And they said "Let's make *before feasts*  
A veil for temple of the Lord."

And the *high* priest said "Call me pure  
Virgins of David's tribe *and sure*."

The officers went out and sought

And found seven virgins as thought.

And the priests called to mind the child

Mary, that she was undefiled

Before God and of the tribe styled.

And the chiefs went and fetched her too.

And they brought them into the view

Of the temple of the Lord YHWH,

And the *high* priest said "Cast me lots,

Which of you shall weave gold in slots

And the pure white and linen fine

And the silk and hyacinthine,

And the scarlet and purple true."

And the lot of the purple due

And the scarlet then fell unto

Mary, and she took them and went

Back to her house as she was sent.

*And at that season Zacharias*

*Became dumb, and Samuel was pious*

*In his place till when Zacharias*

*Spoke again.* But Mary took thread

Of scarlet and spun it instead.

Today the great and well-read wish the fray  
Gave them the podium and right to say.

Give me the right or weakness and the bill  
Of feminine to fit the lowly hill.  
Instead of pulpit and the higher church,  
To show abroad, the countried pine and  
birch.

Instead of light and sound, the woven  
shroud,

The veil to cover Your sight from the  
crowd.

Give me like Mary what to do at home,  
Ignoring creeds and liturgies of Rome.  
Like Mary I shall humbly take my task  
And never think to question or to ask  
Why I am chosen by the treasured lot  
To be a silent drone in divine spot.

### **Gospel of James 11**

1 And she took the pitcher and went  
Out to fill it with water lent:  
And hear a voice said "Hail, you are  
Greatly favoured, the Lord *in star*  
Is with you, blessed are you here  
Among all women *with their gear*."  
And she looked all around her on  
The right and left to see what's drawn  
Of this voice, and with trembling filled  
She went back to her house and spilled  
Naught from her pitcher, and took out  
The purple and sat down no doubt  
To pull the thread both in and out.  
2 And see an angel of the Lord  
Stood by her saying "Fear no sword,  
Mary, for you have found grace in  
The sight of the Lord without sin,  
And you shall conceive His word." And  
She heard it and would understand,  
Saying "Shall I truly conceive  
From the living God in reprieve,  
And bear a child as women do?"  
And then said the angel of YHWH  
"Not so, Mary, for a power due  
Of the Lord shall descend on you,  
Which is why that holy one born  
Of you shall be called *not forlorn*  
But Son of the Highest *in view*.  
And you shall call his name Jesus:  
For he shall save in omnibus  
His people from their sins. And Mary  
Said "Behold the handmaid and chary  
Of the Lord is before Him: be  
It to me by your word's decree."

No doubt the Christian failure to take this  
Fair Gospel word as one divine in bliss  
Is simply that the child of Mary born  
Is Your word spoken without heathen  
scorn,

The power of Your creative speech abroad  
Upon the blooming earth and budding sod.

No doubt the Christian who would only  
dress

In the four Gospels' canon and confess  
The pagan trinities of low and less  
Sees these words as of no account. But I,  
Beloved, enter ecstasies to the sky  
To hear the golden Gospel words go by.  
Beloved, I too stand here beneath my tree  
Submitted to Your word's divine decree.

### **Gospel of James 12**

1 She made the purple and the scarlet  
And brought them to the priest *like starlet*.  
The *high* priest blessed her and he said  
"Mary, YHWH Alohim *of dread*  
Has magnified your name, and you  
Shall be blessed among all the crew  
Of earth." 2 And Mary rejoiced and  
Went up to Elizabeth's strand  
Her relative, and so she called  
At the door. 3 And Elizabeth  
When she had heard it *out of breath*  
Threw down her sewing where it lolled  
And ran to open up the door,  
4 And when she saw Mary in store  
She blessed her and said "How is this  
The mother of my Lord in bliss  
Should honour me with coming kiss?  
5 See, he who is in me leaped up  
And blessed you *like a jumping tup*.  
6 Mary forgot the mysteries  
That Gabriel the archangel's pleas  
Revealed to her, 7 and she looked up  
To heaven and said "Who am I, Lord,  
To be of all the earth adored?"  
8 And she stayed with Elisabeth  
For three months and with each day's  
breath  
Her womb increased, and Mary feared  
And went to her own house areared  
And hid herself from Israel's folk.  
She was sixteen years old at stroke  
Of *all* these mysteries under cloak.

The awe and holy fear that marked the meeting  
 Of Mary and Elizabeth in greeting  
 Does little here to camouflage the rate  
 Of simple joy and expectation's state  
 That comes to every pair of girlish mate  
 Comparing notes at such a time of life.  
 The way is known to every budding wife.  
 Beloved, the words of angel's soon forgot  
 In light of ordinary days and plot  
 Resound again when mind is brought up sharp  
 Before the vision of the cloud and harp.  
 The three months that I wait between the fast  
 And the Ashura coming in at last  
 Are also fraught with awe and common blast.

### **Gospel of James 13**

I Now it was the sixth month with her,  
 And see Joseph came from his *burr*  
*Of* building, and came in his house  
 And found her great with child *like spouse*.  
 He struck his face, and threw him down  
 Upon the ground on sackcloth brown  
 And bitterly he wept and said  
 "How shall I meet Lord God instead?  
 What prayer in excuse for the head  
 Of this maid? For I had her out  
 Of YHWH my Alohims' house stout  
 A virgin and have not saved her.  
 What man has made this thing occur?  
 Who did this evil in my house  
 Defiling a virgin like spouse?  
 Is not Adam's fate come on me?  
 For while he gave thanks on the lee,  
 The serpent came and found Eve lone  
 And deceived her from off her throne.  
 So it's happened to me to groan."

Let me break in to point out how tradition  
 Has carelessly read Genesis' position.  
 All think that Eve had wandered from the side  
 Of Adam to where evil serpent cried.  
 The truth is that she gave the fruit to him  
 Who was with her through all her spick and vim.  
 The primitive society that set  
 The matriarch above the male to get  
 A clearer and more handsome way of life

Taught serpent too how to address the wife.  
 Joseph fails to appreciate the rate  
 Of truth revealed in old matriarchate  
 Perhaps because he lives in the icon  
 Of Virgin Mary without a veil drawn.

2 And Joseph got up from sackcloth  
 And called Mary as he were wroth  
 And said to her "O you who were  
 Cared for by God, now by what stir  
 Have you done this? You did forget  
 The Lord your God. Why have you set  
 Yourself in such debasement when  
 You were fed by angels, not men  
 Within the sanctuary then?"

3 But she wept bitterly and said  
 "I am pure and by no man led."  
 And Joseph said to her, "Then how  
 Did you get pregnant *like a cow*?"  
 And she said "As YHWH my God lives,  
 I really do not know what gives."

The answer of the Virgin Mary stated  
 Is just exactly what a man awaited  
 From any girl that got herself in sway  
 Of trouble round about the family way.  
 Her answer is that she has no idea  
 How such a thing could happen or appear.  
 Beloved, see how the word of angel spoken  
 Has so soon left the mind without a token.  
 The waking hours of weaving and preparing  
 The harvest soup distract from bold and daring  
 Visions of angel wings and voices kept  
 Within the laura where she laughed and wept.  
 I too lose all virginity to find  
 The tasks about the house mount up and mind.

### **Gospel of James 14**

I And Joseph was greatly afraid  
 And left her alone where she stayed,  
 And pondered what he ought to do.  
 And Joseph said "If I take cue  
 To hide her sin, I shall be found  
 In conflict with YHWH's law on ground,  
 And if I show to Israel's folk,  
 I fear that the child is the stroke  
 Of an angel, and then I'll be  
 Betraying innocent degree

To judgement to be put to death.  
 What shall I do? I'll let her breath  
 Go from me in a secret way."  
 And the night came upon his day.  
 2 And see an angel of the Lord  
 Appeared in his dream and adored  
 To say "Don't be afraid of this  
 Child, for what's in her is the kiss  
 Of the Holy Spirit, and she  
 Shall bear a son and your decree  
 Shall be to call his name Jesus,  
 For he shall save his people thus  
 From their sins. And Joseph arose  
 From sleep and glorified as chose  
 The God of Israel who had shown  
 This favour to her *hardly grown*:  
 And he watched over her *alone*.

If Mary was naïve to say the birth  
 Was without work of man upon the earth,  
 What is there left to say of Joseph then?  
 He chose belief of dream instead of woe  
 Of human wisdom come into his den.  
 If Muslims now kept to the divine law  
 That Allah vouchsafed to them for their  
 awe

They would not take a pregnancy to show  
 The woman had sinned when she had a go.  
 Beloved, in face of evidence for bad  
 Let me remain always among the glad  
 To give no credence to the rumour that  
 A daughter or a son of You had sat  
 In sinners' way. Keep me out of such fat.

### **Gospel of James 15**

1 Now Annas the scribe came to him  
 And said to him "Why were you dim  
 Not to come to our gathering?  
 And Joseph said to him a thing:  
 I was tired with the journey, and  
 I rested the first day at hand".  
 And Annas turned and saw Mary  
 Was pregnant with a child to see.  
 2 He went to the priest hastily  
 And said to him, "Joseph, to whom  
 You bore witness has sinned to doom."  
 And the priest said "What did he do?"  
 And he said "The virgin and true  
 That he got from temple of YHWH,  
 He has defiled her secretly,  
 Stolen her marriage without fee,  
 And not declared it in the ear

Of Israel's folk to make it clear."  
 The priest replied and said "Indeed  
 Did Joseph take so little heed?"  
 And Annas the scribe said "Send out  
 Officers, and they'll find no doubt  
 The virgin's pregnant and grown stout."  
 The officers went out and found  
 It was as he said *round and round*,  
 And they brought her and Joseph to  
 The place of judgement *as was due*.  
 3 And the priest said "Mary, why did  
 You do this, and also you hid  
 Your debased soul forgetting God  
 Your Lord, and you lived on the sod  
 Of the Holy of Holies and  
 Were nourished by the angel hand  
 And heard the hymns and danced before  
 The Lord, why have you played the  
 whore?"

But she wept bitterly and said  
 "As YHWH my Alohims lives, led  
 Am I in purity with Him  
 And have not known any man dim."  
 4 And the priest said to Joseph then,  
 Why did you do this thing again?"  
 And Joseph said "As YHWH my God  
 Lives I am pure upon the sod."  
 And the priest said "Bear no false tale  
 But speak the truth: you did prevail  
 To lie with her by stealth and yet  
 Not declare it in judgement set  
 Before the folk of Israel met,  
 And have not bowed your head beneath  
 The mighty hand to get the wreath  
 Of blessing on your seed?" But he  
 Joseph stood there just quietly.

Beloved, the circumstances round the head  
 Of innocent and poor are always led  
 To make those in the judgement seat  
 surmise

That they are evil in all good men's eyes.  
 So Joseph and the Virgin both remain  
 In silence before man and the throne's gain.  
 There's nothing to be said when evil brew  
 Is cast out in the sight of earthly crew.  
 The rumour and the whisper and the glint  
 Of evil eye is clearer than the print.  
 Beloved, I too have stood up to condemn,  
 And I too have been quartered in the hem  
 Of accusation I could not reply.  
 Save all of us, Beloved, at least we try.

### Gospel of James 16

1 And the priest said: Restore the lady  
Virgin whom you took *with hand shady*  
Out of the temple of the Lord.  
And Joseph wept *before the Lord*.  
And the priest said "I'll make you drink  
The water of conviction, think,  
Of the Lord, it will make appear  
Your sins before your eyes *in fear*.  
2 And the priest took thereof and made  
Joseph drink and sent him *thus paid*  
Into the hill-country. And he  
Returned both hale and sound. And he  
Made Mary also drink and sent  
Her, to the hill-country she went.  
And she returned both hale and sound.  
And all the people marvelled round,  
Because sin appeared not in them.  
3 And the priest said "If the Lord God  
Has not made your sin show on hem,  
Neither do I condemn *or prod*."  
And he let them go. Joseph took  
Mary and left for his own nook  
Rejoicing, glorifying still  
The mighty God of Israel.

How lovely and how kind the story goes!  
The text of Moses for this law just shows  
The drink administered to wife and not  
To husband with the fatal, dusty drought.  
But here both man and woman bear the  
pain  
Of the test from the tabernacle train.  
I praise You, my Beloved, that You saw fit  
To let the test fall on the bull with wit.  
Beloved, if every theologian and  
If every priest not to mention the manned  
Were ready to come in such love and stand  
As that priest did, the world would be as  
planned,  
A paradise of hope and peace, how grand  
A place to feast and enjoy where we sit!

### Gospel of James 17

1 Now there went out royal decree  
From Augustus the king *on spree*  
That all that were in Bethlehem  
Of Judea be writ on stem.  
And Joseph said "I'll set down my  
Sons, but this child, for what and why  
Shall I record her? As my wife?

No, I'm ashamed and on my life.  
Or as my daughter? but all men  
Of Israel know and know again  
That she is not my daughter here.  
May the Lord's will come and appear."  
2 He saddled the she-ass, and set  
Her on it, and his son he let  
Lead it and Joseph followed on.  
3 They came within three miles near  
drawn,  
And Joseph turned himself around  
And saw her looking at the ground  
With a sad face, 4 and so he said  
To himself, "Maybe the time's spread  
That pains her to give birth instead."  
5 And once again Joseph turned back  
To see her laughing in the track,  
6 And asked her, "Mary, what's with you,  
That I see laughter from you true  
At one time and another time  
I find you sad *and without rhyme*?"  
7 And Mary said to Joseph then,  
It is because two folks I ken  
With my eyes, the one weeping by,  
And still lamenting as they cry,  
The other with joy and no sigh.  
8 And they were half-way there and then  
Mary said to him, "Take again  
Me down from the donkey, for that  
Which is in me presses *the fat*  
To come out. And he took her down  
From the donkey and *without frown*  
Said to her "Where shall I take you  
To hide your shame *from neighbour's*  
*view*?"  
For the place was a desert hue.

The pictures that my infancy bestowed  
Failed in the showing of the donkey's load.  
Indeed the Virgin sat upon the beast,  
But only Joseph guided it unceased.  
But here I read he set his son to take  
The bridle and lead donkey for his sake.  
No tiny band of refugees are these,  
But a whole clan of young men on their  
knees.  
Beloved, I joy to know that You took care  
More than the artists thought who spoke  
their share.  
Sweet Mary did not have to be afraid  
Of bandit or of beast come on parade  
With all the sons of Joseph there to make

Her journey to and fro a piece of cake.

### Gospel of James 18

I And he found a cave there and brought  
Her into it, and his sons taught  
He set beside her: and went out  
To find a midwife of the stout  
Hebrews in Bethlehem about.  
2 “Now I Joseph was walking, and  
I found I walked not, came to stand.  
And I looked in the air and saw  
The air in amazement and awe.  
I looked up to the zenith and  
Saw it was still come to a stand,  
And the birds of the sky stood too  
As motionless and all their crew.  
And I looked on the earth and saw  
A dish set and the workmen’s paw  
Stretched to the dish, and they that chewed  
Were frozen and chewed not the food.  
And those who put stew to their lips  
Were motionless as though in grips  
Of looking up toward the sky.  
And see a flock of sheep went by,  
But took no step, while he who led  
Them lifted up his staff for dread,  
But did not strike, and hand stayed high.  
I saw the flowing river nigh,  
And the kids bent to taste the wet,  
And everything motionless set.  
Then of a sudden all returned  
To motion and went on *unspurned*.”

Beloved, perhaps You do not understand  
How at some times all heaven in a band  
And earth stand still and for a moment  
wrought  
Seem frozen in eternity and plot.  
You who are timeless and know everything  
Perhaps never experience such a ring.  
But Joseph touched eternity with sound  
And found the blessing frozen to the  
ground.  
The night is bright as day when You adorn  
The sky with hope of coming of the morn,  
And all things weep and joy without delay  
When You turn peaceful night into the day.  
Beloved, I too stop for a moment’s round  
To find divinity in all that’s found.

### Gospel of James 19

I A woman came down from the hill,

And she said to me, “Man not still,  
Where are you going?” and I said  
“I’m looking for a midwife bred  
Of the Hebrews.” And she replied  
And said to me, “Do you abide  
Of Israel?” And I said to her,  
“Indeed, I do.” It did occur  
She said “And who is the wife that  
Is giving birth in the cave’s flat?”  
And I said “One betrothed to me.”  
And she said to me, “Is not she  
Your wife?” And I said to her then,  
“It is Mary brought up in den  
Of YHWH’s temple, and I received  
Her as wife by lot unreprieved;  
And she’s not my wife, but conceived  
By the Holy Spirit.” And so  
The midwife said to him in tow,  
“Is this the truth?” And Joseph slow  
Said to her, “Come up here and see.”  
And the midwife went *faithfully*.  
2 And they stood in the cave on spot,  
And see a bright cloud shadowed lot.  
The midwife said “My soul today  
Is magnified, because the way  
My eyes have seen marvels’ display:  
For their salvation now is born  
To Israel *as once was sworn*.”  
And right away the cloud withdrew  
From the cave, and a light in view  
Came so our eyes could not outdo.  
But step by step that light withdrew  
Until the young child came in view:  
And it went back and took the breast  
Of its mother Mary *caressed*.  
And the midwife cried out aloud  
And said “Great is the thing allowed  
To me today, that I have seen  
This new sight *and yet live serene*.”  
3 The midwife went out of the cave  
And Salome met her *in wave*.  
And she said to her, “Salome,  
Salome, a new sight I pray  
To tell you. A virgin gave birth,  
Something beyond her estate’s worth.”  
And Salome said “As YHWH my  
God lives, and so if I don’t try  
And prove her estate, then will I  
Not believe that a virgin could  
Bring forth a child *as woman should*.”

If Salome doubts of the virgin birth,



Then do not blame me who, though of no  
worth,  
Doubt too, Beloved, of everything You do.  
You made me of the doubting sort of crew.  
If Salome, that great lady of faith  
Could doubt Your grace at whisper of a  
wraith,

Then I, whose faith is not a mustard seed,  
Remain to doubt and doubt again each  
creed.

Beloved, though I rest in Your bosom kept  
Sweeter on earth than any palace swept,  
I doubt and doubt again, while heavenly  
quires

Resound with praises, and the divine fires  
Kindle and burn in my heart of desires.  
My doubting heart too has looked up and  
leapt.

### **Gospel of James 20**

1 And the midwife went in and said  
To Mary, "Clean yourself and bed,  
For there's not small contention spread  
About you." And Salome made  
A trial and cried out on parade,  
Saying "Woe to my sin and doubt,  
Because I've tempted the God stout,  
And my hand falls into the fire."  
And she prostrated in desire  
To YHWH and said "O Alohim,  
God of my ancestors I deem,  
Remember that I am the seed  
Of Abraham, Isaac, indeed  
Of Jacob: so make not of me  
A public example's degree  
To Israel's folk, but restore me  
To the poor, for You know, YHWH that  
In Your name I performed the vat  
Of my cures and received my pay  
From You. 3 Now see, an angel's ray  
Appeared from YHWH to her to say,  
"Salome, Salome, the Lord  
Has heard you, bring your hand unscored  
Near to the young child and take him  
And there shall be to you from him  
Salvation and joy. 4 Salome  
Came near and took him up to say  
"I will give reverence to him,  
For a great king is born and grim  
To Israel." And see, right then  
Salome was healed once again,  
And she went out of the cave when

She was justified *in the den*.  
And see, a voice was heard to say  
"Salome, Salome, relay  
None of the marvels you have seen  
Till the child enters on the green  
Within Jerusalem one day."

The miracle of Moses when the hand  
Was turned to blanching leprosy could  
stand

One more appearing to the midwife's luck.  
A miracle makes her then bow and tuck.  
But see, Beloved, no stopping of my cue,  
No hampering of my hand is in view,  
Nor yet do I hear voices from the sky  
Revealing what I doubt because I'm shy.  
If Salome finds her salvation bought  
When she takes up the baby from the pot,  
What of myself, Beloved, one never  
taught?

I touch the joy of every baby born  
And find enough salvation that is worn  
In daily miracles, so I have sworn.

### **Gospel of James 21**

1 See Joseph got ready to go  
Into Judaea. And a show  
Appeared in Bethlehem and in  
Judaea with a sound of din.  
For there came Magi in to say  
"Where is the king born on this day  
To the Jews? We have seen his star  
In the east and have come from far  
To give him reverence *at the bar*." 2  
When Herod heard the matter he  
Was troubled and sent men to see  
The wise men. And he sent out for  
The high priests and asked them the score,  
And said "How goes the writ before  
The Christ, where is he born, what's  
more?"

They said to him, "In Bethlehem  
Of Judaea: for so's the gem  
Of writing." And he let them go.  
And he examined all the show  
Of the wise men, saying to them,  
"What sign did you see as a gem  
About the king that's born below?"  
And the wise men said on the go,  
"We saw a very great star shine  
Among those stars to dim them fine  
So they could not be seen at all.

By that we knew a king in stall  
 Was born to Israel, and we  
 Came to pay reverence to his fee.”  
 And Herod said “Go look for him,  
 And if you find him safe and trim,  
 Come tell me, so I may also  
 Come and pay reverence and not slow.”  
 3 And the wise men went out. And lo,  
 The star they had seen in the east  
 Proceeded before them at least  
 Until they came into the cave;  
 And it stood above the cave’s wave.  
 The Magi saw the young child there  
 With Mary his mother and fair,  
 And they brought out of their pack-ware  
 Gifts of gold, frankincense and myrrh.  
 4 An angel warned them not to go  
 Back by Judaea in a row,  
 So they went back to their country  
 Along another road’s decree.

The fact is they were right who came to say  
 That the king of the final, righteous day  
 Should come from Bethlehem, and should  
 arise  
 From David’s house twice blessed beneath  
 the skies.  
 But that promise of Micah came to sway  
 For end of time, not for another prize.  
 It was honest mistake to think if he  
 Was really the one promised faithfully,  
 He ought to bring a consummation down  
 Upon the earth, at least Bethlehem’s town.  
 Instead he turns to legend and the years  
 Turn into two millennia of fears.  
 Is this the way You answer prophecy?  
 You’re too caught up in Your eternity.

### **Gospel of James 22**

1 But when Herod perceived that he  
 Had been deceived by Magis’ spree,  
 He became extremely angry  
 And sent out murderers in fee,  
 And told them, “Kill every baby  
 From two years old and under that,  
*Take both the skinny and the fat.*”  
 2 When Mary heard children were killed,  
 She was afraid, and took with gild  
 The young child and wrapped up with care  
 In swaddling clothes and laid him there  
 In an ox-manger in the air.  
 3 But Elizabeth when she heard

They sought John, took him out and stirred  
 Up to the hill-country to look  
 Around her for a safer nook  
 To hide him, but she found no place  
 To hide from every danger’s trace.  
 Elizabeth groaned and aloud  
 Said “O great mountain, don’t be proud  
 To hide a mother and her child.”  
 Elizabeth was in the wild,  
 Not able to go up. Straightway  
 The mountain split and took her in.  
 And there was light, a shining ray  
 Always before them to show gin,  
 Because an angel of the Lord  
 Guided and kept them and restored.

How many times, Beloved, have You come  
 down  
 To split the river, sea, or angry town?  
 The moon was split according to renown  
 Of some Islamic tale. The mountain where  
 I learned to walk and keep my humble  
 share  
 Has been split by the mining company.  
 The Appalachian Plan comes in for free.  
 Beloved, in every place where rulers rule  
 And buyers come to market like a fool,  
 There are good reasons for the folk to flee.  
 So split another mountain or a sea.  
 And when You do, see how many with  
 child  
 Run out to refuge in the sane and wild  
 Away from harvest of the ones beguiled.

### **Gospel of James 23**

1 And Herod went looking for John,  
 And sent officers out as pawn  
 To Zacharias, saying “Where  
 Have you hidden your son, now where?”  
 And he answered and said to them,  
 “I’m a servant of God and gem  
 Always in YHWH’s temple to serve;  
 I don’t know where my son may curve.”  
 2 The officers went on their way  
 And told Herod all these things’ lay.  
 And Herod was angry and said  
 “His son is to be Israel’s king.”  
 And he sent back to him, saying  
 “Tell the truth, where is your son now?  
 For you know your life’s anyhow  
 In my power.” And the officers  
 Went out and told him all these spurs.

3 And Zacharias said "I am  
A witness of God if you slam  
Me; for my spirit YHWH will take,  
If you shed innocent blood's wake  
In outer court of temple's stake."  
About the dawning of the day  
Zacharias was killed as prey.  
And Israel's folk did not know that  
He had been killed upon his mat.

It's not just infants that the presidents  
Are out to kill, but grown men with good  
sense.

That does not make the thing better or  
worse,

But only shows the nature of the curse.  
It's not just infants Herod held in fear,  
But wise men and the prophecies to steer  
The hopes and hearts of ordinary folk  
To You, Beloved, and out of kingly yoke.  
Beloved, slay me upon the marbled floor  
Of temple, at the temenos or door,  
But let my life pour out before Your throne  
In witness that You are one God alone.

And I shall breathe today and with my  
breath

Proclaim that You are God and beyond  
death.

### **Infancy Gospel of James 24**

1 But the priests came in at the time  
Of the greeting and as in mime  
Zacharias' blessing did not  
Meet them in the manner once taught.

The priests waited for Zacharias,  
To greet him after the prayer pious,  
And glorify Most High for aught.  
2 But since he did not appear when  
They had expected him again,  
They were all scared, till one of them  
Took courage and went in the hem,  
And he saw by the altar place  
Blood there congealed as though in trace,  
And heard a voice that said at last:

"Zacharias is killed and passed,  
And his blood shall not be wiped out  
Until his avenger come stout."

When he heard that message he feared  
And went out and told what appeared.

3 And they took courage and went in  
And saw what had been done therein:  
The wall plates of the temple wailed,

And they tore their clothing unveiled  
From the top to the bottom railed.  
They found no body there in place  
But his blood turned to stone in trace.  
And they were so afraid they went  
And told all the people present  
That Zacharias was unbent.  
And all the tribes of the folk heard,  
And mourned for him and they were stirred  
For three days, while the priests concurred  
For who should be set in his place.  
The lot fell on Simeon's face.  
Now he was the one who was warned  
That he should not die unadorned  
With the sight of the Christ child come  
In very flesh *and sound of drum*.

When Your beloved was stricken from the  
stake  
And torn down from between the sky and  
rake,  
The temple curtains ripped from top to toe.  
When Zacharias came to meet death row  
The very panels of the temple shrieked  
To see the blood upon the holy leaked.  
The holy house is filled with ghosts it  
seems

Beyond the brass and marble of its gleams.  
Beloved, Your holy house upon the skies  
Is filled with anguish at the way the ties  
Of men are broken now at violence.  
The death of Zacharias but prevents  
The flood of many deaths in precedents  
After the king Herod come in disguise.

### **Gospel of James 25**

1 Now I, James, who wrote this tale down,  
It was in Jerusalem's town,  
When there broke out a restless time  
When Herod died *in all his crime*,  
I made retreat to desert places  
Until the riots ended traces  
In Jerusalem. So I gave  
Glory to YHWH Alohim grave,  
Who gave me the gift and the way  
To write in wisdom this tale's sway.  
2 And grace shall be with those that fear  
Our Lord Jesus Christ *without tear*:  
To whom be glory now again  
For ever and ever. Amen.

The sweet James does not enter in the fit

Of what Jesus did or did not to sit  
In temple or in garden and with wit  
Teach all the crowds who came to see him  
lit.

The sweet James only tells of how his birth  
Affected those around him in the worth,  
And how with joy and fear the folk of earth  
Divided at his call and light and mirth.  
Beloved, I too see how the world divides  
On right and wrong, and every man takes  
sides.

Each blames the other, but few stop to see  
The right is what You say, no mystery,  
On Sinai, and the wrong's what You  
declare

In Decalogue to say what is not fair.

### The Infancy Gospel of Thomas

The stories of Thomas the Israelite, the  
Philosopher, concerning the works of  
the Childhood of the Lord.

Whether the Gospel Arabic or this,  
The text is far from certain of the kiss.  
And yet it is so sweet with joy and hope  
I give it approbation and not rope.  
The holy Qur'an speaks in the same sigh  
Of Jesus who spoke from the cradle's ply.  
The true-hearted soul of medieval church  
Loved this dear gospel. But those in the  
lurch

Of later unbelief have cast aside  
The glories of the infant Jesus' pride.  
Beloved, I turn my vision to the days  
A little boy lived always to Your praise  
And set right every wrong from wood to  
craze  
Of the melamedh come in for the ride.

### Gospel of Thomas 1

I, Now then Thomas the Israelite  
Relates to you a thing that's right,  
To all my Gentile brothers now,  
What deeds done in childhood and how  
Our Lord Jesus Christ mighty things  
Performed when born *among the kings*  
Of our land, here's the start of things.

They say that Thomas was not the one  
meant

In other gospels of disciples kent.  
And yet the quoting of Irenaeus  
Sets the date back so far that in a truss  
It may be older than canonicals,  
Despite the quoting of the Lucan hulls.  
The good Hippolitus too and the queer  
Origen quoted Thomas without fear.  
Beloved, here at the start of miracles,  
And at the dawn of boyish life and tear  
I touch the wonder of growing into  
Manhood among the saintly and the crew  
Of ordinary and suspicious mates,  
The drift of humankind with wooden  
plates.

### Infancy Gospel of Thomas 2

1 This little child Jesus when he  
Was five years old playing beside  
The ford of a brook, and there he  
Gathered the waters there that glide  
And formed them into pools and made  
Them clean by just a word he laid,  
2 And having made soft clay, he moulded  
Of it twelve sparrows, *wings unfolded*.  
And it was Sabbath when he did  
This, and many another kid  
Playing there saw the things he did.  
3 And a certain Jew when he saw  
What Jesus did, *against the law*  
Playing upon the Sabbath day,  
Went and told Joseph right away,  
"See, your child playing at the brook  
Took clay and formed twelve little birds  
And thus defiled the Sabbath day"  
4 And Joseph came out there to look  
And shouted to him in these words,  
"Why do you do on Sabbath day  
What is unlawful, tell me, pray?"  
But Jesus clapped his hands and cried  
Out to the *clay* sparrows beside  
Him saying to them "Go and fly!"  
And the sparrows flew away high  
Chirping the while. 5 And when the Jews  
Saw such to amaze and confuse,  
Departed and told their chief men  
What they'd seen Jesus do again.

Some also look in envy and complaint  
On the mud pies I make on Sabbath day  
As I leave gathering of sinner and saint,  
And in my lowly hovel lift a lay  
Of Psalm and Sura to Your ageless praise,

Yes, some look on to criticize my ways.  
 Teach me to answer neither look nor shout  
 With anything but turn and turn about,  
 And as I whirl to clap my hands that You  
 Turn and return to accept what I do,  
 Not for its greatness nor wisdom, but for  
 The grace and mercy that, Beloved, You  
 bore.

So may I see my lifeless prayers take wing  
 Made lively by the spirit that You sing.

### **Infancy Gospel of Thomas 3**

1 But the son of Annas the scribe  
 Was standing there *by evil bribe*  
 With Joseph; and he took a branch  
 Of willow and started to blanch  
 The waters which Jesus had brought  
 Together. 2 And when Jesus saw it,  
 In anger he spoke to him there,  
 “Evil, ungodly, foolish share,  
 What harm did the pools do to you?  
 See, it shall now come down on you  
 To be withered up like a tree,  
 And not bear leaves, or root in fee,  
 Or ever fruit.” 3 And straightway he  
 Completely withered up, but then  
 Jesus went back to Joseph’s den.  
 But the parents of the lad took  
 His withered body at a look,  
 Bewailed his youth and brought him to  
 Joseph, and accused him and crew  
 “For you have such a child as this  
 That does such *evil* deeds as this.”

I laud the people of an early time  
 Who calculated that it was no crime  
 For Jesus to produce a thing or two  
 In vengeance on the haughty, upper crew.  
 Today the good must turn the other cheek  
 At every evil call and wicked shriek.  
 Today the child must not hit back or she  
 Will be judged by her mother righteously.  
 Beloved, I love the Jesus who knew where  
 To take revenge upon the well-dressed  
 square,  
 And put him in his place and underwear.  
 The withering of tree or body of  
 Another child that straightens up to shove  
 Is also matter for rejoicing’s share.

### **Infancy Gospel of Thomas 4**

1 After that he went through the town

Again, and a child charging down  
 Pushed him against his shoulder, and  
 Jesus was provoked *more to stand*  
 And said to him “You shall not take  
 The finish of the course you make.”  
 And straight away he fell down dead.  
 But certain ones who saw then said  
 “Where did this young child come from,  
 for

Everything he says becomes war,  
 And every word becomes a deed?”  
 The parents of the dead child came  
 To Joseph and blamed him with speed,  
 Saying “You have a child *for shame*  
 That you cannot live in this town  
 Unless you teach him not to frown  
 And curse but to bless, lest he slay  
*All of our children in a day.*

No doubt the Californian way to shoot  
 The careless driver takes a parting boot  
 From Thomas’s report in branch and root.  
 The jostle of the crowd bent on the Lord  
 Was always in his body like a sword:  
 He felt the virtue leave him at the touch  
 Of ailing woman come to seek him much.  
 So as a child he also felt the hue  
 Of shoving beyond what other men do.  
 Beloved, I too would touch the little child  
 Who’s sent into Your world irreconciled  
 With what men bear in ordinary rate  
 Of market competition and the state.  
 I too look for the death of each such mate.

### **Infancy Gospel of Thomas 5**

1 Joseph called the young child apart  
 And chided him: “Why did you start  
 To do such things, and make this crew  
 Hate us and persecute us too?”  
 But Jesus said “I know these words  
 Are not yours, but are from the herds,  
 Yet I shall still honour your wishes  
 And hold my peace and keep my dishes;  
 But they shall bear their punishment.”  
 And right away those who had meant  
 To accuse him were struck down blind.  
 2 And those who saw it were consigned  
 To their fear and perplexity,  
 And said about him in degree,  
 That every word that he spoke free,  
 Whether good or bad came to be  
 A marvel and wonder to see.

And when he saw Jesus did so,  
Joseph got up and had a go  
At his ear and twisted it sore.  
3 The young child was angered the more  
And said to him, "It is enough  
To seek and not find things are tough,  
And surely you know I am yours?  
So do not vex me with your stores."

If Joseph twisted Jesus' ear today,  
Someone would call child services and say  
To pick him up for such abuse and pay.  
The Christ himself cannot escape the way  
That people are scorned on the earthly  
sway.

I have those who accuse me of the lie,  
And those in jealousy come in to spy,  
And know that such reaction on the part  
Of the dear Christ, though coming from the  
heart,

Is justified and just. Had You made all  
Men like the little Jesus at the call  
Of righteousness, then this dark and light  
ball

Would be a better place to live and eat  
The bread and even pie in autumn treat.

### **Infancy Gospel of Thomas 6**

1 A certain teacher, Zacchaeus  
By name, stood there and heard the fuss  
In part when Jesus said these things  
To his father with marvellings  
That being still so young a child  
He spoke such matters unbeguiled.

2 And after a few days he came  
Near Joseph and addressed his name.  
"You have a wise child of great fame.

Come, let me teach the boy to read.  
And I'll teach him with letters' seed  
All knowledge and to be polite  
And greet his elders, all in sight  
With honour as grandfathers and  
As fathers and love those who stand  
In his own generation's band."

3 He told him all the letters from  
Alpha to Omega in sum,  
And questioned him not being dumb.  
But Jesus looked at Zacchaeus  
The teacher and said to him thus,  
"You do not know the Alpha by  
Its nature, so how can you try  
To teach others the Beta's cry?"

You hypocrite, first if you know  
The Alpha, then reveal its show,  
And then we shall believe you when  
You teach the Beta's specimen."  
Then he began to show the meaning  
Of the first letter in its screening  
So that the teacher could not say  
A word in answer to his way.  
4 And in hearing of omnibus  
The young child said to Zacchaeus,  
"Hear, O teacher, the ordinance  
Of the first letter and its dance  
And pay attention to its scence:  
It has its lines, it has its heart,  
It has its parallels apart,  
You see it appear and depart,  
Raised high with three levels to start,  
Balanced and equal in its art.  
So are the rules of Alpha's part."

I don't suppose the teacher came to teach  
The alphabet of Grecian in his reach,  
But alef bet from Scripture and to preach.  
And yet three lines and levels show them  
all,

Both Greek and Syriac and Hebrew's call,  
To be the first of letters in the stall.  
I don't suppose that Jesus in his thrall  
Taught Cabbalistic jargon to the man.  
Such secrets are not lawful to the span.  
Beloved, I get my letters best I can,  
And read the Scriptures from Moses in plan  
As far as good Muhammad, and I scan  
The light of heaven on earth as did that  
child,  
And like that boy I remain just as wild.

### **Infancy Gospel of Thomas 7**

1 When Zacchaeus the master heard  
So many allegories stirred  
Of the first letter spoken by  
The young child, he could not reply  
Before his answer put so high,  
And said to those who stood nearby,  
"Woe's me, the wretch I am, I see  
I am defeated in degree,  
I've brought shame to myself in fee  
By taking this young child to me.  
2 "Take him away, I do so pray,  
My brother Joseph, in my way  
I cannot take the harshness of  
His look, I cannot speak above

The word. This young child's not of earth,  
 But one who can tame fire in berth,  
 Like one begotten e'er the world  
 Was made and firmament unfurled.  
 What womb bore this, what belly fed?  
 I do not know. In woe I'm led,  
 O my friend, he puts me away  
 From all my sense, I go astray  
 From following his knowledge ray.  
 I have deceived myself, three-fold  
 Wretch that I am, how I was bold  
 To get a disciple, I'm told  
 I have a master in his hold.

3 "Friends, I think on my shame now old  
 Worst by a young child; and I  
 And ready to faint and to die  
 Because of the boy: I cannot  
 Look him in the face as I sought.  
 When all men say I've been confounded  
 By just a little child surrounded,  
 What can I say? And what can I  
 Tell about the first letter's cry  
 Of which he spoke to me to vie?  
 I'm ignorant, my friends, I know  
 Neither the start nor the end's row.  
 4 "So please, my brother Joseph, go  
 And take him away to your place,  
 For he is something great in race,  
 Whether hero or angel's trace  
 I don't know what to call his face."

The fact is that the alef is so great  
 That even Scripture cannot bear it's state  
 And starts with bet and makes that sign the  
 start

Of revelation of the divine heart.  
 The books of Moses start with b and show  
 Beginning in the wisdom of Your glow.  
 And even the Qur'an follows in suit  
 And starts with b as in the name to boot.  
 So how can Zacchaeus come to describe  
 What You have left in secret from the tribe  
 Of humankind for all eternity?  
 The alef and Your oneness' mystery  
 Stands at the start, a number and a quest,  
 The witness that You are one and the best.

### **Infancy Gospel of Thomas 8**

1 And as the Jews were counselling  
 Zacchaeus, the young child to sting  
 Laughed out aloud and said "Now let  
 Those bear fruit that were barren set,

And let them see who once were blind  
 Of heart. I have come down in kind  
 From above so I may lay curse  
 On them, and call them to converse  
 Of things that are above, as He  
 Commanded so to you sent me."  
 2 When the young child stopped speaking,  
 then  
 All who were blinded among men  
 By his curse became whole again.  
 And no one after that would dare  
 To provoke him, lest for his share  
 He should curse him and he should be  
 Maimed or blinded disgracefully.

Some may think that the curse was a bit  
 much.

But I think it was too little to touch  
 The hearts of those around with fear of  
 such.

He ought to have cursed them enough so  
 they

In latter years had never come to say  
 Give us Barabbas but take Jesus out  
 And execute him on a stake, one stout.  
 If Jesus had been as wise as a man  
 As he was in childhood, the evil plan  
 Of killing Son of God would have been  
 rough.

Sweet Jesus simply did not curse enough.  
 Beloved, teach me to curse and with a will,  
 So I may keep my way upon the hill  
 And not fail with the cart come out to spill.

### **Infancy Gospel of Thomas 9**

1 Now after certain days Jesus  
 Was playing on the housetop's truss,  
 And one of the young children that  
 Were playing with him fell down flat  
 From the housetop and died. And so  
 When all the other children know  
 And see, they flee the spot and leave  
 Jesus alone without reprove.

2 The parents of the dead child came  
 Accusing him and casting blame.  
 And Jesus said "I did not throw  
 The boy down from the roof below."  
 But still they blamed him for the show.

3 Then Jesus jumped down from the roof  
 And stood by the corpse, cried for proof,  
 "Zeno, for so was the child's name,  
 Get up and say if I'm to blame,

And if I threw you down for shame.”  
And right away the child got up  
And said “No sir, not like a tup  
Did you throw me down, but instead  
You raised me back to life from bed.”  
They saw it and they were amazed,  
The parents of the child unfazed  
Glorified Alohim because  
Of the thing that came true to clause,  
And gave reverence to Jesus dazed.

Evil is human heart, so that a child  
Innocent of all wickedness defiled  
Is blamed unless he can show with the call  
Of raising up the dead out of death’s thrall  
To witness of his innocence and part.  
So Jesus had to play to grosser heart.  
Before the miracle, the parents sigh  
In praise to You beneath the golden sky.  
Beloved, the day itself and so the night  
Are miracles in Your and in my sight.  
Let every eye see that divine work done  
In every second spinning with the sun,  
And fail to cast the blame on those who  
wait  
For You, Beloved, beside the empty plate.

### **Infancy Gospel of Thomas 10**

1 After a few days, a young man  
Was splitting wood nearby in scan,  
And the axe fell and cut his foot  
In two, and losing much blood put  
About to die. 2 And when the folk  
All gathered round to see the stroke  
The young child Jesus also ran  
There and by force came through the  
crowd,  
And took hold of the foot allowed  
Of the young man and right away  
The foot was healed and whole that day.  
And he said to the young man then  
Whose foot had been cut off again  
And healed, “Get up now and split wood  
And mind me as well as you could.”  
But when the multitude there saw  
What happened they fell down in awe  
Of reverence for the young child and  
Said “Truly God’s spirit has spanned  
This young child *here in our own land.*”

Three miracles that irritated men  
Are met by three that made them turn again

To You, Beloved, in praise for goodness  
done.

Now let the little boy go out and run  
And play, not stay to teach and work the  
land,

Unfertilized hearts of men and women  
scanned.

Six miracles in all bring back to life  
The deadened village from its daily strife.  
Had Jesus had such success in the world,  
We might not now lie in a faith uncured,  
Society that lives by war and graft,  
The politics of putting fore to aft.  
Had Jesus worked as a man as he did  
As a child, all the world might know his  
bid.

### **Infancy Gospel of Thomas 11**

1 When he was six years old at last,  
His mother sent him out to cast  
And draw water and bring it in  
The house and put in water bin,  
And gave him a pitcher, but in  
The crowd he struck it on another  
And broke the one he got from mother.  
2 But Jesus spread his cloak out and  
Filled it with water and as planned  
Brought it to his mother. And she  
When she saw what he did, then she  
Kissed him, and kept within her heart  
The mysteries all she saw him start.

The water-basket is a thing well known  
To Iroquois, as well-known as corn pone.  
It may have been invented on the spot  
By Jesus when he shattered waterpot.  
The water-basket keeps the water cool  
While folk are outside wielding every tool  
In garden and in workshop, by the pool  
For fish in hopes of supper as a rule.  
I’m glad Your Christ is not the relished son  
Of just one culture and one tide to run,  
But in the village caught on space and time  
Knows to observe the wayward hill to  
climb  
Both east and west, the nomad and the set,  
The many forms humanity has met.

### **Infancy Gospel of Thomas 12**

1 At planting time, out went the child  
With father to sow corn as styled  
Upon their field, and as his dad



Put down the seed, the child was glad  
 Also to sow the grain he had.  
 2 He reaped and threshed it all the more,  
 A hundredweight he had in cor.  
 He summon all the poor in town  
 Up to his threshing floor's renown,  
 And gave them all some corn to eat.  
 And Joseph took what had in treat  
 Remained. And he was eight years old  
 When he worked this miracle bold.

Every man plants in hopes to reap that day.  
 That is no miracle in Jesus' way.  
 I say the word and hope the hearer will  
 Bend to my plot or else then remain still.  
 I bring the pot to boil and take the egg,  
 Expecting right away to break the keg.  
 I prune the apple tree and wait in spring  
 To eat the apple magic there and sing.  
 I set my snare upon the meadow green  
 And sit to wait if there's a sparrow seen.  
 Beloved, if wheat grows up to thresh the  
 time  
 It was planted, I rejoice in the rhyme.  
 But truth is waiting in the share of men,  
 Until Your Christ appears here once again.

### **Infancy Gospel of Thomas 13**

1 His father was a carpenter  
 Who made ploughs to use when to stir  
 The soil, and yokes for oxen's fur.  
 There was a rich man who came by  
 To order a bed warm and dry  
 Be made for him. But one plank stood  
 Too short, and Joseph, try as could,  
 Could not make it work, but the child  
 Jesus said to dad reconciled,  
 To Joseph, "Lay down two beams here,  
 Set in the middle to appear."  
 And Joseph did as the child said.  
 And Jesus stood at the bedstead  
 And took hold of the shorter beam  
 And stretched it to an equal ream  
 With the other one. And his dad  
 Joseph saw it and he was glad,  
 And hugged the child amazed and kissed  
 Him saying "Surely I've not missed  
 God's blessings, since He's given me  
 This young child to help faithfully."

The greatest irritations in one's life  
 Are not the confrontations born of strife

Where boldness to do right is firmly set  
 By situations coming as they're met.  
 Oh no! The greater trials are those that  
 come  
 In daily tasks, and troubled hours that hum  
 With work-a-day incentives to release  
 Tranquility and scurry out from peace.  
 Beloved, I've seen a board cut short though  
 done  
 Twice with the measure and the rule  
 unspun.  
 The carpenter would have been glad that  
 day  
 If Jesus had arrived to help and stay.  
 The board-stretching machine's not yet in  
 stock  
 Of any hardware outlet on my block.

### **Infancy Gospel of Thomas 14**

1 When Joseph saw the child was grown  
 In mind and age, he thought a loan  
 Of letters would improve his lot.  
 He took him to a scholar's spot  
 And set him at a teacher's hand.  
 The teacher told Joseph he planned  
 To teach him first the Grecian way  
 Of writing, then the Hebrew sway.  
 He said so since he knew the skill  
 Of the child, and he feared to fill  
 The role of teacher. Still he wrote  
 The alphabet and Jesus smote  
 It with his eye and thought for long,  
 And uttered no response or song.  
 2 Then Jesus said to him, "If you  
 Are truly a teacher then do  
 Tell me the power of alpha and  
 I'll tell you power of beta's stand."  
 The teacher was provoked and struck  
 Him on the head. And the child's luck  
 Was to be hurt, and so he cursed  
 Him and he fainted, and what's worst  
 He fell down on the ground and muck.  
 3 The child went back to Joseph's place,  
 And Joseph was sad in disgrace,  
 And told his mother to her face,  
 "Don't let him go out any more,  
 They all succumb who make him sore."

So I was right. The teacher thought he'd try  
 To put one over on the child on sly  
 By taking Greek instead of Hebrew tongue.

He thought Greek unknown to a child so young.

I too was set to Greek and Hebrew when I was a young boy in the scholar's den.  
But I had not the wit to tell the man  
To preach to me about the alpha's span.  
Instead I learned my conjugations well  
And wrote the declinations for a spell.  
Beloved, if Jesus knew all things before  
The teacher came into the schoolroom door,

He was a prodigy unknown to all  
Teachers before and since in the school hall.

### **Infancy Gospel of Thomas 15**

1 After a while Joseph's good friend,  
Another teacher said "Just send  
The young child to me to the school,  
Perhaps I can teach him the rule,"  
Joseph said "If you dare at all,  
Brother, take him to hear your call."  
And so he took him, though afraid  
And the child gladly came and stayed.  
2 He went straight in the school and took  
A book open in a desk nook,  
And did not stay to study letters,  
But straight off spoke up to his betters  
By power of Holy Spirit, and  
Taught those the law who came to stand.  
And a great crowd came there to hear,  
And marvelled at beauty in ear  
Of what he taught, though just a child  
To utter such things wise and mild.  
3 But Joseph heard and was afraid  
And ran into the school waylaid  
Thinking this teacher too would be  
Unable to handle the wee.  
But the teacher told Joseph, "Know,  
My brother, I took this child slow  
To be a scholar, but he's full  
Of grace and wisdom, and so pull  
Him out and back into your place."  
4 When the child heard that, on his face  
There was a smile and so he said  
"Because you have spoken well-bred  
And borne right witness, for your sake  
Ill shall be healed." And right away  
The other teacher rose that day.  
And Joseph took the child and went  
Back to his house as he had meant.

The quiet word of recognition still  
Calms the unruly boy with ragged will.  
A word of thanks to me, and I am here  
To serve the speaker with my heart and gear.

A word of criticism harsh to bear  
And I am ready to go off somewhere.  
If Jesus is reflection of divine  
In human body and in human sign,  
Then You Yourself, Beloved, would rather know

A word of praise acknowledging Your show  
Than judgement of the places You don't go.

Beloved, I praise You for the coming cold,  
I praise You for the spring and summer gold,  
And for the tattered autumn leaves grown old.

### **Infancy Gospel of Thomas 16**

1 Joseph sent his son James to find  
Fire wood and bring it home resigned.  
The young child Jesus came along  
And followed James who was one strong  
To gather faggots and bring back  
The fire wood to the house in stack.  
At once a viper bit the hand  
Of James, something he had not planned.  
2 He was stuck down, ready to die,  
When Jesus came near by and by  
And breathed on the bite. Right away  
The pain ceased, and the snake that day  
Burst open and James came to stay.

How many times I've jumped across the snake  
That lay unobserved on the way I take.  
I had a dog named Meshach once who hated  
All serpents whether live or deadly rated.  
Despite the many rattlers in the wood  
And all along the river, I still could  
Go there in safety, since that dog would greet  
The snakes before I saw them from the street.  
He was so fast that he could kill the things,  
And always did so without feeling stings.  
I'd rather have the warning dog than one

Small brother who cured bites already done.

But if no dog's around, then I will choose  
The second best, wee Jesus without shoes.

### **Infancy Gospel of Thomas 17**

1 After that in the neighbourhood  
Of Joseph a wee child and good  
Fell ill and died and so his mum  
Cried bitterly as she was glum.  
And Jesus heard the mourning sound  
And he ran quickly where he found  
The dead child, and he touched his breast  
And said "I tell you like the rest,  
Don't die, but live and go back to  
Your mum and keep her in love's view."  
And right away he opened eye  
And laughed to see him standing by.  
And he said to the woman, "Now  
Take him up and give him from cow  
Some milk, and so remember me."  
2 And the crowd that stood by to see  
Were all amazed and said "Truly  
This wee child is either a god  
Or angel of God on the sod,  
For every word he speaks in sum  
Is a work perfect when it's come."  
And Jesus just wandered away  
With other children out to play.

A Jewish village would not say the word  
That a man is a god, not undeterred.  
But then attraction of the Grecian way  
Was further enhanced by the Roman sway,  
So it is possible that far off day  
That some spoke like the Greeks, if just in  
play.

The wee child is a child. I see the way  
He asks the mum for milk as soon as he  
Has half a chance to turn her from the fee.  
A child he was, a child he came to be,  
And not a god, or even king, or lord,  
No rabbi, priest, or wielder of the sword,  
Nor carpenter nor farmer, one who came  
To join his fellows in the funnest game.

### **Infancy Gospel of Thomas 18**

1 After a while there was a work  
Of building, and the sound to irk  
Of a great uproar rose, and so  
Jesus got up to see and go,  
And there he saw a man lie dead,

And took hold of his hand and said  
Sir, I tell you, get up and do  
Your work with the rest of the crew."  
And right away the man arose  
And bowed down to him to his toes.  
2 And when the crowd saw that indeed  
They were astonished at the speed,  
And said "This wee child is sent down  
From heaven here upon our town  
To save many souls from death and  
He's got the strength to save in band  
All his life long, he's come to stand."

Twelve clay birds may predict the way the  
life

Of Jesus would go in peace and in strife.  
He lived to work twelve miracles in all,  
Each one revealing a step in the hall  
Of righteousness. The twelve predicted too  
The twelve disciples that made up his crew.  
I look beyond the Gospel to the age  
When twelve in witness wrote upon the  
page  
Of history in tones of grief and care,  
In tones of truth and justice everywhere.  
Beloved, I know the many series of  
Twelve sent from You with message of  
Your love,  
And give my loyalty to those and You  
And not usurper kings who have no clue.

### **Infancy Gospel of Thomas 19**

1 And when he was just twelve years old  
His parents by their custom's mould  
Went to Jerusalem to feast  
At the Passover with increased  
Friends on the way. But after that  
Passover, they returned out flat  
To their home where they always sat.  
But Jesus went back in the town,  
Though his folks thought he had come  
down.  
2 When they had travelled for a day,  
They looked for him where he might stray  
Among their kith and kin away,  
And when they did not find him there,  
They were hysterical with care.  
And so they went back to the town  
To look for him both up and down.  
After the third day they found him  
Inside the temple sitting trim  
Among the doctors hearing and

Asking them questions out of hand.  
 Everybody listened to him  
 And marvelled how a wee one dim  
 Could put to silence wise and good  
 Elders and teachers as he could  
 Explain points of the law and each  
 Parable that the prophets preach.  
 3 His mother Mary came and asked  
 Him saying "Here, child now unmasked,  
 Why did you treat us so? See, we  
 Have been seeking you grievingly."  
 But Jesus said to them, "Now why  
 Did you look for me? You know I  
 Must be in my Father's house here."  
 4 And the scribes and Pharisees said  
 "Are you the mum of this child bred?"  
 And she said "So I am". And they  
 Say to her, "Blessèd be your way  
 Among women, because God blessed  
 The one born to rest on your breast.  
 For we have never any time  
 Seen such glory and wisdom's rhyme  
 And such excellence put to test."  
 5 Jesus got up, went with his mum  
 Submitting to his parents' hum,  
 But his mum always kept in mind  
 All that had happened and combined.  
 And Jesus grew in wisdom and  
 In height and grace and to command.  
 To him be glory now again  
 Ever and ever and amen.

I see stuffy old Luke pour over text  
 Of Thomas and look on with brow  
 perplexed  
 And then choose nothing but the final  
 word.  
 The miracles and childish thoughts that  
 stirred  
 The simple heart did nothing for his claim  
 As an historian with historian's aim.  
 Some love the words of Luke's propriety,  
 And I admit their charm for social spe  
 As well as for their literary turn.  
 But when I come to Thomas, heart must  
 burn  
 And pulse jump at the lovely child to earn  
 The gratitude of villager and scribe,  
 A famous and a good man of his tribe.  
 I take them both, and neither of them spurn.

## The Gospel of Matthew

When Matthew takes a hint from Mark to  
 make  
 Another Gospel in the Gospel's wake,  
 He adds not just a superstitious touch  
 In finding more of Scripture and as much  
 In proof of Jesus' claims from Moses and  
 The Psalms and Prophets gone out in the  
 land.  
 It's not so much prediction that he sees  
 As will to fulfil all the prophecies,  
 The attitude that what is written must  
 Be the fair model for us men of dust.  
 So Jesus rides two donkey in his trust.  
 Beloved, I find with faith or not the care  
 That Matthew gives to Jesus and to spare.

### Matthew 1

1 The book of genealogy,  
 Line of transmission appointee  
 To Jesus the Christ, David's son,  
 The son of Abraham when done.

The same concern that veils Muhammad's  
 speech  
 Is here, that return to Abraham's peach.  
 But that is only half the striven goal.  
 To be a Muslim counts the middle toll.  
 Beyond the bowing and the fasting I  
 Must find the son of David, at least try.  
 The unity in Abraham is good,  
 But loyalty to David's what I should  
 Maintain, if I am serious in the way  
 Of following the Scriptures in their ray.  
 This Gospel is the logical recourse  
 After the books just read that would  
 endorse  
 The kingdom and the throne of David here  
 And for eternity and without fear.

2 Abraham handed down the crown  
 Isaac then to Jacob's renown,  
 And Jacob to Judah and brothers.  
 3 Judah also produced some others,  
 Perez and Zerah by Tamar,  
 Perez produced Hezron, a star,  
 And Hezron produced Ram, 4 that rab  
 In turn produced Amminadab,  
 Amminadab produced Nahshon,  
 And Nahshon then produced Salmon.  
 5 Salmon got Boaz by Rahab,

Boaz produced Obed by Ruth,  
 Obed produced Jesse in truth,  
 6 And Jesse got David the king.  
 David the king got Solomon  
 By her *who was* the fiancée  
 Of Uriah. 7 Solomon's sway  
 Gave way to Rehoboam, who  
 Produced Abijah, Abijah  
 Produced Asa, 8 and Asa too  
 Got one Jehoshaphat for awe,  
 Jehoshaphat got Joram, and  
 Joram then produced Uzziah.  
 9 Uzziah had Jotham in hand,  
 And Jotham Ahaz, who produced  
 Hezekiah stayed home to roost.  
 10 Hezekiah got Manasseh,  
 Manasseh Amon for his say,  
 And Amon had Josiah then.  
 11 Josiah not weakest of men  
 Got Jeconiah and his brothers  
 About the time with all the others  
 They went captive to Babylon.  
 12 When they were brought to Babylon,  
 Jeconiah got Shealtiel,  
 And Shealtiel Zerubbabel.  
 13 Zerubbabel got Abiud,  
 Abiud produced Eliakim,  
 Eliakim got Azor good.  
 14 Azor produced Zadok in scheme,  
 And Zadok then produced Achim,  
 And Achim produced Eliud.  
 15 Eliud got Eleazar,  
 Eleazar Matthan in car,  
 And Matthan Jacob tenderly.  
 16 Jacob produced Joseph unwary  
 The husband of the Virgin Mary,  
 Of whom was born Jesus called Christ.  
 17 So all the generations spliced  
 From Abraham to David *are*  
 Just fourteen generations' bar,  
 From David to captivity  
 In Babylon fourteen run free,  
 From the bondage in Babylon  
 To Christ *are* fourteen ages gone.

The fourteen holy ones in every age  
 Bear on their shoulders, page by shining  
 page,  
 The burden of the world, without their right  
 The universe would sink into the night  
 Of nought, instead of being shimmering  
 screen

Where is reflected beyond space and seen  
 Your golden image. We who slumber on  
 Are kept in peace until the ruddy dawn,  
 No retribution comes, for their dear sake  
 Who pass the loving cord along and make  
 The circle close around the whirling feet  
 Of forties and fourteens, where masters  
 meet.

Beloved, look on the generations' dance  
 And give the rising dancers glance for  
 glance.

18 Now the birth of Jesus the Christ  
 Was so: his mother was *enticed*  
 By Joseph *and* engaged, but then  
 Before they came together men  
 Saw she was pregnant by the power  
 Of holy spirit *in an hour*.  
 19 But Joseph her fiancée was just,  
 Not wanting to humble to dust,  
 Intended to break the contract  
 In secret as merciful act.

If the man really was a just one, why  
 Did he try then to hide her on the sly?  
 By law he ought to have brought her  
 straight out

To be stoned for adultery en route.  
 It's not mercy to break the law because  
 The miscreant's a friend, kin or in-laws.  
 Nepotic action's root of every ill  
 In government from town hall to the hill.  
 Beloved, if the man knew the child was not  
 His own, then he should have exposed the  
 plot.

Let dreams and visions of angels require  
 A man still follows law and order's pyre.  
 Or then reverse it all to meet the kind  
 Of order that the jungle's like to find.

20 But while he thought about these things,  
 Indeed, an angel of YHWH brings  
 A message to him in a dream,  
 Saying, "Joseph, *not what things seem*,  
 You son of David, do not fear  
 To take Mary your wife *and dear*,  
 For that which is conceived in her  
 Is of the holy spirit's stir.

21 "And she'll bring forth a son, and you  
 Shall call his name Jesus, for YHWH  
 Saves, for He'll truly save his folk  
 From their sins as He promised, spoke."

They say the name of YHWH is never  
 found  
 In the New Testament of Scriptures bound.  
 It's true the word the Septuagint made  
 Come in translation of that word waylaid  
 Is often used for Jesus on parade  
 And for You Yourself, my Beloved and  
 stayed,  
 And for a gentleman called sir when paid.  
 Behind the curious Your name appears,  
 In some of these, and even without fears  
 Within the name of Jesus when sky clears  
 To see YHWH saves remains after the  
 shears.  
 Beloved, I say Your name in any case,  
 With every breath exhaled I find the trace  
 Of YHWH impaled on living, fleshly face.

22 So all this was done that it might  
 Be fulfilled which was spoken right  
 By YHWH through the prophet, saying  
 23 "Indeed, the virgin shall be spring,  
 Pregnant with child, and bear a son,  
 And they shall call his name *when done*  
 Immanuel," which is translated,  
 "God's with us" *still and not abated*.  
 24 Then Joseph was aroused from sleep,  
 Did as YHWH's angel said to keep,  
 And took to him his wife, 25 and did  
 Not lie with her until what hid  
 In her was born, her firstborn son.  
 And he named him Jesus when done.

I take issue, Beloved, with Matthew's tale  
 Stolen from Isaiah and dressed in mail.  
 The truth is Isaiah in prophecy  
 Spoke to the king who was too proud to see  
 A sign that You would save the people  
 brought  
 Under threat of the enemy unsought.  
 The words were spoken and fulfilled right  
 then  
 Before the king so he'd have faith again.  
 So Isaiah could not have meant at first  
 The baby born to Mary when he durst.  
 And yet the events of that ancient day  
 Were signs of Your salvation on the way,  
 And as such were appropriate to take  
 In memory of a new baby's wake.

God with us still, despite the Roman yoke,

You sent this Son, and thus and thus he  
 spoke.  
 God with us still, despite the prophets gone,  
 And only whispered promise of the dawn.  
 The same God that fought with the waves  
 of old  
 That turned the ship of Noah to sheep's  
 fold,  
 The same Jehovah that taught the Red Sea  
 To make a path wherein the oppressed flee,  
 The same God that spoke fire on Carmel's  
 hill,  
 And then again on Sinai, deep and still.  
 Arouse me from my sleep to know the  
 voice,  
 Beloved, of whom You sent and to rejoice  
 His name means then and now Jehovah  
 saves,  
 Let no Saviour but You abide the waves.

## Matthew 2

1 Now after Jesus Christ was born  
 In Bethlehem of Judaea  
 In the days of Herod *of scorn*  
 The king, indeed, wise men *of law*  
 From East came to Jerusalem,  
 2 Saying "Where is he who has been  
 Born King of the Jews *to be seen?*  
 For we've seen his star in the East  
 And have come to prostrate *at least*  
 Before him." 3 When Herod the king  
 Heard, he was troubled *by the thing*,  
 And all Jerusalem with him.  
 4 And when he had gathered to him  
 All the people's chief priests and scribes  
 Together, he inquired *with bribes*  
 Of them where the Christ should be born.  
 5 So they said to him *not forsworn*,  
 "In Bethlehem of Judea,  
 For thus is written by the paw  
 Of prophet: 6 'But you, Bethlehem,  
 In the land of Judah, *a gem*,  
 Are not the least among the *high*  
 Rulers of Judah, for from you  
 Shall come a *greater* ruler who  
 Will shepherd My folk Israel.'"

The prophecy of Micah came to spill  
 The news that David would return to fill  
 Israel's throne united with all men  
 In peaceful, Messianic sort of den.  
 In fact the prophecy may not be that

At all, but just report that David sat  
In Bethlehem with dad and mum and kin  
Before he came to reign on Israel's din.  
Beloved, how does the word relate at all  
To Jesus born in Bethlehem in stall?  
Not by prediction, but obedience  
To Scripture in both sense and in nonsense.  
Beloved, let me too do in Scripture's light  
My deeds and goings in and out of sight.

7 Then Herod, when he'd on the sly  
Called the wise men, determined from  
Them what time the star seen had come.  
8 And he sent them to Bethlehem  
And said "Go search with stratagem  
For the young child, and when you've  
found,  
Bring back to me the word and sound,  
That I may come and prostrate too  
Before him *who is born and true.*"

I see the star, Beloved, the Persians sought  
Sent to proclaim the coming of the one  
You set upon the throne of hearts that  
ought  
To know and do Your will. The thing is  
done.

The rulers in hypocrisy pretend  
That they too wish to follow him and mend  
Their ways and all injustices. Believe  
No man in power. Prime ministers will  
weave  
A net of violence for babe in arms.  
Retreat, retreat from smiles and hidden  
harms.

The star alone, Beloved, is uncorrupted  
That leads by Your permission, the erupted  
Enlightenment of You in oneness poured,  
A bright and guiding star above me soared.

9 When they heard the king, they departed,  
And indeed, the star *not down-hearted*,  
Which they had seen in the East, went  
Before them, till it came *where sent*  
And stood where the wee child's present.  
10 When they saw the star, they rejoiced  
With exceedingly great joy *voiced*.  
11 And when they had come in the house,  
They saw the young child with the *spouse*  
Mary his mother, and fell down  
And prostrated before his crown.  
And when they had opened their treasures,

They gave gifts to him without measures:  
Gold, frankincense, and myrrh. 12 Then,  
being  
Divinely warned in a dream *seeing*  
That they should not return to Herod,  
They departed *after they'd tarried*  
For their own land by other ferried.

The Persian guests brought gold to give to  
one

Whose lifework ended as it had begun  
In witness to Your oneness. Nevermore  
Does gold appear in Your sent prophet's  
store.

Perhaps good Joseph used the unexpected  
Windfall to travel to the land selected.  
But then his donkey used so little gas  
That travelling there could well be done on  
grass.

Despite their insight into dream and veil  
The Persian contribution's always sale.  
They bring as gifts what they themselves  
find dear

And never take a thought for what brings  
cheer.

Their gifts are all one needs to worship  
idol.

An Arab would have brought him spur and  
bridle.

13 Now when they had departed, lo,  
An angel of YHWH came to Jo-  
Seph in a dream, saying, "Arise,  
Take the young child *to his surprise*  
And his mother, flee to Egypt,  
And stay there until I've let slipped  
The word to you, for Herod will  
Seek the young child that he would kill."  
14 When he arose, he took the wee  
Child and his mother *faithfully*  
By night and left for Egypt, 15 and  
Was there until the death *as planned*  
Of Herod, that might be fulfilled  
What was spoken by YHWH *and drilled*  
Through the prophet, saying "Out of  
Egypt I called the son I love."

No Persian has monopoly on dream  
And divine guidance, though the Persian  
seem  
To take the sceptre handed down from  
Cyrus,

To hold the world in wonder and admire us.  
Stepfather of a prophet can hear You  
In night dreams guiding him in what to do.  
Your son was once called from far Egypt's  
land

To walk across the Red Sea on dry sand.  
That great and awful paradigm remains  
The prophecy of when Your blessing rains.  
So You, Beloved, call Jesus from the Nile  
Where he went down to rest and hide  
awhile.

Call me too from the city where I sleep  
Where mothers and their sons still fail to  
weep.

16 Then Herod, when he saw that he  
Was deceived by the wise men, he  
Was exceeding angry, and he  
Sent forth and put to death all male  
Children who in Bethlehem's vale  
And in its districts could be found,  
From two years old and under, sound  
According to the time which he  
Had found out from the wise men's *plea*.

17 Then was fulfilled what Jeremiah  
The prophet said, when he spoke higher,  
18 "A voice was heard in Ramah then,  
A lamentation, weeping when  
A great mourning Rachel was weeping  
For her children, and was not keeping  
Comforted, since they'd gone from men."

The Roman creed still spoken by the fair  
In every grand cathedral, everywhere  
That missionary sword has staked a claim  
To bow to idol and profane Your name,  
Was first invented, or to me it seems,  
By Herod in his anger against dreams.  
It is an ancient heathen faith that knows  
All things are righted, thorn becomes a  
rose,

When Jesuses are crucified or bombed.  
Each village through the centuries  
pogromed

Attests to faith in infant crucifixions  
To save the world from all of its afflictions.  
Herod, not Christ, set up the Christian  
Church

When he was left by magi in the lurch.

19 But when Herod was dead, indeed,  
An angel of YHWH came *with speed*

By dream to Joseph in Egypt,  
20 Saying "Get up, take the young *shipped*  
Child and his mother, and go to  
The land of Israel, for those who  
Sought the young child's life now are  
dead."

21 Then he arose, took the young *bred*  
Child and his mother, and came to  
The land of Israel. 22 But when he  
Heard Archelaus was reigning *free*  
Over Judea and instead

Of his father Herod, he was  
Afraid to go there. And he was  
Warned by God in a dream, and turned  
Aside to Galilee *he'd spurned*.

23 And he came and lived in a city  
Called Nazareth, that *without pity*  
It might be fulfilled which was spoken  
By the prophets, "He'll be *in token*  
Called Nazarene *in line unbroken*."

Some say that Nazareth was still unknown  
And unbuilt when the warning dream was  
shown.

Perhaps the name was meant indeed to be  
A signal of the vow he should be free  
Of wine and drunkenness, a Nazarite.  
Whatever's true, whatever theory's right,  
There's always some new king to set the  
stage

For bloodshed of the poor, to rise and wage  
Wars and to make new floods of refugees.  
The human body's always on its knees.  
Only the spirit hears Your faithful call  
And flies in freedom when the bodies fall.  
The children offered to the golden calf  
Lie bleeding where the new kings come to  
laugh.

### **Matthew 3**

1 In those days John the Baptist came  
Preaching in wilderness of *fame*  
In Judaea, 2 saying "Repent,  
For heaven's kingdom has been sent."  
3 For this is the one told about  
By the prophet Isaiah's *shout*,  
Saying "The voice of someone crying  
In the desert 'Prepare the *flying*  
Way of the Lord, make his paths straight.'"  
4 And John himself was clothed in *rate*  
Of camel's hair, and with a leather  
Belt round his waist *to hold together*,



And his food was locusts and wild  
 Honey *delicious to the child*.  
 5 Jerusalem, and all Judea,  
 And all the region round to see you  
 Beside the Jordan went out to him  
 6 And were baptised *who came to view him*  
 By him in the Jordan, confessing  
 Their sins *Lord Almighty addressing*.

I hoist my camel cloak and tighten belt  
 And peer at vain solutions wise men felt  
 Would make society not paradise  
 Perhaps, but where the great and rich and  
 nice

Can make a profit. Honey crystallizes  
 On roasted locust, food the world despises,  
 But which to me is desert luxury.  
 Instead of liberation for the free,  
 The gospel message still provides the best  
 And shortest corridor from east to west.  
 Repentance is the best that men can do,  
 All else must soon fail and the rule and rue  
 Give way, Beloved, to Your lone  
 sovereignty.

I take it for myself rejoicingly.

7 But when he saw the multitude  
 Of Pharisees *come with the brood*  
 Of Sadducees to his baptism,  
 He told them *in a word to frizz them*,  
 "O brood of vipers! Who warned you  
 To flee from coming wrath in view?  
 8 "Therefore bear fruits worthy of coming  
 To repentance, 9 *"and in your summing*  
 Do not think to say to yourselves  
 'We've Abraham as father *delves*.'  
 For I say to you God is able  
 To raise up children *round His table*  
 To Abraham from out these stones.  
 10 "And even now the axe laid *groans*  
 To the root of the trees. Therefore  
 Every tree which does not bear store  
 Of good fruit is cut down and thrown  
 Into the fire. 11 "I do atone  
 By baptizing you with a *soak*  
 Of water to repentance' stroke,  
 But he who's coming after me  
 Is mightier than I *can see*,  
 Whose shoes I'm not worthy to bear.  
 He will baptise you *and beware*  
 With the holy spirit and fire.  
 12 "His winnowing fan *of desire*

*Is* in his hand, and he will clean  
 Thoroughly through his threshing green,  
 And gather his wheat in the barn,  
 But he will burn the chaff *to darn*  
 With fire unquenchable as seen."

Beloved, the sermons You inspire are not  
 Constructive, positive, indeed, they've got  
 An air of madness and a tone well placed  
 For insurrection of the pauper-faced.  
 Successful preaching has no place for  
 words

Of disrespect for priest and prince or birds  
 Of regal feather. Water, fan and fire  
 Seem far too near undisciplined desire.  
 Let axe be laid not to established trees,  
 But let's hope reformation by degrees  
 Will turn all people into gods. For that,  
 Beloved, John too must learn to eat the fat  
 And know there is none greater than the I  
 That stands upon the threshing floor to die.

13 Then Jesus came from Galilee  
 To John at the Jordan to be  
 Baptised by him. 14 John hindered him,  
 Saying "I am in need *and dim*  
 To be baptised by you, and do  
 You come to me?" 15 But Jesus *true*  
 Answered and said to him "Permit  
*It to be so* now, for it's fit  
 For us to do all righteousness."  
 Then he allowed him *to confess*.  
 16 Then when Jesus had been baptised,  
 He came up straightway from *capsized*  
*In* the water, and lo, the skies  
 Were opened up before his *eyes*,  
 He saw God's spirit coming down  
 Like a dove landing on his crown.  
 17 And suddenly from heaven a voice,  
 Saying "This is my Son of choice,  
 In whom I am pleased to rejoice."

I too come up from breath to breath, but  
 find  
 Baptisms following baptisms blind  
 And make me deaf. I see no lovely dove  
 Descending from the sacred heavens above  
 Upon my holy crown. Instead I sputter  
 To get my breath before I hit the gutter  
 Again. To tame wild birds takes patience  
 and  
 Days quietly in toil upon the land.

I hear no voice divine and pure and sweet  
Above the waves to sweep me off my feet.  
I only know directly that the I  
In silence, too close to my ear and eye  
To see or hear, is greater far than any  
Son, daughter or the pride and power of  
many.

#### Matthew 4

1 Then by the spirit Jesus led  
Went up into the desert dread  
To be tempted by Satan's spread.

2 When he had fasted forty days,  
And forty nights *spent in God's praise*,  
After that he was famished *man*.

Like Moses anciently upon the mount,  
Jesus too fasts the same greater account.  
The ninth month or the third depending  
how

One starts the count, arises and somehow  
Draws all to fast before Your coming word.  
So Moses, Jesus and Ahmed were stirred.  
Each year the season comes to mind the  
time

When You gave books of revelation's  
rhyme

To prophets whom You called up in their  
prime.

Beloved, I too have fasted when the days  
Where gilded for Your speaking and Your  
praise.

Beloved, I too have fasted while the nights  
Promised the incantation of delights  
Of Torahs, Psalms, Qur'ans and Gospel  
rights.

3 Now when the tempter came to *scan*  
Him, he said "If you're Son of God,  
*Which means Messiah on the sod*,  
Command that these stones become bread."

4 But he answered *tempter* and said,  
"It's written, 'Man shall not live only  
By bread *in crust or even stonely*,  
But by each word that proceeds from  
The mouth of God *where good words*  
*come*.'"

Satan delights in those words "Son of God"  
Knowing what deceits he will find to prod  
Humankind into infidelity  
And idol worship before gallows tree.

But Your sent one does not despite the  
word

And argue if son or servant's preferred.  
He leaves the level of mere bread to find  
The higher, greater hope of heart and mind  
In noting that such argument's behind,  
Instead devouring Your word is the best  
Of every argument to take a rest.  
Beloved, I live by Your word and I know  
The beauties of its blossoms and the show  
Of its perfumes in melodies to flow.

5 Then Satan took him up into  
The holy city *for the view*,

And set him on the temple spire,  
6 And said to him *in his desire*,  
"If you're the Son of God, *Messiah*,  
Throw Yourself down. For it is written  
'He'll give His angels charge of smitten,'  
And, 'In *their* hands they'll carry you,  
Lest you dash your foot on a stone.'"

7 Jesus told him, "It's written too,  
'You'll not tempt the Lord *on His throne*.'"

If Satan tries to quote a word divine,  
He twists it to his own purpose's shine.  
Any crime can be justified in truth  
By reference to Scripture like a youth,  
But there's a way to know the right from  
wrong,

And that's to use criterion of song  
In ten commandments. Suicide is not  
Acceptable in any sort of plot.  
Beloved, I see the doubt again in stride  
About the Son of God gone for a ride,  
And how Your sent one does not argue  
case,

But answers the doubt with a sane embrace  
Of Scripture in response to the abuse  
Of Your word. Beloved, always bless  
recluse.

8 Again, the devil took him up  
On a very high mountain *cup*,  
And showed him all the world's kingdoms  
And *all* their glory *in its sums*.

9 And he said to him "All these things  
I'll give to you if you *like kings*  
Fall down in prostration to me."

10 Then Jesus said to him, "Now flee,  
Satan! For it is written, 'See,  
You shall worship the Lord your God,

And Him only serve *by His rod.*”  
11 The devil then left him, indeed,  
Angels came to serve him and feed.

The god of this world is a god impeared  
From the beginning with the flag unfurled,  
And known with intimacy from the light  
That Enoch sheds upon the earthly night.  
Though given power and glory, even  
might,  
He never was to worship, even when  
He still was friend-protector of earth’s men.  
His message is always that worship’s due  
To others in this world and not just You.  
Though Your sent one maintains that You  
alone  
Are worthy of worship, some can’t atone  
Without trying to make this very one  
An idol bowed to on the day of sun.  
But You, Beloved, sit single on the throne.

12 Now when Jesus heard that John had  
Been put in prison *dark and bad*,  
He departed for Galilee.

13 And leaving Nazareth, then he  
Came and lived in Capernaum,  
Which is by the sea when you come  
In the regions of Zebulun  
And Naphtali *under the sun*,

14 That it might be fulfilled which was  
Spoken by Isaiah who was  
A prophet, saying 15 “The land of  
Zebulun and also land of  
Naphtali, *by way of the sea*,  
Beyond Jordan, in Galilee  
Of the Gentiles, 16 the people who  
Sat in darkness saw great light *true*,  
And on those who sat in the place  
And shadow of death light’s found face.”

I doubt not that the great light that was seen  
By prophet Isaiah was more the screen  
Of hope that Israel might escape the clutch  
Of the Assyrian and pagan touch.  
Ahaz looked out upon the weary dark  
And longed for comfort from the graven  
spark.

He had no time to think Messiah might  
Come centuries after the perk and fight.  
Beloved, I too look to the northern hills  
And hope to find after the darkness fills  
The winter of my life, that light instils

Upon the many watches of the night.  
Be it Messiah or the spoken grail,  
I look toward a new sky and a pale.

17 From then Jesus began to preach  
And say “Repent, for now in reach  
Is heaven’s kingdom come to teach.”

The message of Your Christ is not to stand  
Before the gallows of Your son and hand  
His blood in sacrifice atoning sin.  
Rather it is to contemplate within  
Repenting of such sin and not relying  
On human sacrifice and someone’s dying.  
Rather it is to repent and to live  
According to the easy yoke You give  
In ten commandments brief and soon to  
learn.

The message is not to arise and burn  
With heathen watchfulness that gods arise  
In spring when earth awakens under skies  
Of warmth to sprout anew with green and  
gold.

The message is one sweet and one soon  
told.

18 And Jesus, walking by the Sea  
Of Galilee, saw two agree,  
Being brothers, Simon called Peter,  
Andrew his brother *to complete her*,  
Casting a net into the sea,  
For they were fishermen *again*.

19 Then he said to them, “Follow me,  
And I’ll make you fishers of men.”

Some see the Dagon fish-god of Phoenician  
Arising here to make its faith’s completion  
In made-up legend of a century  
After the time that Jesus touched the sea.  
Though Veda and Little Red Riding Hood  
As well as Jonah’s whale and gourd  
withstood

Remind us of the fallen image there  
With broken hands and fins on the floor  
bare,

The truth is Your sent one knows well the  
ark

Containing the tablets where to embark  
Upon the ten commandments and Shekinah  
That illuminate all the world for finer.  
If legend comes to tarnish the mind’s  
power,

I turn to You, Beloved, to find Your hour.

20 They straightway left nets, followed him.

21 Going from there, he saw *not dim*

Two other brothers, James *the son*

Of Zebedee, and John *for one*

His brother, in the boat along

With Zebedee their father *strong*,

Mending their nets. He called to them,

22 And straightway they relinquished *hem*

*Of* the boat and their father, and

Followed him *obeying command*.

I follow Your sent one, indeed, I do,

He's mentioned in all Four Books to be true,

And his mother is raised in Qur'an's word,

A miracle beneath the palms occurred.

I follow Your sent one, though I've no net

To leave behind, nor boat, nor brother yet,

And still I follow Your sent one to be

Obedient to You, Beloved, and free.

Let my steps ever follow in those set

By caller of the fishermen beside

The sunny waters of Galilee's tide,

Until the little hills turn red and blue,

The poplars join in evening's briefest hue,

And I find that he leads me back to You.

23 And Jesus went round Galilee,

Teaching in their synagogues *free*,

Preaching the gospel of the reign,

And healing every kind of pain,

And all kinds of disease among

The people *who sat there unsung*.

24 Then his fame went throughout *the land*

*Of* Syria, and they *in hand*

Brought to him all the sick folk who

Were there afflicted with the rue

Of many diseases and ills,

And those who were in demon chills,

And epileptics, paralytics,

And he healed them, *goy and Semitics*.

25 Great multitudes came after him,

From Galilee, and *from the rim*

Decapolis, Jerusalem,

Judaea, and beyond Jordan

*To hear and be healed by the man*.

The man You sent is famed around the earth

For every kind of purpose, every worth.

The native nations in my place of birth

Must see him as first of medicine men.

The Roman ready always to make king

A god instead of man for anything

Will cry him god before the altar found

In every temple of the Roman round.

Each man sees the reflection of his hopes

In the sent one and that's the way he copes.

This moment I need healing not at all

Since I am healthy at Your constant call,

But if You will, make my hand like his was

To heal those sick about me as he does.

### Matthew 5

1 And seeing the crowds, he ascended

A mountain, and when he had wended

His way there and was seated, then

His disciples came to *the glen*.

2 Then he opened his mouth and taught

Them each one, saying not for naught

3 "Blessed *are* the poor in spirit, for

Theirs is kingdom of heaven's *door*.

4 "Blessed *are* those who mourn, they shall be

Comforted *in a while for wee*.

5 "Blessed *are* the meek, for they'll inherit

The *whole world instead of a garret*.

6 "Blessed *are* those who hunger and thirst

For righteousness, for they not worst

Shall be filled. 7 "Blessed the merciful,

For they'll obtain mercy *to pull*.

8 "Blessed *are* the pure in heart, for they

Shall see God. 9 "Blessed the peaceful way,

For they shall be called sons of God.

10 "Blessed are those who're struck by the rod

For righteousness' sake, for theirs is

The kingdom of heaven and His.

Islam, the faith of peace and Shalom set

Upon the desert and the river met,

Should produce many known as sons of God.

Instead the rue and cry is on the sod

That God has no sons, not even in pod.

Disarmingly the truth is such, I guess,

You have no wife (though mother some confess),

And so no sons indeed. Mary remains

A virgin after all for all Your pains.

Refusal to allow God any sons  
Seems to result in violence in tons.  
Give me back my original Islam,  
Its peace born under cultivated palm,  
And I shall count again the Prophet's gains.

11 "Blessed are you when men shall revile  
And persecute you *for a while*,  
And say all kinds of evil things  
Against you falsely for my stings.

12 "Rejoice and be exceeding glad,  
For great *is* your reward and had  
In heaven, for so they persecuted  
Prophets before you unrefuted.

13 "You are the earth's salt, but if salt  
Has lost its flavour, where's the fault?  
It is then good for nothing but  
To be thrown out and trampled glut  
Underfoot by men. 14 "You're the light  
Of the world. A city in sight  
Upon a hill cannot be hidden.

15 "Nor do they light a lamp *unbidden*  
And put it under basket, but  
On a lampstand, and it gives glut  
Of light to all *who're* in the room.

16 "Let your light so shine on men's *doom*,  
That they may see your good works and  
Praise your Father in heaven's land.

17 "Don't think that I come to destroy  
The Law or the Prophets' *employ*.  
I did not come to destroy but  
To fulfil *everything that's shut*.

18 "For truly, I say to you, till  
Heaven and earth pass away *to fill*,  
Not one jot or one tittle will  
By any means pass from the law  
Till all is fulfilled *to the paw*.

19 "Whoever therefore breaks just one  
Of the least of these commands done,  
And teaches men so, shall be called  
Least in the heavenly judgement walled,  
But who does and teaches *them*, he  
Shall be called great in the *kingly*  
Courts of heaven. 20 "For I tell you,  
That unless your righteousness grew  
Beyond that of the scribes and yet  
The Pharisees, you won't, *you bet*,  
Come in the kingdom of heaven *met*.

I know not if I have a light to shine,  
It seems to me so many under pine

Think they have faith to share that I must  
hear.

Nobody wants to know my love and fear.  
I have no jot or tittle in the wave  
To change in Decalogue before the grave,  
And anyone can read or hear my hope  
By looking at Your law with telescope.  
Beloved, I teach no one to keep Your law.  
My words fall on the empty air and claw.  
But if someone heard what I have to say,  
They'd know that I'd be great on  
judgement day,

Because I have no truth or word to speak  
Besides the Sinai law at which I peek.

21 "You have heard it said of old time,  
'You shall not kill *for paradigm*,  
The one who kills commits a crime  
In danger of the judgement's *fine*.'

When Peter Chelcicky wrote in his net  
Against the slaughters of the church that set  
Its violence with king to rule the crude,  
He was a Christian pacifist in brood  
Of anarchy. Two virtues he displayed,  
And only missed the Sabbath on parade.  
If he had taken trinity to be  
His pacifism and his anarchy  
United with his Sabbatism found  
Upon the seventh day, I'd raise the sound  
Across the world that he was a true saint.  
Two out of three is not bad without plaint.  
Beloved, look on the hallowed grave with  
grace,  
And raise him up in Sabbath-keeping's  
trace.

22 "But I say to you *in this line*  
The one who's angry with his brother  
Without a cause is like to smother  
In the judgement. The one to say  
To his brother, 'Raca!' *one day*  
Shall be in council chamber's way.  
But whoever says, 'You fool!' shall  
Be in danger of fire of hell.  
23 "Therefore if you should bring your gift  
To the altar, and memory lift  
That your brother's aught against you,  
24 "Leave your gift there before the stew,  
And go your way. First reconciled  
Be to your brother, *like a child*,  
And then come and offer your gift.

25 "Agree with your foe in the way,  
Quickly, lest foe take you in sway  
Of the judge, the judge hand you over  
To the officer *and the drover*,  
And you be thrown in prison's *doom*.  
26 "Truly, I tell you, it will loom  
Over you not to get out from  
There till you've paid last penny's sum.

I understand, Beloved, Your sent one hopes  
The listening crowd upon the disgorged  
slopes

Will understand by these awful words that  
Jesus does not deny the law out flat,  
But lends support to Your word and the  
true.

But at the same time he here seems to make  
The easy difficult for spirit's sake.  
Most men refrain from killing, well  
enough,

But to avoid anger is really tough.  
We can choose not to act on anger, but  
We cannot choose to feel no wrath in gut.  
The sweet Christian, for all the fortitude  
Turns simple law into a lawless feud.  
Actions, not feelings, are the soul's own  
brood.

27 "You've heard that it was said of old  
'You'll not commit adultery *bold*.'

28 "But I say to you that who looks  
At a woman to lust her tooks  
Has committed adultery yet  
With her in his heart, *and you bet*.

29 "If your right eye cause you to sin,  
Pluck it out and give it a spin,  
For it is better for you that  
One of your members perish *drat*,  
Than for your whole body to be  
Cast into hell *eternally*.

30 "And if your right hand make you sin,  
Cut it off and throw in the bin,  
For it is better for you that  
One of your members perish *fat*,  
Than for your whole body to be  
Cast into hell *eternally*.

I beg to differ with the hopeful steer.  
Erection is a sign of healthy gear,  
No sin to be confessed with sigh and tear.  
More than that, as I read the law I see  
That to destroy one's eye or hand must be

Prohibited. What's wrong to perpetrate  
Upon the body of a loyal mate  
Is wrong to stay upon oneself as well.  
I pick these two points and I come to tell  
You that Your grand Messiah fails the test,  
Of both the law and reason with the best.  
All men know that the lust of heart is root  
Of sinful actions in the hidden boot,  
But also that sin happens to invest.

31 "Furthermore it was also said,  
'The one to divorce a wife wed,  
Let him give divorce bill instead,'  
32 "But I tell you the one who does  
Divorce his wife except for cause  
Of uncleanness will make her fall  
Into adultery for thrall,  
And the one who will marry her  
That is divorced will so incur  
Adultery *in his own stall*."

Uncleanness must be defined by the law,  
And that is only at a final straw  
When one discovers that the mate so sweet  
Is too close kin to keep her for a treat.  
If uncleanness were sleeping with the  
neighbour,

The punishment for that is not hard labour  
Or divorce, but death sentence. Read the  
book.

The Christian evangelical forsook  
Both law and gospel when he cried aloud  
Biblical grounds for divorce under cloud.  
The law gives no excuse for such a thing,  
But grudgingly allows divorce in sting  
For those hard-hearted on their way to  
pout.

No Biblical grounds give reason to shout.

33 Again you've heard it has been said  
By those in ancient times once bred,  
'You shall not forswear yourself but  
Make your oaths to the Lord *from gut*.'

34 But I tell you, don't swear at all,  
Not by the sky, for it's God's stall,  
35 Not by the earth, it's His footstool  
Nor by Jerusalem as *cool*,

For it's the great king's city *rule*.  
36 Nor shall you swear by your own head,  
Because you cannot make instead  
One hair white or black *in your dread*.

37 But let the thing you say be yes

Or no, what's more than these is guess  
Of evil *and not your address*.

Though Torah teaches that a man must  
swear,

The good Lord does a good thing in the  
glare

Of swearing's abuse, when he says to tell  
The truth and not falsehood that leads to  
hell.

Intention to deceive by formula  
And patent ways of oath set without awe  
Is punishable by the king at law.

Here Jesus shows authority to state  
The law's intention at the city gate.  
As such he flies in face of reprobate,  
The Pharisaic sop to Roman king,  
The Sadducean confinement to the thing  
Set down in writing. He would keep both of  
The points of faith: law and the royal glove.

38 You've heard it has been said before,  
An eye for eye, and tooth in store  
For tooth. 39 But I say don't resist  
Evil, but who has hit or missed  
You on your right cheek, turn to him  
The other also, *if he's grim*.

40 If anyone takes you to court  
To take away your coat for sport,  
Let him have your shirt-tail as well.  
41 And when one makes you walk a spell  
As far as a mile, don't be short  
But go two miles *not to compel*.  
42 Give to the one who asks of you,  
And do not turn away from view  
Of anyone who borrows too.

A step beyond resistance passive is  
To go a second mile in eager fizz  
Complying with demands oppressors lay  
Upon the backs of hopefuls in the fray.  
It is great form of sabotage of all  
Foremen and factory owners in the stall.  
But I doubt that it helps with central bank  
In private ownership, we've them to thank.  
Resist or not, do good work at the wheel,  
Or sabotage the metal at the heel,  
Nothing avails but violence destroying  
The central banks that overturn employing.  
If I flout pope, he's a saint seen beside  
The board of IMF in brew and bride.

43 You've heard it has been said of late,  
You'll love your neighbour and you'll hate  
Your enemy. 44 But I tell you  
Love your foes and bless who curse you,  
Do good to those that hate you, and  
Pray for those who treat you with hand  
Of spite and persecute you banned.  
45 So you may be the children of  
Your Father in the sky for love;  
For He makes His sun rise upon  
The wicked and the good in spawn,  
And sends rain on the just and on  
The unjust *both at dusk and dawn*.  
46 For if you love those who love you,  
What reward do you have in pew?  
Don't even publicans do that?  
47 And if you greet your brothers fat,  
What's more to you than any cat?  
Don't even publicans do that?  
48 Be perfect then just like your Dad  
In heaven is a perfect lad.

You would have more followers in this  
place

If You just made a difference in the race  
Of righteous and the wicked when You  
trace

The blessings of the sun and rain in space.  
If there were benefit in prayer in fasting  
Beyond the spirit blessing while it's lasting,  
Then for the benefit many would come  
And be perfect as You are in Your sum.  
Beloved, I ask for nothing as my share,  
I fear neither Your hell nor covet fair  
Celestial palaces, white robes to wear.  
I'm satisfied to love You. Let You be  
My lover or my hating enemy.  
It is enough to love You everywhere.

### Matthew 6

1 "Take heed you do not give your alms  
In front of men, or without qualms  
You'll have no reward with your Dad  
In heaven. 2 "Therefore, *as though sad*  
When you give in your charity,  
Don't blow a trumpet for your fee  
As do the hypocrites around  
In synagogues and *on the ground*  
In the streets, so they get the sound  
Of praise from men. Assuredly  
I tell you they have their reward.  
3 "But when you give your alms in board,

Don't let your left hand know what you  
Are doing in your right hand's view.  
4 "So your alms may in secret be  
Seen by your Father who can see  
In secret to come openly  
To reward you *and faithfully*.

The one You sent, Beloved, proclaims a  
faith

Well-pillared, not an unsubstantial wraith.  
The first stone column of that faith is alms  
In charity, in bread beneath the palms.  
The secret gift of fruit and meat without  
A showy proclamation without doubt  
Fulfills that word. So alms remain till now  
The first and boldest pin of righteous vow.  
That man You sent is dear to me and many  
For the fair words he spoke, but is there  
any

So hard to do as this? I feed the poor  
Week after week that seek my door  
obscure,  
And find the morsel laid on other's tongue  
Fed to the blessed Messiah though unsung.

5 "And when you pray you must not be  
Like hypocrites who love to see  
Their prayers standing in synagogues,  
And on street corners *just like dogs*,  
So people see them praying there.  
Truly I tell you that their share  
Of reward is already there.

6 "But you, when you pray go into  
Your bedroom and shut the door too,  
Pray to your Father who's not seen,  
And your Father whose sight is keen  
To see in secret will pay you  
Openly for the thing you do.

7 "So when you pray do not repeat  
Words vainly as in heathen seat,  
For they think that they will be heard  
Because of their abundant word.

8 "Don't be like them, because your Father  
Knows what you need before you *bother*  
To ask Him. 9 "So pray like this *stirred*:  
Our Father in heaven, hallowed be  
Your name. 10 Your kingdom come *to see*  
Your will done on earth as in heaven.  
11 Give us today bread *without leaven*.  
12 And free us of our debt of sin  
As we forgive those who are in  
Such debt to us. 13 And bring us not

Into the trial, but save from plot  
Of evil. For the kingdom *sought*  
Is Yours, the power *over men*,  
And glory for ever. Amen.

14 For if you forgive men their sins  
Your heavenly Father too begins  
To forgive you. 15 But if you don't  
Forgive men their sins, then He won't,  
Your Father won't forgive your sins.

If prayer is meeting You, Beloved, in heart  
Instead of many words, then do Your part  
To build the second pillar of this room  
Messiah grants the world to escape doom.  
Indeed the first concern of prayer is that  
You might forgive the sinner where he's at.  
The only requisite for Your forgiving  
Is that I too forgive the poorly living.  
Much easier, I trow, to trust in crosses  
Than to forgive transgressors and their  
bosses.

But then divine grace granted to us all  
Is infinite or else that grace must fall.  
I enter in the silent house of prayer,  
The inner chamber where the soul must  
dare.

16 Moreover when you fast, don't be  
Like hypocrites with face sadly  
So men will know that they are fasting.  
Truly I tell you their pay's casting.

17 But when you fast anoint your head  
And wash your face, 18 so they're not led  
To think you're fasting before men,  
But to your Father who again  
Is in secret, your Father who  
Sees you in secret will give you  
Open reward *for what you do*.

My secret fast, Beloved, is known to You.  
You follow at a heartbeat what I do.  
At evening when I sip the water and  
Lay date on tongue, I stop to understand  
What fast might bring to mind and bring to  
heart.  
What fast might bring to hand's a higher  
part,  
To feed the hungry's fasting's better start.  
My fast was never planned by Your  
command,  
It was not fabricated legal art,  
But was my rushing past the full fruit stand



Forgetting all else in the busy street  
To greet You, my Belovèd, where we meet  
In unexpected rendez-vous. Forgive  
The unpreparedness in which I live.

20 "But lay up for yourselves in heaven  
Treasures where neither moth nor *leaven*  
*Nor* rust corrupts, and where thieves do  
Not break through to steal revenue,  
21 "For where your treasure is, there too  
Will be your heart. 22 The body's light  
Is the eye, if your eye has sight  
Your whole body is full of light.  
23 "But if your eye is evil, then  
Your whole body is a dark den.  
If then the light in you is dark,  
How great's that darkness *without spark!*  
24 "No man can serve two masters, he  
Will hate the one and love to see  
The other, or else he will hold  
One and the other shut out cold.  
You can't serve God and your greed told.  
25 "That's why I tell you, Take no thought  
For your life, what you'll eat on spot  
Or what you'll drink, or what you'll wear.  
Is not life more than food and share  
Of the body than clothes to wear?  
26 "See how the birds fly in the air,  
They do not sow or reap the bear,  
They don't gather up into barns,  
Yet your heavenly Father by barns  
Feeds them. Are you not better yarns?  
27 Who of you taking thought can add  
One armlength to his height *unclad?*  
28 And why do you consider clothes?  
Consider the lilies *in rows*,  
How they grow without labour and  
Without spinning their clothing planned.  
29 And yet I say to you that even  
Solomon in all unbelieving  
Glory of his was not arrayed  
Like one of these *here on parade*.  
30 So if God dresses up the grass  
Of the field here today to pass  
Tomorrow in the fire, shall He  
Not much more clothe you in degree,  
O you with little faith to see?  
31 "So do not say 'What shall we eat?'  
Or 'What shall we drink *on the street?*'  
Or 'What shall we put on with plea?'  
32 "For all these things the Gentiles seek,  
While your heavenly Father's not weak

To know you need all of these things  
*To keep life in your legs and wings.*

Hypocrisy waylays the soul that strives  
To carry out the divine law, contrives  
In charity both alms and prayer, and  
fasting.

But other dangers block the pilgrim way.  
Excuses for not going out today  
In pilgrimage, endemic are and lasting.  
The economic factor is the first  
Excuse for staying home, if not the worst,  
And followed hard on by security  
Both of the house and store, and vagrancy.  
I who have little faith seek first Your house  
As I depend on living like the mouse  
On lilies of the field without my spinning.  
Perhaps Your pilgrimage will be my  
winning.

33 "But strive first for God's kingdom and  
His righteousness and all this band  
Will be poured on you. 34 "Take no  
thought

About tomorrow, for the lot  
Of the tomorrow will take thought  
Of the things of itself. Enough  
For this day is the bad and tough."

The Decalogue to Moses can be found  
In Exodus, the one on David's ground  
In Psalm fifteen, the third to last appears  
When Christ Messiah had reached thirty  
years.

Beloved, vouchsafe another without tears  
And I in no one else shall slate the sound,  
Forgive impatient waiting on my part,  
Since this last word is sharpened like a  
dart:

Sufficient to each day its evil work.  
Who knows but I in evil do not shirk  
Despite my daily reading of Your word.  
Who knows but that its flight, unlike the  
bird,  
Aspires to no skies met, but's satisfied  
With gates of truth upon an earth descried.

### **Matthew 7**

1 "Judge not, that you may not be judged.  
2 "For with what judgement you fers judge,  
You will be judged not to be budged,  
And by the measure you might fudge,

It will be measured back to you.  
 3 “And why do you look at the clue  
 In your brother’s eye, not regarding  
 The rafter-beam that’s still bombarding  
 Your own eye? 4 “Or how can you say  
 To your brother, ‘Let me remove  
 The speck from your eye’, and approve  
 The beam in your own eye? 5 “For shame!  
 First take away the plank of blame  
 From your own eye, and then you’ll see  
 Clearly to remove what may be  
 The speck in your *dear* brother’s eye.  
 6 “Don’t give what’s holy to the dogs,  
 Nor cast your pearls before the hogs,  
 Lest they trample them *with a cry*  
 Under their feet, and turn and tear  
 You in pieces *there while you swear*.

But who’s to judge who is a dog or hog  
 Before whom I should not speak  
 Decalogue?

I dare not judge a speck for fear of plank,  
 That detriment that blinds religious crank.  
 Commission one to bear a message and  
 He’ll certainly come under tooth and hand  
 Of wolfly dog and every kind of swine.  
 There’s no escaping the effects of wine.  
 The dog and hog betray by bark and smell  
 Their names and their intentions very well.  
 The one can grunt, the other smile and  
 snarl,  
 From meanest magistrate to lordly jarl.  
 That’s why I’m burdened with a slightly  
 care,  
 And sit up in the filth a while to swear.

7 “Ask, and it will be given you,  
 Seek, and you’ll find, knock, and it’s *true*  
 It will be opened for you *too*.  
 8 “For everyone who asks receives,  
 And he who seeks finds *sheaves and*  
*beeves*,  
 And to him who knocks it’s unlocked.  
 9 “Or what man is there who unblocked  
 Among you, if his son asks bread,  
 Will give him a *hard* stone *instead*?  
 10 “Or if he asks a fish *of you*,  
 Will give a serpent *to make do*?  
 11 “If you then, being evil, know  
 How on your children gifts bestow  
 In goodness, how much more will your  
 Father who is at heaven’s *door*

Give good things to the ones who ask!

It’s not my lack of faith that makes me ask  
 You naught, Beloved. I have my heavenly  
 flask.

My satisfaction in my house and gear,  
 And in my status and my lack of fear,  
 Is what makes my fasting prayers oft  
 appear

Deficient in petition where I wait.  
 The second p of plaint is also state  
 That finds little room in my prayers of late.  
 Of four p’s I have mostly praise and  
 penance

To make half the store of most of Your  
 tenants.

Though I give only half of what’s Your  
 due,

I still enjoy the softness of Your pew,  
 And all the fish and bread and stones You  
 give,

And that there are no serpents where I live.

12 “Therefore, whatever you want men  
 To do to you, do so again  
 To them, for this becomes the law  
 And the prophets *when held in awe*.

13 “Enter in by the narrow gate,  
 For wide’s the gate, and broad *estate*  
 The way that leads down to destruction,  
 And many go in by its suction.

14 “Because the gate *is* narrow and  
 Restricted *is* the way *to stand*  
 Which leads to life, and there are few  
 Who find it *in the things they do*.

The harsh restrictions mentioned by Christ  
 here

That make the narrow gate a gate of fear  
 Are not the many actions and remote  
 Of saintly church-goers who do by rote  
 According to the expectations’ note.  
 The harsh restrictions mentioned here are  
 quite

Simply and clearly brought up to the light  
 In saying do to others as you would  
 That others did to you and when they  
 could.

Your genius can reduce the law at once  
 To one rule comprehended by a dunce,  
 But hardly fit for those with self-esteem  
 To guide them to ambition’s higher dream.

The others have to wait and bear the brunts.

15 "Beware of false prophets, who come  
In sheep's clothing, but meddlesome  
Inside like wolves ranging for prey.

16 "You will know them by their fruits'  
sway.

Do men gather grapes from thorn bushes  
Or figs from thistles *in their pushes?*

17 "Even so, every good tree bears  
Good fruit, but a bad tree ensnares  
With bad fruit. 18 "A good tree cannot  
Bear bad fruit, nor *can* one with blot  
Bear good fruit. 19 "Every tree that does  
Not bear good fruit's cut down *that was*  
And thrown into the fire. 20 "Therefore  
By their fruits you will know their score.

Unless we rehabilitate the one  
Reported to have betrayed Your own son,  
He lacks one of the twelve fruits in his  
store

To prove him not a false prophet and more.

Accepting that Judas was not the fiend  
That anti-Semites have so long opined,  
I move on to the prophet that's to come  
To number his own fruits' compendium,  
And find their number one by one in store  
To make up twelve from Ali to the door  
Of the steed that in secret way upbore  
The Master of the Age to a new shore.

The prophecies, Beloved, count and  
recount

While I turn my eyes toward that ranging  
mount.

21 "Not everyone who says to me,  
'Lord, Lord,' shall enter in the spree  
Of heaven's kingdom, but he who  
Does my Father's will in heaven's *due*.

22 "Many will say to me that day,  
'Lord, Lord, have we not come to say  
Prophecies in your name, and in  
Your name cast out devils *of sin*,  
And in your name miracles win?"

23 "And then I shall declare to them,  
'I never knew your stratagem.  
Get out, you workers of such sin."

24 "That's why whomever hears this word  
Of mine and does as he had heard,  
I will compare to a wise man  
Who built his house on a rock's *plan*.

25 "The rain came down, the floods came  
up,

The winds blew and beat *like a tup*  
On that house but it did not fall,  
Since the strong rock bore up its wall.

26 "And everyone who hears this thing  
I say and does not bellowing

Do as I say, is one just like  
A foolish man who made his strike  
To build his house upon the sand,  
27 "The rain came down, the floods arose,  
The winds blew and beat in their throes  
Upon that house and it fell down  
With a great fall, *one of renown*."

28 It happened when Jesus had done  
With these sayings the folk were spun  
Astonished at his teachings *won*.

29 For he taught them as one who had  
The power to cleave the good from bad,  
And not as the scribes *followed fad*.

The wise man builds his house upon the  
rock

Was good advice from one who ought to  
know

For having built beside both fell and loch  
Before his call to serve the Manito.

So carpentry is something he's got pat,  
A job to fall back on in case of famine  
Or rabbis' monthly wages falling flat.  
There is one thing I'd like him to examine  
In one mess I have made in floor and wall  
When I installed a sauna in the attic.

I only left a little leak. That's all  
It took to make my downstairs rooms  
aquatic.

In Edinburgh they make every house  
Of sandstone. It's combine or learn to  
dowse.

## Matthew 8

1 When he had come down from the  
mount,

Great multitudes *on his account*  
Followed him. 2 And indeed, there came  
A leper, bowed down to exclaim  
Before him, saying, "Lord, if You  
Are willing, You can make me clean."

3 Then Jesus put out *his* hand to  
Touch him, saying, "I really do,  
Be cleansed." Immediately was seen  
His leprosy was wholly clean.

4 And Jesus said to him, "Don't tell  
Anyone *who has made you well*,  
But go your way, show yourself to  
The priest, and offer the gift due  
That Moses has commanded you,  
As a witness to them *that's true*."

The one You sent, Beloved, may well cure  
all

Diseases that come in his way, the tall,  
The short, the cripple Jew, Samaritan,  
The old, the young, the poor, the leper man,  
But even he respects it seems the priest  
And social order. All from great to least  
Must bow to human myth of what is right  
And proper. Sometimes though I think in  
spite

It's better to ignore the common mores  
Of clean-unclean, the statutes and the  
scores

Of regulations that protect the dreams  
Of those who will not wake from that  
which seems,

And flouting all but futile time and space  
Tear down the veils and stand before Your  
face.

5 Now when Jesus came to the city  
Of Capernaum, came pleading pity  
From him, certain centurion came

6 Saying, "Lord, my servant *is lame*  
Lying at home *and* paralysed,  
In dreadful torment *agonized*."

7 And Jesus said to him, "I will  
Come and heal him *from being ill*."

8 Centurion answered and said, "Lord,  
I am not worthy you *adored*

Should come under my roof, but just  
Speak a word, and my servant must

Be healed. 9 "For I'm also a man  
Under authority, and can

Command the soldiers under me.  
And I say to this *one*, 'Go see,'

And he goes, to another, 'Come,'  
And he comes *never troublesome*,

And to my servant, 'Do this,' and  
He does *it just as I command*."

10 When Jesus heard, he marvelled, and  
Said to those who followed, "Truly,

I say to you, I do not see  
Such great faith, not even to be

In Israel! 11 "And I say to you

That many will come, *not a few*,  
From east and west, and sit down where  
Abraham, Isaac, Jacob share  
In the kingdom of heaven there.

12 "But the sons of the kingdom will  
Be cast out in outer dark *'s ill*.

There'll be weeping, gnashing teeth *there*."

13 Then Jesus said *without a care*

To the centurion, "Go your way,

And as you have believed *today*,

Let it be done for you *in power*."

His servant was healed that same hour.

Beloved, make me like pagan men and not  
Like true bred and righteous men who've  
been taught

To keep Your law as though it were pretext  
For non-existent God. I say what next?

The heathen knows Your will. Then make  
me so.

I shall be heathen too, I shall and know

That all things in creation jump to true  
Obedience, the natural thing to do.

Let me not stop to find the sense of law

Through logic or through likeness, but let  
awe

Alone teach me to run. I turn my back

On scholar, Mishna, resala, all lack

The spontaneity of truth. Your word

Suffices me that rules the beast and bird.

Who came to sit with Isaac, Abraham

Were not supposed descendants of the ram.

Those who were sons were put out in the  
dark.

It makes me wonder what's a son and  
shark.

It seems the sons or descendants are turned

Into sharks and into things to be burned,

While those who're not take the sons' place  
to be

Sons descending from Your eternity.

Son is a word not always made to fit

The siring and the bearing, gyp and kit.

Sometimes it means the one who takes the  
load

And bore the name and fame in what he  
showed

To be his true desire despite his birth.

To be such son of God's a thing of worth.

14 When Jesus came to Peter's home

He saw his wife's mother in foam  
 Of fever. 15 When he touched her hand  
 The fever left her by command,  
 And she got up and served them food.  
 16 When nightfall arrived *and its mood*  
 They brought him those who were  
     possessed  
 With devils, and he threw distressed  
 Spirits out with a word and healed  
 All who had illness *unconcealed*,  
 17 So that the thing might once come true  
 That was spoken by prophet due,  
 Isaiah saying "He took on  
 Our weakness and illnesses drawn."  
 18 When Jesus saw the multitudes  
 Around him, he ordered his dudes  
 To set off for the other side.  
 19 And a certain scribe came *wide-eyed*  
 And told him, "Master, I will come  
 After you wherever you *hum*."  
 20 And Jesus told him, "Foxes have  
 Dens and the birds in the sky have  
 Nests, but the Son of man does not  
 Have where to lay his head *on plot*."  
 21 Another follower came by  
 And said to him, "Sir, let this guy  
 Go first to lay his dad in tomb."  
 22 But Jesus told him, "Let their doom  
 Fall on the dead and let bury  
 The dead themselves, but follow me."  
  
 The reason why the spiritual and fine  
 Find it so difficult to stay and dine  
 With those You send, or follow in their  
     stead  
 Yourself, is just that You and they've no  
     bed  
 Nor dining table laid with luscious things.  
 That's why instead they follow priests and  
     kings,  
 And corporate executives. The hole  
 Of fox and nest of bird, though on the dole,  
 Is better stirred to give the proper props.  
 Who follows You and Your sent prophets  
     drops  
 Into the nothingness of faith. His mosque  
 Is bare the ground and blue the sky and  
     bosk  
 Of oak or pine upon the hill. I've stepped  
 Out in this empty gallows floor and swept.  
  
 23 Now when he got into a boat,

His disciples followed to float.  
 24 And all at once a great storm came  
 Upon the sea, the boat was *lame*,  
 Covered with waves, while he just slept.  
 25 And his disciples came *and crept*  
*Up to him* and awoke him, crying,  
 "Lord, save us! For we *all* are dying!"  
 26 But he said to them, "Why be scared,  
 O you with little faith *prepared?*"  
 Then he got up, chided the wind  
 And the sea, and great calm was finned.  
 27 So the men marvelled, and they said  
 "Who is this man that winds are led  
 To obey him, and the sea-bed?"  
  
 No man has such a conscience that he  
     sleeps  
 On rough boards at the bottom boat that  
     keeps  
 On sending water up and down to soak  
 The sleeve and dress. I say, I'd have  
     awoke.  
 The storm within my head alone makes  
     brief  
 The little hours of sleep by trunk and leaf.  
 The one You sent had faith to slumber or  
 Was tired from healing people on the shore.  
 Might he wake once again to still my life,  
 The storm that strikes my peace with  
     foolish strife.  
 And I shall listen never more to flood,  
 Nor wind nor sound, nor scurry to the  
     blood  
 That every man thinks remedies the wrong.  
 Recite Your name, a lullaby in song.  
  
 28 And when he arrived over there  
 In the land the Gergesenes share,  
 He met two possessed in their fate  
 With devils coming from the gate  
 Of the tombs, very fierce so that  
 No one could pass by where they sat.  
 29 See how they shouted, saying "What  
 Do you want with us, Jesus cut  
 Out Son of God? Have you come here  
 To torment us before the fear  
 Of our time?" 30 In the distance grazed  
 A herd of many pigs *unfazed*.  
 31 So the devils begged him and said  
 "If you throw us out, let us led  
 Go into the herd of those pigs."  
 32 And he said to them *in their digs*,

“Go then.” And when they had come out,  
 They went in to the herd in rout  
 Of porkers and see the whole herd  
 Of pigs ran faster *than false word*  
 Down the embankment to the sea  
 And drowned in the waters *sadly*.  
 33 And those who kept them fled and went  
 By every path from the town bent,  
 And told everything that occurred,  
 What happened not only to herd  
 But to the devil possessed *bird*.  
 34 See then the whole town came to meet  
 Jesus and when they came to greet  
 They begged him to depart their street.

If You send any man, a prophet or  
 Divine guide to illumine this human store,  
 I warn You, my Beloved, we have our  
     ways,  
 We have our swine to care for on still days.  
 If You should cast away the things that  
     plague  
 And devil sweet society, I beg  
 That You remember with such also go  
 The lovely swine that grace our tables,  
     show  
 The world that we are people well refined.  
 If You should wake those raging or  
     reclined  
 Among the tombs to live in view of truth,  
 They would arise, I tell You in all ruth,  
 Entreating You to go away. Let lie  
 The sleeping swine, Beloved, let lie and  
     die.

### Matthew 9

1 So he got in a boat, *and* crossed  
 Over, and came to his own place.  
 2 Then indeed, they brought him a *lost*  
 One paralysed *and in disgrace*  
 And lying on a bed. But when  
 Jesus saw the faith *of the men*,  
 He said to the paralytic,  
 “Son, be happy, *though you are sick*,  
 Your sins are *all* forgiven you.”  
 3 At once some of the scribes, a few,  
 Said to themselves, “This man  
     blasphemes!”  
 4 But Jesus, knowing their thoughts, seems  
 To say “Why do you in your hearts  
 Think evil? 5 “For which *of two parts*  
 Is easier, to say, ‘Your sins

Are all forgiven you *in bins*,’  
 Or to say, ‘Man, arise and walk’?  
 6 “But that you may know *while you talk*  
 The son of man has power on earth  
 To forgive sins *for what they’re worth*”  
 He told the paralytic, “Rise,  
 Take up your bed, and, *being wise*,  
 Go to your house.” 7 And he arose  
 And, departing, to his house goes.  
 8 Now when the multitudes saw *it*,  
 They marvelled *like to have a fit*  
 And glorified God, who had given  
 Such power to men *to love and live in*.

Beloved, Your sent one made the point that  
     he  
 Had power from You to set the cripple free  
 Not only of fleshly infirmity  
 But from his sins. The noble Pharisee  
 Said in his heart that this was blasphemy.  
 The Pharisee is not so bad, you see,  
 As Christians sweetly claim that he must  
     be.  
 It was not wickedness but jealousy  
 Another rabbi had the power to see  
 Beyond the limits of orthodoxy.  
 He wanted at the least democracy  
 Within rabbinical academy,  
 Instead of guidance by divine proxy  
 Established by You for eternity.

9 As Jesus went away from there,  
 He saw a man named Matthew share  
 His seat with the tax booth, and said  
 To him, “Follow me,” and as led  
 He got up and following sped.  
 10 It so occurred as Jesus sat  
 Eating in the house *without hat*,  
 Many tax gatherers as well  
 As sinners came to sit a spell,  
 With him and his followers *chat*.  
 11 And when the Pharisees saw that,  
 They said to his followers flat,  
 “Why does you Master eat with those  
 Tax collectors and sinners *pose*?”  
 12 When Jesus heard that, he told them,  
 “The well don’t need a doctor’s hem,  
 But those who’re ill *not to contemn*.”  
 13 But go and meditate the word  
 And find what it means when it’s heard,  
 ‘I shall have mercy and not *herd*  
*In sacrifice*,’ for I have come

Not to call the righteous, but bum  
And sinners to repentance' hum."

They will accuse, Beloved, the one You  
sent  
That he takes no regard of what is meant  
By word against pollution, and he sits  
To eat with unclean men. Commandment  
splits  
Mankind into the clean and unclean camps.  
Your sent one lights at last the fading  
lamps  
Of equal standing for all humankind  
Before Your face, Beloved, so those who  
mind  
Even today that some are clean and some  
Are physically polluted by their rum  
And by their birth, are simply incorrect.  
Divine verdict has not come to select  
Men by the virtue of ablutions but  
By their power to crack the mystic nut.

What does this braver text your sent one  
quotes  
Mean in Your own sermon and study  
notes?  
You'd rather have mercy than sacrifice.  
Indeed, mercy's not over common price.  
The church and temple meet the eager  
crowd  
With lifted chalice filled with blood  
allowed  
And say that without sacrifice there's none  
Forgiveness of the evil things we've done.  
And here the very sacrifice himself  
Sets sacrifice upon forsaken shelf  
And claims Your mercy's big enough and  
free  
To set all tax collectors, sinners free.  
I would have believed Your word for the  
latter,  
But tax collectors are another matter.

14 Then the disciples of John came  
To him, saying "Why do for blame,  
We and the Pharisees fast oft,  
But Your disciples are too soft  
To fast?" 15 And Jesus said to them,  
"Can the sons of bride-chamber's gem  
Mourn as long as bridegroom's with them?  
But the days will come when bridegroom  
Will be taken out of the room,

And then they will fast *for their doom*.

16 "No one puts a piece of unshrunk  
Cloth on an old garment *caplunk*,  
For such a patch will pull away  
From the clothing, and the tear's way  
Made worse. 17 "Nor do they put new  
grape  
Juice into old wineskins *to scrape*,  
Or else the wineskins will explode,  
And the grape juice will spill its load,  
And the wineskins be spoiled to boot.  
But they put new grape juice in chute  
Of new wineskins, and both salute."

The Pharisees and John's disciples fasted  
On Mondays and on Thursdays while they  
lasted.

The followers of Jesus also kept  
The fast in solitude while others wept  
In public for acclaim. They were not found  
On weekdays designated round and round,  
But fasted on command of their dear Lord.  
The fast is valid when one can afford  
A divine guide to say the time to do.  
The Decalogue and Torah say what's true  
But give no time for fasting. That is done  
Through every prophet and his guided son.  
Let me too fast so that no man can know  
The when and where I let my idols go.

The sons of the bride-chamber were not  
born  
From the paunch of the bride-chamber  
forlorn

Which has no flesh nor blood nor tongue  
and groove,  
But only walls and laces, loves to prove.  
The sons of the bride-chamber are not  
brothers,  
And all of them have different fathers,  
mothers.

The sons of the bride-chamber, friends of  
bride  
And companions of groom, each chooses  
side.

How often the word son has naught to say  
About the siring and begetting day.  
How strange that Son of God must  
therefore be

Of one and same substance, divinity,  
When son of the bride-chamber is not made  
Of wood and stone, of lace or lemonade.

18 While he was talking, see, there came  
A certain ruler without blame  
Bowing down to him saying then,  
“My daughter’s even now dead, when  
You come and lay your hand on her  
She’ll be alive, it can occur.”

19 Jesus got up and followed him  
And so did his disciples *grim*.

20 And see, a woman who was ill  
With haemorrhage and bleeding still  
For twelve years, came behind to touch  
The fringes of his cloak *as much*.

21 She told herself, “If I can just  
Touch his cloak, I’ll be well and must.”

22 But Jesus turned around and when  
He saw her, he said “Daughter, then  
Take comfort, your faith’s made you well.”  
And the woman the truth to tell  
Was well from that moment again.

I come, Beloved, on this day long removed  
And like the woman who was not reproved  
For touching holy men, though full unclean  
With bloody issue, deed done though  
unseen,

I come to touch the blue-fringed seamless  
cloak

That lawfully wrapped round the one who  
spoke

In that law’s name that mandates sacrifice  
And purity, and all things that suffice.  
I touch the one You sent and I am whole,  
Cleansed from my ostracism and the role  
A righteous world would cast on me. I try  
To slip away unseen by holy eye  
And by the proud and wealthy who despise  
The likes of me. You raise me to the skies.

23 And coming in the ruler’s house,  
Jesus saw musicians to grieve,  
And people making noise to drowse.

24 He told them, “Get out of the way,  
For the young lady’s not in sway  
Of death but only sleeps today.”

And they laughed and made fun of him.

25 But when the folk were out and trim,  
He went in, took her by the hand  
And the young lady rose to stand.

26 The fame spread throughout all the land.

Who am asleep in all I think to do.

Let him ignore the laughter of the great  
And well-dressed patrons of the church and  
state.

I wait. Though I am dead in every eye  
That turns toward the lofty and the sky,  
And merely of the earth, the soil and sand,  
I swear I only sleep awaiting hand  
With Your mandate, Beloved, I cast off all  
Those claiming insight and the divine call.  
I wait as dead to all the pomp and gold  
That draws the crowds to Sufi and to bold.  
I take the hand alone of prophet, guide,  
And live to You, Beloved, all men aside.

27 When Jesus had gone out from there,  
Two blind men followed him with blare  
Saying “Son of David, have pity.”

28 When he entered the house and city,  
The blind men came to him and he,  
Jesus, said to them, “Can it be  
That you believe I can do this?”

They told him, “Sir, you cannot miss.”

29 Then he touched their eyes, said “Let be  
According to your faith to see.”

30 And their eyes opened; Jesus charged  
Them directly, said and enlarged,  
“Don’t let anyone know, agree.”

31 But when they left they spread the word,  
His fame in all that country stirred.

The Son of David comes and even blind  
Men come to beg his mercy and to find  
The balm and healing that name must  
assure.

In David’s name I too look to the pure  
And mighty power that You, Beloved, send  
down

Upon the humble dervish without crown.  
You open eyes and I find that I see,  
Although none knew my blindness  
formerly,

And this sight seems but blindness to the  
best

And wise on earth. I turn to east and west  
And see, no longer blind, that You are  
there,

Invisible no longer but laid bare  
In every light and shade, in every tree  
Where magpie hops to cling there clumsily.

Let that one that You sent take my hand too 32 On going out, see, they brought him



A man who could not speak and dim  
Possessed with a devil *for trim*.

33 And when the devil was cast out,  
The dumb man spoke. The crowds in doubt  
Were surprised and they said "Such things  
Were never seen in Israel's *springs*."

34 But Pharisees said "He casts out  
Devils through prince of devils' *spout*."

35 And Jesus went through all the towns  
And villages teaching the clowns  
In synagogues and preaching there  
The good news of the kingdom's share,  
And healing every sickness and  
Every disease among the band.

36 But when he saw the multitudes,  
He was moved with pity on broods,  
Because they fainted, scattered out  
As sheep with no shepherd about.

37 He said to his disciples then,  
"The harvest truly's great of *men*,  
But labourers are few, 38 so pray  
The Lord of harvest that He may  
Send workers in His harvest day."

With every two bit clown the word goes  
out

That nothing like this ever was about.

And always there are those to wring their  
hands

Or point out theological demands.

I flee to You, Beloved, from human doubt

As well as human weakness to the spout

Of trickster rhetoric. I flee to You,

Who have alone the source of all that's  
true.

Let me not flail the windmills nor accept  
The popular and sweet. Enough I've wept.

I flee to the compassion that You gave  
To prophet, guided one, and divine slave.

I pray that workers to Your harvest might  
Bring in the bread of corn before the night.

### Matthew 10

1 When he had summoned him his twelve  
Disciples, he gave power to delve  
Against unclean spirits, to cast  
Them out, and heal all sorts in blast  
Of illness and infirmity.

2 And the names of the twelve in fee,  
The twelve apostles here are these:  
The first, Simon called Peter too,  
And Andrew his brother in crew,

And James the son of Zebedee's,  
And John his brother who agrees,  
3 Then Philip, and Bartholomew;

Thomas, Matthew the publican;  
James son of Alphaeus, and man  
Lebbaeus, whose surname to scan  
Was Thaddaeus; 4 Simon in store  
The Canaanite, and then one more  
Judas Iscariot, betrayer.

5 These twelve Jesus sent out waylayer  
Commanding them and as he said  
"Don't go the way the Gentiles tread,  
Or enter Samaritan bed.

6 "But go instead to the lost sheep  
Of Israel's house and Israel's keep.

7 "And where you go to preach and stand  
Say 'Heaven's kingdom is at hand.'

The message is a good one, I too swear,  
To think that David's throne, eternal share,  
Is close to being raised once more upon  
A dark world long awaiting heaven's dawn.  
The truth is that usurpers still appear  
And find a following of love and fear.

Beloved, I trust the Saviour's golden word  
And step out of the bleating, awful herd,  
And bow to You alone. I'm not deterred  
That few find David's star, the sceptre  
raised

Upon a world where only You are praised.

The kingdom is at hand, so be it late

Or soon if ever at the folding gate,

I enter now, confess one king in rate.

8 "So heal the sick, the lepers too,  
And raise the dead, cast out the crew  
Of devils; freely you received,

So freely give. 9 Provide no gold  
Nor silver, nor brass of deceived

In your purse, 10 no itinerary,  
No extra coat, nor sticks to hold,  
For every workman can make merry  
With food as his pay for his work.

11 In every city do not shirk  
To ask who's honest there, and go  
And stay with him till end of row.

12 When you come in a house, then greet.

13 And if the house is worthy, meet,

Let your peace come upon it neat:

But if it is not worthy, let

Your peace return to you to set.

14 Whoever does not receive you

Or hear the things that you say true,  
When you leave that house or that town,  
Shake the dust from your feet with frown.  
15 Truly I tell you, it will be  
Easier for Sodom to see  
Gomorrah on the judgement day,  
Than for that city in the way.

Beloved, you should have had Your Christ  
give out  
At least something for sale. The meagre  
shout

Of Gospel that the kingdom's almost here  
Is not enough to pay for time and gear.  
But then I guess in those days things for  
sale

Were far less varied than the modern tale.  
Today a man can buy just anything  
That can be made to shift a sound and sing.  
Beloved, You might have had the men  
perform

A dervish trick or two to keep them warm  
On nights when no house opened to their  
view.

To send them with a story and a hand  
To heal if any came to understand  
Their trick was rather negligent of You.

16 See, I send you as sheep out in  
The middle of the wolves *in din*,  
So be as cunning as a snake,  
And harmless as a dove *awake*.  
17 Watch out for men, for they will take  
You into court, and they will beat  
You in the synagogues *with heat*.  
18 You'll be brought in to governors  
And kings for my sake and my stores  
Of witness against them as well,  
Both Gentiles *and to Israel*.

19 But when they bring you up, do not  
Plan what or how to answer aught,  
For it will be given to you  
On the spot what you should say true.  
20 For the one that speaks is not you,  
But spirit of your Father who  
Comes down again to speak in you.

I've never yet been brought in to confess  
Before interrogators of address.  
But since I do not trust the central bank,  
The ones controlling presidents in flank

And Baptist churches where they come to  
wank,  
No doubt my peace till now is simply by  
The fact I stay at home and do not fly.  
The airport is a dangerous place where  
They pick up innocent folk on the stair  
And torture them to reveal how they think  
That terrorists should be held on the brink.  
I have no plan or excuse what to say  
For having not dropped bombs out of the  
way.  
Give me the speech Christ promised on that  
day.

21 The brother will betray his own  
Brother to death, the father stone  
His own child and the children rise  
Against their parents *in surprise*  
And have them sentenced *all* to death.  
23 But when they persecute you here  
In this city, flee without fear  
Into another, for I say  
The truth to you, you will not stay  
In all of Israel's towns a day  
Till Son of man come back *to play*.  
24 The student's not above his teacher,  
Nor servant above master preacher.  
25 It is enough for student that  
He is like his teacher who sat,  
And servant to be like his master.  
If they have called the very master  
Of the house Beelzebub, then faster  
Will they call those still on his mat.  
26 So do not be afraid of them.  
There's nothing hidden in the hem  
That shall not be revealed *pro tem*,  
Nothing but shall be brought to light.  
27 What I tell you in darkness now,  
Speak in the light, *write on the brow*.  
What's heard *in whispers* in the ear,  
Preach on the housetops *without fear*.  
28 And do not be afraid of those  
Who kill the body *as it grows*,  
But cannot kill the soul, instead  
Fear Him who can destroy both *led*,  
The soul and body in hell's *bed*.

Beloved, I love or think I love You now,  
But fear is often far off, I allow.  
I'm more prone to fear what the people  
think  
About me tottering upon the brink

Of their destruction, than I fear what You,  
Belovèd, think of what I say and I do.  
Illusion is the way of life on earth.  
Try it sometime and see how far You're  
worth.

It would be a good exercise to wait  
Reciting the big ten and not be late  
To know that I shall be judged now today  
And always by the very things they say.  
Kill if You must both body and the soul,  
But keep me in the path of Your law's goal.

29 Two sparrows are sold for a penny,  
Yet not one of them shall take any  
Fall on the ground without the sight  
Of your Father knowing its plight.  
30 But even the hairs on your head  
Are counted *and in His mind read*.  
31 So do not be afraid, for you  
Are worth more than a sparrows' crew.

My New Age sensibilities awake  
To think that Your sent one made some  
mistake  
When he said that the folk were of more  
worth  
Than many sparrows flying on the earth.  
It's just an ethnocentric conceit  
That a man is better than those you meet  
A-scratching on the forest floor or yet  
A-flying from the branches that are set  
With needles new or leaves full-fleshed and  
met.

There are things in some birds superior  
To human capabilities in store.  
The only reason I see that we think  
We're better is because the missing link  
Assures us Your image in us will kink.

32 So whoever shall confess me  
In front of friend and family,  
I will also confess before  
My Father on the heavenly *shore*.  
33 But whoever shall deny me  
Before his own fraternity,  
I'll also deny before my  
Father who is up in the sky.  
34 Don't think that I have come to send  
Islam (peace) upon the earth *to bend*,  
I have not come to send out peace,  
But rather a sword to release.  
35 For I have come to set a man

Against his own father and scan  
Of daughter against her own mum,  
Not to mention son's wife to come  
Against her mum-in-law *to hum*.  
35 And a man's foes shall be those of  
His own household, *those held in love*.  
37 The one that loves his mum and dad  
More than me is not worth a tad  
To me, and the one that loves son  
Or daughter more than me *when done*  
Is not worthy to kiss my bun.

Islam came in with claims of peace  
allowed,  
Intending to meet Jew and Christian crowd  
With its proposal of fair unity  
In Abrahamic faith for all to see.  
The trial was adept, but in the end  
The empires that arose by foe and friend  
Set violence in families and in  
The populations setting out to win.  
True, Islam is not quite so violent  
As Christianity has given vent,  
If only in the conquest of Mexique.  
But violence is violence in pique  
Or in restraint. The civilized in mode  
May even be worse than simple ox goad.

38 The one that does not take his cross  
And follow me's not worth a toss.  
39 The one that finds his life shall lose,  
And the one that his life refuse  
For my sake shall find it no loss.  
40 The one who takes you in takes me,  
And the one who will receive me  
Receives the One who sent me *free*.  
41 The one who takes a prophet in  
In the name of a prophet's win  
Shall get a prophet's reward's din.  
And the one who receives a man  
Who's righteous in the name and plan  
Of a righteous man shall receive  
A righteous man's reward's reprieve.  
42 Whoever gives a drink to one  
Of these wee folk a cup unspun  
Of cold water in just the name  
Of a disciple for his claim,  
I tell you truly he shall not  
Lose his reward upon the spot.

This variation on Rabbinic theme

That he who saves one man save the whole  
dream  
Is finely wrought. I like the bit about  
The water for the wee one at the spout.  
The gift of nourishment and life is sent  
From man to child, from mother to prevent  
The end of human life. So to present  
A bit of bread and water in the cup  
Is to give the Creator what to sup.  
Beloved, enter and eat a meal with me,  
And feed me from abundance of Your  
spree  
Until I learn to share eternity,  
The crust, the grape juice, and the lack of  
thorn  
Upon the rose where Your good faith is  
born.

### Matthew 11

1 It happened when Jesus had ended  
Commanding his twelve men well-fended,  
He left that place to go and teach  
In their cities as well as preach.  
2 But when John had in prison heard  
The deeds of Christ, he then sent word  
By two of his followers *stirred*.  
3 They said to him "Are you the one  
Who should come or should we begun  
Start looking for another *son*?"  
4 Jesus answered and he told them,  
"Go tell John again what in gem  
You hear and see come *from my hem*.  
5 "The blind receive their sight, the lame  
Walk, and lepers are cleansed from blame,  
And the deaf hear, the dead are raised,  
And the poor at last are amazed  
To have the good news preached to them.

If what you mean by gospel's what is sold  
Today in churchly places by the bold  
To take collections and pass round the plate  
Or leather bag, depending on the state,  
Then I'd much rather not be poor to hear  
The gospel with its jerk of knee and tear.  
The good news I'd consider a sound sign  
That Jesus was sent by You to assign  
Him a place among prophet and sure guide,  
Would be that You at last are on the side  
Of the oppressed and poor, whose wealth  
was taken  
By the colonials, ships' sails out-shaken,

And by their off-spring with a deal fast  
sealed  
For corporate oil to the finely healed.

6 "And happy is whoever's not  
Offended in me and my lot."  
7 As they went off Jesus began  
To tell the crowd about the man  
John, saying "What did you go out  
Into the desert to find out?  
A reed blown in the wind unstout?  
8 "But what did you go out to see?  
A man dressed in new fashionry?  
See, those who use designer clothes  
Are in kings' houses and such shows.  
9 "But what did you go out to see?  
A prophet? Yes, I tell you free  
More than a prophet. 10 "This is he  
Of whom it was written, 'Now see,  
I send My messenger before  
Your face to prepare what's in store  
For you.' 11 Truly I say to you,  
'Among those born of women too  
There has not risen prophet greater  
Than John the Baptist, no, not satyr.  
Yet he that is heaven's kingdom's least  
Is greater than he is increased.  
12 'And from the days of John the Baptist  
Until now heaven's kingdom's wrapped us  
In violence, and so such take  
The kingdom by force and its sake.  
13 'For all the prophets and the law  
Prophesied until John in paw.  
14 'And if you can receive the word,  
He is Elijah once conferred  
To come. 15 'Who has ears to hear, let  
Him hear. 16 'What simile can get  
The likeness of this generation?  
It's like children sitting in station  
And shouting to their mates a ration,  
17 "We played our whistles for you and  
You did not dance to hear the band,  
We sang laments for you, but you  
Did not start to weep as was due."

John says himself that he is not the one,  
Elijah promised to come on the run.  
Was that just modesty (perhaps it was),  
Or ignorance on his part and his paws?  
Or did he really think the flesh and blood  
Of good Elijah would come pluck the bud?  
Christ's words deny the coming of the true,

And yet Elijah himself came in view  
And vision in transfiguration's pew.  
The spiritualizing of Scripture tells  
A tale of foe in exegetic woe.  
Keep me, Beloved, from spiritualizing hells  
And I shall peacefully hoe out my row  
Until reality takes all the show.

18 'For John did not come with the feast  
Of food and drink and joy increased,  
And they say "He's possessed, the fool."  
19 'The son of man came to the pool  
Eating and drinking, and they say  
"See the man's gluttonous, his way  
Is like the wino's, he's a friend  
Of tax collectors *on the mend*  
And sinners." But wisdom's seen right  
By those who follow her in sight."  
20 Then he began to curse each town  
Where he had done deeds of renown,  
Because they did not repent then.  
21 "Woe to you, Chorazin! Woe men  
Of Bethsaida! for if the great  
Deeds done in you had found their mate  
In Tyre and Sidon, they'd have done  
Penance long ago under sun  
In sackcloth and ashes *to run*.  
22 "But I tell you that it shall be  
Better for Tyre and Sidon, *see*,  
On judgement day than for your plea.  
23 "And you, Capernaum, who are  
Proud up to heaven, shall fall like star  
Down to hell, for if deeds so great  
As have been done in you of late  
Had been done in Sodom, today  
It would be standing in its way.  
24 "But I tell you that it shall be  
Better for Sodom's land and tree  
On judgement day than for your plea."

The best thing Christ did in his time was  
    curse  
The towns that did not repent of the worse  
After he'd planted miracles in them.  
The best thing Christ did on earth is  
    condemn.  
The best thing Christ did when he saw the  
    crowd  
Was flee across the sea under a cloud.  
The multitude is death among the proud  
To prophets and to healers in their hem.  
Beloved, I turn to You for mercy's sake,

And not to Your sent and condemned in  
    wake.  
I pity him and love, he knew the stake.  
Beloved, I turn to You alone for grace,  
Despite the wonder of the Christ child's  
    face,  
The naked sore attracting tooth and mace.

25 At that time Jesus answered, said  
"I thank you, Father, Lord of spread  
Out heaven and earth, because You hid  
This things from the wise and smart lid  
And showed them to mere babes You bid.  
26 "Just so then, Father, for it seemed  
Good in Your sight it would be deemed."  
27 All things are given over to  
Me by my Father, no man true  
Knows the son, but the Father does.  
Nor none know what the Father was  
Except the son, and the one to  
Who the Son will reveal the true.  
28 Come to me, all who work and go  
Beneath a heavy burden's show,  
And I will give you rest below.  
29 Take my yoke on you, learn from me.  
For I am meek with heart truly  
Humble, and you'll find your souls rest.  
30 For my yoke's easy *at the test*,  
And my burden's light *on the crest*.

The burden that You sent one sets upon  
His follower may or may not be drawn  
By the weak and the lowly, but the welt  
That You raise, my Beloved, is duly felt  
Not at all by the body in the grave,  
Nor by the round of Your child and You  
    slave.

Salvation is no work that man can do,  
It's lighter than the light of any crew.  
Salvation is Your work alone, just as  
Creation's power's not found in human jazz.  
You only can bear up the burden to  
Create a human being in his pew.  
You only can redeem from death and make  
A corpse rise up immortal in Your wake.

## Matthew 12

1 At that time Jesus came to walk  
Through the grain-fields *with corn on stalk*  
Upon the Sabbath *day*. Now his  
Disciples were hungry, *that is*,  
Began to pluck the ears of grain

And eat the kernels *raw and plain*.

2 And when the Pharisees saw it,  
They told him "Look, it is not fit  
Upon the Sabbath *day* to do  
What your disciples *take and chew*  
Upon the Sabbath!" 3 But he said  
To them "And have you never read  
What David did when he *unfed*  
And those who were with him hungry,  
4 "How he entered God's house, *and see*,  
Ate the showbread which was not lawful  
For him to eat, nor for those who  
Were with him, only priests, *how awful?*  
5 "Or have you not read in the law  
That on the Sabbath priests in awe  
Within the temple profane it,  
The Sabbath, without blame, *and fit?*  
6 "Yet I say to you in this place  
There's *one* greater than temple *grace*.  
7 "But if you had known what *this* means,  
'I desire mercy, not *machines*  
*Of sacrifice,*' you would not have  
Condemned the guiltless *as you have*.  
8 "For the son of man is lord of  
Even the Sabbath *in his love*."

If Jesus' friends were hungry after church,  
That only shows the people left in lurch  
Their guests and failed to give something to  
eat.

The keeping of the Sabbath is a treat,  
And hospitality's the watchword then.  
Jesus and company fell among men,  
Which means they had to break their fast  
alone,

Without the help of human heart of stone.  
The Sabbath cannot be kept without eating,  
And without hospitality for treating,  
And failing that, one must take from the  
field

And eat right there the bounties of its yield.  
When all forsake me, My Beloved, You are  
The generous host feeding me afar.

9 He went away from there and came  
Into their synagogue *of fame*.

10 And, see, a man with withered hand  
Was there. And they asked in demand  
Of him and saying "Does the law  
Allow a man to heal a paw  
On Sabbaths?" They would accuse him.  
11 But He said to them, "What man *dim*

Among you will have one sheep trim,  
And if it falls into a hole  
Upon the Sabbaths, will his goal  
Not be to take hold of it there  
And lift it up and out *with care?*  
12 "So how much more then is a man  
Worth than a sheep? So if you scan  
It's lawful to do what you can  
Of good upon the Sabbath days."

In those days a man had a market price  
And could be well compared with a sheep  
                  nice.

Twenty shekels or thirty in the book  
Is a man's price, depending on who took.  
A sheep is somewhat less. And if you look  
In Torah, the price of a woman's nook  
Is half that of a man. Perhaps today  
A woman's price is better one for pay,  
Since in the sweet and narrow Christian  
                  way

She can be sold in Amsterdam for those  
Who rule in government and business  
                  shows

To muck in glory of red lights and strobes  
That go revealing through the lady's robes.  
So Jesus asks what is the price that blows.

13 Then he said to the man, "Stretch out  
Your hand." And he without a doubt  
Stretched it out, and it was restored  
As well as the other one scored.

The man had his hand hidden in his cloak  
So that no one would see him under stroke  
Of punishment divine for sins committed,  
Both those that he had not and had  
admitted.

It was a shame and near pollution that  
He came into the synagogue and sat.  
But if he kept his hand well out of sight,  
Then he was tolerated in the light.  
Beloved, Your sent one fails to met the eye  
With sensitivity of those who spy.  
Without a promise of healing or try  
He tells the man to stretch it out and show  
The withering congregation and then lo  
It had been healed, restored to healthy  
glow.

14 But as they filed out of the place,  
The Pharisees took council's mace

Against him, how they might destroy.  
 15 But Jesus, knowing of their ploy,  
 Escaped from there. And a great crowd  
 Came after him to be allowed  
 Healing, and so he healed them all.  
 16 And he solemnly gave the call  
 That they should not make advertisement.  
 17 He did that by the old advisement  
 Spoken by Isaiah the prophet,  
 Saying 18 "See My Son not to scoff at,  
 Whom I have chosen, one I love,  
 In whom My soul delights above.  
 I shall put My spirit on him,  
 And he will publish judgement grim  
 To nations *all around in shove*.  
 19 "He will not strive, he will not shout,  
 No one shall hear his voice about  
 In the streets. 20 "A bruised reed he'll not  
 Break, and a smoking flax he's got  
 He will not quench before he brings  
 Judgement out into victory's springs.  
 21 "The hoping nations name his *rings*. "

Matthew's account here fails to give a sop  
 To the fact Isaiah came in to lop  
 Off Israel in all as servant's shop.  
 The text refers to every Jew and not  
 To Jesus only, who threw in his lot  
 With one nation in subject then to Rome.  
 Matthew's quotation comes too close to  
 home.

The word of Jesus coming so soon after  
 His reticence to be centre of laughter  
 Shows that he would give all Your folk the  
 role

Of serving You by healing on the dole.  
 The miracles You do through him are done  
 Not by him only, but the people won  
 By Your choice and their obeying for fun.

22 They brought him one demon possessed,  
 Who did not sing, no word confessed,  
 And he healed him so that the blind  
 And dumb could see and speak *his mind*.  
 23 And all the people were amazed,  
 And said "Is this not David's son?"  
 24 But hearing, the Pharisees crazed  
 Said "This one does not what he's done  
 In casting out demons except  
 By Beelzebub, ruler inept  
 Of the demons." 25 But Jesus who

Knew their thoughts, said to them, "It's  
 true

Every kingdom divided will  
 Come to an end at a stand-still.  
 And every town and house to be  
 Divided will not stand in fee.  
 26 "If Satan throws out Satan, he  
 Was set against himself to be.  
 How then will his kingdom stand *free*?  
 27 "If I cast out the demons by  
 Beelzebub, by whom do try  
 Your representatives of late  
 To cast them out? That's why *in state*  
 They shall be your judges *in rate*.  
 28 "But if I cast out demons by  
 The spirit of Alohim nigh,  
 Then Alohim's kingdom has come  
 Down *crashing* on you *like a drum*.

The Vatican has always been a house  
 Divided and caught in nibbling of mouse.  
 And yet no institution comes to share  
 With it the long life of the good and fair.  
 Of course dear Jesus did not know about  
 The coming of the Vatican with clout,  
 Or he would not use such an argument,  
 That house divided is a house forspent.  
 Beloved, the crew of Babylon indeed  
 Is so divided among rival creed  
 That hardly anything there can concede.  
 For all their beauty, I cast now aside  
 All faiths that come in livery and pride,  
 And take alone Your throne where I abide.

29 "Or how can anyone go in  
 A strong man's house and break his bin,  
 If he does not first of all tie  
 The strong man up, then he can try  
 To rob his house. 30 "The one who's not  
 With me is against me in plot,  
 The one who does not gather up  
 With me just scatters *like a tup*.  
 31 "That's why I tell you, every sin  
 And blasphemy's forgiven in  
 Mankind, but the blasphemy of  
 The spirit's not forgiven *for shove*.  
 12 "The one who speaks a word denying  
 The Son of Man, for all his trying,  
 It shall be forgiven. But when  
 He speaks against the spirit's *yen*,  
 It shall not be forgiven him,  
 Not in this age nor in the *dim*

Age left to come. 33 “Either point out  
Both tree and fruit it bears in stout  
To be good, or the both to be  
Spoiled and corrupt, for every tree  
Is known by the fruit on it wee.  
34 “Children of vipers, how can you,  
Being evil, speak what is true?  
The heart is full of many things,  
And of those ready the mouth sings.  
35 “The good man from the blessings’ store  
Of his heart brings good things and more.  
The evil man from evil store  
Sets evil things outside the door.  
36 “But I tell you, each idle word  
That men may speak, they’ll with heart  
stirred  
Give account on judgement day heard.  
37 “For by your words you will be shown  
Right, and by your words too alone  
Will you be in guiltiness thrown.”

O my Beloved, what hard saying is this?  
I had depended on my works for bliss  
And thought that what I said would not  
touch me  
On the last day. Now Your sent one makes  
free  
Accusing man for every idle word  
And wife for every answer made when  
stirred.  
Shall I be justified or else condemned  
By what I say in truth or false when  
hemmed  
About with circumstance? Or by my  
rhymes  
Abundantly repeated between times?  
So be it then. Judge me by what I say  
And what I say once more on this new day.  
There is no god but You, Beloved, I scorn  
Invented gods upon the day they’re born.

38 Some of the scribes and Pharisees  
Replied to say “Teacher, with ease  
We want to see a sign from You.”  
39 And he answered and told them true,  
“An evil and adulterous crew  
Seeks a sign, and no sign shall be  
Given to them, except the free  
Sign of Jonah the prophet wee.  
40 “And even as ‘Jonah was in  
The belly of the beast of fin  
Three days and three nights,’ so shall be

The Son of Man in the earth’s breast  
Three days and three nights there to rest.  
41 “The Ninevites will stand to speak  
In the Judgement with this crew weak  
And will condemn it. For when they  
Hear Jonah preaching in the way,  
Repented. See, a greater now  
Than Jonah is here anyhow.  
42 “The southern queen too will be raised  
In judgement with this crew amazed  
And will condemn it. For she came  
From ends of the earth to hear game  
Of Solomon, and see one greater  
Than Solomon is here, *though later*.  
43 “But when an unclean spirit leaves  
A man, he goes out through dry leaves  
To find rest and finds no reprieves.  
44 “Then he says ‘I will go again  
To the house from which among men  
I was thrown out. And when he comes,  
He finds its standing in the slums,  
Though swept and decorated then.  
45 “Then he goes and takes with him seven  
Other spirits of greater leaven  
Of wickedness than he himself,  
And they enter and live on shelf,  
And so the end’s worse than the start.  
So shall it be also to smart  
In this wicked company’s heart.”

The seven devils truly have their names  
That show their worth and rightly lay the  
blames  
Of each on each. The first is surely pride,  
And lying and to shed blood are beside,  
While wicked plans and feet fast to comply  
Are devils well enough to satisfy.  
False witness and to sow discord among  
The brothers make up seven devils hung.  
The last state of the human soul is worse  
Than the beginning if life is a curse.  
But blessing and true guidance among men  
Is sevenfold and glorious again  
Where truthful spirits make the  
proclamation  
That You, Beloved, are one and without  
station.

46 But while He still talked with the crowd,  
See his mother and brothers bowed  
Outside and stood up there to try  
To speak to him *and give the lie*.



47 Then someone said to him, "See there,  
 Your mother and Your brothers dare  
 To stand outside and try to speak  
 With you, *at least to have a peek.*"  
 47 Then one said to Him, Now, behold,  
 Your mother and Your brothers *bold*  
 Stand outside to speak to you *cold*.  
 48 But he replied and told the man,  
 "Who is my mother, and who can  
 Be my brothers? Just take a scan."  
 49 He pointed at his own disciples,  
 And said "See, my mother in stripes  
 My brothers *both the quick and span*.  
 50 "For everyone who does the will  
 Of my Father in heaven's *hill*,  
 They are my brother, sister and  
 My mother, *if you understand.*"

Sweet Jesus must be David on the throne,  
 Since he has the authority alone  
 To make law in application his own.  
 If my mum stood outside and knocked  
 aloud  
 On any door of mine, I would be proud  
 To open it, at least if I had heard,  
 Or anyone had brought me in the word.  
 Commandment says to honour mum and  
 dad.  
 It seems to me what Jesus did was bad.  
 But who am I to say what's right and  
 wrong,  
 Since I'm not any king above the throng?  
 Let Jesus be interpreter and bold  
 Of all of Your commandments known of  
 old.  
 Then I'll be faithful servant and not sold.

### Matthew 13

1 When Jesus left that house he went  
 And sat down by the sea *intent*.  
 2 And great crowds gathered near him, so  
 He went into a boat to row  
 And sat down, and the multitude  
 Stood on the shore *where things were*  
*viewed*.  
 3 And he spoke to them many things  
 In parables and in sayings.  
 See, one went out to sow *in rings*.  
 4 And while he sowed, some seed fell by  
 The roadside and the birds that fly  
 Came up and ate them to their fill.  
 5 And other seeds fell where the stone

Choked up the soil, so when they'd grown  
 Up quickly they'd no depth of earth.  
 6 So when the sun rose in its dearth  
 It scorched them without root of worth.  
 7 And some seeds fell among the thorns  
 And thorn bushes grew round their bourns  
 And choked them. 8 And some seed fell on  
 The good ground to yield fruit, outdrawn  
 A hundredfold, and sixtyfold  
 And thirtyfold *when it was sold*.  
 9 Anyone who has ears to hear  
 Let him hear what these things appear.

Beloved, Your sent one was a mason sure,  
 Or carpenter as many say for cure.  
 That's why he seems to know hardly a  
 thing  
 About the way of planting in the spring,  
 Or autumn as may be. My neighbour took  
 His sack of seeds on shoulder by the brook  
 And set to sowing all the field laid bare.  
 There were both stony places and thorns  
 there,  
 But his hand was so sure no seeds fell out,  
 But all fell on the good soil like a clout.  
 The man was a school teacher too and not  
 A farmer with a practiced hand in plot.  
 Methinks now Christ was joking and the  
 crowd  
 Must have crowed then with laughter at the  
 ploughed.

10 The disciples said and came near  
 To him, "Why do You speak unclear  
 In parables to them *in fear*?"  
 11 He answered and he said to them,  
 Because it has been given in hem  
 For you to know the mysteries  
 Of heavenly kingdom by degrees,  
 But it's not been given to these.  
 12 The one who has shall get the more,  
 And have overabundant store.  
 But one who does not have, what he  
 Has even shall be shaken free.  
 13 That's why I use parables' sign  
 When I speak to them by design,  
 Since they do not see, and their ear  
 Though listening does not know to hear,  
 Nor do they understand *or fear*.  
 14 What Isaiah predicted then  
 Is fulfilled saying of these men,  
 "In hearing you will not hear and

In no way will you understand,  
And seeing you will see indeed  
Without perceiving *thought or need.*”  
15 For this folk’s heart has gone to seed  
In grossness, and with heavy ears  
They close their eyes because of fears  
Of seeing with eyes, or with ears  
Hearing and understanding by  
The heart and be converted nigh  
To healing from me as appears.”

It’s not so much prediction as the note  
That humankind are worse than billy-goat.  
Stupidity is more the attribute  
Of Homo sapiens than ration’s root.  
The crass of men ride on the tails of those  
Exceptional ones who write and compose.  
To call it prophecy is hopeful shows,  
But like to disappointment in the boot.  
Beloved, though I have ears and eyes, I  
stay

In darkness and in silence, in the sway  
Of love to You, while I ignore the way.  
The routes of high theology miss me  
As much as parable in those times free  
When people listened to the folktales wee.

16 But your eyes are blessed since they see,  
And your ears since they hear freely.

17 For truly I tell you that many  
Prophets and righteous ones, if any,  
Hoped to see what you see and did  
Not live to see lifting of lid,  
And to hear what you hear and failed  
To live to hear the word prevailed.  
18 Hear the sower’s story regaled.

19 The ones who hear the kingdom’s word  
And fail to understand it stirred,  
Then comes the evil one and takes  
Away what’s sown for their heart’s sakes,  
Are shown in the seed sown beside  
The road and there not to abide.

20 And that sown on the stony ground  
Is this; those who hear the word’s sound  
And take it straight away with joy,

21 But have no root in self employ,  
But only for a brief time wakes,  
Till tribulation and the quakes  
Of persecution for the word,  
He’s straight off hurt by what occurred.  
22 And the seed sown among the thorns  
Is this: the one who hears its bourns,

And the care of this world and lies  
Of wealth choke the word where it flies  
To bear no fruit *or realize.*  
23 But that seed sown on the good ground  
Is this; the one who hears the sound  
Of the word and grasps in his mind,  
Who bears and yields fruit of his kind  
A hundredfold, or sixty or  
Thirtyfold, is the one in store.

The four ways are four gates of being here:  
The road, the stony ground, the thorn as  
spear,

And the good ground. The road is tarikat,  
Where love is plucked up quickly like as  
not.

The thorning earth is living just by law,  
The stony ground is in awareness awe,  
But only that gate where the good earth  
stays

Is full of divine wisdom and its praise.  
Beloved, I walk upon the road and find  
Both love and stony hearts, I do not mind.  
I glimpse beyond the earthly cares the light  
Of Your awareness far but shining bright.  
But my heart and my love dissolve at last  
In that fresh earth upon which I am cast.

24 He set before them one more story,  
Saying: Kingdom of heaven’s glory  
Is like a man sowing good seed  
In his fields *in view of his need.*

25 But while the household slept, a foe  
Came secretly with tares to sow  
Among the wheat, and went his way.

26 And when the sprouts met light of day  
And put forth fruit, the tares too showed.

27 The household servants came and told  
The master, “Sir, did you not sow  
Good seed in your field? Then from where  
Do we see growing up the tare?”

28 And he told them, “Some enemy  
Has done this.” And the servantry  
Said to him, “Do you want us to  
Go and gather the tares in due?”

29 But he said “No, for fear you might  
In gathering tares out of sight  
Pull up the wheat as well with them.

30 “But let the two both grow in hem  
Until the harvest. In the time  
Of harvest I will tell the prime  
Men of the reapers first to take

The tares and tie them up for sake  
Of burning, but gather the wheat  
Into my barn and keep it neat."

When I was a child we had gardens where  
The corn and beans and squash were  
growing fair  
In hills, and all around them could be seen  
The weeds that had to be hoed on the  
scene.

Eurasian agriculture sows instead  
Of planting, and that is a difference bred.  
If Your kingdom had been a better shoe,  
A turtle-backed one, as I have in view,  
The tares might have been hoed out of the  
pew.

Beloved, I'm not a man to hoe or reap.  
Though I was not forced to the fields to  
creep.

My grand-dad ran away from home to flee  
The hoeing of the corn, but after he  
Saw the world's face, he hoed then  
gratefully.

31 Another parable he set  
Before them saying kingdom met  
Of heaven is like a mustard seed  
A man sows in his field with heed,  
32 Which truly is smaller than all  
The other seeds, but when in stall  
It grows it's greater than the plants,  
And turns into a tree askance,  
So that the birds of the air come  
To sit in its branches *and hum*.  
33 He told them one more story then.  
The kingdom of heaven among men  
Is like some yeast a woman takes,  
Hides in three cups of flour cakes  
Until the whole begins to rise.  
34 Jesus spoke all these things in guise  
Of parables to the folk and  
He did not address them in hand  
Without a parable to stand;  
35 That it might be fulfilled as spoken  
By the prophet, saying awoken,  
"I'll open mouth in symbols' signs,  
And utter things kept in confines  
Of secret from the very start  
Of the world to bottom of heart."  
36 Then Jesus sent the multitude  
Away and went *not to intrude*  
Into the house. And his disciples

Came to him, saying *in their griples*,  
"Explain to us the parable  
Of the tares of the field *in full*."

The Psalm is not a prophecy, but yet  
The master took its word as something set  
For him to follow, and that's a fine thing.  
Let me, Beloved, also define the ring  
Of my life by the things found in Your  
word.

Let me too go beyond commandment  
stirred

And above mere predictions to adhere  
To any hint of an example dear.  
Beloved, let me adhere, but let no man  
Come after me and think the divine plan  
Is set in close prediction of my fate.  
It's joy in Your commandments I await,  
Not some determined, hopely clause to fear  
Or act mechanical to eye and ear.

37 He answered and said to them, "He  
Who sows the good seed is the wee  
Son of Man. 38 "The field is the world,  
The good seeds are the sons unfurled  
Of the kingdom, but the tares are  
The sons of the wicked *one's star*.

39 "The enemy who sowed them is  
The devil, the harvest of his  
Is the end of the age, and yet  
The reapers are angels, *you bet*.

40 "Therefore as the tares are gathered  
And burned in the fire *undeterred*,  
So it will be at end of age.

41 "The Son of Man will send, engage  
His messengers, and they'll take out  
Of his kingdom all things and rout  
That offend, and those who practice  
Lawlessness, 42 "and cast in abyss  
Of fire. There will be wailing and  
Gnashing of teeth *in that hot land*.  
43 "The righteous then shine like the sun  
In the kingdom their Father won.  
Who has ears to hear, hear *what's done!*

Ha! sons again without a mother, father!  
I wonder why Trinitarians bother.  
I guess the devil makes them do the thing  
Since they remain such tares tied up with  
string.

May angels fine or messengers return

To take the tares and throw them out to  
burn!

Beloved, I cling to You to know You're  
one,

And cannot be divided when they've done.  
The messengers are many, angels fly  
Hither and yon about the crowded sky.  
The seeds are minion, and the tares reply  
In myriad voices raised up till the doom.  
But in divinity there's only room  
For You alone, Beloved, forever shy.

44 Again, kingdom of heaven is like  
A treasure hidden under spike

Of grassy field, which a man finds  
And hides again for joy that minds,  
And goes and sells all that he has  
And buys that field *for all his jazz*.

45 Again, heaven's kingdom's like a man,  
A merchant seeking pearls to scan.

46 And when he finds one precious pearl,  
He goes and sells all to last curl,  
And buys the precious one by plan.

47 Again kingdom of heaven compares  
To a drag net thrown out as snares  
Into the sea and brings in all  
Of every kind into the stall,

48 And when it's full, is drawn to shore,  
And there they sit and put in store  
What's in it, and throw out the poor.

49 So it will be at age's end,  
The angels go out to attend  
And separate the wicked from  
The righteous *by the rule of thumb*.

50 They'll throw them in the burning fire,  
Where there will be both weeping dire  
And gnashing of the teeth *to come*.

It is a mercy, my Beloved, that You  
Do not throw men in hell according to  
This word before the end of time and age.  
The Baptist deacon on my youthful page  
Wrote that men go to hell as soon as death  
Comes in to steal the slender human breath.  
You are more merciful than Baptist crowd,  
Blood-thirsty though they be when they're  
allowed

To spread their doctrines with their heads  
unbowed.

In life and sleep of death all men remain  
In equal share of joy and silent pain.  
Let some what for reward in loss or gain,

Beloved, my love to You is all I need  
Of both, I swear, beyond my word and  
creed.

51 So Jesus asked them, "Did you now  
Understand all these things somehow?"  
And they replied to him, "Yes, sir."

52 And he told them, "Because of this,  
Every scribe learned in the bliss  
Of heaven's kingdom's like a man,  
The master of a house in span,  
Who brings out of his treasure store  
The new and the old from before."

53 It happened when Jesus had done  
These parables, he moved his bun.

54 And coming into his own land,  
He taught them in their synagogue,  
So that they were surprised in band  
And said "Where did the dialogue  
Come to this man and wisdom lurk,  
As well as every mighty work?

55 "Is this not just the builder's son?  
Is not his mother Mary won,  
And his brothers, James, Joses too,  
And Simon and Judas in pew?

56 "Are not his sisters all with us?  
Where then did he get such a fuss?"

57 And they were offended in him.  
But Jesus told them *on their limb*,  
"A prophet is not without glory  
Except in his own land *and story*,  
And in his own household *and grim*."

58 And he did not do many great  
Works there because of doubt *and hate*.

The prophet is a word expressing all.  
No man is favoured in his own home stall.  
That may explain the rush to emigrate,  
And why new cities are filled up of late.  
The home fires are kept burning by the rate  
Of those who saw boys playing by the grate  
And thought them boys eternal there to  
play.

Men do not see the changes of a day.  
And yet they ought to have minded the  
times

When as a child his miracles in rhymes  
Made all the neighbours fear his anger  
then.

So brief is memory of child and men.  
My doubt, no doubt prevents my share in  
knowing

The miracles of Your own show and going.

#### Matthew 14

1 At that time Herod the tetrarch  
Heard Jesus' rumours in the dark.  
2 And he said to his servants, "This  
Is John the Baptist, not to miss  
He's risen from the dead, that's why  
He's working wonders *in the sky*.  
3 Herod seized John and bound him and  
Put him in prison by remand  
Of Herodias, the wife of  
His brother Philip *without love*.  
4 For John told him, "It is not right  
For you to take her in the night."  
5 That's why he wanted to kill him,  
But fearing the crowd which held *trim*  
That he had been *God's* prophet *grim*.  
6 But when Herod's birthday feast came,  
Herodias' daughter danced in flame  
And pleased Herod to no end's shame.  
7 So then he promised with an oath  
To give her whatever she quoth.

A man's head's always turned when  
dancing girls  
Come out to prance and swish their lovely  
curls.

It never at that moment enters mind  
That hair is merely dead skin in a bind.  
This time the heads of two men were  
turned round:  
The head of Herod, who politely frowned,  
And head of John the Baptist on the  
ground.

That's the effect of dancing with the wined.  
Beloved, I dance too on the barren earth  
And find my head is turned for all it's  
worth

By Your appearance on the cloud and sun,  
And Your revealing where the small mice  
run

Across the forest carpet woven fast  
By tiny hands untiring at the cast.

8 But her mother encouraged her  
And said "Give me on a plate spread  
Johannes the baptiser's head."  
9 The king was sorrowful but still  
Because he had sworn to fulfil  
Before his guests, he ordered it  
To be given her, *though unfit*.

10 And sending, he beheaded John  
In the prison. 11 And his head drawn  
Was brought on a plate to the girl,  
And she took it where her mum shone.  
12 And his disciples took the pearl  
Of his body and buried it,  
And went and told Jesus to wit.  
13 When Jesus heard, he went apart  
From there in a boat to the start  
Of wilderness. When the crowds heard  
Of his address, their hearts were stirred  
To follow him on foot *and cart*  
Out of the cities *and apart*.  
14 When Jesus went out, he then saw  
The great crowd and with pity's awe  
He healed their ailments *at a draw*.

I doubt my hand has been led to the touch  
That heals a single soul, indeed not much.  
But if a grief can bring such power to men,  
Then turn my every sorrow come again  
To healing for the crowds around my glen.  
I turn upon my wilderness in place,  
Praying that no crowd may perceive my  
face,

And take Your bounties with right hand up-  
raised,  
And scatter them abroad with left hand  
crazed.

The wilderness looks on verst after verst  
As far as Vladivostok at the worst,  
And whispers not a word before the sight  
Of one man whirling in the morning light,  
Of one man whirling on the dergah's night.

15 When evening came, disciples drew  
Near him and said "The place is cru,  
The hour has fled. Dismiss the crowd,  
So they may enter towns allowed  
To buy provisions for their stew."

16 But Jesus said to them, "No need  
For them to go away with speed.  
Just give them food to eat indeed."

17 But they said to him, "We have none  
Here except two fish and five bun."

18 And He said "Bring them here to me."

19 He told the crowds to sit sweetly  
Upon the grass and then he took  
The five loaves and two fish on hook,  
And looking up into the sky,  
He blessed them and broke them with sigh  
And gave his disciples the loaves,

And the disciples gave the doves.

20 And everybody ate their fill.

And they gathered the overspill,

Twelve baskets full *and fit to kill*.

21 Those fed were five thousand of men

Besides women and children then.

Given it's mostly women and offspring

Who go to church to hear the preacher sing,

The ratio to men is twenty to one.

That adds to one hundred thousand when  
done.

I've never been so great at counting up.

My talents, as they are to drink and sup,

Are truly modest. When it comes to You,

I cannot get past one to three in view

No matter what I do. And as for laws

I only count the ten upon my claws.

If You had wanted me to number more,

You should have given me more fingers in  
store.

So I just throw the number out in rate

And wait for stones to fall upon my pate.

22 And straight off Jesus commanded

His disciples into boat's lid

To go before him and across

To the other side while he'd toss

The crowds out *for their gain or loss*.

23 And having dismissed the crowds, he

Went up into the mountain's lea

Alone to pray. And darkness came

And he was there alone in claim.

The prayer-book of the time, the great  
Siddur,

Was simple book of Psalms, Tehilim pure.

How many hours did Jesus take to say

All one hundred and fifty Psalms in sway?

It can be calculated in a day

To nearest hour if not half-hour for sure.

My own grandmother read each night at  
last

The book of Psalms, the prayers in Hebrew  
cast

In King James English, vigilant and fast.

Myself, I hardly get beyond the first

Psalm in my clamour to be of the worst,

But still I meet the midnight blessings  
where

You come to join the temple of the air.

The Psalms rise up invisible with care.

24 But the boat was now out to sea,

Tossed by the waves, wind contrary.

25 But in the fourth watch of the night,

Jesus went out to them in sight

Walking upon the sea's *strange light*.

26 When the disciples saw him come

Walking on the sea, every bum

Of them was troubled, and they cried,

"A ghost! A ghost!" Each was beside

Himself for fear of that false ride.

27 But straight away Jesus spoke to

Them, saying "Sit in comfort's pew,

It's only me. Don't be afraid!"

Sir Tyler and Sir Frazer must indeed

Have read with satisfaction the fair need

Of men of magic to believe in ghosts.

So then evolved religion for her hosts.

Although a sudden snap of twig at night

In forests dark and lonely is a fright,

I fail to rise to such grand faith to see

The ghosts come trailing in to grin at me.

Beloved, the visionary way I've crossed

Has long since settled to an old-aged tossed

In cynical retreat and doubtful cast.

Still I grasp You invisible to last.

Do not betray me like Your son to blast

The sea with odd lights shining on my  
mast.

28 And Peter answered him and said

"Sir, if it is you, tell me led

To walk to you across the spread

Of the sea waters raising dread."

29 And he said "Come on!" So he got

Out of the boat and like a shot

Peter walked on the waters there

To go to Jesus *on a dare*.

30 When he saw how the strong winds  
blow

And started to sink in the flow,

He shouted out, "Sir, save me, row!"

31 And right away with outstretched hand

Jesus took hold of him to land,

And said to him, "So little faith,

Why did you doubt, *for just a wraith?*"

32 And coming to the boat again,

The wind ceased. 33 In the boat the men

Came and prostrated themselves there

Before him saying, "Truth to share,

You are God's son, *and so beware!*"

I've heard of those who walk on fire to show  
Themselves full of faith in the trance to glow.

I've heard of Pentecostal waifs who know  
The way to walk on rivers is to go  
Out stepping in faith. But the final show  
Is emptiness for one, for other row  
Of disappointment in emotion's peal.  
Beloved, my heart is made of stone and steel.

I do not doubt reality, I do  
Not doubt Your word on Sinai in the dew  
Of morning or the evening coming true.  
It's in the noon I doubt, when cares of life  
Run over me with labour and with strife.  
I prostrate myself now before light's view.

34 Having crossed over they arrive  
In Gennesaret's land alive.

35 The men of that place knew him and  
Sent all around the near-by land,  
And brought the sick under his hand.

36 They begged him just to let them touch  
The fringes of his robe, not much.  
And everyone that touched him so  
Was healed of every illness' low.

If there was blue in those days to be had,  
I reckon that the fringes were not bad.  
Maybe the lack of blue upon the rate  
Is why touching of fringes now in fate  
Heals no one that I know of out to gad.  
I look about for Jesus' fringes now,  
And think to touch them with both lip and brow,

And find the autumn leaves in colour fling  
About me where the little angels sing.  
But none of them are blue, though gold is found  
And trampled to the earth and in the ground.

And red like ruby can be seen abroad  
Where maples brush the morning and the sod  
With other colours known to man and God.

### Matthew 15

1 Then the scribes and the Pharisees  
Came to Jesus out of the ease  
Of the town of Jerusalem

And said 2 "Why do Your folk in hem  
Transgress what the elders hand down?  
For they don't wash their hands *gone brown*  
Before they eat their bread *in gown*."

The point is not hygienic, but the rite  
Of rinsing hands and coming to recite  
The blessing set out in tradition slight  
Baruch atta... and following for spite.  
Let no one think I focus all my blame  
On the Rabbinical in sort of game.  
All faiths add to the Decalogue what's needed

To justify neglect of the unceded.  
Beloved, no doubt my own behaviour  
would

Incite remarks if any stopped or could  
Take note of what I do here as a hood.  
As soon as Jesus fails to foot the bill  
Of custom he's called on in judgement sill.  
The non-conforming is one fit to kill.

3 But he replied to them and said  
"Why do you also transgress then  
On your part commandment to men  
From God for your tradition's wen?"

4 "For God commanded saying thus:  
'Honour your dad and mum' for fuss,  
'The one who speaks ill of his dad  
Or mum, by death let him be had.'

5 "But you say 'Anyone who states  
'An offering, what you'd take on plates  
From me, 6 "and in no manner rates  
Honour to dad or mum in gates'  
And you annulled command of God  
By your tradition *under rod*."

Sweet Jesus here refers to Decalogue  
In contrast to tradition in a fog.  
Disarming expression for the like  
Is oral law, vocabulary strike.  
It's not clear here if Jesus stands alone  
Upon the Decalogue or takes the throne  
Of the Mosaic code in its extent  
Of applications throughout all the meant.  
Beloved, I take the literal as true:  
He quotes from Decalogue and brings to view

The one criterion by which on cue  
All things can be evaluated too.  
What's good enough for Jesus I admire

And take it for my own winter attire.

7 Hypocrites! Well did Isaiah

Prophecy about you and saw,

8 “This folk comes near Me with their mouth,

And with their lips honour the south,

But their heart remains far from Me.

9 “Only in vain they worship Me,  
Teaching as doctrines man’s own fee.”

10 And summoning the crowd he said  
To them, “Hear and understand led.

11 “It’s not the thing come in the mouth  
That defiles a man, but what leaves  
The mouth man defiling receives.”

The sweet Christian straightway thinks this  
word gives

Him the permission to eat without sieves

The mouse and swine under the green  
tree’s hall.

But Jesus speaks against tradition’s call,  
Not anything that’s mentioned in the book.

Nor is he talking about diet’s rook,

But about what enters the mouth on hand  
Not washed and blessed by the human  
command.

The fact is that germs are more likely to

Invade the body if tradition’s due

Is so ignored. Defilement is the rate

Of following the human desires grate

Instead of the command of God. Beloved,

Strike dead the exegetes that come so  
gloved.

12 Then came the disciples to him

And said “You know that hearing trim

The message the Pharisees were

Offended by what did occur?”

13 But he said in reply, “Each plant

My heavenly Father did not grant

Shall be uprooted. 14 “Leave the fer.

They are blind leaders of the blind,

And if the blind lead their own kind,

Both will fall in a pit *unsigned*.”

Here Jesus states outright he comes  
opposing

What men spoke and not You in Your  
bulldozing.

That means what he said does not apply to  
A legislation found in Torah due.

But diet is well-marked in Moses’ book,

In Leviticus, You just take a look,

And in sweet Deuteronomy as fair.

Christ did not mitigate what’s written there,

But washing hands with blessing on the air.

A second curse I call down on the church

And on the preachers on their preaching  
perch,

And bless the Jew and Muslim in their  
search

Obeys You, Beloved, not in the lurch.

I call a curse and blessing, call with care.

15 Replying Peter said to him,

“Explain us this parable grim.”

16 But Jesus said “Are you also

Still without understanding’s glow?

17 “Don’t you see how what goes inside

By the mouth, in belly to hide

And be cast out in excrement?

18 “But the things that come out in word

From the mouth come from heart unstirred,

And these defile man more than turd.

19 “For out of the heart comes excuses,

Evil things, murders and abuses,

Adulteries and fornications,

Thefts, lies, and blasphemies in rations.

20 “These are the things that will defile

The man. But eating all the while

With unwashed hands does not defile.”

Let me say this just one more time.

The question is not one of rhyme,

Not one of law Mosaic or

Of law that You spoke at the door,

But washing hands. Just take a look.

There’s nothing of that in the book

From Genesis to the end of

The books of Moses for all love.

But claiming Jesus here gives leave

To break the law’s without reprieve,

It is a lie and blasphemy,

And so defiles the one on spree

Defending such a lie as well

As those who hear that lie to tell.

21 And Jesus went away from there

To parts of Tyre and Sidon’s share.

22 And see a Canaanite dame came

Out from those regions with the claim

“Have mercy on me, Sir, you are

The Son of David and a star.



My daughter's horribly possessed  
By demon power, *torn and undressed.*"

23 But he did not answer a word.  
His disciples came near up-stirred,  
Saying "Send her away, for she  
Disturbs us crying mightily."  
24 But he replied, "I was not sent  
But to lost sheep of Israel's tent."  
25 But she came falling on the ground  
Before him saying "Sir, confound,  
Help me!" 26 But he replied again,  
"It is not meet to take bread then  
From the children and throw to hound."  
27 But she said "True, sir, even hound  
Eats crumbs that fall from owners' table,  
*As many as such hounds are able.*"  
28 Jesus answered her to resound,  
"O woman, your faith's great in bound,  
May it be so as your desire."  
And her daughter was healed that hour.

Although my daughter is not so possessed  
By demons that I have come and addressed  
Your sent one begging for help of the best,  
I still beg for the crumbs of livelihood  
Due to the dervish dog, whose faith though  
good

Extends not to the hopes of future wealth  
To be gained by the cunning saints in  
stealth.

I do not cry to enter heaven's gate,  
Nor do I draw back from the promised fate  
Of hell. Instead I sit with my eyes cast  
Upon Your table now, Beloved, and fast  
With ears forward and tail vibrating, sit  
In hopes of getting what You may see fit,  
Caught in mid-air or sniffed on the ground  
lit.

29 Going from there Jesus came near  
The Sea of Galilee, and here  
Climbing the mountain, sat for cheer.  
30 And great crowds came to him with  
lame  
And dumb, and blind, and others came  
With defects. And they fell down in  
Prostration at his feet to be  
Healed among all the company.  
The crowds were amazed at the din  
Of the dumb speaking, the maimed found  
Whole, the lame walking and the sight  
Of the blind seeing all around.

And they gave thanks with all their might  
To Israel's God *and did it right.*

32 But Jesus summoned to come near  
All his disciples and said clear,  
"I'm filled with pity for the crowd,  
Since they've already been allowed  
To stay with me three days and yet  
Have nothing here to eat or set.  
And I don't want to send away  
The people hungry, so they may  
Not faint on the road where they're met."  
33 And his disciples said to him,  
"From where in such a desert grim  
Will we get so much bread to give  
To such a great a crowd to make live?"  
34 Jesus asked them, "How many loaves  
Do you have?" And they said *in droves*,  
"Seven, and some small fish *from coves.*"

Without a prophet in the offing I  
Come with a basket and a smile as shy  
As if it were not hidden meat and guiding  
I shelter in my heart no less confiding.  
But seven loaves from Ali to the son  
Of Ja'fer is a progress well half done.  
And to the loaves are added some small  
fishes

That magnify their Lord in all their wishes.  
Take this basket of bread and fishes, Lord,  
And in Your servant's hands instead of  
sword  
Feed all creation with its barley scales  
Till wisdom in the flesh retreats and fails.  
I do not ask for banquets and gold dish,  
Beloved, when You provide bread and a  
fish.

35 He ordered the crowds to sit down  
Upon the ground *without a frown.*

36 And taking seven loaves and fish,  
He gave thanks, broke them *in a dish*  
And gave to His disciples, and  
The disciples gave the crowd *hand.*

37 And all ate and were satisfied.  
They gathered up what came to bide  
In seven baskets and beside.

38 Those who ate were four thousand men  
As well as dames and children then.

39 After he sent the crowds away,  
He went into the boat to sway  
Up to the edge of Magdala.

Despite my wondered interest in the things  
 Of faith and spirit instead of the springs  
 Of wealth and soil, I too rise and take note  
 That Jesus was a gallant man in boat.  
 The greatest barrier to armies now  
 And then was and is food to serve the  
 POW.

But Jesus solved that military claim  
 By making bread and fish outdo the game.  
 Aside from banking armies, I myself  
 Would have an interest for the cupboard  
 shelf.

One that needs no replenishing would save  
 Me time and money here before the grave.  
 Beloved, I thank for daily bread and raise  
 Petition for a sounder source in maze.

### Matthew 16

1 The Pharisees and Sadducees  
 Came testing him *to shoot the breeze*,  
 Asked that he would show them a sign  
 From heaven. 2 He gave answer *benign*  
 And said to them, "When it is eve  
 You say, 'Fair weather we'll receive,  
 For red's the sky', 3 "and then at morn,  
 'Today foul weather *will be born*,  
 For the sky's red and threatening.'  
 Hypocrites! You know how to sing  
 The face of the sky, but cannot  
*Discern* the signs the times *have taught*.  
 4 "A wicked and adulterous nation  
 Seeks after a sign's generation,  
 And no sign shall be given it  
 Except the sign of prophet *fit*,  
 Jonah." And he left them in station.

There is no need of sign from heaven above  
 Since You, Beloved, once gave the sign in  
 love

At Sinai. Jesus Your sent one is true  
 Because he came to tell us what to do  
 In keeping the law that You once provided.  
 With that criterion the thing's decided.  
 A wicked folk look to a thing beyond  
 The Decalogue, to find a witch's wand  
 In this or that issue that's not at stake,  
 But has advantage in that it can take  
 The mind from the ten duties You revealed.  
 Before the clamour I keep my eye peeled.  
 Beloved, no sign but that of Jonah's given:  
 Repent, O Nineveh, be good to live in.

5 Now when his disciples had come  
 To the other side, they had *rum*  
 Forgotten to take bread. 6 Then he,  
 Jesus said to them, "Take heed, be  
 Ware of the leaven of Pharisee  
 And Sadducee." 7 And they reasoned  
 Among themselves, saying *the fund*,  
 "*It is* because we took no bread."  
 8 But Jesus, being aware, said  
 To them, "O you of small belief,  
 Why do you reason *like a thief*  
 Among yourselves because you've brought  
 No bread? 9 "Don't you perceive *the*  
*drought*,

Or remember the five loaves wrought  
 For the five thousand and how many  
 Baskets you took up, *and if any?*

10 "Nor the seven loaves of the four  
 Thousand, how many baskets were  
 And you took them up *of the store?*

11 "How is it you don't understand  
 That I did not speak to you *planned*  
 Concerning bread? *But* to beware  
 Of the leaven *found everywhere*  
 Of Pharisees and Sadducees."

12 Then they understood he did not  
 Tell *them* to beware of the plot  
 Of leaven of bread *on the trees*,  
 But of accommodating teaching,  
 Pharisees and Sadducees *preaching*.

Both Pharisee and Sadducee made bread  
 Of meeting Roman suspicion and dread  
 By saying there was no need of the sent  
 Of You, since every scholar knows what's  
 meant

By the law and in Pharisaic bent  
 Can apply it to every situation,  
 Or else in Sadducean kind of ration,  
 That law suffices insofar as it  
 Be clearly written and it clearly fit.  
 This teaching lays to rest the Roman fears  
 That a Messiah might rise to their tears.  
 The way is paved for selling cheese and  
 bread

And oil so all the wealthy may be fed.  
 That bread's still fresh today, so it appears.

13 When Jesus came into the place  
 Of Caesarea Philippi,  
 He asked his disciples *to face*,  
 Saying, "Who do men say that I,

The Son of Man, am?" 14 So they said,  
 "Some *say* John the Baptist, some spread  
 Elijah, and others *say true*  
 Jeremiah or one of *few*  
 Prophets." 15 He said to them, "But who  
 Do you say that I am, *say true*?"  
 16 Simon Peter answered and said,  
 "You are the Christ, the son of God  
 The Living." 17 Jesus answered, said  
 To him, "Blessed are you *on the sod*,  
 Simon Bar-Jonah, for flesh and  
 Blood has not put this in your hand,  
 But my Father who is in heaven.  
 18 "And I also say to your *leaven*  
 That you are Peter. On this rock  
 I will build my group *and the stock*  
 Of called out ones, and gates of Hell  
 Shall not prevail against it *well*.  
 19 "And I will give you the keys of  
 The kingdom of heaven *and love*,  
 And whatever you bind on earth  
 Will be bound in heaven *for worth*,  
 And whatever you loose on earth  
 Will be loosed in heaven *above*."  
 20 Then he commanded all his men  
 That they should tell no one *again*  
 That he was Jesus the Christ then.

Accepting Jesus as Messiah, Christ  
 Was power to do, and it surely sufficed.  
 As Christ applied the Decalogue in truth,  
 His follower could also and with ruth  
 Bind and loosen according to the rule  
 Of Decalogue heard and known by each  
 fool.

That rock and foundation of glory stands  
 In Peter, Christ and ever on the sands  
 Of Sinai's perch. As John says, doing Your  
 Will makes a man Your child certain and  
 sure.

But Jesus is Your son also by what  
 You sent him to accomplish and to shut.  
 Beloved, Your key still unlocks treasure  
 store  
 Within Your will revealed, an open door.

21 From then on Jesus tried to show  
 His disciples how it would go  
 For him to come up to the town  
 Jerusalem and suffer frown  
 Of many things from elders and  
 Chief priests and scribes and then to stand

For the death sentence, and be raised  
 On the third day (may God be praised).  
 22 After he drew his aside then  
 Peter began rebuking him,  
 Saying "God be gracious to you,  
 Sir, this shall not come down on you."  
 23 But he turned round and said to Peter,  
 "Satan, get behind me, your neater  
 Words are an offence to me now.  
 You are not thinking in the way  
 Of God but in the human sway."  
 24 Then Jesus told his students, "If  
 Anyone has decided stiff  
 To follow me, let him deny  
 Himself, and let him come and try  
 To carry his own cross, and let  
 Him follow me *and not forget*.  
 25 "Whoever hopes to save his own  
 Life will lose it. But one who's thrown  
 His life away for my sake will  
 Find it again and find it still.  
 26 "For what use is it if a man  
 Gained the whole world, but without plan  
 Forfeits his own soul? Or what will  
 A man give in exchange for life?  
 27 "For the son of man will come soon  
 With his angels in glory's noon  
 Of his Father to sound of fife,  
 And he will then give the reward  
 To each for what his deeds have scored.  
 28 "Truly I tell you, there are some  
 Standing here who will never come  
 To taste of death, until they see  
 Man's son come in his kingdom's fee."

The fact is, my Beloved, there never came  
 The glory of the kingdom's happy name  
 During extended lifetime of those there  
 Before everyone came to have grey hair  
 And enter in the silent tomb of death.  
 All tasted of that fickle, fetid breath.  
 The fact is all are long since dead and yet  
 The gloried kingdom has not yet been met.  
 Beloved, if you will tell me now and why  
 I show still linger underneath the sky  
 To wait the coming kingdom, I will lay  
 A psalm of praise upon Your head today.  
 The only argument I find is that  
 All earthly kingdoms fail and still taste flat.

## Matthew 17

1 And after six days, Jesus took

Peter and James, and for no crook  
 His brother John, and brought them up  
 Into a high mountain like tup.  
 2 And he was changed before their sight,  
 His face shone like the sun so bright,  
 And his robe in the light was white.  
 3 And see, Moses and Elijah  
 Appeared to them and talked in awe.  
 4 Quoth Peter then to Jesus, "Sir,  
 It's good for us to see the fer.  
 If you like, let us make three tents  
 Here, one for you, one that prevents  
 Moses, one for Elijah too."  
 5 While he still chattered the undue,  
 See a bright cloud came into view.  
 And see a voice out of the cloud  
 Said "This is My son, I am proud  
 To find delight in him, aloud  
 Hear what he proclaims *to the crowd.*"  
 6 When they heard that, his students fell  
 Down on their face quite scared as well.  
 7 When Jesus approached, he touched them  
 And said "Get up, don't fear the hem."  
 8 When they had raised their eyes, they did  
 Not see a soul but Jesus hid.  
 9 And as they came down from the hill,  
 Jesus commanded them to fill  
 No ears with the vision until  
 The son of man be raised from death.

This glory that enshrouded Jesus when  
 He went up on the mountain with three  
 men  
 Must be fulfilment of the prophecy  
 Found earlier that some living should see  
 The coming with the brightness of the love  
 Of divine hope and grave come from  
 above.  
 Inauguration of the Son of God  
 Is here repeated after on the sod  
 He had bowed down in baptism to gain  
 The righteousness that John's word could  
 sustain.  
 Beloved, I seek no vision of the great,  
 Despite my loving Moses and the state  
 Of good Elijah hidden in the room  
 Of Muhammad Al-Mahdi for a bloom.

10 And his disciples asked him, saying  
 "Why do the scribes enter essaying  
 To say Elijah must come first?"  
 11 Jesus replied and said to them,

"Elijah truly comes *uncursed*  
 Before to restore all in hem.  
 12 "But I tell you, Elijah's come  
 Already, but they did not know  
 Him, but they did to him in sum  
 According to their sinful show.  
 The same way will the son of man  
 Be cut off by their hands in plan."  
 13 So the disciples understood  
 He spoke to them as plain as could  
 About John the Baptist, *the good.*

That's just what I don't like about the word  
 Of oracles and Scriptures that occurred  
 In every time and place. Here's no  
 exception.  
 Your sent one turns the hope into ineption.  
 Either Elijah comes, the self-same man,  
 Or anyone on earth can muster scan.  
 If the prediction's not in literal vein,  
 Then it is loose enough for any pain.  
 But worse than that, each one who brings a  
 file  
 Of speculations based on Scriptures' guile  
 Pretends to greater depth of thought the  
 while,  
 Or spiritual penetration with a smile  
 Of fine superiority. To say  
 Things are not what they are is just fools'  
 play.

14 And when they came near to the crowd,  
 A man came near to him and bowed  
 Down before him and asked petition,  
 15 "Sir, have mercy on the condition  
 Of my son moonstruck, suffering sore,  
 Sometimes falling in the fire's store,  
 And often where the waters pour.  
 16 "And I brought him to your own men,  
 Who could not cure the lad again."  
 17 Jesus replied and said to them,  
 "O faithless, crooked ones in hem!  
 How long shall I be here to straighten?  
 How long shall I bear with your prating?  
 Bring him here to me, *don't condemn.*"  
 18 Jesus rebuked it, and the demon  
 Came out of him faster than seaman,  
 And the boy was healed from that hour.  
 19 Then the disciples came in dour  
 To Jesus privately and said  
 "Why couldn't we cast out the dread?"  
 20 And Jesus said to them, "Because

Of your unbelief. A true clause  
 I say to you, 'If you have faith  
 As a grain of mustard for wraith,  
 You'll tell this mountain where to go,  
 And it will move. Nothing in stow  
 Will be impossible to show.  
 21 "But this kind does not go out but  
 By prayer and fasting *with door shut*."

With prayer and fasting and with faith  
 allowed,  
 I've faced the demon and the human crowd  
 And failed to make a dent on rum and  
 proud.

The fact is none can work in wonders laid  
 Except the fine performers with a trade.  
 The real in miracle is just the hope  
 Of desperation finding where to grope.  
 The fact that prayers are answered under  
 moon

And even in the glare of the sun's noon,  
 Does not change it a whit. If late or soon,  
 Your sent one is too conscious of his bit  
 When he claims lack of trinity to sit  
 In his disciples' failure. I'm not blind  
 To the course of the chicken coop in mind.

22 And while they walked in Galilee,  
 Jesus said to them and freely,  
 "The son of man is soon to be  
 Delivered in the hands of men.

23 "And they will come to kill him then,  
 And on the third day he'll be raised."  
 And they were sorrowful and dazed.

24 When they came to Capernaum,  
 Those who received the temple drachm  
 Came to Peter and asked him if  
 His teacher did not pay tax stiff.

25 He answered them, "Yes." And when he  
 Came in the house Jesus sweetly  
 Caught him and said "What do you think,  
 Simon? From whom do earthly twink  
 Of kings receive customs and due?  
 From their sons or strangers in view?"

26 Peter answer him, "From the crew  
 Of strangers." Jesus said to him,  
 "Then truly sons are free on brim.

27 "But so we don't offend the lot,  
 Go to the sea and what you've got  
 In way of hook throw in and take  
 The first fish that swims in its wake.  
 And open its mouth then to find

A coin. Take that and go to bind  
 Their tax for you and me in stake."

The world goes after wonders of the fish,  
 And how Jesus could know and Peter wish  
 A coin into its mouth. But I am blessed  
 To gaze rather at what Jesus confessed.  
 Since You, Beloved, are Father of mankind  
 As well as bird and fish upon the Wynd,  
 No tax laid down by ruler of the state  
 Or civil servant to collect in rate  
 Is justified. But so's not to offend  
 Their sensitivity in the back end,  
 We pay up with a smirk behind the hand.  
 It's much the same as with the robber band.  
 Beloved, as Your son on the thousand hills,  
 I owe You only, and no other bills.

### **Matthew 18**

1 Right then the disciples came to  
 Jesus, saying "Say now then who  
 Is greater in the kingdom of  
 Heaven here or there up above?"

2 And Jesus called up a wee child  
 And set him among them *unguiled*.

3 And he said "Truly I tell you,  
 Unless you change and be in view  
 Like little children, none of you  
 Can even enter then into  
 The kingdom of the heavenly crew.

4 "Then whoever will humbly be  
 As this wee child, this one truly  
 Is greater in heaven's kingdom's spree.

The Lord does not command his own to be  
 As lacking in knowledge as a child wee.  
 He does not order lack of competence,  
 He does not order sweetness in the tents.  
 Humility alone is what he makes  
 The way of children for disciples' sakes.  
 Discussion of who's greater in the group  
 Is the most burning issue in the loop.  
 Without its contemplation, there is no  
 Confederation in the human show.  
 By the requirement of humility  
 The Lord dissolves all acts of unity  
 And in one word disbands both church and  
 state

And takes the reins himself of small and  
 great.

5 "And whoever receives one such

Wee child in my name comes to touch  
 Me. 6 “But whoever causes one  
 Of these wee ones with faith well won  
 In me and so offends the mite,  
 It would be better in his sight  
 For a millstone that turned by ass  
 Be hung on his neck and like bass  
 Be sunk in the deep sea to pass.  
 7 “Woe to the world from its offence!  
 Offence will come, yet woe’s expense  
 To that man through whom comes extents.  
 8 “And if your hand or foot offend,  
 Just cut it off and cast a bend,  
 It’s better you come into life  
 Lame or maimed, than to come in strife  
 Of two hands or two feet to be  
 Thrown in fire of eternity.  
 9 “And if your eye offends you, pluck  
 It out and cast it from your luck,  
 It’s better you come into life  
 One-eyed than having two with knife  
 Be thrown into hell’s fire with fife.  
 10 “Make sure you do not despise one  
 Of these wee ones, for when all’s done  
 I tell you that their angels won  
 In heaven constantly look upon  
 The face of my Father in heaven.

Beloved, I praise You for these words  
 unkept,  
 Expression of the son of man who wept.  
 Those who offend the wee ones on Your  
 earth  
 Look for a judgement and a punished berth.  
 It’s not that I remark how many small  
 Children are offended by man and pall,  
 But that I know in that society  
 Where I live I am truly of the wee.  
 I’ve been offended daily by the spree  
 Of folk who do not dream that they await  
 Enormous punishment at coming gate.  
 My preaching has led few to You and life,  
 But many times more to the coming strife.  
 I’m gate of hell to all those holding knife.

11 “For son of man *by bread or leaven*  
 Has come to save the lost *and gone*.  
 12 “What do you think? If any man  
 Has one hundred sheep in his span,  
 And one of them wanders away,  
 Will he not leave ninety-nine gay  
 Upon the mountains and go out

To look for the one left in doubt?  
 13 “And if he happens to find it,  
 Truly I tell you he comes fit  
 Rejoicing greatly over it  
 More than over the ninety-nine  
 That did not stray to line and pine.  
 14 “So it is not the will before  
 Your Father in celestial score  
 That one of these wee folk should die.  
 15 “But if your brother comes to sin  
 Against you, go reprove and win  
 Him just between the two of you.  
 And if he hears you, you have gained  
 Your brother *from the baned and stained*.  
 16 “But if he does not hear, take one  
 Or two more with you, so what’s done  
 May be in the mouth of the two  
 Or three witnesses standing true.”  
 17 “But if he fails to hear them, tell  
 It to the congregation well.  
 And if he also fails to hear  
 The assembly, let him appear  
 To you as Gentile and the one  
 Who comes to collect taxes done.  
 18 “Truly I say to you, what you  
 Bind on the earth will be shut too  
 In heaven. What you forgive on earth  
 In heaven too receives such worth.

No one I know seems to take note of this:  
 The court of justice from beginning’s bliss  
 Does not take in account the conflict that  
 Arises when the brother denies flat  
 That he has sinned at all. It only goes  
 To serve when there’s agreement in the  
 rows  
 That one has sinned against the other’s  
 toes.  
 What shall I do, Beloved, when hurt to core  
 And find the perpetrator of that score  
 Will not admit the wrong he’s done to me?  
 Should he then be allowed to go scot-free?  
 Of course the punishment this new law  
 brings  
 Is social ostracism in the wings.  
 All sinners go scot-free in Jesus springs.

19 “Again I say to you, if two  
 Of you agree on earth for due,  
 Whatever they ask, it shall be  
 Awarded from my Father *free*  
 In heaven as a *gift faithfully*.

20 "For where two or three gather in  
My name there I'm with them to win."

The kingdom of Christ and of David too,  
The follower of Abrahamic crew,  
Is found today as then among the few,  
The gathering of two or three in pew.  
The musahip, the pair that prays together,  
Is the only church that can bear the  
weather.

As soon as more are taken in the launch  
They must quarrel about who is the  
craunch.

Beloved, though I may complain of the  
fact,

My congregation's too small in the pact  
Of me and spouse and daughter and  
grandson,

Truth is it is too numerous by one,  
Fact is we could divide in half to be  
Two churches independent from the spree.

**I hereby institute the heavenly church,  
The true church for all those left in the  
lurch,**

**The Church of the Beloved, where two  
or three**

**Gather in Your mercy's eternity  
To covenant in promises to see**

**In Decalogue by David's throne and  
perch.**

**I meet the son of David day by day  
To read Beloved and I without the pay,  
And find the Sabbath temple in time  
come**

**Each week to fill my pleasure and my  
sum.**

**My only law's the ten commandments  
here,**

**My only love is You whom I hold dear  
And see in the face of the ones come near  
To cantillate Your Word, to pray and  
hum.**

21 Then Peter came to him and said  
"Sir, how many times being bled  
When my brother sins against me  
Shall I forgive him and freely,  
Up to seven times *hit in the head*?"  
22 Jesus said to him, "I don't say  
To you, up to seven times *a day*,  
But up to seventy times seven's *sway*."

When I have learned to keep Your law for  
good

And obey each command as well I should,  
And when the legal practices that bind  
And shore up all the principles in mind  
Are well established in my good behaviour,  
And I can finally dispense with saviour,  
Then there shall still be amply seven times  
And seventy and more of all my crimes  
Since I so often breathe a breath without  
Remembering what Your name's all about.  
Forgive that I add little mind to breath  
As I go rushing onward and toward death.  
And yet I whisper with each breath Your  
name,  
And in my sleep say Huu and so acclaim.

23 Because of this the kingdom of  
Heaven is like a man, king for love,  
Who wanted to take an account  
Of his slaves. 24 And starting amount,  
One debtor of ten thousand grand  
Was brought to him in the demand.

25 But he had nothing to repay,  
So the ruler ordered in sway  
For him to be sold and his wife  
And all his children, goods and fife,  
All he had so that he could pay.

26 The slave fell in prostration and  
Bowed the knee to him saying grand  
"Sir, have patience with me, and I  
Will pay all back to you *or try*."

27 And filled with pity then the king  
Of that slave released him to sing,  
Forgiving him the loan and thing.

28 But as he went out that slave found  
One of his fellow slaves around  
Who owed him one hundred dinars.  
He seized him and he choked to scars  
And said "Now pay me what you owe."

29 The fellow slave was not one slow  
To fall down and beg saying so:  
"Have patience, I'll pay all I owe."

30 But he would have nothing of that,  
But cast in prison where he sat  
Till he should pay back all he owed.

31 But his fellow slaves saw what stowed  
And were grieved by it greatly too.

And they went to report it to  
Their master, all that had come true.

32 The master summoned him and said

“You are a wicked slave and bred,  
 I released you from all the debt  
 Because you begged with your heart set.  
 33 “Should you not have had mercy then  
 On your fellow slave among men  
 As I had mercy on you then?”  
 34 His master was then filled with wrath  
 And set him in the gaolers’ path  
 Till he should pay back all his debt.  
 35 My heavenly Father’s heart is set  
 To do so to you with regret  
 Unless each of you from the heart  
 Forgive his brother of sin’s part.

Beloved, your sent one’s here at last  
 Betraying Christendom’s false blast  
 That sacrifice vicarious  
 Is the only path to the bus.  
 By parable he gives command  
 In the most warning kind of stand,  
 That we must forgive and must be  
 Forgiven only by mercy  
 Without a sacrifice at all.  
 When the slave pushed against the wall  
 Demanded even restitution,  
 The master vanquished his solution.  
 Beloved, forgive me now indeed  
 As I forgive who do not plead.

### Matthew 19

1 It happened after Jesus finished  
 Speaking these words, he moved  
     *diminished*  
 From Galilee and came up to  
 The border of Judea’s view  
 The other side of Jordan’s *stream*.  
 2 And great crowds followed him *on beam*  
 And he healed them there *like a dream*.  
 3 The Pharisees came to him to  
 Tempt him and say to him in crew,  
 “Is it lawful for a man to  
 Divorce his wife for any due?”  
 4 But he answered them saying true,  
 “Have you not read that He who came  
 Creating at the start of game  
 Created them male and female?”  
 5 And he said “That’s why a man leaves  
 His dad and mum and joins his sleeves  
 To his wife and the two become  
 One flesh *to go about and hum*,  
 6 “So that they are no longer two,  
 But one flesh. So what God’s joined crew,

Let no man come to separate.”

Your sent one suggests that the best to follow

Is always earliest text come to swallow.  
 He chooses Eden’s fair estate to show  
 The rule of marriage, not the come and go  
 Of the Mosaic code of concubine  
 And second and third wife upon the vine,  
 Of divorce and the climate of the wine.  
 All others in their wait require the late  
 In text to supersede the early state.  
 So Christians take the Gospel and the grate  
 Of St. Paul, while the Muslims quash them all

And start with the Qur’an upon the wall.  
 I choose no sides, but still with Jesus fall  
 Just since I’m still working on the first call.

7 They said to him, “Then why did Moses  
 Command to give divorcement closes  
 And put away the dame that chose us?”  
 8 He told them, “In hardness of heart,  
 Moses allowed the both to part.  
 But it was not so from the start.”

Anything taught after refusal to  
 Hear the words on Sinai, rebellious crew,  
 Is given as a second choice in view  
 Of hardness of the heart instead of true.  
 Beloved, I cast aside my favourite saints,  
 Both Moses, even David of complaints,  
 And Jesus and Muhammad and Ali,  
 And come to You alone who set me free  
 From the hardheartedness of church and state,

Of synagogue and even the mosque late.  
 All are hard-hearted on this dergah floor,  
 Despite the beauty of every heart’s core  
 Where You sit in reflection, the great I,  
 The only One, Beloved, that I can spy.

9 And I tell you, “Whoever puts  
 Away his wife, if not for gluts  
 Of uncleanness, and goes to marry  
 Another, commits adultery.  
 And the one who marries her who  
 Was put away commits it too.”  
 10 His disciples said to him, “If  
 The case of man and wife’s so stiff,  
 Better to go jump off a cliff  
 Than marry and suffer the diff.”



11 But he said to them, "Not all make Room for this message, but for sake Of those to whom it's given in stake."  
 12 "For there are eunuchs who were born So from their mother's womb unsworn, And there are eunuchs who were made Eunuchs by men, and so they stayed, And there are eunuchs who themselves Made themselves eunuchs *among elves* For the sake of heaven's kingdom's *shelves*.

The one who can take this let him Receive it *and live with it grim*."

Beloved, I bring You word Your sent one's told  
 A thing beyond the message wrought in gold  
 That You gave from the start. He's been too bold.

He makes it sound like celibate estate Is more blessed than the ecstasy of rate And rocking in rhythm to copulate. If he thinks so, I doubt his data's great Enough to make comparison of late. By his own exegesis from the start To make of Genesis the better part, He's wrong. The celibate way is result Of hardened hearts, unless he'd catapult Us into wedding chemical and take Divine Sophia both to sleep and wake.

13 They brought wee children up to him So he might lay hands on them trim And pray. But the disciples came And rebuked them saying for shame.  
 14 But Jesus said "Permit the wee Children and don't prevent their glee To come to me, for of such is The kingdom of heaven in biz."  
 15 And laying hands on them, he went Away from there *as he was sent*.

This text is so abused, Beloved, I'd think You would have prevented it on the brink Of canonizing writings on the blink. Some say it means that children ought to take

A squirt of water on the head for sake Of immersion, while others see excuse In laying on of hands for their abuse. The evils of priestcraft and paedophile

Go hand in hand a weary watch and mile. A clear text to put those men down with smile  
 Would have been better than to greet with guile.

It must be Your love of wee ones blinds You  
 To politics and wickedness of crew  
 Of adults leaning on the fence in view.

16 See one came near and said to him, "Good Rabbi, what good thing with vim Shall I do that I may indeed Inherit eternal life's seed?"

17 And he told him, "Why do you call Me good? No one is good *in stall* Except One, God! But if you wish To enter into life, then *fish*  
 To keep the commandments in all."

18 He asked him then "Which?" And Jesus Said "You shall not kill nor commit Adultery, nor in a fit Steal nor bear false witness *with grit*,  
 19 "But honour your dad and your mum, And love neighbour as self *in sum*."

The human heart divides Your law in two, Beloved, and that's why every blasted crew Takes the last thing here, which alone is not Writ in the Sinai message for a plot To deny that Your oneness, image, name And Sabbath should be counted in the game.

So treacherous is human thought to find The meaning of Your word when left behind.

The fact he only quotes a part of it Does not mean he thinks the rest is unfit. The fact he quotes another verse instead Does not mean he would pour upon our head  
 More obligations than You Yourself fed.  
 But he affirms the Sinai message writ.

20 The young man told him, "All these things I've kept from my youth up *in springs*. What more do I need *without strings*?"

Let this be a good lesson to both me And You, Beloved, sitting up in Your tree.

Don't ask more questions than you should  
and be  
Both satisfied with the first answer's fee  
And happy to get on with what sweet spree  
At the time brightens our eternity.  
What's wrong with every faith established  
here

Is this precisely, commandments in fear  
Numbered from one to ten do not appear  
To be enough for foolish human mind.  
Beloved, I take the Decalogue and find  
It sweet and far sufficient for my kind,  
Simply because I'm neither rich nor blind  
To satisfy my heart in You resigned.

21 Then Jesus said to him, "If you  
Wish to be perfect, residue  
Of all your property both sell  
And give to the poor, and *pell-mell*  
You'll have treasure in heaven's *well*,  
And come and follow me a *spell*."  
22 But the young man heard the word in  
Great sorrow, because in his bin  
He had great wealth *which is no sin*,  
And so he went off *with no grin*.

I told you so! Jesus would never bother  
To say such hard things if people had rather  
Stuck to their own business instead of  
coming  
To ask about deep secrets they've been  
humming.  
Now all the cloistered hermitage of hell  
Proliferating in the Christian dell  
Is justified, also justified well,  
Because one young man could not keep his  
mouth  
Shut in the face of truth blown in from  
south.  
Who knows what damage I have done,  
though I  
Am far from young and being rather sly,  
For all the crowd of words I have put by?

23 Jesus told his disciples then,  
"Truly I tell you among men  
The rich man will find very hard  
To enter heaven's kingdom *barred*.  
24 "And I tell you again, it's easier  
For a camel to pass through *breezier*  
A needle's eye, that for a man  
Of wealth to enter in *the span*

*Of the kingdom of God by plan."*

25 His disciples greatly surprised  
Heard this when they'd been so apprised,  
And said "Then who can be saved here?"  
26 But Jesus looked at them and said  
"With men impossible is bred,  
But with God all things can be sped."

If it's too hard for wealth to come into  
Your kingdom, still it seems this word if  
true

Is too hard for the Christian in the pew.  
I've heard at least three explanations fit  
To show that the word means another wit  
Than what it says about the camel's size  
And where a needle fits in needle's guise.  
The wealthy are not comfortable here,  
And the poor too gloat too much at the ear.  
Beloved, I'm not set up here to condemn,  
My purpose and my role upon Your hem  
Is not to justify, explain or crow.  
It's merely to point out the jaundiced show.  
Do as You like with camels, men, and  
dough.

27 Peter replied and said to him,  
"See, we've left everything in trim  
And followed you. What then shall be  
The fate of us most faithfully?"  
28 And Jesus said to them, "Truly  
I say to you, who's followed me,  
In the time when the son of man  
Sits on throne of his glory's span,  
You also will sit on twelve thrones,  
And judge Israel's twelve tribes *from  
stones*.

29 "And everyone who's left house and  
Brothers or sisters, father and  
Mother or wife or children or  
Land for sake of my name in score  
Shall get return a hundredfold,  
And life eternal in the fold.  
30 "But many first ones shall be last,  
And last ones be first *in the blast*."

If Jesus meant the promise that he made  
Should be pie in the sky and on parade,  
It's certain that his followers did not  
Understand such a thing to be their lot.  
They understood that they should sit on  
thrones  
In Palestine in their own life of groans,

And not in future kingdom ages thence.

That's certain as they sat there in their tents.

Beloved, I bring a suit against the one

You sent to tell us all about the fun.

If he did not lie when he gave his word,

At least he led astray and made hearts stirred

With something promised that did not come true

In the lifetime of any of that crew.

### Matthew 20

1 For heaven's kingdom's like a man,

Housemaster, who went out to scan

Early the workers who should come

Into his vineyard, *and not scum*.

2 He agreed with the workers for

A dinar for the day in store

And sent them to his vineyard door.

3 He went out once more the third hour

And saw some standing round to scour

The market idle, 4 said to them,

"Go also to my vineyard's hem

And I'll give you what's just in hem."

And so they went. 5 Again he went

About the sixth and ninth hour spent,

And did the same *with every sent*.

6 He went out at eleventh hour

And found some idle standing dour,

And said to them, "Why stand all day?"

7 They answer him then in this way,

"Because no one has hired for pay."

He said to them, "You also go

Up to the vineyard for a show,

And you'll get paid for a just row."

I'm not sure that employment office now

Is better than just standing to allow

The patrons in the market come to see

Who's out of work and ready for the bee.

Such offices tend to serve just the goal

Of keeping their own workers off the dole.

It's natural in any case that makes

No product the reward for all its stakes.

And nowadays, beyond the telephone

And file there is the whiz and whir and groan

Of desk computer to make sure that all

Seem busy and productive in the mall.

Beloved, I seek a simpler life and find

My poverty upon the hill well-dined.

8 When evening came the master of  
Vineyard summoned manager's glove,

"Call in the workers and give pay,

Beginning from the last in sway,

Back to the first and in that way."

9 And those who had arrived at last

At the eleventh hour to cast

Received a dinar as earned fast.

When the first ones arrived to stay,

They thought they'd get some more in sway.

But they each got a dinar's pay.

11 And when they got it they complained

Against the master who'd retained.

12 They said "These last just worked an hour,

And you've made them equal in power

To us who have carried the tower

And heat of the day *under bower*."

I'm not so much astounded that a lord

And vineyard owner should, when he had scored,

Been less than just in terms of equal shares.

That's no concern of wealthy nor their cares.

What bothers me is the twelve hours of work,

When by my calculations at the dirk,

An eight-hour day is better for a perk.

Let not this Jesus institute a way

Of grand oppression like the early sway

Of the industrial revolution's play.

I'm glad I did not live in Jesus' day.

I'd rather work the eight while all alive

Deny the faith and adhere in a hive

To a false church. My fate is where I thrive.

13 But he replied and said to one

Of them, "My friend, I have not done

You wrong. Did you not once agree

With me for dinar's salary?"

14 "Take yours and go. It's my own wish

To give the last too the same *dish*.

15 "Is it not lawful that I do

What I want with my things *and crew*?

Or is your eye wicked because

I am good *and without sharp claws*?"

16 So the last shall be first, the first

Shall be last *though they are uncursed*,

For many are called *to the row*,

But few are chosen *as they go*.

There are but few today who really think  
That everyone that's born on earth to sink  
Should have an equal show for what they  
think.

Justice today is more the rhetoric  
Of those who have a share in politic  
To ration an elite some of the thick  
And leave majority without a stick.  
For forty years no one has wasted breath  
On justice for justice' sake before death.  
Beloved, the story means but little now  
Beyond the fact that salary somehow  
Is all a trick of whim and luck and brow.  
That may indeed be good reflection of  
Your universe and what You take for love.

17 Jesus went to Jerusalem,  
And took his twelve disciples' hem  
From the way and he said to them:  
18 "See we're going to Jerusalem,  
And the son of man there will be  
Betrayed to the chief priests freely  
And to the scribes. And they'll condemn  
Him to death *on the wicked tree*.  
19 "And they'll give him up to Gentiles  
To mock and scourge and in their guiles  
To crucify. And the third day  
He'll rise again *in glory's way*."

The only thing that Jesus seems to take  
From solar myths himself before the rake  
Of crucifixion is the third day's stake.  
The Jonah tale is full of solar cake.  
What resurrection of the man in fact  
Speaks of is that his innocence well-packed  
Conquered at last the humdrum civil  
servant  
That signed the sentence without being  
fervent.

If Jesus really rose up from the dead,  
It's not my sins that benefit when led,  
But the good news that the establishment  
That killed him could not touch the one  
You sent.  
And if not him, then never anyone  
Who sticks to Your law even under sun.

20 Then the mother of the sons of  
Zebedee came to him *in love*  
Along with her sons, and bowed down

And asked a favour from his *crown*.  
21 And he said to her, "What do you  
Desire?" She answered to him true  
"Give order that my sons, these two,  
May sit one on Your right hand due  
And one on your left in the day  
You come into your kingdom's sway."  
22 But Jesus answered her and said  
"You do not know what you are led  
To ask. Are you able to drink  
The cup of which I'm on the brink,  
And be baptised with the immersion  
With which I'm getting with aversion?"  
They said to him, "We will not sink."  
23 And he said to them, "Indeed you  
Shall drink my cup, my cup of rue,  
And you shall be immersed with that  
Sinking in which I'm sunk in vat,  
But to sit on my right and left  
Is not mine to give *as bereft*,  
But to those for whom it was planned  
By my Father *in His command*."

Some think that Jesus is the power behind  
The universe instead of You in kind.  
But here he says he does not have the mind  
To give a place of credit to a friend.  
He's not much use to my ambition's end.  
If I would be great, let me serve, says he.  
I serve no one at all, for I am free.  
I do not seek to be great any more,  
Since I found out from Jesus the true score.  
The search for fame and greatness, though  
a chore,  
Leaves only emptiness before the door.  
I gain more from the patch my wife  
prepares  
To hold the flower garden and its wares.  
Let others live with conscious and with  
stares.

24 The ten were angry when they heard  
What the two brothers there had stirred.  
25 But having called them, Jesus said  
"You know that rulers of lands led  
Hold power above them by the hand  
Of high chiefs controlling the land.  
26 "But it will not be so with you.  
But whoever wishes in pew  
To be great, let him come to serve.  
27 "Whoever wants to be the first  
Among you let him serve, *not swerve*

*Among the ambitious and cursed.*

28 “Just as the Son of Man did not  
Come to be served, but to serve lot,  
To give his life a ransom plot.”

In all the many competitions here  
For place and power, wealth and fine  
career,

I covet that place where Your sent one sat,  
The lowest place, the servant’s habitat.  
He came, as every one that You have sent,  
To spend his life in service where he went,  
A ransom for the poor and the oppressed  
Who were downtrodden by the better  
dressed.

And so he lived, and so he came to die,  
Whether obscure or in the public eye,  
Obedient servant, Torah-true from first  
To last. Leave me to give my life, though  
worst,

In service to Your throne, let me live life  
Below the threshold of the worldly strife.

### **Matthew 21**

1 When they came near Jerusalem  
As far as Bethphage, toward hem  
Of Mount Olives, then Jesus sent  
Two disciples, 2 as he had meant,  
“Go to the town across from you  
And straight off you will find in view  
A donkey tied and colt on cue.

Untie them and bring to my pew.

3 “If anyone says aught to you,  
You shall reply, ‘The Lord has need  
Of them,’ and he’ll make so decreed.”

4 But all this happened to fulfil  
What the prophet said for a drill:

5 “Then the daughter of Zion, see,  
Your king comes to you, meek to be  
Riding on a donkey and on  
A colt, the offspring of an ass.”

6 And the disciples soon were gone  
To do what Jesus said to pass.

7 They led the donkey and the colt.  
They put on them garments *to bolt*,  
And set him on them *for a ride*.

Sometimes the stories told around the fire  
By redskins satisfied of their desire  
Include such episodes that one cannot  
Imagine because of some crazy knot.  
The rabbit licks his elbow for a chance,

The children turn to stars, begin to dance.  
This is a crazy knot here, I must say,  
This riding on two donkeys in the way.  
No wonder crowds came by and stopped to  
sway.

Some circus prancers can accomplish it  
While standing, but there’s no one who can  
sit

On two beasts at one time, and that’s  
because

A man has got just one sitter in pause.  
St. Matthew is a man of greatest wit.

8 The multitude scattered their clothes  
Upon the road, and others rose  
To cut off branches from the trees,  
And spread them in the way for ease.

9 And the crowd both in fore and aft  
Cried out and said *not being daft*,  
“Hosanna to the son of David!  
Blessed is the one who is unslavèd  
To come in the name of the Lord!  
Hosanna to the highest scored!”

I too praise any son of David who  
Comes in the lovely name of YHWH and  
You!

But where I live the holy spirit’s not  
A dove, it’s more a sparrow that’s been  
shot,

If the decorum in the vestige pew  
Of Pentecostal where I live in view  
Is indication of what’s right and true.  
That means that following the custom here,  
My praise is rather quiet. I appear  
But seldom in the public eye with great  
And sounding voice to praise You in such  
rate.

Though branches there may be and some to  
spare,

The area’s a nature reserve’s share.  
I’m not allowed to come with axe and pare.

10 So he entered Jerusalem,  
All the town was shaken with them,  
And said “Who’s this?” 11 The crowd  
replied,

“This is Jesus, who is the *loud*  
Prophet from Nazareth *unbowed*  
In Galilee.” 12 Jesus went in  
The temple of God *and the din*  
And threw out all of those who sold

And bought inside the court threshold.  
He overcast the tables where  
The money changers changed their ware,  
And the seats of those selling doves.  
13 And he said to them *without gloves*,  
“It’s written, My house shall be called  
A house of prayer, but you’ve installed  
A den of thieves.” 14 And blind and lame  
Ones came to him in temple frame  
And he healed them *in every claim*.  
15 But the chief priests and scribes who

saw  
The miracles he did with awe,  
And all the children crying out  
In the temple saying with shout,  
“Hosanna to David’s son,” they  
Were angry *in their priestly sway*.  
16 And they said to him, “Do you hear  
What these people are saying here?”  
And Jesus said to them, “I do.  
Did you never read *the Psalm true*,  
‘Out of the mouth of babes and sucklings  
You’ve ordained praise’ *on all these  
bucklings?*”

The son of David quotes the Psalms, I  
swear,  
He knows the wonders of the tinkling air.  
If Jesus is the son of David, I  
Bow to him and his right to rule the sky.  
But if he’s just a god incarnate then  
I leave him with the rest of such god-men  
To wander in the myths of pagan rite  
That I turn from for good and hide my  
sight.

All men have their own prejudices here,  
Some follow what they’re taught from birth  
to fear,  
Some follow what they think is right and  
clear,  
Some follow the majority with cheer,  
But let me, My Beloved, keep at my ear  
Your voice alone and David’s songs alight.

17 He left them and went from the town  
To Bethany, and settled down.  
18 When he came back to town at dawn,  
He felt his hunger drawing on.  
19 He saw a fig tree by the road,  
And went up to it seeking food,  
And found nothing but leaves to goad.  
And he said to it, “Let there be

No fruit on you eternally.”  
And the fig tree straight off dried up  
*So no one there could drink or sup*.  
20 When his disciples saw the thing  
They marvelled at it and saying  
“How quickly the fig tree dried up!”  
21 Jesus replied as fast as tup,  
“Truly I tell you, if you’ve faith  
And do not doubt *for sound or wrath*,  
Not only will you do the great  
Miracle of the fig tree’s fate,  
But even if you said command  
To this mountain ‘Go up and stand  
In the midst of the sea,’ it would.  
22 “And everything you ask or should  
In prayer, believing, so you could.”

It’s right to curse the human soul that  
makes  
Light of Your ten commandments and  
mistakes  
The self to be a god who ought to get  
All glory and all honour on the set.  
But is it right to curse the humble tree  
That brings forth by the laws You set to be  
The gauge of life and love eternally?  
I think not, my Beloved, I think not yet.  
A doubting Thomas, I lack faith and daring  
To contemplate and act on what You’re  
sharing.  
If You provide no fruit upon the bush,  
I rejoice in the shade it comes to push.  
Let those You send from now on pity green  
Things growing on the earth from thorn to  
bean.

23 When he had come into the court  
Of holiness, the chief priests’ sort  
And elders of the folk came by  
Him as he taught, saying *in sly*,  
“By what authority do You  
Do these things? And who gave to you  
This power *to grant and say and do?*”  
24 And Jesus answered them and said  
“I’ll ask you one thing, if you’re led  
To tell me, then I’ll also tell  
You by what authority *swell*  
I do these things *and do them well*.  
25 “The baptism of John, from where  
Was it? From heaven or human share?”  
And they reasoned among themselves,  
Saying “If we admit like elves

From heaven, then he will say to us,  
 'Why did you not believe the buss?'  
 26 "But if we say from men alone,  
 Then we fear the folk won't atone,  
 For all consider John to be  
 A true man of God's prophecy."  
 27 And they replied to Jesus then  
 Saying "We do not know *for yen*."  
 And he said to them, "Neither then  
 Will I tell what authority  
 I have to do the things you see.

By what authority did Jesus, John,  
 Muhammad and Elijah come upon  
 The earth to teach and do. Say, by what  
 power?

I see that You are silent for an hour.  
 Ask me the question difficult and sound,  
 And I shall answer You upon the ground.  
 By what authority? I hear around  
 The din of truth that preachers all  
 propound,  
 But hear no rate of who sent them to speak  
 In Your name telling all the folk to seek  
 Some other way besides the one You spoke  
 On Mount Sinai. Who proclaims it a joke?  
 By what authority do men now take  
 Qur'ans and Testaments outside Your  
 stake?

28 "But what do you think? Once a man  
 Had two sons, and coming by plan  
 To the first he said, 'Son, go out  
 Today and work the vineyard route.'  
 29 "And he replied and told his dad,  
 'I will not.' But after when sad  
 He went and did so, *a good lad*.  
 30 "He went then to the second son,  
 And said the same. And then *by gun*  
 He answered, 'I'm off, sir, to run.'  
 But he did not get off his bun.  
 31 "Which of the two now did the will  
 Of the father?" They answered still,  
 "The first." Jesus then said to them,  
 "Indeed I tell you, *by the hem*  
 Tax takers and their prostitutes  
 Enter before you *in your boots*  
 The kingdom of God *for cahoots*.  
 32 "For John came to you in the way  
 Of righteousness, you would not pay  
 Attention to him. But the ones  
 Who gather taxes and the tons

Of prostitutes believed him well.  
 You saw it happen for a spell  
 But you did not repent at all  
 After that and believe his call."

Of prostitutes I shall not say a word.  
 But I doubt now such things could have  
 occurred  
 That tax collectors ever'd be preferred.  
 Perhaps in ancient Rome the tax was  
 lawful.

But in the USA it is just awful  
 Work of such bandits as were never known  
 Under the reign of tyrants on the throne.  
 The tax on tea was a malicious thing,  
 Perhaps or not. But the true spiralling  
 Came from the prohibition to instate  
 One's own in monetary aggravate.  
 The tax collection comes from banking  
 union  
 Out to impoverish without impunition.  
 There is no hope for any such a mate.

33 "So hear another story now.  
 There was a certain man, somehow  
 The master of a house, who came  
 To plant a vineyard in his name  
 And place a hedge around the same.  
 And he dug a winepress in it,  
 And built a tower to keep it fit.  
 He leased it out to keepers of  
 Vines and left the country to shove.  
 34 "And when the time of harvest came,  
 He sent his servants there to claim  
 From the vine workers' profits hame.  
 35 "And the vine workers took his slaves  
 And they beat one, and killed for graves  
 Another and one stoned *for shame*.  
 36 "And he sent more slaves than at first.  
 And they did the same at their worst.  
 37 "At last he sent his son to them,  
 Saying 'They will respect my gem.'  
 38 "But when they saw the son they said,  
 The vine workers among their dread,  
 'This is the heir. Come, let's kill him  
 And take his property with vim.'  
 39 "They took him and they threw him out  
 Of the vineyard, killed *with a shout*.  
 40 "So when the master of the house  
 Comes to the vineyard *like a mouse*,  
 How will he treat vine workers' clout?"  
 41 They said to him, "Such wicked men,

He'll utterly destroy them then,  
And he will lease the vineyard out  
To other vine workers and stout  
Who'll give him his due time again."

I do not know what rating should be given  
To such a movie as this where they've  
striven

And violently killed servant and son  
And anyone else who might fail to run.  
Your Jesus tells such grisly tales that I  
Might prevent hearing by the younger fry.  
If Jesus means he's at the pinnacle  
Of a long line of prophets in the pull  
Who were rejected, that's as might be here.  
It's human to reject what all men fear,  
And all men fear a man who does the good  
And fails not in speaking of what he  
should.

Beloved, keep me from violence of those  
Who run the church and state in stylish  
clothes.

42 Then Jesus told them, "Did you not  
Read in the Scriptures as you sought,  
'A stone which the builders rejected  
Became the corner stone confected?  
This was from YHWH a miracle  
Before our eyes *to view the pull?*'"

43 "Because of this I say to you,  
'The kingdom of God's gone from you,  
And it will be given to a crew  
Producing its fruits in His view.  
44 "And he who falls down on this stone  
Will be broken, but on whose bone  
It falls, it will crush him *alone.*'"

45 When the chief priests and Pharisees  
Heard his parables *taught with ease*,  
They knew he spoke of them *to freeze*.  
46 They would have arrested him then,  
But they were afraid of the men  
Who held him in a prophet's den.

I'm not at all sure when the word was writ  
About the corner stone once seen unfit,  
That ancient writer had in mind the man  
Jesus Christ as by some diviner plan.  
But if all others find the shoe fits well  
When they read Torah, Psalm, Prophet,  
Gospel,

Then I guess Jesus has a right to read  
The Scriptures to apply to him in need.

Beloved, I too am such a corner stone,  
Rejected from temple before the throne,  
With granite face lifted to sun and rain,  
To cloud and snowstorm, quiet without  
pain,

Awaiting word of silence come from You  
Before I rise and go to live and do.

## Matthew 22

1 And in reply Jesus again  
Spoke in parables to the men,  
Saying 2 The kingdom of Heaven  
Is like a man, a king who made  
A wedding feast for his son laid.  
3 And he sent his slaves to call those  
Invited to the wedding feast,  
But they did not want *feet that froze*.  
4 Again he sent more slaves increased,  
Saying "Tell the invited ones,  
See, I've prepared my supper buns,  
My oxen slain as well as fat,  
And everything's done in the vat,  
So come now to the wedding feast."  
5 But they did not mind him at all,  
And went away each to his thrall,  
One to his own field, and one to  
His merchandizing and his due.  
6 And the rest, seizing his slaves, then  
Insulted them and killed the men.

This talk of always killing's like to be  
A self-fulfilling sort of prophecy.  
If Jesus had just caught the vision of  
Conforming to the spirit of times in love  
He might well have avoided cross and date  
With death at such a young age and full  
pate.

The violence that Jesus sees around  
Him and remarks once with each warning  
sound

Is still the margin of the Roman share  
Of just war perpetrated everywhere.  
But I do not go out to stand before  
The tanks to keep them on their landing  
shore.  
That's why I've lived so long to share the  
score  
Of grey beard and grey hair, what's left in  
store.

7 And when he heard, the king became  
Filled with wrath and sent armies game



To destroy those murderers and  
 Burn down their city *at a stand*.  
 8 Then he said to his slaves, "Indeed,  
 The wedding feast's prepared for greed,  
 But the guests were not worth their seed.  
 9 "Then go out to highways and nooks  
 And call in all you find of crooks  
 Into the wedding feast agreed."  
 10 They went out in the highways and  
 Those servants gathered all in hand,  
 As many as they found to stand,  
 Both evil and good, so the grand  
 Wedding feast was filled up with guests.  
 11 And the king coming in to look  
 Over those set at tables' nook  
 Saw one man there without his vests  
 Of wedding garments *white on hook*.  
 12 And he said to him, "Friend, how did  
 You come in here without the bid  
 Of wedding dress?" But the man hid  
 His consternation without words.  
 13 Then the king said to the slave herds,  
 "Tie hand and foot and take away  
 And throw out into darkness' sway.  
 There shall be weeping there and gnashing  
 Of teeth before punishment slashing.  
 14 "For many are invited, but  
 Few do not find the door is shut."

I too have been in the attendance of  
 A wedding in Arab province of love.  
 When all were gathered to the feast in  
 sight,  
 Each guest was in a wedding garment  
 white,  
 A new dishdasha and face shining bright  
 Beneath the headdress bound before the  
 shove.  
 There were men at the door preventing  
 such  
 Uncouth from entering the feast to touch  
 The table and the hand of groom in clutch.  
 I guess the failure of the Nubian  
 Guards caused the situation of this man.  
 I'll take a lesson now, if ever son  
 Of mine is married, I shall have this done,  
 And set the Nubians about doors spun.

15 Then the Pharisees went and planned  
 How to trap him with wise words scanned.  
 16 They sent their disciples to him  
 Along with Herodians dim

Saying, "Rabbi, we know you're true  
 And teach the way of God as due,  
 And do not care about the folk,  
 Not looking to repute in stroke.  
 17 "So tell us what you think. Is it  
 Lawful to give Caesar a bit  
 In tribute or is it unfit?"  
 18 But Jesus recognized their guile  
 And said "Why do you tempt with smile,  
 You hypocrites *for bank and pile?*  
 19 "Show me the tribute coin." And they  
 Brought a dinar to him to say.  
 20 And he asked them, "Whose image here  
 And superscription do appear?"  
 21 They answered him "Caesar's." Then he  
 Told them, "Then give away in fee  
 To Caesar what is Caesar's own  
 And to God what is due His throne."  
 22 They marvelled when they heard the  
 thing,  
 And left him and went *on to sing*.

Beloved, Your sent one was so smart to say  
 A word to save his own skin on a day  
 When questioned about tribute in the sway  
 Of Rome. Since then his words have made  
 appeal  
 To justify the weight of stately heel.  
 But tyranny is never justified  
 By the submission of true to deride.  
 I submit with both courtesy and smile  
 To state and mugger intruding a while  
 Upon the way I walk with You a mile.  
 The coin is sound or not, but it discloses  
 A better lesson than the church imposes:  
 By wily in the way I answer those  
 Who question what I may or not oppose.

23 On that day, Sadducees, who say  
 There's no rising from death *to play*,  
 Came to him to question his way,  
 24 Saying "Rabbi, once Moses said  
 If any should die having wed  
 Without issue, his brother must  
 Marry his wife and raise up lust  
 Of seed to take his brother's crust.  
 25 "Well seven brother were with us.  
 The first one married *marvellous*  
 But died straight off without a child,  
 And so left wife to brother *wild*.  
 26 "In the same way the second one  
 And the third through the seven done.

27 "And last of all the woman too  
Died, *and so then died all the crew.*  
28 "Now in the resurrection who  
Of the seven will take her true  
To be his wife? All were her due."

The Levirate is something that I find  
Intriguing, though I am as one born blind,  
Not having any brother so confined.  
There are some tribes of people who relate  
To marriage to all brothers in one gate  
As the ideal or if not any rate  
The possible. And so I give the mate  
The answer that in Paradise or in  
The northern hills from India for sin  
All seven brothers can be husbands of  
One wife and still maintain the lady's love.  
If the Levirate is a case to be,  
Then surely any lady is set free  
To make her choice among the progeny.

29 Jesus replied and said to them,  
"You err not knowing Scriptures' gem  
Nor power of God *to raise the hem.*  
30 "For in the resurrection they  
Do not get married nor in sway  
Give in marriage, but they are like  
The angels in God's heaven *to strike.*

The Sadducean question comes alive:  
Then what are angels like if they don't  
wife?  
Both resurrection and angelic fare  
Seem to the Sadducee imaginaire.  
I've never seen a human being raised  
Up from the gloomy trough to see unfazed  
The light of day again. I've never seen  
An angel picking squash or corn and bean.  
So what's the marvel of the answer here?  
Jesus will silence one question in ear  
By raising one more issue that cannot  
Be demonstrated beyond being taught.  
Beloved, I will believe or not believe,  
It makes but little difference to Your  
sleeve.

31 "As for the resurrection of  
The dead, have you not read above  
What God spoke to you in *the shove*,  
Saying 32 'I'm Abraham's God and  
The God of Isaac, *understand*,  
And Jacob's God?' But God is not

God of the dead but of the lot  
Of living people *in their spot.*"  
33 When the crowd heard these words, then  
they  
Marvelled to hear his teaching's way.

The book of Jubilees makes it quite clear  
That Abraham died on the bosom dear  
Of Jacob, which means You are in the steer  
By saying You're the God of living three.  
There was a time out from eternity  
When Abraham and Jacob knew Your face,  
Though veiled behind the sunrise and its  
trace  
Of ruby and of amber to the race  
Of sunset by the sea, the rolling sea.  
Beloved, Your deity depends not on  
The life of anyone, not Jacob's spawn  
Nor of their fair ancestors in the dawn.  
You are the God of all, living and dead,  
Of animate and inanimate spread.

34 But when they heard he'd stopped the  
tongue  
Of Sadducees, Pharisees hung  
Together on the lower rung.  
35 And one of them, a lawyer, came  
To question him and tempt the same,  
And said 36 "Rabbi, which is the great  
Commandment of the law you rate?"  
37 And Jesus answered him, "You'll love  
The Lord your God with all the shove  
Of your heart, soul and mind above.  
38 "This is the first command and great.  
39 "The second's like it and to state:  
You'll love your neighbour as yourself.  
40 "These two commandments are the shelf  
On which all Law and Prophets hang,  
*The commandments with a big bang.*

Love for You and for all my fellowmen  
Does not exclude the women too, I ken.  
And yet both man and woman make the  
claim  
That since love fulfils all of the law's game  
I need not keep the Sabbath day at all.  
Love is enough upon the earthly brawl.  
If that be true, then I am free to kill  
And steal as well, if only love instil  
My motives for the both. It's right to slay  
Any of fellowmen if I can play  
That I love each and every one I slit

Open at throat or heart or where they sit.  
I can commit adultery too, if  
I love the gal, not just because I'm stiff.

41 But when the Pharisees came by  
Jesus began to question why,  
42 By saying "What now do you think  
About Messiah on the brink?  
Whose son is he?" And they replied,  
"He's son of David to *abide*."  
43 He said to them, "Then how indeed  
Does David when inspired to heed  
Call him lord, saying "YHWH said to  
My lord, sit at my right hand's view  
Until I put your enemies  
As a footstool for your foot's ease?  
45 "For if David calls him his lord,  
How is he then his son *adored*?"  
46 And nobody could answer him  
A word, nor did anyone dim  
Dare from that day to question him.

The point that Jesus makes about the king  
Calling his son sir is not hard to ring.  
First off, it's merely supposition that  
David himself penned those words where  
he sat.

The Psalm is one ambiguous to say  
"To David." If some other writer's sway,  
He may report what You spoke on a day  
To David, who was lord of him who wrote.  
If You gave David then dominion's boat,  
It does not follow that Messiah's float  
With all the hoped-for promises implied  
Is therefore ready to come and abide.  
Jesus has demonstrated only that  
It's messianic hopes that still fall flat.

### Matthew 23

1 Then Jesus spoke to the crowd and  
To his disciples on the land,  
2 Telling them: The scribes and the brand  
Of Pharisees sit in the seat  
Of Moses *as to gain a treat*.  
3 So everything he tells you to,  
Keep carefully and try to do,  
But do not do as they themselves  
Do, for they command *on the shelves*  
But do not carry out *like elves*.  
4 For they bind heavy burdens there,  
Burdens too heavy there to bear,  
And lay them on men's shoulders too,

But they do not want to come through  
To move them with one finger's cue.  
5 And they do all their works to be  
Seen by their fellows. They make free  
With broadest of phylactery,  
And make large the borders of clothes.  
6 They love the highest seat they chose  
At suppers, and the first seats in  
The synagogues *of their own sin*,  
7 And greetings in the market place,  
To be called Rabbi to the face.

The word of Jesus is ambiguous  
Here, which is nothing new to them or us.  
He says to follow verdicts of unjust,  
And then complains they're too harsh in the  
dust.

The only sense I make of this is that  
Some verdicts are right and ring in the vat,  
While others are undue, without  
foundation.

But how to know the difference in their  
station?

Beloved, I follow Decalogue as written  
And every law that comes after to sit on,  
If it is there to bolster and explain  
The Decalogue caught sunning in the rain.  
That does not make me Rabbi, no, nor  
brother.

At least it keeps me live and not to  
smother.

8 But you, do not be yourselves called  
Rabbi, for one's your chief installed,  
The Christ, and you are brothers called.  
9 And call no one your father here  
On earth, for One comes to appear  
In heaven, your Father, One to hear.  
10 Do not be called leaders, for One  
Is your leader, the Christ *when done*.  
11 But the greater among you must  
Be the servant the others trust.  
12 "And whoever exalts himself  
Will be humbled *upon the shelf*,  
And he who humbles himself will  
Be exalted *upon the hill*.

There are among the priests folk now call  
father  
Who are both humble and before the  
slaughter  
Take bullet before letting the flock fail.

Mechanical of word's no way to flail.  
 Besides that, my Beloved, it's just the way  
 We are made up today and yesterday  
 To call the man who begot us our dad.  
 Does Jesus think that is too vain and bad?  
 Refusal to call him our father would  
 In my book constitute an act of hood  
 Against the one commandment that we  
     should  
 Keep for the promise given to the good.  
 Jesus is not a Rabbi, no, nor teacher,  
 But riddle-teller instead of a preacher.

13 "But woe, you scribes and Pharisees,  
 Hypocrites! You shut up with ease  
 The kingdom of heaven for men,  
 For you neither go in *again*  
*Yourselves*, nor do you allow those  
 Who are entering where they chose.  
 14 "Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees,  
 Hypocrites! For you come to squeeze  
 Widows' houses, and for pretence  
 Make long prayers *and devoid of sense*.  
 Therefore you will receive the greater  
 Condemnation. 15 "Woe to you *later*,  
 Scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites!  
 You travel land and sea where sits  
 One to proselytize, and when  
 He's won, you make him twice again  
 A son of hell as yourselves *then*.

Your blessed Messiah came to compare  
     You  
 Who have comparison to none nor few.  
 If he's a son of God, then truth to tell,  
 His opponents are set as sons of hell.  
 So he compares, it seem, Your beloved  
     frame,  
 If frame You be or have beyond the name,  
 To hell. Now I suppose it may be true  
 That hell has as long pindle as You do  
 To beget sons. That quiet implication  
 Is found in every Trinitarian ration.  
 Indeed, it may well be that You abide  
 And hell as single one, not side by side.  
 In You all move and have their being wide,  
 Some for the bliss and some for being tried.

16 "Woe to you, blind guides, you who say  
 'Whoever swears by temple sway,  
 It does not hold, but who shall swear  
 By the gold the temple may wear,

He is bound *by the word that day*.  
 17 "Blind fools, which is the greater thing,  
 The gold or the temple whose wing  
 Makes the gold holy? 18 "Who shall swear  
 By the altar has naught to bear,  
 But who swears by the offering brought  
 Is bound *in everything he thought*.  
 19 "Blind fools, which is greater, the gift  
 Or the altar that for its shrift  
 Makes the gift holy *when it's caught*?  
 20 "Whoever then shall swear by altar  
 Swears by it and *without a falter*  
 By all that's on it, *bit and halter*.  
 21 "Who swears by temple swears by it  
 And by Him who lives in it *fit*.

I look, Beloved, upon the Kaaba drawn  
 In stone and beauty on the face of dawn,  
 Remembering whose birth hallowed the  
     place  
 And whose first cry lent emptiness its  
     grace.  
 I look, Beloved, upon the Kaaba where  
 I find Your house and home, yet know the  
     share  
 Is slight to hold eternity and all.  
 You are not made of matter in a wall.  
 You are not found in stone and mortar nor  
 Even within the infinite in shore  
 That seems the human heart. You are  
     beyond,  
 Below, within, without, all but a frond  
 Of hope and faith releases You to be  
 The God of my heart and eternity.

22 And he who swears by heaven above,  
 Swears by the throne of God of love,  
 And by Him who comes there to sit.

Beloved, I fail to swear indeed as I  
 See how the word of man is a far cry  
 From truth, and blindness also touches eye  
 Of even souls who cling to You alone.  
 And yet I come to You upon Your throne,  
 Despite the fact that I see nothing there,  
 Nor even any throne above to share.  
 You have no sight or sound upon the air,  
 Nor any form nor edge in my compare  
 By which I might distinguish Your own  
     face.  
 And yet I find You in this howling place.  
 Beloved, You are too close to me to see

Despite the throne that towers above me,  
Despite the emptiness my heart would  
trace.

23 Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees,  
You hypocrites! For you pay fees  
Of tithes of mint and dill and cummin,  
And you have left aside from humming  
The greater issues of the Law,  
Judgement, mercy, and faithful awe.  
It was right to do these, and not  
To have left those aside unsought.  
24 Blind guides, you strain out the gnat, but  
Swallow the camel in your gut.

Beloved, Your buddy makes, it would  
appear,  
Distinction between the laws in Your gear.  
Out of the six thirteen, it's said, I fear,  
That all are equal in their share of sheer.  
I join the Lord Jesus to make distinctions  
Between some laws and others in their  
pinktions,  
By saying that the Decalogue alone  
Is absolute before the divine throne.  
All other laws are set in time and place  
According to the needs of human race,  
And may change with the change of human  
face.

If right or wrong, I humbly take my stand  
And keep the straight path between shore  
and sand.  
It's far too narrow for a plane to land.

25 Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees,  
You hypocrites! You wash the frieze  
Outside of cup and dish, but leave  
The inside full of things to thieve.  
26 Blind Pharisee! Wash first the in  
Side of the cup and dish *for din*,  
So the outside of them may be  
Clean also from your robbery.  
27 Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees,  
You hypocrites! For at your ease  
You're like the whitened sepulchres,  
Which outwardly as it occurs  
Seem beautiful, but then inside  
Is where bones of the dead abide,  
And all corruption *for the ride*.  
28 So you too seem outside to be  
Righteous to men, but inwardly  
Full of lawless hypocrisy.

29 Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees,  
You hypocrites! You build degrees  
Of tombs for the prophets and bring  
Adornments for the tombs to sing  
Of the righteous. 30 And then you say  
"If we'd lived in our fathers' day,  
We would not have helped them to slay  
And shed the prophets' blood that way."  
31 So you bear witness to yourselves  
That you're the sons of all such elves  
Who murdered prophets *where they lay*.  
32 So what your fathers started then  
You bring to its completion's den.

Beloved, your sent one is insane to think  
That any human beings on the brink  
Could be consistent in each word and deed.  
We always speak ideals before we heed,  
And then fail to measure up to the creed.  
It's simply our humanity in need,  
And not hypocrisy now gone to seed.  
And yet, Beloved, I do admit the share  
Of very human in the word laid bare  
That Jesus speaks. We all expect the other  
To do as spoken by, despite the mother.  
I too learn with the years not to be rash  
In what I claim to do when I am brash,  
And give no credit but stick to bold cash.

33 You serpents and you vipers' breed,  
How shall you escape hell indeed,  
And hellish judgement on your greed?  
34 Because of this, see now, I send  
To you prophets and sages bend  
To scribes, and some of them you'll kill  
And crucify, and some you will  
Flog in your synagogues and will  
Persecute from town to town still,  
35 So that should come on you at last  
All the righteous blood that's been cast  
Out on the earth, from the blood of  
Righteous Abel to the blood of  
Zechariah-ben-Berechiah,  
*Who was a man a faithful crier*,  
Whom you slew twixt the Holy Place  
And the altar *and left the trace*.  
36 Indeed I tell you, all these things  
Fall on this generation's wings.

To call a man a snake is just too much,  
Beloved, although I see there is a touch  
Of pride in what my father says of such

Who're born in West Virginia without  
crutch.  
They're snakes and proud to be so on a day  
When the outsiders come along to play.  
Perhaps the ethnic pride itself comes in  
Corrupting long ago believers' din  
And so calls down on righteous pates to  
win  
The condemnation of Christ to their skin.  
Beloved, the serpent race in viper's hue  
Is in each heart and head of every crew,  
But can be quelled by Your sent one in  
view  
Who bears each heart a witness of You  
true.

37 Jerusalem, Jerusalem,  
Who kills the prophets in her hem,  
And stones those sent to her, how oft  
I wanted to gather undoffed  
Your children like a hen calls up  
Her chicks to wing because of tup,  
And you did not desire the cup.  
38 See now, your house is left to you  
In desolation, in plain view.  
39 For I say to you, in no way  
Shall you see me here on out gay  
Until the time that you will say  
"Blessed is he who comes in the name  
Of YHWH *and shall complete His claim.*"

I know the feeling, my Beloved. I see  
The infinite of dawn peek out to be  
The love of every face come around me,  
And when I cry with joy to see Your own,  
The face turns hard and shatters my faith's  
bone.

You are present in every human face,  
And yet You flee in ignorance to trace  
The selfish hope, the crass reward, the  
beam

Of taking for the true the things that seem.  
I know the disappointment, Love, and turn  
From every eye to the sky's eye to burn  
My sorrow in the leafy margin where  
Your ever-fleeting image comes to bear  
Lightly upon my breath, upon the stair.

## Matthew 24

1 Then Jesus went out and departed  
From the temple, and then they started,  
His disciples, to come to show

Him the temple buildings *below*.  
2 And Jesus said to them, "Do you  
Not see all these things? It is true,  
I say to you, not *one* stone shall  
Be left here standing up, that shall  
Not be thrown down." 3 Now as he sat  
On Mount of Olives, where he's at,  
Disciples came in private, saying,  
"Tell us, when will these things be? And  
What *will be* the sign that you stand  
To come, and of the age's end?"

It seems, Beloved, a stone or two's still  
standing  
In that distressful city that we're branding  
With violence as nothing new or old.  
The stone wall hot by day at night grows  
cold,  
Just like the hearts both hot and cold that  
bare  
Destruction in Jerusalem the fair.  
One sent from You proclaimed that they  
would stand  
One stone upon another in that land  
Until at last they all should be thrown  
down.

His hearers understood that time's renown  
To be at the last day, and so it seems  
That wall of stones still enters all men's  
dreams.

Throw down my stones, Beloved, today  
that I  
May enter in sweet judgement day's reply.

4 And Jesus answered them not staying,  
"Take heed no one deceives his friend.

5 "For many will come in my name,  
Saying, 'I am the Christ' *in fame*  
And will deceive many. 6 "And you  
Will hear of wars and rumours *true*.  
See that you are not troubled, for  
*All these* must come to pass *and more*,  
But the end is not yet. 7 "For nation  
Will rise against nation *and station*,  
And kingdom against kingdom. And  
There'll be famines *on every hand*,  
Pestilences, and earthquakes in  
Various places. 8 "All these *win*  
*As* the start of sorrows. 9 "Then they  
Will deliver you up *one day*  
To tribulation and kill you,  
And you will be hated *with rue*

By all nations for my name's sake.

Not many men say they are Christ and live  
Freely to speak again without the sieve  
Of watchful psychiatric care and aid  
Of calming drugs to empty what mind  
played.

Yet christs there be in every time and place  
A human being claims to show Your face  
To others with divine authority.  
Ah yes, there are the priests of trinity,  
Their bishops and their popes in quantity,  
Their chiefs of state and of economy,  
Their captains and their admirals as well  
As every boss that's known this side of  
hell.

Who is not deceived by the great and swell  
Will catch the tale of trouble such can tell.

10 "And then many will offence take,  
Each other will betray with hate.

11 "Then many false prophets *of late*  
Will rise up and deceive many.

12 "And because lawlessness reigns free,  
The love of many will grow cold.

13 "But he who endures *in the fold*  
Until the end shall then be saved.

14 "This kingdom's gospel *once engraved*  
Will be preached in all the world as  
A witness that each nation has,

And then the end will come. 15 "Therefore  
When you see what was said before  
By Daniel of 'abomination

Of desolation,' stand in station  
In holy place' (whoever reads,

May understand prophetic *seeds*),  
16 "Then let those who are in Judea

Flee to the hills *so they won't see you*.

17 "Let him who is on the housetop  
Not go down to take *from his crop*

*Or* anything out of his house,  
*Nor silver coin nor hen nor grouse*.

18 "And let him who is in the field  
Not go back to get clothes *concealed*.

19 "But woe to those who are with child  
And those who're nursing in days *mild*!

20 "And pray that your flight may not be  
In winter or Sabbath's *decree*.

Four things alone Your sent one in this  
book

Commands to pray for, now just take a  
look,

And the last is for peace on Sabbath day  
Not to be caught in flight within its ray.  
They tell me that was just because the Jews  
Would make the flight a hard one and  
abuse,

Not that Your own would keep the Sabbath  
true

And love to find it bringing them to You.

But the fulfilment of the prophecy

Of Daniel was long after the Jewry

Was in control of the Judean hills.

Abomination that comes in and spills

The temple mount was not built till the  
time

The Muslim hordes poured in with hoop  
and crime.

21 "For then there will be tribulation,  
Such as not known since instigation

Of the world till this time and station.

22 "And unless those days were made  
short,

No flesh would be saved *from their sport*,

But for the elect's sake those days

Will be shortened *and for God's praise*.

23 "Then if anyone says to you,  
'Look, here's the Christ!' or 'There!' then  
do

Not believe *it*. 24 "For false christs and

False prophets rise *on every hand*

And show great signs and wonders to

Deceive, if possible, the true.

25 "See, I have told you beforehand.

26 "Therefore if they say to you, 'Look,  
He's in the desert!' do not book

A flight, *or* 'Look, he's in the inner

Rooms!' then do not believe *the sinner*.

27 "For as the lightning comes from east

And flashes to the west *at least*,

So also will the coming be

Of Son of Man *for all to see*.

28 "For wherever the carcass is,

There eagles gather in a whiz.

Quotation from Daniel twelve seems to  
make

The fall of Ottomans the easy stake.

The tribulation came after that time,

The fall of the stock market and its rhyme,

The great depression and the holocaust

Come down upon the world that was still  
lost.

The tribulation was cut short at cost,  
And now we live in that brief generation  
Of some reprieve to Your own chosen  
nation.

In the midst of this controlled violence  
That in peace rests upon this earth's  
pretence  
Shall come the lightning strike to show the  
core

Of sin wrenched from the pot to touch the  
gore.

I wait the cataclismic, light-drenched shore.

29 "Right after those days' tribulation  
The sun will be darkened *in ration*,  
And the moon will not give its light,  
The stars will fall from heaven *as bright*,  
And the powers of the heavens be shaken.

30 "Then Son of Man's sign unmistakable  
Will appear in the sky, and all  
The tribes of earth will mourn *and fall*,  
And they will see the Son of Man  
Coming on heavenly clouds *by plan*  
With power and glory above all.

31 "And he will send his angels and  
A great sound of a trumpet grand,  
And they will gather his elect  
From the four winds, from one aspect  
Of heaven to the other *hand*.

Some say the signs have all fulfilled in  
past,

The dark day, the blood moon, the stars  
down-cast.

But those were just the shifting seams of  
time.

The world after the show went on to climb.  
Those wonders shall appear again one day,  
And when they do, it will be late to say  
Repent. The flower of Your eternity  
Will break through the veils for all men to  
see.

The argument of Jew and Christian then  
About the sought Messiah in his den  
Will matter no more, and the Muslim's  
fight

About the Mahdi, whether born or right,  
Will fail at last. And all shall see the sight,  
And leave off faith and hope before the  
bright.

32 "Learn this figure from the fig tree:  
For when its branch has already  
Become tender and puts forth leaves,  
You know that summer near retrieves.

33 "So you also, when you see all  
These things, know that it's near *the call*  
*And even* at the doors! 34 "It's true,  
I say to you, this generation  
Will by no means pass or be few  
Till all these things stand in their station.

They say the prophecy of Jesus failed  
And all that generation was impaled  
Upon death's wing. When Ellen White for  
sting

Repeated the same prophecy to sing,  
Her creditors came swooping down to say  
She also lied mistaken in the way.  
If so, she followed Jesus in his pay.

For both spoke of the last times and the  
sight  
Of the last signs before the judgement light.  
And so both spoke the truth and they were  
right.

When cosmic fabric rends, the end is near,  
And all who see it, see it but to fear  
The breaking in of the eternal day  
Of Sabbath rest where all the nations stay.

35 "Both heaven and earth will pass away,  
But my words will not lead astray.

36 "But of that day and hour no one  
Knows, not even angel or son,  
But my Father only *when done*.

If Jesus is the self-existing One  
As written on the icons in the sun,  
The very substance of Father of lights,  
Very God of God come in human sights,  
Then he must know all things known to  
You too,

Our God and Father come before the true.  
Yet here he says his knowledge is  
prevented

By Your own knowing of the unrelented.  
I take the word and not theology,  
I take the spurred and not philosophy,  
And stand unled astray, though I may be  
Unknowing of the secrets that I flee.  
Beloved, pity my child's simplicity  
As I lean on Your breast and in Your view.



37 "But as the days of Noah, so  
 Also the Son of Man will show.  
 38 "For as in days before the flood,  
 They ate and drank and *mixed their blood*  
*In marrying and giving in*  
*Marriage and forgetting their sin,*  
 Until the day that Noah went  
 Into the ark *where he was sent,*  
 39 "And did not know until the flood  
 Came and took all of them away,  
 So too will come Son of Man's day.

It was not that they did not know that made  
 The people in Noah's day on parade  
 Fail of salvation, it was that they paid  
 Attention to no ark where Noah stayed.  
 I look around me here to see the ark.  
 No one has built one in the city park.  
 Will not keep me from drowning with the  
 clerk.

Beloved, I eat and drink most every day,  
 And have a wife well married in my pay,  
 And I know nothing of the end of time,  
 Catastrophe about to fall on rhyme.  
 When You provide a shell to shelter me,  
 Reveal it to my eye and I shall see.

40 "Then two *men* will be in the field:  
 One will be taken *without shield,*  
 The other left. 41 "Two grinding at  
 The mill: one taken *where she sat,*  
 The other left. 42 "So watch therefore,  
 For you do not know what time your  
 Lord is coming. 43 "But know this, that  
 If the house master had known what  
 Time the thief would come, he'd have *shut*  
*The door and* watched and not allowed  
 His house robbed *or his pasture ploughed.*  
 44 "Therefore you also must be ready,  
 For the Son of Man's coming *steady*  
 At a time you do not expect.

Not getting ready is the word You sent,  
 But being ready is like to prevent  
 Surprise that ends in woe. And so I've  
 spent

My life to be ready when You relent.  
 I keep the Decalogue, I do Your will,  
 And failing each day to fulfil the bill  
 I come repenting day by day to fill

My cup with Your grace and Your mercy  
 still.

Such watching in the tent I trust will show  
 The day when it begins to burn and glow  
 And Son of man returns or comes at last  
 To conquer love and hope of earthly past.  
 Beloved, rob my house now and every day  
 Till nothing's left for robbers but the clay.

45 "Who then's a faithful and wise slave,  
 Whom his master made ruler grave  
 Over his household, to give them  
 Food in due season's *stratagem?*

46 "Blessed *is* that servant whom when his  
 Master comes, will find that he is  
 Doing so. 47 "Truly, I tell you  
 That he will make him ruler too  
 Over all his goods. 48 "But if that  
 Evil servant says in his *fat*  
 Heart, 'My master delays his coming,'  
 49 "And begins to beat fellow *humming*  
 Among the servants, and to eat  
 And drink with drunkards in their seat,  
 50 "The master of that servant will  
 Come on a day when he is still  
 Not looking for *him* and a time  
 That he is not aware is prime,  
 51 "And will cut him in two and give  
 Him his share where hypocrites live.  
 There shall be weeping there as well  
 As gnashing of teeth *for a spell.*

Two faiths provide for humankind to hear.  
 One clamours that his coming is right near  
 And others say delay is at the ear.  
 Truth is the ones who cry delay are right  
 Up to the very verge of coming night.  
 The faithful song is wrong and so along  
 Until the very edge of evil's gong.  
 There is no paradox on earth but this.  
 The wicked tell the truth and yet they miss  
 The saving grace of folly at the kiss  
 Of time run out upon the open bliss.  
 Beloved, let me believe this is the last  
 Day of life that I have to work and cast,  
 Though ten thousand more come until  
 they've passed.

## Matthew 25

1 Then the kingdom of heaven shall be  
 Compared to ten virgins who see  
 Their lamps, and who went out in bloom

To the meeting of the bridegroom.  
 2 And five of them were wise, and five  
 Were foolish. *All ten were alive.*  
 3 The foolish ones who took their lamps  
 Forgot to take oil in their damps.  
 4 But the wise took oil in their pots  
 Along with their lamps in their lots.  
 5 But the bridegroom delayed to come,  
 All fell asleep in the humdrum.  
 6 At midnight though, a cry went out,  
 "See, now the bridegroom comes about!  
 Go out to meet him *with a shout.*"  
 7 Then all those virgins were aroused  
 And lit their lamps that had been doused.  
 8 The foolish ones said to the wise,  
 "Give us some of your oil in prize,  
 For our flame flickers and it dies."  
 9 But the wise answered, saying, "No,  
 Lest there not be enough to glow  
 For us and you. But rather, go  
 To those who sell and buy a row."  
 10 But while they went away to buy,  
 The bridegroom came *down from the sky.*  
 Those who were ready went with him  
 Into the wedding feast *and trim,*  
 And so the door was shut *and grim.*  
 11 Afterwards the rest of the virgins  
 Also came with their oil *of sturgeons,*  
 Saying "Sir, sir, open for urgings."  
 12 But he replied and said "It's true  
 That I do not recognize you."  
 13 So watch, for you do not know when  
 The day or hour that you will ken  
 The Son of Man comes back again.

The difference between foolish and wise  
 Is not that sleep came to close both their  
 eyes,  
 But that the one was ready all the time  
 While others were just settling in the crime  
 Of getting ready all the while in rhyme.  
 To be ready or get ready defines  
 Who sits at wedding parties drinking wines  
 And who is shut out from holy confines.  
 Let me not get ready for judgement day,  
 But rather to be ready all the way.  
 I joy to know that I've no task to fill,  
 No job to get me ready on the hill.  
 But it's enough in grace to be instead  
 Of getting in the furnace of the spread.

14 For it is like a man who left

On a trip abroad, who was deft  
 To call his own slaves and give his  
 Possessions to them to keep biz.  
 15 And to one indeed he gave five  
 Talents, and to another, two,  
 And to another, one *to strive,*  
 And to each one according to  
 His ability. And he went  
 Abroad straight off from the present.

I'm up for business with my books in view:  
 I'll give five to the best to sell on cue  
 And with the profits he can sell ten more  
 If he is good at playing shop and store.  
 It is a Gospel theme, and so I rate  
 The ones who read and sell in my estate  
 The good and fair, while others are mere  
 drones  
 To sit and gawp at masters and their bones.  
 All humankind is easily divided  
 Into two camps, criterion provided:  
 Those who appreciate Beloved and I  
 And those who reap beneath an empty sky.  
 Beloved, I guess in that I'm just like You.  
 You spot those who keep ten  
 commandments too.

16 And the one with five talents went  
 And acted on them all unspent  
 And earned five more not to relent.  
 17 In the same way the second one  
 Took the two talents he had won  
 And with them gained two more *for fun.*  
 18 But the one who received just one  
 Went off and dug a hole when done  
 And hid his master's silver there.  
 19 After a long time from his ware  
 The master of the slaves came and  
 Called in account his slaves as planned.  
 20 The one who had received the five  
 Came up and brought another five,  
 Talents near, saying "Sir, you gave  
 Me five talents to keep and save,  
 And I have gained five talents more."  
 21 His master said to him in store,  
 "Well done you good and faithful slave.  
 You worked hard over little grave,  
 I'll set you over much. Come in  
 To the joy of your master's bin."  
 22 Then the one who got two came in  
 And said "Sir, you gave me to win  
 Two talents. See I've gained two more."

23 His master said to him for score  
“Well done you good and faithful slave.  
You worked hard over little grave,  
I’ll set you over much. Come in  
To the joy of your master’s bin.”

I too thank those who sell a book of mine  
Even if it’s to make a profit fine  
For himself only in the final share.  
Congratulations to those who’re aware.  
The minimum of good grace I require  
Is selling of two books as though on fire.  
Only the elite can make five in pyre.  
But everyone of virtue can sell two  
And keep the third to read for her review.  
Your sent one himself spoke of two or  
three,  
And that makes a whole church with quire  
and fee.  
Beloved, I’ll give you just one copy free,  
As You’re no salesman, but You still  
deserve  
To have a look at what I write with verve.

24 And the one who got just one talent  
Also came up and he was valiant  
To say “Sir, I knew you were hard,  
Reaping where you did not sow shard,  
And gathering where you did not  
Scatter to make a business plot,  
25 “And so I feared and went my way  
And hid your talent there to stay  
In the earth. See now, take your pay.”  
26 His master answered him to say  
“You wicked and you lazy slave!  
You knew that I reap and I pave  
Where I do not sow, and I take  
Where I did not scatter and rake.  
27 “Then you ought to have put away  
My silver in the bankers’ pay,  
And when I came I should get my  
Own back with interest on the sly.  
28 “So take the talent from him and  
Give it to the one in the band  
Who has ten talents on the sand.  
29 “For to each one who has the more  
Shall be given to break his score.  
But from the one with naught in hand,  
Even what he has will be taken  
Away and out the door be shaken.  
30 “So cast the worthless slave away  
Into outer darkness to play.

There will be weeping to bequeath  
As well as gnashing of the teeth.

Beloved, I should not be so hard on one  
Who bought my book and settled down for  
fun  
To read it in his den of earth alone  
And not tell any soul about the loan.  
One sale’s a sale, and what’s been said of  
pence  
And taking care of pounds still has some  
sense.  
I would not cast him out in darkness where  
The teeth are gnashed and weeping is the  
share  
Of humankind. Instead, I’d let him wear  
A smile to see the punishment of fire  
Heaped on the millions who without desire  
Pass by my book unbought, though pockets  
weigh  
In silver and in golden counterplay.  
Let buried treasure, Beloved, have its day.

31 “But when the Son of Man comes in  
His glory, and with all the din  
Of holy angels with him, then  
He’ll sit on his throne of glory.  
32 “Before him shall be gathered men  
Of all the nations and then he  
Will separate them carefully  
From one another, as the good  
Shepherd separates sheep from hood.  
33 “And truly he will set the sheep  
At his right hand, but the goats keep  
On the left hand. 34 The king will say  
To those on his right hand to lay,  
'Come, blessed of my Father *today*,  
Inherit the kingdom prepared  
For you from earth’s foundation shared.'  
35 “For I was hungry and you gave  
Me food to eat, in thirst I’m brave,  
And you gave me to drink the lave,  
I was a stranger, and you took  
Me in *and never once forsook*.  
36 “I was naked, and you clothed me;  
I was sick, you visited me;  
I was in prison, and you came  
To me with comfort *and not blame*.  
37 The righteous will answer and say  
“Sir, when did we see you in pay  
Of hunger, and feed you, or thirst  
And gave you drink *and like to burst?*

38 "And when did we see you become  
 A stranger, and took you to hum,  
 Or naked and clothed you in sum?  
 39 "And when did we see you were sick,  
 Or in a prison wall built thick  
 And come to you in time for nick?"  
 40 In answer then the king will say  
 To them, "Truly I say today  
 To you, in what you came to do  
 It for one of these in my crew  
 Of least of brothers, so did you  
 The thing to me *and in my view.*"

Truth is, Beloved, the Gospel spells out  
 right

The greatest principle of faith in sight.  
 There is no I but You, and all the night  
 Is just a veil that blinds the human blight.  
 The simplest soul upon the earth that  
 knows

The I-ness of the morning that arose  
 In ecstasy no words could then express  
 Contains the grand reflection and address  
 Of You, Creator of all hope and fire.  
 You are reflected in glory and mire.  
 The slave upon the workbench is Your own  
 Heart and mind tortured to the marrow  
 bone,  
 And none defies Your will but for the cast  
 Of divine wareness in the living blast.

41 Then he will also say to those  
 On his left, "Go from me in rows,  
 You cursed ones, get you in the fire,  
 The everlasting, that entire  
 Is so prepared for devil and  
 His angels *in their wicked band.*

42 "For I was hungry, you did not  
 Give me a thing to eat in lot.  
 And I was thirsty and you did  
 Not give me anything in bid  
 To drink; 43 "I was a stranger, and  
 You did not take me in to stand;  
 Naked, and you did not clothe me;  
 Sick and in prison by decree  
 And you did not come visit me."

44 Then they will also answer him  
 Saying "Sir, when did we see grim  
 Hunger on you, or thirst, or then  
 When were you a stranger in glen,  
 Or naked, sick, or in the den  
 Of prison and fail to serve you?"

45 Then he'll reply to them in crew  
 And say "Truly I say to you,  
 In what you did not do to one  
 Of these the least, neither for fun  
 Did you do it to save my bun."  
 46 And these shall go away to be  
 In punishment eternally,  
 But the righteous into reward  
 Of life eternal *without sword.*

All men know that the soul contains  
 The realization beyond the pains  
 Of human flesh, that I am God alone  
 And there is none other who can atone.  
 Distinction comes with knowing in the care  
 Of man's existence and in woman's share,  
 That every body caught within the coil  
 Is equally with I-ness on the soil  
 Reflection of divinity to toil.  
 Seeing You, my Beloved, in every face,  
 Instead of mine alone, is saving grace.  
 All who fail in that sight are sent to hell  
 To be lone gods forever under spell  
 Of blindness of reality to tell.

### **Matthew 26**

1 It happened, when Jesus had done  
 Speaking all these things *for the fun,*  
 He said to His disciples *won,*  
 2 You know that the Passover's come  
 After two days, and Son of Man's  
 Betrayed to crucifixion's hum.

The synoptics pretend Passover comes  
 After two days alone and so it hums  
 Four days behind John in the patient lurch.  
 That's just because John uses for his search  
 The luni-solar calendar Rabbis  
 Have since that time dared always to  
 revise,

While Matthew tames the Jubilees in guise,  
 And makes the Passover come Tuesday  
 night.

The two ways of the reckoning in sight  
 Show how the crucifixion of the wight  
 Can be in Matthew after feast's delight,  
 But on the eve of the fifteenth for those  
 Who follow the officials in their rows.  
 The Gospel's contradictions fail to pose.

3 Then the chief priests along with bans  
 Of scribes and the folk's elders came

Assembling to the high priest's court,  
Who was Caiaphas by name.

4 And they connived to plot in sort  
To seize Jesus by guile to kill.

5 But they said "Not by the feast's frill  
To avoid rioting and spill."

Society is safe and sane because  
The most of men obey its obscene laws  
That ignore justice, mercy, and the right,  
But make appropriate the thing in sight.  
It's not appropriate to spoil the feast,  
The holiday, the peace, the folk's  
increased,

But fair enough to murder in the night,  
And stalk the singer after the twilight.  
There's hardly now, Beloved, a gathering  
In boardroom or in governmently ring  
But shares the character of that meeting  
With the high priest to bring Jesus astray.  
Appropriateness carries off the day,  
While innocence is left to die for pay.

6 And Jesus was in Bethany,  
In Simon the leper's home tree.  
7 A woman came to him freely  
With alabaster bottle filled  
With precious ointment and distilled.  
She poured it on his head in share  
While he was lying *eating* there.  
8 When his disciples saw the thing,  
They were offended and saying  
Why such a waste under the wing?  
9 "The ointment could have been sold for  
A great price and given to the poor."

I too, Beloved, would like to do my thing  
In this world by taking under my wing  
The people who need help and charity.  
But that is not how You created me.  
You made me to be outcast from the  
church,  
Despised by those who run the comic  
perch,  
Appreciated by the quiet few  
Who have an eye for small beauties in  
brew.

My beauties are so microscopic that  
It takes adjusting in the melting vat  
Before they are apparent to the nose.  
Though bottle's crushed, I'm quelling like  
a rose.

The alabaster shards reflect the light  
Shed from my work in chambers of the  
night.

10 But Jesus knew what they were saying.  
"Why strike the woman with gainsaying?  
For she's done a good thing to me.

11 "For you will always have degree  
Among you in their poverty,  
But you do not always have me.  
12 "For when she put this oil on me,  
She did it for to bury me.

13 "Indeed I tell you, where with speed  
This Gospel is preached to world's need,  
What she did will be spoken well  
Of her in memory of her spell."

The promise Jesus made is true indeed,  
Which indicates no exegete in need  
Need question the authentic story here:  
Each true Gospel will keep it at the ear.  
That cuts out Luke for sure. He missed the  
rote,  
And so his Gospel's left the sheep for goat.  
The implication is that Matthew's not  
Compatible to stay in the same plot  
With Luke at all. A shorter Bible then  
Would be the right one for most modern  
men.

Beloved, don't be so harsh with either one:  
You see the church let both in by the tonne,  
So I retreat in my own poverty  
To see the conflict in the church rightly.

14 Then one of the twelve went to plot  
With chief priests, Jude Iscariot.  
15 He said "What will you give to me  
If I deliver you freely  
This man?" And they counted for him  
Thirty silver coins tarnished dim.  
16 From then on he looked for the chance  
To betray him *with wrong and dance*.  
17 And on the first day of the Feast  
Of Unleavened Bread, came *increased*  
The disciples to Jesus, saying  
To him, "Where do you hope for staying  
To eat the Passover *for slaying?*"

The first day of the feast was the day set  
As the fourteenth of the first month that's  
met,  
So this day the disciples came to speak

Was a day earlier in that same week  
 That John calls day of preparation and  
 Was the day of the crucifixion grand.  
 The question rises, that the meal they eat  
 For the Passover came before the treat  
 Of crucifixion, while the law provides  
 They should have eaten after taking sides.  
 The conflict of the calendars can be  
 Because the synoptics refer to Jubilee  
 While John sticks to the noble Pharisee  
 And how Rabbinic luni-solar rides.

18 And he said "Go into the town  
 To a certain man *of renown*  
 And tell him what the teacher says  
 'My time is near, *and not for praise*,  
 At your place I intend to keep  
 Passover with my friends *to peep*.'  
 19 And the disciples came to do  
 As Jesus ordered them in crew,  
 Preparing the Passover too.  
 20 When evening came, he came to lie  
 Down there with the twelve *without spy*.

I'd have held out for forty, I'm so crass.  
 I would not give in for just tacks and brass.  
 And yet that sly delay is merely boasting.  
 No doubt I've betrayed Jesus in my hosting  
 For nothing more than a guffaw accepting  
 Me in the crowd of others who're inepting.  
 It is betrayal that I let some pass  
 And call him second in the triune mass.  
 I should cry loud against idolatry.  
 Instead I am polite to pagan spree.  
 Let Jesus uphold Decalogue and I  
 Am ready to claim him above the cry  
 Of those who wish to pass the poor chap by  
 Or make of him a god and on the sly.

21 And while they ate, he said to them,  
 "Truly I tell you one *in hem*  
 Of you will betray me *for gem*."  
 22 And grieving very much, they started  
 To ask by turn, "Sir, is it I?"  
 23 But he replied and told them *tarted*,  
 "The one who dips his hand *to try*  
 Me in the dish betrays my *sigh*.  
 24 "Truly the son of man's betrayed  
 As it was written for him stayed.  
 But woe to that man by whom then  
 The son of man's given to men.  
 It would have been better for him

Never to have been born so grim."  
 25 The one betraying in reply,  
 Judas said "Teacher, it's not I?"  
 He said to him "You are the spy."

According to all rules of guest and host,  
 Betrayal of one eating jam and toast  
 At one table is something beyond boast.  
 All cultures, lands, each family and coast  
 Know how to be hospitable with roast.  
 The pretence of Judas seems ripe to see,  
 And yet he too follows the master's key:  
 Whatever the Tanach says one should do,  
 No matter how far-fetched in modelled cue,  
 He's out to do the thing just to please You.  
 Beloved, give me such faith combined at  
 last  
 With some more knowledge of Your will to  
 cast,  
 And I like Jesus and Judas shall lean  
 Obedient to commandments I have seen.

26 And as they ate, Jesus took bread  
 And blessed and gave it as he said  
 To his disciples "Take and eat,  
 This is my body for a treat."  
 27 And when he took the cup, he gave  
 Thanks and handed it in their *lave*,  
 Saying "All of you drink the meet.  
 28 "For this is my blood on the seat  
 Of new covenant which for crowd  
 Of many's poured out as allowed  
 Releasing sins that many greet.

If just a joke or allegory I  
 Don't think that cannibalism can vie  
 With truth. Your sent one was not wise to  
 make

Allusion to eating his flesh for sake  
 Of drinking blood. Too many on the take  
 Read that as literal or even worse  
 The functional replacement of a curse.  
 It's better just to say eating the flesh  
 And drinking human blood is something  
 fresh  
 Forbidden by the law and all good sense.  
 Then we'd have been turned from the mass  
 to pence.

I don't appreciate the state we're in  
 Because of cannibalistical sin  
 In every church from here to Timbuctin.

29 "But I tell you, I shall not drink  
Of this fruit of the vine on brink  
Till that day when I drink it new  
In my Father's kingdom with you."

Your sent one, despite reputation from  
The wedding at Cana and every sum  
Of company he's caught with like a bum,  
Here makes a clean breast of his own  
delight:

He will not drink fermented wine in sight,  
And on the day he meets his friends again,  
He'll only drink new wine among his men,  
And that is just grape juice. No doubt by  
then

The final prophet will at last have shown  
That drinking alcohol's a thing that's  
known

To be an inappropriate thing here  
Where thousands of deaths come from it  
each year.

30 And singing a Psalm they went to  
The Mount of Olives out of view.

The Great Hallel no doubt is what they  
sang:

Their only songbook was the swing and  
twang

Of Tehilim, the book of David's Psalms,  
The book that swears and praises and then  
calms.

I add to praise and plaint and penance that  
Petition that I might not sing them flat.  
But You who bent creating suns and  
moons,

The universe of power and beauty's  
swoons,

Despite all effort to give me my boons,  
Cannot make my voice born of alley cat  
Sing true and beautiful after the bat.

Beloved, I still sing David's Psalms and  
find

That I rise higher than the tined and wined  
Who skip to dock and pole to make them  
blind.

31 Then Jesus told them, "You all will  
Be offended in me while still  
This very night goes on to trill.  
For it's been written, 'I will strike  
The shepherd, and the flock is like

To be spread scattered *on the hill*.

Jesus and his are cute in the fair way  
They seek to follow Tanach every day  
In all they do. There's hardly any word  
They speak but is reflection often blurred  
Of what some prophet spoke in ancient  
time.

Make my life too, Beloved, of such a  
rhyme.

Because the shepherd's struck and sheep  
are bent

On scattering, so Jesus will relent  
And kneel beneath the quirt until he's  
spent.

The Christian secretly pretends that he  
Would not have left his master on the lee,  
But in that he betrays the fact he fails  
To keep the law and prophets in his tales.  
Let me be no such Christian in my key.

32 After my resurrection I  
Will go before you up to spy  
*The land of Galilee undry.*

33 And Peter answered him and said  
"If all others here have been led

To be offended, know that I  
Will never leave you in the die."

34 Jesus told him, "Truly I say  
To you, tonight before the ray  
Of the cock crowing, you'll deny  
Me three times *and still wonder why.*"

35 Peter told him, "And should I die  
With you, I never will deny,  
No never!" The disciples all  
Said the same thing *against the wall.*

36 Then Jesus came with them into  
A place called Gethsemane's view.  
And he told his disciples there,  
"Sit here, and I shall go in prayer."

37 He took him Peter and the two  
Of Zebedee's sons in the crew,  
And he began to cry and moan.

38 And then he spoke to them alone,  
"My soul is deeply grieved to see  
My death. Stay here and watch with me."

39 He went a little farther and  
Fell on his face, and prayed *to stand*,  
Saying, "O my Father, if it  
Is possible, let this cup *fit*  
Pass from me, but not as I will,  
But as You *will let it fulfil.*"

O my Belovèd, with what pain You saw  
 The one You sent by night alone withdraw  
 Into the garden and fall to the earth to pray  
 Upon his face and in prostration stay  
 The while! As he is my example, let  
 Me too on earth prostrate by minaret  
 Beneath a dome of stone or sky  
 Until the prayer in prostrating's gone by.  
 Then save me from the bitter cup and cross  
 If so be Your intention to my loss  
 Or gain, as was to him who living rose  
 Toward the sky. My prayers by night  
     transpose  
 The darkness into starlight, starlight  
     guiding  
 My resurrected steps and faith confiding.

40 He came to the disciples and  
 Found them asleep. He said to Peter,  
 "Indeed, it seems you could not stand  
 To watch one hour, *for sleep was sweeter.*  
 41 "But watch and pray that you do not  
 Fall into such temptation's plot.  
 The spirit truly's willing but  
 The flesh is weak though it may strut."  
 42 He went away a second time  
 And prayed, saying "Father, what crime  
 Would it be if I missed this cup?  
 But let Your will be up and up."  
 43 He came and found them once again  
 Asleep, for they were weary men.  
 44 He left them and went back once more  
 And prayed a third time the same score.  
 45 He came to His disciples and  
 He said to them, "Sleep is not banned,  
 Rest for what little time remains.  
 See how the moment rushes in,  
 The son of man for all his pains  
 Is betrayed into hands of sin."

The fact that Jesus speaks of flesh and  
     spirit  
 Shows how far into Greece or at least near  
     it  
 The first century of Judaism fell.  
 It is a sorrow that I have to tell.  
 The unity of anthropology  
 Of Semites is a wonder that I see,  
 And although Hellenistic thought resides  
 In modern science too, it still derides  
 The basics of reality I share

With men of common sense and  
     everywhere.  
 The spirit is not willing if the flesh  
 Is not confounded by the shapely fresh.  
 The spirit and the flesh are just one thing  
 And making two of them is dastard fling.

46 "Get up and go, for see arrives  
 The traitor coming from his hives."  
 47 And as He spoke, see, Judas came,  
 One of the twelve, Judas the same.  
 And with him was a great crowd bearing  
 Both swords and clubs from chief priests  
     wearing  
 And elders of the people *swearing.*  
 48 And the betrayer gave a sign,  
 Saying "The one kissed by design  
 Is the right one, so grab him fine."  
 49 And coming up at once to Jesus,  
 He said "Hello, master," *to please us,*  
 And then he kissed him *in the line.*

It's common among men today as then  
 To betray with a kiss among the ten.  
 The ramming of faint praise, the willing  
     sore  
 That raises up the friend to touch the gore,  
 All happen in both politics and mire  
 Of workplace everywhere and without tire.  
 Because we live in civilized law's grace  
 The safest way to betray's with a face  
 Of friendship and of lawfulness of mace.  
 Turn law and custom both against a man  
 And there's no rising from the push and  
     span.  
 Beloved, kiss me or not, I find the way  
 Is sordid and still gross before the play,  
 And full of pitfalls for the john at bay.

50 But Jesus said to him, "My friend,  
 Why are you here, and to what end?"  
 Then they came up to Jesus then  
 And grabbed him there among his men.  
 51 And one of those with Jesus then  
 Stretched out his hand and drew his sword  
 And struck the high priest's slave *aboard*  
 And sliced off his ear *as abhorred.*  
 52 Then Jesus told him, "Put away  
 Your sword back in its place to stay.  
 For all who take the sword shall die  
 Beneath the sword without a cry."  
 53 "Or do you think that I cannot



Now call on my father in plot  
 And He will put beside me more  
 Than twelve legions of angels' store?  
 54 "How then should the Scriptures fulfil  
 Unless I go walk up this hill?"  
 55 That very hour then Jesus said  
 To the crowds, "Have you now been led  
 Against me with swords, clubs and all  
 As against a robber in pall?  
 I sat with you each day to teach  
 Within the temple and in reach  
 And you did not lay hands on me."  
 56 But all this happened by decree  
 Of prophets in the Scriptures so.  
 Then all his disciples would go  
 And on the run forsake his row.

Jesus' disciple wore a sword indeed,  
 Which is a thing to wonder at with speed,  
 Unless he changed his teaching at the  
 draught,  
 When all the rabble grabbed at what they  
 sought.  
 The man had sworn that he would not deny  
 His master even if the darkened sky  
 Fell on him. But he just was not prepared  
 To have his master turn on him sword  
 bared.  
 I have no sword, and what I had I gave  
 Back to my cousin, one well to behave,  
 To keep it safe in hand after the spoil  
 Of Japanese warehouses on the foil.  
 And yet I too follow the Scripture's sound  
 And keep my feet still walking on the  
 ground.

57 And those who seized Jesus led him  
 Away to Caiaphas grim  
 The high priest, where the scribes and  
 elders  
 Were gathering from helder-skelders.  
 58 And Peter followed him afar,  
 Even to the court of the bar  
 Of the high priest. He went inside  
 And sat with the house folk to bide  
 What would happen and would betide.  
 59 And the chief priests and elders and  
 The whole Sanhedrin looked in band  
 For false witness against the stand  
 Of Jesus, so they might put him  
 To death, *as their thoughts were so grim.*  
 60 But they did not find an excuse,

Even though there were for abuse  
 Many false witnesses that came,  
 Till at last two false ones for shame  
 61 Said "This one said 'I can destroy  
 The temple of God and employ  
 But three days to build it again.'"  
 62 And the high priest stood right up then  
 And said to him, "Do you not say  
 A word in answer? Hear the way  
 These witness against you today."  
 63 But Jesus kept his mouth shut till  
 The high priest told him, "I instil  
 You on oath by the living God  
 That you tell us if on the sod  
 You are the Christ, the son of God."

The son of God is here defined at last  
 In opposition to pagan outcast  
 Gods and their goddesses as just a term  
 Technical for the Christ, Messiah firm.  
 If he is Christ, then he's the son of God,  
 Just as was David with promise in pod.  
 But that means nothing of his essence true,  
 Or whether he's diviner than the crew  
 Of other men born in a world of rue.  
 The son of God just means the ruler king  
 Come after David to sort out the thing.  
 If pagan stories know another wing  
 Of solar myths with resurrection's sting,  
 That has nothing to do, nothing to do.

64 Jesus said to him, "So you say.  
 And I will tell you more today.  
 This time you'll see the son of man  
 Sit on the right hand of might's span,  
 And coming on the clouds in sway."  
 65 Then the high priest tore off his robe  
 And said "He blasphemed *like a strobe!*  
 Why do we need more witnesses?  
 See now you've heard blasphemy's whiz.  
 66 "How does it seem to you?" And they  
 Replied and said "Death sentence pay."

As I read the text carefully I find  
 No word of blasphemy among the blind.  
 Not once did Jesus speak in pride or shame  
 Against You or against Your holy name.  
 He may have made a very foolish claim,  
 But that's not blasphemy, not for a game.  
 The wickedness of his accusers' heart  
 Attributed to him blasphemy's part,  
 As though he made himself then out to be

You Yourself, second one in Trinity.  
I hate to find such guilt in ancient crowd  
Or in the one today that speaks aloud  
Accusing him of the blasphemy's word.  
They fill the churches with unholy herd.

67 Then they spat in his face and they  
Beat him with the fist in array,  
And some slapped him 68 and came to say  
'Prophecy to us, Christ, and tell  
Who is the one striking you well?'"

To claim that Jesus Christ was God  
Himself,

The second person of Trinity's shelf,  
Is just to spit in his face and beat him  
With the fist and slap him with hard hands  
grim.

Establishment of church in ancient time  
Accused him of the same in awful rhyme  
That priests and elders still today in crime  
Accuse him of, for nickel and for dime.  
Beloved, I stand against the fit of crowd  
And claim that what the man said is  
allowed,

That he is innocent of all the farce  
That priest and political shove in arse.  
Beloved, I take the faith of Jesus bold  
That's nothing but what Decalogue has  
told.

69 And Peter sat outside in court.  
And one girl came near him *in sort*  
Saying "You were with Jesus then,  
The Galilean among men."

70 But he denied before then all,  
Saying "I don't know him at all."

71 And he went out into the porch  
Where someone else saw him *to scorch*  
And said to those there, "This man too  
Was with Jesus Nazarene's crew."

72 And once more he denied and swore,  
"I didn't know this man before."

73 And soon those standing by came near  
And said to Peter for his fear,  
"Truly you also are of those,  
Your accent betrays you for shows."

74 Then he began to curse and swear,  
"I do not know the man *from mare*."  
And straight away a cock crowed there.

75 Then Peter remembered the word  
Of Jesus saying to him stirred,

"Before a cock crows, you'll deny  
Me three times *here beneath the sky*."  
And he went out sorely to cry.

Peter's mistake was placing confidence  
In arm of flesh, even though its defence  
Was that he was Messiah in his tents.  
The confidence in Christ to remove sin  
By dying on a cross will never win,  
And those who deny him his rightful place  
By such illusions will deny his face.  
Beloved, let me join feather, then, and fin.  
Mistaken expectations always lead  
To disappointment in the fond-held creed.  
Let me expect nothing of You at last  
For keeping to the Decalogue to cast  
Out every faith established under mast.  
I love and obey without hope of seed.

### **Matthew 27**

1 As morning drew near all the chief  
Priests and the elders for relief  
Of the folk took counsel with each  
Against Jesus to kill the peach.

2 They tied him and led him away  
And gave him to Pontius *fey*  
Pilate the governor *in sway*.

3 Then Judas, his betrayer, saw  
He was condemned, repented paw,  
Returned the thirty pieces of  
Silver to the chief priests for love  
And elders, 4 saying "I have sinned,  
Betraying innocent blood *binned*."  
But they said "What is that to us?  
See to it yourself while you curse."

5 He threw the silver pieces in  
The temple and left with a din,  
And hung himself, *which was a sin*.

This play acting by taking every cue  
From obscure passage of Tanach and true  
Tradition spoken by common assent  
Among the pious must at last relent.  
Judas went along with the role game till  
He saw the priests were really there to kill.  
And then in awful horror threw the coin  
Into the temple. He'd no longer join  
The game and see his own beloved one  
slain.

Judas was the first one among the sane.  
But sanity on this world's stage must end  
In treachery to self without a friend.

Beloved, I take Your Scriptures in my guile  
As guide indeed, but do not play the while.

6 The chief priests took the silver money  
And said "It is not right or funny  
To put this in the treasury,  
Since it's the price of blood's degree."  
7 They counselled together and bought  
With them the potter's field for slot  
Of foreigners' place to be buried.  
8 So that field to this day *unharried*  
Is called the Field of Blood *when carried*.  
9 So was fulfilled what had been said  
By Jeremiah, prophet spread,  
Saying "And I took thirty count  
Of silver, the price of slave's mount,  
As Israel's sons would set amount,  
10 "And gave them for the potter's field,  
As order by the Lord appealed."

First off the writer was one Zechariah  
And not the favoured prophet Jeremiah.  
The scroll might well go by his name  
perforce.  
But that's of little consequence, of course.  
What strikes me is that murderers still feel  
For what's appropriate in row and reel.  
What difference to the treasury to gain  
A coin that is still reddened with the stain  
Of blood, when that coin left the sacred hall  
To buy the life of innocence in thrall?  
Truth is, each treasury is filled with such,  
With blood corruption and the evil touch.  
The murderer is squeamish with as much,  
But not with the death stroke. He needs his  
crutch.

11 And Jesus stood before the chief.  
The governor questioned him lief,  
And said "Are you the Jews' king's *grief*?"  
And Jesus said to him, "You're saying."  
12 And when He was accused *dismaying*  
By the chief priests and elders, he  
Answered nothing, *stayed quietly*.

The term the son of God is just a stroke  
That means in jargon the king that awoke  
To reign on David's seat and by  
appointment  
Of You, Beloved, and by divine  
anointment.  
The priest says son of God, the ruler there

For Rome says king of Jews in his own  
share,  
But both mean the same thing, and that's  
the care.

The priest eschews the rise of king to bear  
The rulership and usurp priestly ware.  
The emperor is jealous of the state.  
And so the two join in a plot for mate.  
Beloved, I too long for the stable slate,  
But find the violence upon my pate,  
And so retreat to You alone to swear.

13 Then Pilate said to him, "Do you  
Not hear how many things of rue  
They testify now against you?"  
14 And he did not reply a word,  
So that the chief was greatly stirred.

Hope always rises in the human heart  
That some word will free him from awful  
part  
Of power. But truth is nothing can be said  
To the interrogator when one's led  
Before the rack. Nothing one says will free  
Despite the wicked promises of glee.  
The torture is for its own sake and not  
To get confession of ungainly plot.  
Confession merely adds a crime in lot  
And stands a useless thing to relieve pain.  
The only freedom from the hand of king  
Is death, and that's why Jesus knows to  
sing  
Nor word nor hope before the royal reign.  
Let me keep my mouth shut, Beloved, or  
sting.

15 And at the feast, the governor  
Was wont to set free *from the store*  
One prisoner to please the crowd,  
Whatever one they had allowed.  
16 And they had there one of renown,  
A prisoner, Barabbas down.  
17 When they were gathered, Pilate said  
To them, "Whom do you wish I spread  
Free for you, this Barabbas, or  
Jesus who's called the Christ *and more*."  
18 For he knew they delivered him  
Through envy, *that's why they were grim*.

I wonder what the simple man had over  
The elite leaders not yet sent to clover

That they could envy him. No treasure  
trover

Was he who had no place to lay his head.  
They surely did not envy him his bed.

I need not ask the question. It is sure  
That they envied his power to work a cure,  
Not for the cure itself, but for the praise  
He gained from men and women all his  
days.

Though praise is cheap and fickle, all the  
more

The ones who bid for power love it in store.  
That's why, no doubt, elections always find  
More praise and blame are scattered than  
the kind

Of issues discussed for importance due.  
Thanks are appreciated more than true.

19 But he was sitting on the seat  
Of judgement, and his wife's entreat  
Was sent to him to say "Don't meet  
Anything here between you and  
This just man brought into the stand.  
For I have suffered much this night  
For having him in my dream's sight."

20 But the chief priests and elders came,  
Persuaded the crowds to acclaim  
Barabbas, and to cast the blame  
On Jesus *for their own great shame*.

21 And answering, the ruler said  
To them, "Of the two here out-spread  
Which do you want me to set free?"  
And they said "Set Barabbas free."

22 Then Pilate said to them, "What then  
Should I do to Jesus of men  
Called Christ?" They all said to him then,  
"Crucify him *by your decree!*"

The media will always make the crowd  
Choose wickedness within the things  
allowed

By the establishment of judgement hall.  
They always hear the priestly din and call.  
It's not surprising in the least to see  
That robbers stand their trial and then go  
free,  
While innocent when caught within the  
mesh

Of the police give up their lovely flesh  
To punishment and even unto death.  
Such is the stink of normal human breath.  
Beloved, protect me from the siren voice

Of media and priestcraft with its choice  
Of limited in violence to make  
The status quo the desired birthday cake.

23 The ruler said "And for what sin?"  
But they cried out in greater din,  
Saying "Crucify him in bin!"

24 And seeing that nothing was gained,  
But rather a riot sustained,  
Pilate took water to wash hands  
Before the crowd saying commands,  
"I'm innocent of this man's blood  
Who's righteous, your eye's full of mud."

25 And all the people then replied,  
Saying "His blood on us abide  
And on our children," *so they cried*.

26 Then he set them Barabbas free.  
But he flogged Jesus and sent him  
Up to be crucified *in trim*.

The difference between the rabble and  
The one that sits upon the judgement stand  
Is not of guilt, oh no, they both have that,  
But that the rabble cries without a thought  
But for excitement of the priestly plot,  
While the judge on the stair knows what  
he's wrought.

The one excuses it that hands tied flat  
Or washed as it may be by the strong tide  
Of the opinion public on the side.  
He fails to note the public din has come  
From the same source as his own power to  
hum:

Desire to keep the status quo of power  
Among the chosen by corruption's hour.  
Beloved, I watch it from my own rose  
bower.

27 The soldiers took Jesus into  
The praetorium and in view  
Of governor assembled all  
The cohort against him in thrall.

28 They stripped him and put on him then  
A scarlet cloak *with scarlet hem*.

29 They plaited him a crown of thorn  
And placed it on his head *forlorn*,  
And put a reed in his right hand.  
They bowed the knee before him and  
They mocked him, saying "Hail, sir, stand  
King of the Jews *throughout the land*."

30 They spit on him, they took the reed  
And struck him on the head indeed.

31 When they had mocked him, they  
stripped off  
His cloak, and they put on to scoff  
His garments and led Him away  
To crucify him *for their pay*.

Beloved, remark that every deed and vile  
Done in this world to innocence with guile  
Is done by those who do their duty and  
Merely receive their pay after in hand.  
This is the great interpretation that  
The state gives to the word of Jesus flat  
That anger and hate are the sin and not  
The deed itself, but rather sinful thought.  
Because the soldiers do not know or hate,  
But only maim and kill both soon and late  
Within the hours for which they're paid a  
rate,  
What they do is no wrong, but duty done  
To state and god and goddess of the sun.  
Beloved, I'd rather be a robber's mate.

32 They went out and they found a man,  
A Cyrenean, named Simon.  
They made him bear the cross *for fun*.

When rulers set loose soldiers on the folk,  
They always pretend nothing's in the stroke  
But just a bit of fun for passing bloke.  
Simon too was an innocent come by,  
And that's why he was chosen on the sly.  
If he'd been of the rabble and the crowd  
Demanding crucifixion, they'd allowed  
Him to pass freely through the streets  
again.  
Such is the course of every kind of men.  
Beloved, at times I think You made  
mistakes  
In making men instead of just mudcakes.  
The Cyrenean walks the earth today,  
Impoverished by servitude and pay  
Of those who hold the oil and gold in sway.

33 They came to a place that is called  
Golgotha, place of the skull walled.  
34 They gave him vinegar with gall  
To drink, but when he tasted *tall*,  
He would not drink the stuff at all.  
35 They crucified him, then sat down  
To distribute his cloak and gown.  
They cast a lot fulfilling what  
Was spoken by the prophet's glut,

"They divided my garments for  
Themselves, and cast a lot in store  
Of my clothing." 36 And they sat down  
To watch him *die beside the town*.  
37 And they put up over his head  
His charge, as it was written spread:  
This is Jesus, the king of Jews.

Let Jesus be my king too, not just Jews,  
Because he is the one that I would choose.  
He upheld Decalogue before the face  
Of power and held it till the taunt and pace  
Came to the cross. Besides that he too  
claimed  
To be the son of David and unblamed.  
The son of David who takes Decalogue  
As rule of thumb and fortune in the bog  
Of worldly wandering, I take for mine,  
And drink a toast to him with homely wine.  
Beloved, no other kings need I below  
The lunar calendar that churns the slow  
Return to David's promises and glow.  
I wait the true reward, turn from the show.

38 Two robbers were strung to abuse  
With him, one on the right and one  
On his left. 39 Those passing the fun  
Blasphemed him shaking their heads won,  
40 And saying "You who once tore down  
The temple and built its renown  
In three days, if you're God's son now  
Come down from the cross anyhow!"  
41 And in the same way, the chief priests  
With scribes and elders' mocking feasts,  
Said 42 "He saved others; He is not  
Able to save himself from plot.  
If He is the King of Israel,  
Let Him come down now from the fell  
Cross, and we will believe him well."  
43 "He trusted in God. Let Him come  
And rescue Him now, if the bum  
Is one that He desires. For he  
Said, 'I'm the son of God', freely."  
44 The robbers also crucified  
With him cursed the same at his side.  
45 And from the sixth hour it was dark  
All over the land till the bark  
Of the ninth hour. 46 And at that time  
Jesus cried out aloud in rhyme,  
Saying "Eli, Eli lama  
Sabachthani, that is in straw  
My God, my God, why did You then

Forsake me *here before all men?*”

When Jesus sang Psalm twenty-two aloud  
Upon the cross or torture stake the crowd  
Heard him sing in the targum Aramaic  
Instead of in the Psalms of the Hebraic.  
Today hardly a man comes near reciting  
The Aramaic Psalms for two things  
righting.

The first is that the Hebrew's taken over,  
And that may be a grace in blooming  
clover.

The second is that siddur and the plot  
Of mass and dua nowadays hit the spot.  
Despite the fact the son of David sings  
In the unknown tongue of the later wings,  
I here declare return to David's own  
Tongue and submission to his covered  
throne.

47 Some standing there heard that and said  
”This one calls Elijah instead.”

48 At once, one of them running took  
A sponge filled with vinegar's crook  
And put it on a reed and gave  
The drink to him *before the grave*.

49 But the rest said, “Leave him alone,  
Let's see if Elijah will come  
To save him.” 50 And crying again  
With a loud voice, Jesus died then.

Today as then the crew of working men  
Who keep establishment running again  
Are loyal to the church and state, and yet  
Cannot even recognize on the set  
The words of Psalm and Scripture when  
they're met.

They hear instead the name Elijah or  
Some other star and braggart of their lore.  
No use to cry the truth aloud or sing  
The Scriptures in the street or on the wing  
Of crosses, for the people down below  
Will never hear a word of heavenly glow.  
There's hardly any Bible-readers know  
This was the title of the Psalm he sang.  
They think it's just a sentence with a  
twang.

51 And see the temple veil was torn  
In two from above to adorn  
Down to the floor, and the earth quaked  
And the rocks were thrown out unbaked.

52 The tombs were opened, and many  
Bodies of the saints were raised free  
Who had long slept in dark degree.  
53 They came out of the tombs when he  
Was resurrected and went in  
The city and appeared to win  
To many there in the city.

This tale is hard for gullible like me  
Even to take with salt not to say tea.  
And yet who knows what truth's behind the  
door.

The news I hear today's like to ignore  
Important things and merely propagate  
The propaganda useful to the state.  
It is no argument we should have heard  
If such a resurrection had occurred.  
It could happen today, and none be stirred  
Unless it were a chance to make a buck,  
For my own credibility's unstuck.  
If You want none on earth to believe You,  
Beloved, then go on telling what is true,  
And see how fast Your word's ignored on  
cue.

54 But the centurion and those  
With him guarding Jesus disclose,  
Saw the earthquake and what arose,  
And they were greatly in fear's throes,  
Saying “Truly this one was he,  
The son of God *and mightily*.”

Whatever pagans like these mean when  
they

Say son of God I hesitate to say.  
It's more likely they want to turn a rake  
At some Horus or Dionysian stake.  
The aptitude is found in their grandsons  
Today within the Catholic church in tons,  
The Roman will to believe every tale  
That conquered peoples bring out without  
fail.

The Trinties are crime a dozen here,  
And everywhere I can think to appear.  
The missionary zeal of these last five  
Centuries leave hardly a man alive.  
Beloved, I see the evidence awake  
Above the altar piece for the sun's sake.

55 Many women were there to see  
Afar off, those who wandered free  
After Jesus from Galilee,

Serving him *there and tenderly*,  
56 Among them Mary Magdalene,  
And Mary the mother serene  
Of James and Joses, and the mum  
Of the sons of Zebedee come.

It's not that women were courageous then,  
Or more courageous than the Saviour's  
men.

They came and stood far off while the men  
chose

To run and hide behind the doors that close.  
The likelihood of crucifying those  
Women was less than for men in last  
throes.

Because of her dose of curiosity,  
Mary the Magdalene has been set free  
As spouse of Jesus to offend the eye  
Of Christian-like ascetics by and by.  
If three girls stand here in sight of the tree,  
Then four in all of spouses have not come.  
He might have had up to four like a bum  
Of today's Muslim crowd, and still chew  
gum.

57 When evening came, a rich man from  
Arimathaea, who was called  
Joseph and also was installed  
Disciple to Jesus, came in  
To Pilate asking for his bin  
The body of Jesus to win.  
Then Pilate ordered that the body  
Be given. 59 And he took the body,  
And Joseph wrapped him in clean cloth,  
60 And laid it in his new tomb's *wrath*,  
Which he had cut out in the rock.  
And rolling a great stone in stock  
At the door of the tomb, he left.  
61 And there was Mary Magdalene  
And the other Mary was seen,  
Sitting beside the grave bereft.

What did I say about the Muslim score?  
Now here is proof, if any here need more.  
The man is caught for burial like those  
Today in linen come to crowd their toes.  
The spices and the washings that arose  
Around him are a reminiscence fair  
Of what the Muslims do for their own  
share.

If Jesus gets the burial of such,

Then why not four wives for his divine  
touch?

If he was tempted in all points as we,  
Then he must have had a full family,  
For that is where the great temptation lies,  
Not in the politics of others' eyes.  
Four can be survived. Not every man dies.

62 And in the morning which had come  
After the Preparation's hum,  
The chief priests and the Pharisees  
Assembled by Pilate to please,

63 Saying "Sir, we've recalled how that  
Deceiver while living out flat  
Said, 'After three days I will rise.'

64 "So order that the grave in guise  
Be secured till the third day rise,  
So his disciples might not come  
By night and steal away the bum  
And tell the people 'He is raised  
From the dead,' and so the last crazed  
Deception be worse than the first."

65 And Pilate said to them, "You've got  
A guard, so go away in plot  
And make it as tight as you've sought."

66 And going along with the guard,  
They made the grave secure and hard,  
And sealed it with the stone in shard.

It seems the enemies of Jesus minded  
His words better than his own friends  
unblinded.

His foes expected resurrection's plot,  
While his own people and family forgot.  
The same is true today, what you may say  
To friend and disciple carries no sway,  
And none learn from a master in the trick  
Of living through the bin and through the  
slick.

But let a foe overhear any word  
And he will twist it from what had occurred  
And use it to show with the glee of turd  
How wrong a man may be and where to  
stick

The knife in back or chest, or give a kick.  
Beloved, how many times it goes unpurred!

### **Matthew 28**

1 But late in the sabbaths, as it  
Drew near to the first in the *fit*  
Of sabbaths, Mary Magdalene  
And the other Mary were seen

To come to look upon the grave.  
2 And see, a great earthquake to rave,  
An angel of the Lord came down  
From heaven and came near the town,  
And rolled away the stone before  
The door and sat upon the store.  
3 And his face was as lightning's glow,  
And his clothing as white as snow.

What most amazes me is how the crude  
Argue about which day ought to intrude  
As day of resurrection: should it be  
A Saturday or Sunday that's set free?  
I see that there's no proof historical  
That Jesus ever lived upon this ball,  
And that might be a matter to try first,  
Instead of thinking about days as cursed.  
Beloved, the only day You seem to take  
As of importance for commandment's sake  
Is just the Sabbath. On that day You find  
Me coming to Your throne and there  
resigned  
To live beneath Your grace and melody  
Of Psalm that rises upward and faintly.

4 And those keeping the guard were shaken  
From fear of him, and they were taken  
Down to the ground as though as dead.  
5 But the angel replied and said  
To the women, "You must not fear,  
For I know that you seek one dear,  
Jesus who has been crucified.  
6 "But he was raised and is not here,  
As he said. Come and look inside  
The place where the Lord did abide.

The whole myth of the dying god-man  
might  
Have concentrated on the rising light  
Merely because an earthquake shook a  
tomb  
The Roman soldiers guarded for their  
doom.  
The earthquake is enough to cause in time  
Proliferation of stories in rhyme  
About a man who once was crucified  
But turned out to be son of god unfried.  
Beloved, I do not say such is the case.  
But if it is, it does not change my face.  
I still adhere to those commandments he  
Affirmed beside the shore of Galilee.  
And whether live or dead or in glory,

I follow his path of faith for the free.

If I had heard the voice of angel when  
The women sat beside the deathly den,  
I might have run to tell the news to all  
I knew to meet the great celestial call.  
But I think it more likely, knowing me,  
That I would have been doubtful of the  
spree,  
And contemplated long wherefore the  
vision  
Was one external or inside incision.  
Beloved, I am a doubting Thomas here,  
And yet I come before Your throne in fear  
And love to You and to Your own  
commands  
To keep them while I'm living on earth's  
sands.  
Whether the angel rises on my beams  
Or not, I live above the thing that seems.

7 "Go quickly then and tell his friends  
That he was raised up from death's ends.  
And see, he goes before you to  
Galilee. You will see him too.  
See this is what I have told you."  
8 And so they went away from there,  
Away from the tomb *and its share*  
As fast as they could go with fear  
And great joy, they ran to appear  
To his disciples with news *dear*.  
9 But as they left to give the word  
To his disciples *as were stirred*,  
See, Jesus also met them too,  
And said "Good morning, howdy do?"  
And they came near and grabbed his feet,  
Prostrating themselves *at the treat*.  
10 Then Jesus told them, "Do not fear.  
Go tell your brothers who are near  
That they may go to Galilee,  
And there *at last* they will see me."  
11 After they left, some of the guard  
Came to the city saying *starred*  
To the chief priest what had occurred.  
12 The elders took counsel *in herd*  
And gave the soldiers silver *turd*  
Enough *to keep them off their word*,  
13 Saying "Say his disciples came  
And stole him at night while for blame  
We were asleep, *and that's our claim*."  
14 And if this is heard by the chief,  
We will persuade him from your grief.



15 They took the silver and they did  
As they had their instruction's bid.  
And this report was spread abroad  
By the Jews to this day's applaud.

It's easy to claim that they paid them off  
Not to tell the tale and to hear men scoff.  
But the fact that two rumours are about  
Makes it most difficult now not to doubt.  
In fact, if Jesus had stayed dead I would  
Find it the easier to believe the good,  
And not because of miracle and power,  
But because the tale here is like the shower  
Of solar myths abounding round the state.  
A variant that departed the rate  
Would be more credible to have on plate.  
I do not worship Baal or Horus or  
Tammuz or Dionysiacal boar.  
We do not need such gods, not any more.

16 But the eleven friends went to  
Galilee to the mount in view  
Appointed them by Jesus' word.  
17 And they saw him and they were stirred  
To fall down in prostration, yet  
They still doubted *the scene and set*.

If they still doubted though they saw the  
flame,  
The body and the word spoken in claim,  
Then how can anyone today be sure?  
And why would anyone today endure  
Such fables of the spring death and release  
Into new life to work vital increase?  
You may have cosmic doings in Your  
cloud,  
But my duty here is one spoke aloud,  
To keep the ten commandments and leave  
You  
To handle Your forgiveness on men due  
As You wish and as You contrive to do.  
If You chose to work out salvation's fare  
In strange and irrational terms to wear,  
It's not for me to think about or share.

18 And Jesus came near and he spoke  
With them, saying "All power for broke  
In heaven and earth is given to me.  
19 "Go and make of all nations my  
Disciples, baptise them in dye  
Of the name of the Father, Son  
And Holy spirit when you're done.

20 "Teach them to observe everything  
That I've commanded you on wing.  
And see I am with you each day  
To the end of this age in pay.  
Amen and amen, so I say."

The very last words that You sent one said  
Bring out the fighting spirit in those bred  
To follow him: they want to argue round  
Baptism sprinkled or dunked to be  
drowned,  
And whether You are three not to be found.  
I cast aside the dogmas of the day,  
And meet the coming of the Sabbath ray  
Through the miqwe until I find the way  
To hear Your great commandments and  
obey.  
Obedience is the condition met  
By those with whom Your sent one abides  
yet.

I keep his faith, Beloved, and find him still  
Beside me in the valley, on the hill,  
Alive, though once dead, living to the fill.

## **The Gospel According to Mark**

The briefest Gospel, that of Mark, and terse  
Is one I delight to set down in verse.  
It's manly and no nonsense in its way,  
And yet inspires the soul with holy ray.  
Some say it was the first to be set down,  
And Matthew and Luke copied with a  
frown.  
I doubt we know the ins and outs of all.  
It could be all the Gospels in the stall  
Are written in the century come late  
After the events they claim to relate.  
What is so is that the words still ring true,  
And by their similarity unto  
The pagan myths destroy those ancient  
tales  
Of such idolatry that none avails.

### **Mark 1**

1 Beginning of the gospel of  
Jesus Christ, son of God above,  
2 As written in the prophets, "See,  
I send my messenger *to be*  
Before your face, which shall prepare  
The way before you *to go there*.  
3 "The voice of one crying aloud

In wilderness 'Prepare *in crowd*  
The way of the Lord, make His ways  
Straight *before Him and for His praise.*'''

4 John baptised in the wilderness,  
And preached baptism to confess  
Repentance for *all sins'* remission.

5 And there went out *in great ambition*  
To him all Judea's land, and  
Those of Jerusalem *at hand*,  
And were all baptised by him in  
River Jordan confessing sin.

6 And John was clothed with camel's hair,  
A girdle of a skin was there  
About his loins, and he did eat  
Locusts and wild honey *for treat*.

Both locusts and camel flesh are for sale  
In some markets I've visited when pale.  
But I have tasted neither, to be true.  
The one's acceptable by Torah's rue  
But not by habit of my stomach's crew.  
The other is acceptable in plight  
According to the holy Qur'an's light.  
If John's fulfilment of the prophecy  
By doing of the standard he could see  
From Scripture in the desert place and wee,  
Then I too may follow his footsteps there,  
Without taking the locusts for my share.  
Beloved, Your honey is enough for me  
As I walk out upon the rocky bare.

7 And he preached, saying "There comes  
one

Greater than I, when I am done,  
The latchet of whose shoes I'm not  
Worthy to stoop down and untaut.

8 "I've indeed baptised you with water,  
But he'll baptise you with *the slaughter*  
Of holy spirit." 9 And it came  
To pass in those days *one by name*  
Of Jesus from Nazareth came,  
From Galilee, and was baptised  
By John in Jordan *all surprised*.

10 And right away when he came out  
Of the water, he saw *with shout*  
The heavens opened, and the spirit  
Like a dove come on him *or near it*.  
11 And there came a voice from the sky  
That said "You are my beloved guy,  
In whom I am well pleased *to cry*."

Before the Sabbath comes I'm sure to dress

Myself for the baptisms I confess,  
And take the day of preparation and  
Of congregation for the mark I stand.  
And as I rise from waters like a grave,  
I know, Beloved, Your greater power to  
save.

I rise confessed, repented, cold and brave,  
And look out all refreshed upon the land.  
I hear, Beloved, as it were voice aloud  
Come down from heaven, searing through  
the cloud,

To say that I too am a son of God,  
Though lowly, true, and swimming on the  
sod.

With gasp of new breath, sputtering, I  
know

That You raise up the soul from death  
below.

12 Immediately the spirit drove  
Him in the wilderness *to rove*.

13 There he was in the wilderness  
Forty days, tempted *in distress*  
Of Satan, and was with the wild  
Beasts, and the angels *came and smiled*  
To serve him. 14 Now after that John  
Was put in prison *and had gone*,

Jesus came into Galilee,  
Preaching the gospel *to the free*  
Of the kingdom of God *to be*,  
15 And saying "The time is fulfilled,  
And the kingdom of God is billed,  
Repent *and go beyond the mind*,  
Believing the gospel *in kind*."

The Gospel of Jesus has just two points,  
But they're not popular in churchly joints.  
The first is Your kingdom is near and dear,  
The second is repent for what we hear.  
Both issues rest firmly upon the law  
Of ten commandments spoken once for  
awe

On Sinai. So the Gospel is the word  
That the commandments never have been  
blurred.

I do repent, Beloved, as the command  
Of Jesus, in the light of things that stand  
Firm in the Decalogue, and so I live  
On a foundation better than they give  
Me in the pew or standing under cross.  
The Gospel is just that You are the boss.

16 Now as he walked beside the sea  
Of Galilee, of Galilee,  
He saw Simon and Andrew there  
His brother casting nets *for share*  
Of fish from the sea, for they were  
Some fishermen. 17 And Jesus said  
“Come after me, and be you led,  
And I will make you fishermen  
*Fitter and able* to catch men.”

18 And right away they left their nets  
And followed him *to place their bets*.

19 And when he'd gone a little way  
He saw Zebedee's sons, the brothers  
James and John in their boat *asway*,  
Mending their nets *among the others*.

20 And straightway he called them, and  
they

Left their father Zebedee lone  
In the boat with paid helpers' *drone*  
And went after him *without groan*.

The followers of Jesus have come from  
The profession of fishermen to drum  
Up followers the more. They do not see  
A difference in calling, it may be.  
If they're successful, the result is just  
The ocean's being depleted like dust.  
The use of nets is what does that, I think.  
A sportsman who's an angler on the brink  
Of mountain stream may also take the stock  
Down to the danger level on his rock.  
Whatever fishermen do, it is not  
In interests of the fish in quiet plot.  
Jesus reveals a sinister thing here  
Prophetic of the church that would appear.

21 Then they went to Capernaum,  
And straightway, on the Sabbath day  
He entered *meritorium*  
Of synagogue and taught the way.  
22 And they were surprised at his teaching,  
For he taught them as one outreaching  
Authority that the scribes had.

Establishment of faith under Rome's sway  
Did not, for fear of Caesar, hold the way  
Of great authority, but rather stood  
To argue about the law if they could.  
Jesus made his fatal mistake when he  
Proclaimed that You gave him authority.  
That was enough to raise suspicion where  
The scribes were careful always to be ware

Of any threat to Caesar's kingly share.  
Beloved, I trow Your sent one was the true  
Interpreter of Your will for Your crew.  
But You neglect to take note that each  
block  
Has its own bully. Stop here and take stock.  
That's why we have invented door and  
lock.

23 And in their synagogue a *sad*  
Man with an unclean spirit cried  
Out 24 saying, “Let *us* alone! *Bide!*  
What have we to do with your side,  
Jesus of Nazareth? Have you  
Come to destroy us? I know you  
Who you are--holy one from God!”  
25 Jesus rebuked him *on the sod*,  
Saying, “Be quiet, and come out.”  
26 When the unclean spirit *with shout*  
Had torn him and cried with loud voice,  
He came out of him *without choice*.  
27 Then they were all amazed at that,  
And questioned themselves *where they sat*,  
And said “What thing is this? What new  
Doctrine *is* this *heard from the pew?*  
For with what *divine might* and power  
Commands he even *at the hour*  
The unclean spirits to obey?”  
28 And so his fame spread all around  
Through all the Galilean ground.

I don't know what an unclean spirit is.  
Perhaps the times have changed with  
modern biz.

It's rare now that in company refined,  
In pew and under golden cross and blind,  
That folk foam at the mouth, fall down and  
cry.

And those who do are given on the sly  
Some medication for eclectic fit,  
Which may sometimes serve for a vision's  
kit.

Whatever Jesus healed or cast away,  
It was something of a more ancient day.  
But then as now, most who cry “He is  
God”

When they meet Jesus walking on the sod  
Are speaking through demonic in device,  
And Jesus bids them stop the work of mice.

29 As soon as they'd come out from there  
They left the synagogue *to share*

With James and John *the Sabbath fare*  
 In Simon and Andrew's house there.  
 30 But Simon's wife's mother lay sick  
 With a fever *or fever's trick*,  
 And soon they told him of her *stick*.  
 31 And he came and took her by hand,  
 And lifted up, and made her stand,  
 And straight away the fever left her,  
 And she served them *what food had cleft*  
*her*.

I think that Jesus is as good a man  
 As any on the block. I see his plan  
 To heal a mother-in-law under ban.  
 Most men avoid the mother-in-law where  
 They come with friends and food and fun  
 to share  
 A weekend under sun and weather fair.  
 The motive may have been that she would  
 serve  
 The guys, if well, with that much greater  
 verve.  
 Beloved, I too once had mother-in-law,  
 Apostle to the Lapps, some said in awe,  
 Who hit the road when no road through the  
 fells  
 Was found but that of reindeer without  
 bells.  
 She sold the books that told of Jesus' spells  
 To heal from demons north and south in  
 claw.

32 At evening, when the sun went down,  
 They brought him all that *in that town*  
 Were sick or with devils possessed.  
 33 And all the city there addressed  
 To gather themselves at the door.  
 34 And he healed many, many score  
 Of their diseases, what is more,  
 Cast out their devils, but did not  
 Let them speak, since they knew his *plot*.

Despite degree of pain and suffering  
 The folk waited until the end of sting  
 Of Sabbath day before they brought the ill  
 To Jesus to see if he filled the bill.  
 It could have been respect for Jesus' rest.  
 It could have been respect for Your law's  
 vest.  
 But knowing populace from east to west,  
 It probably was signal of the fear

Of priests and their police with travelled  
 gear.  
 Beloved, today there is no one to say  
 Whether or not I keep the Sabbath day.  
 For love alone I eagerly await  
 The coming of the Sabbath and its plate,  
 And find You better than religious state.

35 He got up in the morning long  
 Before the daylight began song,  
 And went out to a lonely place  
 And sought in prayer *the divine face*.  
 36 And Simon and the others there  
 Followed after him for their share.  
 37 And when they'd found him, said to him  
 "They're all looking for you with vim."  
 38 And he said to them, "Let us go  
 Into the next towns *in the row*,  
 That I may preach to them also,  
 Because that's why I'm on the go."

This text in which the Lord keeps Sunday  
 mass  
 In early morning is one they by-pass  
 Who wish to show that Sunday is the day  
 When men should stop their work and  
 come to pray.  
 I help the lost cause with this contribution:  
 Jesus at least once in sly elocution  
 Performed the mass in hidden place alone,  
 Away from Queen Elisabeth's dark throne.  
 Perhaps it was a priest's hole in the dark  
 Of a lone castle Catholic to mark  
 His universal love to humankind,  
 Even the uncircumcised and the swined.  
 Beloved, if so, I join the mass to hear  
 The syllables turn to Your word and ear.

39 And he preached in their synagogues  
 Throughout all Galilee *and frogs*  
 And devils cast out *from their clogs*.  
 40 A leper came to him to beg,  
 And kneeling to him on his leg,  
 Said to him, "If you will, you can  
 Make me a clean and healthy man."  
 41 And Jesus with compassion moved  
 Put out his hand and touched and proved  
 And said to him indeed I will,  
 Be clean *right now and healthy still*."  
 42 As soon as he had said the word  
 The leprosy from him was stirred,  
 He was a clean and healthy *bird*.

43 He warned him and sent him away.  
 And told him "Remember to say  
 Nothing to any man today,  
 But go show yourself to the priest  
 And offer for your healing *beast*  
 Which Moses made witness at least."  
 45 But he went out and told abroad  
 What Jesus did and to his land  
 So that he could no longer stride  
 In open at the city side  
 But fled into the desert places  
 Where everyone sought out his traces.

One saving grace marks Jesus at his post,  
 Despite his darker sayings that leave most  
 More darkened in their minds than they  
     were when  
 They had not heard a whisper from his den.  
 That saving grace is his compassion moved  
 When met with human suffering in the  
     grooved.  
 I follow his example in my speech  
 Ambiguous and with failure to reach  
 The soul with the clear word that I should  
     preach.  
 So I participate in Jesus' wrongs,  
 Despite the way I sing King David's songs.  
 Beloved, may I too follow Jesus' way,  
 And be filled with heart and with hand in  
     sway  
 Of the compassion that taught him its lay.

## Mark 2

1 And *now* again he came into  
 Capernaum after *some* days,  
 And it was told abroad *for true*  
 That he'd come to that house *to graze*.  
 2 And right away they gathered there,  
 So many they'd no room to spare,  
 Not even to come to the door,  
 And so he preached the word before.

I wonder what word Jesus preached the day  
 He came into Capernaum to stay.  
 Mark does not say, perhaps because the  
     word  
 Was simple and expected and unblurred.  
 The sermons that have not escaped the fair  
 Oblivion are such as cause to ponder  
 What the man could have meant with mind  
     to wander.  
 The word he preached is left unstated here,

And so I'm justified to see and hear  
 A repetition of the word You sent  
 On Sinai for all humankind unbent.  
 The Decalogue and faith of Jesus are  
 As far as I can see equivalent.  
 The three are one along with David's star.

3 Then they came to him and they brought  
 One sick of palsy which was got  
 There carried by four. 4 And when they  
 Could not come near him for array  
*Of crowd*, they took *tiles* from the roof  
 Above him, and *without reproof*  
 Made a hole in it, and let down  
 The bed where lay *upon his crown*  
 The *man* sick of palsy. 5 When saw  
 Jesus such faith, he said unto  
 The sick man in the palsy's *claw*  
 "Son, your sins be forgiven you."  
 6 But there sat certain of the scribes  
 Who reasoned in their hearts *with bribes*.  
 7 "What blasphemies does this man speak?  
 Who can forgive sin *of the weak*  
 But only God?" 8 And straight away  
 When Jesus' spirit caught the lay  
 Of their thoughts in them, he did say  
 "Why do you cogitate this way  
 Within your hearts? 9 "Which thing with  
     ease  
 Can any say and that will please  
 The sick with palsy: Your sins are  
 Forgiven you, *or harder far*.  
 Get up and take your bed and walk?  
 10 "But so you'll know how to take stock  
 The son of man has power on earth  
 To forgive sins *of any worth*,  
 He says to the sick palsied man  
 11 "I tell you, get up, take *by plan*  
 Your bed and go back to your home."  
 12 And right a way he rose to roam  
 Took up his bed and then went out  
 Before them all, so *without doubt*  
 All were surprised and glorified  
 God saying "We have never spied  
 Such things before, *though we have tried*."

The simple words of comfort Jesus spoke  
 To the man who sought him under the  
     stroke  
 Of condemnation of those who believed  
 That sickness was the proof of those  
     deceived

By sin, were twisted by those standing by  
To be blasphemous under a blue sky.  
Today the folk of church and song repeat  
The accusation to heavy rock beat,  
And claim that Jesus did claim to be God,  
Despite the fact that You alone bear rod  
Of sovereignty here in the universe.  
Both scribe and Christian are under a curse  
For the false witness that they bear of him  
Who merely did his best to help the slim.

13 And *after that then* he went out  
Again along the sea-side *route*  
And all the multitude came there  
To him and he taught them *their share*.

14 As he passed by, he saw Levi  
*Son of Alphaeus* sitting by  
The custom stand, and said to him  
"Follow me," and he got up trim  
And followed him. 15 It came to pass  
As Jesus sat to eat *his bass*

In his house many publicans  
And sinners came and sat *as fans*  
With Jesus and his company:  
Who followed him there were many.

16 And when the scribes and Pharisees  
Saw him eat with publicans, please  
Sinners, then they said to the ones  
Who followed him, "How is it, *sons*,  
He eats and drinks with publicans  
And sinners?" 17 Jesus heard *their plans*  
And told them "People that are well  
Do not need the physician's spell,  
But people that are sick; I came  
Not to call the righteous *in blame*  
But sinners to repentance' *claim*."

18 The disciples of John along  
With Pharisees were very strong  
At fasting, and they came to say  
To him "Why do John's folk and those  
Of Pharisees fast *in their clothes*,  
But your disciples never fast?"

19 And Jesus said to them *at last*  
"Do the sons of the wedding fast  
While the bridegroom's with them? As  
long

As they have the bridegroom for song  
They cannot fast. 20 But the days come  
When the bridegroom is taken from  
And then in those times they shall fast.

At least two sons are implicated here,

And if we add the wedding, things are  
clear,

We have a blessed Trinity, the three  
All of one substance though to sing for free  
And one is wedding, not made of the flesh  
Nor of bone, but perhaps of the right fresh  
Breezes that blow through wedding hall of  
fame.

That could then be the spirit as it came.  
All nature comes in threes and that is proof  
That You are also three, or else a spoof.

Ah my Beloved, preserve me and the race  
From all blasphemy in this horrid place  
Made glorious by the presence of Your  
face,

Unknown, unseen, unfelt but by Your  
grace.

21 "No one sews a *new piece to last*  
On an old garment, for the first  
New patch that covered up the worst  
Draws up and makes the rent but worse.

22 "No one puts new grape juice *to curse*  
Into old wineskins, else the new  
Grape juice bursts old wineskins in two,  
And all the grape juice is spilled; those  
Wineskins are spoiled, new grape juice  
chose

New wineskins." 23 And it came to pass  
That he went through the cornfields' *grass*  
Upon the Sabbath day, and his  
Disciples started *with a whiz*  
To pick ears of corn as they went.  
24 And the Pharisees said *when bent*  
To him "Indeed, why do they do  
On Sabbath day unlawful *brew*?"

If those who came to scold the friends that  
day

Who picked grain on the Sabbath in the  
way

To bring their hunger to an end had come  
To give their guests a meal of Sabbath  
hum,

They would not have had any chance to see  
Them eating in the roadside fields for free.  
It's just as much a sin to fast as take  
An earth to break the fast for Sabbath's  
sake.

Beloved, You are not like the living score  
Of priestly sages gathered at my door.  
They cry me down to die of hunger on

The Sabbath and hardly after the dawn.  
But You have given me the grain and nut  
Beside the doors of churches that are shut.

25 And he said to them, "Have you not  
Read what David did when he sought,  
Was hungry, he and those with him?  
26 "How he went into God's house *grim*  
In days of Abiathar high priest  
And consumed the show-bread at least  
Which is not lawful to devour  
Except the priests *at the right hour*,  
And gave also to those with him?"

Abiathar was very unlike priest  
In churches round the world today at least.  
I've not found many worth a meal at all,  
With two exceptions on the earthly ball.  
Perhaps the fact my own door's open wide  
Each Sabbath day to any who would bide  
And eat my bread and drink my wine and  
    hide  
Is why I am not qualified to be  
A priest or pastor on the Christian spree.  
A Lutheran priest in Pittsburgh one day  
Took me to eat one Sunday without pay.  
A Baptist pastor once gave me a meal  
Along with his wife, which was a good  
    deal.

27 And he said to them "Sabbath's made  
For man, and not man *to be stayed*  
For the Sabbath. 28 "Therefore the son  
Of man's lord of the Sabbath *done*."

The Sabbath was made for man, I should  
    ask  
Why not for women too while husbands  
    bask?  
But those who would deprive me of my rest  
God-given, non-negotiable, would test  
The waters to see if they could demand  
The Sabbath for the Jew alone in land,  
And for the donkey that's in Jewish hand.  
Jesus perhaps forgot the donkey's place.  
Or then he figured that the human race  
And donkeys were so similar to trace  
That man was term enough for both that  
    beast  
And the wives of the both for the increased.  
Beloved, I stubbornly refuse to let  
The Sabbath day fall from the things I get.

Jesus claims to be Sabbath's lord, and I  
Wonder what he could mean by that reply.  
If he's a fair messiah chosen well  
To apply law to Your people in spell,  
Then he would be the lord of nearly all  
The statutes that appear in sacred hall.  
That would conflict with the state of the  
    state  
Under the Roman wages and their fate,  
Which were suspicious of authority  
Besides that then invested in the see  
Of Rome. That's nothing rightly new to  
    me.

Beloved, let him be lord of what he will  
And I will stand obedient on Your hill.

### Mark 3

1 And he entered again into  
The synagogue, and there in view  
Was a man with a withered hand.  
2 And they watched him, if he'd command  
Him to be healed on Sabbath day  
That they might accuse him *to stray*.  
3 And he said to the man who had  
The withered hand "Step forward, lad."  
4 And he said to them "Is it lawful  
To do good on Sabbath or awful?  
To save a life, or else to kill?"  
But they held their peace *and were still*.

Refusal to save life on any day  
Is to kill, if it's true what these words say.  
The rationale of argument here taken  
Is logical conclusion of things shaken.  
It's easy to argue about details  
Of how the Sabbath should be kept in sails,  
But Jesus cuts down to the quick to note  
That it's a matter of life in the boat.  
Beloved, it's also matter of life and  
Death, when the priests and saviours take  
    the stand  
That that one concrete blessing on demand  
That gives the right inalienable here  
To rest on Sabbath day is out of gear.  
Depriving of Sabbath deprives life's sand.

5 When he'd looked round on them in  
    wrath,  
Grieved for hardness of their hearts' path,  
He told the man "Hold out your hand."  
He stretched it out *at the command*,

And his hand was made well again,  
 Just like the other. 6 And so then  
 The Pharisees went out to plan  
 With Herodians against *the man*,  
 To kill him. 7 But Jesus withdrew  
 With his disciples to the sea,  
 And a great crowd from Galilee  
 Followed him, and from Judea,  
 8 Jerusalem, Idumea,  
 From beyond Jordan, and about  
 Tyre and Sidon, a great crowd *stout*,  
 When they had heard what things he did,  
 They came unto him *where he hid*.  
 9 And he told his disciples that  
 A small ship should wait where he sat  
 Because the people crowded him.  
 10 For he'd healed many *and made trim*,  
 So they pressed near him just to touch,  
 As many as had plagues and such.  
 11 And unclean spirits when they saw  
 Him, fell down before him in awe,  
 And shouted "You're the son of God!"  
 12 And he directly reprimanded  
 Them not to make him known *high-handed*.

The expression Nebuchanezzar coined  
 Is now repeated by demons enjoined  
 To stop their clatter. But the Christian  
 church

Is founded on demonic sort of smirch,  
 That Jesus is the Son of God by which  
 They mean He's God himself and we can  
 switch

From You to him and back without a hitch,  
 Without knowing the difference from pitch.  
 Beloved, I let no man usurp the throne  
 That rises in my heart and is Your own,  
 That rises on the universe in arch  
 Above the desert streams that sometimes  
 parch,

Above reality in all that's seen.  
 Beloved, let no prophet come to demean.

13 And he went up into a mountain  
 And called to him *beside a fountain*  
 All those he wished, and they arrived.  
 14 And he ordained twelve *undeprieved*,  
 That they should be with him, to send  
 Them out to preach 15 with power to mend  
 Sicknesses and to cast out devils.

16 And Simon he *brought down some levels*

With Peter as a *new* surname;  
 17 And James the son of Zebedee,  
 And John brother of James *of fame*,  
 Both whom he surnamed worthily  
 Boanerges or sons of thunder,

Och! Sons of thunder and light, now do  
 tell!

With what fair and couth woman at what  
 spell

Did thunder lie to beget his sons well?  
 Or is the thunder mother of the pair?  
 I doubt she has a womb in underwear.  
 Absurdity is all men say of You  
 Who would find You produce a son when  
 due.

Beloved, come down in thunder once again  
 And speak Your word a message to brave  
 men,

And say once more there is no god in store  
 For heaven and earth but You, one and no  
 more.

Mythology is easier far to take  
 Than truth and truth alone for Your dear  
 sake.

Beloved, come once again and plant a  
 stake.

18 And Andrew and Philip, *no wonder*,  
 Bartholomew and Matthew too,  
 Thomas, James son of Alpheus,  
 And Thaddeus and Simon true  
 Canaanite, 19 and the last Judas  
 Iscariot who was the one  
 Who betrayed him when he was done;  
 And they entered into a house.  
 20 And the multitude came *to dowse*  
 So they'd no time even to eat.  
 21 And when his friend heard of the  
 rumour,

They went to restrain his *ill humour*  
 Saying "*The man has now gone mad.*"

22 And the scribes who came down from  
 sad

Jerusalem, said "He has got  
 Beelzebub, *by which* prince *taught*  
 He casts out devils. 23 He called them  
 And told parables' *stratagem*,  
 "How can Satan cast out Satan?"  
 24 And if a kingdom is divided



Against itself *and not one-sided*,  
 It cannot stand. 25 And if a house  
 Is set against itself, that house  
 Cannot stand. 26 And if Satan rise  
 Against himself, and be divided,  
 He cannot stand, but is derided.  
 27 “No one can go into the house  
 Of a strong man to spoil or grieve  
 His goods except he will first bind  
 The strong man *in front and behind*,  
 And then he’s free to spoil his house.  
 28 “Truly I say to you all sins  
 Shall be forgiven, *thrown into bins*,  
 Of human beings and what they  
 Blaspheme blasphemies on the way,  
 29 “But who shall blaspheme holy spirit  
 Shall never be forgiven or near it  
 But is in danger of damnation  
 Eternal and always *for ration*,”  
 30 Because they said he’s got unclean  
 Spirit *staying upon his scene*.

The fact is Jesus was just wrong when he  
 Thought that a house divided could not see  
 Existence for time and eternity.  
 The Roman Catholic church goes on and on  
 Despite many divisions on the lawn.  
 Dominicans have sometimes come upon  
 Franciscans with the weight of horror’s  
 spree.  
 And wars between two Catholic nations are  
 Not unknown in the annals of this star.  
 Beloved, Your sent one comes to the  
 defence  
 Of himself with all weapons in his tents,  
 And some are true and some less true in  
 sense,  
 But all lived up to what they needed to,  
 Defending him from the low doubting  
 crew.

31 His mother and his brothers came  
 And stood outside to call his name.  
 32 The multitude around him sat  
 And said to him “Indeed whereat,  
 Your mother and brothers outside  
 Are looking for *where you abide*.  
 33 He answered them and said “Who’s my  
 Mother or my brothers *who cry*?”  
 34 He looked around about at them  
 Who sat about his *diadem*,  
 And said “Look at my mother here,

And *all my brothers come to cheer*.  
 35 “For anyone who’ll come to do  
 The will of God, the same is *true*  
 My brother, sister, mother too.”

I’m glad to be the brother of Your Christ,  
 Since he claims that those who find it  
 sufficed  
 To keep Your ten commandments are the  
 ones  
 Who are his relatives after the runs.  
 I just hope in the illustration here,  
 In making a point fine and well appear,  
 He did not neglect honour to his mum,  
 Which would show disobedience in thumb.  
 Beloved, the many loyalties of life  
 In this world of go-get and greater strife  
 Neglect the ten that make relations best.  
 Let me not depart from my mother’s nest,  
 But find the few, so few, who love Your  
 law  
 Surround me instead of the tooth and claw.

#### Mark 4

1 And he began again to teach,  
 Beside the sea he sat to preach,  
 And there was gathered unto him  
 A great crowd *of the people trim*,  
 And so he entered in a boat  
 And sat out in the sea *to float*;  
 And the whole crowd was by the sea,  
 Upon the shore *and in the lea*.  
 2 By parables he taught them things  
 And told his teachings to their kings.  
 3 “Listen and see, there went out one  
 To *sow seed in the field for fun*.  
 4 “It happened as he sowed, some fell  
 By the wayside, birds of the dell  
 Came to devour *the seeds they smell*.  
 5 “And some fell on the stony ground  
 Where hardly any soil was found,  
 And straightway it sprang up, for it  
 Had no depth of the earth and fit.  
 6 “But when the sun shone hot, it burned,  
 Because it had no root *and learned*,  
 And so it withered away *spurned*.  
 7 “And some fell among thorns, the thorns  
 Grew up and choked it *with their scorns*  
 And it yielded no fruit *nor corns*.  
 8 “And other fell on the good ground  
 And yielded fruit that sprang up *sound*,  
 And increased and brought forth at last

Thirty, sixty, or hundred cast.”

The optimism of the parable  
Is far beyond my own, and it is full.  
The fact is almost all the seeds thrown out  
By sower with his shoulder bag and clout  
Falls on the good ground. Hardly any goes  
Upon the path, among the stones and rows  
Of thorns. The word that Jesus spreads  
abroad  
To keep the ten commandments of our God  
Is hardly heard by any on the sod,  
And fewer still live under easy rod.  
Beloved, he erred in thinking that the truth  
Would win the hearts of humankind and  
youth.  
Instead the pagan idols blend with him  
For solar myths and other sorts of dim.

9 And he told them “Who has an ear  
To hear, then indeed let him hear.”  
10 And he told them “To you it’s given  
To know the mystery to *live* in  
The kingdom of God, but to them  
Who are without *the kingdom’s gem*  
All in parables’ stratagem.  
12 “That seeing they may see and not  
Perceive the very things *they’re taught*;  
And hearing they may hear and not  
Understand, lest in time *and plot*  
They should be converted, their sins  
Should be forgiven and cast in bins.”

Indeed, the many do not hear the word,  
Are left with heart still burning with the  
stirred  
And pliant messages that have occurred  
In idols’ wake since serpent rose to speak  
Words cunning, plausible and fair and  
sleek.  
Desired by eye, sweet to the taste, and still  
Pretending to make wise, the tower and  
mill  
Of old deceit is ever new and bright.  
Ears hear but understand not in the night,  
And eyes awaken only to delight  
In art and treasure and the fond conceit.  
Beloved, my heart lies in the burden’s fleet  
That I saw from my childhood in the street:  
The crowd is certain to surpass the bill.

13 And he said to them “Don’t you know

This parable *I’ve come to show*?  
How then will you understand all  
The parables *I’ve come to call*?  
14 “The sower sows the word of God.  
15 “And these by the wayside are clod  
Where the word is sown, but when they  
Have heard, then Satan comes their way,  
And takes away the word once sown  
In their hearts, *but has never grown*.  
16 “And these are likewise which are sown  
On stony ground, who, when they’ve heard  
The word, receive with glad hearts stirred,  
17 “But have no root, and so remain  
*A little time upon the plain*,  
After when affliction comes up  
Or persecution *is their cup*,  
For the word’s sake, and straight away  
They are offended in the way.  
18 “These are like the ones that are sown  
Among thorns, such hear the word thrown,  
19 “And this world’s cares and riches’ lies  
And other lusts *before their eyes*  
Come in and choke the word, and it  
Becomes unfruitful *and unfit*.  
20 “These are like those sown on good  
ground,  
Such hear the word, receive it sound,  
And bring forth fruit, some thirty-fold,  
Sixty, one hundred, *dear as gold*.”

A fifth kind now arises in my heart,  
Not of the hardened way nor stony part,  
Nor of the care of thorn or the good  
ground,  
But a fifth way to go and keep the sound.  
Your word falls on my heart each day and I  
Receive the garden of the shining sky.  
No care nor treasure comes to cross my  
way,  
No Satan nor affliction devours pay.  
And yet I bear no plant or fruit at all.  
Each morning I am nourished in the stall  
With new seeds of Your making from my  
thrall.  
The manna I receive stays not a day,  
But comes renewed, refreshed, a morning  
ray.  
While others march in progress, here I stay.

21 And he told them “Is candle brought  
To be under a bushel *sought*,  
Or under bed, and not be set

On candlestick *out of the wet?*

22 For nothing's hid which shall not be  
Revealed and manifest freely;  
Neither was any secret kept

But it came abroad, *in light leaped*.

23 If any man have ears to hear  
Then let him hear *what things appear.*”

24 And he told them “Take heed what you  
Hear: with what measure you make do,  
It shall be measured out to you,  
And unto you that hear shall more  
Be given *when you reach the door*.

I hear more than the nun within her room  
The round of Psalm and Scripture to my  
doom.

My measure is beyond the feast's employ,  
Above the hopes, within the crumpled joy.  
I hear and with the hearing I become  
Responsible to bring forth of the sum,  
And share the fruit of visiting the site  
Of Your creation's abundance and light.  
Beloved, I bear no more than granite heart,  
At most the lichens under foot that start  
To make the traveller slip under the load.  
I bring no grape or wheat into the road.  
But the thin colours of my lichen skin  
Reflect the law revealing what is sin.

25 And he said “God's kingdom is like  
As if a man should cast *and strike*  
Seed in the ground, 27 then go to sleep,  
And get up night and day *to keep*,  
And the seed sprout and grow, but he  
Does not know how *nor can agree*.

28 For earth brings forth of herself fruit,  
First the blade, then the ear *to boot*,  
After that the full corn in ear.  
29 But when the fruit comes to appear,  
Right off he puts the sickle in  
And brings the harvest into bin.”

Indeed I do not know the sprouting seed,  
The plant that grows up so much like the  
weed.

I've given up the hope of bearing fruit,  
Of climbing to the stars, lifting by boot.  
My bin is ready, empty to the full,  
The warehouse stands with pride  
immutable,  
And if you bless the field drawn by Your  
word,

It is a happiness to my heart stirred.

And if you leave me barren in the way,  
I still rise to give thanks at break of day.  
Your kingdom is Your own, I merely stand,  
The doubter in Your field, scarecrow on  
land

Amazed to see the ear beneath the leaf,  
Expecting now and ever some new grief.

30 He said “To what shall we compare  
God's kingdom, or with what thing fair  
Shall we liken it? 31 It is like  
A grain of mustard seed *in spike*,  
Which when it's sown upon the earth  
Is less than any seed in worth:  
32 But when it's sown, it grows up tall  
Greater than all herbs *at the wall*,  
And shoots out great branches so that  
Where birds of the air came and sat.”

The mustard seed is not as small as that.  
And furthermore, from where I've seen and  
sat,

It never makes a tree, hardly a bush,  
Not swell enough for bigger birds to push.  
And yet the mustard seed is beyond all  
Faith ever met in bin or barn or stall.  
The greatest faith there is is not a crumb  
Compared to the dark mustard seed in sum.  
Beloved, the seed however small or big  
Is visible and put down were I dig.  
But faith as trust or faithfulness, the two,  
Cannot be seen, invisibly they do.  
Your sent one jokes comparing faith in size  
To seeds or fruit or trees in any guise.

33 With many such parables he  
Spoke the word to them *faithfully*,  
As they were able to hear it.

34 But without parable *and fit*,  
He did not speak to them. When they  
Were alone he explained the way  
To his disciples what to say.

I'm willing to believe the righteous sage  
Who opposed Roman army on rampage  
With the conservative in ancient view  
Of Decalogue and its way to serve You  
Under the auspices of one appointed  
By You and on the human throne anointed.  
I hear his parables and searching their  
meaning,

But do not accept heart-rending in keening  
For Queen of heaven and virgin at the start,  
Or resurrected Horus for his part.  
Accept or not, Beloved, my simple faith  
That You are sovereign and not pagan  
wraith,  
Creator and the giver of Your law,  
And not supporter of the tooth and claw.

35 The same day and at evening come  
He told them "Let's go over from  
Here to the other side. 36 And when  
They'd sent away the crowd of men,  
They took him even as he was  
Into the ship *away from claws*,  
And there were also with him there  
Other little ships *and to spare*.  
37 There arose a great storm of wind  
And the waves beat the ship *unfinned*,  
*Water poured in* so it was full.  
38 And he was in the capable  
Stern of the vessel fast asleep  
Upon a pillow, *not a peep*,  
They woke him up and told him there  
"Master, we perish, *don't you care?*"  
39 He got up and rebuked the wind  
And said unto the sea *unpinned*  
"In peace, be still!" and the wind ceased  
And there was a great calm *increased*.  
40 And he said to them "Why the scare?  
Have you no faith found anywhere?"  
41 And they were greatly frightened and  
Said to each other *all the band*  
"What kind of man is this that wind  
And even the sea have been binned,  
Obedient to his *word and hand?*"

The Bektashi pir who merely sat still  
Through storm while all the others in the  
mill  
Hysterically cried for salvation's hill  
While Golden Horn raged round them to  
the fill,  
Just kept to Jesus' own example then.  
So is it with all great and righteous men.  
The answer to the question, don't you  
know  
That only the thickness of the ship's row  
Stands between you and death? is still to  
throw  
Awareness that on land not even that  
Divides me from the death of those who sat

In judgement of Your law. My sleep is  
sound,  
Too sound indeed for the dangers around,  
Of democratic demonizing found  
In every place on this unholy ground.

### Mark 5

1 And they came to the other side  
Of the sea, to the countryside  
Of Gadarenes. When he had come  
Out of the ship, then straight away  
There came out of the tombs a chum  
To meet him who was under sway  
Of an unclean spirit 3 who had  
A place to live among the tombs,  
And no one could secure the lad  
Not even with chains *in their rooms*;  
4 Because he had been often bound  
With cuffs and chains and even sound  
Chains had been pulled apart by him  
And the cuffs shattered *by that grim*  
*Spectre in human form*, so none  
Could tame *the man when all was done*.  
5 And always day and night he dwelt  
Crying in mountain tombs unfelt,  
Cutting himself with stones. 6 But when  
He saw Jesus afar off, then  
He ran and fell down in prostration.  
7 He shouted in a loud elation  
And saying "What have I to do,  
With you, Jesus, son of most high  
God? So by God I adjure you,  
Not to torment me." 8 For reply  
He told him "Come out of the man,  
You unclean spirit *under ban*."

No man says that Jesus came in the flesh  
But by the spirit of God sent down fresh.  
No man says that Jesus is son of God,  
The second person in the triune pod,  
God out of God, light out of light unshod,  
Except by unclean spirit in the mesh.  
The heathen faith has crept through  
Christian crowd  
On centuries of Roman reign allowed,  
And now defines what's Christian and  
what's not:  
The pagan is the defined in the plot.  
Beloved, I take no pagan faith for mine,  
But stick to You and what You set on tine  
Of Decalogue. Here Jesus now refuses

Acknowledgement from the tongue that abuses.

9 And he asked him “What is your name?”  
And he answered “Legion’s my name,  
Because we are many of fame.”

10 And he begged hard not to be sent  
Out of the country *when he went*.

11 There was near the mountains a great  
Herd of pigs eating there of *late*.

12 And all the devils begged him “Send  
Us into the pigs there to mend.”

13 Right away Jesus gave permission  
The unclean spirits *on condition*  
Went out and entered in the swine.  
And the herd ran down the incline  
With violence into the sea,

About two thousand *porcinely*,  
And all were drowned upon the sea.

This story shows that Jesus is not God,  
For if he had known that the demon rod  
Would drive the herd of pigs into the sea,  
He would have had compassion on the wee  
Creatures of His own making on the sod.  
He would not let the devils take the life  
Of piglet with the mother under knife.  
If Jesus had been God, he would have kept  
The herd of swine safe where they fed and  
slept.

My logic is as strong as any given  
By atheist who will not admit living  
Of any God at all, because if He  
Existed, universe would surely be  
Of all evils and wickednesses free.

14 The feeders of the pigs all fled  
Into the city where they said  
What happened, in the country too  
They spread the news to not a few.  
And they went out to see the sight.  
15 They come to Jesus and see him  
Who was possessed of devil *grim*,  
And had the legion, sitting clad,  
And in his right mind, then they had  
A stroke of fear. 16 And those who saw  
It told them what happened with awe,  
Of the devil-possessed man and  
About *all* the pigs *in the land*.  
17 And they began to beg him to  
Leave them and their region *to stew*.

The superstitions of good men in days  
Past leaves them open to sentence of craze.  
If Jesus had rebuked the demon-filled  
Today near where the swine had come and  
swilled,

And demons had then driven from the host  
Of pigs the rhyme and reason of their boast,  
No one would give credence at all or say  
That Jesus had done anything that day.  
The string of miracles could not be laid  
To Jesus in blame or in praises paid.  
It takes more faith than I’ve got to believe  
In demons or in rushing herds’ reprieve,  
And so today Jesus could work him sore  
And we’d just laugh at his claims to the  
gore.

18 And when he’d come into the ship,  
He who had been possessed with rip,  
Begged him to be allowed to go.  
19 But Jesus would not let him go,  
But told him, “Go home to your friends,  
And tell them of the great godsend  
The Lord has bestowed upon you  
And His compassion in your lieu.  
20 And he departed and began  
To spread abroad *to every man*  
In Decapolis what great things  
Jesus had done *to heal* his *wings*,  
And everyone was sure surprised.

Jesus told the man to give praise to You  
For healing after all the scrap and stew.  
In other words Jesus did not lay claim  
To the divine in word or act or name,  
But recognized that You alone are God,  
And no man, even sinless, on the sod.  
But what did the man straightway go and  
do?

He praised the man Jesus with cry and hue.  
The same mistake fills every church I find.  
They will not look to You, they are so  
blind,  
But like dogs chasing the finger that’s  
raised  
To point, they call Jesus God as half-  
crazed.  
No matter what invention and what act  
I see, I recognize only Your pact.

21 When Jesus had again devised  
To find by ship the other side,

A great crowd gathered at his side,  
 And he was standing near the sea.  
 22 And, behold, there came *sorrowfully*  
 A ruler of the synagogue,  
 Jairus by name *when not incog*,  
 And seeing him, fell at his feet  
*In prostration, in awe discrete.*  
 23 And begged him earnestly and said  
 "My little daughter's almost dead,  
 I beg you come and lay your hands  
 On her, and she *at your commands*  
 May be healed so she'll live, *not die.*"

Note well, Beloved, the ruler of the church  
 Is ready to get help from You in lurch.  
 But wait until the health and wealth and  
 song  
 Are shining on him instead of the wrong.  
 Then he will turn about to find his pride  
 Alone is worth the time of day and ride.  
 I too come round to You both day and  
 night,  
 And hardly find a sign of You in sight.  
 But when You answer prayers of fear and  
 might  
 For saving from death's door, I find You  
 right.  
 Forgive, Beloved, the days of work and  
 stress,  
 Forgetful hours, when come to Your  
 address,  
 I fail to find in You alone the mess  
 Of pottage that I seek beyond caress.

24 And Jesus went with him, and by  
 Him followed a great crowd close by.  
 25 A certain woman from whom flowed  
 A constant loss of blood *bestowed*  
 For twelve *long* years, and suffered much  
 At many of physicians' touch,  
 And had spent everything she had,  
 And not improved, at least as bad,  
 27 When she had heard of Jesus, came  
 Among the crowd behind his fame,  
 And touched his clothing, 28 For she said  
 "If I may only touch his *dread*  
 Clothes, I shall be made whole and well."  
 29 And right away her flowing blood  
 Was dried up from its gushing flood,  
 And she felt in her body that  
 She was healed of that plague *that sat*.

Your saints are everywhere set out to be  
 The source of cure and hopes for the  
 unfree,  
 And even tombs are windows on the share  
 Of blessing that You would spread  
 everywhere.  
 The superstitious crowd receives reward,  
 And that affirms the superstition's sword.  
 I too have sought to touch the sacred hem  
 Of saint, and bowed beneath the glow of  
 gem  
 On shrine that covers tombs silent and still.  
 I too have found my healing in the bill.  
 Beloved, such things encourage heart and  
 will  
 To turn to crusts and not coming to fill  
 The life with leaning on Your sacred heart.  
 Heal yes, but keep me from believer's part.

30 And Jesus right away aware  
 That virtue had gone out *to spare*,  
 Turned around in the crowd and said  
 "Who touched my clothing *and in dread?*"  
 31 And his disciples said to him  
 "Do you see the crowd *to the rim*  
 And yet ask 'Who touched me?'" 32 And  
 he  
 Was looking all around to see  
 The one that had performed the thing.  
 33 The woman in fear and trembling  
 Knowing what was done in her, came  
 And fell down before him *for blame*  
 And told him all the truth *by name*.  
 34 And he said to her "Daughter mine,  
 Your faith has made you well *and fine*.  
 Just go in peace and in good health  
 Free of that awful plague of stealth."

I praise Your sent one that he turns away  
 The superstitious way that people pray.  
 He does not think the virtue that went out  
 Of him is his own virtue on the snout.  
 He knows that You alone, Beloved, are  
 there  
 With hand of hope and heart of loving care.  
 No saint and no messiah gives the gold  
 Of new life to the shepherdless in fold.  
 All comes from faith in You, no matter  
 which  
 Tomb or which guru faces the full pitch.  
 Beloved, let me give praise where praise is  
 due,

For every gift thanks only given to You,  
For every breath of life my grateful voice  
Again lifts up to You and to rejoice.

35 While he was speaking some arrived  
From the house of the man *deprived*,  
The ruler of the synagogue  
Who said "Your daughter's latest prog  
Is that she's dead, so therefore why  
Bother the master with your cry?"  
36 As soon as Jesus heard the thing  
That was spoken *for sorrowing*,  
He said to the synagogue head  
"Be not afraid, believe instead."

I'd think the rumours would have given  
folk  
An inkling that even the dead in stroke  
Might be raised by Elijah come again  
Like ancient prophets working for all men.  
But no, they told the ruler not to keep  
The master on the useless way, but weep.  
Though weeping is a valid way to spend  
Expression of my faith in You and bend  
To grief, such weeping on the way to mend  
Would have been lack of faith in those You  
send.  
Beloved, may I be ready to abide  
In trust that You are still by every side  
Of those who worship You by Your law  
sent,  
Even when death seems to be what was  
meant.

37 And he let no one come along  
But Peter and James and the *strong*  
Brother of James *by name of John*.  
38 He came to the house *walking on*  
*Where lived* the chief of synagogue  
And saw the rush and how they wept  
And how greatly wailed the adept.  
39 And when he came in he told them  
"What's this weeping for stratagem?  
The girl is not dead, but has slept."  
40 And they laughed him to scorn. But  
when  
He had put all of them out, then  
He took the girl's father along  
With the mother *to hear his song*,  
And those with him and went in where  
The girl had been laid out *with care*.  
41 And he took the girl by the hand

And said "Talitha cumi," stand,  
Which is interpreted *in Greek*,  
"Young lady, stand up, *don't be meek*."  
42 And right away the girl arose  
And walked about *on feet and toes*,  
For she was aged about twelve years,  
And they were astonished from tears  
With great astonishment, *my dears*.  
43 He gave them strong orders that no  
Man should know of the deed and show  
And ordered that something to eat  
Should be given her *for a treat*.

The crowd was amazed that the girl once  
dead  
Got up alive after lying in bed.  
Your power is truly amazing, but I  
Am so accustomed to it where I lie  
That I pass through the resurrection met  
With each breath of my own and fail to get  
Amazements rush of gratitude in vain.  
Instead I focus on pleasures and pain,  
Ephemeral glances of light and rain,  
While the great miracle of life abounds  
Minute by minute on my clay-grown  
grounds.  
You sent one dignifies my failure to  
Shout Your praises in everything I do  
By warning me to silence at the view.

### Mark 6

1 And he went out from there and came  
To his own country *without fame*,  
And his disciples followed him.  
2 And when the Sabbath day *in trim*  
Arrived, he began to teach in  
The synagogue, *and in the din*  
Many who heard him were astonished  
Saying "How does he *unadmonished*  
Have these things and what wisdom is  
Given into this hand of his  
To do such mighty works as these  
Wrought by his hands and as he please?  
3 "Is this not the builder, the son  
Of Mary, brother of James *won*  
And Joses, and of Judah and  
Of Simon, and here in our land  
Are not his sisters?" And they were  
Offended at him *like a cur*.  
4 But Jesus said to them, "A prophet  
Is not without honour to scoff at  
Except in his own country and

Among his own kin *in the land*,  
And in his own house. 5 And he could  
Not do the mighty work *he should*,  
Except that he laid his hands on  
A few sick folk, healed *them and gone*.

A few sick folk healed is no slight thing  
done.

If even one had been healed on the run,  
It was a wonder and a great thing then.  
Jesus was not a failure among men.

I should not be discouraged by the way  
The neighbours and the kin failed to give  
pay

To the great talents I've received from  
You.

The Master himself lived through that and  
grew.

Beloved, I've never in my native land  
Nor in another performed works at hand,  
The miracles of hope and growth and life.  
I've been a looker on in this world's strife.  
But I appreciate the works he did,  
Your sent one in the hometown on the skid.

6 He marvelled at their unbelief,  
And went around *for their relief*  
About the villages *in brief*  
And teaching. 7 And he called to him  
The twelve, began to send out *trim*  
By two and two; and gave them power  
Over unclean spirits *an hour*.

8 He commanded them that they should  
Take nothing for their journey good,  
Except a staff, no script, no bread,  
No money in their purse, 9 instead  
Have sandals on, and not two coats.

The missionaries that go out today  
As heirs of the colonials for pay  
Take more than staff and purse and sandal  
shoes,

And one coat unless tropics are in views.  
But who am I to judge the inner part,  
The motive and the song of each one's  
heart?

It may be that the ones who left in crowd  
That day that Jesus ordered them aloud  
Were merely hypocrites, while those now  
bent

On titles and positions where they're sent  
Have eyes to serve You only as You meant.

I might have laid a sacrifice myself  
Upon the mission altar, but an elf  
Like me's unworthy of either kind spree.

10 And he said to them *for their notes*  
"In any place you come into  
A house, stay there until you're due  
To leave that place. 11 "And anyone  
Who does not accept you when done  
Nor hear you, when you leave that place,  
Shake off the dust under the space  
Of your feet for a witness that  
Is set against them *where they sat*.  
Truly I say to you it shall  
Be for Sodom more *practical*  
And tolerable for Gomorrah  
On the day of judgement and *awe*  
Than for that city." 12 They went out  
And preached that men should turn about.

The few You have, Beloved, who bear  
Your name  
And sacred law before the awful flame  
Of human hearts and minds, are more to  
grief

Of humankind than they are to relief.  
The greater part of men look on the sweet  
Divine as nothing to do as a treat,  
And so the coming of Your own is met  
With sentencing to hell of all in set.  
Beloved, keep me within Your law and yet  
Out of the pale of humankind whose woe  
Is only confirmed by the way they go  
And by the way they oppose any show  
Of my obedience to You You get.  
Let me not send any into Hell's glow.

13 They cast out many devils, and  
Anointed with oil every hand  
Those that were sick healed by command.

Remarkable's the power of olive oil  
Upon the head of those who groan and toil  
In sickness on the early web and coil.  
Those who follow the footsteps of the one  
You sent into the world and on the run  
For the redemption of those suffering here  
Feel cooling oil instead of flowing tear.  
Beloved, I take the olive oil at last  
And put it on my salad, an outcast  
From the meat-eaters feast as well as fast.  
If nothing else, the taste is good enough,



And makes me know my living is not  
rough,  
Despite desires to think I have it tough.  
Let me not fly my colours at half-mast.

14 And King Herod heard of his name  
That was spread abroad *to his fame*,  
And said John the Baptist was risen  
From the dead *and gone out from prison*,  
And so the mighty works were shown  
In *him as they had once been known*.

The solar myth that informs every piece  
Of legend and of history's release  
From centuries ago, would put this man  
Herod to take the Baptist John by plan  
Of constellation of Aquarius,  
And have his head cut off six months in  
fuss  
After the baptism of Jesus then.  
Of course the cycle would begin again.  
So Herod states he's risen from the grave.  
The solar myth does not make me a slave,  
And fact is, if Jesus and John are not  
Mentioned in any history I've got,  
Herod is written large enough to plot  
Without a constellation to his lot.

15 Others said that it is Elias,  
While others said *and without bias*,  
It is a prophet or as one  
Of the *earlier* prophets *done*.

The people of an early day were out  
To find the ascended Elias stout  
And living to appear among most men  
And work the worlds of olden times again.  
The people of an early day were ready  
To find the resurrection of some steady  
Prophet of old come once again to speak  
The tomes of prophecy instead of peek.  
Today, Beloved, instead all women near  
Are certain they are reborn with the gear  
Of due and famous of the century  
Before and even further down the tree.  
Hardly a man is willing to take me  
Or any other at value simply.

16 But when Herod heard of that, he  
Said "It is John whom I *was free*  
To behead, he has risen from  
The dead, *and back to me has come*."

17 For Herod himself had sent out  
And laid hold on John, bound him stout  
In prison for Herodias' sake,  
His brother Philip's wife, to make  
Her his own wife. 18 For John had said  
To Herod "It's not right to bed  
Your brother's wife." 19 So Herodias  
Held that against him *at the pass*,  
And would have killed him, *if she could*.  
But she could not, 20 since Herod feared  
John knowing that he *had appeared*  
A just man, and a holy, and  
Observed him, and *when by command*  
He heard him, he did many things  
And heard him gladly *from heart* springs.

The fate of men today as in the way  
Of centuries past stands upon the string  
Of some obscure interpretation's ring,  
A marriage law, a point of regulation,  
A tithe of mint, a sprig of anis' ration.  
So John was ready to give up his life  
To force a verdict obscure on the wife  
Of Herod, knowing that some rabbis found  
Another explanation on the ground.  
Beloved, keep me from falling in the trap  
Of complication outside of the rap  
Of Decalogue, but let me brave the other  
When he is certain he is a right brother.  
May You judge in the details of the map.

21 When a convenient day had come  
That Herod for his birthday rum  
Made a supper to his high lords,  
High captains and chief of his wards  
In Galilee, 22 and when the said  
Herodias' daughter was led  
In to dance and pleased Herod and  
Those who sat with him at his hand,  
The king said to the girl "Ask me  
For what you want, I'll give it free."

My fine friends who bear Your name on  
the sleeve  
Take two birthday parties and both to  
grieve  
To mean no birthdays should be held in  
weight,  
No children set delighted at the gate.  
And right they may be in their verdict's  
state.  
Yet I wonder that this and Pharaoh's day

Suffice to make them stop the birthday  
play,  
And yet the scores of texts confirming draw  
Of Sabbath at the centre of Your law  
Have no effect on mind or heart in awe.  
That only shows that reason and good sense  
Cannot convince any man in his tents.  
It takes a pound of strong obedience  
To make the reason light enough to stay.

23 And he swore to her "What you ask  
I'll give to you until the task  
Of half the kingdom." 24 And she went  
And asked her mother "What shall I  
Demand?" And she said *with a cry*  
"The head of John the Baptist buy."  
25 And she went right back to the king  
In haste and asked as she was sent  
And said "I want right now a thing:  
A platter, and upon the plate  
The head of John the Baptist's fate."

Beheading of the Baptist seems in rate  
To be a mimicry of the stars' fate  
By the Aquarius, which poor John's pate  
Is represented by the constellation  
That's caught upon horizon for a station.  
Despite the similarity to tales  
Of heathen gods, the Gospel word prevails  
In many hearts and homes. I think the ruse  
Of those who see a solar myth in fuse  
Are simply too squeamish to bear the gore.  
The sweet Christian's accustomed to the  
door

Of blood on forehead, hand and foot and  
more.

A contemplation of a severed head  
Adds little to the consumed wine and  
bread.

26 The king was very sorry, yet  
For his oath's sake and for those set  
With him, he'd not refuse her *bet*.

27 And right away king *Herod* sent  
One axe man who commanded bent  
To bring his head, and so he went  
To prison and cut off his head,

28 And brought his head upon a dish  
And gave it to the girl as said  
According to her mother's wish.

A dancing girl can simply not be trusted,

Whether she be one that large or small  
busted,  
Especially if she's got a mother near  
To tell her savoury things whispered in ear.  
A king upon the throne may offer much,  
But kings are susceptible to the touch  
Of public thought and what the courtiers  
wish,  
Just as a senator thinks of the dish  
Of lobbyists if he is one still free  
Of blackmail and of fraud by the turnkey.  
Beloved, the gore upon the plate is spread  
Consisting of one John the Baptist's head.  
It's only one. Most Baptists stick around  
To profit by the king who stands his  
ground.

29 And when his disciples heard it,  
They came and took up his corpse *fit*  
And put it in a tomb *to sit*.  
30 The ones sent out returned again  
To Jesus, and told everything,  
Both what they'd done and taught *the men*.

31 And he said to them *on the wing*  
"Come now apart to desert place  
And rest a *while and breathe a space*,"  
For many came and went apace,  
And they'd no time even to eat  
*A crumb of bread salty or sweet*.

32 And so they went away into  
A desert place by ship in crew.  
33 The people saw them go away,  
And many knew him by the way,  
And ran on foot from every town  
And passed them by when they came down  
To gather where he was to stay.

34 And Jesus, when he came that way  
Saw many people and was moved  
With great compassion *unreproved*  
Because they were like sheep without  
A shepherd, and he started out  
To teach them many things *in route*.

Astral projectors claim the stars alone  
Are focus of the story to the bone.  
It may be that the missing parts of each  
Tale in the Gospel are fleshed out to preach  
By common formula that age could reach.  
But the tale's not left in the limbo score.  
Dear Jesus goes apart to find a shore  
In quiet where to mourn the parting of  
His cousin, whether starry thing above

Or man of flesh and bone and blood and  
love.  
The crowd out to be blessed and healed and  
taught  
Prevents him from achieving grieving spot.  
But the intention's there, Beloved, and I  
See Jesus' heart was bleeding at the sigh.

35 And when the day was then far spent  
His disciples came to his *tent*  
And said "This is a desert place,  
And now the minutes with wings race;  
36 "Send them away that they may go  
Into the country *round the show*,  
Into the villages to buy  
Bread, they've nothing to eat *or die*."  
37 He answered and said to them, "Give  
Them something to eat *so they'll live*,"  
And they said to him, "Shall we go  
And buy two hundred pennies' *woe*  
Of bread and give them all to eat?"

Your sent one here belies the solar tale  
That would make sun the bringer in of rail.  
Instead of You, or sun or his own hand,  
He tells his followers and with command  
To give the crowd to eat out of thin air.  
That should keep souls from needing any  
share

Of the sun's cycle to provoke the ware.  
Beloved, each story that incorporates  
Some aspects of the heathen mythic states  
Comes out at last to show that it is lost  
In human fancy, in a storm that's tossed  
From human breast out to the centuries.  
The blood of sun is just a humble cost  
Before the conjuring of Jesus' breeze,  
Before disciples fallen on their knees.

38 He asked them "How many complete  
Loaves have you? Go and see the meat."  
And when they found out they could say  
"Five loaves and then two fishes lay."

I guess this story comes after Aquarius  
As John the Baptist who refused to marry  
us  
Because Pisces are two fish in the way,  
A basket in the bread of stars to sway  
My mind with myths encompassing the  
bay.  
I've done Weber proud with the way I see

All things in starry-eyed menagerie.  
Beloved, all tales of men and all reports  
Follow a mythic element of sorts.  
When truth is filtered by the human brain,  
It is arranged in ways that we think sane,  
But which distort for flesh and blood to  
seal.

We can have two fish for an added meal,  
But that does not mean stars are how we  
feel.

39 And he commanded them to make  
Everyone sit down *by the stake*  
In companies on the green grass.  
40 And they sat down there all in mass,  
By hundreds' and by fifties' *count*,  
*In all making a great amount*.  
41 And when he'd taken the five loaves,  
And the two fishes *in the groves*,  
He looked up to the sky and blessed  
And broke the loaves and gave the rest  
To his disciples so they'd serve  
Them, and the two fish *they deserve*  
He divided among them all.  
42 And they all ate filled to the wall.  
43 And they took up twelve baskets full  
Of pieces and fishes *to pull*.  
44 The number of the men who ate  
Rose to about five thousand great.

The Zodiac would have predicted fine  
Twelve baskets in a single row and line.  
The number twelve has been the way to go  
Since stars were set in heaven and on show,  
But first met in the number of the sons  
And princes come from Ishmael's fertile  
buns.

That number was not feeble or too slow  
To make Jacob's sons also come in tonnes  
Of twelve despite the fact that thirteen  
names  
Appear when all the lists rise with their  
claims.

Beloved, with a wry smile I follow all  
Twelves and all sevens through the wake  
and stall  
Until at last I find one and alone,  
Not two fishes, but You upon Your throne.

45 He made his disciples get in  
The ship right away for a spin,  
To travel to the other shore

To Bethsaida, while he'd implore  
 The people to go home. 46 When he  
 Had sent them all away, then he  
 Went into a mountain to pray.  
 47 When evening settled *on the bay*  
 The ship was in midst of the sea  
 And he alone upon the land.  
 48 And he saw them toiling in hand  
 Rowing against contrary wind.  
 About fourth watch *of the ensigned*  
 In the night he came walking by  
 A-striding on the sea and nigh.  
 43 But when they saw him *turn about*  
 And so were troubled. But he said  
 To them right off "Don't be afraid,  
 It's only me." 51 And so he went  
 Up to them in the ship, and spent  
 Was the wind, while they were amazed  
 And wondered greatly nearly *crazed*.  
 52 For they considered not at all  
 The miracle of the loaves' call,  
 Because of hardening of their hearts.

Ability to provide bread and fish  
 For thousands is really another dish  
 To quelling storms. So the hard heart may  
 still

Wonder at miracles after the fill.  
 Ability to walk upon the waves  
 Is just as solar myth about me raves.  
 A legend and a campfire tale perhaps,  
 But still it's strenuous to take two laps  
 About the sea of Galilee on foot.  
 By the time one has found the boat to put  
 One's head upon the rolling of the oar,  
 It's time to turn about and beat for shore.  
 Beloved, You are the Master of both stars  
 As well as fishermen and other gars.

53 And when they'd passed *over those*  
*parts*  
 They came to Gennesaret's land  
 And drew up to the shore *at hand*.  
 54 And when they'd come out of the ship  
 Right off they knew him *from the tip*,  
 55 And ran through that whole region  
 round  
 To carry in beds those unsound  
 To where they heard he could be found.  
 56 And wherever he came into  
 Villages, cities, countryside,  
 They laid the sick in the streets' *dew*,

And begged him that they might confide  
 To touch the fringes of his cloak,  
 And all who touched were well on stroke.

The figure of Apollo also stands  
 As healer to the pulsing Gentile bands  
 Who give example to the fisherfolk  
 Of Galilee and others at a stroke.  
 And yet the cry that Jesus has come near  
 Remains a thrilling one for folk to hear.  
 Beloved, I take the sage without a tear,  
 And listen to his teaching by the weir,  
 And find my comfort in the way he brings  
 Your law at last back to its early springs,  
 And lays the obligation and the joy  
 On all to follow Your law in employ.  
 Let others prance pretending freedom now,  
 Your throne alone is where I come to bow.

### Mark 7

1 Then came to him the Pharisees  
 And certain of the scribes *to please*,  
 Down from Jerusalem *with ease*.  
 2 And when they saw some of his men  
 Eat with defiled hands or again  
 With hands unwashed *in blessing*, then  
 They found fault. 3 For the Pharisees  
 And all the Jews, except they please  
 To wash their hands often *with blessing*  
 Will eat *no meat nor even dressing*,  
 But hold fast to elders' tradition.

Jesus is Torah-true in every way,  
 And that is why he refuses the day  
 Of washing and of blessing of the hands  
 Before the meal: it's not found in the stands  
 Of Torah, but is just elders' tradition.  
 So he appears one out to make sedition.  
 The apprehension of the Jews is right:  
 He would destroy the oral law in sight.  
 But when the Christians come upon the  
 scene  
 They lose sight of the question on the bean,  
 The question of ablutions and of prayer.  
 Instead they grasp at straws to justify  
 Their pagan mice and succulent pork pie.  
 Slay them for lack of reason and law's cry.

4 When they come from market *addition*  
 Unless they wash, they do not eat.  
 And many another conceit  
 They have received holding complete,

As washing cups, and pots, and brass  
 Vessels and tables as they pass.  
 5 Pharisees and scribes came to ask  
 "Why don't they do the elders' task?  
 But your disciples eat their bread  
*And meat with unwashed hands instead.*  
 6 He answered and said to them, "Well  
 Did Isaiah prophesy *hell*  
 Of your hypocrisy by saying  
 'This people honours me with praying,  
 But their heart is far from me staying.  
 7 "In vain they worship Me while teaching  
 Commandments of men in their preaching,'  
 8 "As they lay off commands of God  
 And hold to men's traditions' *prod*,  
 As washing pots and cups and such  
 And do many like things as much."  
 9 And he said to them "You reject  
 God's commands that you may respect  
 Your own traditions. 10 Moses said  
 'Honour father, mother, instead.  
 The one who curses father or  
 Mother, let him die *for the score.*'  
 11 "But you say 'If a man shall say  
 To father or mother *one day*,  
 "It is Corban, that is, a gift  
*In offering to God I lift*,  
 Whatever aid I might have given  
*In clothing, food or place to live in*,  
 For help *or comfort to your life*,"  
 He's free from helping *and from strife*.  
 12 "And you don't let him any more  
 Do for father or mother's score.  
 13 "You make God's word of no effect  
 Through the traditions you respect  
 And have delivered. Many such  
 Things you do *and teach at a touch.*"  
 14 And when he summoned all the folk  
 He said "Listen to what I spoke  
 And understand me every bloke.  
 15 "There's nothing from without a man  
 That entering into him can  
 Defile him; but the thing which come  
 Out of him, they defile in sum.  
 16 "If anybody has an ear  
 To hear, then let such a one hear."

The Persian face for keeping all things  
 clean  
 First penetrated and spoiled Jewish scene  
 With rinsing plates and cups to purify  
 All the defiled between the earth and sky.

The silent towers engulf the human race  
 And through Islam their shadows run  
 apace.  
 The Christian throng is satisfied to dip  
 A finger in the holy water's blip.  
 Beloved, keep me from all exaggeration  
 Found in the church, mosque, synagogue  
 and nation.  
 Let not disgust yet for hypocrisy  
 Reduce my soul too in impurity  
 With washings from the fathers: let my  
 hands  
 Be muddy, yet always keep Your  
 commands.

17 And when he came into the house  
 Away from the people *and grouse*,  
 Disciples asked him of the story.  
 18 And he answered them in his glory,  
 "Are you also without good sense?  
 Do you not notice what goes in  
 Cannot defile a man with sin?  
 19 "Since it does not go in his heart  
 But rather in the stomach part  
 And comes out in refuse and fart."  
 20 He said "What goes out of a man,  
 That's all that defiles and that can.  
 21 "For from within, out of the heart  
*Is what defiles man from the start*,  
 Evil thoughts, and adulteries,  
 Fornications, murders *at ease*,  
 22 "Thefts, covetousness, wickedness,  
 Deceit, and lasciviousness,  
 An evil eye, and blasphemy,  
 And pride, and acting foolishly.  
 23 "All these evil things rise within  
 And they defile a man with sin."

The divine law, when rightly understood,  
 Illuminates more purity than could  
 Another allegory in the wood.  
 The rites of purity pertain alone  
 To symbols of the spirit on the bone.  
 So not what goes in mouth or nose or out  
 Must be purified, not the hand about  
 To grasp the bread or cup. From what's  
 within  
 Arise impurity along with sin.  
 So what comes out the lower belt expresses  
 Impurities the evil heart addresses.  
 Therefore I wash no anus for my part,  
 But when I fart, I wash head for my heart,

Hands for my doing, and my feet for cart.

24 And from that place he rose and went  
To Tyre and Sidon's borders *bent*,  
And went into a house and would  
Have no man know it, but he could  
Not be hidden. 25 A certain dame  
Whose young daughter had *to her shame*  
An unclean spirit, when she heard  
Of him, came prostrate *undeterred*.  
26 The woman was a Greek, by nation  
Syro-phoenician *in her station*,  
And she begged him that he would cast  
The devil from the girl at last.  
27 But Jesus told her "Let the child  
Be fed first, for it is too wild  
To take the children's food and throw  
It to the dogs *and let it go*."

28 And she answered and said to him  
"Yes, Lord, *I accept your word grim*,  
Yet even dogs beneath the table  
Eat of the children's crumbs *when able*."  
29 And he said to her "For this word,  
Go on your way *and undeterred*,  
The devil has gone from your bird."  
30 And when she came to her own house,  
She found the devil gone *with louse*,  
Her daughter lying on the bed,  
*Safe and sound ready to be fed*.

Politically correct are scandalized  
Jesus is racist more than realized,  
And wonder he could call a woman dog  
Because she was a heathen who ate hog.  
Such words of him detract from wealth and  
fame,

And had he said them now to smirch his  
name,

The populace would force him to retract  
His earthy power and messianic claim,  
Or at the least to clean up priestly act.  
What scandalizes me, Beloved, is not  
The racial or religious slur he taught,  
But that he granted her wish on the spot  
For her wit in reply. Justice appalled  
Cries out to gift the dumb, silent installed.

31 Again he left the borders of  
Tyre and Sidon and went above  
The sea of Galilee and through  
Decapolis and its lands *too*.

32 And they brought to him a deaf man,

With speech impediment *in bran*,  
And they begged him to put his hand  
On him. 33 And he took him *by hand*  
Aside, away from the crowd's leers,  
And put his fingers in his ears,  
And spit and touched his tongue thereby.  
34 And looking up into the sky,  
He sighed, and then he spoke to him  
"Ephatha" which translated *trim*  
Means "Be opened." 35 And right away  
His ears were opened and the stay  
Of his tongue was loosed to plain say.  
36 And he ordered them not to tell  
A single soul. The more he'd dwell  
On it, the more they'd spread the spell,  
37 And were astonished past belief,  
Saying "He's done all things in brief:  
He makes the deaf to hear and peek,  
The dumb also he makes to speak."

In point of fact, Beloved, it is no loss  
If a few men in society's gloss  
Cannot say anything to wife or boss.  
It is a talent lodged, as Milton states,  
A way to avoid quarrels' reprobates.  
If I had never said a word on earth  
I suspect many would think me more worth  
The salt and alary I have consumed.  
The tongue is the thing that has come and  
doomed

All men to shame and cross, not to say  
word

Of women talking also in the herd.  
Beloved, no one should thank you or Your  
son

As it were for the miracle he's done  
But granting one man speeches for his fun.

## Mark 8

1 In those days the crowd being great  
Indeed, with nothing on their plate,  
Jesus called his disciples to him  
And said to every one *who knew him*,

2 "I'm feeling sorry for the crowd,  
Because their time with me allowed  
Is now three days without a crumb,  
3 "And if I let them fasting come  
To their own houses, they will faint,  
Since many of them, *no complaint*,  
Have come a long way." 4 And they said,  
Did his disciples, answer pled,  
"Where can a man get enough bread

To satisfy these people led  
Here in the wilderness?" 5 He asked  
Them, "How many loaves have you got?"  
And they replied, "Seven *unmasked*."

The local dish were I live is of fish  
And rye bread baked together with a wish.  
Sometimes it seems that Jesus takes the  
plot  
And gives the people the same food we've  
got.  
At other times he does without the fins  
And scales as well as white meat without  
sins.  
Plain bread or Finnish fishcock, it's no  
matter,  
As long as there's no lard in it for fatter.  
It's strange, Beloved, disciples did not  
mind  
The treat Your sent one gave when they  
had dined  
On fish and bread. You'd think they'd get  
the habit  
Of dining on things pulled out like a rabbit  
From hat or air. But they were like all men,  
Forgetful of their blessings come again.

6 He told the folk to take a shot  
At sitting on the ground, and he  
Took the seven loaves thankfully  
And broke them and handed them out  
To his disciples round about  
Who served the people in their turn.  
7 And they had a few fish *to burn*,  
Small ones which he blessed and gave  
word  
To set before the folk *unstirred*.  
8 So they ate and were satisfied,  
And gathered up what food remained  
In seven bushels *left untied*.

Symbolic numbers here again abound  
Despite the fact the fishes are not found  
By twos or twelves or sevens on the  
ground.  
The three times four of twelve gives way at  
last  
To three plus four or seven loaves to cast  
And seven baskets full. The second round  
Is not the twelve so visible and sound,  
But the wave of the seven, the heartfelt  
beat,

The secret of appearances on seat  
Of hidden imams waiting for the time  
When twelve shall appear for the final  
rhyme.

Beloved, when Jesus multiplied the bread,  
Did it increase in his hands or instead  
In the hands of disciples at the spread?

9 The number of eaters *unfeigned*  
Was around four thousand. He sent  
Them packing. 10 And straightway he went  
With his disciples in a boat  
To Dalmanutha on the float.  
11 The Pharisees came out to beg  
A heavenly sign and pull his leg.  
12 And sighing deeply in his heart,  
"Why does this generation start"  
He said "to seek after a sign?  
I truly tell you that no sign  
Shall grace this generation's vine."

It's true enough that feeding thousands on  
The remnants of a few loaves broken drawn  
With some small fish ought to be sign  
enough.  
But Pharisees, notoriously gruff,  
Perhaps thought that a sign from Scriptures  
or  
A wave of rod upon a windy shore  
Would be the more appropriate in store  
Than merely tavern work of serving guests.  
Beloved, Your sent one here comes and  
infests  
The cogitations of my wondered heart.  
He gives the peasants food, but does not  
start  
An argument with scholars or the ones  
Who take responsibility on buns  
For purity of faith by Roman guns.

13 And so he left them and he came  
Into the boat again to aim  
To go across the other side.  
14 Now the disciples, *though they tried*,  
Forgot to take bread in the ship,  
Had only one loaf *for the trip*.  
15 And he told them "Beware, take heed  
Of yeast the Pharisees will feed  
And Herod's yeast." 16 And they agreed  
Among themselves and said the reason  
Is we have no bread, *salt or season*.  
17 When Jesus found out, he told them,

“Why do you figure, haw and hem,  
That you have no bread? Don’t you see,  
Or understand, heart hardenedly?

18 “With eyes don’t you see? And with  
ears

Don’t you hear and recall *with tears*?

19 “When I broke the five loaves among  
Five thousand, how many pails strung  
Did you take up of what was left?”

They told him “Twelve.” 20 *And he said  
deft,*

“And when the seven among the four  
Thousand, how many bushels more  
Remained for you to put in store?”

And they said “Seven.” 21 So he said,  
“How is it you don’t understand?”

I’m not sure what Your sent one meant to  
show

By counting up the sevens and twelves in  
row.

It may be he was mentioning the bread  
So they would understand half a loaf fed  
Thirteen with ease. That would have been  
my spread.

So I don’t see the need of counting out  
Exactly in symbolic digits’ flout.

He begs the hearer understand his words,  
But hardly tells the secret before herds  
Of lowing, deaf disciples. So I turn  
To You, Beloved, to tell me what I’ve  
learned.

I haven’t learned to row a boat worth  
beans.

I cannot multiply bread on Your scenes.  
And counting baskets is beyond my means.

22 And he came to Bethsaida’s *land*.

They brought a blind man to him led,  
And begged him to touch him *instead*.

23 He took the blind man by the hand  
And led him outside of the city,  
And spat on his eyes *in his pity*,

And put his hands on him and asked  
If he saw anything unmasked.

24 And he looked up and said “I see  
Men walking about like a tree.”

25 And so he put his hands again  
On his eyes and made him with yen  
Look up. And he was healed and saw  
Everything clearly *and with awe*.

26 He sent him to his house by saying

“Do not go in the village swaying,  
Or tell anyone in the town.

The shaman of Tibet may often use  
The same cure for the eyes that still accuse  
In this day of such wonder drugs that heal  
One thing while causing chaos in the reel.  
While spitting in the eyes is hardly done  
By Semites to their daughters and for fun  
According to the plague of Miriam run,  
Your sent one is not of that sort and steel.  
The international and Hellenized  
Was more at large in those days and was  
prized,

So it’s no wonder Jesus learned a cure  
From Asian shamans acting for the sure.  
Some claim that Jesus lived and died away  
In that part of the world, and came to stay.

27 And Jesus with his friends’ renown  
Went out into the countryside  
Of Caesarea Philip’s pride.

And on the way he asked his friends,  
Saying to them, “What for amends  
Do men say that I am to bide?”

28 And they answered, “The Baptist John,  
And others say Elijah’s *pawn*,  
But others some one of the prophets.”

29 And He said to them, “And you softits,  
Who do you say I am?” And Peter  
Said “You are the Messiah *sweeter*.”

30 And He warned them that they should  
tell  
Nobody around of his spell.

I promise I shall tell no single soul  
That Jesus is Messiah on the dole,  
You sent one to the world to demonstrate  
How Your law converts humankind from  
state

Of dire rebellion and by grace makes clean  
The life of everyone, both fat and lean.  
I promise not to mention that sweet name  
Of Jesus or of Joshua in blame,  
But only set my sights on You to make  
My whirling in this slaughterhouse at stake.  
Beloved, if everyone refused to share  
The knowledge of messiahship to bear  
A witness to Your oneness in this place,  
Then people might be one of every race.

31 And He began to teach them it



Was necessary for son *fit*  
Of man to suffer many things  
And be rejected in the rings  
Of elders and chief priests and scribes,  
And to be killed because of bribes,  
And after three days rise again.

32 And he spoke the word in the glen  
And openly. Then Peter took  
Him to one side, *his finger shook*,  
And rebuked him *like any rook*.  
33 But he turned around and he saw  
His own disciples hand in crow,  
And he rebuked Peter and said  
"Get behind me, tempter and bred,  
Because you do not care to think  
The things of God, instead you drink  
The things of humankind in link."

This Peter was a great man who desired  
That no pagan-like aspect be hotwired  
To Your sent one, nothing one might  
mistake  
For Dionysiac Mithraic rake.  
That's why he did not want three days to sit  
Upon the resurrection of the fit.  
The man was right. See how the Christian  
church  
Is paganized and leaves all in the lurch  
Through their acceptance of the Easter  
birch.  
Die if he will, save humankind the more,  
But You should have kept him from seed  
and spore  
Reminding sinful worshippers of Baal  
Of what the high places always entail.  
So now we gyrate to rock bands in gale.

34 He summoned up both crowd and  
friends,  
He said to them without amends,  
"Whoever wants to follow me,  
Let him deny himself, take tree,  
And then let him come follow me.  
35 "For whosoever wants to save  
His life will enter in the grave.  
And whosoever loses life  
For my sake and the gospel's strife,  
That one shall save it faithfully.  
36 "For what shall it profit a man  
If he gain the whole world in scan,  
And yet lose his own soul *by plan*?  
37 "What shall a man give in exchange

For his own soul *and to arrange*?  
38 "For whosoever is ashamed  
Of me and my words in this famed  
Age of sinners adulterous,  
The Son of Man will also fuss  
For shame of him when he appear  
In glory from his Father dear  
Along with holy angels near."

I'm selling of my soul, Beloved, to see  
If what I gain of this world's company  
Is worth the loss of Your eternity.  
Because Your prayer is still so sweet to me,  
Does that mean that wealth, stealth and  
sensual lea  
Are not a benefit beneath the veil?  
I'm selling of my soul, Beloved, grow pale  
To hear the harping words that I regale.  
I'm not ashamed of You, nor of Your son,  
But I am quite put out by everyone.  
Unless You take me in, Beloved, I'll sell  
My soul to the first church who'll treat me  
well.

Beloved, there are no takers, by default  
I am Your own, unlovely where I halt.

The only I is You, Beloved, and so  
The one who would preserve the I in show,  
The empty and illusive figure drawn  
Upon the screen of néant in the dawn  
Of universe, that one shall lose the All.  
But the one who sinks that illusion's pall  
In the great Self that You are at the cheek,  
Shall gain anew the true soul week by week  
As Sabbath draws near with the Sabbath  
queen

Illuminating all the dark world's scene.  
Beloved, the self I bring in sacrifice  
Before the flame of truth, while it is nice,  
Is empty and a husk. I bear no load  
Before Your throne, before Your ample  
goad.

### Mark 9

1 And He said to them, "Truly I  
Tell you, there are some who stand by  
Here who in no way shall taste death  
Until they see come in the breath  
Of power the kingdom of God nigh."  
2 And after six days Jesus took  
Along Peter and James in nook  
With John, and led them to a high

Mountain apart, alone to vie.  
 He was transfigured where they spy.  
 3 His garments became shining, white  
 Like snow, the like of which no fuller  
 On earth can bleach *by any puller*.  
 4 Elijah with Moses was seen  
 By them, and they were speaking keen  
 With Jesus. 5 And Peter replied  
 And said to Jesus at his side,  
 "Rabbi, it's good for us right here,  
 Let's make three tabernacles' gear,  
 One for you and one each for Moses  
 And for Elijah who discloses."  
 6 For he did not know what to say,  
 For they were all in terror's sway.

St. Peter cannot keep his fool mouth shut,  
 Which is why I wonder that You rebut  
 Him always with such tenderness and song.  
 The man is often wickedly in wrong.  
 But I must admit in this case that I  
 Too would be overwhelmed if I could spy  
 Both Moses and Elijah on the sly.  
 It seems that Moses was raised from the  
 dead  
 Or he could not arrive with Christ instead.  
 So many that accept Christ still reject  
 Good Moses. Here he's one of Your elect.  
 Your Christ met with just two and made  
 three fly  
 As a minyan instead of ten's respect.  
 Elijah only meets me for the pie.

7 A cloud then overshadowed them,  
 And a voice from the cloud in hem  
 Said "This is My son, the beloved,  
 Hear him *among the pushed and shoved*."

This is the third time in Your life You came  
 To speak in public in direct acclaim.  
 The first time was reciting of the law  
 At Sinai to the millions there in awe.  
 The second was the baptism of Christ  
 When You called him Your Beloved one  
 sufficed.  
 And now You speak again with the same  
 clue  
 That Jesus is Your son beloved and due.  
 That is a claim beyond my wit to rate,  
 Since You have neither wife nor tool in  
 state  
 Of male components, unless in the crude

You are among the circumcised in brood.  
 I'll hear him, Your son, servant, sent one  
 now  
 When he tells me to keep Your law and  
 how.

8 And suddenly, they looked around  
 And saw no one there on the ground,  
 But only Jesus with them found.  
 9 And as they were coming down from  
 The mountain, he commanded them  
 Not to tell anyone what they  
 Had seen, except upon the day  
 The son of man rose from the dead.  
 10 And they held the word to themselves,  
 Debating what could mean for elves  
 The rising up from the grave's bed.

They ought to know full well what it must  
 mean  
 To rise up from the dead and then be seen.  
 Elijah and Elisha both revived  
 Sons from the dead, and so when he arrived  
 To be a son of God, no doubt it came  
 About because of rising like a flame  
 From the grave to live ever and acclaim  
 His own before the throne of glory's name.  
 But if they did not know, then why not ask?  
 It would not have been then too great a  
 task.

But now when Jesus is not here to see,  
 Wrapped up in glory and eternity,  
 My asking just re-echos on the faint  
 Reverberation of my mind's complaint.

11 And they asked him, saying "The  
 scribes  
 Say Elijah comes first for bribes."  
 12 And he replied and said to them,  
 "Truly Elijah comes in hem  
 Restoring all things. What a gem  
 Has been written of son of man,  
 That he should suffer in the plan  
 And be despised *in earthly span*!  
 13 "But I tell you, Elijah too  
 Has come and they did to him rue  
 According to their wishes, as  
 It has been written of his *jazz*."

Where in the books of prophecy, I ask,  
 Was it writ that Elijah took to task  
 The wives of Herods to die from the mask?

I've read the books through and find no  
 place there  
 That says they would do to Elijah what  
 They wanted in the prison where they shut  
 Him for outspokenness before the glut  
 Of Herod's throne in verdicts of a mutt.  
 It is not there. Jesus must have a book  
 Of prophecy in which I cannot look.  
 Beloved, I rue the day that John was sealed  
 With martyrdom in gaol instead of field.  
 When my time comes I hope they take my  
 life  
 In open fields where I can see Your strife.

Ah, now I know the answer! Jesus kept  
 The same arguments that Muslims have  
 swept  
 On him as well. Since fair Elijah rose  
 Into the skies in chariot that glows,  
 And did not die, it must mean he would  
 come  
 Back to the earth and visibly in sum  
 To meet his death. That's what the  
 argument  
 Says about the Jesus that You have sent.  
 Beloved, the truth that all men die might  
 fail  
 Among the great occulted in the veil,  
 And Enoch and Elijah might be born  
 Exceptions to the rule of the forlorn.  
 All men must die indeed, the self cast out  
 And Self alone reign in the heart's redoubt.

I do prefer to think the Baptist John  
 Was not Elijah risen on the dawn,  
 Because the man is dead without a head,  
 Unless it was a star that died instead.  
 I'd rather think Elijah's on the hill,  
 And waiting for my coming up there still  
 To see the sun reflected on the lake,  
 The islands spread before me in the wake  
 Of silver and of grey beneath the sky.  
 I'd rather think Elijah is nearby,  
 And living through the ages of the earth,  
 And riding in a chariot in berth  
 Of flames and clouds in righteousness of  
 worth.  
 I'd rather find Elijah on the sly.

Jesus can still maintain that John fulfilled  
 The prophecy of Elijah unbilled,  
 Even though the man himself had just come

In glory in transfiguration's sum.  
 Jesus delights in making mock and mime  
 Of truth simple enough in rote and rhyme.  
 He makes the simple word a complex rate.  
 That is a wicked thing to do, I state.  
 We've just seen the fire prophet coming  
 down  
 In glory, and with name emblazoned gown,  
 And still Jesus reiterates the fact  
 That John the Baptist is the one we lacked.  
 The crooked ways of faith I do not take,  
 But merely obey You and eat Your cake.

14 He came to his disciples and  
 Saw a great crowd around on land,  
 And scribes to argue and withstand.  
 15 At once the folk all saw him and  
 Were flabbergasted and they ran  
 Up and greeted him to a man.  
 16 He questioned the scribes, "What are  
 you  
 Arguing about with them too?"  
 17 And one answered out of the crowd,  
 Saying, "Rabbi, I was allowed  
 To bring my son to you, because  
 He has a dumb spirit *in jaws*.  
 18 "And wherever it seizes him  
 It throws him round bottom to brim,  
 And he foams and gnashes his teeth.  
 He wastes away without bequeath.  
 I told your disciples so they  
 Might cast it out and cast away.  
 But they could not *perform for pay*."  
 19 He answered them and said "O you  
 Unfaithful generation's crew!  
 How long will I be here with you?  
 How long shall I stand for your rue?  
 Bring him to me *and see what do*."

I'm one of the unfaithful here I know,  
 For every time I pray for those below  
 Who lie ill and weak on a bed, they go  
 But faster into death. I should not so  
 Pray for my friends at all, and hope You  
 might  
 Take pity on their illness and their plight.  
 Too bad Your Jesus does not live here now,  
 But is caught up into the sky from row  
 Of humankind to bask in friendship met  
 With Moses and Elijah and the set  
 Of others so occulted, Enoch and  
 Muhammad Al-Mahdi, that faithful band.

But still I know some people that could use  
Some healing, why not help and why  
refuse?

20 And so they brought him to him there.  
And when the spirit saw his share,  
He threw him violently down.  
He fell on the ground by the town  
And writhed in torment, foaming there.  
21 He asked his father, "How long since  
This happened to make the boy wince?"  
And he said "From childhood *of prince*.  
22 "It often threw him in the fire  
And in the water and the mire  
To try to kill him. But if you  
Can do anything, help us true  
And have some pity on us too."

The unclean spirit takes the portals each  
Of the right way as though he came to  
preach.  
The gate of fire, of water, and of earth,  
Each one arises object of his mirth.  
Only the gate of air is missing here,  
As though he could not touch Your law for  
fear.  
So all faiths come in all four elements  
To push their wares and take in pay their  
pence,  
But all such faiths are demon-driven carts  
In competition for our human hearts.  
The faith of Jesus is the right alone,  
The recognition of One on the throne,  
One God, one law, one grace here to atone,  
And one humanity with heart of stone.

23 And Jesus said to him, "If you  
Are able to believe, all things  
Are possible to faithful rings."  
24 And straight away the father of  
The child cried out *in his great love*  
And said with tears, "Sir, I believe!  
Help my unbelief *to receive!*"

Beloved, I'm Thomas doubter, it is true,  
And I doubt everything that's come in  
view,  
To say no word of what is still unseen,  
Despite the Qur'an's blessing on the bean.  
Beloved, I'm Thomas doubter, but You'll  
not  
Find unbelief in me, just doubting's plot.

I doubt and then I climb into Your trust,  
Not so much because You give from the  
dust

A reason for my faith, but more because  
I see success is built into Your laws.  
But were it not so, still I'd come to You  
Simply because there is no other crew  
That would take me aboard, though with  
tears I  
Should come and beg them under Your  
broad sky.

25 Jesus saw that a crowd was gathered,  
So he rebuked the unclean *weathered*  
Spirit, saying to it, "Deaf, dumb  
Spirit, I order you to come  
Out of him and you may no more  
Go into him *through his closed door*."  
26 And crying out, and throwing him  
Around a lot, it came out grim.  
And he because as if one dead,  
So many thought he died instead.  
27 But Jesus took hold of his hand  
And raised him up and made him stand.  
28 And when he went into the house,  
His disciples questioned to grouse,  
"Why couldn't we then cast it auss?"  
29 And He said to them, "This kind can  
Go out by nothing except plan  
Of prayer and fasting." 30 And they went  
From there and passed through Galilee.  
And he wanted no one to see.

I'm like Your sent one, My Beloved, who  
did  
Not want anyone to see where he hid.  
All other preachers raise a cry and bid,  
An advertisement on the coffee lid.  
I pray that none will come on Sabbath day  
Disturbing me and mine gathered to pray.  
I've prayed a bit, though not at all as due,  
I've fasted in the Ramadhan, it's true,  
But still I do not cast the devils out  
Who rule the town and harbour and the  
spout  
Of church and market and the fell redoubt.  
Beloved, where I have failed to cast the lot  
Out of this earthly temple's barren plot,  
Come to renew what Your sent one has  
taught.

31 For He taught His disciples, and

Said to them, "Son of man will stand  
Betrayed into the hands of men,  
And they will kill him, but then when  
He has been killed, he'll rise again  
The third day." 32 But to understand  
The message was beyond their ken,  
And they feared to question him then.

Here is the reason why Jesus' friends did  
Not ask him what he meant by being rid  
Of life and laid in the dark grave with lid.  
They were afraid to ask. It cannot be  
They were afraid of Jesus on a spree,  
Who might use his divine powers to evoke  
The lightning to come kill them at a stroke.  
They were afraid to ask by the same token  
That men today are silent when awoken:  
They are afraid that other men will laugh  
To hear their ignorance displayed in gaff.  
Beloved, I have no pride like that. I come  
Displaying all my ignorance in sum  
Of sonnets in the thousands like a bum.

33 And they came to Capernaum.  
And when they came into the room,  
He asked them, "What were you in gloom  
Disputing to yourselves about  
As we were walking on the route?"  
34 And they were silent then, for they  
Had been disputing on the way  
As to who was the greater man.  
35 He sat down and he called in span  
The twelve and said to them, "If any  
Wants to be the first shiny penny,  
He must be the last of them all  
And servant in the servants' hall."

The dispute on who is the greater man  
Is the result of Your creating plan,  
By which You place in humankind the I,  
Awareness of Your own divinity.  
Each one of us knows that Creator God  
Resides within awareness of the rod.  
There is no I but the divine in pod.  
With such self-consciousness all men must  
cry  
They are the greatest in the world to spy,  
Until awareness breaks through veils to  
show  
That each is equally in divine row.  
Thanks to You it does not take too much  
sense:

A man is not known for intelligence.  
All know what being dwells within our  
tents.

36 And so he took a child and set  
It among them and hugged the pet,  
And said to them, 37 "The one who takes  
Such children for my name and sakes  
Receives me. And the one who gets  
Me does not get me *for his bets*,  
But the One who has set my stakes."

The thing most relevant here is not that  
Jesus makes certain that children down pat  
Are baptised by the sprinkling from the vat  
Soon after birth with godfers lean and fat.  
What's relevant is that Jesus remained  
To hug the child he set among the pained.  
To hug a child is greater in the way  
Of faith and practice than the preacher's  
pay,  
The theologian's spices and nosegay.  
To hug a child is proof more than the rest  
That Jesus was Messiah and the best.  
All other aspirations might well fail,  
But let me hug a child instead of wail  
My creeds and liturgies in tie and vest.

38 And John answered him and he said  
"Teacher, we saw someone instead  
Casting out demons in your name,  
Who does not follow us in claim.  
And we told him he ought to stop,  
Because he does not keep our prop."  
39 But Jesus said "Do not forbid.  
For there is no one *under lid*  
Who shall do a work by the power  
Of my name and yet stand *an hour*  
To speak ill of me *and my tower*."

The fact is every church I know forbids  
Me to speak in the name of Christ on skids.  
There's hardly any person in this world  
Who would not be welcomed in some  
church curled,  
But me. I'm just about the only one  
Who is not worthy to enter the run  
Of faith and virtue set out in the pew.  
Beloved, I am bereft of all but You.  
And still I silently, unseen by cue,  
Bow praying in the synagogue and aisle

Of the mosque and the church, and all the  
while

You feed me the unseen bread from Your  
pile.

The temple of my heart cannot be breached  
By any who have promised and have  
preached.

40 "For one who's not against us comes  
To help us get through all our sums.

41 "For whoever gives you a cup  
Of cold water to drink or sup  
In my name, because you're of Christ,  
Truly I tell you, hot or iced,  
He'll not lose his reward *in hums*.

Clean water is so rare today that it  
Is far more precious than gold in the kit,  
And so no wonder that the simple act  
Of giving it away is gratefully  
Remembered in the days that have been  
packed

With negligence in earth's polluting spree.  
When I was a child two fountains were  
free:

Water for Whites Only and alongside  
Water of Colored People for the ride.  
Now neither one is regaled with such pride,  
But both must pay more for clear water  
than

For what they put in tank of car and van.  
Though oil still causes war, it costs us less  
Than sparkling water, polluted I guess.

42 "And whoever causes one of  
These little ones that come *in love*  
Of my faith to offend *in glove*,  
It would be better for him if  
A millstone were laid on neck stiff,  
And he be thrown into the sea.

43 "And if your hand offend degree,  
Then cut it off. For it is better  
For you to enter *without fetter*  
Into life maimed, than with two hands  
Be thrown in Hell and in the bands  
Of fire unquenchable *on sands*,

44 "Where their worm does not die, and  
where

The fire is not put out *of flare*.

45 "And if your foot make you offend,  
Cut it off, it's better to end  
In life lame than with two feet be

Thrown into Hell and in degree  
Of fire unquenchable to see,

46 "Where their worm does not die, and  
where

The fire is not put out *of flare*.

47 "And if your eye offend you there,  
Pull it out. For it's better you  
Enter into God's kingdom's pew

With one eye than with having two  
Be thrown into the Hell fire's crew,

48 "Where their worm does not die, and  
where

The fire is not put out *of flare*.

49 "For everyone's salted with fire,  
And every sacrifice on pyre  
Will be salted with salt *entire*.

50 "Salt is good, but if salt has lost  
The taste of salt, then what's the cost?  
Have salt among yourselves and be  
At peace with each other's degree.

Despite the grace and gospel, Your sent  
one

Still thinks to keep Your law is better done  
Than anything a man or woman won.

It's better to lose eye or hand or foot  
Than commit a sin against Your law put.

Those who believe all sins were set free at  
The death of Your sent one on the cross hat  
Fail to consider that even with that,

It's better to lose eye than to look at  
Transgression of Your law, better to cut  
Off hand and foot than keep the rock and  
rut

Neglecting Sabbath rest, going to kill  
The criminal and foreigner on hill,  
Stealing the neighbour's property and bill.

### Mark 10

1 And he got up from there and came  
Into the borders of the claim  
Of Judea and on the side  
Opposite of the Jordan wide.

And there again the crowds came by  
To him, and so he taught them why.

2 The Pharisees came near to ask  
Him if it's lawful as a task  
For a man to divorce his wife,  
Just to be difficult for strife.

3 But he replied and said to them,  
"What did Moses command your hem?"

4 And they said "Moses did allow

Divorcement by a bill and how.”  
 5 And Jesus answered and told them,  
 “Because of your hard-hearted phlegm  
 He wrote this order on your gem.  
 6 “But from creation’s start God made  
 Them male and female on parade.  
 7 “Because of this, a man shall leave  
 His father and mother and weave  
 With his own wife *upon his sleeve*,  
 8 “And the two shall be one flesh; so  
 They are no longer two in row,  
 But one flesh *from both head to toe*.  
 9 “Therefore, what God has joined  
 together,  
 Let no man put apart *with feather*.”

Beloved, You married humankind to all  
 That You once wrote on Sinaitic wall  
 And spoke so all could hear what You  
 would say.  
 You never changed the holy Sabbath day.  
 And so I know that if I come with bill  
 Of a divorcement and try to fulfil  
 Another day, You will come to commend  
 Me for adultery and wait to rend.  
 What You have joined together, my  
 Beloved,  
 Whether of flesh or days to meet ungloved,  
 Let no man, whether Jesus, Pete or Paul  
 Put once apart to sadden and appal.  
 Beloved, I meet the Sabbath queen each  
 week  
 And find all the desires my heart would  
 seek.

10 Again in the house came to ask  
 His disciples would take *to task*  
 About the same matter *in cask*.  
 11 And he said to them, “Anyone  
 Who divorces his wife when done  
 And marries another commits  
 Adultery *there where she sits*.  
 12 “And if a woman puts away  
 Her husband and marries to stay  
 With another, she too commits  
 Adultery *to do such fits*.”

According to the Torah law a wife  
 Cannot give bill of divorce in the strife,  
 But only men have such a right at all.  
 So Jesus here envisions at the wall  
 Emancipation and women’s last rights.

Just think, a wife could divorce from her  
 plights.  
 The stories Jesus tells fail not to take  
 Imagination in account of cake,  
 But this one takes at least two loaves to  
 make.  
 Your sent one lets us down from the fair  
 heights  
 Of our enthusiastic human fights  
 To see that where the liberty instates  
 Responsibility too claims its rates:  
 Adultery’s so common in our fates.

13 And they brought children to him so  
 He might touch them. But then rebuked  
 The disciples those who had looked  
 To carry them *to him below*.  
 14 But Jesus saw and was he mad.  
 He said to them, “Allow each lad  
 And lass to come to me, and do  
 Not hinder them. For of such crew  
 Is God’s kingdom, *and it is true*.  
 15 “Truly I say to you, the one  
 Who does not take the kingdom won  
 Of God as a child may not come  
 Into it ever, every bum.”  
 16 He took them in his arms and set  
 His hands on them and blessed each pet.

It’s just because the waifs are cute that he  
 Took them in his arms and blessed each  
 and wee.  
 It’s just because they’re helpless and  
 awaken  
 The instinct of protection when they’re  
 taken  
 That Jesus points to children as the measure  
 Of man and woman in the heavenly  
 treasure.  
 But fact is children are not innocent,  
 No more than grown-ups in the way they  
 went.  
 It matters not, whether a man or child,  
 Either can be obedient or wild.  
 I simply do not understand what he  
 Meant that we should be children in degree,  
 Especially since the church teaches well  
 Original sin spoils children that fell.

17 He went out into the highway,  
 And a man came running to pay  
 Him obeisance and questioned him,

“Good teacher, what shall I do trim  
That I may have eternal life?”

18 But Jesus said to him *like knife*,  
“Why do you call me good? No one  
Is good except One, God *when done*. ”

19 “You know the commandments: Do not  
Commit adultery, do not  
Commit murder, and do not steal,  
Do not bear false witness, in deal  
Do not defraud, honour your dad  
And mother *so you’ll not be sad*. ”

When Jesus took examples from the law  
He left out the first ones and spoke in awe  
Of later ones, and some take in their craw  
To understand the first commandments  
went

The way of all flesh and left only lent  
The final ones they see of social bent.  
But surely Jesus referred to the whole  
By mentioning a part, that was his goal.  
And that is seen because he chose to state  
The shorter ones and to abbreviate  
The one for dad and mum. Man finds  
excuse

To make idols and break the Sabbath’s use  
If any straw or daw can help the tide  
And leave him to his own career and ride.

20 And he replied and said to him,  
“Teacher, I’ve observed all these things  
From my youth till this day *in rings*. ”

21 And looking at him, Jesus loved  
Him, and said to him *unreproved*,  
“One thing is lacking to you. Go,  
Sell what you have, and don’t be slow  
To the poor. You’ll lay up and keep  
Treasure in Heaven. And come creep  
After Me, taking up the cross.”

22 But he was sad at the word’s loss,  
And went away in sorrow, for  
He had great possessions in store.

So Jesus has attraction for the small,  
The cute and sweet to climb over the wall.  
So Jesus loves the wealthy for their stake  
In social and in culture on the make.  
I guess he learned his lesson here at last,  
Love the children failed to reach his cast.  
Love not the rich and then when they  
refuse

To follow righteousness while in their  
pews,

You will not be in disappointed crews.  
Look only on the man that will obey,  
Who lives to act in light of every day  
According to Your law, and You will say  
At last that disappointment in the way  
Has never entered Your heart, not a ray.

23 And Jesus looked around and said  
To his disciples, “How few led  
Into the kingdom of God spread  
Before them riches *on their head*. ”

24 And the disciples were amazed  
At his words. Jesus was not fazed,  
But said to them, “Children, how hard  
It is for those trusting in lard  
Of wealth to come into God’s reign.

25 “It’s easier for camel to gain  
Passage through needle’s eye, than for  
A rich man to enter the door  
Of God’s kingdom.” 26 They were the  
more

Astonished, saying to themselves,  
“Who can be saved of men *or elves*? ”

27 But Jesus looked at them and said  
“It’s humanly impossible,  
But not for God. for all things spread  
Are possible with God *in full*.

28 Peter began to say to him,  
“See, we left all our gear and trim,  
Came following you *to the brim*. ”

In fact Peter was of two minds to see  
A wealthy man not join them on their  
spree.

He wanted the prestige the man would  
bring,  
But feared he would take precedence in  
sting.

And so he ruminates aloud the thing.  
“See, we left all to follow under wing,  
So we are better than the wealthy man  
Despite our poverty to do and can.  
I well know how disciples fear to see  
Someone converting to their faith and tree.  
I’ve entered doors a-plenty and seen fear  
In every place that I’d convert with gear  
And distract from their honour with a tear.  
No fear! I’m outside every church and ban.

29 But Jesus answered, said “Indeed,



I say to you that none took heed  
 To leave his house, brothers and all  
 His sisters, father, mother's call,  
 Or wife, offspring or lands for my  
 Sake and the gospel, 30 who'll not vie  
 For hundredfold now in this time,  
 Of house and brother, sister and  
 Mother, children as well as land,  
 With persecutions, come to stand  
 In the age to come and to climb  
 Into eternal life *I've planned*.  
 31 "But many first shall be last then,  
 And the last shall be the first men."

I'm not so troubled by the fact one must  
 According to the word of Jesus trust  
 In nothing the world offers on the plain.  
 It's not the vow of poverty that's pain.  
 What bothers me the more is how the  
     words  
 Can be distorted by the craven herds  
 To mean that no honour need be paid to  
 The father and the mother of the crew.  
 To keep the ten commandments in my view  
 Is all important, more important than  
 Relinquishing Beersheba unto Dan.  
 Beloved, let neither wealth nor poverty,  
 Loved father, mother, wife, child set me  
     free  
 To disregard Your law eternally.

32 They were in the highway to go  
 Up to Jerusalem in row  
 With Jesus first, the others went  
 Astonished, fearing what he meant.  
 He took the twelve once more and started  
 To tell them how he'd be uncared.  
 33 "See, we're going to Jerusalem,  
 The son of man, *your joy and gem*,  
 Will be betrayed to the chief priests,  
 And to the scribes *before the feasts*.  
 They'll condemn him to death and will  
 Betray him to the nations still.  
 34 "And they will mock him and will flog  
 Him and will spit at him in cog,  
 And kill him, and on the third day  
 He will rise up again in sway."

Fact is that Jesus needed no word set  
 In scroll to prophesy the fate he met.  
 The folk as well as leaders never failed  
 To crucify those who stood up unequalled

To keep Your law's commandments in the  
     way.  
 Fact is that persecution is the pay  
 Of all on earth who dare stand and obey.  
 Not only was the Tanach a prediction  
 Of Jesus' rejection and crucifixion  
 In every word and story that it told,  
 But so was very air to breathe and fold.  
 Things have not changed a wit in berth and  
     stall.  
 The crosses are still raised against the wall,  
 The priests and prophets still eat under pall.

And they came down to Bethany  
 And there was a woman in spe  
 Whose brother had died. And she came  
 Up to him and prostrated dame  
 Before Jesus said to him, "Son  
 Of David, mercy on me won."  
 But the disciples rebuked her.  
 Jesus was angered by the stir  
 And so he accompanied her  
 To the garden where the tomb lay.  
 And a great sound then right away  
 Was heard from the tomb, and Jesus  
 Went toward it and without a fuss  
 Where the young man was, stretched his  
     hand  
 And raised him up by his command,  
 And supported him by his hand.  
 The man looked at him and with love  
 Called him to his side from above  
 That he might be with him, so they  
 Went up from the tomb to the way  
 Of the young man's house, for in pay  
 It was a wealthy one in sway.  
 And for six days Jesus taught him.  
 And when it was late and come dim,  
 The young man went coming to him.  
 He'd put a linen on his form  
 Of nakedness *to keep him warm*,  
 And stay with him throughout that night.  
 For Jesus taught him secrets *bright*  
 Of the kingdom of God *with might*.  
 But after he got up from there,  
 He turned to Jordan's region *bare*.

This brief addition to the Gospel sound  
 Affirms the secrecy I see abound  
 When Jesus hides his works and orders all  
 To keep mum about his life and his call.  
 The Gospel's here merely to proclaim that

Your sent one taught his secrets on the mat  
Of seven days in all, until the vat  
Was naked of all self bereft of fat.  
The secret teaching itself is unnamed.  
The content of the Gospel is ashamed  
To meet the light of day, no doubt because  
All are slain in this world who keep Your  
laws.

I take the secret of Bektash and know  
That all the world's illusion of the slow.

35 And James and John came up to him,  
The sons of Zebedee, both grim,  
And said "Rabbi, we'd ask of you  
To give us what we'd ask you to."

36 And he said to them, "What do you  
Desire for me to do for you?"

37 And they said to him, "Grant to us  
To sit one on your right for fuss  
And for the other, Whig or Tory,  
To sit on your left in your glory.

38 But Jesus said to them, "You do  
Not know what you're asking. Can you  
Drink the cup which I drink and be  
Baptised with the baptism's key  
With which I'm baptised and for free?"

39 They said to him, "Absolutely."  
But Jesus said to them, "Indeed  
You will be baptised and with speed  
With the baptism that I take.

40 "But to sit on my right in stake  
Or on me left is not for me  
To give, but for whom it's prepared."

41 The ten, when they heard what they  
shared,  
Began to get angry about  
James and John for coveting clout.

You'd think a week of meditation spent  
With Jesus teaching all his secrets lent  
Would have informed disciples of the true.  
And yet the fact is teaching's in the brew  
Of wind upon the hill, and every heart  
Is filled with the awareness set apart  
That there is no I but You in Your art,  
And still the masses trample on the gain,  
And crush the pearl of truth with idol stain,  
And rush to be the leader of the vain.  
Awareness of the inner divine law  
Is what makes every man think that his  
claw

Should rule the world and put all in his  
maw.

The secret half is hidden from the straw.

42 But having called them near, Jesus  
Said to them, "You know that the muss  
Of nations rule it over them,  
And their chiefs wield their power in stem.

43 "But it shall not be so with you,  
But the one who wants greatness due  
Among you shall take servant's view.

44 "And whoever of you desires  
To become first, he'll tune his lyres  
To be the slave of all the crew.

45 "For even the son of man did not  
Come to be served, but serve the lot,  
And give his life as ransom sought  
For many. 46 And they come not slow  
Into the town of Jericho.

The kingdom and the glory are alone  
In realizing here before Your throne  
That there is no I but You God alone  
And all else is illusion on the bone.  
Ambition and petition of the wife  
And mother does not raise a man from  
strife,

And seat and council and the sweet in store  
Leave neither health nor wealth but in  
stealth gore.

Beloved, I enter in the palace where  
There is no room for any but the fair,  
For You alone, and though I sweep the  
floor,

And whirl a dog upon Your hearth the  
more,

I'm satisfied to sacrifice my head  
Upon the dergah where I have been led.

And the brother of the young man  
Whom Jesus loved was there by plan,  
As well as his mother and one  
Salome. But Jesus when done  
Did not welcome them on the run.

Though Jesus vouchsafed secrets to the one  
Who remained naked without any fun,  
That did not mean his brother and his mum  
Were also given glory in the hum.  
The nepotism of the world is great,  
But in Your kingdom it comes running late,  
And finds no crumb to maintain its estate.

In nakedness, Beloved, I clamour in  
Your gates and wrap myself to hide my sin,  
And find myself stripped from both cover  
and

The self that I had brought in loving hand.  
The wealth of Salome may serve the feast  
Of Your sent one to make the world  
increased,  
But I remain before You without band.

As he and his disciples and  
A large crowd came out from the strand  
Of Jericho, Timaeus son  
Named Bartimaeus the blind one,  
Sat by the highway begging some.  
47 And hearing that it was Jesus  
Nazarene as well as wondrous,  
He started shouting and to say  
“Son of David, Jesus, I pray,  
Have mercy on me *now, today!*”  
48 And many cautioned him be still.  
But he shouted with greater will,  
“Son of David, have mercy on  
Me, a *blind sinner without dawn!*

How many caution me to shut the maw  
And keep to myself both the paw and claw,  
Unworthy of the son of David’s law!  
And yet I clamour at the gate and shout  
To see if You, Beloved, are round about.  
You do not ask of me any delight  
Or any wisdom gained from ear and sight.  
In fact You demand nothing of my right  
As Your sent one passes me in my night.  
My clamour is the only thing that stands.  
If I were silent even Your just bands  
Would leave me in my darkness on the  
sands.  
And so I clamour all the more and pray,  
Beloved, You look on me now and today.

49 Jesus stopped there and summoned him.  
And they called the blind one and dim,  
Saying to him, “Take comfort now,  
Get up, he’s calling you *to bow.*”  
50 And throwing off his garment, he  
Got up and came to Jesus *wee.*  
51 And Jesus answered him and said  
“What do you want from me *and sped?*”  
And the blind one told him, “Sir, I  
Would like again to use my eye.”  
52 And Jesus said to him, “Go, your

Faith has healed you.” and from that shore  
He saw again and followed after  
Jesus on the road *without laughter.*

Like young Mark and the blind Bartimaeus  
I shed my cloak and naked meet the bus.  
I hear the call of Your sent one with fuss  
And rush to find the light of faith and hope,  
Relinquishing my priestcraft and my pope.  
The melody of Jesus’ voice I find  
Through centuries still calling to the blind,  
And where I throw off every weight of kind  
I enter in his healing dined and wined.  
He asks me what I wish and I reply  
That I might regain use of inner eye.  
He sends me on my way before Your  
throne  
Assuring that my small faith will atone  
For what You left me to for moan and  
groan.

### **Mark 11**

1 When they came near Jerusalem,  
To Bethphage and Bethany,  
Toward the Mount of Olives gem,  
He sent two disciples to see  
2 And said to them, “Go *faithfully*  
Into the town across from here.  
And when you get there you will find  
A colt tied on which no man deigned  
To ride. Untie, bring it to me.  
3 “And if anyone says to you,  
‘Why do you do this?’ say as due,  
The Lord has need of it. And he  
Will straight away sent it freely.”  
4 And they set out and found the colt  
Tied at the door outside by bolt,  
Beside the intersection, and  
They untied it and brought in hand.  
5 And some of those who stood by there  
Said to them, “What is this your care  
To unbind the colt without share?”  
6 And they replied as Jesus said,  
And so they let them go as led.  
7 They took the colt to Jesus then.  
And cast their garments out again  
On it, and he sat on the spread.

St. Mark neglects to note that Jesus sat  
On two beasts to fulfil predictions that  
Were made by prophets Matthew knew and  
told.

Mark was not there perhaps and was not  
bold

To set imagination clear and cold  
To see how Jesus could sit astride both  
Beasts and unquitted from his morning's  
growth.

It was a feat, it was a miracle.  
St. Mark fails to take the advantage full.  
Beloved, if You send me around one day  
To ride a colt never ridden to bray,  
Or to ride two beasts, handsome in my  
way,

It will be a fine show to humble me,  
But not a miracle for all to see.

8 And many spread their garments on  
The roadway, and others were drawn  
To cut branches from trees and spread  
Them on the roadway *where he led*.  
9 And those who went before, and those  
Who followed after them too chose  
To shout out saying *in their rows*  
"Hosanna! Blessed is the one  
Who comes in the Lord's name *to run!*"  
10 "Blessed is the coming kingdom of  
Our father David in the love  
Of the Lord! Hosanna on high!"

It's clear the people of Jesus' own time  
Where waiting for the kingdom once to  
climb

Back to the throne and power of David's  
rhyme.

If I, Beloved, long for that kingdom too,  
And wait for David come to life anew  
To sit upon his throne as he is due,  
According to the prophets' sayings true,  
Do not count me for that a man of crime,  
As do the Muslims, Jews, and Christian  
slime.

I'm hated for Your law, I'm hated for  
Exception to usurping states in score,  
But I love David and long for his hand  
To rule upon the earth again in stand.  
Till then I am an outlaw without band.

11 Jesus entered Jerusalem,  
And went into the temple *gem*.  
He looked around at all those things,  
And seeing it was late in rings,  
He went out to Bethany's town  
With the twelve disciples' renown.

12 And the next day as they went out  
From Bethany, he was in rout  
Of hunger. 13 And he saw far off  
A fig tree with leaves not to scoff,  
And so he went toward it to find  
Something on it and to have dined.  
And when he got there all he found  
Was leaves rustling above the ground,  
For it was not fig season's sound.  
14 And Jesus' response to it came,  
"Let no one eat your fruit of blame  
Any more till the age of shame."  
And his disciples heard the claim.

If I curse anything, Beloved, I hear  
The Christians sweetly turning on my ear  
To blame me for the things I say for cheer.  
The same mouth cannot curse and bless,  
they say,  
Forgetting that their Saviour in his day  
Gave cursings and his blessings too, the  
way  
That Deuteronomy once shone the ray.  
They also fail to mind their sentence comes  
From St. James, who desires above all  
rums,  
Obedience to Your law, and not just faith  
Like devils in the hopeless kind of wraith.  
Beloved, teach me to curse and with a will,  
So I may follow the example shrill  
Of Jesus to the fig tree on the hill.

15 And they came to Jerusalem.  
And Jesus came into the hem  
Of the temple and started there  
To throw out those selling their ware  
And those buying the temple share.  
Also he overturned made bare  
The tables of the money changers  
And the seats of dove-selling rangers.  
16 And he did not allow a man  
To bear a pot through temple span.  
17 He taught and told them, "It was  
written,  
My house shall be called and not smitten  
A house of prayer for all the nations.  
But you've made it a den and rations  
Of robbers." 18 And the scribes and chief  
Priests heard. They sought without relief  
How they might kill him, for they feared  
Him, because all the crowd was geared  
To be amazed at what appeared.

19 When evening came, He went outside  
 The town to a park to abide.  
 20 And passing along early, they  
 Saw the fig tree withered from root.  
 21 And Peter minding came to say  
 To him, "Teacher, see how it's moot,  
 The fig tree that you cursed is withered.  
 22 In answer to them Jesus dithered  
 To say "Have faith of God *in boot*.  
 23 "For truly I tell you, whoever  
 Says to this mountain, 'Up and sever,  
 Be thrown into the sea,' and clever  
 Not doubting in his heart, believes  
 What he says will happen, receives  
 Anything he wants in reprieves.

The Pentecostal preacher, with all power  
 Of faith told the assembly in an hour  
 They could walk on the river, if they  
 would.  
 One dear old lady then thought that she  
 should.  
 They all went to the riverbank where she  
 Closed eyes and lifted her hem daintily  
 And walked upon the lapping marge to see,  
 All the while saying "I believe, believe."  
 When the water came to the knees to  
 grieve,  
 She opened up her eyes and looked around,  
 Exclaiming, "Just what I thought would be  
 found."  
 Beloved, give me the faith the Christian  
 lass  
 Had after emptying her full beer glass,  
 And I'll keep my feet dry upon the pass.

24 That's why I say to you, "All things  
 That you ask praying with the springs  
 Of faith that you'll receive the stings,  
 It will be given to you *fast*.  
 25 "And when you stand in prayer at last,  
 If you have anything to blast  
 Against anyone, then forgive,  
 So that your heavenly Father sieve  
 Your own straying in how you live.  
 26 "But if you do not forgive then  
 Neither will your Father again  
 In heaven forgive you your sin."

Beloved, that's why I do not pray on earth.  
 I have too many things against its worth,  
 Too many complaints against the ones who run

About the world to slay me with a gun.  
 I'm willing to live and let live, but see,  
 This is the reason in eternity  
 That I do not kneel down in prayer to Thee.  
 I'll not forgive the things they do to me.  
 Beloved, it's easier far to relent  
 And claim the blood of Jesus has been  
 spent  
 For all forgiveness, than to speak the word  
 Forgiving Hitler's holocaust in herd.  
 No freedom from responsibility  
 I ask, so hold Your justice up in fee.

27 They found Jerusalem again.  
 And as He was walking in den  
 Of the temple, the chief priests and  
 The scribes and elders came in band.  
 28 And they said to him, "By what power  
 Do you dare to do these things dour?  
 And who gave you authority  
 To do all the things that we see?"  
 29 And answering, Jesus told them,  
 "I'll ask you one thing, haw or hem,  
 And answer me, and then I'll tell  
 You by what power I come to spell.  
 30 "The baptism of John, was it  
 From heaven, or from men? Answer fit."  
 31 And they argued among themselves,  
 Saying, "If we say heavenly shelves,  
 He'll answer why don't you believe?  
 32 "But if we say, from men," they feared  
 The people. For all held appeared  
 John really was a prophet *steered*.  
 33 And answering, they told Jesus,  
 "We do not know." Jesus replied  
 To them, "Neither will I provide  
 By what authority I bide  
 To do these things here by your side."

My neighbours in the church ask me to say  
 By what authority the Sabbath day  
 Is binding duty and a golden ray.  
 I ask them whether You spoke on the way  
 Of Sinai or not. They refuse to pay  
 Attention, knowing that if they say yes,  
 Then I'll say to obey Your own address.  
 And if they say not, then I'll come to curse  
 Them for their blasphemy or something  
 worse.

So we remain in silence Quakerly  
 In hope that You will speak and end the  
 spree.

But You are silent, simply because You  
Have said already all You wanted to.  
Blessèd are those who say as well as do.

### Mark 12

1 And He began to speak to them in stories.  
A man planted a vineyard for his glories,  
And set a fence around it, and he dug  
A wine vat and he built a tower's plug.  
And then he leased it to vinedressers there,  
And went away to enjoy of his share.

2 When the time came he sent a slave to  
see

The vinedressers and to collect in fee  
The profit of the vineyards fruit in spe.

3 They took him and they beat him there,  
And sent him out empty and bare.

I understand the Christians sent me out,  
Because I deny Trinity and flout  
The human sacrifice releasing from  
Responsibility for what men hum.  
I understand the Jews do not claim me,  
Because I was not born upon their tree.  
But why the Muslims reject equally,  
I cannot fathom, since I've kept Islam  
In every tenet and practice and balm.  
No doubt the Sabbath in addition makes  
Me suspect and for that and for its sakes  
They sent me like a slave out empty, bare.  
I should be happy they did not beat nor  
Kill. I thank the Shirazis on that score.

4 And so he sent another slave  
To them, and they threw stones, and struck  
Him in the head, and so they drave  
Him off insulting him *for luck*.

5 And once again, he sent another,  
And they killed that one and his brother,  
Beating one and killing the other.

6 But he had one son, his beloved,  
So he sent him too last one shoved,  
Saying "They will respect my son."

7 But these vinedressers said when done  
To one another, "This one's heir,  
Come, let us kill him, take his share."

8 The took him and they killed him and  
They threw him outside vineyard's land.

9 What, then, will the lord of the crop  
Do? He will come and he'll not stop  
Till he's destroyed vinedressers there,  
And he'll give the vineyard for share

To other vinedressers to bear.

10 Have you not read this Scripture's word,  
The stone the builders had deterred  
Became the chief cornerstone's share?

11 This came about from the Lord, and  
It's marvellous to our eyes' band?

12 And they sought to seize him, yet feared  
The crowd. For they knew that he geared  
The parable against them. And  
They left him, went away *and planned*.

The master of the vineyard is Yours truly,  
And all the slaves are prophets sent out  
duly,

And the son is the Son of God well met,  
But rarely in the words of Jesus set.

If I take this to mean the guy is yet  
A deity to be killed when they get  
Their hands on him, I then deny Your word  
In the first of commandments that You  
stirred.

Beloved, I do not follow pagan herd,  
But bless You in Your vineyard with both  
son

And prophet, servants all when said and  
done,

And yet not slaves, for that too is a pun.  
Reality goes unexpressed because  
We cannot see the real till we have claws.

13 They sent some of the Pharisees  
And of Herodians to please  
Him and catch him in traps with ease.

14 They came to him, they said to him,  
"Rabbi, we know that you're not dim  
But true, and you care not to rate

A person by his clan or state,  
But teach the way of God in truth:  
Is it lawful to give tribute

To Caesar, or not, say with ruth?

15 "Should we give or should we not  
give?"

But he knew hypocrisy's sieve  
And said to them, "Why bate me now?  
Bring me a dinar anyhow."

16 When they brought one, he said to them,  
"Whose image and signature's hem  
Is this?" They told him "That one's  
Caesar's."

17 And Jesus replied to those geezers,  
"Render to Caesar Caesar's own,  
And to God what is due His throne."

And they were amazed by his loan.

Your sent one in the end fell in the trap  
Set by Herodians to shut with snap.  
He may have stopped the mouths of  
questioners,  
But what he said now rankles as it blurs.  
It seems to give the place of government  
On earth to any who comes to present  
Enough arms to force everyone to bow.  
That weakens Your own sovereignty  
somehow.

The exegete always goes far beyond  
The teaching of Your word to wave a frond  
In sop to whoever's atomic wand  
Is graceful in the air and on the pond.  
I cry thee nay, and stay to find the great  
Law of Your speaking on Sinai a rate.

18 And Sadducees came to him, who  
Say there's no resurrection due.  
And they questioned him, saying true,  
19 "Rabbi, Moses wrote for us too,  
That if a brother of a man  
Should die and leave a wife in span  
But no child, then his brother ought  
To take his wife and raise up lot  
To his brother, *that is the plot*.  
20 "Then there were seven brothers, and  
The first one took a wife as planned,  
But died with no child on the sand.  
21 "The second took her and he died,  
Without siring a son in pride,  
And the third likewise, till the lot  
22 "Of seven had her on the spot  
Without offspring, till at the last  
The woman died too *in the blast*.  
23 "Now in the resurrection cast,  
When they rise up again, which one  
Will have her as his wife when done?  
For all the seven had her well  
If only for a little spell."  
24 Jesus replied and said to them,  
"Do you not err in haw and hem,  
Not knowing the Scriptures nor yet  
The power of Alohim to get?  
25 "For when they rise up from the dead,  
They neither marry nor are led  
In marriage, but like angels *sped*  
Across the heavens *for their bed*.  
26 "But as for the dead, that they're raised,  
Have you not read Moses' book praised,

As God spoke to him at the bush,  
Saying 'I am the God to push  
Of Abraham, God of Isaac,  
And the God of Jacob to stack?'  
27 He is not the God of the dead,  
But God of the living instead.  
Therefore, you greatly err *unled*."

When Jesus answered Sadducean tale  
About the seven husbands once to fail  
In bringing from one woman new-born  
male,

He does not want to convince them at all.  
If he had been convincing on the ball,  
He should have given a Sadducean call.  
Instead he answers with another quibble  
Between the Pharisees and questers' nibble:  
He compounds resurrection with the ploy  
That angels exist and answer the boy.  
It is no strategy to prove one's point  
By bringing up a second doubt in joint.  
For doubter in the resurrection there  
Doubted also that angels have a care.

28 One of the scribes stepped up when he  
Heard the argument in degree  
Of answers well-given in spree,  
And questioned him, "What is the first  
Commandment of all that's rehearsed?"  
29 And Jesus answered him, "The first  
Of all commandments is when pursed:  
'Hear, Israel. The Lord our God  
Is one Lord, *and He bears one rod*.  
30 'And you shall love the LORD your  
God  
With all your heart upon the sod,  
With all your soul, with all your mind,  
And all your strength *of every kind*.'  
This *is* the first commandment *lined*.

Ah, my Beloved, the one You sent said  
well  
The most important thing the Scriptures tell  
Is that You are the Lord and You are One,  
And no one is God but Yourself, and done.  
You claim the love of all my heart and  
soul,  
You claim my mind and strength and my  
life's goal.  
This is the first commandment and the best.  
Who fail in its obedience and test  
Fail then in all, for You are jealous of

The idol that would steal away the love  
Due You alone. You weep the Trinity  
Of Roman gods should make so fast and  
free  
With human hearts. I hear the word of him  
You sent and sip it deeply from the brim.

31 "And the second is like this: 'You  
Shall love your neighbour man as due  
Yourself.' There is no other law  
Greater than these *on which to draw*."  
32 And the scribe said to him, "Well said,  
Rabbi. You've spoken the truth spread  
That God is one and there is none  
Beside Him *for sadness or fun*.  
33 "And to love Him with all the heart,  
With all the mind and all the part  
Of one's strength, and to love the other  
As oneself *and just like a brother*,  
Is more than all burnt offerings and  
The sacrifices in the land."  
34 Jesus noticed his wise remark  
And said to him, "You're not in dark,  
But near to the kingdom of God."  
And no one dared to lay a prod  
In question on him, *old or mod*.

The man is near the kingdom but not in  
Because he has only the first in bin,  
The knowledge that You're one and it's a  
sin  
To set another up as God with You.  
The man is near the kingdom, yet he lacks  
The love of neighbour to cover his tracks,  
And that is why he's still got a few cracks  
Despite the fact he's faithful in his pew.  
Beloved, I think the love of neighbour  
comes  
Before the love of You, when I add sums.  
It's seeing the divine grace in such bums  
That makes me know You to the point of  
love.  
Without the neighbour I could not give  
glove  
Or face to You, You are so far above.

35 Jesus taught in the temple and replied  
With such speech: "How do the scribes say  
That Christ is David's son beside?  
36 "For David himself said by stay  
Of the Holy Spirit, 'The Lord  
Said to my Lord, "Sit for reward

On My right hand until I place  
Your enemies to be in trace  
Of a footstool for Your feet's pace.'" 37 "Then David himself calls Him Lord.  
And from where is he his son scored?"  
The crowd heard him gladly for grace.

This Jesus loves to torment with the speech  
Of surface meanings of the Scriptures'  
peach  
To draw out paradoxes each to each  
And stop the mouths of men and priests  
who preach.  
So David calls his son Lord, that is not  
Unthinkable except within the plot  
Of patriarchal social bounds, I fear.  
It's like the way the Sadducees would steer  
For seven husbands of one wife in death.  
Tibetan shamans see no rising breath,  
No problem there at all. They might see  
more  
If there were seven wives to fill the score.  
Beloved, Your sent one is a little fink  
Who loves to laugh and raise a crazy stink.

38 He said to them in what he taught,  
"Beware of the scribes in the plot,  
Those who desire to walk in robes,  
And show their greeting in the lobes  
Of public squares 39 and the chief seats  
In synagogues, and the retreats  
At feasts, 40 those who devour the living  
Of widows, and for pretence giving  
Long prayers. These will receive at last  
A greater judgement *on them cast*.  
41 Jesus sat down across from where  
The treasury was and regarded  
How the crowd threw in it their share  
Of copper coins and unretarded.  
And many rich ones threw in much.  
42 And one poor widow came in touch  
And threw in two pennies *unguarded*.  
43 Jesus called his disciples near  
And told what had come to appear.  
"Truly I say to you that this  
Poor widow has thrown not to miss  
More in the treasury than all  
Of those casting over the wall.  
44 For all threw in out of their much,  
But she in poverty to touch  
Threw in all she had left to live,  
*And she had nothing more to give*.



Beloved, there is no treasury where I  
 Might throw a mite into the coffers dry.  
 There is no temple now under the sky,  
 Unless you mean Al-Aqsa standing by,  
 Or the dome of the rock under the glare.  
 But there's no treasury standing up there.  
 Besides the one time I came there to pray,  
 I have no chance to throw my pence away.  
 My heritage is small and filled with care  
 Of winter darkness and the summer air,  
 And I give day by day the life that runs  
 Until at last all of it in its tonnes  
 Is Yours alone when I lie down to sleep.  
 I close the doors and lock the dungeon's  
 keep.

### Mark 13

1 As Jesus left the temple place,  
 One of his disciples in trace  
 Said to him, "Teacher see how great  
 Are the stones of this temple rate!"  
 2 And Jesus answered him and said  
 "Do you see these great buildings spread?  
 Not one stone shall be left upon  
 A stone but all destroyed and drawn."

I think I've seen some stones still standing  
 where  
 Jesus said all would fall in disrepair.  
 I guess the prophecy may still come true,  
 Since all things built by human hand in  
 view  
 Eventually disintegrate and fall.  
 So far the pyramids and Chinese wall  
 Still stand, but everything else on the ball  
 Is off to a good start in its decay.  
 And even those two monuments in sway  
 Have seen the ravages of time and scene.  
 Beloved, the prophecy is safe to make  
 As long as no time limit in the stake  
 Comes to claim that the words have failed  
 and passed.

All stones fall when the judgement comes  
 at last.

3 As he was sitting on the mount  
 Of Olives across from the fount  
 Of the temple, Peter and James  
 And John and Andrew came in claims  
 And asked him the thing privately.  
 4 "Tell us then when these things shall be?"

And what's the sign when all these things  
 Are on the point of fulfillings?"

5 And Jesus answered them to say  
 "Be careful no one lead astray.

6 "For many will come in My name,  
 Saying, 'It's me!' and lead to flame."

So far I don't know how many have come  
 To say they are the Christ, many a bum.  
 Ahmed of Qadian's not least or last,  
 And that is why he remains an outcast  
 Among the Muslims. But of Christian fame  
 There are a dozen more who make the  
 claim.

Though Sabbetai Zwi regarded his own  
 wake

Fulfilment of the prophecies at stake,  
 I have a heart to forgive him and plead  
 You not to judge him harshly in his need.  
 But all messiahs come to earth today  
 To fill the internet with filth and spray  
 Of warning that You wait upon Your ray  
 To polish them and make their faces gay.

7 But when you hear of wars and more  
 News of wars, do not fear the gore,  
 For it must happen, but the end  
 Has not yet come here to extend.  
 8 For nation will rise up to fight  
 Nation, and kingdom against site  
 Of kingdom. And there shall come by  
 Earthquakes in many places nigh.  
 And there shall be famines and grief:  
 Just the beginning sans relief.

9 But take care for yourselves, for they  
 Will deliver you to the sway  
 Of sanhedrins and synagogues.  
 You will be beaten, set in cogs  
 Of governors and kings for me,  
 To them for a testimony.

10 The gospel must first be proclaimed  
 To all the nations *where it's aimed*.

The proclamation of the gospel is  
 What the great spirit says before the fizz  
 Of kings and governments who will arrest  
 The good and true, the fairest and the best.  
 The good news is that Your kingdom is  
 here,

And they are all usurpers with their gear,  
 The ones who make war and cause famines  
 and

Make grief and mischief in the sea and  
land.

Beloved, I proclaim no gospels until  
The synagogue comes to take and fulfil  
This prophecy of beating not just breast  
But the backside until I have confessed.  
It's not likely to happen where I live  
Or anywhere else that the world can sieve.

11 But whenever they take you off,  
Delivering you to rake and scoff,  
Do not be anxious beforehand,  
Of what you should say to the band,  
Nor meditate, but you'll receive  
In that hour words of your reprieve.  
For you're not speaking of yourself,  
Of Holy Spirit *and not elf*.

The spirit that You poured on Israel's folk  
Out in the wilderness to keep off stroke  
Is that mind of Your own and power for  
broke

That's always given testimony wide  
Against idolatry and sinful pride.  
Your Spirit is expression of Your Word.  
But even then there were those who  
preferred

To condemn others in the camp who  
stirred,

And even then You broke in to reply  
That You wished all the folk would  
prophesy.

I prophesy with ukulele and  
The raising of the Psalms from David's  
hand,

And build a temple for Your Spirit still  
Beneath the quartzite knobs of Puijo Hill.

12 A brother will hand out his own  
Brother to death, and without groan  
A father his own child. A child  
Will rise against his parents wild  
And put them to death *as beguiled*.

13 And you'll be hated by all for  
My name. But the one stayed in store  
Until the end will be kept safe.

14 But when you see coming to strafe  
Desolation's abomination,  
The one spoken of in relation  
Of Daniel the prophet to stand  
Where it ought not, let every manned  
To read it understand the plot,

Then let those in Judea's lot  
Flee to the mountains, not be caught.

The rise of golden dome under the rule  
Of Abdul Malik sent us back to school  
To see if that might be abomination  
Set up by Daniel's word of desolation.  
The Byzantine dung heap was taken off  
By Omar himself, I'm asked not to scoff,  
Sixty years before that. I'd think the stink  
Of Rome abomination in a wink.  
Since Antiochus Epiphanes that  
Word has been focus of eternal spat.  
Beloved, abomination is set up  
Each time the human heart come out like  
tup

Refuses to grant You Your sovereignty,  
And makes an idol or a trinity.

15 The one on the housetop let not  
Go down into the house to take  
A treasure out for a keepsake.

16 And the one in the field, let him  
Not return to the things left dim  
To take his garment out with him.

17 But woe to those who're pregnant then,  
And giving suck those days' again!

18 And pray your flight will not come in  
The winter when it's cold to skin.

The conquest of Omar took three full years,  
So three winters went under Al-Quds'  
tears.

The prayer in Anno Domini seventy  
Was brief enough to set the winter free.  
Yet it too was a vacillating tree.  
Woe to the pregnant and those who give  
suck

In every time of fleeing from the duck  
Whoever takes his turn at persecution  
Of humankind in poverty's pollution.  
Beloved, I flee from my own crime and tale  
Of the abominations still on sale,  
The desolations of Your Word and house.  
I turn and nibble silently like mouse.

19 For there will be affliction then  
Such as has not in life of men  
Been from creation which God started  
Till now and never yet departed.  
20 And if the Lord had not made short  
The days, not any flesh in sort

Would be saved, but for those who're  
chosen,  
He shortened it not to be frozen.

So many times of great affliction rise  
That this one seems to take on a disguise.  
Is it a future thing not to despise?  
Or did it happen when the Romans came  
Destroying town and people with the  
flame?  
Or did it come in later Byzantine  
Wrath on the place covered in dung and  
wine?  
Or did the crusades represent the work  
Of the destroyer not indeed to shirk?  
The Ottoman regime was bad enough  
And caused the folk to suffer and be tough.  
Jerusalem looks on the wrath of years  
And finds its history in flood of tears.  
The prophecy is easy as it steers.

21 And if anyone says to you,  
"See, here's the Christ or there in view,"  
Do not believe it, it's not true.  
22 For false christs and false prophets be  
Raised, and they miraculously  
Will give signs and wonders to lead  
Astray if possible indeed  
The very chosen ones in seed.  
23 But you be careful. See, I've told  
You beforehand of all things roled.

Beloved, Your sent one warns that those  
who work  
Their miracles in every kind of quirk  
Are such impostors that will fill the earth.  
Yet now the masses of men without mirth  
Rush after anyone who can raise hand  
To work a miracle upon the land.  
The prophet now most visible that came  
After these words were spoken in acclaim  
Is sweet Muhammad. Is he one to blame  
As false or is he true? I take in trust  
The fact he worked no miracle in dust,  
But yea called all men to keep the fast law  
That You once spoke on Sinai for men's  
awe.  
By those tests he is one of righteous paw.

24 But in those days, after that time  
Of great affliction, the sun's climb  
Will be made dark, and the moon's light

Will never then come into sight.  
25 The stars of heaven will fall down right,  
The powers of heavens shaken with might.  
26 And then they'll see the son of man  
Come in might and glory clouds' span.

The sun has been darkened now more than  
once  
Since Jesus was killed and the Roman  
dunce  
Sat there beneath the cross to cast his lots.  
The moon has been divided and made clots  
Of blood, and the stars fell like rain, and  
yet  
Your sent one on the clouds has not been  
met.

I'll not be of the faithless who cry woe,  
The coming of Your Christ is something  
slow.  
Beloved, I wait the falling of the stars,  
The darkening of sun, the bronze-like bars  
Upon the moon to usher in the news  
That Your Messiah comes with angel  
crews.  
Until then I cry more for justice here  
Than looking for the future without fear.

27 And then he'll send his angels and  
Will gather his chosen in band  
From the four winds, from the earth's end  
To the end of the sky to bend.  
28 And from the fig tree learn the tale.  
When its branch is tender and hale  
To put out leaves, then you all know  
The summer is coming to glow.  
29 So you also, when you see these  
Things happening, know its decrees  
Are near and at the doors appease.  
30 I tell you truly, not at all  
Will this generation in call  
Pass out until all these things come  
Upon the world to sing and hum.  
31 The heaven and earth will pass away,  
But my words will not go astray.

Each prophet who predicts the end of time  
Upon a generation come to climb  
Is shown wrong by the course of history.  
To me that is an ample mystery.  
Of course the grand destruction of the state  
Under the Romans was the city's fate  
Within the generation not too late,

And only forty years there intervened  
Until the horrors fell down and careened.  
Beloved, I make predictions week by week  
That this next Sabbath is the one I seek  
To end the war of seeming and of rail  
And usher in a new day on the pale.  
One day that generation too will fail.

32 But of that day and hour no man  
Knows, not the angels under span  
Of heaven, nor the son himself, but  
The Father only keeps it shut.  
33 So watch and wake and pray, for you  
Do not know when the time is due.  
34 As a man goes away and leaves  
His house under hand of his slaves,  
And to each work appointedly,  
Commanding the doorkeeper, see,  
35 So watch, for you do not know when  
The lord of the house come again,  
At evening or midnight or at  
The time of cockcrow, or dawn set,  
36 So he may not come suddenly  
And find you sleeping cravenly.  
37 And what I say to you, I say  
To all. Watch, and watch in the way!

If Jesus is God Almighty, I'd think  
That he would know the times upon the  
brink.  
But he does not. The reason's clear to see:  
You did not tell the man in secrecy.  
All that Jesus has depends on Your grace,  
And in that he is like the human race.  
The word the rises to create, sustain  
The universe and fall to help the pain  
Of Jesus may well not be thing created.  
But the incarnation of it elated  
Is still the flesh of soil and sod and bone.  
You, my Beloved, You are a God alone.  
Let Jesus be the first of angels and  
Of men, but You alone have divine hand.

#### Mark 14

1 It was the Passover, and Feast  
Of Unleavened Bread as released  
After two days. And the chief priests  
And the scribes sought how, at the feasts,  
They might arrest him secretly  
And have him killed *by Roman spree*.  
2 But they said, "Not during the Feast,  
Lest the mob make trouble increased.

Whether for fear of trouble or the eye  
To desecration of the holy sky,  
The fond establishment would carefully  
Make human sacrifice without a spree.  
The attitude is still around today  
Where every man and woman comes to  
pray  
Before the sacred tent and see the host  
Raised in sublime worshipfulness for toast.  
Beloved, I have not come here so to boast.  
My eye is not on feasts nor fasts to find  
The way to Your heart though my eye is  
blind.  
Instead I leave the bread, the heaven too,  
And flee from all faith to come back to  
You,  
Unchastened and unchastened at the view.

3 And he being in Bethany  
In the house of Simon the leper,  
As he lay there, a woman, see,  
With alabaster pot to pep her  
Filled with pure and costly nard's ointment.  
She broke the stone vial by appointment  
And poured it on his head *to help her*.  
4 And some were outraged in their hearts  
And said "What a waste in these parts  
Of ointment! 5 "For this could be sold  
For three hundred dinars cash cold,  
And be given to the poor's fold."  
And they were angry with her arts.  
6 But Jesus said "Leave her alone.  
Why do you make her sad and groan?  
She's done a good work here for me.  
7 "You have the poor eternally,  
And when you will, you can make free  
To help them. But you do not get  
To be always with me as pet.  
8 "What this one intended, she did.  
She took beforehand what she hid  
Anointing my body at last  
Before the grave where it is cast.  
9 "Truly I tell you, where indeed  
This gospel is proclaimed to feed  
In all the world, what this one did  
Will be spoken of too in bid  
Of a remembrance of her *need*."

I pour the ointment out in wasteful draught,  
Beloved, instead of giving the alms sought  
By the oppressed and drunken in the plot.

The tonnes of child that die each day  
 without  
 My aid or help of others in the pout  
 Might stay my hand, but no, I raise no  
 doubt,  
 But still keep at my writing without shout.  
 One day, Beloved, You'll stop me, I'll be  
 caught.  
 Then in surprise perhaps or fearful hush  
 I'll hear Your proclamation in a rush,  
 Either to condone my lack in the bray,  
 Or offer me the glories of Your day.  
 In either case, Beloved, I bow to pray  
 To You alone while others die away.

10 And Judas Iscariot, one  
 Of the twelve, went away and spun  
 To the chief priests, so he'd betray  
 Him to them *for truth or in play*.  
 11 When they heard they were glad to give  
 In promise silver for his sieve.  
 And he looked for a chance to come  
 To betray him for just that sum.

When Judas saw the waste of fine perfume  
 Poured all at once on Jesus, he would  
 groom  
 Until he had recuperated all  
 The silver that such a bottle and tall  
 Was worth to give to the poor wherewithal.  
 It was his concern for the poor that made  
 Good Judas come out to the world's parade  
 As a betrayer of the divine braid.  
 Beloved, go easy on the man who stayed  
 To think about the poor and reprimand  
 A woman for her wastefulness in hand.  
 It was a lesson taught that still may stand.  
 The poor are with us yet, and men as well  
 As women buy perfumes to beat the bell.

12 On first day of Unleavened Bread,  
 When they'd killed the Passover *spread*,  
 His disciples asked him, "Where do  
 You want to make Passover *due*?"  
 13 He sent two disciples and said  
 To them, "Go in the town *as led*  
 And you'll meet a man in whose hand  
 A pot of water comes *to stand*.  
 Follow him to see where he planned.  
 14 "And wherever he goes in, say  
 To the house owner *as for pay*,  
 'Where is the guestroom where I may,'

Says the teacher, 'come in to eat  
 Passover with my friends *in treat*.'  
 15 "And he'll show you an upper room  
 Of great size, spread, prepared *to boom*.  
 Set up for us there *in the gloom*."  
 16 And his disciples went and came  
 Into the town and found the same  
 As he had told them. They prepared  
 The Passover. 17 When evening bared,  
 He entered with the twelve who came.  
 18 As they lay eating, Jesus said  
 "Truly I tell you, one of you  
 Will betray me, one eating too  
 With me *at the same plate of brew*."  
 19 They were offended at the word  
 And starting saying as each stirred  
 "It is not I indeed, is it?"  
 And each one replied in like wit.

The friends of Jesus need not have returned  
 A question for the information spurned.  
 Each one knew in his heart what he had  
 learned  
 Of self-betrayal by temptations earned.  
 It was a hypocritical device  
 To ask whether Jesus thought each one  
 nice.  
 Each knew of such betrayals that the past  
 Had produced in each life as like to last.  
 And last indeed they did, when each man  
 fled  
 To hiding among the night's black and red.  
 Beloved, I too join in the throng to say  
 I shall not come to You another day  
 With words and actions, deeds that would  
 betray.  
 I join Jesus' disciples as they pray.

20 But answering, he said to them,  
 "It is one from the twelve in hem,  
 The one dipping into the dish  
 With me *as if to find a fish*.  
 21 "The son of man goes true as it  
 Has been concerning him in writ,  
 But woe to that man through whom stayed  
 The son of man to be betrayed!  
 It would be better for him if  
 He never had been born *a stiff*."  
 22 As they were eating, Jesus took  
 A loaf and blessed it, broke and look  
 He gave it to them, and he said  
 "Take, eat, this is my body spread."

23 He took the cup and gave thanks too  
 And gave to each of them the brew,  
 And they all drank some of it too.  
 24 And he said to them, "Here's my blood  
 Of the new covenant in flood  
 Poured out for many *in the mud*.  
 25 "Indeed I tell you, nevermore  
 May I drink of the vine in store  
 Until the day I drink it new  
 In God's kingdom *set down with you*."  
 26 They sang a hymn and they went out  
 To the mount of Olives *with shout*.

It says a hymn, but that hymn was not  
 made  
 By Fanny Crosby in Christian charade.  
 It was the great Hallel set down in Psalms.  
 So this is no excuse for Christian qualms  
 In singing from the sacred book alone.  
 But many love the sensuous in tone,  
 The wail of heathen worship on the hill,  
 Gyration of sex rhythms to the fill.  
 They sang a Psalm, no hymn created by  
 A monk or priest or presbyter in sly.  
 Beloved, I sing my Psalm each day and  
 find  
 That I am drawn to Your heart from the  
 blind  
 To waste no breath in blasphemies unkind.  
 You know what's needed to free and to  
 bind.

27 Jesus told them, "All of you'll be  
 Offended now tonight in me,  
 Because it has been written 'I  
 Will strike the shepherd, and the sheep  
 Will be scattered *out of the heap*.'

When Zechariah wrote those words I know  
 He did not have the faintest hope or show  
 That centuries would pass till long ago  
 A sect of Jews would take each word and  
 slow  
 And pattern the details of life to know  
 According to the choice of words that glow  
 In the Tanach. Beloved, it's a conceit,  
 But lovely in its way, and truly meet.  
 Let me find the days of my life in choice  
 Enacted by my hearing of Your voice.  
 Let me like Jesus and his friends make  
 known

In act and deed the things prophets have  
 shown.  
 And I shall live in peace beneath the grove  
 Of pine and birch to feed my winter stove.

28 "After my resurrection, I'll  
 Prevent you to Galilee's smile."  
 29 But Peter said to him, "If all  
 Stumble, yet I will never fall."  
 30 And Jesus said to him, "Truly  
 I say to you now tonight see  
 Before a cock crows twice you will  
 Deny me three times *to your fill*."  
 31 But he said more vehemently,  
 "If I must die with you, I'll not  
 Deny you ever *in the plot*."  
 And all the rest agreed, the lot.  
 32 They came to a place that was called  
 Gethsemane *by shorn and bald*.  
 He said to his disciples there,  
 "Sit here while I engage in prayer."  
 33 He took along Peter and James  
 And John with him to see the games.  
 And he was sore distressed indeed.  
 34 He said to them, "My soul in need  
 Is deeply grieved, as unto death.  
 Stay here and watch and take a breath."  
 35 He went a little way on then  
 And fell upon the ground again  
 And prayed if it could be this hour  
 Might pass from him, *bitter and sour*.  
 36 And he said "Abba, Father, all  
 Things are possible from Your stall,  
 Take this cup from me, yet not what  
 I want but what You want *to shut*."

When there's a choice or seems to be a  
 choice,  
 The soul draws back from death and to  
 rejoice.  
 For man's redemption it is said he came  
 As far as where the lost were in the flame  
 To give a helping hand. But at the brook  
 He cast a fearing glance and backward  
 look.  
 What all men have to taste of death and rue  
 He found nearly too heavy for his stew.  
 Beloved, You live on high, You do not  
 know  
 The trial of the human way I go.  
 But if You take a look at Jesus' show,

You'll see what all men face in death's red glow.

More courage than the angels' of Your power  
Is found in human heart, in human flower.

37 He came and found them fast asleep,  
And asked Peter, "Simon asleep,  
Could you not watch an hour and keep?"

38 "But watch and pray, so that you may  
Not enter in temptation's way.

The spirit's willing, but the flesh  
Is weak *before temptations fresh.*"

39 He went away again and prayed,  
Saying the same things as waylaid.

40 He then came back and found again  
A little group of sleepy men.

And they had no answer in den.

41 And He came a third time, and said  
To them, "Sleep on now, in rest led.

It is enough. The hour has come.

See, son of man's betrayed by bum  
Into the power of sinners' drum.

42 "Get up and go. See, the one who  
Betrays me has come near *with crew.*"

43 And straight away as he yet spoke,  
Judas comes up, being a bloke  
Of the twelve. And with him a great  
Multitude came with swords and hate  
From the chief priests, and scribes, and old.

44 And the betrayer was so bold

To give a sign, saying "The one  
I kiss is he, take him and lead  
Him off *in safety and in speed.*"

45 He came and straight away drew near  
And said "Rabbi, Rabbi *my dear*"  
And kissed him in greeting *with tear.*

Kiss of betrayal is no rarity.

It's more common today in every tree  
Than in days when it was less mockery  
To place a blade in back literally.

I've been kissed by the members of each  
church

I've entered to leave me out in the lurch.

Kiss me, Beloved, betraying to Your way  
And so take me from out of foreign pay.

The solitary road of Your command

Is sweet to me, though dark before the band  
Of Roman cohort here to rule the land.

Beloved, I touch the night dews and return  
To my own fire and hearth to see them burn

In peace with sacrifice of life and urn.

46 And they laid their hands on Him and  
They seized him *working by command.*

47 But one of those who still stood by  
Took out his sword and was not shy  
To strike the high priest's servant's ear  
And cut the thing off clean and sheer.

48 And in response Jesus told them,  
"Have you come out with sword and hem  
To take me like a robber gem?"

49 "I was with you daily to teach  
In the temple, but you'd not reach  
Me there. But it is what was writ

That is fulfilled *and so made fit.*"

50 And leaving Him, all fled *to wit.*

51 One certain young man followed him  
With a linen cloth thrown as trim  
Around his naked body grim.

Then the young men grabbed him in wrath.

52 But he forsook the linen cloth  
And fled nude from them *life and limb.*

Mark makes a habit of appearing nude.

For him I guess it is not something rude.

For most who read his book, the tried and  
prude,

It is a thing he never ought to doed.

I too am naked as I come by night

And day in secret to imbibe the light

Of truth from Your sent one hidden from  
sight.

Like Adam and like Eve before the fall,

Mark and I come unashamed to the ball.

The secret teaching set out for the few,

The ones who leave all masks and things to  
do,

The vulnerable in their hermitage,

Is never lost but goes on age to age.

It's still found shining on Mount Sinai's  
page.

53 And they led Jesus away to  
The high priest. All the chief priests' crew  
And elders and scribes came there too.

54 And Peter followed him afar,

Into the inner court of star

High priest. And he was sitting there

With the under officers' share,

Warming himself by light and fire.

55 And the chief priests and the whole lot  
Of the Sanhedrin witness sought

Against Jesus, to sentence death.  
 And they found just a waste of breath.  
 56 For many falsely testified  
 Against Him, but the witness pried  
 Was not consistent on that side.  
 57 And standing up, some testified  
 Falsely against Him, saying 58 "We  
 Heard him saying, 'I'll throw this wee  
 Temple down that is made with hands,  
 And in three days I'll build *on sands*  
 Another one not made with hands."  
 59 But their witness was also not  
 Consistent with each other's plot.

Each witness that men make against Your  
 law,  
 Beloved, is made with hand honed to a  
 claw.  
 The reason and the understanding wake  
 Only when Your obedience sets the stake.  
 One must obey first to have decent sense.  
 The contemplation of Your law for pence  
 Of how to circumvent the duty draws  
 Only the bloodstains on undutied claws.  
 Beloved, give me three days or not to show  
 The soul within the testament in glow,  
 The glory of Adam and Vatos till  
 The weeks pass on beneath the clouded  
 hill.  
 I climb my Sinais ever and anon  
 And meet the hope in desperation's dawn.

60 The high priest stood in midst of them  
 And questioned Jesus, spoke in hem,  
 "Do you not answer? Nothing said?  
 What all these witnesses have spread?"  
 61 But He was silent and replied  
 Not a word at all on his side.  
 Again the high priest questioned him,  
 And asked him, "Are you the Christ's  
 whim,  
 The son of the Blessed and grim?"  
 62 And Jesus said, "I am. And you  
 Will see the son of man in view  
 Seated by the right hand of power  
 And coming in the clouds an hour."  
 63 The high priest ripped his robe and said,  
 "Why do we still need witness spread?"  
 64 "You heard the blasphemy. Now what  
 Does it seem to you in the gut?"  
 And they then judged him guilty, but  
 Guilty even to death to cut.

65 And some began to spit at him,  
 And cover his face, and as grim  
 To beat him with a fist and say  
 "Now prophesy!" and those in sway  
 Struck him and slapped him in their way.

According to what Mark heard of that night  
 And what he saw before the coming light,  
 The sent one caught by the police and hand  
 Of church said nothing to that wicked band.  
 It is a true thing, no one should reply  
 To questions asked by governmently guy,  
 For he is there merely to give the call  
 Of their protection to those who appal.  
 Beloved, Your sent one reached the height  
 of fame  
 And wisdom in that he said nary claim,  
 In silence listened to the clamour's shame,  
 And let the theologians play their game.  
 After the ranting of the unbrave I  
 Expect they always turn a punch and die.

66 And Peter being in the court  
 Below, one of the high priest's *short*  
 Maids came along *for fun and sport*.  
 67 And seeing Peter warming there,  
 Looked at him and she told her share,  
 "You were with Jesus Nazarene."  
 68 But he denied, and said on scene,  
 "I do not know nor understand  
 What you are saying out of hand."  
 And he went out to the forecourt.  
 And a cock crowed *to see the sport*.  
 69 And seeing him again, the maid  
 Began to tell those on parade,  
 "This man is one of them who stayed."  
 70 But he denied it once again.  
 And after a while those in pen  
 Said to Peter, "The thing is true,  
 You are of them, you're of the crew  
 Of Galilee in speech and dress."  
 71 But he began to curse a mess,  
 "I don't know this man in duress."  
 72 A second time a cock crowed and  
 Peter remembered Jesus' stand  
 To him, "Before a cock crows twice,  
 You will have denied me here thrice."  
 To think of it he wept *as banned*.

Peter might never have known the deep  
 dark  
 Of his own heart but for the flash and spark



Of a maid in employ come to the park.  
The humble often turn the page and stare  
Upon the awful things once written there,  
The secrets unknown to one's own heart  
where

The din of worship fails to lay them bare.  
Peter might never have known his dark  
night

Of soul without the rude and bawdy slight  
Of one snapping her bubblegum in play,  
Her insolence not fit for light of day.  
Beloved, so many people come to be  
In Your employ and measure out the fee  
Before the dawning of eternity.

### Mark 15

1 Straightway on the morrow the chief  
Priests with elders and scribes' relief  
And all the Sanhedrin together  
Bound Jesus and led him off whether  
To hand him over to Pilate.

2 And Pilate questioned him in state,  
"Are you the king of the Jews, mate?"  
And answering, he said to him,  
"That's what you say, *be truth or dim.*"

3 The chief priests brought strong  
accusations

Against him for many things' rations.  
But he did not answer in trim.

4 But Pilate questioned him and said  
"Do you not answer them instead?  
See how many things they bear witness  
Against you, *is it not a fitness?*"

5 But Jesus answered not at all,  
So Pilate marvelled at the call.

6 And at a feast, he oft released  
To them one prisoner increased,  
Whomever they asked for *as fleeced.*

7 And there was one called Barabbas,  
Taken up with the rebels' class,  
Who in the insurrection had  
Killed a man, *a thing which was bad.*

Just watch what the best of men and most  
just

In Roman employ will do in the dust.  
He has the choice to release one he finds  
Without fault or another to their minds  
Who has committed murder on the way.  
There is no question who will hit the hay.  
In every time and place You can be sure  
That where the government hands in a cure

They'll praise the murderers and set the  
dogs

Upon the innocent who clog the cogs.  
It takes a special sort of man to be  
Just before the fell opportunity  
To set the power of self and state above  
You and Your laws, Your justice and Your  
love.

8 And crying aloud, the crowd started  
To ask him to do as imparted

Always before. 9 But Pilate said  
To them in answer of their spread,  
"Do you want me to give you back  
The king of the Jews without slack?"

10 For he knew that the chief priests had  
Delivered him through envy *sad.*

11 But the chief priests stirred up the  
crowd,

That rather he should set allowed  
Barabbas to them *as endowed.*

12 But answering again, Pilate said  
To them, "What do you want instead  
That I should do to him whom you  
Call sovereign monarch of the Jew?"

13 Again they cried out *suddenly,*  
"Crucify Him *and by decree!*"

14 But Pilate said to them, "For what  
Evil did He do?" But they strut  
And cry the more, "Crucify him!"

15 Then Pilate decided *as dim*  
To do the easy thing *and trim*  
For the crowd. So he had him beaten,  
Delivered up Jesus to sweeten  
The torture stake *or cross as meeten.*

The ruler ages past was one who knew  
The culture and the literature of few,  
And was fastidious in his design.  
Such kings today are rare, and so we pine.  
It's priests who egg the masses to revolt  
Against Your word and law and act the  
dolt.

The crowd is after drink and tart and pussy,  
Not caring much for blood and gore and  
mussy.

Beloved, if You would just remove the  
priests,

The populace would get on with their feasts  
And only take occasional relief  
In murder or in stealing to their grief.

The crowd clamours for what the newsmen  
say,  
Those priests and priestesses of modern  
day.

16 And the soldiers led him away  
Inside the court, praetorium's sway,  
And called the whole cohort *to bray*.  
17 And they put purple on him, and  
They plaited and placed a crown band  
Of thorns on him. 18 And they began  
To greet him, "Hail, king of the Jews!"  
19 And they struck his head with a span,  
And spat at him. And on knees' ruse  
They bowed to him each one to choose.  
20 And when they'd mocked him, they  
took off  
The purple and put what he'd doff  
Of his own clothing, led him out  
To crucify him *with a shout*.

When Pilate gave the man over to be  
Crucified, he let soldiers in their glee  
Do what they will. It's no excuse to see  
We must follow our orders in the spree.  
The soldiers could have comforted him and  
Given him the best in a troubled land,  
A ride out to the execution hill,  
A last meal and a comfort for the bill.  
But no, their orders were at last to kill,  
And so they showed their relish with a will.  
Beloved, the common soldier in the track  
Is just as guilty as commander's flack,  
And so deserve Your judgement for the  
slack.  
There are so many common soldiers still.

21 And they forced one there passing by,  
Simon, a Cyrenian, come nigh  
From a field, Alexander's dad  
And Rufus's, to carry clad  
The cross. 22 And they brought him out to  
Golgotha, which translated to  
Place of a Skull *based on its view*.  
23 And they gave Him wine spiced with  
myrrh  
To drink. But he'd not drink the stir.  
24 They crucified him and divided  
His clothing, casting lots provided  
For whom and what each one should take.  
25 And it was the third hour at stake  
They crucified him as decided.

26 And the inscription of His charge  
Was written over Him quite large,  
THE KING OF THE JEWS *the words*  
*chided*.

27 They crucified two robbers too,  
One on the right and one in view  
Upon the left hand of him too.  
28 The Scripture was fulfilled which says,  
"He was counted with lawless strays."

They say the odds the prophecies by sleight  
Of chance fulfilling in the dark of night  
Are so slim that they could not meet the  
past.

Abuse of such statistics is a blast.  
What happens is not chance in any case,  
But the reality of trebled bass,  
And chance that it were different is the  
more

Than calculations of the sandy shore.  
But that one thrust onto the torture stake  
Would meet there others in same sort of  
make

Is no chance nor fulfilment in the least.  
There's always food and drink at every  
feast.

So he was counted with wicked increased,  
And left to drink the bitter, eat the cake.

29 And those passing by blasphemed him,  
Shaking their heads, and saying *grim*,  
"Aha! You tear the temple down  
And build it in three days' *renown*."

30 "So save Yourself then and come down  
From the cross, *do not fear a frown*."

31 And also the chief priests and scribes  
Mocking each with their diatribes  
Also said "He saved other men,  
He cannot save himself again.

32 "The Christ, the king of Israel?  
Let him now come down from the *fell*  
Cross, that we may see and believe."

And the two crucified on sleeve  
With him defamed him too *to grieve*.

33 It happened the sixth hour that dark  
Came over all the land and park  
Until the ninth hour, *it was stark*.

34 And at the ninth hour Jesus cried  
With a loud voice, saying beside,  
"Eloi, Eloi, lama" *he cried*  
"Sabachthani?" (Which translated  
Is "My God, my God, why now did

You forsake me?") 35 And hearing, some  
Of those standing by said *as dumb*,  
"See, he calls on Elijah's bum."

After the centuries of Christian state  
With Psalter sung by every nun and mate,  
You'd think a Jew in the first century  
Would recognize the Psalms in treasury  
Even in Aramaic targum's trace,  
If not the Hebrew of David's own race.  
That only shows that Jesus and his men  
Were house of David people in their glen,  
And not the run of fill of Jewish class  
That stuck to the Siddur or that day's brass.  
I follow Jesus on the cross or in  
His flight from the establishment of din,  
And stay reciting ever and anon  
The Psalter at the evening and the dawn.

36 One ran up with a sponge in treat  
Filled with vinegar on the seat  
Of a reed to give him to drink.  
But they said "Leave the man alone.  
Let's see if Elijah from throne  
Comes to take him down *with a groan*."  
37 And letting out a horrid cry,  
Jesus then at last came to die.  
38 And the veil of the Holy Place  
Was torn in two from the top brace  
To bottom. 39 And standing nearby  
And seeing when he came to die  
How he gave up that awful cry,  
The centurion said "Truly,  
This Man was God's own son to be."

The cry is what convinced centurion.  
Not silence before accusation done,  
Not patience under threat and lash to stun,  
Not groaning at the thrust of nail and stake,  
But the loud cry he made last for Your  
sake.

I ponder what that could mean in the way  
Of soldiers so accustomed to the bray  
Of dying men. What did he hear so new  
And different from the run and rill as true?  
Beloved, I cannot know. I was not there.  
I have no death cries round me for  
compare.

I trust it was not sound of pain, despair  
Or even victory against the air.  
What was the testimony of the fair?

40 The women also watching from  
A distance, among whom in sum  
Was also Mary Magdalene,  
Also Mary mother of James  
The less, and of Josies in claims,  
And Salome *before the scene*,  
41 Who also followed him and served  
Him when he was in Galilee,  
And many women who'd not swerved  
From coming to Jerusalem.

So many women in the course of things  
Suggest one of two prospects in the wings.  
Either the man was free meat for the stings  
Of marriage and these flies in their  
buzzings

Where hopeful of the marriage cup or then  
The man was married to bevvies in pen.  
Jesus decries the Jewish law in fact,  
But would outright polygamy attract?  
Perhaps it was a case of Shi'ite lore,  
The temporary marriage at the door.  
Beloved, he was tempted here like all men,  
So whether or not these women again  
Were wives or concubines, one thing I  
know,  
They were a great temptation in a row.

42 It became evening already,  
Since it was preparation's hem,  
The day before the Sabbath gem,  
43 Joseph of Arimathea  
Came, an honourable councillor,  
Who himself also waited for  
The kingdom of God. And he took  
Courage, and he went in to brook  
With Pilate and begged to receive  
The body of Jesus to grieve.  
44 And Pilate marvelled if he had  
Already died. And so the cad  
Summoned the centurion and  
Asked him if he'd already panned.  
45 When the centurion told him,  
He granted Joseph the bod grim.  
46 And having bought a linen shroud,  
And taken him down as allowed,  
He wrapped him in the linen, and  
Laid him in a tomb by command  
Cut out of rock. He rolled a stone  
Against the mouth of the tomb sown.  
47 And Mary Magdalene, and Mary  
Of Josies, saw where they would carry

Him and lay him in the tomb chary.

The act of Joseph is an act not proud,  
And one that inspires men to think aloud,  
And wonder what became of him at last,  
The faithful councillor taught by the past.  
If he went on to Britain as is said,  
He took the memory with him of that bed.  
If he lived to doubt not or hope a shred,  
It is a thing to wonder where he's led.  
Beloved, I'm no disciple of the twelve,  
I'm no scholar of Scripture's dig and delve,  
I'm not a councillor among the great,  
But I do bring Your sent one in his state  
To bury him within my heart not late  
To praise him for his part in my own fate.

### Mark 16

1 The Sabbath past, Mary the Mag-  
dalene *who was no man in drag*,  
And Mary mother of James and  
Salome, bought spices in hand,  
And coming to anoint his stand.  
2 And very early on the first  
Day of the week, the sun had burst,  
When they came to the tomb *uncursed*.

This verse of love and life and song,  
This phrase of light before the wrong,  
Is taken by the hard of heart  
To argue for the Sabbath's part.  
The words may seem strange in the Greek,  
And how they express day and week,  
But is the kernel not, Beloved,  
Rather bare-handed and ungloved,  
That the tomb was found empty then,  
A wonder and grace to all men?  
Beloved, I tread the path I find  
Of Scripture daring to the blind  
And live to thank you for the sound  
That Your sent one did tread the ground.

3 And they said to themselves, "Who will  
Roll the stone away from the sill  
Of tomb for us, *we've got no drill*."  
4 And when they looked, they saw the  
stone  
Had been rolled back, for it was grown  
Too large to *dislodge with a bone*.  
5 And having entered in the tomb,  
They saw a young man in the gloom  
Sitting on the right, being dressed

In a white robe. And they confessed  
*Amazement at the turn of doom*.  
6 But he said to them, "Do not be  
Amazed. You seek Jesus freely  
The Nazarene, one crucified.  
He was raised. He's not here beside.  
See the place where they made him bide?  
7 "But go tell the disciples wide  
And Peter that he goes before  
You into Galilean shore.  
And you will find him there indeed,  
Just as he told you *in his speed*."  
8 They quickly fled the tomb to fall  
Into trembling ecstasy's thrall.  
And they told no one, because they  
Were held in trepidation's sway.

The failure to tell made no difference then.  
No one believed the word of greater men  
And women. So the angel's message lay  
Dormant before the women turned away.  
I fail to give the word that he arose,  
And there's no difference for my lack that  
grows.  
Each Easter morning and all through the  
year  
The Orthodox, both men and children's  
cheer  
As well as women, raise the praise in voice,  
The Lord's arisen is their theme of choice.  
Indeed, he's risen is the answer that  
Returns the joy. I remain on my mat  
In doubt or faith, in joy of solitude,  
Sometimes polite and silent, sometimes  
rude.

9 And having risen early on  
The first day toward the Sabbath drawn,  
He first appeared to Mary the  
Magdalene, and from whom once he  
Had cast out seven demons wee.  
10 She went and told it to his friends  
Mourning and weeping *without ends*.  
11 They heard that he was then alive,  
And had been seen by her *to grieve*,  
They did not believe *to deprive*.  
12 And after these things, He appeared  
In different ways to two who feared  
Not to go walking in the land.  
13 Those ones left to report the thing  
To the rest, but they in their fling  
Still did not believe anything.

14 Afterward, as they lay to eat,  
He appeared to eleven's seat,  
Reproached their unbelief and more  
The hardness of their heart before,  
Since they did not believe the word  
Of those who had seen him *and heard*,  
Since he was raised up *like a bird*.  
15 He said to them, "Go out into  
All the world preaching gospel true  
To all creation in their due.

I've preached the Gospel word to many  
men  
And women decked out before me in den,  
And found that they more often could not  
set

Their unbelief aside when we both met.  
I've preached the Gospel word in many  
lands,

In many languages upon the sands  
Of every continent across the globe,  
Without success and reason left to probe.  
I've preached the Gospel to the birds alone,  
To little creatures sitting on a stone,  
And whether they believed or not, I saw  
Them run away with scratch of beak and  
claw.

Beloved, if You gave me the task to preach,  
You also put all creatures out of reach.

16 "The one who believes and is dunked  
In water will be saved when plunked.  
And the one who does not believe  
Will not be saved, without reprieve.  
17 "And signs miraculous will follow  
After believers in this wallow.

They'll cast out demon in my name,  
And speak new languages for fame;  
18 They will handle serpents safe and  
If they drink any poison band,  
It will not hurt them *where they stand*;  
They'll lay hands on the sick and they  
Will be well *when they fast and pray*."

19 Indeed, after he spoke to them,  
The Lord was taken from their hem  
Up into heaven to sit upon  
The right hand of Alohim drawn.  
20 And they went out and preached around  
And the Lord worked through them in  
sound

Where signs miraculous abound. Amen.

Although I do covet the gift to heal  
The sufferings that around me still appeal,  
I do not wish on myself such a gift  
As when I see a serpent for a lift  
To grab it by the tail as Moses did,  
Or drink the poison bottle without lid.  
I'm glad I did not live in that far day  
Among that group of his disciples' sway  
Who had to perform such things in their  
way.

Beloved, I'm well content here in my nest  
Of sour grapes when I proclaim I am  
blessed,  
Awaiting the return of Jesus best  
Beneath the sunset on the lake to west.

### The Gospel According to Luke

Luke here denies the thought that I would  
take,  
That Gospels were first oral in the wake  
Of fast events, and only later on  
Did some few gather sayings, draw upon  
Faint memories and rumours and relate  
The stories of the Christ that had come late.  
Instead he refers to the many who  
Have written down the record of the true.  
As a text ancient among quite a few  
The Gospels seem to have firm evidence.  
Most have been discontinued from the  
fence,  
But Luke's words seem to give weight to  
the thought  
That many Gospels early traced the plot.  
Be that as may, I like the words a lot.

#### Luke 1

1 Since many took in hand to draw  
Up an account concerning a'  
The things that appeared in our awe,  
2 As those from the beginning gave  
To us, as eye-witness and slave  
To the Word, 3 it seemed good to me  
Also, having searched faithfully  
All things from the first, to write you  
In order, most excellent you,  
Theophilus, 4 so you may know  
The certainty of what things show  
Of what you have been made to know.

Theophilus is one unknown to me

Except by name, and so I would make free  
To guess the man loves You to some  
degree.

He has been taught that Jesus was a man  
Born long ago to live and die a span  
And be raised from the dead. I do not doubt  
The possibility of such a rout,  
Although I've never seen the thing take  
place.

The Tanakh has one or two in such grace.  
But if this one who loves You wants to  
know

The truth about the Christ from all the row  
Of many accounts, I applaud the go.  
But certainty is something beyond sight,  
Even with such a Gospel in the light.

5 In the days of Herod the king  
Of Judea, there came to sing  
A certain priest named Zachariah,  
Of the daily course of Abijah.  
And his wife was of Aaron's own  
Daughters, and her name, it was shown,  
Was Elisabeth, *not on throne*.

6 And they were both righteous before  
God, walking blameless in the score  
Of all ordinances and such  
Commandments of the Lord *to touch*.  
7 And no child was born to them, for  
Elizabath was barren sore.

And both were advanced in their days.

8 It happened in his serving ways  
As priest in order of his course  
Before God, 9 by custom perforce  
Of the priests, he went in to the  
Holy Place of the Lord freely,  
For Zacharias' lot to be

Was burning incense *faithfully*.

10 And all the multitude of folk  
Was praying outside at the stroke  
Of hour of incense *in the poke*.

This story ignores the complexities  
Of Judaism in those centuries.  
The people sweetly wait for the priest bent  
To burn the incense in the house he went.  
The prayers rise in communion to behold  
The unity of the folk in the fold.  
The truth is that the courses of the priests  
In those days followed two calendar feasts  
Conflicting and arousing hatred then.  
This story is of that faction of men

Who still accommodated to strong Rome  
Instead of relying on You and home.  
And yet You bless the priest and bless the  
prayers  
Of all the people praying unawares.

11 An angel of the Lord appeared  
To him, standing on the right *tiered*  
Of the altar of incense *geared*.

12 And seeing this, Zacharias  
Was troubled, fear fell on his muss.

13 But the angel said to him, "Do  
Not fear, Zacharias, in view  
Because your prayer was heard, and your  
Wife Elizabeth will be sure  
To bear a son to you, and you  
Shall call his name John, *that will do*.

14 "And he will be both joy and praise  
To you and many *in their days*  
Will rejoice at his birth *and ways*.

15 "For he'll be great in the Lord's eyes  
And he shall drink no wine nor *guise*  
Of strong drink. And he will be filled  
With holy spirit from *the guild*  
Of his mother's womb *to be wise*.

16 "And he'll turn many of the sons  
Of Israel to the Lord *who stuns*,  
Their Alohim *for their home runs*.

17" And he will go out before him  
In Elijah's spirit and vim

To turn the hearts of dads to sons,  
And disobedient ones to be  
Wise in justice and to make *free*  
A folk prepared for the Lord's *spree*."

In times past wine was not given to drink  
To Nazirites, what would the people think.  
But now the wine is cut off from the lips  
Of any holy one the angel skips.  
The minder of Samson brings well to mind  
The problem of sun worship in the bind.  
As Samson lived to destroy all that kind,  
John should also, I should not wonder now.  
He comes at the announcement made by  
prow

Of angel at the altar side somehow.  
And so without a word of conflict here,  
He denies Sadducean thought and gear.  
Beloved, I turn with John's command and  
seek

The wisdom and the justice of the meek.

18 And Zacharias to the angel,  
 “By what shall I know this *from vaingel*?  
 For I am old and my wife too  
 Is far advanced in her days’ due.”  
 19 The angel answered and told him,  
 “I’m Gabriel, who stands up trim  
 Before God, and I was sent here  
 To speak a message in your ear.  
 20 “See now, you’ll be silent and dumb  
 Until the day these things in sum  
 Take place, because you did not show  
 Belief in my words that will grow  
 True in their time to come below.”

The archangel called Gabriel himself  
 Is irritated by the word of elf  
 That hesitates to believe in the sum  
 Of what he in his brightness came to hum.  
 He does not stop considering a man  
 Might be overwhelmed by his height and  
 span.

He punishes the unbelief before  
 It raises a head up to window, door.  
 Beloved, I do well to rage at the man  
 Who disbelieves what I proclaim in plan,  
 Your oneness and Your sovereignty to  
 scan,  
 The truth that You’re reflected in the span  
 Of I-ness known to every human tan.  
 I punish them the very best I can.

21 The people waited Zacharias,  
 And wonder was kept him desirous  
 To stay in the temple to fire us.  
 22 But when he came out, he could not  
 Speak to them, and they knew his lot  
 Was to see a vision inside  
 The temple. And so then he tried  
 To make signs but could not abide.

How the folk knew the man had seen a  
 sight,  
 A vision in the temple and a light,  
 Is more than I can see, since he in spite  
 Of angel could not say a sentence right.  
 The folk are far too ready to believe  
 That visions are the fate and to receive  
 On the part of each priest who rends the air  
 With incense in the temple to beware.  
 Beloved, the folk are far too quick to take  
 The hesitation for mark of Your sake,  
 Just as the angel is too quick to make

A slight of an old man’s slow sort of gait.  
 I cry You justice on the priestly pate,  
 And restitution from the angel’s state.

23 It happened when his work was done,  
 He went to his house *for the fun*.  
 24 And after these days then his wife  
 Elizabeth conceived a life.  
 And she hid herself five months, saying  
 25 So has the Lord done not gainsaying  
 To me in the days in which He  
 Looked on me to take the degree  
 Of my reproach away in spe.

Which is a thing too easy for You here?  
 To make an older woman conceive dear,  
 Or make a young one still a virgin bear?  
 Nothing is too difficult for Your share.  
 If Isaac was born in a miracle,  
 The same is not too hard for You to pull  
 In John from his mum’s womb of years too  
 full.

If You can make two old women give birth,  
 Then making a young virgin in her worth  
 Conceive and bear a child, I dash the  
 thought  
 That the Greeks were too hasty when they  
 brought  
 A law against the claim the gods came  
 down

To sire all the men of Grecian renown.  
 Let me doubt or not, You know what’s in  
 town.

26 In the sixth month, the angel called  
 Gabriel was sent and installed  
 By God to Galilean town  
 Named Nazareth *for its renown*,  
 27 To a virgin who was engaged  
 To a man named Joseph *and paged*  
 Of David’s house. The virgins name  
 Was Mary, *and one to acclaim*.

The rulership of humankind You set  
 In righteousness, Beloved, is often met  
 In twelves and sevens, but the Zaydi style  
 Is that any descendant without guile  
 May be the one appointed, if he takes  
 Aggressive role to set up divine stakes.  
 It seems the principle that anyone  
 Of the house royal may act under sun  
 Is what Luke here envisages when done.

It is enough that Joseph is one of  
The house of David to gain of Your love.  
Beloved, I bear the twelve, the seven, and  
last

Follow Your great appointed in the blast,  
So long as he keeps Decalogue and fast.

28 And entering, the angel said  
To her, "Hail, one with grace to spread!  
The Lord is with you. You are blessed  
Above all women and the best."

29 And seeing this, she was disturbed  
At his word, and considered curbed  
What kind of greeting this might be.

30 And the angel said to her, "See,  
Do not fear, Mary, for you've found  
Favour from God *and all around*.

31 "And see, you will conceive in womb  
And bear a son, and one to bloom  
As you call him Jesus *for doom*.

32 "This One will be great and will be  
Called son of the Most High. And see,  
The Lord God will give Him the throne  
Of His father David alone.

33 "And He will reign over the seat  
Of Jacob forever and meet  
And his kingdom have no end *fleet*."

The promises to David I take well  
To heart as I look back on Israel,  
And on the state of this world turned to  
hell.

But if this Jesus did sit on the throne  
Forever, then I have to pick a bone.  
Fact is oppression by the Roman sort  
As multiplied across the global fort,  
And everywhere blood is not shed for sport  
The masses are kept as a market crew  
To buy the oil that makes the royal brew.  
I'm patient as I wait for hand to show  
That You still guide the plough upon the  
row,

But I raise up a witness so You'll know  
That we still need improvements here  
below.

34 But Mary told the angel, "How  
Will this be since I know no plough  
Of mankind?" 35 The angel replied  
To her, "The holy spirit guide  
Will come on you, the power and true  
Of the Most High will shadow you,

And that is why that holy one  
Born of you will be called God's son.

36 "And see, your kin Elizabeth!  
She's also conceived in the breath

Of her old age, a son, and this  
Is the sixth month for her to kiss  
Who was called barren, though amiss;

37 "For nothing is impossible  
For God in any trick to pull."

The pregnancy of good Elizabeth  
Served to give Mary confidence and breath  
Before the message that she would appear  
To give birth to a virgin without fear.  
There are many of heroes in the land  
Of Greece and Egypt and Chaldean band  
Who have for mother humankind and dad  
A god according to the stories sad.  
But virgin birth is a thing hardly known  
To any under David and his throne.  
And yet a virgin birth is no surprise  
Greater than normal conception in guise.  
Both are a thing I would not have invented  
If I had been You and never prevented.

38 And Mary said, "Behold, the slave  
Woman of the Lord! I am brave

To let it be to me by what  
You say." The angel left her rut.

39 And Mary got up at that time  
And went to the hill country's clime  
As fast as she could go into  
A city of Judah *in view*.

40 And she entered into the house  
Of Zacharias *and his spouse*  
And there greeted Elizabeth.

41 It happened, Elizabeth heard  
Mary's greeting, and the babe stirred  
In her womb, and Elizabeth  
Was filled up with the holy breath.

42 And she cried out with a loud voice  
And said, "You are blessed among choice  
Of women and blessed is the fruit  
Of your womb *to be born to boot!*

43 "And why is this to me the mum  
Of my Lord will to me here come?

44 "For see, as the sound of your word  
Came to my ear, the baby stirred  
In my womb in rejoicing heard.

45 "And blessed is her faith, because she  
Will see the finishing degree  
Of all the Lord spoke in decree."



Each woman who knows pregnancy knows  
well

The babe can move and even jump a spell,  
But that is not a prophecy to tell  
The neighbour woman has a finer son  
To be born six months later on the run.  
The prophecies are mystery to me,  
Irrational for all that I can see,  
And yet their word is full of poetry,  
Fine utterance penetrating bone to make  
A fire within the heart and for Your sake.  
Beloved, the prophecy of female speech  
From Hagar, Hannah, Deborah and the  
reach  
Of good Elizabeth, I take in store  
And read and hear their speaking all the  
more.

46 Mary said "My soul magnifies  
YHWH, 47 and my spirit *as it flies*  
Rejoices in God who's my Saviour.  
48 "For he's regarded the behaviour  
Of His maidservant in her state  
Of lowliness *and made her great*,  
Indeed, from now on all men will  
Call me blessed through the ages *still*.  
49 "For He who is mighty has done  
Great things for me *and great things won*,  
And holy *does* His name appear.  
50 "And His mercy's on those who fear  
Him from age to age. 51 "He has shown  
Strength with His arm, and He has *blown*  
*Out* scattering the proud *alone*  
In heart imagination *grown*.  
52 "He has put down the mighty from  
*Their* thrones, and made the lowly come  
Exalted. 53 "The hungry He's filled  
With good things, while the rich He's  
*billed*  
And sent them empty *all* away.  
54 "He has helped His servant *this day*  
Israel, minding *His* mercy's *sway*,  
55 "As He spoke to our fathers, to  
Abraham and his seed *on cue*. "  
56 And Mary remained with her for  
About three months, and to the door  
Of her own house returned, *what's more*.  
57 Now Elizabeth's full time came  
For her to be delivered *claim*,  
And she brought forth a son *to name*.  
58 When her neighbours and relatives

Heard how YHWH *without fugitives*  
Had shown great mercy to her, they  
Rejoiced with her *upon that day*.

The fervent prayers for offspring made the  
birth  
A joyous thing, thing infinite of worth  
For Sarah, the great paradigm of those  
Women who had no children though they  
chose.  
Elizabeth had prayed with tears for child,  
And like Hannah moved her lips undefiled  
In plaints and praises to Your name,  
Beloved,  
And found herself among the pushed and  
shoved.  
They still come to the tomb of Rachel  
crying,  
Then take their way, some comforted, some  
sighing.  
Sarah, Elizabeth share in the joy  
Of aging barren women who employ  
Surprising answers to their plaints and  
prayers.  
Beloved, the source of song is in their  
wares.

59 It happened on the eighth day they  
Came to circumcise in the way  
The child and called it by the name  
Of his father and by the fame  
Of Zacharias. 60 And his mum  
Replied and said "No way to hum,  
But he shall be called John to come."  
61 And they said to her, "None among  
Your relatives is called or sung  
By this name." 62 And they made signs to  
His father, what they ought to do.  
63 He asked for a slate and he wrote,  
Saying "John is his name to dote."  
And all were amazed at the view.  
64 And instantly his mouth was free  
And opened and his tongue's degree  
Was loosed, and he spoke, blessing God.  
65 Fear came on all those on the sod  
Around them. And in all the land  
Of Judea's hill country spanned  
All these things were discussed and  
scanned.

Some may presume that Zacharias spoke  
In tongues most marvellous under the yoke

Of holy spirit that after months broke  
 The angel barrier and came to stoke  
 The charismatic fervour of the folk.  
 But wait a moment, my Beloved, to hear  
 If he departs from what I have in ear  
 From Mary and Elizabeth in gear.  
 It seems the practice of those days was still  
 A living oral composition's bill,  
 And all could speak in wondered ecstasy  
 With borrowings of phrases in degree  
 From the pool of all sacred poetry:  
 Not glossalalia but mystery.

66 And all who heard laid them up in  
 Their hearts, saying, "What then will win  
 This child?" And the hand of the Lord  
 Was with him. 67 And his dad implored,  
 Zacharias, was filled up by  
 The holy spirit to prophesy,  
 Saying 68 "Blessed be the Lord, the God  
 Of Israel, because His rod  
 Has come to work redemption for  
 His people. 69 "And He raised in store  
 For us salvation's horn and sent  
 Into His servant David's tent.

The horn of our salvation in the tent  
 Of David is not visibly now sent  
 To rule the earth. Behind the scenes  
 perhaps  
 He does a few runs set in token laps,  
 But for the most part rebel reigns and lot  
 Of the oppressed makes gains and losses  
 caught.

The horn of our salvation on the tongue  
 Of Zacharias long ago is hung  
 With expectations of two thousand years  
 That are still in store and seen in arrears.  
 But I trust that Your guided ones of fate  
 See better than I every sort of state  
 And know when to put finger in and hate  
 Or love the ones who reign commensurate.

70 "Just as He promised through the word  
 Of His own holy prophets stirred  
 In ages past as it occurred  
 71 "Salvation from our enemies,  
 From the hand of all foes' decrees.  
 72 "To make mercy with our ancestors,  
 Minding His holy pact's sequesters,  
 73 "The oaths He swore to Abraham,  
 Our ancestor, to give a gram

74 "So we set free of enemies'  
 Hand to serve Him amply in ease,  
 75 "Consecrated and righteously  
 Before Him all the days we see.

This prophet Zacharias sees the promise  
 Of Your Messiah for each doubting

Thomas

As a salvation great from enemies,  
 The ones who overrun the land of ease  
 And make Jerusalem a place of blood.  
 He does not promise that where cows chew

cud

And shepherds come to bow with angel  
 eyes,

A babe should be born in such a disguise  
 That no kings fall down dead before his  
 sight,

And rise no greater rule of love and right.  
 John's dad predicts the glory and the fame  
 Of conquering Messiah in Your name.  
 We're waiting still, Beloved, the Crusades  
 do

Not answer in fulfilment of the view.

76 "And you, child, will be called to be  
 Prophet of the Most High, for you  
 Will go before the face of YHWH  
 To prepare His ways *well and true*,  
 77 "To give salvation's knowledge to  
 His people by remission of  
 Their sins, 78 "through the tender heart  
 love

Of our God, in which the dayspring  
 From on high will visit and bring  
 To us, 79 "to come to those sitting  
 In darkness and shadow of death,  
 To direct our feet *at a breath*  
 Into the way of peace *to ring*."  
 80 And the child grew, and became strong  
 In spirit. And he went along  
 In desert places till the day  
 He came to show Israel the way.

John came to show Israel the holy way,  
 The lighter path to the Messiah's sway,  
 But he himself is butchered by the fane,  
 Not long before this Christ went on to wane  
 Upon the crosses of the Romans lain.  
 But still no longer is the darkness set  
 About the minds of those who came and  
 met

John and Jesus, for both of them direct  
The feet into Islam's ways and select:  
The way of prayer and alms, of fasting  
bent,  
And pilgrimage to Your house or one lent.  
I too seek out the desert, whether where  
The lines of sand and heat lie on the air  
Or where saw-toothed horizon stretches  
there.

## Luke 2

1 In those days there came a decree  
From Caesar Augustus to be  
For all the world inhabited  
To become a registered kid.  
2 This registration first occurred  
Under Cyrenius as spurred  
The Syrian governor preferred.  
3 And all went to be registered,  
Each to his own city concurred.  
4 Joseph too went from Galilee,  
Out of Nazareth the city  
To Judea, to the city  
Of David now called Bethlehem,  
Because he was of David's hem  
And house and kith and kinshipry,  
5 To be registered with Mary,  
Who was his fiancée and she  
Was pregnant, *though virginally*.

Virginity of Mary is established  
At last by the Qur'an, though mainly  
fablified  
According to the Christians who reject  
Apocryphal in Gospels or neglect.  
All things are testified in golden writ,  
The record of each man in the house fit  
Of David or in every town to sit  
In Roman empire with a record knit  
To make taxation easier to draw  
Without the use of gunpowder and claw.  
Virginity's no miracle to help  
Mankind in rows of Rome's taxes on  
whelp.  
That's why I still spend counting of the lot  
A day each year as every man is taught.

6 And it happened as they were there,  
The days fulfilled for her to bear.  
7 And she bore her son, the first-born.  
And she wrapped him and to adorn  
Laid Him in the manger, because

There was no place in the inn's floors.

They should have called to make a  
reservation.

In my experience inns with elation  
Hold rooms till six or seven for a ration,  
And love to have guests pay of every  
nation.

If Joseph had just picked up phone and  
called  
The inn beforehand, they'd have been  
installed

In a place that was worth the money spent.  
Instead he neglected to pay the rent.  
Beloved, I praise all innkeepers I know,  
I'm saddened by the ill-fame of this show.  
But if Your sent one needs a place to lay  
His head now as he wonders earth astray,  
My breast is ready to take him and show  
The humble chamber of my heart to glow.

8 And shepherds were in the same land,  
Abiding in the fields there and  
Keeping watch on their flock by night.

9 And, see, an angel came in sight  
From the Lord to them. And the bright  
Glory of YHWH shone round about.  
And they feared with a fervent rout.

This Gospel's written more, I'd say to  
strike

Against the Sadducean sort of mike  
And support Pharisean doctrine of  
Angels and resurrections than lend glove  
To tales of Jesus in themselves in shove.  
More interest in polemics of that time  
Than in what church councils in poorer  
rhyme

Brought out to serve the populace for crime  
In creeds or iron and swords of the sublime.  
So angels showed themselves. That's proof  
enough

The Sadducees are wrong. For them that's  
tough.

No wonder they have disappeared along  
With the regime they fostered to their  
wrong.

Now we have a united Roman song.

10 The angel told them, "Do not fear.  
For, see, I proclaim good news here  
To you, a great joy, which will be

To all people, 11 “because you see  
Today a Saviour, Christ the Lord,  
Was born to you in David’s ward.  
12 “And this shall be a sign to you.  
You’ll find the babe wrapped up from  
view,

And lying in a manger too.”

13 And suddenly there came in view  
With the angel a multitude  
Of heavenly angels praising God  
And saying 14 “Glory to God in  
The highest, and peace on earth’s din,  
Good will among men *without sin*.”

If Christ is Lord or kyrios, I say,  
Does that mean he’s no longer in Your pay,  
But God Almighty set upon the shelf,  
Along with or in place of Your good self?  
Of course, if Christ is Lord, the word  
implies

More than it does in other texts it lies  
To adorn governors, centurions,  
And even wealthy businessmen in tons.  
The angels proclaim Islam on the earth,  
Which cannot be, if Jesus came in worth  
Of God Almighty, God the Son by birth.  
Since there’s no peace and even less Islam,  
Perhaps I can admit the Christian balm  
Blows up the concept of God like a psalm.

15 It happened as the angels left  
Departing into the sky cleft,  
The shepherds said each man to each,  
“Indeed, let’s go over the reach  
To Bethlehem, and see this thing  
That’s happened as the Lord did sing  
To us.” 16 They hurried off and came  
And sought out Mary *with acclaim*  
And Joseph, and the babe that lay  
There in the manger *on the hay*.

Beloved, I added this one word in print  
To Luke’s description of Christ with a glint  
Of concern that the many mangers set  
Around the world, some of them I have  
met,

At Christmas season all are filled with hay,  
While he forgot to mention it that day  
He wrote it down. I now contribute word  
Of hay to what was seen then and occurred.  
No manger’s worth its salt but what’s  
interred

In hay for feed to cows and sheep that  
stirred

About it with such neighings that are heard.  
Besides, I wanted Jesus where he lay  
To have something more comforting than  
plank.

It’s all right, Love, You do not need to  
thank.

17 They saw and broadcast publicly  
About the message they did see  
Spoken to them about this child.

18 And everyone that heard *unguiled*  
Was amazed by the things they heard  
Spoken by the shepherds *when stirred*.

19 And Mary kept all these words deep  
In her heart thinking *in her sleep*.

20 The shepherds returned, glorifying  
And praising God for all things vying  
Which they heard and saw, even what  
Was spoken to them *to the cut*.

21 And when eight days were done at last  
To circumcise the child and cast  
His name, they called him Jesus then,  
The name called by the angel when  
He came before he was conceived  
In the womb of his mum received.

The ones who claim that Jesus is their god,  
Or God the Son or Trinity with prod,  
Ought to consider that the circumcision  
Was performed on his penis with a vision.  
If he was God before that operation,  
Then he was God uncircumcised in station.  
If he was God, they cut some God off him  
And dropped it in the gutter for a whim.  
That piece that was cut off, now I ask still,  
If that ceased from god being on the hill,  
Or if it lies in solemn case to fill  
The service of an adoration’s bill.  
If some can worship the paten god cookie,  
Then why not also foreskin playing  
hookie?

The eighteen churches, some in Italy  
And some in France and others faithfully  
Around the European panoply,  
Have all lost their claims to the foreskin  
bought

In Palestine or given as gift sought  
Or by a miracle sent at the hand  
Of cantillating and angelic band.

Beloved, I seek the foreskin of Your son  
To worship since nothing else can be done  
Since You accepted such associate  
In Your divinity of Godly state.  
But none is left in any land to find.  
I must be satisfied to remain blind  
To others. To Your worship I'm resigned.

22 When the days of her purity  
By Moses' law were done, you see,  
They took him to Jerusalem  
To present him to the Lord's hem,  
23 As it is set down in the law  
Of the Lord: "Every male *with claw*  
That opens the womb shall be called  
The holy of the Lord installed."

24 And there to offer sacrifice  
According to that Lord's law's splice,  
A pair of turtledoves or two  
Nestlings of doves by the law due.

If Mary's conception's immaculate  
And she bore yet a child by virgin state,  
Then she should have brought no sacrifice  
here.

A sin offering, the one dove for her cheer,  
Is cancelled by her pure virginity.  
The burnt offering, the other in the spree,  
Is cancelled by immaculate to be.  
Luke does not seem to notice how the way  
He describes Jesus makes his form and pay  
An inconsistency on fortieth day.  
No dove was brought for me at all, my

Dear,  
Perhaps because there was no temple near.  
But I was brought up in Your love and fear,  
And Dad and Mum still hope I'll age with  
gear.

25 See, a man in Jerusalem  
Whose name was Simeon, a gem  
Of righteousness and so devout  
He eagerly expected clout  
Of Israel's consolation, and  
The holy spirit shook his hand.  
26 It happened to him, that same spirit  
Told him he'd not see death come near it  
Before he'd see the Lord's Messiah  
*Come down on earth to be pariah.*

Those who think Jesus is Lord God  
Almighty

Have not read Luke except they were too  
flighty.

He is the Lord's Messiah, which means that  
He cannot be the Lord YHWH where He  
sat.

That argument is threadbare now since it  
Has been used by the generations fit  
At least since Reformation came to hit  
The Vatican and turn it into guile.  
But those who live and cannot reconcile  
This Jesus with the promises of smile,  
How do they take this prophecy of late?  
It's one thing to deny Jesus in state,  
But quite another to say Simeon  
Was wrong when inspired by the spirit's  
gun.

27 Led by the spirit he came in  
The temple as the parents win  
Their entrance with the Jesus child  
For them to do as reconciled  
By the customs of legal piled.  
28 And Simeon took him in arm,  
And he blessed God words without harm:  
29 "Now, Master, let your servant go  
In peace according to the show  
Of Your word; 30 "for my eyes have seen  
Your great salvation on the scene.  
31 "You have prepared it in front of  
All peoples *on the earth to love*;  
32 "A light for revelation to  
The nations, and the glory view  
Of Your folk Israel *in their pew.* "  
33 And Joseph marvelled, mother too,  
At the things said about his view.  
34 And Simeon blessed them and said  
To his mother Mary instead,  
"See, this one is set for the fall  
And rising up of many, all  
In Israel, and for a sign  
Spoken against or to resign;  
35 "A sword indeed will also pierce  
Your own soul, so the thoughts of hearts  
Of many shall be shown with darts."  
36 And there was one Anna there too,  
A prophetess, daughter of true  
Phaniel, of the tribe of Asher.  
She was advanced in years to crash her,  
Since she had lived seven years with her  
Husband from virginity's stir,  
37 To be a widow in her time  
Of eighty-four years of the climb,

Who never left the temple, but  
Served night and day and being shut  
In fastings and prayers *to the glut*.  
38 She came up at that very hour,  
And gave thanks to the Lord in power  
And spoke of him to all those in  
Jerusalem waiting to win  
Redemption *from the worldly din*.

39 When they had accomplished the rites  
According to YHWH's law of lights,  
They went back into Galilee  
To Nazareth their own city.

At first Luke spoke about the law as named  
By Moses, a prophet and a man famed.  
But after that one mention, he makes out  
The law is Yours, Beloved One, without  
doubt.

If Moses' law is Yours, then those who  
take

It always with the epithet to make  
Out it is just a human law at stake,  
Not to be read or followed or in wake  
Of wonder loved recited on a day,  
Those people ought to stop and think and  
pay

Attention to the fact that Luke is bound  
More often to say the Lord's law when  
found.

Of course those who desire that Christ be  
Lord

Must then take it as his law too adored.

40 And the child grew, and became strong  
In spirit, being filled along  
With wisdom. And the grace of God  
Was on him everywhere he trod.

41 His parents went back year by year  
Up to Jerusalem with gear  
To the feast of Passover's cheer.

If Jesus kept Passover, why do such  
As claim to follow him among the Dutch  
Keep Easter instead and without a crutch?  
The world of faith is full of wonders I  
Could mention in public or on the sly.  
The Jews keep Passover and yet deny  
The Christ that kept it with them in the try.  
The Muslims fail to paint Christ face to  
face,

Because of the commandment not to trace  
The divine in an image, yet believe

He is no God at all come to receive.  
By the same token Christians paint him  
well,  
Believing He is God the Son to dwell.  
Faith is an inconsistent sort of hell.

42 And when He was twelve years old,  
they,

Went up to Jerusalem's sway  
By the customs around the feast  
*To see if their faith was increased*.

43 And when the time had passed they left  
In their return, the boy bereft,  
Jesus, stayed in Jerusalem.

And Joseph and his mother gem  
Did not notice his stratagem.

44 But they thought he must surely be  
Among the travel company,  
And so they travelled on a day.

And when they looked for him astray,  
They asked both kith and kin and friend.

45 Not finding him, they in the end  
Went back up to Jerusalem  
*To seek in sorrow their own gem*.

46 It happened after three days they  
Found Him in the temple to stay  
Among the teachers to hear them  
And question them at wisdom's hem.

47 All those who heard him were amazed  
At how much his wise answers dazed.

To judge by answers that report would say  
That Jesus gave his questioners in pay  
Twenty years later perhaps to the day,  
I reckon there's more cunning to be found  
Than wisdom in the teachings on his  
ground.

Render to Caesar, yea, render to God  
Is not a wise word but a cunning prod  
Escaping from the traps and snares on sod.  
Beloved, the boy was snotty in the way  
He answered his own betters gone astray.  
If the Messiah is David's son, why  
Does David call him lord? That's merely  
sly.

My concept of wisdom is over high  
Compared to Luke's, Beloved, until I die.

48 And seeing him, they were astounded.  
His mother said to him, "Child founded,  
Why did you play this trick on us?  
See, your dad and I with great fuss

Have looked for you in all the muss.”  
 49 And he said to them, “Why did you  
 Need to look for me? Did not you  
 Know that I’d be busy with crew  
 Of my Father’s business in view?”  
 50 They did not understand the word  
 He spoke to them *and which they heard*.  
 51 And He went with them and came to  
 Nazareth and was subject to  
 Them. And his mother carefully  
 Kept all these words in her heart free.  
 52 Jesus increased in wisdom and  
 In stature and favour as planned  
 Before God and humanity.

See now, Beloved, I told You that the lad  
 Was cheeky. You doubted me then, by cad!  
 See what he told his mother who was sad.  
 So when I read these words, I’m only glad  
 The boy increased in wisdom, which does  
     not  
 Mean that he ever accomplished a lot.  
 Increase does not imply abundance there.  
 I’d hope at twelve his stature was the share  
 Of boy rather than man, so increase nair  
 Did any harm for that. But favour set  
 Before You and the populace he met  
 Is something to be glad about, you bet.  
 Beloved, let me too keep in solemn heart  
 All these words like Jesus’ mum did her  
     part.

### Luke 3

1 In the fifteenth year of the rule  
 Of Caesar Tiberius’ school,  
 Pontius Pilate held the rod  
 Over all the Judean sod,  
 And Herod ruled as the tetrarch  
 Of Galilee, his brother dark  
 Philip ruled as tetrarch to stand  
 In Iturea and the land  
 Of Trachonitis, and there stood  
 Lysanias tetrarch of the good  
 Region of Abilene, 2 priesthood  
 In chief of Annas and the hood  
 Caiaphas, there came the word  
 Of God to John ben Zacharias  
 In the desert *there living pious*.  
 3 And he came to the neighbourhood  
 Of Jordan proclaiming as should  
 Repentance’ forgiveness of sins,  
 4 As it has been writ by the shins

Of the scroll of words of Isaiah  
 The prophet saying like a crier,  
 “The voice of one that shouts aloud  
 In the desert before no crowd,  
 ‘Prepare ye the way of the Lord,  
 And make His paths straight *for adored*.’  
 5 “Every valley shall be filled up,  
 And every mount and hill *like tup*  
 Shall be made low; the crooked places  
 Shall be made into straighter traces,  
 And the rough into smooth ways’ faces;  
 6 “And all flesh shall see the salvation  
 Of Alohim *upon our nation*.”

Salvation is a thing that Christians preach  
 But rarely think about in terms to teach,  
 Define and understand in common speech.  
 Salvation is when Your word comes to one  
 And then he proclaims to all those who run  
 Repentance is their due, and finally  
 Salvation’s the result of such a spree.  
 That’s all there is to it apparently.  
 Beloved, I love salvation in abstract,  
 But I’m not so sure of salvation’s act.  
 It’s not a pretty execution on  
 A cross or contemplation of the drawn  
 And quartered, but what’s worse evaluation  
 Of my own sins before final elation.

7 Then he said to the crowds that came  
 Out to be baptised by his fame,  
 “You sons of snakes, who warned you to  
 Flee from the coming wrath that’s due?  
 8 “Then bring forth actions that are meet  
 For such repentance, don’t retreat  
 To tell yourselves, ‘We’ve Abraham  
 As father.’ For I call your scam  
 Since God is able to raise up  
 Children to Abraham *to sup*  
 Out of these very stones *in cup*.  
 9 “The axe too is already set  
 At the treeroots, therefore each met  
 Not bearing good fruit will be cut  
 Down and thrown in the fire to strut.”

See, that’s exactly what I feared from what  
 Luke said about salvation on the rut.  
 The first thing that I hear’s name-calling  
     and  
 Humiliation on the river’s sand.  
 Repentance is a call into the dark  
 Of the destruction of commercial park.

It's not a happy message that You come  
To accept every human with a hum  
Just as he is or she is, every bum.  
Salvation and my self-esteem depart  
Each from the other at the very start,  
And I am left with salvation in pocket  
Or self-esteem to fake the judge and  
docket.  
I'm not sure that salvation's sweet to heart.

10 And the crowd asked him, saying "What  
Then shall we do *to gain and get?*"

11 He answered them and said "The one  
With two shirts, let him give for fun  
One to the one who has not one.  
And the one who has food to share,  
Let him give to the one who's bare."

12 And tax collectors also came  
To be baptised. They said aflame,  
"Rabbi, what shall we do in claim?"

13 And he said to them, "You just do  
Exactly what's commanded you."

14 Some soldiers asked him, saying then,  
And what about us slaying men?"  
And he said to them, "Do not take  
Anyone in violent stake  
Nor accuse falsely in the wake,  
And be satisfied with your take."

The call to be satisfied with the take  
Of one's own salary in modern stake  
Is just to bolster of the right-wing break  
To help the rich oppress the poor in wake.  
John could have been adviser to the bloke  
Who sits in the White House to lay a stroke  
On Middle Eastern population's folk.

Soldiers who do without complaint and  
make

No fuss to enrich themselves in the lake  
Of oil are just the sort to wield the poke.  
I'm missing something in the situation,  
Or in John's message to violent nation.  
He who gives the shirt off his back is  
thanked

By all but wife and children and untanked.

15 The waiting crowds thought in their  
hearts,

Whether John might not play the parts  
Of the Christ coming to their marts.

16 John answered everyone and said  
"I truly baptise you with water,

But one greater than I instead  
Is coming to this place *of slaughter*,  
Of whom I'm not fit to untie  
His shoestrings. And you can rely  
On him baptizing you at last  
In holy spirit and fire's *cast*.  
17 "His winnow is held in his hand,  
And he'll make bare his threshing stand,  
And gather the wheat in his store,  
But the chaff he'll burn up *the more*  
With fire not to be quenched *in score*."  
18 And he truly preached many things,  
The gospel to the folk *in rings*.

The thing I hate about the gospel word  
Is that it's never defined when it's stirred.  
Repentance is invoked, the kingdom heard,  
But nothing like a definition blurred.  
A hundred times this testament allows  
The word of gospel to print on its brows,  
But only in the last instance it says  
What five points are found in the gospel  
ways.

The book of Revelation finally  
Tells what the gospel's content is freely.  
Perhaps that is because in fact that book  
Was the first written down in Christian  
nook,  
Despite it's being listed and the end  
Of the writings by apostle and friend.

19 But Herod the tetrarch, was blamed  
By him for the issue unnamed,  
Herodias, wife of his brother  
Philip, and one thing and another  
Of evil things that Herod did.

20 On top of all his wicked bid  
He shut John under prison's lid.  
21 It happened in the crowd of folk  
That were baptised, Jesus too spoke  
Up to be baptised, and he prayed,  
The sky opened, 22 and on him stayed  
The holy spirit like a dove.  
There was a voice from heaven above,  
Saying "You are My son of love,  
In whom I delight *on parade*."

I do not doubt, Beloved, that You then  
spoke

To Jesus from the Jordan when he woke  
From small death of baptism's dunking's  
stroke.



There is a precedent in Sinai's sound  
When You came down to meet men on the  
ground.

I do not doubt, Beloved, your spirit's form  
In coming like a dove pure white and  
warm,

Although there is no precedent unless  
The burning bush of Moses at a guess  
Contained the fire of Your sent spirit when  
You spoke out of the bush to birds and  
men.

Fact is that Jesus joined the Baptist church.  
He was not too proud for that lower perch  
Than the Episcopalians in search.

23 And Jesus himself had just turned  
About thirty years old, discerned  
To be the son of Joseph, who  
Was the son of Heli, 24 who grew  
The son of Matthat, Levi's son  
The son of Melchi, Janna's son,  
The son of Joseph, 25 who was son  
Of Mattathias, Amos' son,  
The son of Nahum, Esli's son,  
The son of Naggai, 26 the son of Maath,  
The son of Mattathias' *path*,  
The son of Semei, Joseph's son,  
The son of Judah, 27 who was son  
Of Joannas, who was Rhesa's son,  
The son of Zerubbabel won  
The son of Shealtiel, the son  
Of Neri, 28 the son of Melchi,  
Who was himself son of Addi,  
The son of Cosam, the son of  
Elmodam, the son of Er's *love*,  
29 The son of Joses, who was son  
Of Eliezer, Jorim's son,  
The son of Matthat, Levi's son,  
30 Who was the son of Simeon,  
The son of Judah, Joseph's son,  
The son of Jonan, who was son  
Of Eliakim *on the run*,  
31 The son of Melea, the son  
Of Menan, the son of Mattatha,  
The son of Nathan, and whose father  
Was David, son of Jesse, son  
Of Obed, son of Boaz *won*,  
The son of Salmon, *who for fun*  
*Was born and bred* son of Nahshon,  
33 The son of Amminadab, son  
Of Aram the son of Hezron,  
The son of Pharez, Judah's son,

34 The son of Jacob, Isaac's son,  
The son of Abraham, the son  
Of Terah, son of Nahor, 35 son  
Of Serug, son of Reu, son  
Of Peleg, son of Eber, son  
Of Salah, 36 the son of Cainan,  
The son of Arphaxad, a man  
The son of Shem, the son of Noah,  
The son of Lamech in the shoah,  
37 The son of Methuselah, son  
Of Enoch, son of Jared, son  
Of Mahalaleel, the son  
Of Cainan; 38 son of Enos,  
The son of Seth, of Adam's cross,  
The son of God *without a loss*.

Jesus was lucky in this ethnic day  
When everyone wants to know how to play  
His origins in such a racist way.  
Jesus was lucky to have family tree  
That went back to beginning of the spree.  
But Jesus' luck ran out when he looked  
past

To see the genealogy was fast  
Under the name of his step-father cast.  
I'd think it was a better thing for him  
Not to know anything, than to sit trim  
Upon the laurels of step-father grim.  
Beloved, so many in this vale of fears  
Are like You and Your son of hope and  
tears

Without a family tree to stoke their gears.

#### **Luke 4**

1 And filled up with the holy spirit,  
Jesus came from Jordan or near it,  
And he was led up by the spirit  
Into the wilderness *to fear it*.  
2 There forty days of test and trial  
By the Devil *with word and smile*,  
And he ate nothing in those days,  
And at the end of the time's *ways*  
*Then* he was hungry. 3 At a stroke  
The Devil came to him and spoke,  
"If You are God's son, tell this stone  
To become a loaf of your own."  
4 And Jesus answered him and said  
"It has been written down instead,  
'Man shall not live alone on bread,  
But on each word that God has said.'"

When I was a child no one lived on bread,

But on tv dinners around the spread.  
 The freezer served to keep them fresh and  
 new,  
 The oven served to heat them overdue.  
 Given the supper that five thousand ate,  
 Jesus could easily have filled his plate.  
 He had a point to make. Your word is true.  
 And all he had to think or speak or do  
 Was quote You on the spot and Satan's  
 mouth  
 Was stopped from speaking either north or  
 south.  
 Beloved, I keep the way of Jesus spent  
 In just the opposite sort of a bent.  
 I eat my bread by day and in the night  
 I meditate Your words in my heart's light.

5 The Devil led him to the peak  
 Of a high mountain, and showed there  
 All the kingdoms of the world fair  
 In a flash moment and to seek.  
 6 And Satan said to him, "I will  
 Give all this power to fit the bill  
 Of glory to you, since it's mine  
 Delivered up to me and fine,  
 To give to whom I may incline.  
 7 "So if you fall prostrating here  
 Before me, all is yours and clear."  
 8 And Jesus answered him and said  
 "Get behind me, Satan ill-bred!  
 For it is written and it's said  
 'You shall prostrate yourself alone  
 To YHWH your Alohim in throne,  
 Him only shall you worship spread.'"

The supposition is the story told  
 In Enoch's book of the watchers in fold.  
 The ruler of this earth descended to  
 Gene splicing on the tender human crew.  
 But he is willing to give up his own  
 If Jesus will prostrate before his throne.  
 Jesus might well have taken the grand place  
 Remaining an immortal of the race  
 By only bowing as in kingly trace.  
 He could have used excuse that bowing  
 meant  
 Only the recognition of the sent  
 That Satan was the chief of appointment,  
 And not divine upon the frozen sod.  
 But Jesus refused to make claims of God.

9 He took him to Jerusalem

And stood him on the temple gem,  
 And told him, "If you're son of God,  
 Throw yourself down here on the sod,  
 10 For it is written: "He'll command  
 His angels round you to take hand,  
 Protecting you from all that's planned.  
 11 "So in their hands they'll bear you up,  
 So's not to bruise your foot *like tup*  
 Against a stone *upon the sand.*""  
 12 And Jesus answered and told him,  
 It has been said "You shall look dim  
 On tempting YHWH your Alohim.""  
 13 The Devil finished tempting him  
 And left him for the time *as grim.*

The Devil doubts that Jesus is Your son,  
 Which is a rational thing when he's done,  
 Since You are not one circumcised at best,  
 And never were a husband or so dressed.  
 The Devil quotes the Scripture like a  
 preacher,  
 They all follow his great example feature  
 To twist Your word to make the sin seem  
 right,  
 Obedience to Your law seem like a fright.  
 But Jesus has an answer for the pard,  
 Which is to keep Your law is not that hard.  
 It is no good excuse that one can read  
 Into the text justification's seed.  
 No matter what the Psalm says for a creed,  
 Simply obeying Decalogue's the card.

14 Jesus went back to Galilee  
 By the power of the spirit free.  
 And rumours flew around the place  
 About him *with the populace.*  
 15 And He taught in their synagogues,  
 Praised by all *of their demagogues.*  
 16 He came to Nazareth where he  
 Was brought up. And by his decree  
 Of custom went in on the day  
 Of Sabbaths to stand up to pray  
 And read. 17 And the scroll of Isaiah  
 The prophet was brought to him nigher.  
 And he unrolled the book and found  
 The place where it was written bound:  
 18 "The spirit of the Lord's on me.  
 Because He has anointed me  
 To preach the gospel to the poor;  
 He's sent me to heal brokenhearted,  
 Release to captives, to the blind  
 To see again, and so to find

Saving of those oppressed and crushed,  
 In the salvation where they've rushed,  
 19 "To preach a year acceptable  
 To YHWH *when the cycle is full.*"  
 20 And he rolled up the scroll, and gave  
 It to the attendant to save,  
 And then sat down. And all the eyes  
 Of everyone came to arise  
 On him in the synagogue's wise.  
 21 And He began to say to them,  
 Today this Scripture's stratagem  
 Has been fulfilled here in your ears.  
 22 And all bore witness of his word,  
 And marvelled at the grace that stirred  
 All who heard what came from his lips.  
 And they said "Is this *for hardships*  
 Not the son of Joseph *we've heard?*"  
 23 And He said to them, "No doubt you  
 Will tell this parable as true  
 To me, 'Physician, heal yourself.  
 The rumours of what things *on shelf*  
 Took place in Capernaum *brown,*  
 Also do here in your home town.'"  
 24 But He said "Truly I tell you  
 No prophet's accepted in pew  
 Of his own country's retinue.  
 25 "I truly tell you, there were many  
 Widows in Israel *for a penny*  
*A dozen* in the days when came  
 Elijah shutting heaven's *claim*  
 More than three years and six months'  
 time,  
 When a hard famine came *in prime*  
 On all the land, 26 "and yet was sent  
 Elijah to none of them *meant*  
 Except to Sidon's Zarephath,  
 And to a widow woman's *path.*  
 27 "And many lepers came to stay  
 In Israel in Elisha's day,  
 And none of them the prophet made  
 Clean but the Syrian Naaman *paid.*"

I've learned one thing perhaps that Jesus  
 failed  
 To find out on the shores where he impaled  
 Offended his own lot. As for myself,  
 I offend more the foreigner and elf.  
 But Jesus does not seem to know that when  
 He is among the racist sort of men,  
 The last thing one should do is to remind  
 Them of their own failings among the  
 blind.

Beloved, I've seen the separation made  
 Between the loved and unloved in their  
 grade,  
 And known that none should ever hope to  
 see  
 The justice that each heart knows in degree.  
 There is no soul but contains by Your will  
 Awareness that Your I-ness comes to fill.

28 And all were filled with wrath to hear  
 These things in their synagogue *dear.*  
 29 And they got up and threw him out  
 Of the town and led him about  
 To the brow of the hill on which  
 Their town was built *to find a ditch*  
 To throw him in *without a stitch.*  
 30 But he went his way, passing through  
 The crowd and left them out of view.

I know now why You are not to be seen  
 In churches and in synagogues to ween.  
 You know that those who listen sweetly  
 there,  
 And those who speak as though without a  
 care,  
 All would rush in a crowd to beat Your  
 share,  
 If You were a God seen beneath the air.  
 When You came as they say in human  
 form,  
 Believers were the ones who made it warm.  
 Beloved, I too pass here invisibly.  
 I am Your comrade in arms of the free.  
 By Your great blessing no one looks at me  
 As I come in the square or turn around  
 To find my paths along the leaf-strewn  
 ground  
 That waits for winter silent, without sound.

31 And he went to Capernaum,  
 A town of Galilee and rum,  
 And taught them on the Sabbath's hum.  
 32 They were amazed at what he taught,  
 Because his word with power was fraught.  
 33 And in the synagogue a man  
 Was who had a spirit *in span*  
 Of an unclean demon. And he  
 Cried out with a loud voice *in spree,*  
 34 Saying "Aha! What's between us,  
 Jesus of Nazareth, for fuss?  
 Did you come here to destroy us?  
 I know you, who you are, you are

The holy one of God *and star.*”

It's nothing new to me to hear the case  
Of someone deil-possessed on the White  
race

Make such a fuss in every church for spiel,  
A pew and cry for Trinity's appeal.  
The Sabbath is the time when demons  
come

Together to report and sigh and hum  
About the way that You appear or should  
In human form as holy and as good.  
Invention of God the Son was in fact  
A truly demonic, unsavoury act.  
Just wait and see what Jesus says to him  
To make his act remove from Sabbath trim.  
Today the synagogues are free of such,  
While churches love the Trinity for crutch.

35 Jesus rebuked him and he said  
“Be still, come out of him instead!  
And casting him down in the crowd,  
The demon came from him aloud,  
Without harming him *for their dread.*”

36 Amazement fell on all around.  
They address each other as found,  
Saying “What word is this, that he  
Commands unclean spirits’ decree  
With power and authority,  
And they depart upon the ground?”

37 And rumour of him went around  
In every place, in every bound.

I too could cry against that demon thought,  
The word and doctrines that the devil  
taught

To the Church Fathers in the things they  
wrought.

And if I should, I know amazement too  
Would fall upon that holy, worthy crew.  
And rumour would fly round in saintly due,  
If I should cry against unholy hue  
Of God the Son while sitting in my pew.  
I would cry aloud, if I came to be  
Within those pallid palls on a Sunday.  
Instead I meet the Sabbath in my home,  
To hear the Tanakh read, unlike in Rome,  
In Hebrew syllables and in the tone  
Of sweeter singing than before Your  
throne.

38 He left the synagogue and went

Into the house of Simon spent.  
And Simon's mother-in-law there  
Was lying in great fever's share.  
And they asked him about her care.  
39 He stood beside her and rebuked  
The fever; and it left her cooked.  
She got up right away and then  
Started to serving all those men.

The care that man will lavish on a wife  
Has motives both ulterior in strife  
And motives recognizing right to life.  
No man would have his wife's mum cured  
at all,

Except that when cured she gets on the ball  
And serves him bread and meat in dining  
hall.

So Jesus cured the lady who was ill,  
And she got up to serve and fit the bill.  
Beloved, if I were shaking in my bed  
With fever, though a mother-in-law spread,  
If I were cured, I'd come out to the table  
And wait for someone else to serve as able.  
You crown salvation in celestial stew  
With promises of laden tables too.

40 The sun went down and everyone  
Who was ill with each sickness won  
Brought such to him, what could be done.  
He lay his hands on each one then  
And healed them *both women and men.*

41 And demons also came out from  
Many, shouting, not keeping mum,  
Saying “You are the Christ, the son  
Of God!” And he rebuked each one,  
And did not let them speak at all,  
Since they knew him as Christ and call.

It's almost always demon or a priest  
Described in Luke, who calls out like a  
beast

To say Your sent one is the Son of God.  
So was it then upon the city's sod,  
So is it now. It's hard to hear the diff  
Between the preacher's preaching in the  
stiff

And demon's giving witness in a tiff.  
Beloved, may Your sent Christ rebuke  
today

The bishops and the reverends for the way  
They lie like demons for their paltry pay.  
Let me bear no demonic witness here,

Beloved, but speak Your own  
commandments dear  
In my heart, mind and soul, and when I  
take  
Them on my tongue, be it for Your sweet  
sake.

42 At the start of the day he went  
Into a desert place as sent.  
And the crowds looked for him as bent  
To come to him and hold him fast,  
Not to lose him or be outcast.

43 But he said to them, "It is right  
For me to spread the Gospel light  
To other cities, because I  
Was sent for that aim from the sky."

44 And he preached in the synagogues  
Of Galilee to demagogues.

In that time and that place it was not hard  
To preach in synagogue and temple  
scarred.

I've seen the circles of students unbarred  
In mosque of Al-Aqsa in years just past.  
It takes no decision voted and cast  
By Presbytery or Baptist committee.  
One could just sit down, teach and so make  
free.

If there's a place on earth for me to preach  
Or listen to the words of those who teach,  
It is the grove of fir and pine above  
My yellow cabin I look on with love.  
No human ear but mine is there to hear  
The whispers that You sigh upon my ear,  
The wonders that You speak and that  
appear.

### Luke 5

1 It happened that the crowd pressed hard  
On him to hear the Word God starred.

And he was standing by the lake  
Gennesaret, 2 and saw in wake  
Two boats lying along the shore,  
Where fishermen had left in store  
While they washed out their nets before.

3 And he got in one of the boats,  
Which was Simon's, and asked *for groats*  
To put out a little from land.

He sat down and then took in hand  
To teach the crowd from the boat's stand.

The point of speaking from a boat is this:

First of all, the folk can see and not miss  
A bit of the sight without rock and tree  
To hide the vision sent from Almighty,  
And second, the acoustics are just right  
To hear over the water without sprite.  
I don't think there was anything at all  
To the accusing of one at the wall  
That Jesus set some distance from the thrall  
So none could touch him and push him in  
stall.

Beloved, where I live most of the year I  
Would not sit to hear sermons on the sly  
Beside the lake. I would get chilled no  
doubt,  
And have to leave not hearing all about.

4 When he stopped speaking, he told  
Simon,

"Row out a way and be no shy man  
To let down your nets for a haul."

5 And Simon answered him in call,  
"Sir, we worked through the night in thrall  
But caught us nothing here at all.  
But at your order I'll let down

The net now *before all the town.*"  
6 They did so and they caught a full  
Net of fish, till it tore by pull.

7 They motioned for their friends to come  
From the other boat there *in sum*,  
And help them. And they came and filled  
Both boats to point of sinking *thrilled*.

8 Simon Peter saw that and fell  
At Jesus knees and said a spell,  
"Depart from me, sir, for I am  
A sinful man, indeed I am."

9 For his amazement held on him,  
And on all those with him not dim,  
And the catch of the fish they took.

10 And so too were both James and John,  
The sons of Zebedee to look,  
Who were the partners with Simon.  
Jesus told Simon, "Do not fear.  
From now on you'll catch men *with  
cheer.*"

11 They brought the boats up on the land,  
Abandoned everything they'd planned,  
And followed him on every hand.

The way to fish is always in the night  
If nets are used upon the lake in sight.  
But Jesus was no fisherman to boot,  
But rather was a mason on the toot.

Beginner's luck, it may have been. That's  
why  
His followers, for all the go and try,  
Rarely catch any man and bring him in  
To dunk in lake like fish with scale and fin.  
The dunking is no doubt why Christians  
then  
Drew fish upon the wall of house of men.  
Beloved, I serve me better on the land,  
Without the net, without the hunting hand,  
Without the converts whirling on the sand,  
Without the Bacchanalia round again.

12 It happened in one of the towns,  
See, a leper came from the downs.  
When he saw Jesus, he fell down  
On his face and begged him by crown,  
Saying "Sir, if you only will,  
You can cleanse me from being ill."  
13 He stretched his hand out and touched  
him,  
Saying "I will. Be cleansed and trim!"  
And straight away the leprosy  
Departed from him *completely*.  
14 And He charged him to tell no one.  
"But go and show yourself for fun  
To the priest and offer the gift  
For cleansing as Moses would lift  
In law for a witness in rift."  
15 But rumours of him spread the more.  
And large crowds came to hear before  
Receiving cures from him in store.

This Jesus so respects Mosaic law  
That he tells the man to go show his paw  
To the priests to get clearance in their awe  
To come into the synagogue and draw.  
He missed the opportunity right then  
To start an ecclesia among men,  
Called out ones from the synagogue of fate  
That would not let a leper ruminate  
Upon the law within the bound of late.  
Beloved, the pride rabbinical in state  
Is not beyond the help of divine rate.  
I find the chores set up by folk in time  
Are no more difficult that chosen rhyme,  
No harder than the metre of my climb.

16 But He was drawing back into  
A desert place and praying too.  
17 It happened on one of the days  
When he was teaching, without praise

Of Pharisees and lawyers near,  
Who came out of each hamlet drear  
Of Galilee and Judaea,  
Jerusalem to *stand in awe*.  
And YHWH's power came upon them  
there

For curing of each one in share.  
18 And see, men coming in to bear  
A stretcher with a man to lie  
Paralyzed. And they came to try  
To bring him in, and lay him down  
Before him and *before the town*.  
19 And they could not find a way through  
The crowd, and so they went up to  
The top of the house, and they let  
Him down through the tiles they could get  
With stretcher and all there among  
The folk in front of Jesus' rung.  
20 He saw their faith and said to him,  
"Man, your sins be forgiven grim."  
21 And the scribes and the Pharisees  
Began to reason at his pleas,  
And said "Who speaks such blasphemies?  
Who can forgive sins with such ease  
Except God only, if He please?"

Your sent one did not say that he was right  
To forgive sins of people in Your sight.  
The forgiveness he laid down for the man  
Might well have been forgiveness of Your  
plan.

There was no grasping of Your honour  
there.

Responses of the Pharisees in share  
Went far beyond the claims he came to  
bear.

And yet those claims are echoed in the  
mouth

Of Trinitarian both north and south,  
Who join the jealous leaders in the way  
They seek excuses to be led astray.

Beloved, I claim Your great forgiveness  
now

For the crowds than surround my whirling  
brow,

And mediate Your blessings here  
somehow.

22 But Jesus knew their thoughts and said  
To them in his reply instead,  
"Why do you reason in your hearts?"  
23 "Which is easier said in parts,

‘Your sins have been forgiven you,’  
 Or say ‘Get up and walk as due?’  
 24 “But so you’ll know the son of man  
 Has power on earth and in his span  
 To forgive sins,” he said then to  
 The paralytic man in view,  
 “I tell you to get up and take  
 Your stretcher and go home *and bake.*”  
 25 And he got right up in their sight  
 And picked up the stretcher as light  
 On which he lay, and he went home  
 While praising God. 26 Under the dome  
 Astonishment seized all, and they  
 Praised God and were filled with the sway  
 Of fear, saying “We’ve seen today  
 Wonders and miracles *in chrome.*”

If Jesus was out just to heal the man,  
 Then why should he mention the plague  
 and plan  
 Of sin? I’ve pondered that and think I  
 know.  
 The Pharisees in their own healthy show  
 Thought illness punishment. To heal at all  
 Implied forgiveness of sin under pall.  
 The righteous way was patiently to take  
 The punishment for the atonement’s sake.  
 Despite the fact that in the Christian spell  
 The death of Jesus leaves the blood to tell  
 Forgiveness without rate of hope or bell,  
 Sweet Christians still love to see hand of  
 God,  
 Or finger at least when the evil prod  
 Of some catastrophe splits open pod.

27 And after these things, he went out  
 And saw a tax collector stout  
 Named Levi, sitting at his table.  
 And he told him, “Follow me able!”  
 28 And he left everything, got up  
 And followed him *just like a tup.*  
 29 And Levi made him a great feast  
 In his house. And there were released  
 Crowds of tax collectors to lie  
 There with their cronies standing by.  
 30 And the scribes and the Pharisees  
 Complained to his disciples’ *breeze,*  
 Saying “Why do you eat and drink  
 With sinful, tax-collecting stink?”  
 31 And Jesus answered and replied,  
 “The healthy need no healer’s guide,  
 But sick people come to abide.”

32 “I’ve not come to call righteous *ones,*  
 But sinners, to repentance’ *runs.*”

Strange thing today, the ones that I have  
 known  
 Who work in the tax office like a drone,  
 Are far more morally upright in tone  
 Than bishops by their altar, on their throne.  
 First off, their pay is less, and modesty  
 Of means has become almost virtue, see.  
 I hardly know a tax collector here  
 Who is not both upstanding to appear,  
 But also funny to the point of tear.  
 Beloved, this Roman state changes with  
 time,  
 The waves of social upheaval in prime  
 Set different souls now to the same old  
 crime.  
 That’s to speak of a European set.  
 America may be another bet.

33 Then they said to him, “Why is it  
 John’s disciples fast *as is fit*  
 Often and make prayers, likewise those  
 Of the Pharisees *as they chose,*  
 But yours eat and drink?” 34 And he said  
 To them, “Can you make the sons *led*  
 To the bride-chamber then while he,  
 The bridegroom is with them *sweetly?*  
 35 “But the days will come when the bride-  
 Groom will be taken from their side,  
 Then they will fast in those days *dreary.*”  
 36 Then he spoke a parable *weary*  
 To them, “No one puts a piece from  
 A new cloth on an old one’s *bum,*  
 Because the new will make a tear,  
 And also the piece that was *there*  
 Of the new does not match the old.  
 37 “And no one puts new grape juice *sold*  
 Into old wineskins *to unfold,*  
 Because the new grape juice will burst  
 The wineskins and be spilt for worst,  
 And the wineskins will be spoiled too.  
 38 “But new grape juice must then accrue  
 To new wineskins, and both are saved.  
 39 “And no one, having drunk old *waved,*  
 Straightway desires the new, for he  
 Says ‘The old is better for *glee.*’”

All these stories and allegories told  
 Are just here for one thing and to be bold.  
 And that’s to explain why Yours do not fast

And say their prayers so ardently as cast.  
 The presence of the prophet will suffice  
 It seems to lay off fasting and be nice.  
 Sons of bride-chamber seem to indicate  
 That sons there may be other than the state  
 Of fatherhood for wedlock. So the rule  
 That Your sent one must also be a spool  
 Chipped from a block and thus a god  
     among  
 Men is a song that has been falsely sung.  
 Beloved, now he is gone from sight and  
     view.  
 Does that mean I should fast and pray to  
     You?

### **Luke 6**

1 It happened on the second great  
 Sabbath, he passed along with mate  
 Through the sown field to demonstrate.  
 And his disciples plucked the ears  
 And ate them as it then appears  
 By rubbing in their hands the ears.

Who knows what the great Sabbaths of the  
     year  
 Might have been among festivals and gear?  
 Some think the seven Sabbaths that came  
     late  
 After the Passover are indicate.  
 Some think three Sabbath in the year once  
     past  
 The higher holidays are those to last.  
 If so, this was one after Pentecost  
 When the disciples worked to eat and lost  
 The favour of the folk that had been tossed  
 Under the duty to provide a meal  
 For visitors upon the Sabbath heal.  
 Beloved, the prohibition on the fast  
 Might have justified reaping grain to steal,  
 While the inhospitable rant and reel.

2 "Some Pharisees said to them, "Why  
 Do you commit unlawful spy  
 To be done on the Sabbath days?"  
 3 And Jesus answered them and said  
 "How is it you have never read  
 What David did when hungry, and  
 Those who were with him in his band?  
 4 "He went into the house of God,  
 And took the shewbread in the pod,  
 And ate it and gave those to eat  
 Who were with him some of the treat,

Which is unlawful that we taste  
 Unless we're priests *and do not waste.*"  
 5 And he said to them *when he scored,*  
 "Son of man's also Sabbath's lord."

I'm glad to hear that Jesus is the lord  
 Of Sabbath and not Sunday unrestored.  
 I would not want to follow in disgrace  
 The footsteps of a Mithra sort trace.  
 I'm glad that Jesus follows David's lead  
 As though born of the one anointed's seed,  
 In line of those upon whom promise lies  
 Until eternity reaches the skies.  
 Beloved, I come upon the Sabbath day  
 Into the temple that still bears the sway,  
 The praises of Israel where You dwell,  
 The Psalms of David instead of the bell  
 Of pagan faith. I find the bread still there  
 As on the day that David ate his share.

6 It happened on another day  
 Of Sabbath, he went on his way  
 Into the synagogue to teach.  
 A man was there who could not reach  
 With his right hand withered away.  
 7 And the scribes and the Pharisees  
 Kept close to him if by degrees  
 He might heal on the Sabbath day,  
 So that they too might find a way  
 To bring a charge against his sway.  
 8 But he knew all about their thoughts,  
 And said to the man with the rots  
 Upon his hand, "Get up and stand."  
 And he stood right up in the band.  
 9 The Jesus said to them, "I will  
 Ask you one thing, can you fulfil  
 The law by doing good or ill  
 Upon the Sabbath day, to save  
 Life or to send it to the grave?"  
 10 He looked around at them and said  
 To the man, "Stretch your hand outspread!"  
 And so he did. And so his hand  
 Was healed just like his other hand.  
 11 But they were filled with wrath and  
     spoke  
 Together how to lay a stroke  
 On Jesus *before he awoke.*

The Sabbath You established, my Beloved,  
 To give pause to the ones who work  
     ungloved.  
 You made it a sign and a tool concrete



To dispel the powers of the indiscreet.  
But see how quickly men can take Your  
grace  
And turn it to destruction of the race.  
Luke fails to mind that Jesus spoke in  
wrath

To scribes and Pharisees blocking his path.  
Refusal to admit reason made him  
Flair up in temper fit for trim and dim.  
Beloved, I too am angry here to find  
That those I speak to choose now to be  
blind.

The choice is every man's and woman's too.  
It matters, my Beloved, what people do.

12 It happened in those times that he  
Went out into the hills a wee  
To pray, and he spent the night there  
With God alone and sought in prayer.

Beloved, I sleep at night. Those nights that  
I

Lie wakeful, I do come with prayerful sigh  
To whisper in the dark the Psalms. I try  
To mind the Hebrew words and then if not  
I stake the French or English in my plot.  
Poor Huguenot! The centuries resound  
With life outside that fertile birthing  
ground,

And yet a man or two like me is bound  
To say the night prayers in Genevan round.  
Beloved, I join Your sent one on the hill  
For just a moment of prayer to fulfil  
Before I turn from trundra out of sight  
Behind my firs and pines toward morning  
light,  
Within the quiet darkness of the night.

13 When day came he summoned his  
friends,

Choosing out twelve to make amends,  
Whom he also appointed to  
Be his own sent out ones in crew.

14 Simon, whom he also named Peter;  
And his brother Andrew, *no cheater*,  
James and John, Philip *all in crew*  
*Not last or least* Bartholomew,

15 Matthew and Thomas, James the son  
Of Alphaeus, Simon the one  
Called Zealot, 16 Judas James's brother,  
And Judas Iscariot another  
Who also was a traitor won.

The only twelve in Scripture that contains  
A traitor by the story that remains  
Is that group of apostles that the Christ  
Sent out to cure the world of diced and  
sliced.

All others are a righteous brood and met  
In kindness or at least in goodly set.  
But now a few cast doubt on all the rue  
That Judas made for generations' view.  
Beloved, I count the many twelves and find  
Them all illuminating the consigned  
Commandments from Mount Sinai in the  
wake

Of the transmission of their beauty's lake.  
I see them whirling with the forty's band  
Invisibly in blessing on the land.

17 He came down with them and he stood  
On a plain, and a crowd of would-  
Be disciples and others there  
From all Judaea and the fair  
Jerusalem, coast country bare  
Of Tyre and Sidon. These came to  
Hear him and then to be cured too  
From their diseases, 18 also those  
Who were troubled by demons' woes.  
And they were healed from all their throes.  
19 And all the crowd tried to touch him,  
Because power went out of him trim  
And healed everybody who chose.

The sermon on the mount of Matthew  
comes

Here as the sermon on the plain for sums.  
From Tyre and Sidon people come to claim  
The healing of Your sent one for his fame.  
Disease and demons flee before Your  
name.

I too reach out to touch the seamless dress  
And only find before me dreamless guess  
Unless You enter in the humble word  
Of bird and beastie on my mountain stirred.  
Beloved, I turn from Sabbath light to dim  
Sweet comforts of the night filled to the  
brim

With sounds of Psalm and with the  
multitude

Of hopes before Your throne set on the  
brood

Of churriqueresque firs to make my mood.

20 He raised his eyes up to his friends  
And said: Blessed are the poor at ends,  
For God's kingdom is yours to pose.  
21 Blessed are those who are hungry now,  
For you will be filled up somehow.  
Blessed are those who weep now, for you  
Will laugh to see another view.

22 Blessed are you when men shall hate  
you,

And when they put you out with rue  
Reproaching, and cast out your name  
As evil, for the sake and blame  
Of son of man, 23 rejoice that day  
And leap for joy, for see the pay  
Is much in heaven! For their ancestors  
Did so to the prophets *and questers*.

Not poor in spirit but the very poor,  
Not hungering for righteousness but sure  
The very starving without hope to find  
The bread among the better drunk and  
dined,  
Are blessed by Lucan quotation refined  
Of what Your sent one spoke beyond the  
cure.

I hardly live to hunger in the way  
I meet my meals in line day after day,  
And poverty may seem to be my pay,  
But wealth beyond my need is mine to stay.  
If I am not pleased with the lacks of men,  
At least I can rejoice I'm shunned again  
By bishop and by king set up to call  
The glories of the marketplace and stall.

24 But woe to you, rich men, for you  
Have your comfort now in your due!  
25 Woe to you who are filled, for you  
Will hunger! Woe to you who laugh  
Now, for you will mourn for your gaff.  
26 Woe to you when all men speak well  
Of you, their ancestors cast spell  
On false prophets *in Israel*.

I think that Matthew hid a word or two  
Because he could not bear to curse the crew  
Of folk before him in the neighbour pew.  
If blessings blow, then blow also the woes,  
Despite James doubting that they both in  
rows

Might come from the same lips if not from  
toes.

The Deuteronomic in blessing finds

The counterpart and point between the  
blinds,

The light and shadow of both day and night  
Require the ebb and flow of love and spite.  
Beloved, I take the blessings and the  
weight

Of woes upon my thinning, near-bald pate  
And with the word increase the wondered  
state

Of dwelling in Your temple soon and late.

27 But I say to you, those who hear,  
Love the hostile and those who steer  
Their hate on you, 28 Bless those who  
curse

You and pray for those who do worse.  
29 To those who strike you on the cheek,  
Turn the other too, *don't be weak*.  
And from those who take your coat off,  
Do not keep back your shirt to doff.  
30 To everyone who asks, then give.  
Don't ask for return from the sieve  
From those who borrow, *but let live*.

Truth is, Beloved, I have no enemies  
Despite my complaints sent out upon the  
breeze.

The wicked pass me by and hardly note  
That I stay here reciting Psalms by rote  
Until the morning light turns toward the  
night,  
And light upon the cobblestones of might  
Turns toward the dances and the songs of  
spite.

Truth is, Beloved, no man requires my  
coat,

And no one strikes my cheek however  
slight.

If one or two have cursed, my prayer  
remains  
To follow them beyond their spending  
pains.

There's hardly anyone who asks of me  
A mite to pile upon the beggar's fee.  
Of life and death, Beloved, I'm almost free.

31 What you want men to do to you,  
Do the same to the others too.

The golden rule is clad for every fool,  
And set out in delight beside the pool  
Of alabaster. All around the streams

The alcoves bring their shades filled up  
with dreams.

The golden rule, what I may want of men  
Let me bestow upon them all again,  
Peeks from the armpit of all faiths to find  
The world of men already knows the kind.  
Beloved, Your sent one seems richly  
inclined

To wisdom and propensities refined,  
But his originality in show  
Is little more than Jewish mama's glow,  
Without which he would be no more in row  
Than any goy philosopher in tow.

32 And if you love those who love you,  
What thanks is there to come to you?  
For even sinners love those who  
Love them. 33 And if you only do  
Good to those who do good to you,  
What thanks is there to you? For so  
Even the sinners do *for show*.

34 And if you lend to those from whom  
You hope to get profit and room,  
What thanks is there for you to get?

For sinners also lend to those  
Who sin to get profit they chose.

35 But love the ones hostile to you,  
And do good and lend without view  
Of gain, and your reward will be  
Great, and you'll be sons of degree  
Of the Most High, for He is kind  
To unthankful and bad resigned.

If lending without hope of some return  
Is hall mark of Your sons and what they  
earn,

Then few on earth would covet state and  
name

Of being Your own son, even for fame.  
I do not say I am of that crass lot,  
Although I understand the act and plot.  
Fact is I too am just a sinner here  
Before the Decalogue I fail to fear.  
Beloved, if You insist on taking me  
To be Your child now or eternally,  
I submit to the notion with will free,  
But let you know that as I live today  
I still feel the sting of reward and pay,  
And know the difference that comes to  
play.

36 Therefore, be merciful, just like

Your Father's a merciful tyke.

Good Luke would have me merciful  
instead

Of perfect as fair Matthew's table spread  
Indicts upon my willing and bowed head.  
If choice is between perfect and the grace  
Of mercy, I know enough of my place  
That my perfection is clearer to trace.  
The challenge of perfection is addition  
Where mercy requires multiplied condition.  
All men know in their heart of hearts that  
they

Are perfect in their words and work and  
play.

But none of us is willing to requite  
With mercy instead of justice and spite.  
Luke is too hard, Beloved, let me return  
To Matthew, simple in the things to earn.

37 Do not judge others and don't let  
Others judge you. And do not set  
Your condemnation on the crowd,  
Nor let them condemn you unbowed.

Forgive and you will be forgiven.

38 Give, and good measure will be given  
To you, packed down, shaken and driven  
And spilling over on your breast.  
For the same measure that you wrest  
Will be measured back in your vest.

The fact is every man is here to judge  
And be judged by his neighbour come to  
fudge.

There's no avoiding one or other here,  
And Jesus should have known that without  
tear.

I cannot help or not how I am judged,  
But I can decide never to be budged  
From judging others only by Your law,  
And never by the rule of heal and claw.  
It matters not what colour skin or eye,  
Or how one dresses under a clear sky.  
It matters rather that one does not steal,  
Nor kill nor commit uncleanness in keel.  
I judge the other with the least I can  
And turn a deaf ear to the judgement's ban.

39 He spoke a parable to them:  
A blind one cannot take the hem  
Of a blind one *by stratagem*  
And guide him. Will they not both fall

Into the ditch *instead of stall?*

40 The student is not better than  
His teacher, but then every man  
Who's been perfected will *in plan*  
Be like his master *come to scan*.  
41 But why do you dwell on the speck  
That your brother's eye may reflect,  
But do not notice the great beam  
That spoils your own eye, it would seem?  
42 Or how can you make your remarks  
To your brother, "Brother, let sparks  
From me take the speck from your eye,"  
Not seeing the beam in your eye?  
O hypocrite! First take the beam  
Out of your eye, and then you'll seem  
To see clearly to take the speck  
Out of your brother's eye *select*.

This slapstick humour does not make me  
smile.

The contrast of the speck and beam for  
guile

Is too gross for my sensitivity.  
I prefer humour of slighter degree.  
But to each prophet his own sorcery.  
I'd just point out that no one acts like that.  
No one has a beam in his eye out flat.  
And if there is a speck, no one stands by  
Forgetful of the pain to wonder why,  
But takes it out himself or finds a friend  
With steady hand and magic wand to wend.  
Beloved, the art of parables is cheap,  
But often far too difficult to keep  
The interest bound with lessons not to  
weep.

43 There's no good tree that bears bad fruit,  
Nor a bad tree with good fruit's suit.  
44 Each tree is known by its own fruit.  
They do not harvest figs from thorns,  
Nor do they harvest grapes in bournes  
Of brambles. 45 The good man will bear  
Good things out of his own heart's share.  
The evil man will bring out such  
Evil things from evil heart's touch.  
For his mouth speaks from the great share  
Of what his own heart has to bear.  
46 Why call me sir, sir, and yet not  
Do everything that I have taught?  
47 Everyone who comes to me and  
Hears my words and does my command,  
I'll show you what he's like to stand.

48 He's like a man who builds a house,  
Digging a deep foundation's dowse  
Upon the rock. When the flood lies,  
The rush against that house in guise  
Cannot make it tremble for it  
Has been founded on the rock fit.  
49 But the one who hears but does not  
Do is like a man who has wrought  
A house on earth without foundation,  
And when comes the flood's inundation,  
It falls straight off, and such a fall  
Is great indeed, like to appal.

Jesus does not require the fair belief  
In crucifixes carved beyond relief,  
In god-men resurrected from the grave  
Of gardens made fertile by wench and  
brave

In sacramental clench for what they gave.  
No, Jesus just requires the same that You  
Yourself required when You came into  
view

On Sinai and stood a moment or two  
And left the message of what men should  
do.

Many call You Lord among goy and Jew,  
But of that number there are very few  
Who stand to obey what You said that day,  
From worshiping You only in Your sway  
To keeping Sabbath when it comes to bay.

### **Luke 7**

1 When he finished what he was saying  
In the hearing of the folk staying,  
He set out for Capernaum,  
*The home of both good men and bum.*

2 A certain centurion's slave,  
One dear, was sick unto the grave.

3 He heard about Jesus to save,  
And sent Jewish elders to brave  
Him and ask him to come and heal  
His servant and put back in weal.

4 They came to Jesus earnestly  
Asking him saying "He's worthy  
Of this favour just 5 because he  
Loves our nation and he has built  
A synagogue for us from silt.

6 So Jesus went with them. But when  
He was not far away again  
From his house, the centurion  
Sent friends to him to tell him drawn,  
"Sir, do not trouble yourself now,

For I'm not worthy that your brow  
 Come under my roof anyhow.  
 7 "That's why I did not deign to come  
 To you myself. But say in sum  
 The word and my slave will be rum.  
 8 "For I'm a man also of power,  
 With soldier under me to scour,  
 And I tell one to go, and he  
 Goes. And to another to come,  
 And he comes. To my slave in sum,  
 'Do this!' And he does faithfully."  
 9 When Jesus heard these words, then he  
 Was amazed, and turned to the crowd  
 Behind him, he told them aloud,  
 "I tell you that I have not found  
 Such faith in all of Israel's ground."  
 10 The messengers when they returned  
 To the house with what they had learned  
 Found the slave well *for what he earned*.

The army teaches all men to obey,  
 And that is seen in what he came to say  
 When the centurion admired the way  
 Of Jesus and his power to offer sway.  
 Yet Jesus call the army discipline  
 The greatest sort of faith that came to win  
 In all of Israel alive that day.  
 My Quaker ancestry is like to think  
 The attitude of Your sent one doth stink.  
 Although Penn wore the sword as long as  
 he  
 Could do so in good conscience and  
 degree,  
 No one called army discipline the best  
 Of faith. That waits for colours of a vest  
 Dominionist, pariah of the West.

11 It happened on the next day he  
 Went into another city  
 Called Nain. And many of his folk  
 Went with him, and a crowd for broke.  
 12 As he came near the city gate,  
 See one just dead was coming late  
 Carried upon a bier, the son  
 Of a mother who had just one,  
 And she was a widow undone.  
 A large crowd came with her *unspun*.  
 13 When the lord saw her overcome  
 With pity and told her in sum  
 To stop her weeping. 14 When he'd come  
 Up near it, he touched the bier and  
 The bearers bearing came to stand.

And he said "Young man, I tell you  
 To get up *and look on the view*."  
 15 The dead one sat up and began  
 To speak. And he gave him by plan  
 To his mum. 16 And fear came on all  
 And they praised God, saying in thrall,  
 "A great prophet has come to call  
 Among us and God has returned  
 To His folk *to see what they've learned*."  
 17 This thing about him went abroad  
 In all Judaea for a prod.

For all the blame that's been placed on the  
 run  
 Of mill in Israel when the day was done  
 That Jesus walked the earth, they had more  
 sense  
 Than Christians following in pagan tents.  
 When Jesus raised the dead, they did not  
 cry  
 Like heathen shouting to Paul on the sly  
 That he is god himself. No they came clean  
 And shouted that a great prophet is seen.  
 Beloved, the futile and unfaithful roar  
 Of church and vestal virgin at the door  
 To say that Jesus is one God the Son  
 Still reigns and pains the world and not for  
 fun.  
 They still think all's repaired by killing one  
 Or two in Middle East under the sun.

18 And John's disciples came to tell  
 Him what happened in Israel.  
 19 And John summoned two of his own  
 Disciples and sent out alone  
 To Jesus saying "Are you he  
 Whom we await, or should we see  
 Another to come by decree?"  
 20 And the men came to him and said  
 "John the Baptist sent us outspread  
 To you to ask you if you are  
 The coming one or should a star  
 Be still expected coming far?"  
 21 Right then he was engaged in healing  
 Many diseases and the feeling  
 Of plagues and evil spirits too.  
 And he gave many blind their view.  
 22 Jesus replied and answered them,  
 "Go and report to John the gem  
 Of what you saw and heard, the blind  
 See once again, the lame resigned  
 Walk and the leprous are cleansed too,

The deaf come hearing, the dead do  
Rise up, and the poor hear *anew*  
The gospel preached to them *in pew*.  
23 "Blessed is the one without offense  
For what I do in their presence."

The preachers love to contrast the word of  
John the Baptist to Jesus hand in glove  
When he came to be baptised with the  
shove,  
And this word of doubt as supposed he said  
From prison where for faith he had been  
led.

That is a wicked thing to do by me.  
John is a sinless creature of degree,  
Which is why he was put to death in spree.  
Jesus will meet the same fate, not because  
Without bloodshed You cannot save Your  
laws  
And save mankind from death's uncomely  
claws.

As it was then, so it remains, so still.  
All good men are crucified, come what  
will,  
By faint praise or by death on Calvary's  
hill.

24 When John's messengers went their  
way,  
He said to the crowds in their sway  
About John, "What did you go out  
Into the wilderness redoubt  
To see? A reed shake in the wind?  
25 "What did you go out *winged or finned*  
To see? A man dressed in fine cloth?  
Behold, those dressed in splendid froth  
Are in the luxury that's found  
In royal palaces around.  
26 "But what did you go out to see?  
A prophet? Yea, I say freely,  
A prophet and yet more truly.  
27 "This is the one of whom he wrote:  
Behold, I send out one to tote  
My message before your face, who  
Will prepare your way before you.  
28 "For I say to you, among those  
Born of a woman, none arose  
A prophet greater than John  
The Baptist. But the least upon  
The kingdom of God's greater than  
He is *in kingdom's final plan*."

John was the greatest of prophets because  
He saw with his own eyes the hopes of  
each

Of ancient prophets come alive to preach  
In that salvation prepared from the jaws  
Of time eternal to meet Roman claws.  
John was the least after the ripened peach  
Of the Messiah, son of David's reach,  
Because he did not live to see its laws.  
Beloved, the days are long past since arose  
The rushing of the spirit's wind that chose  
The fair apostles on a far-off day.  
Beloved, the years are long since peace  
would close  
The canon with Islam in final ray,  
The heart of man with You alone in sway.

29 The folk and tax collectors heard  
All this and justified God's word  
For having been baptised in herd  
Of *John the Baptist with heart stirred*.  
30 But Pharisees and lawyers set aside  
God's counsel for their part and to deride,  
Not being baptised by him *in the hide*.

Are You best pleased, Beloved, by sinful  
ones

Who are moved by a preacher from their  
buns  
Because he has a following with noise?  
Or are You pleased with scholarship and  
poise?

I tend myself to have respect more for  
The latter. Rank emotions for their score  
Are easily manipulated more.  
It's not the guru cult or popular  
In John that makes of him the greater star,  
But the fact that he called repentance' bar,  
Forsaking of such sins that were and are.  
Beloved, neither the charismatic gift  
So-called, nor scholarship can ever lift  
The soul into repentance without rift.

31 The lord said "To what shall I now  
Compare the men alive somehow?  
And what are they like anyhow?  
32 "They are like children where they sit  
In market calling out in fit  
To one another, saying too,  
'We piped to you, you did not dance,  
We were lamenting for your lance,  
And you did not weep at the chance.'

33 "For John the Baptist came in view  
 Eating no feast nor drinking wine,  
 And you say a demon in fine.  
 34 "The son of man came eating and  
 Drinking, and you say out of hand  
 See a man gluttonous, a drunk,  
 A friend of tax-collecting skunk  
 And sinners *who in sin are sunk*.  
 35 "But wisdom's justified of all  
 Her children *settled in their stall*.

This bit of folklore Jesus has preserved  
 From ancient times is just what they  
 deserved  
 Who would not be satisfied with the rate  
 Of either John or Jesus in their state.  
 But that is neither here nor now for me,  
 Who am so stuck on anthropology.  
 What game went along with the words they  
 sang  
 In Nazareth's small streets with shout and  
 clang?  
 None knows today perhaps, but I think  
 back  
 Upon those golden days of Jesus track  
 And figure he must have played with a will  
 Upon the green of Nazareth's near hill.  
 Beloved, my own play is as long ago  
 It seems as Jesus' games all in a row.

36 A certain Pharisee invited  
 Him home to lunch at his house cited.  
 And he went in and lay at table.  
 37 And see, this woman who was known  
 As a sinner in town of stone,  
 When she found out as she was able  
 That he reclined there at the table  
 In the house of the Pharisee,  
 She took an alabaster wee  
 Bottle of perfume and sweetly  
 38 Stood at his feet and wept behind,  
 Washing his feet with tears made blind,  
 And wiped them with hair of her head.  
 She kissed his feet with heat and poured  
 Perfume upon them from unstored.  
 39 The Pharisee who had invited  
 Him saw that as though so incited,  
 Said to himself if this one truly  
 Had been a prophet, he unduly  
 Would have known and well what this  
 wench  
 Who touches him is, sinful stench.

The sins of sex in other time and place  
 Were thought the worst among the human  
 race,

Perhaps because a woman can be blamed  
 In most of them, if not the men inflamed.  
 It does not take a prophet here to know  
 Who is or who is not a wench in show,  
 So that the Pharisee erred in the way  
 He thought to make Jesus Christ come to  
 pay.

Beloved, I too shed fervent tears of love  
 Upon the memory of Jesus dove,  
 And wipe the perfume from his feet where  
 I

Bend to pour out on them the costly dye.  
 The past is past hope, and the future ray  
 Is certain for just this portion of day.

40 Jesus answered the man and said  
 "Simon, I have a bone to spread."  
 He said "Rabbi, speak out instead."  
 41 There were two debtors to a man  
 Who lent money, the one in span  
 Owed five hundred dinars in can,  
 The other just fifty in plan.  
 42 As neither had wherewith to pay,  
 He freely forgave both *that day*.  
 Then which of them now would you say  
 Will love him better in his way?  
 43 In answer to that Simon said  
 "I guess the one to whom was spread  
 The greater sum forgiven by."  
 He told him, "You chose the right guy."  
 44 He turned to the woman and said  
 To Simon, "Do you see this head?  
 I came into your house and you  
 Did not give water for the due  
 Washing of my feet, but she came  
 And washed my feet with tears *of shame*  
 And wiped them with hair of her head.  
 45 "You gave me no kiss, but she did  
 Not stop kissing my feet, *the kid*,  
 From the time I came at your bid.  
 46 "You did not anoint my head here  
 With oil but she came with her tear  
 Anointing my feet with perfume.  
 47 "That's why I tell you in her room  
 Her many sins are loosed, that's why  
 She has loved much *without a try*.  
 But to whom little is forgiven,  
 He loves but little *having striven*."

48 He told her, "Your sins are forgiven."  
49 And those who lay nearby with him  
Said to themselves, "And by what whim  
Does this one claim to forgive sin?"  
50 But he told the woman come in,  
"Your faith has saved you, go in peace."  
*That's how Jesus came to release.*

No one is ever saved in Jesus' eyes  
But by their own faith risen in disguise.  
It's never by Your grace or power or hope,  
Nor by his purity or golden rope.  
No one is ever saved but by the way  
She lays hold on the love of just today,  
And touches heaven while working night  
and clay.

No one is ever saved by other's grope.  
Beloved, I may be saved, I may be not,  
It is not mine to grasp within Your plot,  
But better than salvation is the love  
I bear to You while in the push and shove  
Of market and of worship where the sun  
Illuminates the birds of Mecca won.

### **Luke 8**

1 It happened after that he went  
In every town and village sent  
To preach and proclaim gospel meant  
Of God's kingdom. And the twelve came  
Along with him *to share his fame.*  
2 Also certain women who had  
Been cured of ill and spirits bad:  
Mary called Magdalene from whom  
The seven demons had left room,  
3 And Joanna wife of Chuza,  
Herod's steward, and Susanna,  
And many others who served him  
With their possessions' gear and trim.  
4 And a great crowd gathered with those  
In every town he came and chose.  
He spoke a parable, suppose.  
5 The sower went to sow his seed.  
And as he sowed, one fell indeed  
Beside the road and trampled down,  
The birds of the sky gobbled down.  
6 Another fell upon the rock,  
And sprouted, but dried up in stock,  
Not having water from the dock.  
7 Another fell amid the thorns,  
And growing up in the thorns' bournes,  
They choked it *with crowding and scorns.*  
8 Another fell on the good earth,

And grew up to produce of worth  
Fruit hundredfold. Saying these things  
He shouted, "The one in whom rings  
His ears let him hear my teachings."

The parable's a form of poetry,  
And those who hear it judge by imagery,  
Or rhyme's or metre's regularity.  
They want the levels of thought to increase,  
As though the round of seasons must  
release

The contemplation of cycle of birth  
And life and aging on the puckered earth.  
But fie upon the expectations that  
Determine the views of the thin and fat.  
The art of poetry is simply flat  
Expression in words the experience  
That may or may not make someone some  
sense.

It parts from prose in being more direct,  
The exclamation that I might select.

9 And his disciples questioned him,  
Saying "What is this parable?"

10 And he said "To you it is trim  
To know the mysteries of God's  
Kingdom, but to the rest in full  
Are parables among the clods,  
That seeing they might never see,  
And hearing they might come to be  
Without understanding in fee.

11 And this is the parable, see:  
The seed is God's word by decree.

12 Those by the roadside are those who  
Hear, and then the Devil comes to  
Take away the word from their heart,  
Lest they might believe for their part,  
And be saved. 13 And those on the rock  
Are those who, when they hear the stock,  
Receive the word with joy, and these  
Are without root, but in their ease  
Believe for a time, and in time  
Of trouble, they reverse the climb.

14 And those that fell in the thorn bush  
Are those who hear but then the push  
Of care and riches and the rife  
Pleasures of their own earthly life  
Choke them and they do not bear fruit  
In their maturity to suit.

15 And those in the good ground are those  
Who with right and good heart they chose  
To hear the word and keep and bear



Fruit in their patience in full share.

Four portals guard all life: the gate of law  
Where Satan comes to steal the work of  
straw;

The way of love, a moment's joy to pass  
And leave the soul withered upon the grass;  
The way of full awareness of all things  
In heaven and earth, which ends in riches'  
stings;

And finally the portal of truth where  
There is no self competing with Self's  
share,

But where the word of Decalogue bears  
fruit

In law and love and awareness to boot.  
Beloved, I grasp the hidden explanation  
And look out on the world of expiation,  
The road, the rock, the thorn, and the good  
earth,

The fourth gate where I come to take my  
berth.

16 But no one who lights a lamp sets  
A pot over it or then gets  
It under a canopy, but  
Sets it on a lampstand unshut,  
So those who come in see the light,  
*And are not left out in the night.*

17 For nothing's hidden which will not  
Be revealed in the mystery's plot.

18 So watch how you hear, for the one  
Who has may be given for fun,  
And the one who does not have may  
Have taken from him his last ray.

19 His mother and his brothers came  
To him, and could not for the claim  
Of the crowd get near him for fame.

20 And they told him and said "Your mum  
And your brothers stand there and strum,  
Hoping to see you in the hum."

21 And he replied and said to them,  
"My mother and my brothers' hem  
Are these: the one who come to hear  
The word of God, and do *with fear*."

Two choices lie before me in the wood,  
Two roads to quote Jack Frost as if for  
good:

I can keep on with sinning and just take  
Belief in Jesus' name for saving's sake,  
Or then I can become his brother dear

By keeping Your commandments in my ear  
And in my hand to do them in Your fear.  
I'd rather be a brother to the man,  
The Christ, than be saved by his blood in  
plan,

And remain outside obedience clan.  
To each his own. I walk and talk with him  
Along the Sabbath and the hill's stone rim  
And call him brother, something I've not  
had,

Rather than breaking Your law like a cad.

22 It happened on one of the days  
That he and his disciples' *maze*  
Entered into a boat. And he  
Said to them, "Let's go over, *see*,  
To the other side of the lake."

And they put out to sea *in wake*.

23 And as they sailed he fell asleep.  
And a windstorm came up to sweep  
Across the lake, and they were filled  
And were in danger *to be spilled*.

24 They came and woke him and they said  
"O master, master, we are dead!"

And he woke up then to rebuke  
The wind and water, for a fluke  
They ceased and there was a calm *spread*.

25 And he said to them, "Where's your  
faith?"

And they were afraid and amazed,  
And said to one another crazed,  
"Who then is this one who commands  
Even the wind, water *on sands*,  
And they obey him *as though dazed*?"

The rocking of the boat made some to fear,  
While to another as it would appear,  
It was the lulling into sleep and dreams.  
The universe is never what it seems.  
Reality has myriad faces known  
To myriads more before the divine throne.  
I lie asleep within the rocking boat  
In which some find their wealth is still  
afloat

And others meet the spectre of despair,  
The scythe of hunger and the threat of care.  
I look on both as dreams and far away,  
Hung here between the life of power and  
sway

And life of dying before hope and ray.  
The fate of men is hanging on a hair.

26 They sailed down to the Gadarenes' Country, which is opposite scenes Of Galilee. 27 And he went out Into the country, and a stout Man from the town met him, who had Demons for a long time and bad. He did not dress in clothing nor Did he stay in a house or store, But lived among the tombs *on gore*. 28 He saw Jesus and he cried out, He fell down before him with shout, And said "What's for me and for you, Jesus, son of God, Most High true? I beg you, don't torment me too."

I'd ware of calling Jesus son of God, Since that's the favourite title in the prod Of demons in Luke's testifying pod. I'd flee the more from saying God the Son, A formula that's not found under sun Of Scripture, but only where heathen run. I'd take Your sent one for just what he is And's said to be exactly in the whiz Of Scripture, and no more and if not less. You have not left Your people here to guess.

Beloved, if I'm a Biblicist at heart And in the practice of my humble part, That sets me off from every church and creed And leaves me all alone before Your need.

29 For he ordered the unclean fiend To come out of the man unbeaned. For oftentimes it had seized him, And he was bound with chains and grim Irons under guard, but he would tear The fetters off and go somewhere Into the wilderness cast out By demon powers showing their clout. 30 And Jesus asked him, "What's your name?"

And he said "Legion" for in blame Had many demons laid their claim.

When Jesus asks the demon now his name Before the great establishment in claim, He answers still and ever as the same A legion of sects risen to their shame. The Christian soul is now infested with Denominations all founded on myth And human efforts to circumvent what

You once proclaimed on Sinai in a nut Shell to be the criterion of all, Of faith and life and person in the stall, Of church and mosque and synagogue come late.

Beloved, the clamour of the demons' call Is still with me, but I turn back the pall And find Your throne, Your love, Your safety's gate.

31 And they begged him not to command Them into the abyss to stand.

32 There was a passel of swine there Feeding upon the mountain's share. And they begged him that he'd allow Them to go into them somehow.

And he gave them leave *if they dare*.

33 The demons came out of the man And entered in the swine by plan, And the whole herd rushed down the cliff Into the lake and all drowned stiff.

34 The herdsman saw the thing and fled, Reported in the town and said To all the farms about them spread.

35 They went out to investigate, And came to Jesus to relate, And found the man from whom went out The spirits sitting at the feet Of Jesus, clothed and in mind stout, And they were afraid to repeat.

36 And also those who had seen it Described how the one with a fit Was healed. 37 And all the multitude Of the neighbourhood of the brood Of Gadarenes were filled with fear. And they begged him to leave his gear And go from them. And he got in The boat and left *that place of sin*.

What did Jesus expect after he chose To destroy so much property and those Beasts that the Torah gives no right to slaughter?

His hopes were drowned with the swine in the water

If he thought Gadarenes would come to hear

His teaching and his preaching without peer.

Of course it could be argued that the swine Were not by Torah legal tender tine, Not property at all, despite the way

Their guardians had come to make them  
pay.  
The argument both theological  
And legal notwithstanding, final sal  
Was Jesus had to leave. Beloved, let pigs  
Not keep me from Your sent ones in their  
digs.

38 The man cured of the demons prayed  
Him to be with him. Jesus stayed  
To send him on his way and said  
39 "Go back to your house and tell all  
That God has done for you in stall."  
And he went off proclaiming through  
All the town what Jesus could do.

Most people under the sun wonder why  
Jesus did not let the healed man stay by  
Him and become a pillar in the church.  
Instead he left him alone in the lurch.  
The fact is the lone dervish has the best  
Of portions. He does not have to invest  
In wranglings and in quarrels. He's a guest  
In every court and highway on the way  
Through the four gates of heaven and  
earthly sway.

Beloved, I had tried the locks on the doors  
Of every temple You have in Your stores,  
And in Your grace abundant all turned me  
Aside and out into eternity.  
Your praises are my temple and Your fee.

40 It happened when Jesus came back,  
The crowd was glad to get him back,  
For they all waited for his share.

41 And see, a man named Jairus came,  
And this one was ruler of fame  
Of a synagogue. And he fell  
At Jesus' feet and begged him well  
To come into his house a spell,  
42 Because his only daughter born  
Of about twelve years, it was worn  
That she was dying. As he went,  
The crowd pressed all about him bent.

The contrast between the centurion  
And the chief of the synagogue when done  
Was not so much in faith but modesty.  
I've often thought a soldier in degree  
More modest than the preacher on his  
spree.

The pattern is almost an absolute,

Despite the fact that soldiers to the root  
Are killers in their way. But so are men  
Of the cloth when they turn around again.  
But all men are united in the face  
Of death and the fear of it that they trace.  
I contemplate the evidence and wonder  
That I too fear the lightning and the  
thunder.

It's life I choose each day as well as grace.

43 A woman having haemorrhage  
For twelve years and spent heritage  
On the physicians all in vain,  
44 Came up behind him, she was fain  
To touch the fringes of his cloak,  
*Though not neglecting what he spoke,*  
And straight away the haemorrhage  
Stopped. 45 Jesus then said at that stage,  
"Who touched me?" All denied the charge,  
Peter and those with him at large  
Said "Master, the crowds press and barge,  
And jostle you. And do you say  
'Who has now touched me on the way?'"  
46 But Jesus said "Someone touched me,  
For I felt virtue leaving me."  
47 And seeing she had been found out,  
The woman came trembling in rout  
And fell prostrated before him  
And told him before all the grim  
People why she touched him and how  
Straight off she had been healed somehow.  
48 And he said to her, "Daughter, be  
Comforted. Your faith made you free.  
Go in peace *and without a row.*"

Which is it, my Beloved? The virtue that  
Jesus felt leaving body where he sat,  
Or the faith of the woman in her touch,  
And in her hoping and awaiting much?  
Both superstition and the sacred tale  
Combine here to make up the tended whale  
With scientific convention that hope  
Is healer with a sixty per cent scope.  
Reality is too complex by far  
To be attached to any sort of star,  
The supernatural or scientific,  
Neither suffice to explain the specific.  
The mind of man continues to the end  
To wonder and find explanations friend.

49 As he still spoke, someone came out  
To tell the synagogue chief stout,

“Your daughter's dead. Do not think more  
To trouble the teacher from door.”

50 But Jesus heard and answered him,  
Saying “Do not fear and be grim,  
Only believe and she'll restore.”

51 He came into the house and he  
Did not allow anyone free

To go in except Peter and  
James and John and the father and  
The mother of the girl to stand.

52 And all were weeping with a wail.  
But he said “Stop the weeping's tale.  
She has not died, but is asleep.”

53 They mocked him because they knew  
well

She had succumbed to dying's spell.

54 But he put them all outside and  
Took hold of the young daughter's hand  
And called out saying, “Child, get up.”

55 Her breath returned and she got up  
Straight off. And he commanded then  
That she be given food again.

56 Her parents were amazed, but he  
Commanded them not to agree  
To tell anyone of the spree.

Just raising people from the dead does not  
Prove that the one You sent to earthly plot  
Is God Almighty. After all, there were  
Elijah and Elisha to concur.  
He did the thing by the power and the grant  
You gave him to uproot as well as plant.  
If You had given me such power to choose,  
You would see how many in this world  
loose.

I'd raise up every child that goes to sleep  
Until no coffins were made small and deep,  
But only double-sized for those who share  
The extra-large sizes in Western wear.  
Beloved, consider what such powers might  
do

Before You grant me such to stir the stew.

### **Luke 9**

1 He summoned his twelve friends and  
gave

Them power and authority grave  
Over all demons and to heal  
Diseases *for the woe and weal.*

2 And he sent them out to proclaim  
The kingdom of God and at same  
Time heal the sick. 3 He said to them,

Take nothing for the way in hem,  
No staff nor purse nor bread nor coin,  
Nor even two coats to enjoin.

4 And into what house you go in,  
Remain there, do not leave it's din.

5 As many as who don't receive you,  
Go from that town not to believe you  
And shake its dust from off your feet  
In witness against their defeat.

6 They went out and passed through the  
towns,

Proclaiming the gospel with frowns  
And healing everywhere the beat.

7 Herod the tetrarch heard all these  
Things that happened through him at ease,  
And he was wondering because

Some said John had been raised from claws  
Of death, 8 and by some Elijah

Had appeared, and others a prophet  
Of ancient times rose not to scoff at.

9 And Herod said, “John I behended,  
But who is this who is unfetid,  
Of whom I hear such things?” And he  
Tried to meet him in company.

The preachers tell me that forgiveness and  
Eternal life is something from Your hand  
To give only to those who understand  
That Jesus rose up from the dead as  
planned.

That simply is unjust, if that is true.  
The first way You prepared would better  
do:

To keep the ten commandments in Your  
love,

And repent of not keeping them in glove  
To have Your grace forgiving and in need.  
But this rumour of John just spoils the seed.  
It shows that whether Jesus rose or not,  
It was inevitable in the plot  
That some would say he rose up from the  
rot.

Set up no vague conditions, so I plead.

10 The disciples came back and told  
Him the things they had done out cold.  
He took them privately apart  
In to a country town *from start*  
Called Bethsaida. 11 But the crowds knew  
And followed him. They came in crew  
And he spoke to them all about  
The kingdom of God. He was stout

To cure those in need of cures too.

12 But the day was coming to end.  
The twelve came to him saying "Friend,  
Let the crowd go to town and farm  
To find food and lodging from harm,  
Because we're in a desert warm."

13 But he told them, "Give them to eat."  
But they said "We don't have complete  
More than five loaves and two of fishes,  
Unless we buy for all their wishes."

14 For there were about five thousand  
Men, but he told his friends in hand,  
"Make them sit down in groups of fifty."

15 And they did so, and all sat *nifty*.

16 And taking the five loaves and two  
Fish, he looked up to heaven's view,  
And blessed them, and broke, and gave to  
The disciples to serve the crew.  
17 They ate and were all filled. And twelve  
Baskets of leftovers to shelve  
Were taken up *after the due*.

Jesus gets in a fight with Pharisees  
About washing his hands before with ease  
Eating bread. That's because he does not  
take

Traditions of the elders on the make,  
But only Torah to guide his life's breeze.  
Then why does he go in oral tradition  
Of blessing the food as if by sedition?  
That's not commanded in the Torah more  
Than washing hands in ritual and gore.  
He's like all men I know who choose the  
right.

They still keep to some things they learned  
in sight

From their background's surroundings for a  
blight.

Beloved, keep me in Decalogue to last,  
All other considerations outcast.

18 It happened as he prayed alone,  
The disciples stayed by the throne.  
He asked them, saying "Who do folk  
Say that I am and at a stroke?"

19 They answered and said "Baptist John,  
And others say Elijah drawn,  
And others that some ancient prophet  
Has risen again *not to scoff at*."

20 He asked them, "But who do you say  
I am?" And Peter spoke away,  
"You are the Christ of God *in sway*."

I'm willing to believe that Jesus came  
As Christ of God before the Jewish claim  
Against the Roman balustrade of shame.

I'm willing to believe it with a will  
And follow the man to the darker hill.  
But I'm not willing to believe a man  
Is God Almighty and Creator's span,  
Simply because Your Torah makes it plain  
That You are not a man nor son and sane  
Of any man born in the earthly fane.  
It does not help to say he is the son  
Not of man but of woman on the run,  
Because he himself claims his right to be  
The son of man and not eternity.

21 He strictly warned them not to tell,  
22 Saying "Son of man goes through hell  
To be rejected by the old,  
The chief priests and the scribes who're  
bold

To kill him but he shall be raised  
Up on the third day *and be praised*."

23 He said to all, "If anyone  
Desires to come after my bun,  
Let him deny himself and take  
Up his load daily for my sake,  
And let him follow in my wake.

24 "The one who would save his own life  
Will lose it, but who in the strife  
Loses his life for my sake will  
Be one to save it and save still.

25 "For what profit is to a man  
Who gains the whole world in a span,  
But destroys his soul losing plan?

26 "Whoever is ashamed of me  
And my words, son of man will be  
Ashamed of that one when he comes  
In his glory and Father's sums,  
And with the holy angels' hums.

27 "But truly I tell you, there are  
Some standing here who'll have no bar,  
But shall not taste death till they see  
The kingdom of God *visibly*."

In every day and age, in every crowd,  
There are those few that have once been  
allowed

To see Your kingdom come down from the  
sky  
And settle like a dove upon the head  
Of one or two who pass the pleasures by

That grate the world, who by Your law are  
led.

In Jesus' day a few heard what he said  
And entered in the kingdom divine and  
Saw the accomplishment of all at hand.  
Beloved, bring down Your kingdom on me  
now

Today and everyday, if not in sight,  
Then in Your kingdom's law by day and  
night.

I turn from every government and church  
And rush into temples of fir and birch.

28 About eight days after these words,  
It happened, taking in their herds  
Peter and John and James, he went  
Into the hill to pray as spent.

29 And as he prayed his countenance  
Was changed and his clothing to glance  
Was shining white and not by chance.

30 And see, two men talked with him there:  
Moses and Elijah laid bare.

I just wonder how they knew that the men  
Who stood with Jesus were Moses again  
And Elijah. The two stated before  
As living in celestial gate and store  
Were Enoch and Elijah and not Moses.  
So why assume it was Moses that chose us?  
Unless he introduced himself in flame,  
Or Jesus told them afterwards the claim,  
Both things left unreported in the text,  
I stay here reading these words still  
perplexed.

This presumes resurrection if it's true  
That Moses appeared in body and view.  
That puts the Gospel in polemics known  
For the first century of Jewish groan.

31 They came in glory and spoke of  
His coming entry in *the love*  
Jerusalem. 32 But Peter and  
Those with him were pressed as in hand  
Of sleep. But waking fully, they  
Saw his glory, and two men stay  
With him. 33 It happened as they left  
That Peter told Jesus bereft,  
“Sir, it is good for us to be  
Here, and I say let us make three  
Tents, one for you, and one for Moses,  
And one for Elijah's discloses,”  
For he was out of his own tree.

The first thing some folk want to do when  
they

See visions of glory among the hay,  
Is start a church and build a tabernacle.  
Young Brigham did so as soon as could  
tackle

The desert and the salt flats lost in bay.  
Beloved, I too would like a church or  
people,  
With or without a dome or sovereign  
steeple,

Where I was welcomed in on Sabbath day  
To sing the Psalms and hear the people  
pray.

But truth is not vouchsafed to brick and  
stone,

Nor to the hearts made hard as flinted bone  
That stand around the marketplaces here,  
The Roman and Genevan and the peer  
Of London left in Canterbury's steer.

34 As he said these things, a cloud came  
And overshadowed them *in flame*.

They feared to enter in the same.

35 And a voice came out of the cloud,  
And said “This is My son, I'm proud  
To love him, hear his word aloud.”

You called David Your son in days long  
past

To make against heathendom a contrast,  
To topple stories of such kings whose  
mums

Lay with the gods and bore heroes and  
bums.

The human father of David's secure  
In epic poetry of Ruth and sure.

He was Your son because You found him  
pure

And promised him eternal kingdom won.

Now You speak aloud to Jesus and show  
Him son of David on the run and go.

How then does that blaspheming voice  
arise

To make him one among those pagan guys  
Whose mothers were the whores of gods  
who stalk

The virgins of their people and give talk?

36 As the voice rose, Jesus remained  
Alone. And they quietly gained.

And they told no one what they saw  
 In those days *before tooth and claw*.  
 37 It happened on the next day they  
 Came down from the mountain to stray,  
 And a large crowd met in the way.  
 38 And see, a man called out aloud  
 From the crowd, saying, "Teacher *proud*,  
 I beg you to look at my son,  
 Because his is the only one.  
 39 "And see, a spirit takes him and  
 Straight off cries out and puts in band  
 Of trembling and foaming, and then  
 Leaves him with sore and bruise again.  
 40 "I prayed your disciples that they  
 Should cast it out, in vain I say."  
 41 Jesus replied and said "O you  
 Who disbelieve among this crew,  
 Perverted ones, how long shall I  
 Be with you and put up with sty?  
 Bring your son here another try."  
 42 But as he came the demon tore  
 Him and vehemently in store  
 Convulsed him. But Jesus laid in  
 To the unclean spirit with din  
 And healed the child, and gave him back  
 To his father *and without slack*.  
 43 All were amazed by divine power.  
 And as all marvelled in that hour  
 At the things which he did, then said  
 Jesus to his disciples *led*,  
 44 "Keep in your ears these words of mine,  
 For son of man will soon resign  
 Betrayed into the hands of men."  
 45 But they did not understand this,  
 And it was veiled so they would miss.  
 And they feared to ask about this.

When Matthew wrote of this warning that  
 son  
 Of man would be betrayed and killed for  
 fun,  
 He did not mention that a veil was set  
 On purpose on the heart of his friends met.  
 If You, Beloved, laid a restraining hand  
 Upon their hearts and minds and by  
 command,  
 Then we today, as sweeter Christians stand,  
 Do not well to blame them for what we get.  
 Beloved, the veils of time and place lie still  
 Upon my ears and eyes, and so fulfil  
 The gesture of creation on the bill.  
 And yet beyond the veils I see the light

Of Your throne and Your presence shining  
 bright,  
 Let say what will the enemy in sight.

46 But they began to argue more,  
 Which of them was greatest in score.  
 47 Jesus saw the argument in  
 Their heart, and took a child of kin  
 And stood him beside his own place.  
 48 He said to them, "The one with grace  
 To receive this child in my name  
 Receives me also just the same.  
 And whoever receives me too  
 Receives the one who sent me due.  
 For the one being least of all  
 Shall be the greatest one in stall."  
 49 And John replied and said withal,  
 "Master, we saw one casting out  
 Demons in your name, and with shout  
 We stopped him because he does not  
 Follow along with us in plot."  
 50 And Jesus told them, "Don't forbid,  
 The one who's not against us hid  
 In our favour *under our lid*.

There are a good many around today  
 Who are like Jesus' disciples in play.  
 They don't accept the charity that's done  
 By those of another sect under sun  
 As worthy of reward of thanks when spun.  
 The good the Catholics do, though more  
 than all,  
 Is just swill in the bucket of the pall  
 Of independent Baptists at the ball.  
 And Sunnis can do no good, though they  
 might  
 Fill all the world with Muhammad's fair  
 light.  
 Beloved, extinguish in me all desire  
 To judge another by his label's fire.  
 Fill up my Buddhist, Hindu, Christian heart  
 With Jewish, Muslim lights to do my part.

51 It happened when the time approached  
 For him to be taken reproached,  
 He turned toward Jerusalem  
 To go up in the city's hem.  
 52 He sent his messengers before  
 His face, and they went in the store  
 Of a town of Samaritans,  
 So as to make ready his plans.  
 53 And they did not receive him since

His face was toward Jerusalem.

54 James and John his friends saw to wince  
And said "Sir, is your stratagem  
That we tell fire to come down from  
The sky to destroy every bum  
As did Elijah *for a gem?*"

55 But he turned and rebuked them and  
He said "You don't know contraband  
In what spirit you take in hand.

56 "For son of man did not come here  
To destroy men's lives as in fear  
But to save." And they went into  
Another village still in view.

They say Jesus was a Samaritan,  
But that was just a way to plague the man.  
And yet he does not hate that brood as such  
Who were of his own nation ought as  
much.

That does not make him universalist,  
But only lover of those who resist  
Temptation not to keep the Sabbath day.  
It's Sabbath-keepers Jesus loves and may.  
Beloved, Your sent one ought to be more  
broad

Minded upon the earthly sort of sod,  
And accept equally those who keep Sunday  
And leave the Sabbath for both work and  
fun day.

Then only can he be considered fair,  
A Christian sort of gentlemen and ware.

57 It happened as they went that way  
One said to him, "I will not stray  
From following upon your way  
Wherever you may go, sir, too."

58 And Jesus told him, "Foxes do  
Have holes and the birds of the sky  
Have nests, but son of man to lie  
Has nowhere to lay down his head."

59 And to another one he said  
"Follow me." But he told him, "Sir,  
Let me go bury my dad first."

60 But Jesus said to him, "Let stir  
The dead to bury the dead, thirst  
To go announce God's kingdom worst."

61 Also another said "I will  
Follow you, sir, but first I still  
Must take leave of those in my house."

62 But Jesus told him, "Any spouse  
Who puts his hand to the plough and  
Looks back, is not fit one to stand

In the kingdom of God *I've planned.*"

As far back as good Tobit I can see  
That virtue is in burying's decree.  
The man who tells us not to bury kin  
Is aiding an abetting, fearful sin.  
Not only is the matter of respect,  
But one of hygiene or of such neglect.  
Besides that Jesus pretends poverty  
Beyond degree of his reality.  
He has a dozen rich women who give  
Far more than he could need to thrive and  
live.

Beloved, the dervish following is still  
The best thing that we have upon the hill,  
Pretending to be poor is still the faith  
To keep me from the churchly sort of  
wraith.

### **Luke 10**

1 After these things the Lord appointed  
Seventy others more *anointed*,  
And sent them two by two before  
His face into each city's *door*  
And place where he Himself intended  
To go. 2 Then he said unoffended  
To them, "The harvest truly's great,  
But the labourers few *in state*,  
Therefore pray YHWH of the harvest  
To send out labourers and blessed  
Into his harvest. 3 "Go your way,  
Indeed, I send you out as gay  
As lambs among wolves. 4 "Carry not  
Money bag, knapsack, nor the plot  
Of sandals, and greet no one by  
The wayside. 5 "But whatever house  
You enter, first say *to the spouse*,  
'Peace to this house.' 6 "And if a son  
Of peace is there, your peace begun  
Will rest on it, if not, it will  
Return to you *to fit the bill*.

A son of peace, now is that not the same  
As son of Islam, or if name's a name,  
A son of God? I turn my head for shame  
To hear the quibble arise in such blame.  
Peace to the house, if son of peace is there.  
How can peace have a son, that has no hair  
Or arms or legs not to mention the fair  
And hidden parts when siring is done  
there?



Beloved, You sent one to the world to  
 speak  
 And he was called both son of man and  
 bleak  
 The son of God, and that makes right nor  
 wrong  
 But he was also prince's of peace song.  
 You bear no sons at all, no, and not  
 daughters.  
 But still You have Your sons full at the  
 slaughters.

7 And stay in the same house to eat  
 And drink the things they give as meat,  
 For the worker is worthy to  
 Take his hire. Do not move from view  
 Of one house to another's pew.  
 8 Whatever city you go in  
 And they receive you *without sin*,  
 Eat the things set upon your tin.  
 9 And heal the sick in it, and say  
 To them, "God's kingdom's come in sway."  
 10 But in whatever town you go,  
 And they do not receive your flow,  
 Go out into its streets and say  
 11 "Even the dust on us to stay  
 From your town, we shake of today  
 Against you. Yet know this indeed,  
 That God's kingdom came near your seed."  
 12 And I tell you that on that day  
 It shall be more fun in the sway  
 Of Sodom that for that town's way.

I might think that my preaching has been  
 heard  
 And set aside by mouse and hare and bird,  
 To say no word at all of humankind.  
 And yet the ego of man is thing blind.  
 More like the Gospel of the ant and fly  
 That I neglect to see as I pass by  
 On my trips up the wooded hill to take  
 A wondered glance at tree and sky and lake  
 If worthy of the dust to shake at me  
 From wing and foot of crusty bumblebee.  
 I see, Beloved, Your message in all things,  
 My own heart and the voice of nature's  
 springs,  
 And so repent at last most bitterly  
 That just this morning I began to see.

13 Woe to you Chorazim! And woe  
 To you Bethsaida! If the row

Of wonders which were done in you  
 Had been in Tyre and Sidon's view,  
 They would have repented long since,  
 Sitting in sackcloth, ash *to wince*.  
 14 It will be more fun for Tyre and  
 Sidon in Judgement than that planned  
 For you. 15 And you, Capernaum,  
 Were you not lifted up to hum  
 Toward heaven? "To hell you'll be cast  
 down."

16 The one who hears you too hears me,  
 The one rejecting you in fee  
 Also rejects me, and the one  
 Who rejects me rejects when done  
 The One who sent me *on the run*.  
 17 The seventy came back with joy,  
 And said "Sir, even demons employ  
 Submitting to us by your name."  
 18 And he said to them, "I then saw  
 Satan fall out of the sky's trough  
 Like lightning. 19 "See, I've given you  
 The power to step on serpents too  
 And scorpions and over all  
 The power of enemy in thrall,  
 And nothing shall hurt you at all.  
 20 "Refrain however from rejoicing  
 That evil spirits in their voicing  
 Submit to you. But rather do  
 Rejoice that your names are writ too  
 In heaven among celestial crew."

The glimpse of joy and hope that comes at  
 times  
 Between the rows of prose and price of  
 rhymes  
 To share my life and day with lighter tone  
 Distract me, my Beloved, from divine  
 throne.  
 What seems important here where I repeat  
 The motions of sleep, exercise, and eat  
 Would keep me from the nobler share and  
 meet:  
 Remembrance of the name inscribed above,  
 The heavenly remembrance taught in love.  
 Though evil spirits do not oft submit  
 To my commands though given strong and  
 fit,  
 Their counterparts in daily rounds are fleet  
 Pretending to be all the flesh of treat.  
 I turn from shadow to the thing complete.

21 Right then Jesus rejoiced in mind,

And said "I praise You, Father kind,  
Sovereign of heaven and earth, that You  
Hid these things from the wiser crew  
And cunning and revealed them to  
Mere babes. Indeed, Father, to You  
It was a pleasure as one due."

The effort to define the Deity  
In any sort of grand theology,  
The worst of which produces Trinity,  
Is founded on grand scheme philosophy.  
The effort may be honest, but misplaced,  
And so sophisticated join the waste.  
The truth is in the simple declaration  
Before the folk of each and every nation  
That You are One and You alone are God.  
All else is speculation on the sod.  
A tiny child knows well the difference  
Between one and three tottered on the  
fence.

And like a babe I choose the one I wish,  
And that is You, Beloved, not bone or fish.

22 All things were delivered to me  
By my Father, and no one, see,  
Knows who the son is in degree  
Except the Father; and who be  
The Father but the son, and he  
To whom the son wants to make see.

Some would have Your sent one to be  
God almighty Himself upon the tree,  
Because all things are given to him free.  
But if he were indeed God, surely he  
Would already have all authority,  
And nothing could be given, added, or  
Delivered up to him to keep in store,  
Because he'd have all things and naturally.  
Beloved, I love You for the things You are  
Above creation's wonders, stone and star.  
I love You for the glittered gifts You give  
To humankind or even one to live,  
The power and the authority that You  
Bestow on Your sent one, a man in view.

23 He took the disciples alone,  
And said "Blessed are the eyes in tone  
That see what you see *here in bone*.

24 "For I tell you that prophets and  
Kings many wished to see at hand  
What you see, and did not see, and  
To hear what you hear and did not

*Get to hear what you hear in plot."*

Your sent one claims he is fulfilment sure  
Of promises that prophets and kings pure  
Delighted in and hoped for in their time.  
He claims he's both the melody and rhyme.  
Your sent one tells the secret of his race,  
His coming and his planning in Your grace,  
Revealing the good news then face to face  
To those so fortunate to be in place.  
Beloved, I am a doubter, but I take  
The message of Your messenger in wake  
Of thought and search and hope and find  
the way

He teaches does not depart from the ray  
You spoke on Sinai on another day.  
I rejoice in the promises You make.

25 And see, a certain lawyer stood  
And tested him and said as should,  
"Rabbi what shall I do that I  
May have eternal life in *sky*?"

26 And he told him, "What has been writ  
In the Law? How do you read it?"

27 He answered, he replied and said  
"You shall love YHWH your God instead  
With all your heart, with all your soul,  
And with all your strength, and in goal  
With all your mind, and finally  
Your neighbour as yourself to see."

28 And he told him, "You answered right.  
Do this and you shall live *in light*."

29 But he wanted to make a show  
Of himself so Jesus would know,  
So he said "Who's my neighbour *Joe*?"

Leave well enough alone's a lesson that  
No man seems to learn while he's still a  
brat.

Islamic law would be so simple if  
So many questions had not jumped the  
cliff.

Why ask who is my neighbour, if I do  
Not wish to accept all the human crew?  
The danger is that I shall hear a sound  
I would rather not meet upon the ground.  
The hope that Your brief laws, though easy  
done,

Might be made easier under the sun  
Still keeps men questioning if this or that  
Might not be better hidden under mat.

There's always the chance some Rabbi  
might say  
We do not need to keep Your law today.

30 Jesus took of the tale and said:  
A certain personage was led  
To go down from Jerusalem  
To Jericho and fell in hem  
Of robbers, who both stripped him and  
With blows left him half dead to stand.  
31 By a coincidence a priest  
Was going down that road at least,  
And when he saw him, he passed by  
Along the other side to spy.  
32 In the same way a Levite came  
To the same place and saw the blame,  
And passed on the other side's *shame*.  
33 But one Samaritan came there,  
And saw him filled with pity's share.  
34 And came near and bandaged him up,  
Poured oil and wine from his own cup.  
He put him on his own beast and  
Brought him to an inn, care at hand.  
35 He left the next day, and he took  
Out two dinars and gave the look  
Of them to the innkeeper and  
Told him, "Take care of him by hand,  
And whatever more you may spend,  
When I come back, I'll pay the lend."  
36 Who then of these three seems to you  
To have become the neighbour true  
Of the one fallen at the hand  
Of the marauding robber band?

The whole world knows the blessed story,  
but  
No one knows the name forgotten and shut  
Of sympathied Samaritan who came  
To help his neighbour and thereby found  
fame.  
The name and fame of what men do may  
go,  
But the effect of a good deed will show  
A thousand generations in the glow  
Of ten commandments promising the  
claim.  
Beloved, let what good I may have done  
here,  
Though I cannot remember now with fear  
Much in the way of charity or hope,  
Still let it carry on from rope to rope  
A thousand generations, while my name

And words are lost in seas of Your acclaim.

37 And he said "The one who performed  
The deed of mercy" So informed  
Jesus told him, "Go do the same."

It was a bit much for sweet Jesus to  
Tell questioners to act like one in view,  
Samaritan to top the pill with gall.  
I think the man just likes to show the call.  
He wants to scandalize his hearers' crew.  
The scandal that Samaritan and Jew  
Make between themselves was caused by  
the way  
The Persians acted to keep folk in sway.  
They sent the Jews back to Jerusalem  
To keep an eye on Samaritan hem.  
In the same way they relied on the hope  
Samaritans would tell tales on the slope.  
Divide and rule devised by Cyrus once  
Helped Persians to plague every sort of  
dunce.

38 As they went on, it happened he  
Went in a certain village wee.  
A certain woman who was named  
Martha received him in hearth famed.  
39 This one had a sister they called  
Mary, who also sat enthralled  
At Jesus' feet and heard his word.  
40 But busy Martha ran and stirred.  
And then she came and said "Sir, do  
You not give a care that it's due  
My sister should come help me too  
And not leave me alone to serve?"  
41 But Jesus answered her with verve,  
"O Martha, Martha, you take care  
And trouble with many a share,  
42 "But there is need of only one,  
And Mary chose the good and won,  
Which shall not be taken from her."

The cares of life seem basic and the most  
Important, how to find a fine pig roast  
And wine to sweeten it in gullet ground.  
But Jesus says that only Mary found  
The needful thing, to stop and hear his  
word.

That was a strong statement, clear and  
unblurred.  
But what word did she hear? Luke does not  
say.

It may have been the same in Matthew's  
 way,  
 That Your law shall not pass till earth be  
 moved,  
 And universe be unhinged and ungrooved.  
 Beloved, I hear Your sent one always  
 saying  
 To turn to You alone when I am praying,  
 And keep Your ten commandments every  
 day,  
 Like Mary come to find the better way.

### Luke 11

1 And it happened as he was praying  
 In a certain place, when allaying,  
 One of his disciples asked him,  
 "Sir, teach us to pray *true and trim*,  
 As John taught his disciples *swaying*."

The human heart is totally depraved  
 According to the way that Beza saved.  
 And it is true that even here I see  
 In the petition such iniquity.  
 They do not want to learn to pray so they  
 Can come to worship You and properly.  
 They want to be like John's folk for a day,  
 Conforming to a model's symmetry.  
 Beloved, let no man teach me how to pray.  
 I want the fruit of wicked heart to stray.  
 I want You only with my wordless plaint,  
 And let my sonnetry try even saint.  
 I want You with praise, penance and  
 petition  
 Within my silent heart, Your recognition.

2 And he said to them, "When you pray,  
 Say: Our Father who's come to stay  
 In heaven, hallowed be Your name,  
 Let Your kingdom come, let Your claim  
 Be done on earth as in heaven's fame.  
 3 "Give us the bread we need each day;  
 4 "And forgive us our sins, for we  
 Also forgive iniquity  
 Of everyone who's in our fee.  
 And lead us not in trials' way,  
 But save us from the evil sway."

The words quoted by Luke are somewhat  
 changed  
 From those that Matthew six had once  
 arranged.

That shows they must not have prayed out  
 in rote  
 The prayer as Pater Nosters now would  
 gloat.  
 It is no set prayer at all then, but just  
 A list of subjects that we take in trust.  
 Beloved, I pray al-fatihah and find  
 The rote is still good for my meagre blind.  
 So why not let the monk and nun get on  
 With praying their hail maries on the  
 dawn?  
 You penetrate the wicked veils of will,  
 So much the greater than the flesh is still,  
 And give the heart each tune that stays to  
 thrill,  
 Or leave in calm remoteness on the hill.

5 And he said to them, "Which of you  
 May have a friend and so come to  
 Him in the middle of the night,  
 And say to him, 'Friend, before light  
 Lend me three loaves of bread, please do.  
 6 "A friend of mine just came to me  
 Returning from a long journey,  
 And I have nothing to serve right.'  
 7 "And the one inside answers him  
 To say do not cause troubles dim.  
 'The door is shut, my children fast  
 In bed with me. I can't avast  
 Get up to give you bread and trim.'  
 8 "I tell you, if he won't get up  
 For friendship to extend the cup,  
 Still because he knocks long and loud,  
 He'll get up and give in a crowd."  
 9 And I tell you, "Ask and it will  
 Be given you; seek also, still  
 You'll find; and knock and it will be  
 Opened to you abundantly.  
 10 "For everyone who asks receives,  
 And those who seek bring in the sheaves,  
 And to the one who knocks the door  
 Will open on abundant store.  
 11 "And what father among you, when  
 The son asks for bread will again  
 Give him a stone? And if a fish,  
 Will he give a snake in the dish?  
 12 "And if he should ask for an egg,  
 Will he give him a scorpion's *leg*?  
 13 "Then if you who are evil know  
 How to give good gifts to the row  
 Of your children, how much more then  
 The heavenly Father will give when

The holy spirit comes to those  
Who beg of Him the thing they chose?"

The children's trinity is bread and fish,  
And after fish an egg fulfilling wish.  
The devil's trinity is stone and snake  
And scorpion to share for goodness' sake.  
But You alone, Beloved, are like Dajjal,  
With single eye to give party and ball  
The blessings of good things, promise to  
make.

You are no trinity at all, but You  
Consistently know what to bring in view  
Of sweetmeats for the spirit and the mind,  
The human heart that stays to sleep behind.  
Beloved, while tasting three abundances,  
I learn what is Your will and what is fizz,  
Your promises by serpents unconfined.

14 He cast out a demon and it  
Was dumb. It happened in the fit  
As the demon went out the dumb  
Spoke, and the crowds amazed the bum.

15 But some of them said "He casts out  
The demons by Beelzebub *stout*,  
The chief of demons *and with clout*."

16 And others tempted him and sought  
A sign from heaven to be taught.

17 But he knew their thoughts and told  
them,

"Each kingdom divided in hem  
Against itself's fated to fall,  
And so a house against the wall.

18 "So if Satan's divided too  
Against himself, his kingdom's crew  
Cannot stand either, what to do.

Yet you say I cast out the brew  
Of demons by Beelzebub due.

19 "And if I cast out demons by  
Beelzebub, by whom then do try  
Your sons to cast them out foreby?  
They'll be your judges, and that's why.

20 "But if I cast out demons by  
The power of God, then upon you  
Has come God's kingdom, it is true."

The miracle is sign perhaps to some,  
To every brainless churl and careless bum.  
Performance of such tricks proves naught  
at all,

Nor that Beelzebub is still on the ball,

Nor that the power of God holds earth in  
thrall.

They only distract people from the scent  
Of truth, Beloved, that always came and  
went.

It was not smoke and lightning, thunder,  
fire

That proved You right on Sinai of desire.  
It was the first commandment spoken there,  
The Unity come crashing through the air.  
If humankind can once accept the fact  
That You are one alone and not retract  
That oneness seen in humankind, we're fair.

21 When a strong man is armed and takes  
Guard of his dwelling, so he makes  
His property in safety's *wakes*.

22 But just as soon as stronger men  
Come, they will overcome him then,  
And take away his armour fast  
Which he depended on and cast  
Out his arms broken in the blast.

23 The one who's not with me has passed  
Against me. And the one who does  
Not gather scatters *where he was*.

When Jesus set his friends back in their  
place

Forbidding a man from the healing race  
By using Jesus' name though he was not  
One of the disciples upon the plot,  
He meant that others outside his own sect  
Could be about Your work, Beloved, select.  
Now here the man denies his own word by  
Insisting those who are not writ in sky  
Among his own disciples are a threat.  
So inconsistency is something met.  
Beloved, I'm neither with nor against any  
Except on the criterion of many  
To keep or not the ten commandments true.  
Let me be against all, but be for You.

24 When unclean demon leaves a man,  
He goes through desert parts to fan.  
But he does not find rest, so he  
Says "I'll return to my home wee  
From which I came out by decree."

25 He comes and finds the place is swept,  
Embellished, washed, painted, and kept.

26 Then he goes and takes seven more  
Spirits more wicked than his score,  
And comes back in to stay, so that

The last state of the man's out flat  
Worse than the first *for gear and store*.

The seven spirits that dwell in my heart  
To rend the veils that would keep us apart,  
Beloved, are seven spirits from Your  
throne.

I care to bow to You, Beloved, alone.  
The seven spirits that see all the earth  
From the celestial haven of Your berth  
Flame hotly in my breast, though floor may  
be

Unswep, ungentle and unsightly scree.  
Beloved, sweep where You will, I'm at a  
loss

To be the cleaner of Your temple toss,  
And yet the best job I've had in this state  
Has been the cleaning of the toilets' rate,  
The scrubbing down of the floors and the  
tiles,

The chasing of foul smells for miles and  
miles.

27 It happened when he said these things,  
A certain woman in the wings  
Of the crowd lifted up her voice  
And said to him, "Blessed is the choice  
Womb that has borne you and the breasts  
That gave suck in your interests."

28 But he said "No, rather are blessed  
Those who hear Word of God confessed  
And keep it *thoroughly and best*."

The blessed Virgin Mary is a saint,  
Among the best to whom comes such  
complaint

Of every human in the Roman nest,  
And in the eastern church too to invest.  
I do not think that it's exclusive thing,  
This blessing on the womb and well as  
wing.

Why cannot Mary be blessed in her way  
As well as those who live here in the sway  
Of Your commandments to keep them, I  
pray?

Beloved, bless virgin Mary and bless me,  
Both to keep Your word faithfully and see  
That if the womb is empty and the manger  
Of Bethlehem and Your sent one's in  
danger,

He may dwell in my heart abundantly.

29 The crowds pressed round and so he  
said

"This is a generation led  
Of evil. It seeks oft a sign,  
And no sign will come in their line,  
Except the sign of prophet Jonah.

30 For even as Jonah was a loner  
Sign to the Ninivites, so too  
The Son of Man is to this crew.

The Gospel makes the sign of Jonah be  
The number of days and of nights at three,  
And yet here Luke records a different staff,  
One to make whale and gourd-eating worm  
laugh.

It's not the days and nights that are the sign,  
Nor trinities of either to divine,  
But the call to repentance that awaits  
Each folk to hear a prophet in their states.  
The sign of every prophet who is true  
Is that he calls repentance from the rue.  
Beloved, I am a prophet to myself,  
Calling me to repentance on my shelf,  
Along the paths that filled with snow today,  
Among the shedding firs' brief light in ray.

31 The queen of the south will be raised  
Upon the Judgement with the crazed  
Men of this generation and  
Will condemn them because she fanned  
From the ends of the earth to hear  
The wisdom of Solomon near.  
See one greater than Solomon  
Is here, and that's something begun.  
32 Men, Ninevites will rise up in  
The Judgement with this crew *in din*,  
And will condemn it, because they  
Repented at Jonah word's sway.  
See one greater than Jonah's here,  
*But you refuse to lend your ear*.

Some quote the Qur'an that all prophets due  
Are equal and no one is better brew  
Than any other in the divine pew.  
Yet Jesus himself claims to be a greater  
Than Solomon and Jonah's instigator.  
The queen of Sheba is a lady ready  
To drop a sentence on each John and  
Freddy,  
While Ninevites who once repented then  
Will have a thing to say to modern men.  
Beloved, I trek a way to find the two,

One northward from Jerusalem in view,  
The other buried in the drowsy south,  
Waiting with milk and honey in the mouth,  
Waiting for faithful judgement's residue.

33 But no one lights a lamp and sets  
It in a hidden place nor gets  
A corn measure to hide it in,  
But sets it on a lampstand's tin,  
So those who come in see the light.  
34 The body's lamp is the eye, so  
When your eye's sound, body also  
Is all light. But when it is bad,  
Also your body's dark *and sad*.  
35 Watch then so the light in you's not  
A darkness where you wander sot.  
36 If then your whole body is light,  
Without any darkness in sight,  
All will be light, as when the lamp  
Enlightens you shining *through damp*.

But if the light and lamp is a fair gem,  
A jewel of love from Jerusalem,  
Then the one who gains it may keep it  
where  
Its holy scintillating is the share  
Of his eyes only. The light of the crowd  
Is merely darkness of the vain allowed.  
But if the light of love is set for all  
To see and to extinguish at a call,  
Then it will flicker and in pain will fall,  
If the light of love is not safely kept.  
Beloved, I've squandered light and I have  
wept.  
Yet I may never learn to keep the sweet  
And truthful to myself as for a treat.  
I may forever shed what should be swept.

37 As He spoke came one Pharisee,  
Inviting him to lunch freely.  
He went in and lay down to see.  
38 The Pharisee watched most surprised  
That he did not first wash *apprised*  
Before the dinner *undisguised*.

Your sent one should have washed his  
hands when he  
Came to the table for hygienic spree.  
The point is taken well that he will not  
Conform to oral law that has been taught  
Outside the written Torah. But the germs  
That multiply beneath his nails in terms

Might override the making of the point.  
I do not follow oral law in joint,  
But still I wash my hands before the meal,  
At least after a visit and appeal  
To toilets. But the dirty hands of Christ  
Seem quite unnecessary to unlice.  
Beloved, the argument of washing still  
Meets baptism in every sort of pill.

39 But the Lord said to him, "Now you  
Pharisees cleanse the outer view  
Of the cup and the dish, but leave  
You inside full and to retrieve  
Of robbery and evil sleeve.  
40 Fools! Did not the one who once made  
The outside also in parade  
Fake the inside *and so it stayed*?  
41 But give alms of the things within,  
And see, all things are clean *from sin*.

Actions that cleanse are giving alms, it's  
true,  
The most basic of such actions in view.  
But fasting also cleanses and the bath  
Of head and hand and foot upon the path,  
Immersion of the body at a time  
Determined by intimacy in crime.  
The washing of the outside is enough  
To make hypocrisy of smooth and rough,  
When robbery and extortion remain  
To hide beneath the washing of the vain.  
Beloved, let alms lead in the way of right,  
The path that leads out of the frozen night  
Of life upon the planet made of dust  
To show me all the joys of what man must.

42 But woe to you, you Pharisees,  
For you pay tithes of mint's degrees,  
And rue and every herb, and miss  
Justice and God's love not to kiss.  
It is right to do those things too,  
But not to leave aside the true.  
43 Woe to you, Pharisees! For you  
Love platform seats in synagogues  
And greetings of the demagogues.  
44 Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees!  
You hypocrites! For you are like  
The inside of the tombs *to strike*,  
And those who walk above them do  
Not know what's in your heart *of rue*.

Imagination is Christ's favourite word,

Activity in heart and might that stirred  
 Him to think how the tombs beneath his  
 feet  
 Are hardly thought of by the folk who  
 meet.  
 The beds are green with ferns and purple  
 flowers,  
 The leaves dripping alive after the showers,  
 While underground the vaults are silent  
 where  
 The slow decay wins over faint and fair.  
 Beloved, may my open heart overflow  
 In actions that reveal what is below,  
 And let the hidden chamber of my life  
 Be far removed from scandal and from  
 strife,  
 Be filled with Your Self only in the way  
 I think and speak and act as well as pray.

45 One of the lawyers answered him,  
 "Rabbi, what you say's a thing *grim*,  
 And is an insult to us *dim*.  
 46 And he said "Woe to you also,  
 You lawyers! Because you're not slow  
 To burden men with weights too hard  
 To bear, and you yourselves are starred  
 Not to touch the burdens with one  
 Of your fingers *to lift the tonne*.  
 47 "Woe to you! Because you construct  
 The tombs where the prophets are tucked,  
 And your ancestors killed them *trucked*.  
 48 "So you bear witness and consent  
 To the acts of ancestors bent,  
 For they indeed killed them, and you  
 Fabricate their tombs for the view.

The fact is Jesus twists the common word.  
 The people who built up the tombs were  
 stirred  
 To do so because they believed that they  
 Were doing what they could to right the  
 way  
 Their fathers wronged the prophets in their  
 sway.  
 But Jesus takes their witness turned around,  
 And makes them also guilty on the ground.  
 That is not reassuring if the man  
 Is given power of judgement by Your plan.  
 I'd rather be condemned in justice well  
 For what I did, than for such unjust spell.  
 If Jesus hoped to convict men of sin,  
 He went about it in an unwise din.

But who am I to notice or to tell?

49 "Because of this, God's wisdom said  
 "I'll send prophets, apostles led  
 To them, and they will kill and drive  
 Them out of *land and home and hive*.  
 50 "So the blood of all prophets shed  
 From the start of the world till now  
 Shall be required of this crew's brow,  
 51 "From the blood of Abel until  
 The blood of Zechariah still  
 Who perished between altar and  
 The sanctuary in its stand.  
 Indeed I tell you, it will be  
 Required from this crew in degree.  
 52 "Woe to you, lawyers! Because you  
 Took key of knowledge, and then you  
 Yourselves did not go in, and you  
 Kept out those who would enter too."  
 53 As he said these things to them then,  
 The scribes and Pharisees again  
 Were filled with rage and they began  
 To plot against him as by plan,  
 54 And lie in ambush for him too,  
 And tried to catch him saying new  
 Things they could use in accusation  
 Against him *to their own elation*.

It may seem an exaggeration here  
 That men planned to kill Jesus for their  
 fear.

But I can believe that, since I have seen  
 The missionary way to rout and preen.  
 The missionary teacher was warned well  
 Not to give native children better gel  
 On their reports than children of those sent  
 As missionaries in the heathen tent.  
 When he judged by performance rather  
 than

The whiteness of their skin, they formed a  
 plan  
 To crash his plane and tell the widow that  
 It was the will of God in mercy sat.  
 The lesson is that chiefs of church and state  
 Cannot be trusted with sword soon or late.

## Luke 12

1 The meanwhile a great multitude  
 Of folk had gathered *to the dude*,  
 So many that they trampled down  
 The people come out *from the town*,  
 He started telling first of all



His own disciples *of the call*,  
 “Beware the yeast of Pharisees,  
 Which is hypocrisy *to please*.  
 2 “For there is nothing hidden that  
 Will not be revealed where it’s at,  
 Nor hidden that will not be known.  
 3 “Therefore whatever you have shown  
 In the dark will be heard in light,  
 And what you’ve spoken in the night  
 Ear and in inner rooms will be  
 Proclaimed on the housetops *to see*.  
 4 “And I say to you, my friends, do  
 Not be afraid of any who  
 May kill the body, after that  
 There’s nothing they can do with bat.  
 5 “But I will show you whom to fear:  
 Fear him who, after he has killed,  
 Has power to cast in hell, *as willed*,  
 Indeed I tell you he’s to fear!

Beloved, give me a glimpse of inner hell  
 That I may realize the house and well  
 And plot and company where I’m today  
 Is paradise, there is no other way.  
 The faces I see all around are those  
 That reflect Your face in the way You  
 chose.

Behind my shoulder twitter in a cloud  
 Ten thousand angels in psalmody loud  
 Who hide like fables if I turn my head,  
 And then start up again their songs instead.  
 Beloved, give me a glimpse of hell in sight  
 That I may see my paradise’ full light  
 And know the hidden treasure of Your will  
 Beyond the veiling shadows and the hill.

6 “Are not five sparrows sold for two  
 Copper coins? And not one *or few*  
 Of them’s forgotten before God.  
 7 “But the very hairs of your pod  
 Are all numbered. Do not fear then,  
 You’re of more value, *you as men*,  
 Than many sparrows. 8 “Also I  
 Say to you, whoever comes by  
 To confess me before men, him  
 The Son of Man will not hold dim,  
 But confess him *upon the sod*  
 Before all the angels of God.

Ah, what did I just say about the crowd  
 Of angels pattering about out loud?  
 My senses doubt the truth of Jesus’ word

That says a man is worth more than a bird.  
 Worth more in what market, I undeterred  
 Ask brashly. At Thanksgiving time a turkey  
 Brings higher price than unemployed and  
 quirky.  
 They build their nests like men, and care  
 for young  
 As do those who inherit human lung  
 Instead of beak of sparrow or the strung  
 Hearts of angels. My own democracy  
 Would rather men, birds, angels all should  
 be  
 Of one price and the same, infinity  
 Beyond the silver and the golden rung.

9 But the one who denies me in  
 The presence of men for his sin  
 Shall be denied before the face  
 Of the great angels *in their race*.  
 10 Whoever speaks a word in blame  
 Of son of man and to his shame  
 It will be forgiven, but he  
 Who blasphemes against spirit’s fee  
 Of holiness, it shall not be  
 Forgiven him *before the flame*.  
 11 When they bring you to synagogues  
 Before magistrate demagogues,  
 Take no thought how or what to say,  
 Or of what answer that you may.  
 12 The holy spirit will teach you  
 In the same moment what to do.  
 13 One of the crew spoke up to him,  
 “Rabbi, speak to my brother grim,  
 So he’ll divide the goods with me.”  
 14 And he told him “Man, do you see  
 Who made me a judge in degree  
 Over you *for your gear and trim?*”

From the days that the elders sat in gate  
 Of town and village to give justice rate  
 To this day in the Middle Eastern plot  
 It has been expectation to be taught  
 And given verdicts for the way men ought.  
 The questioner had every right to ask  
 The same of Jesus who took up the task  
 Of one expounding law and faith aloud.  
 Jesus was impolite not to say proud.  
 But it goes further. If he could not lend  
 A verdict then in judgement on the mend,  
 Then how can he be judge of all things  
 when  
 You set him on a throne to judge all men?

It's inconsistency that makes me fend.

15 He said to them, "Take heed, beware  
Of covetousness. For man's share  
Does not consist in abundance  
Of things he possesses *in glance*."

16 He spoke a parable to them,  
And said "The field that lay in hem  
Of one rich man produced in full.

17 "Thinking he was comfortable  
He said 'What shall I do, because  
I have no room to store my braws?'

18 'And he said 'This thing I shall do:  
I'll pull down my barns, build a few  
With more room to store produce and  
The many goods I have on hand.

19 "'And I will say to myself, "Man,  
You have enough for years in span.  
Just take it easy, eat and drink,  
And have a good time on the brink.'"

20 "But God said to him, 'You're a fool,  
Tonight your life ends at the rule,  
Then who shall have the things you've  
got?'

21 "So is the one who gets a lot  
Of wealth for himself, but is not  
Rich in the things that God has taught."

Live for today as if it were the last  
Is good advice handed from those who've  
passed.

Live out today as though a thousand years  
Spread out in hope before the joys and tears  
Is good advice that's spoken by the wise.  
Put both together and it's no surprise  
That health and wealth and status in its  
guise

Will bless and distract from the coming  
fears.

Beloved, let me build barns and fill them  
up,

And still drink from the proffered heavenly  
cup.

The wisdom of providing set aware  
That just one breath is each man's only  
share

Both hand in hand wisely come to prepare  
The heart and hand to live without a care.

22 He said to his disciples then,  
"That's why I tell all of you men,  
Take no thought for your life and what

You'll have to eat nor for the glut  
Of body and what you will wear.

23 "The life is more than food, the fair  
Flesh is more than clothing to bear.

24 "Consider ravens which do not  
Sow or reap, neither have a plot  
In store or barn, and yet God's sought  
To feed them. How much better are  
You than birds flying towards a star?

25 "And which of you by taking thought  
Can add an arm-length to the lot  
Of his height? 26 "If then you cannot  
Do simple things like that, why take  
Thought for the rest come in their wake?

27 "Consider how the lilies grow,  
They do not toil or spin a row,  
And yet I tell you, Solomon  
In all his glory was not spun  
Like one of these, no single one.

28 "If God so clothes the grass today  
Upon the field, and which by ray  
Of morning is cast out, away  
Into the oven, how much more  
You of such little faith in store?

29 "And do not seek what you will eat,  
Or what you'll drink to be complete,  
And do not doubt in your mind's seat.

30 "For all these things earth's nations do  
Seek after, and your Father too  
Knows that you need such things in view.

31 "But rather seek God's kingdom and  
All these things will come in the stand.

When Matthew quotes these words, his  
context runs

Among the pillars of Islamic duns:  
The fast, the alms, the prayer, and it would  
seem

That these words touch excuses that men  
beam

Upon the pilgrimage. But Luke does not  
Seem to recognize such a narrowed plot.

When I went on the pilgrimage, You did  
Not provide for me on the open lid,  
But the Shirazi Foundation came in  
Inviting me to share in the Hajj din.

I thank You, my Beloved, and I thank them  
Providing such a splendid, precious gem.  
I did not lack for anything in store,  
But ate and drank beside Your open door.

32 "Do not fear, little flock, for it's

Your Father's pleasure *where He sits*  
To give you kingdom *in the land*.

33 "Sell what you have and give in alms,  
Provide yourselves with bags for balms  
That do not age, a treasure in  
The heavens that will not fail for din,  
Where no thief comes, nor moth unspin.

34 "For where your treasure is, there will  
You heart be also to the fill.

35 "Buckle your belt and light your lamp.

36 "And be like men that stamp and champ  
To see their lord coming back from  
The wedding, so when he does come  
And knock, they may open the door  
Receiving him for evermore.

37 "Blessed are those servants whom the  
lord

When he comes shall find watching horde;

Truly I tell you, he'll put on

His belt and make them sit well drawn  
To eat and he'll come out to serve.

38 "If he comes in the second watch,  
Or in the third watch not to swerve,  
And finds them there and not to botch,  
Then those servants are blessed *with verve*.

39 "Know this, that if the owner of  
The house had known when thief would  
shove,

He would have set a watch to keep  
The house unbroken *in his sleep*.

40 So you be ready too, because  
The son of man comes in the claws  
Of a time when you least expect."

41 Then Peter asked him, "Sir, do you  
Speak this tale to just us select,  
Or even to all in the crew?"

Beloved, I do wish that the lord would  
come

And put an end to this infernal hum.

The fact that I enjoy my hermit's vale  
And sit beneath the pines smartly and hale  
Does not diminish from the lack of ease  
That plagues the most of men as by Your  
please.

I too take up responsibilities

Of keeping a house safe from robbers and  
The cold that creeps anon upon the land.

I do not ask to know the day or hour,  
But only that You keep it in Your power,  
That You will send out at the moment  
shown

Best on the earth for all the powers flown  
To come at last repentant to Your throne.

42 And the lord said "Who is the one  
Who is faithful and wise when done  
As steward, whom his lord shall make  
A ruler in his household's sake,  
To give share of food in the wake?"

43 "Blessed is that servant, whom his lord  
When he comes shall find acting scored.

44 "Truly I tell you, he will make  
Him ruler over all in stake.

45 "But if that servant in his heart  
Says 'My lord has delayed his part,'  
And so starts beating men and maids,  
And eats and drinks to drunken spades,

46 "That servant's master will come on  
A day he least expects the drawn,  
And will cut him in pieces and  
Will give him share in wicked band.

47 "And that servant who knew the will  
Of his lord and prepared no bill,  
Nor did according to his will,  
Shall be struck many times by hand.

The faith of Jesus Christ's apocalyptic,  
Even though the world's end is very  
cryptic.

Establishment of faith is dubious  
Of end-time prophecies to make a fuss.  
The former seems a madness and the latter  
A system to make preachers all the fatter.  
My own grandmother hoped until the day  
She died to see Your sent one on the ray  
Of clouds and coming back to save the pay.  
And yet she died in disappointment then.  
Was she wrong when she thought the times  
of men

Were numbered and the world should end  
again?

Though disappointed it seems she was right  
Always to wait for coming of the light.

48 But the one who did not know and  
Committed things of contraband  
Shall be punished with a few licks.

For the one to whom's given tricks  
Shall be held accountable for  
The greater amount in his store.

49 I have come to send fire on earth,  
If it's already in its berth  
Kindled, then what is it I'm worth?

50 But I've a baptism for me,  
And I grieve to accomplish, see.  
51 Do you think I've come to bring peace  
On earth? I tell you, no, release  
Of a division *on increase*.

Despite the fact that Jesus taught to do  
The pillars of Islam in Matthew's pew:  
The fasting, alms, the prayer, and it may be  
Pilgrimage to Jerusalem's degree,  
He did not come to bring peace or Islam.  
That was the work of prophet under palm.  
He came instead to send a fire and taught  
No resignation to the Roman plot,  
But strict obedience to Your own law  
Instead of to the jungle sort of claw.  
Beloved, I enter baptisms of fire  
And leave the folk around to walk the mire,  
While I recite the secret Psalms and blessed  
And wait upon Your throne among the  
best.

52 From now on there shall be five in  
One house, three against two and din  
Of two against three for their sin.  
53 The father shall divide from son,  
The son against the father done;  
The mother against daughter too,  
The daughter against mother's view,  
The mother-in-law against her  
Own daughter-in-law to concur,  
And daughter-in-law against womb  
That bore her husband in her room.

The house of monolatry is divided  
Among five sects claiming they have  
confided  
In You alone: the Jew, Samaritan,  
The Christian and the Muslim and the span  
Of the Sabaeon on the river sided.  
The Jews and Christians of today unite  
Against Samaritan for their great plight  
And against Muslim and Sabaeon right.  
The shifting faces of plurality  
Show clearly down through all their  
history.  
Beloved, I leave all sects to their own grief  
Or visions of grandeur beyond belief,  
And cling to You alone and to those sent  
By You to bring to light the worldly bent.

54 He also told the people, "When

You see a cloud rise up again  
Out of the west, straight off you say  
'There's a rain shower on the way,'  
And so it is just as you say.  
55 And when you hear the south wind  
blow,  
You say 'It will be hot below,'  
And so it happens *and not slow*.  
56 You hypocrites, you can read well  
The sky and earth and live to tell,  
But how is it that you do not  
See what the time and age have taught?  
57 Indeed, why do you not yourselves  
Judge what is right *and wrong on shelves*?  
58 When you go with your enemy  
Before the magistrate in fee,  
While you are on the way do all  
You can to escape from his thrall,  
Lest he bring you before the judge,  
And the judge send you off to budge  
Before the officer and he  
Throw you into the company  
Of prison to stay wretchedly.  
59 I tell you that you'll not get out  
Until you pay your bill *with clout*.

The Scripture is sufficient for all men  
To read or memorize and know again  
In every case what is the wrong and right.  
No need for ayatollahs in our plight,  
No need for canon law in priestly sight,  
No need for rabbis to say when it's night.  
The ten commandments themselves give  
enough,  
And if that's not enough when things get  
tough,  
The Bible and Qur'an and Al-Kafi  
Suffice to make known all abundantly.  
Beloved, I read the word of every sect  
And I still do not know what You expect  
Beyond the Decalogue to set me free  
To cantillate the Psalms eternally.

### **Luke 13**

1 At that time there were some who told  
Him of the Galileans bold,  
Whose blood Pilate had shed to mix  
With their own offerings in a fix.  
2 And Jesus answered them and said  
"Do you thing that these Galileans  
Were sinners by all Galileans,  
Because they suffered such *from paeons*?

3 "I tell you not, but unless you  
Repent you'll also wear that shoe.  
4 "Or those eighteen on whom the tower  
In Siloam fell down in power  
To kill them, do you think that they  
Were sinners above all that stay  
There in Jerusalem? 5 "I say  
No, but unless you repent you  
Will all perish in the same rue."

In ancient days the human mind was quick  
To think that divine punishment of sick  
Is in degree of their sins without trick.  
They could not conceive how You might  
allow

Injustice in the world risen somehow.  
Today we see injustice everywhere  
And use that as proof, not You do not care,  
But that You cannot exist here at all.  
Or rather You exist alone to make  
An act of God, destruction in its wake.  
Beloved, Your sent one does not take these  
terms,

But rather focuses where human squirms,  
And calls all to repentance rather than  
To pondering the rights of divine plan.

6 He also spoke this parable.  
A certain one had a fig tree  
Planted in his own garden's lea.  
And he came seeking fruit in full,  
And found none growing *on the tree*.  
7 Then he said to his vineyard man,  
"See, these three years I've come to scan  
Fruit on this fig tree and find none.  
So cut it down and let's have done."  
8 He answered him and said "Sir, let  
It stay this year too, till I set  
About to dig and dung it yet.  
9 "And if it bears fruit, and if not,  
After that you'll cut it as sought."

The worker is the one that brings to light  
The patience of the watcher in the night.  
The lovely Jesus makes You out to be  
Ready to cut down root and leaf and see  
The body into hell-fire for Your glee.  
But his role is an interceding word  
To make atonement for the lack of herd.  
Beloved, I take the intercession now,  
Forgetting the atonement on the brow  
Of thorns, for human sacrifice is not

Permissible within Your garden plot.  
And when I bear fruit or when I fail there,  
Dig round my feet and dung my barren  
share,  
And let me turn the soil to praise in air.

10 He taught in synagogue one day  
Of Sabbath. 11 And see, there astray  
Was a woman who had been ill  
For eighteen years, and she drooped still  
And could not get up on her hill.  
12 When Jesus saw her, he called her  
And said to her, "Woman, now stir  
Freed from my illness to occur."  
13 And he laid hands on her and she  
Was right off made straight as could be,  
And she praise God *abundantly*.

From my Islamic point of view I wonder  
Why Jesus could not heal this one in  
thunder

Without the laying on of hands. You see,  
It is improper to touch woman's tree  
If one is a man, which was his degree.  
Why could he not just say the word and she  
Would be freed from affliction? Perhaps he  
Was out to provoke the Jews in the way  
He healed upon the blessed Sabbath day,  
And needed act of hand to give them grist  
To raise up against him accusing fist.  
Beloved, I too am provocation when  
I'm noticed at all by my fellowmen.  
Otherwise I keep to my Sabbath den.

14 The ruler of the synagogue  
Answered with anger in a fog,  
Because Jesus healed on the day  
Of Sabbath, and told folk in sway,  
"There are six days in which men ought  
To work, in them therefore in plot  
Come and be healed, but do not come  
Upon the Sabbath day to hum."

15 The lord then answered him and said  
"You hypocrite, are you not led  
Each one of you on Sabbath day  
To loose ox or ass from stall's way  
To take him to water *and hay*?  
16 "And ought not this lady who's yet  
A daughter of Abraham met,  
Whom Satan's bound these eighteen years,  
Be freed from this bondage of tears  
Upon the Sabbath day and let?"

17 When he said this his foes were shamed,  
And all the folk rejoiced unblamed  
For all the glorious things he claimed.

Note, my Beloved, You Lord of Christian  
State

And Church set out beneath the sun for  
hate,

That Your sent one did not retort to say  
That he had put an end to Sabbath day.

Instead he gave interpretation fine

Of the law, and so established its vine.

Unless the law was binding, there was no  
Need to make a midrash upon its show.

Beloved, I come each Sabbath day to You  
With crooked heart from all the things I do,  
And ask that in a moment I be made  
Straight to praise You upon the Sabbath  
glade,

And find the recitation of Your Word  
Returns me from my mingling with the  
herd.

18 Then he said "What's God's kingdom  
like?

With what comparison to strike?

19 It's like a grain of mustard seed,

Which a man took and cast indeed

Into his garden, and it grew,

And became a great tree, it's true,

And the birds of the air would perch

Upon its branches *as in church*.

Despite the fact that Jesus comes to say  
That mustard seeds turn into trees in bay,  
Which is not true, the lesson is well  
learned.

God's kingdom is not something men have  
earned,

The corporation, product, or release

Of a new franchise on the load's increase.

Your kingdom is a tiny thought or word

That incubates in one heart still unstirred,

But day by day in silence grows aloft

To be the comfort of the furthest croft.

Beloved, I take two birds found in the bush

And remain for the final blast and push

Out of the nest to fly above the tree

And see the glories of eternity.

20 And once again he said "To which  
Shall I compare God's kingdom's pitch?

21 It is like leaven, which a wench  
Took and put in three measures' hench  
Of meal, till the whole rose *on bench*  
Well leavened in yeast *and its stench*.

22 He went through the cities and towns  
To teach on the way through the downs

Toward Jerusalem. 23 Then said

One to him, "Sir, are there few led

To be saved?" And he said to them,

24 "Endeavour to go in the hem

Of the most narrow gate, for there

Are many, I tell you, who dare

To make the attempt to go in,

And are not able *with their sin*.

25 "When once the owner of the room

Has got up and shut the door's gloom,

And you start standing outside knocking

At the door, saying, 'Sir, sir locking,

Open the door for us,' and he

Shall answer you and say *freely*,

'I do not know you from *your tree*.'

26 "Then you'll start saying 'We have eaten

And drunk before you, you unbeaten

Taught in our streets in high degree.'

27 "But he shall say 'I tell you, I

Do not know where you have come by,

Leave me, all you sinners that spy.'

It's not the fact I live before Your face

And have no breath outside that of Your  
grace

That means upon the Judgement Day that  
You

Will know me to be among fried and true.

Criterion is not the bread and wine

Dropped on the tongue or not among the  
fine,

But the occurrence or not of the way

Of wickedness in which I'm like to stray.

Beloved, I read the first Psalm of my  
choice

And heard the proposition given voice:

You know the way of righteousness indeed,

But ways of sinners are forgotten weed.

Let me do more than drink from cup and  
eat,

Let my hand do the righteousness in feat.

28 "There shall be weeping and the sound

Of gnashing teeth, when you have found

Abraham, Isaac, Jacob too,

And all the prophets, in the view

Of God's kingdom, while you're turned out.  
29 "And they shall come from east to  
spout,

And from the west and from the way  
Of the north and the south in sway,  
And shall sit in God's kingdom's ray.  
30 "And see, the last shall be the first,  
And the first be the last *uncursed*."

I'm one of those come from the north, I  
guess,

Unless the far-off ancestry's confess  
From Africa is true beneath my dress.  
I'm certainly among the last in view,  
No leader, unrespected by the crew  
Of those who rule the world by rue and  
shrew.

I'm among last of all as I rush in  
To find Your kingdom beyond earthly din.  
Beloved, I have not got used to the rate  
Of first and highest in the earthly gate,  
And so I should not be happy above  
To lead the armoured with a push and  
shove.

Let me remain in Your kingdom last too.  
It is my old and worn accustomed pew.

31 The same day there came Pharisees,  
Saying to him, "Get out now, please,  
For Herod will kill you with ease."

32 And he told them, "Go tell that fox,  
'See, I cast out devils in stocks,  
And I cure folk today and yet  
Tomorrow and on the third bet  
I'll be perfected *where I'm set*.'

33 "And yet I have to walk today,  
And still tomorrow on the way,  
And the day after, for it's not  
Meet that a prophet meets his lot  
Outside Jerusalem in plot.

As representative of vulpine race,  
Beloved, I take issue with Jesus' face.  
He maligns me and mine to a disgrace  
By comparing Herod to us in trace.  
First off, he had neither the silver hair  
Or russet to set him within our lair.  
He was not like us, for we look to You  
Obeying the instinct You told us to.  
He looked for circumvention of Your law,  
While we live honestly by hook and claw.  
Tell Jesus to take back his evil word

Against the foxes, and we'll join the herd  
Of those who praise his name on earth  
below,  
And hope for life eternal in his show.

34 "Jerusalem, Jerusalem,  
You who kill prophets and stone them  
Sent to you, how often would I  
Have gathered your children *with sigh*  
As a hen takes brood under wing,  
And you would not have anything!  
35 "See, your house is left desolation,  
And truly I say for your ration,  
You will not see me till the time  
When you shall say 'Blessed is the rhyme  
Of him who comes in YHWH's name's  
*prime*.'"

It seems at last Jerusalem has won  
Out over Rome and Athens and when done  
Over Mecca and Babylon to shun.  
The paradigm of each city set out  
To model for the world without a doubt,  
But only that of Salem with a shout  
Is found in every place and bin and bun.  
There's not a town or country on the earth  
That fails to kill the prophets in their berth  
And stone those sent to warn of the  
disgrace

That ambushes the hurtling human race.  
Some kill with faint praise, stone with  
maddened curse,  
The demonizing newsreel, or just nurse  
Ignoring of the true, averting face.

#### **Luke 14**

1 And it came to pass, as he went  
Into the house of one chief gent  
Of Pharisees to eat bread on  
The Sabbath day, they watched him drawn.  
2 And see, there was a certain man  
Present who had dropsy *in pan*.  
3 And Jesus answered speaking to  
The lawyers and Pharisees' pew,  
Saying "Is it a lawful thing  
To heal on Sabbath day *in spring*?"  
4 As they said nothing, he took him  
And healed him and let go *for whim*.  
5 And he gave answer to them saying  
"Which of you with a donkey straying  
Or ox fallen into a pit,  
Will not straight off come rescue it

And on the Sabbath day *for fit?*"  
6 And they could not reply again  
To these things, *though they were wise*  
*men.*

Why did Your sent one enter in conflict,  
And answer with a midrash gone and  
tricked?  
He might have said the Sabbath day's  
grown old,  
And tattered with abuse in Israel's fold.  
But in the new and lovely kingdom found  
Upon the earth as well as sacred ground,  
We need not keep the Sabbath in the round,  
But rejoice on Mithraic day of sun  
In celebration of the things I've done  
In conquering death and bringing true life  
After the Sabbath questioning and strife.  
In other matters he looked forward to  
The brightness of the coming and the true.  
He missed his chance to show he wasn't  
Jew.

7 And he set forth a tale for those  
Invited and the ones who chose  
The best seats for themselves and told  
Them, 8 "When you get an invitation  
To any wedding, don't be bold  
To sit in the best seat and station,  
For fear a nobler man than you  
Has been invited, 9 "and the crew  
Inviting you and him to come  
Will tell you, 'Give this man his sum,'  
And you be shamed to take the last  
Seat in the banquet hall avast.  
10 "But when you are invited, go  
And sit down in a seat that's low,  
And when the one inviting you  
Comes, he may tell you without rue,  
'Friend, go up higher,' and then you  
Will be respected in the view  
Of those at the table with you.  
11 "For whoever exalts himself  
Shall be abased, and who on shelf  
Humbles himself, shall be raised high."  
12 Then he said to the one who had  
Invited him, "When you are glad  
To make a supper or a feast,  
Don't call your friends, brothers increased,  
Nor kinsmen, nor rich neighbours in;  
Lest they invite you back again,  
And you get your reward to spin.

13 "But when you make a feast, call poor,  
The maimed, the lame, the blind *in store.*  
14 "And you shall be blessed, for they can't  
Pay you back, so your pay shall plant  
On resurrection of the just,  
*Come back to life out of the dust.*"  
15 When one who sat at meat with him  
Heard these things, so he said to him,  
"Happy is he who shall eat bread  
In the kingdom of God *where led.*"

The grand beatitudes of those who hear  
Your sent one telling stories in the ear  
Contrive to get attention, as I fear.  
Blessed is the womb that carried him, say  
some,  
And blessed also the one to eat the crumb  
Within Your kingdom before he is numb.  
I don't suppose that Luke meant by this  
word  
Your kingdom was the Eucharist in herd.  
It happened that the man was eating when  
The thought came into head and heart and  
wen.  
I'm blessed, Beloved, though not a womb  
or slice  
Of bread or eater of anything nice,  
And find a seat both soft and low so none  
Come chase me out and throw me on my  
bun.

16 And he said to them, "A man made  
A great feast and to the feast bade  
Many to come, 17 "and sent his slave  
At supper time to give the wave  
To those invited, 'Come, for all  
Is ready *for who heed the call.*'  
18 "And everyone made an excuse.  
The first said to him, 'I have use  
Of a piece of ground and I must  
Go tend to it, I beg your trust  
To have me excused *from the hall.*'  
19 "Another said 'I've bought five yoke  
Of oxen, and must try at stroke.  
Please excuse me too from the call.'  
20 "Another said 'I've got a wife,  
So I can't come, *not on your life.*'  
21 "So the servant came back to tell  
His master it did not go well.  
The master of the house in wrath  
Told his servant to find the path  
And lane of the town and bring in



The poor, maimed, halt, and blind within.  
 22 "And the servant said 'Sir, it's done  
 As you commanded, and *by gun*,  
 There's still room *there to have some fun*.'  
 23 "The master said to the slave then,  
 'Go out in the highways and fen,  
 And make them come in, that my room  
 May be filled up to *chase the gloom*.  
 24 "For I say to you, none of those  
 Men I invited will come close  
 To tasting of the meal I chose."

The parable is rightly divined when  
 I think the chosen are among lost men,  
 And those that You accept are the poor  
     found  
 In lanes and byways on infertile ground.  
 The dervish race is heir to the lost creed  
 Of Ebionites who kept Your word in seed,  
 The love of Jesus though without the claim  
 Of deity to win or lose the game.  
 The bishop said my faith was destitute,  
 Despite my going back to sit on root,  
 That I should rather follow king and priest  
 To find my show and welcome thus  
     increased.  
 Instead I stay in my own poverty  
 Before the throne of sky, before the sea.

25 And there went great crowds with him,  
     and  
 He turned and said to them in band,  
 26 "If anyone comes to me and  
 Does not hate father, mum, and wife,  
 And children, brothers, sisters' strife,  
 And even his very own life,  
 He cannot join disciple band.  
 27 "Whoever does not bear his cross  
 And come after me *for the loss*  
 Cannot be my disciple *planned*.  
 28 "For which of you, to build a tower,  
 Does not first sit down for an hour  
 And count the cost, whether he's got  
 Enough to finish on the spot,  
 29 "Lest by chance after he had laid  
 Foundation he could not have paid  
 To finish it and all would laugh  
 Who saw it undone *under staff*;  
 30 "Saying 'This man began to build,  
 Not able to finish fulfilled.'  
 31 "Or what king going out to war  
 Against another king on shore,

Does not sit down first and consult  
 Whether he can meet with result  
 If he has ten thousand to meet  
 Army of twenty thousand feet?  
 32 "Or else, while the other is yet  
 A great way off, he sent to get  
 Ambassadors in peace to treat.  
 33 "So likewise, whoever he be  
 Of you not to forsake for me  
 All that he has, he cannot be  
 One of my disciples *in fee*.

I count the cost of Your weight on my  
     beam  
 And on my mote for rote in what they  
     seem,  
 And find the temple made of Sabbath day  
 Expensive in amount of solar ray,  
 And hear the sema' sung and round and  
     round  
 Wrought worthier than gold upon the  
     ground.  
 The palace of the Psalms is free to speak  
 By day and night each day throughout the  
     week.  
 I raise the palace walls of Psalm and pray  
 The democratic Sabbath temple's way,  
 And find the cost in monetary cents  
 Is nothing, but the wealth it represents  
 Is infinite in what it gives my breath,  
 And what it takes from me until my death.

34 "Salt is good, but if the salt's lost  
 Its taste, where is the seasoning's cost?  
 35 "It's not fit for the land, nor yet  
 For the dunghill, but men will set  
 It out. The one who has ears let  
 Him hear *the message that he's met*.

A rat's nest is the highest thing in art  
 For rats, though hardly noble from the start  
 Of human revelings in colour-form.  
 Men see it only a way to keep warm.  
 I wonder what angelic view may find  
 Of human arts that does not show them  
     blind  
 To glories in the way men paint and sing.  
 Do they see art in humans' anything?  
 The pearl before the swine, the tasteless  
     salt,  
 The water and the setting up of malt,  
 The sonnet and the tricking out of

Word Divine, they are all things that can be  
slurred.  
I read my own words scribbled in response  
And split the ears of wise man and of  
dunce.

### Luke 15

1 The publicans and sinners came  
To hear *his message in acclaim*.  
2 And Pharisees and scribes in blame  
Said "This man accepts sinners' claim,  
And eats with them too *just the same*."  
3 He spoke this parable to them,  
Saying 4 "What man among your hem  
Who has a hundred sheep, if he  
Should lose one of them, will not see  
The ninety-nine left to their fate,  
And go to seek the desolate  
Until he finds it soon or late?  
5 "And when he's found it, he puts it  
Upon his shoulders with joy lit.  
6 When he comes home, he summons  
friends,  
And neighbours, telling them no ends,  
'Rejoice with me, for I have found  
My sheep that was lost *on the ground*.'  
7 "I tell you so shall be the joy  
In heaven for one sinner in ploy  
Repenting, more than ninety-nine  
Just people without need to shine  
In their repentance *or resign*.

Evangelists love this tale for the way  
It gives proof that You love where sinners  
stray.  
And yet it proves against the Pauline crowd  
That You have dozens more of which  
You're proud.  
There are the ninety-nine and more who  
need  
At close of day no penance for each deed,  
Who have lived by Your law and simply  
fed  
Upon celestial wine and heavenly bread.  
They may not be among the craven crew  
That attains to acclaim in worldly view,  
But that does not diminish from the fact  
They obey where some others may have  
lacked.  
Your law is not beyond the human hand  
To do as You, Beloved, came to command.

8 "Or what woman when she has got  
Ten pieces of silver in slot,  
If she loses one piece, she'll light  
A candle, sweep the house *affright*,  
Look for it carefully in sight?  
9 "And when she's found it, she will call  
Her friends and neighbours to the wall,  
And say 'Rejoice with me, for I  
Have found the coin I'd lost *nearby*.'  
10 "So I tell you, that there is joy  
Before God's angels for the boy  
Repenting of his sins' employ."

The people where I live do not parade  
Their gold and silver to the neighbours  
paid.  
Instead they pretend that they haven't any,  
And really ought to borrow pound and  
penny.

The more the neighbour speaks of poverty,  
The more I know he has wealth in his fee.  
Irrational is human culture's way,  
And that is seen in every land I stray.  
Beloved, I shall rejoice with You today  
For found and lost, for hope that You may  
pay  
The meals of the nouveau poor where they  
play.  
The bread that once grew in abundance  
here  
Is now the property of landed peer,  
The companies that rise and take our gear.

11 He said "A master had two sons.  
12 "The younger told his father's runs,  
'Dad, give me my inheritance.'  
And he divided up his pants.  
13 "Not long after the younger son  
Gathered up all the gear he'd won,  
And set out for a far land fun,  
And wasted all his wealth in store  
Upon the feast and on the whore.

It sounds to me like he went to Beirut.  
That's where the whores used to come  
down and loot.  
That's also where they say after the run  
In Mecca and Medina in the sun  
The folk would go to have a bit of fun.  
It must be in Beirut the fatal son  
Found refuge from the love of father and  
Hostility the older brother had.

Beloved, I come to take a faithful stand  
Against the fun and riotous and bad.  
It's better far to be Christian and sad.  
The round of sacrifice upon the field  
Is hopeful of a wiser, better yield.  
The wilder oat is bitter when unpeeled.

14 "And when he had spent all, there came  
A heavy famine in the claim  
Of that land, and he was in want.  
15 "And he went out and joined the haunt  
Of one man of that country gaunt,  
Who sent him out to keep the swine,  
Raised in his fields *and looking fine*.  
16 "He wanted to devour the husks  
That the pigs ate *upon their tusks*,  
For no one gave him *bread to dine*.  
17 "He came to himself and he said  
'How many of Dad's slaves have bread  
Enough and more, while I may starve!  
18 "I'll get up from this place to carve  
With my dad, and I'll say to him,  
'Dad, I have sinned *and acted dim*  
Against heaven and against your trim,  
19 "And am not worthy more to be  
Called your son, but make me unfree  
As of your hired servants to see.'

Truth was the lad was hardly worth his salt,  
And so the pigs were given corn and malt,  
While he stayed hungry in field by default.  
It's no excuse a lad is useless though  
To starve him so that pigs can take the  
show.

The feeding of pigs now takes more in  
wheat  
Than to keep alive children in the heat.  
The better way would be to breed no more  
Hogs for the Gentile table and the store,  
And keep the fodder for the poor who need  
A bite to eat instead of merely seed.  
Beloved, Your world has gone astray to  
find  
That porkers are a morsel for their greed  
Among the better diners when they dined.

20 "And he got up and came to where  
His father was. But for his share,  
He saw him way down the road there,  
His dad did, and felt pity for  
Him and ran and hugged him the more  
And kissed him *hard as he could bear*.

21 "And the son told him, 'Dad, I've sinned  
Against heaven and in your sight pinned,  
And am not worthy to be called  
Your son *by hairy or by bald*.'

22 "But the father said to his slaves,  
'Bring the best robe right off its staves,  
And put it on him and a ring  
Put on his right hand, and to sing  
Put shoes on his feet without sting.  
23 "And bring the fattened calf and kill,  
And let us eat merry to fill,  
24 "For see my son was dead and gone,  
And is alive again and drawn,  
And he was lost and has been found.'  
And they made merry all around.

It's like fathers in general to see  
Them dote upon the children who in spree  
Indulge themselves and waste the wealth in  
fee.

There's hardly any fathers on the earth  
Who do not spoil the younger son from  
birth.

And that was the occasion for the fall  
In the first case, when he climbed over  
wall.

As only son, I have no rule to follow,  
And do not need to go outside and wallow.  
I'm both the elder and the younger here,  
And I have neither joy nor pain to fear.  
Beloved, they say You too have just one  
son,  
The Christ Messiah come to join the fun.  
So how You cope is a way better done.

25 "And now the elder son was in  
The field, and he came near the din  
In the house and he heard within  
The music and the dancing's sound.  
26 "And he called one of the slaves round,  
And asked what these things meant  
profound.

27 "And he told him, 'You're brother's  
come,  
And your dad's killed the calf in sum,  
Because he's got him safe and sound.'

28 "And he was angry, and would not  
Go in, and so his father sought  
Him out and begged him to be caught.

29 "And he replied and told his dad,  
'See, all these many years I've had  
To serve you, and not disobey

In anything you came to say,  
 And yet you never gave to me  
 A kid to feast with friends on spree.  
 30 "But just as soon as this son comes,  
 Who has consumed his wealth on bums  
 And whores, you kill the fattened calf,  
*So which of us has the last laugh?*"  
 31 "And he told him, 'Son, you're with me  
 All the time, and all wealth in fee  
 That I have is yours. 32 "It was right  
 That we come celebrate in sight,  
 For your own brother had been dead,  
 And here he is alive instead,  
 And he was lost, but now is led."

The elder son, he has a valid point,  
 His father's ungainly around the joint.  
 He should have reckoned with the simple  
 view  
 That looking down the road each day or  
 two  
 Without a word of praise or thanks done to  
 The elder son was diplomatic brew.  
 The elder son is right, Beloved, I know,  
 And fathers ought to act well here below.  
 But this dad is not near insane as You,  
 Who by the story sent a son to do  
 The strangest thing on earth: to die instead  
 Of guilty partners who made their own bed.  
 Such action does no good at all to men,  
 But only makes You look stupid again.

## Luke 16

1 He spoke to his disciples too.  
 There was a certain rich man who  
 Had a steward at once accused  
 Of wasting his wealth and abused.  
 2 He called him and asked him, "What's  
 this  
 I hear about you *I would miss?*  
 Give me account of what you've done,  
 For you are out upon your bun."  
 3 The steward said within himself,  
 "What shall I do *like dwarf or elf?*  
 My master takes away from me  
 The stewardship. I cannot see  
 Myself digging in poverty,  
 And I'm ashamed to beg *for delph*.  
 4 I know what I'll do when I've lost  
 My job, so they will take the tossed  
 Out in their houses *to set free*.  
 5 He called his master's debtors in,

And said to the first, "What's your sin,  
 How much do you owe master's bin?"  
 6 And he said "One hundred in oil."  
 He told him, "Take receipt *in foil*,  
 Sit down fast and write fifty's *spoil*."  
 7 He asked another, "How much do  
 You owe?" He said "A hundred too  
 Of wheat." And he replied to him,  
 "Take your receipt and write down *dim*  
 An eighty's weight *and make it trim*."  
 8 The owner praised the unjust steward,  
 Because he'd done wisely in cuedward,  
 For the sons of this world are in  
 Their ways more cunning than *their kin*,  
 The children of light *without sin*.

If anyone desires to see the man  
 You sent as faulty in the divine plan,  
 This is the text to take. He seems to think  
 Admirable the cunning at the brink  
 Manipulating debts to let some sink  
 And others rise upon the wealth and stink.  
 The owner praised the man who used his  
 wealth  
 To buy the good will of debtors in stealth.  
 If the dishonest of this world can take  
 By cunning the profits for their greed's  
 sake,  
 Then You would have Your own in  
 cunning spree  
 Claim of Your wealth for others not to see.  
 I lay my thieving hand on heaven's gate  
 And plunder grace in infinite estate.

9 I tell you, make yourselves friends by  
 The mammon of unrighteous guy,  
 So when you fail, they will take you  
 In permanent houses *on cue*.  
 10 The one who's faithful in the least  
 Is also faithful in the feast  
 Of much; and the one who's unjust  
 In little's unjust in the worst.  
 11 So if you've not been faithful in  
 Unrighteous mammon, who will win  
 To trust you with the true to spin?

They say the most effective killers in  
 The battle are the ones who with a grin  
 Take over companies and win the race  
 Of gain for mere lust of the running pace.  
 The prize in killing is the same in peace:  
 The famous are just killers in release.

The quality of leadership is just  
Capacity to eat immoral dust.  
Beloved, let me not be successful here,  
Neither in dress of peace nor in the fear  
Of battle between those who join their gear  
To take advantage of the oil and steer.  
I flaunt Your grace among the ragged  
weeds,  
The magpies and the goldenrod in seeds.

12 If you've not been trustworthy in  
What is another's store and bin,  
Then who will give you what's your own?  
13 No servant can serve as in loan  
To two masters, for one he'll hate  
And love the other, or *in state*  
Will hold to one despising *late*.  
You cannot serve both God and mammon.  
14 The Pharisees too, who with stamin  
Were covetous, heard all these things,  
And they derided him *in rings*.

This anti-semitic word is beneath  
Your sent one to have murmured with his  
wreath.  
The Pharisees are the ancestors of  
Rabbinical in Judaism's glove,  
And surely not all of them were the kind  
To be so grasping of riches behind.  
He must mean that the few among that folk  
Who were the greedy type came in and  
spoke  
Against the lord for what he said for broke.  
The truth is by the dervish law and state,  
A man cannot serve wealth and still relate  
To You as to the Master of his life.  
To do so is to bring on inner strife.  
Relinquishing all, I come to Your fate.

15 And he said to them, "You are those  
Who justify yourselves in rows,  
But God knows your hearts, for that which  
Is loved by men is in the ditch  
In sight of God *and at a pitch*.  
16 "The law and prophets were till John,  
Since then God's kingdom's drawing on,  
And every man runs in as drawn."

The ones who look for kingdom in the  
scent  
Of future will not know where kingdom  
went.

The kingdom came the very day that John  
Spoke up and pointed to Jesus on lawn.  
There is no kingdom but that once set down  
To David in the Middle Eastern town,  
Jerusalem. And that kingdom remains  
Today for loss or for eternal gains.  
Beloved, I do not wait for You to come  
Again upon a mountain with the sum  
Of law for Your great kingdom on the  
earth.

The first one that You gave for David's  
worth  
Is good enough. It has been rarely tried,  
But when it has, it shows it can abide.

17 Faster shall heaven and earth go down  
Than one jot of the law from town.

You think that heaven and earth will fall  
before  
One tittle from Your law will fail on shore.  
You did not reckon with the Christian  
church  
That leaves the world to founder in the  
lurch.  
The law that You are one is turned to three,  
Your invisible form to imagery,  
Your name is given to such pagan gods  
That reject Your Sabbath to eat their pods.  
If that is not enough, parents go blind  
While children steal and kill and go behind  
The barn for their adulterous acts and  
shows,  
While liars and the covetous in rows  
Sing praises in contemporary pose.  
I hope, Beloved, that You simply don't  
mind.

18 Whoever puts away his wife  
And marries another for strife  
Commits adultery, and the one  
Who marries the divorced one done  
From her husband commits a tonne.

Fact is the law gives the right of divorce,  
So this word is in conflict and perforce  
Shows that the Gospel is not valid here,  
Unless there is an explanation near.  
Matthew notes that *porneia* is excuse,  
No doubt the marriage that is an abuse  
Of incest law. Your sent one has no right  
To drop the Torah law. His great insight

May well be that the Middle Eastern style  
Of marriage for a few hours and a smile  
To cover prostitution is so mad  
A circumvention of your law and sad,  
That You Yourself stand in astonishment  
To see the lengths that humans represent.

19 There was a certain rich man who  
Was dressed in purple and in hue  
Of finest linen, and ate well  
From day to day and for a spell.  
20 A certain beggar who was named  
Lazarus lay at his gate tamed  
And full of sores and uncomplained.  
21 He wanted to eat the crumbs that  
Fell off the place the rich man sat,  
And dogs came and licked his sores flat.  
22 It came to pass the beggar died,  
Carried by angels to the side  
Of Abraham, the rich man died  
Too and was buried *large and wide*.  
23 In hell he lifted up his eyes  
From torments as he sees in skies  
Abraham far off, on his breast  
Was Lazarus there come to rest.  
24 And he cried saying "Father mine,  
Abraham, have mercy in sign,  
And send our Lazarus, so he  
May dip his fingertip for me  
In water and cool my tongue, for  
I'm tormented in this flame's store."  
25 But Abraham said "Son, now mind  
How you had in your life resigned  
Your good things, and by the same token  
Lazarus had the marred and broken.  
But now he's comforted and you  
Are tormented *as is your due*.  
26 "Besides that there's a great gulf fixed  
Between us and you so unmixed  
Those who would come from here to you  
Cannot, and neither can your crew  
Pass over to us from your view."  
27 Then he said "I beg you to send,  
Father, to my father's house tend  
Him, 28 "for I've got five brothers there,  
So he may witness of the share,  
So they'll not also come to bake  
In this place of torment and stake."  
29 Abraham told him, "They indeed  
Have Moses and the prophets' seed,  
Let them hear them, and hear in need."  
30 And he said "No, father Abram,

But if one went to them from damn  
Of death, they will repent a dram."  
31 And he said to him, "If they'll not  
Hear Moses and the prophets' plot,  
Neither will they be convinced though  
One rose up from the dead to show."

The Hellenistic belief that the dead  
Are live in hell arises here instead  
Of the Semitic shade of Sheol led.  
It's just a tale, and its purport is not  
To describe paradise of hellish plot.  
I do not know the future, nor would I  
Understand it if it were written sly.  
And yet I know bosom of Abraham  
Is still the place I flee in life for dram  
And shall be pillow in my death if grace  
Lead me away from every awful place.  
Beloved, I tip the gulf and drink the drop  
That Dives covets instead of the sop,  
And thirst the more until You come to stop.

#### **Luke 17**

1 He said to his disciples, "There's  
No way to avoid the despairs  
Of coming offences bewares,  
But woe to one who brings the tares.  
2 "It would have been a better thing  
If a millstone were hung like ring  
Around his neck and he thrown in  
The sea, that he should make a din  
Offending one of these wee fers.  
3 "Watch out, if your brother trespass  
Against you, rebuke such an ass,  
And if he repents forgive him.  
4 "If he sins against you so grim  
As seven times a day, and then  
Comes back seven times to say again,  
'I do repent,' you'll forgive him."

While I have none who sin against me  
much,  
At least not seven times in the day to touch,  
It's rare that any sins against me and  
Returns repenting at all as You planned.  
Since none sin against me more than a few  
Times at most, I remember what to do,  
And forgive them without repentance due,  
Since Your sent one said You forgive the  
true  
In just the way that they forgive the ones

Who sin against them on their toes and  
buns.

So keep his word and forgive all I write  
Without me doing penance in Your sight,  
And I'll rejoice to find a ray of light  
Here in this world that bashes when it  
stuns.

5 And the apostles told the lord,  
"Increase our faith *and make restored.*"

6 And the lord said "If you had just  
As much faith as a mustard dust,  
You might say to this sycamine  
Tree, 'Be uprooted by the spine  
And be planted in the sea's brine,'  
And it would have obeyed you fine.

7 "But which of you with slave to plough  
Or feed the cattle anyhow

Will say to him, when he's come from  
The field, 'Go sit and eat and hum?"

8 "Will you not rather say to him,  
'Get supper ready and be trim,  
And tighten your belt and serve me  
Till I have eaten and drunk free,  
And after that you'll eat and drink?"

9 "Does he thank that servant and wink  
Because he did what he was told?  
I throw not, may I be so bold.

10 "So you too, when you've done the  
things

All that were in your commandings,  
Then say 'We're just poor slaves and we  
Have only accomplished duty.'"

The sweeter sort of Christian always takes  
This word with lumps of salt in the waves'  
wakes.

If anybody fails to steal or lie,  
They're happy as a mark upon the sty.  
But if a person keeps the Sabbath day,  
They cry foul for abuse of legal way.  
Of all commandments Sabbath is alone  
A legalistic sight for such a drone.  
And yet, Beloved, to rest upon that hour  
Is to acknowledge You upon Your power,  
And is but duty done, not for reward  
Nor for the fear of lightnings or of sword,  
But sign of poor slaves or of children won  
To Your account before the battle's done.

11 It happened as he went up to  
Jerusalem, that he passed through

The middle of Samaria

And Galilee. 12 And as in draw  
He came into a certain town,  
There met him ten men of renown  
As being lepers standing far.

13 They raised their voices up a bar  
And said "Jesus, sir, have mercy  
On us." 14 And when he saw them be,  
He said to them, "Go show yourselves  
To the priests. And as the time delves,  
As they were going faithfully,  
They all were healed of leprosy.

15 And one of them, when he saw that  
He had been healed, he turned back flat  
And loudly praised God off the bat.

16 He fell down in prostration at  
His feet and thanked him on the mat.  
He was Samaritan at that.

17 And Jesus answered, said *to him*,  
"Were not ten healed, where are the trim,  
The other nine, *I see none dim?*"

18 "The only one who came to praise  
God was this foreigner in ways."

19 And he said to him, "Get up, go  
Your way, for your faith made you so."

The point was sharp that Jesus came to  
make

According to Luke in the hardened stake.  
He stuck the Jews to say Samaritans  
Were better in their kindly manners' plans.  
The miracle was not the men believed  
And went off to the priest when they  
received

The promise only, which had come about  
While they were busy walking on the route.  
The miracle was not that Jesus could  
Heal leprosy among wicked and good.  
The miracle was that one man turned back  
To say his thanks. Very few have that  
knack.

Beloved, let me be wiser than the store,  
A genius, having learned thanks given  
more.

20 When Pharisees asked him about  
The time God's kingdom should come out,  
He answered them and said "The king-  
dom of God is not seeing's thing.

21 "Neither shall they say 'See now, look!'  
Or 'Over by the other nook!'  
For see, God's kingdom's here with you."

Those who pretend to spirituality,  
And lecture to New Agers in a spree,  
Say that the kingdom's in the heart, within  
Where silence meets to greater sort of din.  
The kingdom's not within a man of sin  
Or in a righteous heart. It is a man  
Who was seen there before their eyes in  
span.

The kingdom was with them that very day  
In the figure of flesh and blood and clay.  
I reckon though I cannot see his day,  
He hides in occultation on the way,  
And stays before Your throne, Beloved, to  
pray.

I enter in the kingdom of the son  
Of David and invisibly have won.

22 He said to his disciples then,  
"The time will come when you again  
Will wish to see one of the days  
Of son of man, and not to raise.

23 "And they will say to you, 'Behold,  
It's here or there,' but when you're told,  
Do not go or follow the sold.

24 "For as the lightnings from one end  
Of the sky to the other bend,  
So shall too be the son of man  
In the day that he comes to span.

My mind seem rational to think the earth  
Must go on as it is in faith and mirth.  
But the apocalyptic sort of berth  
Is found in Luke and other gospels' worth.  
Beloved, send out the son of David when  
The colder shoulder turns among such men  
As seek or not Your justice come again.  
I hear the news of peace made here and  
there,  
Of human rights proclaimed among the  
fair,

But do not go to see them take their share.  
I wait for lightning from the east and west  
To shine upon the coming of the best,  
And find the waiting short despite the pain  
Of rival runs and stuttering of rain.

25 "But first he has to suffer much,  
Rejected by this people's touch.

26 "And as it was in Noah's days,  
So also shall be in the days  
Of son of man *coming for praise*.

27 "They ate and drank and married wives,  
And gave in marriage all their lives,  
Until the day Noah went in  
The ark, and then the flood in din  
Came and destroyed all *in their sin*.

28 "So also it was in the days  
Of Lot: they ate and drank for stays,  
They bought and sold, planted and built,

29 "But the same day at a full tilt  
That Lot went out of Sodom it  
Rained fire and brimstone in a fit  
From the sky and destroyed them all.

30 "Just so it will be in the day  
When son of man appears to stay.

I recognize the markings of the time  
In which I live like Noah in his prime,  
Like Lot and Lot's wife looking back on  
crime,

Because I see the hovering of the climb.  
Beloved, the days have spilled about the  
hill

That captivates my gratitude and still  
Sleeps under sun and cloud or frozen rill.  
The son of man may come for all I care  
Tomorrow or today to give the share  
Of punishment or reward to the fair.  
My penance is enough to sleep and wake  
Beneath the firs and pines and birch's stake.  
The roll of snow that tumbles from the roof  
Is din enough, apocalyptic proof.

31 "Then the one on the rooftop who  
Has his belongings in the pew  
In the house, let him not come down  
To rescue it about the town,

And the one in the field, let him  
Not go back to save gear and trim.

32 "Remember Lot's wife, *it was grim*.

33 "The one who tries to save his life  
Shall lose it, and the one *in strife*

To lose his life will save *from knife*.

34 "I tell you, in that night there'll be  
Two in one bed, and one go free,  
And yet the other will be left.

35 "Two shall be grinding till bereft  
Shall be the one and yet the other  
Shall be taken up not to smother.

36 "Two shall be in the field, and one  
Shall be taken, the other spun."

37 They answered and said to him, "Where,  
Sir?" And he said to them, "Forbear,



Wherever the corpse lies, then there  
The eagles gather for their share.”

If all days are alike in evil share,  
Then how can eagles give a clear sign  
there?

The nearness of the coming is not seen  
In wars or famines on the fat or lean,  
In hopes or desperations of the great  
Or of the smaller people in their fate.  
The circling of the buzzards in my youth  
Told me as well then as now of the truth  
That time goes on without a sign of end  
Except it tatters where the knots would  
blend.

Beloved, I trust the coming. Let me be  
Upon the housetop, bed or field to see  
Arrival of the waited and Mahdi,  
The coming of Your Christ to end the  
spree.

### **Luke 18**

1 He spoke a parable to them,  
That men should always pray a dem  
And not just wither on the stem.  
2 He said “There was a judge in town  
Who feared neither God nor the crown.  
3 “There was also a widow there  
In that place, and she came to share,  
Saying 'Avenge me of my foe.'  
4 “But he would not and he was slow.  
But in time he said to himself,  
Though I fear neither God nor elf,  
5 “Yet because this widow's a pest,  
I will come to avenge her, lest  
By always coming she'll tire me.”  
6 “And the lord said “Listen to what  
The unjust judge said in his gut.  
7 “And shall not God avenge His own  
Chosen, who cry day and intone  
In the night to Him, though He wait  
A long time to repair their state?”  
8 “I tell you He'll avenge them fast.  
Still when the son of man at last  
Shall come, will he find faith on earth?”

Beloved, I do implore You day and night  
To spread my book in many people's sight.  
But not to buy alone, Beloved, but read,  
And not to read alone, Beloved, with greed,  
But to turn to You only in their need.  
I do implore You night and day to bring

My sonnet prayers to ears to hear them  
sing,

But not to hear alone, but to reject  
The futile and remember to select  
What tends to goodness, truth, and beauty  
here.

Beloved, turn my small efforts to good  
cheer,  
And multiply the good and bend the chaff.  
I turn around the slaughter ground and  
laugh  
To find Your answer sounding proud and  
clear.

9 He spoke this parable to those  
Who trusted in their righteous pose  
And despised others *in their rows*.

The remnant righteous is a class that's set  
Since Jeremiah was a prophet met.  
The elite of a church or synagogue  
Has always had its own admiring cog.  
And everywhere that Islam speaks the  
word,

There is a dervish group to leave the herd.  
The pinnacle of truth appears to be  
Laestadians, who know they'll only see  
The Finns and Swedes that make up their  
party  
Stand straight before Your throne to get  
their fee.

All others will land in hell by decree.  
Beloved, I join in no elite nor in  
The great established throng in righteous  
din,  
But flee to You alone and so I win.

10 Two went to the temple to pray,  
The one a Pharisee to stay,  
The other just a publican.

11 The Pharisee stood by himself  
And prayed thus: God upon Your shelf,  
I thank you I'm not like the others  
Among men to extortion brothers,  
Unjust, adulterers or such  
As even this publican's crutch.

12 I fast two days a week and I  
Give tithes of all I have in sty.  
13 The publican stood to one side,  
And would not even lift in pride  
His eyes toward the sky, but struck  
His breast and said *again for luck*,

“Have mercy on me, God, for I  
Am just a sinner *going by*. ”  
14 I tell you, this man went back home  
Put right, while the other *in Rome*  
Did not. For every one that sets  
Himself up high, shall be put low,  
But every humbler one then gets  
Exalted *by God and not slow*.

The doctrine of justification here  
Demands a human sacrifice to cheer.  
But the loved Gospel makes no such in  
claim,  
But justifies repentant man and dame.  
Without a cross, without a Saviour near  
Besides Your lovely self, Beloved, he came  
To pray the best of prayers and without  
shame  
To beat his breast, the gesture You would  
steer,  
And beg Your mercy infinite in fear  
And make no other claim beside the same,  
That he was just a sinner at Your ear.  
Beloved, of all men that You have held  
dear,  
That loathsome tax collector now of fame  
Stands noble above every Christian blame.

15 And they brought him babies to touch,  
But when the disciples as much  
As saw it they rebuked the folk.  
16 But Jesus summoned them and said  
“Let little children come as led,  
Do not prevent them, for of such  
Is God's kingdom made up as much.  
17 “Truly I tell you, everyone  
Who does not take God's kingdom won  
As does a little child shall not  
By any means get in the plot.”

The kingdom was a personage, a man,  
The son of David by eternal plan,  
And not an inspiration in the heart  
Within as some today would paint the cart.  
The difference between the man and child  
Is not that one is righteous, mild or wild,  
But that the child accepts the king who  
comes  
With joy enthusiastic and with drums,  
And climbs up in his lap, looks in his face,  
And asks him for a story by his grace.  
Adults at best shake hands and are polite

And distant, though some days they even  
might  
Flatter or fawn or jostle for their right.  
Beloved, I come a child for Your delight.

18 A certain ruler asked him saying  
“Good master, what shall I waylaying  
Do to inherit life eternal?”  
19 And Jesus said to him infernal,  
“Why do you call me good? There's none  
Who's good but God alone *when done*.  
20 “You know the *ten* commandments  
well,  
Fall not under adultery's spell,  
Do not kill, do not steal, do not  
Bear a false witness in a plot,  
And honour dad and mum *a lot*. ”

Jesus rejects the attributes of God,  
But sets himself a man upon the sod.  
His brief sermon capitulates Your own,  
Beloved, spoken upon Mount Sinai's  
throne.

They tell me Jesus here rejects the most  
Of the commandments by selection's boast,  
But I say he identified the text  
By quoting the briefer ones unperplexed.  
In those days verse and chapter had no clue  
In reference for the numbering now due.  
He does not thereby imply they are few,  
But rather that the whole is law in crew.  
Beloved, I hear the word Jesus made true:  
It shows him to have come in faith from  
You.

21 And he said “All these I have kept  
Since I was babe *in arms and slept*.  
22 When Jesus heard these things, he said  
To him, “There is one thing instead  
That you lack: sell all that you've got  
And give out to the poor the lot,  
And you'll have treasure in the plot  
Of heaven. Come follow what I've taught.”  
23 And when he heard this, he was sad,  
For he was a very rich lad.

Note here, Beloved, that those who claim  
the man  
Had not kept Your law faithfully in span,  
Because all men are sinners by Your plan,  
Make Jesus out a liar as well as  
The man who testified for Your law's jazz.

The law is simple, made for childlike hand,  
And for the foot of youth upon the sand,  
And for the tottering aged in command.  
It is not necessary that all come  
To sin upon the shore and then to hum  
Before the priest forgiveness of the sum.  
Jesus would add love to the law but not  
Thereby annul the law from garden plot.  
Let me remain a poor man yet one taught.

24 When Jesus saw that he was sad,  
He said "How hard it is for cad  
Of wealth to enter in *the gate*  
*Of the kingdom of God not late!*  
25 "It's easier a camel should  
Go through a needle's eye than would  
A rich man enter reign of God."  
26 And they that heard it said "Who then  
Can ever be saved among men?"  
27 He said "Impossible with men  
Is possible with God again."

The people that were listening to the word  
That day when Jesus saw what had  
occurred  
With the rich man, must have been rich to  
think  
That it's impossible here on the brink.  
Who can be saved if rich man fail to dine?  
The answer of course is the poor in wine.  
Beloved, I am a dervish in my state,  
A poor man waiting at Your hearth both  
late  
And early, instead of a man to seek  
The wealth of powerful as well as weak.  
Impossible or not I find the way  
Of poverty in soul and power so gay  
That even without sun upon the hill,  
The calm of winter darkness comforts still.

28 Then Peter said "See, we have left  
All and followed you *as bereft.*"  
29 And he told them, "Indeed I say  
To you, there is no man in view  
That has left house, parents of pew  
With brothers, or wife or his spawn,  
For the kingdom of God in dawn,  
30 "Who shall not get more in this age  
And in the world to come *the page*  
*Of everlasting life on cue.*"

The plan of Abraham was family

For church and not the Canaanites' degree.  
The church of Jesus is to leave them all  
And stick to one or two in secret stall.  
The kingdom is among the two or three  
Where Jesus is present invisibly.  
Beloved, if I have two or three with me  
It is a celebration at the call.  
As missionary, I'm not on the ball.  
Sabbath by Sabbath in the family's pose  
I meet to greet Your name and smell the  
rose  
Of divine presence on the loving shore.  
I hear the beloved knock upon the door  
And open all the while to read Your lore.

31 Then he took the twelve and told them,  
"See, we go to Jerusalem,  
And everything that's written by  
The prophets of the son of man,  
Should come to pass under the sky.  
32 "He'll be turned over to the span  
Of Gentiles to be mocked, abused,  
And spat upon *by the confused.*  
33 They'll beat him and put him to death,  
The third day he'll regain his breath."  
34 They did not understand a thing  
Of what he said, a hidden ring  
From them, and so they did not know  
The things that he had spoken so.

The lively in a later day resolved  
That Jesus fulfilled prophecies involved.  
No doubt for some things that was very  
true,  
And yet, I see him taking on the view  
That what the Bible says he has to do  
As duty, not fulfilment of the word  
Of prophecy, but burning heart now stirred.  
The doing then is never something new.  
Beloved, I find my punctuated days  
Are met with in a world of swirled in haze,  
But for the cryptic paths of Hebrew verse  
That brighten my way with a song or curse.  
I follow in the steps that Jesus kept  
Though I'm not a messiah where I've swept.

35 It happened when he came up near  
To Jericho, a blind man dear  
Sat by the wayside begging cheer.  
36 And when he heard the crowd pass by,  
He asked about it, what and why.  
37 And they told him that Jesus of

Nazareth passes by *in love*.

38 And he set up a cue and cry,  
Saying "Jesus, David's son nigh,  
Have mercy on me *where I sigh*.  
39 The ones in the front rebuked him,  
And told him to shut up by grim,  
But he just shouted all the more,  
"Son of David, pity my score."  
40 Jesus stopped and commanded him  
To be brought before him and trim,  
And when he came near, he asked him,  
41 And said "What do you want from me?"  
And he said "Sir, I want to see."  
42 And Jesus told him, "Have your sight.  
Your faith has saved you from the blight."  
43 And straight away he got his sight,  
And followed him while praising God.  
And all the folk who saw the prod,  
They also gave such praise to God.

Beloved, I also set my faith and store  
On David and his son forevermore.  
And when he passes me in my dark night,  
I raise a cry to him to have the sight  
Of truth and justice in a world of pain,  
A world of solitude, a world of gain,  
A world that cares no whit for pity's reign,  
A world of dawn upon the autumn lake  
In grey shine beside flames the birches  
make,  
A world of open sky where I can fly  
On things of hope resigned if I just try,  
A world grown old in dusty beauty where  
The strings of gold and pearls still come to  
share  
A tawdry but endearing canopy.

### **Luke 19**

1 And Jesus entered Jericho  
And walked right through it *nice and slow*.  
And see, a man named Zacchaeus  
Who was the top tax man to fuss,  
He was a really wealthy cuss.  
3 He tried to get Jesus in sight,  
But could not for the press and height,  
Because his own stature was slight.  
4 He ran ahead and climbed up in  
A sycamore tree from the din  
That would pass by *beneath his grin*.  
15 When Jesus came there, he looked up,  
And saw him and addressed the tup,  
"Zacchaeus, hurry and come down,

Today I'll stay in your house brown."  
6 He hurried down to him with joy.  
7 And when they saw it, they complained,  
And said that he had gone untrained  
To visit a sinner man stained.  
8 Zacchaeus stopped and told the lord,  
"See, sir, half of the wealth I've stored  
I give to the poor, and if I  
Have taken something on the sly  
Dishonestly, I give him back  
Four times the sum *not to be slack*.  
9 And Jesus told him, "Today now  
Salvation's to this house brow,"  
Since he too's Abraham's son's stack.  
10 "The son of man has come to seek  
And save the lost *who take a peek*."

In the case of dishonest men of state,  
The tax collector and the business rate,  
It does suffice merely to repent of  
The stealing done and with or without love  
To make the restitution that is spoken  
In Torah for a pleasure and a token.  
No sacrifice of lamb or human flesh  
Is needed to start out holy and fresh.  
Even the ones who usually come to spoil  
Your sent one's day with snares and  
fowling coil  
Are satisfied to see Zacchaeus sit  
Upon the bough and like butterfly flit  
Out to restore to all what he had taken.  
The Roman crosses are now all forsaken.

11 As they were listening to these things,  
He added a parable's wings,  
Because he was near to the city  
Jerusalem, and they thought witty  
The kingdom of God should appear  
Straight off *unless it was too queer*.  
12 And so he said: A certain man  
Of noble birth took to his plan  
To go into a far-off land,  
And then to come back *as he planned*.  
13 He called his ten servants to him,  
And gave them ten pounds to keep trim  
Until he came back to the band.  
14 His citizens hated him, and  
Sent messages after him, saying  
'We will not have this reign in swaying.'  
15 It happened when he did come back,  
Having received his kingdom's rack,  
He summoned these servants to him,

The ones he gave the money trim,  
 To find out how much each one had  
 Gained by their trading *on the pad*.  
 16 The first one came and said "Sir, see,  
 Your pound has gained ten pounds in fee."  
 17 He told him, "Good, you faithful slave,  
 Because you've been true with the lave,  
 I'll give you ten cities to brave."  
 18 The second one came in to say  
 "Sir, your pound has gained in its pay  
 Five pounds more in the trading way."  
 19 Likewise he said to him, "I'll set  
 You over five of my towns met."  
 20 Another one came saying "Sir,  
 See, your pound which I've kept in fur;  
 21 "For I feared you, because you are  
 A harsh man taking from the bar  
 What you've not set down, and reap well  
 What you did not sow with a spell."  
 22 And he said to him, "From your mouth  
 I will judge you and sell you south,  
 You wicked slave. You knew that I  
 Was a harsh master, taking sly  
 What I'd not set down, and to reap  
 What I'd not sowed, but got it cheap.  
 23 "Why did you not then give my pound  
 To the bank, when I'd come around  
 I might get my own back and sound  
 With interest on investment ground?"  
 24 And he said to those who stood near,  
 "Take his pound from him and with cheer  
 Give it to the one with ten pounds."  
 25 They told him, "Sir, he's got ten  
 pounds."  
 26 "For I tell you that every one  
 Who has, will be given a tonne,  
 And from the one who has no gain,  
 From him shall be taken in pain.  
 27 "But those my foes who would not take  
 My reign, bring them here to the stake  
 And slaughter them before my wake."

The kingdom had come soon as John had  
 said,  
 As soon as he pointed to Jesus led.  
 But the arrival of the man to sit  
 On David's throne was not enough in mitt.  
 He had to go on a long journey still  
 To receive crown and sceptre with a will.  
 The kingdom does not tarry though the  
 years  
 Amount to two millennia of tears.

The king is at Your throne to fill his hands  
 With all the glories of the universe,  
 And when his hands are full at Your  
 commands  
 He shall return with blessing and with  
 curse.  
 Beloved, I now invest in kingdom come,  
 Awaiting just the killing of the bum.

28 When he had said so, he went on  
 Up to Jerusalem as drawn.  
 29 It happened, when he had come near  
 To Bethphage and Bethany,  
 At the hill called Mount Olives dear,  
 He sent two disciples to see,  
 30 Saying "Go to the village there  
 Across the way, in which and where  
 You come in you'll find a colt tied,  
 On which no man has come to ride,  
 Untie him and bring him to me.  
 31 "If anyone asks you, 'Why do  
 You untie?' you shall tell him *due*,  
 'Because the lord needs him *on cue*.'  
 32 And those who were sent went their  
 way,  
 And found it as he came to say.  
 33 And as they loosed the colt, the one  
 Who owned it came to see the fun,  
 And asked them why they took the colt.  
 34 They said the lord desired the dolt.

The king is king indeed, and not a mere  
 Churl on the threshing floor of Roman  
 spear.  
 The stone is cut without hands and is set  
 Ready to crush the Roman kingdom met.  
 The centuries pass by and donkeys go  
 Out of style in the ways of royal woe,  
 But still the kingdom's here, and strong and  
 near  
 To every heart gathered for royal cheer  
 Where two or three meet under donkey's  
 rate  
 To find the son of David at the gate.  
 He rides again in every town where in  
 The homely hearth the minyan without sin  
 Is two or three of male or female kin.

35 They brought the colt to Jesus then,  
 And spread their coats on it again,  
 And set Jesus on it to ride.  
 36 And as he went through countryside,

They spread their clothes on the roadway.  
 37 And when he had come near just at  
 The descent of Mount Olives' mat,  
 The whole crowd of disciples there  
 Began to rejoice and to share  
 Their praise to God with a loud voice  
 For all the mighty works of choice  
 That they had seen and to rejoice.  
 38 They said "Blessed be the king that  
 comes  
 In the name of the Lord in sums,  
 Peace in the sky and glory in  
 The highest, *he comes without sin.*  
 39 Some of the Pharisees among  
 The crowd said to him as they'd sung,  
 "Now master, rebuke your own friends,  
 And your disciples for their bends."  
 40 He answered and told them, "I say,  
 If they should stop praising that way,  
 The stones themselves would shout and  
 sway."

The population of the earth today  
 Is greater by far than in that far sway  
 When the folk shouted hosannas in praise.  
 And yet the stones had better turn and raise  
 The shout, for now few seem to know the  
 man  
 That You sent to Jerusalem in plan.  
 So let the stones cry out that he's the son  
 Of David and still reigns upon the run  
 Of earth before the day and night are spun.  
 Let stones cry out, since human voice is  
 stilled,  
 Or rather turned to idols when they're  
 thrilled,  
 And would make of Your own a second  
 god,  
 And put You with him three peas in a pod.  
 Let the stones shout aloud before the prod.

41 When he got near, he saw the town,  
 And wept to see it *glower and frown*.  
 42 He said "If you had known, yes you,  
 At least in this your day in view,  
 The things that are of your own peace!  
 But now your eyes have no release.  
 43 "For the days come on you that your  
 Foes shall throw a ditch round your store,  
 Surrounding you in their increase,  
 44 "And he'll throw you down to the  
 ground,

Your children too, and all around  
 They'll not leave one stone on a stone,  
 Because you did not come to own  
 The time you came *before the throne*.  
 45 He went into the temple, and  
 Began to throw the merchant band  
 Out with their customers to stand.  
 46 He said to them, "It's written well,  
 My house is a house where to dwell  
 With prayer, but you have turned it to  
 A den of thieves *in every pew*."  
 47 And he taught every day there in  
 The temple. But the chief priests' *kin*  
 And scribes and elite of the folk  
 Tried to destroy him *at a stroke*.  
 48 They could not find a way to do,  
 For all the people in the crew  
 Wanted to hear him speaking true.

I've seen the teachers sitting in that place  
 With circles of disciples still to trace  
 Upon the carpets spread beneath the red  
 Stone of Al-Aqsa's house built there  
 instead.

The centuries have changed nothing at all:  
 The stones still hear the blessings of the  
 call

To prayer to summon worshippers in thrall,  
 The popular teachers still line the wall,  
 And when the generations change along,  
 New ones rise up to sing the ancient song.  
 Beloved, I take my place along the rows  
 Of worshipers who touch each other's toes,  
 And bow to You alone and find the grace  
 That Jesus taught long ago in this place.

## **Luke 20**

1 It happened on one of those days,  
 As he was teaching the folk ways  
 Inside the temple, and preaching  
 The good news, the chief priests in ring  
 And the scribes came to him along  
 With the elders to show him wrong.  
 2 They spoke to him and said "Tell us,  
 By what authority and fuss  
 Do you do these things? Or who's he  
 Who gave you this authority?"  
 3 And he replied and said to them,  
 "I'll also ask of you a gem,  
 And answer me by stratagem.  
 4 "The baptism of John, was it  
 From heaven or merely of men fit?"

5 And they thought to themselves and said  
 "If we say from heaven, instead  
 He'll say why did you not believe.  
 6 "But if we say that men deceive,  
 The people will all stone us here.  
 For they believe a prophet's near  
 In John." 7 So they responded that  
 They could not tell where it was at.  
 8 And Jesus told them, "Neither then  
 Do I tell you by what power's yen  
 I do these things *by you again*.

The baptism of John by every word  
 Of Gospel is baptism not deterred  
 By You, Beloved, but for hearts truly  
 stirred.

Repentance and the miqwe are well known  
 To Jew and Gentile here before Your  
 throne.

As preparation day arrives, the man  
 And woman come to cleanse themselves by  
 plan

In the sweet waters set in cor and fan.  
 Beloved, the water's not enough for me,  
 Although I took the baptism in fee  
 Before I stepped upon Hijaz in sand.  
 I donned the garment white at Your  
 command.

I rather raise petition of a hand  
 To take Your own baptisms where I stand.

9 Then he began to tell the folk  
 This parable. A certain bloke  
 Planted a vineyard, and let it  
 To workmen, and went out to sit  
 In a far country for a time.

10 When the time came he sent to prime  
 The workmen, that they should give him  
 The produce of the vineyard trim,  
 Then the workers beat the servant,  
 And sent him far away with scant.

11 He sent another servant then  
 And they beat him too once again,  
 And treated him most shamefully,  
 Also sent him away empty.

12 Again he sent a third, and they  
 Wounded him too, and cast away.

13 Then the lord of the vineyard said  
 "What shall I do? I'll send instead  
 My loved son, it may be that they  
 Will have respect for him when they  
 See him *coming out to them led*."

14 But when the workers saw him, they  
 Said to themselves, "This is the heir.  
 Let's kill him now and take his share."  
 15 So they threw him out at the gate  
 And killed him. And so by what rate  
 Shall the lord of the vineyard do  
 To them when he comes into view?  
 16 He'll come destroy these workers and  
 Give the vineyard into the hand  
 Of others. And when they heard it,  
 They said "May God forbid *the fit*."

The Pharisees say may God forbid that  
 Destruction fall upon the vineyard flat.  
 They knew the story from the prophet's  
 pen,

And did not have to realize again  
 That Jesus was repeating warning set  
 By inspiration of the Bible met.  
 So God forbid indeed destruction come.  
 And yet the decades future in their sum  
 Brought grief beyond the punishment  
 foretold.

The killing of a son out in the cold  
 Itself could merit not such sorrow taught  
 By Titus and his men in tragic plot.  
 Beloved, let every vineyard stand to yield  
 The fruit to join the bread of every field.

17 He looked at them and said "What's this  
 Then written Scripture that the stone  
 The builders set aside to miss,  
 Has become the head cornerstone?"  
 19 The chief priests and the scribes that  
 hour

Tried to arrest him in their power,  
 Yet they feared the folk, for they knew  
 He'd told this tale against their crew.

Your sent one, my Beloved, had at his rear  
 The populace to protect him from fear.  
 That's why they could not take him in the  
 seat

Of temple teaching those around his feet.  
 Your sent one, my Beloved, could speak  
 aloud

Against establishment of faith and crowd,  
 Knowing the public place was safe for him.  
 Beware the night, I say with warning grim.  
 I speak against establishment like he,  
 But have no faithful bulwark of the free  
 Behind my words to stand protecting me.

I am alone before the awful crowd  
That transgresses Your law as they're  
allowed  
By church and priest. And yet I am  
unbowed.

20 They watched him and sent out their  
spies,

Pretending to be just men's guise,  
To take hold of his words and make  
A case to bring him in their wake  
Before the governor's assizes.

21 They asked him saying "Master, we  
Know you speak and teach righteously,  
Neither do you accept the face,  
But teach God's way truly with grace.

22 Is it lawful to give tribute  
To Caesar or no, what's the fit?"

23 But he saw through their cunning way,  
And asked them, "Why tempt me *today*?"

24 "Show me a penny. Whose image  
And superscription's on its *page*?"  
They answered saying "Caesar's *wage*."

25 He said to them, "Give therefore to  
Caesar the things to Caesar due,  
And to God things of God in view."

26 And they could not take him with words  
Before the people in their herds,  
And they were amazed at what he  
Answered and held their peace *sweetly*.

The persecuted and the good and fair  
Can speak no message on the craven air,  
Because the words they speak are shaken  
there

By those out to twist hope and force the  
dare.

What glories might Your sent one have  
expressed

Had he not had to deal with those  
addressed

With questions subtle merely to intrude  
A doubt upon a beauty and a brood!  
Because of that today the millions give  
To Caesar what they ought to keep to live,  
And recognize the state as true and just,  
When it is really broken in the dust.  
Show me the day when all look at the light  
Blinding and overwhelming every sight.

27 There came some Sadducean men,  
Who deny resurrection then,

And they asked him a thing again.

28 They said "Master, Moses wrote us  
If any man's brother in muss  
Die having a wife, but without  
Offspring, his brother without doubt  
Should take his wife and raise up seed  
To his brother *left in his need*.

29 There were seven brothers and the first  
Took a wife and died for the worst  
Without spawn. 30 And the second took  
Her as wife and died like a crook  
Without a child. 31 The third took her  
And in the same way every fer  
Of the seven, and left no spawn but  
They all died *when they kicked the butt*.

32 And last of all the woman died.

33 So in the resurrection tide,  
Whose wife shall she be who became  
The wife of seven without shame?

The Sadducean question on the law  
Was cunning and erudite in the paw.  
But by that token of reason and power  
Of revelation on the trysting hour,  
It was an abuse of the word just by  
The suppositions of a priori.

Let me not be a man, Beloved, to find  
Your word a mere excuse to make me  
blind.

I'm blind enough beneath the veils I see.  
I need no greater blindness of degree.  
Who is the wife in resurrection's spree?  
A better question is for now and near,  
And how to keep the purity with fear,  
The faith with true obedience in stake,  
The heart sincere and without sin to make.

34 And Jesus answered them and said

"The progeny of this world led  
Do marry and give wives to bed,  
35 But those accounted worthy of  
The resurrection's world above,  
Do not marry or give of wives.

36 Neither can they die in their lives,  
For they are like the angels there,  
And are children of God in care,  
As resurrection's sons to share.

37 But that the dead are raised is seen  
By Moses even on the bean  
At the bush when he called the Lord  
The God of Abraham restored,  
And God of Isaac, Jacob's Sword.



38 For He's not a God of the dead,  
But of the living: all are led  
To life before His *throne* instead.  
39 Then certain of the scribes replied,  
And said "Master, well said beside."

The answer Jesus gave the Sadducee  
To show the resurrection's Your decree  
Is subtle, far too subtle one for me.  
That You are God of living and not dead  
And yet of Abraham and his sons spread,  
Does not prove anything beyond the fact  
That Jesus meditated it unslacked.  
The burning bush does not enlighten me.  
Is resurrection implied in the word  
Of Moses that You are a God who's stirred  
By generations past? Perhaps it does.  
But that's not convincing to one who was.  
Beloved, raise me to life today and here.  
Do not wait for a future day of fear.

40 And after that they did not dare  
To ask him anything or share.  
41 And he told them, "How do they say  
That Christ is David's son in sway?  
42 "But David himself in the Psalms  
Says 'YHWH said to my lord of palms  
To sit at My right hand *in pay*,  
43 "Till I make your foes in their way  
Your footstool *where to rest today*.'  
44 "So David called him lord, and so  
How can he be his son in row?"

The promise once prophetic was that You  
Would resurrect King David in our view,  
And set him once to reign again as due.  
And yet another promise has been made:  
That he should not lack son on throne's  
parade  
Throughout eternity. The promises  
Are contradictory and flash with fizz.  
That Jesus noticed that is no surprise.  
He was the son of David in some guise  
As all the people shouted in his praise.  
Both David and his son require some stays.  
Beloved, I seek both David and his son,  
And enter in the kingdom they have won,  
And for my part they're both lords when  
I'm done.

45 Then in the hearing of the folk  
All there, he said to his friends woke,

46 "Beware of the scribes, who desire  
To walk in long robes and require  
Greetings in the markets, high seats  
In synagogues, and the chief place  
At feasts, 47 "and who devote the trace  
Of widows' houses, and for show  
Make long prayers, the same shall receive  
The greater damnation *on sleeve*."

The scribes praised Jesus when he spoke a  
word  
Against the Sadducean question blurred.  
But that does not make Jesus join with  
them.  
He rails on them in further stratagem.  
Your sent one separates himself from all  
Sects in the faiths lined up along the wall.  
Beloved, I too rail on both foe and friend,  
And though the gale blow, I refuse to bend.  
Proverbial as grass upon the soil,  
I'm neither tree unbending nor such coil.  
Instead I am a dandelion sans stem,  
Blooming beneath accustomed cutting  
down:  
I feel no more the raging of the town.  
I bloom pressed to the earth, beneath the  
frown.

### **Luke 21**

1 He looked up and he saw the rich  
Throw in the treasury to pitch  
Their gifts. 2 And he saw coming too  
A certain poor widow who threw  
In there two mills *without a hitch*.  
3 And he said "Of a truth I say  
To you, that this poor widow's way  
Was putting in more than they all.  
4 "For all these others from the store  
Of their abundance have poured more  
Into the offerings of our God,  
But she of her poverty's prod  
Has cast in all her living's stall."

The great corrupt of all the preachers find  
This tale an excuse further and inclined  
To say that even poor ought to support  
Their ministries to keep them in the sport.  
Because temple establishment back then  
Was a corruption and a thieving den,  
Jesus in praising the poor widow's fare  
Confirmed that support ought to be their  
share.

Beloved, the lesson to be taken is  
That behind such a desperation's whiz  
There was a history of poverty,  
The last meal eaten, loss of hope's degree,  
The last act before hunger should aspire  
To cast the fainting body in the mire.

5 As some spoke of the temple and  
How it was decorated grand  
With fine stones and with gifts to stand,  
He said 6 "These things that you behold,  
The days come when there'll not be told  
One stone left on another *cold*,  
That will not be thrown down *and sold*."  
7 They asked him, saying "Master, when  
Shall these things be? And what sign then  
When it shall happen once again?"

OK, the ancient wailing wall remains,  
And it is not to be sniffed at for gains,  
For it is mammoth in its standing canes.  
But that is no proof that the man was wrong  
In his prediction of what came along.  
It was a mere expression, stone on stone,  
To say destruction was complete to bone.  
And so it was, despite Titus who scanned  
To stay the retribution of his band.  
They did not try to waste the flames at all,  
And if they had, they hardly in their stall  
Could manage to extinguish the fire set  
By passions and by wickedness unmet.  
The human soul is lost in wandered lanes.

8 And he said "Beware that you not  
Be tricked, for many come in plot  
Of my name saying 'It is I,  
And the time promised has come nigh,  
But don't go after them or try.  
9 "But when you hear of wars and strife,  
Do not be afraid for your life,  
For these things must first come to pass,  
But the end is not near *the brass*."  
10 Then he said to them, "Nation will  
Rise against nation, and king still  
Against reign of the other lass.  
11 "And great earthquakes shall come to  
shake  
In many places, and the lack  
Of food and pestilences crack  
With fearful sights and horrid signs  
Shall come from the sky *in its lines*.

It was not difficult here to predict  
Catastrophe upon an earth untricked.  
One only need to wait a day or two,  
And somewhere death and grief will come  
to view.

Hope is a thing to avoid like the pest,  
It squanders life while waiting for the best.  
It gets no better than the hurtful claw,  
The raucous music and the loud guffaw.  
Beloved, across the metal grate and bell  
I look to find the blossom on the knell,  
The momentary colours I love well,  
The breeze refreshing on the dripping slate.  
I find reprieve in passing from the hate,  
The disregard for life and death come late.

12 "But before all these, they shall lay  
Their hands on you, oppression play,  
Deliver you up to the fray  
Of synagogues and prisons' way,  
To bring you before kings and to  
Rulers for my name's sake in view.

13 "And for witness they'll turn to you.

14 "Be certain in your hearts not to  
Meditate beforehand the cue  
Of what to answer them *in pew*.

15 "For I'll put wisdom in your mouth,  
Which all your foes from north and south  
Shall not be able to cast out.

16 "You'll be betrayed and without doubt  
By parents and brothers and kin,  
And friends, and some shall meet the din  
Of execution *by their sin*.

17 "And you shall be hated by all  
For my name's sake *and for my call*.

18 "But no hair of your head shall fall.

Not for the name of Jesus do men hate.  
They hated before he came in the state.  
The hate is born of those loves that incline  
To see one's own soul as unique divine,  
And thus the enemy of every cast  
And every other human come to last.  
Not for the name of Jesus do men cry  
Down retribution from a fading sky.  
Beloved, all men are enemies alone,  
Each one devises his own lasting throne,  
And each applauds the way to do the task,  
Whether the communist or business mask,  
Or late communitarian that throws  
In human rights as if in helpful pose.

19 "In your patience you will possess  
 Your lives *and keep to your address.*  
 20 "And when you see Jerusalem  
 Surrounded by armies in hem,  
 Then know its destruction is near.  
 21 "Then let those in Judaea flee  
 To the mountains, and those who be  
 In the town leave it, let them not  
 Who are in the countryside's plot  
 Go in the town for refuge sought.  
 22 "For these are the days of judgement,  
 That all written there may be sent.  
 23 "But woe to pregnant women then,  
 And nursing mothers in days when  
 There shall be great distress at hand,  
 And wrath upon this folk and land.  
 24 "They'll fall by the mouth of the sword,  
 Led captive to all nations scored,  
 Jerusalem shall be thrust down  
 And trodden by the Gentiles' frown,  
 Until the times of Gentiles end  
*And they remain without a friend.*

My concern's for the pregnant mothers  
 when  
 The pestilences fall on sons of men.  
 When fair Jerusalem saw Titus' crew,  
 Those fled who had taken to heart the view  
 Of Your sent one. Some see the word come  
 true  
 Not only in Jerusalem of old,  
 But also in the coming days of cold.  
 I see the bent around me closing fast,  
 How none will stop to reason in the blast,  
 And how hate unrelenting is still cast  
 Upon those not yet weary doing good,  
 Obeying Your commandments as they  
 should.  
 The time of Gentiles draws near close and I  
 Wait looking toward the grey and lowering  
 sky.

25 "There shall be signs in sun and moon,  
 And in the stars, on earth for boon  
 Of nations in distress to know  
 Why sea and waves are roaring so.  
 26 "Men's hearts fail them for fear, and for  
 Seeing those things come on the shore  
 Of earth, for powers of heaven shall shake.  
 27 "They'll see the son of man in stake  
 Come in a cloud with power and great  
 Glory. 28 And when these things await

No more, but come to pass, look up,  
 And raise your heads, redemption's cup  
 Is drawing near, *and is not late.*

The signs of sun and moon have long since  
 come.  
 The crucifixion shall in ready sum  
 The darkness overreach the land and stay  
 To veil the reaches of that fateful day.  
 The moon has risen red, the stars still fall  
 Upon the atmosphere to burn and all.  
 Beloved, I raise my head and search the  
 heath  
 For my redemption's coming and the  
 wreath  
 Of glory on the crown of that man made  
 The son of David and king on parade.  
 Beloved, I raise my head to hear the call  
 Re-echoing about a world in thrall,  
 Bending the branch of aspen shuddering  
 Before the warning of the coming king.

29 He told a parable to them.  
 See the fig tree in all trees' hem.  
 30 They bud and bloom and so you see  
 And know yourselves that summer's spree  
 Is now near. 31 And so likewise you,  
 When you see these things have come true,  
 Know that God's kingdom's near at hand.  
 32 Truly I tell you that the band  
 Of this same generation's folk  
 Shall not pass till all's done at stroke.  
 33 Though heaven and earth shall pass  
 away,  
 But my words shall not pass away.

I see the bud and bloom of spring appear  
 And know Your kingdom waited has come  
 near  
 To treat me with the scents of youngish  
 year.

I see the new gold of leaf turn to green,  
 I hear the rush of grackle on the scene,  
 And touch the iridescence of the sheen,  
 Fill knowing light in splendour pales before  
 The promises of reawakened shore.  
 The year that I await is not to wane  
 Before autumnal happenings and rain.  
 And yet each time I see the sun grow less  
 Until I look toward winter and I guess  
 Another round of pale earth shall be here  
 Before I learn to warble and to fear.

I mentioned once before the very fact  
 That all the hearers of this word have  
     lacked  
 Existence on this world of smoke and tears  
 For centuries and centuries of years.  
 The word may not have passed away, it's  
     true,  
 Because it's written here and still in view,  
 But the prediction falls flat on its face  
 Before the lengthening of divine grace.  
 Beloved, I had not been born if the sign  
 Had not been once reversed from human  
     line,  
 And so I do not raise Your mercy's trace  
 Against You for false prophecies in race.  
 Let generations go or come for me,  
 I take the world today for what I see.

34 Beware, lest any time your hearts  
 Be overcharged with surfeit's arts,  
 And drunkenness and cares of life,  
 So the day unexpected rife  
 Come on you. 35 For as a snare it  
 Shall come on all of them that fit  
 On the face of the whole world's kit.  
 36 So watch and pray, so you may be  
 Considered worthy then to flee  
 All these things that shall come to pass,  
 And stand before son of man's mass.  
 37 And in the day time he would teach  
 In the temple, and at night reach  
 The mount called Olives to stay there.  
 38 And all the folk came in the share  
 Of morning to him in the place  
 Of the temple to see his face,  
 To hear him say his words of grace.

Avoiding drunkenness is not too much  
 For me here just because I do not touch  
 The alcoholic drinks that come to clutch  
 Society with a grip like the steel.  
 I shatter glass and bottle under heel.  
 But watching here and praying is a thing  
 I do neglect in my gross wandering.  
 The sonnets that I write do not count there  
 Since they are far to cynical for prayer.  
 I've been to tread the temple floor to hear  
 The teaching of Your sent one in his gear,  
 And I have looked to Mount Olives to find  
 The shadow of his night dreams on my  
     mind.

Head clear, I watch and pray for the  
     divined.

## Luke 22

1 The feast of unleavened bread came  
 Near, which is Passover of fame.  
 2 The chief priests and the scribes sought  
     how  
 They might kill him, though they would  
     bow  
 To their fear of the people. 3 Then  
 Satan came in Judas again  
 Named the Iscariot, who was  
 Of the number of the twelve's buzz.  
 4 He went off and put heads together  
 With the chief priests and captains' tether,  
 How he might betray him to them.  
 5 And they were glad and promised *gem*  
*Of* money to lay in his hem.  
 6 He promised and looked for a chance  
 To betray him outside the glance  
 Of the crowd *with a wrong and prance*.

O my Beloved! How does the human face  
 Face ritual and dance beneath Your grace  
 And move and breathe in You from light to  
     light  
 And still slumber in dark of the mind's  
     night!  
 While sweeping out the leaven of the store,  
 They plan to kill another man on shore  
 Of earth's existence, one precarious,  
 Like every human thing this fabulous  
 Creation hosts. The very slightness of  
 Our life should awaken us to its love.  
 Beloved, there is no I but You and I  
 Would see no other in the face and eye  
 Of every human touched with life below.  
 Beloved, put Your divinity on show.

7 The day of unleavened bread came  
 When the Passover should be slain.  
 8 And he sent Peter and John, saying,  
 "Go set the Passover belaying,  
 So we may eat it in acclaim."  
 9 They said to him, "Where do you wish  
 Us to prepare *the spoon and dish?*"  
 10 And he told them, "See, when you go  
 Into the city in a row,  
 A man will meet you carrying  
 A pot of water on his wing,  
 And follow him into the house

Where he goes in *to delve and douse.*"

11 "You'll tell the house owner the lord  
Says to you, 'Where's the chamber scored  
Where I'll eat the Passover meal  
With my disciples *in my keel?*'

12 "And he'll show you an upper room,  
Large and well furnished, without gloom  
Make ready for what we'll consume."

How did Jesus know that the man would  
come

To show the way with a water pot glum?  
This fostering of superstition rises  
From background planning out of his  
surprises.

So he agreed beforehand with the man  
To show the way with water pot by plan.  
Or then, Beloved, You did reveal the thing  
To Your sent one, as though by magic ring  
You could impress his friends to  
faithfulness

By knowing that You know and do not  
guess.

I've seen the unexpected, unexplained,  
But keep my mind pure from the  
unprofaned,

And still reserve my judgement when the  
air

Is filled with miracles and answered prayer.

13 And they went and found as he said  
And readied the Passover spread.

14 And when the time had come, he sat  
With the twelve apostles on mat.

15 And he told them, "With great desire  
I've wished to eat Passover pyre  
With you before I suffer fire.

16 "For I tell you, I'll not eat more  
Of it before the fulfilled store  
Of the kingdom of God require."

17 He took the cup and he gave thanks,  
And said "Take this, divide the shanks  
Among yourselves. 18 "For I tell you,  
I will not drink the vine's fruit true  
Until the kingdom of God come."

19 He took the bread and he gave thanks,  
And broke it and gave them the yanks,  
Saying "This is my body which  
Is given for you in the ditch,  
Do this in remembrance of me."

20 The cup too after dining took  
He saying "This cup is the brook

Of the new testament in my  
Blood which is shed for you nearby.

21 "But see the hand of the one that  
Betrays me is here on the mat.

22 "And truly son of man shall go  
As it was once decided so,  
But woe to that man by whose hand  
He is betrayed to evil band."

There are those who wish to read every  
word

Here as a literal thing and inferred.

They want the bread to be the human flesh  
And the wine to be human blood spilled  
fresh.

The clear impossibility of such  
Remains the sign of faith that such folk  
touch.

Since You can do all things, You do as  
much.

You only hide the meat beneath the treat  
Of bread and grape juice in former form  
sweet,

But in reality the folk become  
True cannibals ingesting life in sum.  
I see there are ways to betray Your word  
And still find literal in the absurd.  
Keep me both humble and with meaning  
stirred.

23 They started to question themselves,  
Which of them who should from their  
shelves

Do this thing as though by command.

24 And there was also argument  
Among them about which was spent  
To be the greatest one to stand.

25 And he told them, "The Gentile kings  
Take rule over them in their things,  
And those who rule are held to be  
Their benefactors in degree.

26 "But you shall not be so: the one  
That's greatest among you when spun,  
Let him be as the younger one,  
And the one that is head as he  
Who is a servant faithfully.

27 "Which one is greater, the one that  
Sits eating or the one unsat  
To serve? Is not the one that eats?  
But I'm among you in my feats  
As one who serves to you your treats.

The lost disciples at the meal protest  
To know which of their number is the best.  
They do not notice prodigies of God  
That turn the bread to human flesh in sod  
Before the flesh is struck with Calvary's  
prod.

If God can turn bread into flesh in days  
After the sacrifice of crossly haze,  
Then surely He can do it before it  
Has been nailed to the tree in trembling fit.  
But if salvation's caught in such a wit  
Of divine doings, there's no need a whit  
For Jesus' death at all upon the cross.  
You create ever new flesh at a toss.

28 "You are the ones who have stood fast  
With me in my trials to last.

29 "And I appoint to you a kingdom,  
As my Father gave me in wingdom.

30 "So you can eat and drink beside  
My table in my kingdom's ride,  
And sit on thrones to judge the twelve  
Tribes among Israel *and delve.*"

Jesus himself is satisfied to be  
Merely a servant while his friends in spe  
Must be kings of kingdoms cast on the lea.  
The quickest way to power is to cast lot  
With Jesus who leads in the divine plot  
Of setting up his own in royal fare.  
It is a wonder and a sightly ware  
I find promised to Jesus' friends in air.  
Beloved, appoint me to the kingly post  
Of my own head and life before the roast  
Of hell fire, and I shall switch on the toast.  
I'll sit with Jesus at the heavenly feast  
If You let me inside the gates increased,  
The open gates of pearl for godly boast.

31 And the lord said "Simon, Simon,  
See, Satan has desired a tonne  
That he may sift you like a bun.  
32 "But I have prayed for you, so that  
Your faith shall not fail where you're at;  
And when you are converted, then  
Strengthen your brethren *among men.*"

33 And he said to him, "Sir, I am  
Ready to go with you in gramme  
Both into prison and to death,  
*To serve you until my last breath.*"

34 And he said "I tell you a thing,  
Peter, the cock shall not take wing

To crow this day before you will  
Deny you know me three times still."

Again Your sent one shows and with a will  
That he knows future events in the bill.  
And yet it is no hard task to infer  
That such a hard night would cause in the  
blur

All the disciples to cast in the cowl  
And join the displaced monks upon the  
prowl.

After denying Jesus for a while  
I come to rake the coffers with a smile.  
That's all there is of priestly efforts left.  
The whole religious world is one bereft.  
Beloved, I trust that Your sent one once  
prayed

For Peter, and yet Peter's hand was stayed.  
Let him pray for me with much greater  
force  
So I may deviate not from the course.

35 And he told them, "When I sent you  
Without a purse and scrip and shoe,  
Did you lack for a thing in view?"  
And they said "Not a thing, *it's true.*"

36 Then he said to them, "But now he  
Who has a purse, let him make free  
To take it, and likewise the scrip,  
And he who has no sword at hip,  
Let him sell his cloak and buy one.

37 "For I tell you that this in pun  
Is written and must come to be  
Accomplished totally in me,  
And he was counted among those  
Who transgressed, for the things in rows  
About me have an end *that rose.*"

38 And they said "Sir, see here two  
swords."

And he told them, "Enough accords."

How many cohorts of imperial train  
Do they intend to meet with two swords  
vain

And what's the use of swords at all when  
they

Are commanded to desist from the fray?  
I know the literal is always meant,  
If meaning can be found in what is sent.  
And still I like to think two swords are  
there

To represent the things come from Your share.

There was no testament then but the old,  
So two of testament's out in the cold.  
Of course we could see rather that the one  
Is sign of Torah while the other done  
Is sign of the Zabur under the sun.  
Both are swords of the word when they've begun.

39 He came out and went as he did  
To mount of Olives where he hid,  
And his disciples followed him.  
40 When he arrived, he said to them,  
"Pray that you enter not trial's hem."  
41 He went away from them about  
A stone throw's distance without doubt  
And knelt down, and prayed, 42 and he said

"Father, if it's Your will as led,  
Remove this cup from me: and yet  
Not as I wish, but as You've set."  
43 And angel came from heaven to be  
A strengthening comfort's degree.  
44 And as he was in agony,  
He prayed all the more earnestly;  
And his sweat was as it were great  
Drops of blood falling *from his pate*  
Down to the ground *both soon and late*.

Both angel coming down to lend a hand  
And sweating drops of blood as by command  
Seem quite miraculous in contraband.  
The miracles that Jesus came to do  
Are all caught up within the cry and hue  
Of his disciples, who are also true.  
It is a miracle that they could sleep  
Out in the fresh air with excitement's heap  
About them all, that they could sleep a peep.

Instead of praying that they not be taken  
By Roman soldiers when they come and waken,  
They slip into a calm and peaceful slumber.  
Their mettle's up to spar and tough as lumber,  
And their faith's holding tight and found unshaken.

45 And when he got up from his prayer  
And had come back to his friends there,

He found them sleeping sorrow's share,  
46 And said to them, "Why do you sleep?  
Get up and pray, lest you should weep  
In your temptation, so beware."  
47 And while he still spoke, see, a crowd,  
And the one called Judas allowed,  
One of the twelve, went before them,  
And came near Jesus at his hem  
To kiss him *by greeting and bowed*.

Despite the knowing of the water pots,  
The showing of the upper room in lots.  
The recognizing of the priests and scribes,  
The screening of their plans and subtle bribes,

Their coming at that moment's a surprise,  
A glance as unexpected from the skies.  
Just when he exhorts them to prayer again,  
It is too late to man the bridge of men.  
Beloved, my days are filled with my due care,  
Foreboding of what I know is my share,  
And yet the simple theft of time and place  
Comes in surprise, an unexpected face.  
The tempest and the calm look on to see  
Uniqueness in each moment of the free.

48 But Jesus said to him, "Judas,  
Why betray son of man with kiss?"  
49 When his followers saw the state,  
They asked him, "Sir, shall we give rate  
With the sword *so we cannot miss*?"  
50 And one of them struck the servant  
Of the high priest and in the rant  
Cut off his right ear *not to hiss*.  
51 And Jesus answered and he said  
"Let it go this far." And he sped  
To touch his ear and healed his head.  
52 Then Jesus said to the chief priests,  
And captains of the temple feasts,  
And elders who had come to him,  
"Have you come out as for a thief,  
With swords and staves to cause some grief?

53 "When I was with you every day  
In the temple, you did not stay  
Extending any hand on me:  
But this is your time in the spree  
Of darkness *without light or ray*."

The healing of the ear's surreal plot  
That should have taken all aback like shot.

Instead they all ignore the miracle  
And focus on the arrest and the pull.  
Why did they not arrest him in the day?  
They feared the people and the people's  
sway.

The swords are bared on every side by  
night  
And flash in the gleam of the torch alight,  
But little meets the flesh, excitement rife  
Is the watchword of human sort of life.  
Beloved, I neither teach upon the floor  
Of lovely red Al-Aqsa by the door.  
I do not find the garden in the dark,  
Nor meet the Roman soldiers in the park.

54 Then they took him, and led and brought  
Him to the high priest's house and plot.

And Peter followed far behind.

55 And when they'd kindled fire in blind  
In the middle of the hall and  
Had sat down together in band,  
Peter sat down among their kind.

56 But a maid saw him as he sat  
Beside the fire, looked closely at  
Him and said "This man's one of those."

57 And he denied him on his toes  
And said "Woman, I don't know him."

After a little while another  
Saw him and said "You are a brother."  
And Peter said "Man, I am not."

59 An hour later in the plot  
Another confidently said  
"Truly this one was also led  
With him, a Galilaean spread."

60 And Peter said "Man, I do not  
Know what you're saying." And  
straightway

While he still spoke, the cock's dismay.

61 And the lord turned and looked down on  
Peter. And Peter then was drawn  
To mind the word of the lord, when  
He had said to him, "Before then  
The cock will crow and you'll deny  
Me three time underneath the sky."

It was no penetrating look divine  
That struck good Peter to the core and line.  
That Jesus knew what Peter in that place  
Would do and say to save his naked face  
Was not a prophecy sent down from You.  
It simply was a very human view.  
The astute human watcher of the ward

Soon learns the thrust and nature of the  
sword.

He knows his man much better than the  
man

Himself can mind or even hope to scan.  
It was a sorrowed sort of thing to say  
To Peter earlier upon that day,  
But better to be warned on both counts of  
The coming storm and any lack of love.

62 And Peter went out and he wept  
Sorely. 63 And so the men who kept  
Jesus mocked him and hit him hard.  
64 They blindfolded him *like a bard*,  
They struck him on the face and asked  
Him, saying "Prophecy as tasked,  
Who was it who struck you now, *pard?*"

65 And many other things blaspheming  
They spoke against him *in their scheming*.

The questioning of searchers for the truth  
Is often no more avid than these youth  
Proposed to Jesus to predict the one  
Who would hit him next on the face or bun.  
Sincerity of search is a thing rare,  
More rare than faith or charity to share,  
More rare than hope of heaven on the stair.  
All men or many have that trinity,  
But laying aside pride of unity  
And stepping out in lone humility  
Is not for the soul timid of its fee.  
Beloved, though I may feel the sting and  
toil,

I follow with an avid sort of spoil,  
Content misapprehension's in the coil.

66 As soon as it was day the elder  
Of the folk and the chief priests held a  
Meeting with the scribes and brought him  
Into their council, saying dim,

67 "Are you the Christ? Tell us out trim."  
And he told them, "If I tell you,  
You will not believe, though it's true.

68 "And if I also ask, you'll not  
Reply nor let me go as sought.

69 "In days to come the son of man  
Shall sit on right of God's power's plan."  
70 They all said "Are you then God's son?  
He told them, "You say so for fun."

71 And they said "What need is there now  
For further witness anyhow  
For we ourselves heard what he said."



The priests themselves know well the  
 pagan king  
 Of Babylon coined the word with the ring,  
 The son of God for the Messiah's sting.  
 But now, like serpent in the park that time,  
 They want to play deceit with word and  
 rhyme.  
 That serpent mixed the cunning and the  
 bare  
 And thus took Madame Eve as unaware.  
 The priests mix son of God, a term that  
 meant  
 The promised one, Messiah, the one sent,  
 And turned it to the literal to be  
 A witness of their fonder trickery  
 To claim he fell into gross blasphemy.  
 Now the church itself echoes demons'  
 touch  
 And teaches that You really are three such.

### Luke 23

1 The whole crowd of them got up then  
 And led him into Pilate's den.  
 2 They started to accuse him, saying  
 "We found this one wicked gainsaying  
 Among the people and forbidding  
 To give tribute to Caesar *kidding*,  
 Saying he is himself the Christ,  
 The King *of Israel complicit*."  
 3 And Pilate asked him saying then,  
 "Are you the King of the Jews' *den*?"  
 And he replied to him and said  
 "You say the thing *as you were led*."  
 4 Then Pilate said to the chief priests  
 And to the people *from the feasts*,  
 "I find no fault in this man spread."  
 5 And they clamoured the more and said  
 "He stirs up the folk teaching all  
 The Jews from Galilee *in thrall*  
 To this place backed *against the wall*."  
 6 When Pilate heard Galilee said,  
 He asked if the man to him led  
 Were Galilean *as by call*.  
 7 As soon as he found out he came  
 Under Herod's *great power and game*,  
 He sent him to Herod who stayed  
 Then in Jerusalem *waylaid*.

The trick of civil servants who are not  
 Always so civil is a common plot.  
 They sent you from one office to another,

Knowing how to disturb a fellow brother.  
 So Pilate sent off Jesus to the court  
 Of Herod to irritate him in sort.  
 As soon as civil servants start their game  
 You know you've lost the battle and the  
 flame.  
 They'll crucify you soon or late and share  
 The flesh and blood to gain a living there.  
 Beloved, if I'd been You, I'd never made  
 A civil servant in this world's parade.  
 I'd have invented some society  
 Without the middle level of the spree.

8 When Herod saw Jesus, then he  
 Was very glad. He wished to see  
 Him for a long time, because he  
 Had heard the rumours *on the spree*,  
 And hoped to get a chance to see  
 A miracle performed *in spe*.  
 9 He asked him many things, but he  
 Replied not a word *in degree*.  
 10 And the chief priests and scribes stood  
 and

Loudly accused him *in a band*.  
 11 And Herod with his soldiers made  
 Fun of him, in gorgeous arrayed,  
 Sent back to Pilate on parade.  
 12 And the same day Pilate got back  
 In the good grace of Herod slack,  
 For before that they were not friends,  
*But now they both had made amends*.

Pilate was the one in the end who had  
 A hankering for truth, but not too bad.  
 Herod preferred the circus track instead,  
 A miracle if you please on the bread.  
 The one's sunk in cynic philosophy,  
 The other in entertainment's degree.  
 And both of them agree that Jesus should  
 Be beaten by the officers of good.  
 Beloved, save me from those who keep the  
 order  
 As well as from those who cast up the  
 mortar.  
 The round of civilized address is made  
 Of contained violence put on parade,  
 To entertain the ruling faction and  
 To keep the rag-assed folk under command.

13 And Pilate, when he summoned all  
 The chief priests, rulers, folk *in thrall*,  
 14 Told them, "You brought this man to me

As one perverting the folk, see,  
I've questioned him before you and  
Found no fault in this man as scanned  
Of those issue that you demand.

15 "No, nor did Herod, for I sent  
You to him, and see, nothing bent  
Worthy of death is done by him.  
16 "So I will beat and release him."  
For he had to release to them  
For the feast one by stratagem.

It's rare the rulers find one brought to them  
For judgement innocent, unless the gem  
Is one of their own. But it can occur,  
As it did with dear Jesus on the fur.  
But what do judge and justice then concur  
About? To beat the innocent to show  
Their clout. A man set on a throne's not  
slow  
To learn the hopes of wielding power's  
flow.

Beloved, what of the guilty in the hand  
Of power if in a green tree such a stand  
Illuminates the courtyard and the band?  
I flee the state for all it stands in awe  
Of law of crook and power, of hook and  
claw,  
And look out for the pretence of the paw.

18 And they shouted at once and said  
"We all want this man to be dead,  
Give us Barabbas now instead."  
19 He caused a riot in the town  
And for murder had been called down.  
20 So Pilate, wanting to release  
Jesus, spoke to them on increase.  
21 But they just shouted all the more,  
"Crucify him, show us the gore!"  
22 And he said to them the third time,  
"Why, what's he done in wicked rhyme?  
I've found no cause of death in him.  
I'll beat him and let him off trim."  
23 They cried aloud on every side  
Demanding he be crucified.  
And their voices and of the chief  
Priests prevailed and without relief.  
24 So Pilate gave the verdict that  
It should be done there as they sat.  
25 And he released for them the one  
Who'd rioted and was undone  
In prison for the murder's stun,  
Whom they desired to save, but he

Delivers Jesus to their spree.

Given the choice to save a rogue or one  
Too innocent of evil to have fun,  
The crowd today as then will take their  
time  
To choose the son of wickedness and  
crime.  
Each day the world is given anew the  
choice  
Between Barabbas and the Christ, and  
voice  
Comes loud and clear for the one that is set  
To keep the status quo of rage unmet.  
Beloved, I too choose in this heart of mine  
The one of two in everything divine:  
The quester of the noble kingdom taught  
In iron and stone or better in the plot  
The one whose eye is single and is taught  
To keep Your law in love and not be  
bought.

26 As they led him away, they laid  
Hold on one Simon who had stayed  
In Cyrenia, as he came in  
From the countryside and for kin  
They set the cross on him to carry  
It after Jesus. *It was scary.*

The innocent and passer-by's the one  
To carry every cross when things are done.  
The rabble shouting for the gore and those  
Who wield the sword fall always on their  
toes.  
The one whose business is the field and  
home,  
The mundane, is the target of new Rome.  
Beware the secular state in whose room  
The Roman adherent stands up for doom,  
The ATF, the FBI, all such  
Are instruments of Vatican that touch  
The skin and bone of innocent in clutch.  
What inquisitions were born on the day  
The Roman cohorts took Jesus in sway!  
The Cyrenians pay and pay and pay.

27 There followed him a crowd of folk  
And women who wailed at the stroke.  
28 But Jesus turning to them said  
"Daughters of Jerusalem spread,  
Weep not for me, but weep for you  
And for your children *in their pew.*

29 "For see, the days are coming too  
In which they'll say 'Blessed are the few  
As barren and the wombs that bear  
Not, and breasts that have nothing there.'

30 "Then they'll begin to tell the hills,  
'Fall down on us,' and to the hills,  
'Hide us from the evil that spills.'

31 "For if they do these things to me,  
A green tree, what thing shall it be  
Done in the dry one by degree?"

With Ruby Bridge and Wacko under belt,  
Titus long dead after the brazen welt,  
The rogue state that pretends to right the  
wrong

Still stands to hear the trumpets and the  
song.

The daughters of Jerusalem may weep,  
But now the whole earth groans beneath the  
sweep

Of Roman army sent abroad to keep  
The peace with guns and tanks. I fain  
would ask

How such are instruments to meet the task.  
Beloved, the hills of Mecca still look down  
Upon the milling crowd where with a  
frown

In days past blood was spilt in name of  
crown.

And every city now becomes in name  
Jerusalem and Mecca for the flame.

32 Two other prisoners were led  
With him to execution's spread.  
And when they had come to the place  
Called Calvary, there *without grace*  
They crucified him and the two  
Evil-doers, one *on the view*  
*Of* the right hand, the other on  
The left. 34 Then Jesus said when drawn,  
"Father, forgive them, for they know  
Not what they do." They were not slow  
To divide up his clothing and  
Cast lots *to give to each a strand*.

35 And the people stood there to see.  
The rulers also with them free  
Derided him, and said that he  
Saved others, let him save himself,  
If he was Christ, *and not an elf*,  
The chosen of God *on the shelf*.

36 The soldiers also mocked him and  
Came offering vinegar in hand,

37 And saying "If you're the Jews' king,  
Then save yourself from the death sting."

38 A sign was put up overhead  
In Greek and Latin and it read  
In Hebrew: This is the Jews' king.

It's not an extremely delightful thing  
To be a king of Jews in fall or spring.  
The fall is great and shattering the ring  
When buds burst forth on Aaron's rod to  
sting.

The sentence is a brief one and I make  
The message out in each tongue that I take.  
The Saviour could not save himself from  
death,

Though he was kingly to the final breath.  
He could not save himself and still walk in  
The path of danger once brought in by sin.  
He had to meet mankind upon the plain  
Where mankind stood, and come as far as  
pain

To relieve pain, as far as death to foil  
The enemy of his unrightful spoil.

39 One of the evil-doers which  
Were hanged reviled him and in pitch  
Said "If you are the Christ, then save  
Yourself and us *to show you're brave*."

40 The other answering rebuked  
Him saying "Are you also spooked  
Not to fear God, though you're condemned  
With the same one that has him hemmed?"

41 "But we in justice for what we've  
Done, but this one deserves reprieve."

42 And he said to Jesus, "Sir, mind  
Me too when you come in *the grind*  
*Of* your kingdom." 43 Jesus told him,  
"Truly I say to you today  
You'll be with me in paradise."

All men are caught up in the two that  
stayed

Beside the torture stake as on parade.  
All men speak to Your sent one to relate  
The recesses of human heart in state.  
Some spew forth bitter curses for the good,  
And pay back insults for the understood.  
But there are those whose hearts are  
touched by grief,

Who strangle hope and cling to new belief.  
Beloved, as I look on the dying rood,

And pace beneath the dungeon of the  
crude,  
Let the curse, though deserved, stay in my  
heart,  
And let instead the loving word impart  
A blessing on the Jesus left alone  
By world and folk and the deriding throne.

44 About the sixth hour it was dim  
All over the earth holding sway  
Until the ninth hour would arise.  
45 The sun was darkened, and the veil  
Of the temple was torn in pale.  
46 When Jesus cried aloud, he said  
"Father into Your hands I spread  
My spirit," and when he said that  
He died *before all those who sat*.  
47 When the centurion saw what  
Happened, he praised God from the gut,  
Saying "Surely this man was good,  
*And lived and died as a man should.*"  
48 All the folk that gathered to see  
The things that happened *by decree*,  
Beat their breasts and returned *sadly*.  
49 All his friends and the women too  
Who followed from Galilee's crew,  
Stood far off watching the to-do.

Too late to save his hands from blood the  
man  
Of Rome saw the divine light in the span  
Of Jesus' face and joined his witness to  
The universe to say the man was true.  
Too late to save his innocence indeed,  
But not too late to save his soul in creed  
Of Jesus' love and witness of the law  
That binds all hearts to You and to Your  
awe.  
Beloved, I have no javelin to shake  
At son of man nor soldier's arm at stake,  
And yet I look upon the dying gleam  
Of patience and see beyond what things  
seem.

I stand afar off with the wifely brood  
And know the choices of the great and  
rude.

50 See, a man named Joseph, and he  
Was a counsellor, good to be  
And just. 51 He had not consented  
To the deed that the others did,  
Of Arimathaea, city

Of the Jews, and who also he  
Waited for the kingdom of God.  
52 This one went to Pilate to prod  
Him to give to him Jesus' bod.  
53 He took it down and wrapped it in  
Linen, and laid it without din  
In a tomb hewn in stone, wherein  
No one had been buried before.  
54 And that day was the preparation,  
And the Sabbath come on in station.  
55 The women too, who came with him  
From Galilee, followed as grim  
And saw the tomb and where was laid  
The body *as though in parade*.  
56 And they returned and they prepared  
Spices and ointments, and repaired  
To rest the Sabbath day according  
To the commandment's word affording.

The hardest Sabbath anyone has kept  
Perhaps was this one when the women  
wept.  
And yet each Sabbath in this world has  
taught  
Some mother's heart somewhere the evil  
plot  
Of sorrow for a dead child in the lot.  
Beloved, I weep and pray for each one here  
That sorrows for a lost child on the sheer  
Wing of this Sabbath day though fraught  
with cheer.  
Beloved, the hours pulse with the failing  
thread  
Of the sweet hopes of flesh and blood now  
dead.  
The mourners turn away, the day declines,  
The aspens whisper to the stricken pines,  
The birches shudder, bend and light the  
way  
Before the firs sink in another day.

### **Luke 24**

1 On the first of the week at dawn  
They came into the tomb as drawn  
With spices which they had prepared  
And certain with them, *those who cared*.  
2 And they found the stone rolled away  
From the sepulchre's *light of day*.  
3 And they came in and did not find  
The body of Lord Jesus kind.

The spices and the linen of that day

So long ago when Jesus came to pray  
Have not changed in the Middle Eastern  
way.

It's only now that some embroider best  
The name of the departed on the breast  
Of the shroud, while some others always  
seek

To write there Ismail only on the cheek.  
But all bring spices to the charmed inquest.  
Beloved, I would bring spices to the tomb  
Of Jesus if I found its place and room.  
If it was empty then, worse is today,  
When three tombs vie with each in what  
they say.

The trinity of resting places teach  
Me not to search a dead Christ in my reach.

4 It happened, as they were perplexed,  
See, two men stood by them unsexed  
In shining clothing *like to blind*.

5 And as they were afraid, and bowed  
Their faces to the earth, aloud  
They said to them, "Why do you seek  
The living where the dead men peek?"

6 "He is not here, he's risen, mind  
How he spoke to you still inclined  
In Galilee, 7 and said 'The son  
Of man must be delivered won  
Into the hands of sinful men,  
Be crucified, third day again  
Rise.'" 8 They remembered then his words,

9 And returned from the tomb in herds  
Told all these things to the eleven,  
And to all the others *by heaven*.

10 And it was Mary Magdalene,  
Joanna, Mary on the scene  
The mother of James and the others  
With them, who told this to the brothers,  
Apostles. 11 And their words to them  
Seemed idle tales, and *to an em*  
They did not believe *in the gem*.

12 Then Peter got up and ran to  
The tomb, and stooping down to view  
The linen clothing laid as due,  
Then left and wondered to himself  
At what had happened *on the shelf*.

Impetuous as Peter was, it seems,  
The women beat him to the tomb of  
dreams.

But let me not despise the women's tale,  
Despite the fact that mankind often fail

To mark the truth of wenches' word and  
sale.

I run to the tomb with a lingered eye,  
Knowing I'll find it empty as the sky,  
Except for linen gathered on the stone,  
And folded neatly to soften the throne.  
Beloved, as I come to the chamber cut  
In the stone of my heart, let it not shut  
Your sent one out, but let him resurrect  
Within the hopeful life that I select,  
Arisen from the failures of my gut.

13 And see, two of them went that day  
To a town called Emmaus way,  
Which was sixty furlongs in sway  
Off of Jerusalem to stay.

14 They talked together of these things  
That happened, all these happenings.  
15 It happened while they talked together,  
Jesus himself came near their tether,  
And went with them. 16 Their eyes were  
closed  
From recognising him supposed.

How many conversations I have had,  
Tuned in on distractions hopeful or sad,  
And never recognized the soul before  
My eyes that opened up my household's  
door!

I speak of the events of yesternoon,  
I reckon at the value of a spoon,  
But fail to see divinity half mast  
Upon the driven brow of the outcast.  
Beloved, still my tongue and still more my  
heart,  
The seething mind creative to a tart,  
And let the calm of recognition fall  
Upon me as I meet the human thrall.  
Where I see now the fleeting form of clay,  
Let me see brightness of diviner day.

17 He said to them "What are these things  
You're talking about with sad rings?"

18 And one of the Cleopas named  
Replied to him and said unblamed,  
"Are you a stranger then in town  
Not knowing what happened *with frown*?"  
19 He asked them, "What things?" And  
they said

To him, "About one Jesus led  
Of Nazareth, who was a great  
Prophet in deed and word of late

Before God and all the folk's rate.  
 20 "And how the chief priests and our  
     rulers  
 Delivered him to Roman schoolers  
 To be condemned to death and they  
 Have crucified him *in their way*.  
 21 "But we thought he might have been he  
 Who should have redeemed Israel free,  
 And besides all this, it has been  
 Now three days since *this work of sin*."  
 22 "And certain women indeed too  
 Of our band astonished our view,  
 As they went early to the tomb,  
 23 "And found no body in the room,  
 They came and said that they had seen  
 A vision of angels as keen  
 To claim that he was now alive.  
 24 "And certain of them in our hive  
 Went to the tomb and found it so,  
 As the women had said below,  
 But they did not see him in show."

The hopeless and the empty have the word  
 Of a Christ crucified among the herd.  
 The faithless and the faint, though fully  
     stirred  
 By messages of worldly peace occurred,  
 Repeat the story of the birth and death  
 Of Jesus with a spiced, sweet-smelling  
     breath.  
 The empty tomb is subject to suffice  
 For pagan rituals to please the nice.  
 Beloved, let me not be deceived by such  
 Tales wondered by the loving in their  
     touch.  
 Reveal instead to me the resurrection  
 Of Your obedience in Your reflection.  
 Then I shall stay no idle tales upon  
 The way to Emmaus before the dawn.

25 Then he said to them, "O fools slow  
 Of heart to believe all that spoke  
 The early prophets to the folk!  
 26 "Should not Christ have to suffer such  
 To enter his glory *and touch*?"  
 27 And starting at Moses and all  
 The prophets, he explained the call  
 In all the Scriptures of himself.

Sweet Jesus said never to call a fool  
 By name, or go into a hellish school.  
 And yet he does the thing himself when he

Finds faithless hearts in grief in wandering  
     spree.  
 Truth is the name of Jesus comes to be  
 In books of Moses in the man that rose  
 To follow Moses in the power's pose.  
 From Joshua to Jesus is a march  
 Too crippled to receive much more in  
     starch.  
 And yet fulfilment is not to be found  
 In prophecy as much as in the ground  
 Of Jesus' desire always to conform  
 To the descriptions of Your faith kept  
     warm.  
 I'm filled with glory of that worthy sound.

28 And they came near the village shelf,  
 Where they were going, and he made  
 As though he would pass by the stayed.  
 29 But they implored him saying "Stay  
 With us, for it is evening's way,  
 The day is far gone." And he went  
 In to stay with them to prevent.  
 30 It happened as he sat to eat  
 With them, he took bread for a treat  
 And blessed and broke and gave to them.  
 31 Their eyes then recognized the gem,  
 And they knew him. And straight away  
 He vanished out of sight *on ray*.  
 32 And they said to each other then,  
 Did not our hearts burn in us then  
 While he talked to us on the way,  
 And opened to us Scriptures' day?"  
 33 And so they got up right away  
 And went back to Jerusalem,  
 And found the eleven in hem  
 Together and those there with them.  
 34 They said "The lord is risen indeed,  
 And has appear to Simon's creed."  
 35 And they told what happened to them  
 Away, how they knew him when he  
 Was breaking the bread faithfully.

The blessing Jesus used to bless the bread  
 Was what was recognizable instead  
 Of features or the hair upon his head.  
 I wonder at that blessed attribute,  
 Since nothing of the kind is found in boot  
 Of Moses' law, that law he takes with care,  
 Assured to accomplish all that is there.  
 He fails to wash his hands with the word  
     said  
 By Pharisee before the meal is spread,

But takes the lack of blessing in the law  
As opportunity to speak with awe  
Your blessed wonders as he lifts the loaf.  
No one can mistake him now for an oaf,  
Because his words of blessing show his  
paw.

36 And as they told it, Jesus stood  
Himself among them safe and good,  
And said to them "Salaam to you,"  
*Islamic sort of greeting due.*

The book of Ruth gives the first greeting  
found  
In Scriptures for the faithful on the ground.  
It is YHWH bless you in the rush and  
round.  
No doubt the Jewish sort of awe to leave  
The name of YHWH unspoken would  
unsleeve  
That ancient greeting and replace with  
peace.  
So peace is prosperous in the release.  
The Muslims learned it from the Christian  
sort  
And from the Jews in their greetings and  
sport.  
Peace is what's needed, yet I linger here  
To take the older word upon the ear  
With a nostalgia born of love and fear.  
Beloved, may a time come when peace is  
sure,  
And we can all return to blessings pure.

37 But they were petrified with fear,  
Thinking that a ghost had come near.  
38 He asked them, "Why are you afraid?  
Why are thoughts in your hearts arrayed?  
39 "See my hands and my feet, it's I,  
Touch me and see. No spirit nigh  
Has flesh or bones, as you see laid  
In me *and in my body made.*"

Did Your sent one, Beloved, believe in  
ghosts?  
He ought to have told his friends out of  
boasts,  
"Pshaw! There no such thing found in this  
town's coasts."  
Instead he affirms superstition's roasts  
By saying flesh and bones reveal the part  
Of human life surrounding risen heart.

Touch me, Beloved, and see that I am here,  
Dressed in Your hope and in Your love and  
fear.

I do not look to spirits in the race,  
To spirituality in any trace,  
But cling fast to the word made flesh in me  
And in each human person that I see,  
A witness, my Beloved, that You remain  
Sustainer of the seen and unseen vein.

40 And when he'd spoken so, he showed  
Them his hands and his feet not slowed.  
41 While they for joy did not believe,  
And wondered, he asked them reprieve,  
"Do you have any food to serve?"  
42 They gave him a piece of broiled fish  
And honeycomb *laid on a dish.*  
43 And he took it and ate while they  
Looked on to see it go its way.

If Jesus had lived in this ray and age,  
He would not have arose in patronage  
Of ichthine diet, knowing with a rage  
That vegans also read the Gospel's page.  
If Jesus had walked cobblestone that's set  
About the town where I live and beget,  
He might have eaten fish indeed, and yet  
The vegetarian's a mortal bet.  
Beloved, I need no evidence in store  
To believe that he is alive and more,  
Although my name is Thomas, I do not  
Expect a piece of fish to seal the plot.  
Instead I am a doubter for my joy,  
Not for the credence that I find in ploy.

44 He said to them, "These are the words  
That I spoke to you in your herds  
While I was still with you, that all  
Things must be fulfilled at the call  
Written in law of Moses, and  
In prophets and Psalms of my stand."  
45 He opened then their minds to know  
So they might understand the glow  
Of Scriptures *and not be so slow.*  
46 He said to them, "So is it written,  
That Christ must suffer as one bitten,  
And rise up from the dead again  
On the third day live among men.  
47 "And that repentance and remission  
Of sins should be preached in commission  
Of his name among nations all,  
Starting at Jerusalem's wall.

48 "And you are witness of these things.  
 49 "And see, I send my Father's word  
 In promise upon your hearts stirred,  
 But stay in Jerusalem's town,  
 Till from on high power come down."  
 50 He led them out to Bethany,  
 And lifted up his hands *sweetly*  
 And blessed them. 51 And it came to pass  
 While he blessed them, as bold as brass  
 He parted from them rising high  
 And carried up into the sky.

I do not find a place where it is said  
 In Tanakh that the Christ must die when  
 bled.  
 The passages that make the fellow blink  
 Are in a different context, different ink.  
 And yet I trust the truth that Jesus spoke:  
 He placed himself beneath the Torah's yoke  
 And showed it to be universally  
 The better page of writing that I see.  
 Beloved, I'm just as bound by joy as he  
 To live according to the marvelled word  
 Of Tanakh instead of the mighty herd.  
 The ways of justice and of prophecy  
 Are one in glory and in poverty,  
 The goal of life and mercy I can see.

### The Gospel according to John

They say this Gospel is a different kind,  
 Although its structure is also consigned  
 In the same mould as Mark's: I am not  
 blind.  
 Though logos and legions of speeches rank  
 Beyond the simple stories in the tank  
 Of the synoptics, still the message true  
 Appears in all four stations where they  
 grew.  
 The son of God appears here as anew,  
 As the life-giver by walking the plank  
 And reaching where humankind sat in rank.  
 If that is heresy not found before,  
 At least it is a hopeful light in store.  
 Beloved, I pray You honour his request  
 That his life be conferred upon the rest.

### John 1

1 In the beginning was the word,  
 And the word was with the God *heard*,  
 The word was an exalted one.

2 It was in the beginning *done*  
 That it was with God, 3 and all things  
 Were made through it, *no questionings*  
*But* without it, nothing was made  
 That was made, 4 and in it was life,  
 And life was men's light *without strife*.

All things have come by Your word only,  
 so  
 I find life and light in the words that go  
 From sacred text and prophecy to make  
 Human hearts ready for Your blessed sake.  
 Beloved, Your word is still exalted on  
 My fervent lips in prayer before the dawn,  
 At noon and in the dusky evening peace.  
 Your words give life and light and never  
 cease.  
 Though my soul seems to stray in time and  
 place,  
 Your word takes me back to Your life and  
 face,  
 Back to beginning where You are in truth,  
 With Your exalted word in joy and ruth.  
 Beloved, may that word so exalted give  
 On tongue and ear as long as I'm to live.

5 And the light on the darkness stayed,  
 And darkness did not comprehend.  
 6 There was a man that God did send,  
 Whose name *was* John. 7 *And* this man  
 came  
 For a witness, to bear *the same*  
 Witness of the light, that all through  
 It might believe. 8 Though *it was true*  
 He was not that light, but to bear  
 Witness of that light *he was there*.  
 9 That was the true light which gives light  
 To every man coming in *sight*  
 In the world. 10 It was in the world,  
 And the world was made *and unfurled*  
 Through it, the world did not know him.  
 11 He came to his own, *who were dim*,  
 His own did not receive him, 12 but  
 Those who did receive him *clear-cut*,  
 To them he gave right to become  
 Children of God, to those *in sum*  
 Who believe in his name, 13 those born,  
 Not of blood, nor of the flesh will,  
 Nor of man's will, but of God's *still*.  
 14 The word became flesh *without scorn*  
 And lived among us, and we saw  
 His glory, the glory *with awe*



As of the only generated  
Of the Father, (*by whom created*)  
Full of grace and truth *unabated*.

A child of God is one who is born of  
Your will, one who does everything for  
love  
Of You, and desires only that Your will  
Be done in all things here for good or ill.  
They err who think God has a son or  
daughter  
Born of the flesh: the word is chosen  
slaughter.

John clearly says it deals with will of God  
And not the flesh and being born of sod.  
Because of such error the Qur'an states  
Not to make mention of such sons and  
mates.

But You, Beloved, sent to the world Your  
word

To live among us, with glory conferred.  
I take him, son or servant called to do  
Your will, and know Your word, Beloved,  
is true.

15 John bore witness of him and cried  
Out, saying, "This was he of whom  
I said, 'He who comes *to abide*  
After me will come in my room,  
For he was before me *and bloom*.'" "

16 And of his fullness we have all  
Received, and grace for grace *to call*.

17 For the law was given through Moses,  
Grace, truth through Jesus Christ, *who*  
*chose us*.

18 No one has seen God any time.  
The only generated son,  
Who's in the Father's bosom *prime*,  
He has declared *him, well and done*.

No man can see You, my Beloved, who are  
Too near to see, and yet behind the star.  
Only Your sent one can reveal to me  
The depth of Your being and wonderfully.  
The divine guide, the divine proof allows  
Your grace and truth to shine on human  
brows

And so appear beside the sheer and dear.  
Who is the express image of You near  
Out of Your very heart declares the room  
And brings my poor reflected soul from  
doom.

The divine guide brings fullness to my soul  
Until I see You only in his role.  
Beloved, I come rejoicing in Your grace  
And find Your image beyond rhyme and  
place.

19 Now this is the witness of John,  
When the Jews sent their priests to faun  
And Levites from Jerusalem  
To ask him, "Who are you?" to them  
20 He confessed, and did not deny,  
But he confessed, "No Christ am I."  
21 And they asked him, "What then? Are  
you

Elijah?" he said, "I am not."  
"Are you the Prophet, *answer do?*"

And he answered no *on the spot*.

22 Then they said to him, "Who are you,  
That we may give an answer to  
Those who sent us? What do you say  
About yourself?" 23 He said, "*Today*  
*I am* 'the voice of one who cries  
In the wilderness "make straight-wise  
The way of YHWH,"' as said prophet  
Isaiah." 24 Now those who were sent  
Were from Pharisees *not to scoff at*.

25 And they asked him, saying, "Content  
Why then do you baptise if you  
Are not the Christ, Elijah *true*,  
Nor the Prophet?" 26 John answered them,  
Saying, "I baptise with *the hem*  
*Of* water, but there stands among  
You one you know not *nor have sung*.

27 "It's he who, coming after me,  
Is preferred before me *to be*,  
Whose sandal strap I'm not worthy  
To loose." 28 In Bethabara these  
Things were done beyond Jordan's *lees*,  
Where John baptised *his devotees*.

The famous four questions the Jewish child  
Must ask at the Passover tempt the wild  
In me to say three questions long ago  
Seem to have lurked behind the Jewish  
show.

Three figures were awaited for awhile:  
The Christ, Elijah, Prophet without guile.  
In all the seven questions make the sum  
Of what the chosen wish to know to come  
And what has happened in the past to meet  
Your divine guidance, divine proof for  
treat.

If only men today of every creed  
Would stop to ask who is the Christ indeed,  
And who Elijah and at last who came  
The final Prophet preaching in Your name.

29 The next day John saw Jesus come  
Toward him, and said, "Behold! The chum,  
The lamb of God who takes away  
The sin of the world *come today!*"

How does or did Your sent one take away  
The sin of the world in his little sway  
In Palestine? Perhaps the word means he  
By sinlessness set men and women free  
From the chains of those priests who say no  
man

Was ever sinless nor obeying can.  
Perhaps the word means he opposed great  
Rome,

And in opposing had to leave his home  
And hearth to meet the Roman execution,  
And without faltering in retribution  
Gained victory over the cross and over  
The oppressor, oppressor's sins and clover.  
He took away the sin of fear and of  
Collaboration with the Caesar's love.

30 "This is the one of whom I said,  
'After me comes a man who's *led*,  
Preferred before me, for he was  
Before me.' 31 "I knew not from straws,  
But that he should be manifest  
To Israel, I came *without rest*  
Baptising with water." 32 And John  
Bore witness, saying, "I saw on  
Him sitting the spirit come down  
From heaven like a dove *for crown*.  
33 "I did not know him, but he who  
Sent me to baptise with *the dew*  
*And* water said to me, 'Upon  
Whom you see the spirit come on,  
And staying on him, this is he  
Who baptises with *saint esprit*.' 34 "And I have seen and testified  
This is the Son of God *and tried*."  
35 Again, the next day, there John stood  
With two of his disciples *good*.  
36 And looking at Jesus as he  
Was walking by, "Behold," said he  
"See God's lamb *in innocency!*"

No grace comes through the water of  
ablution  
As though to wring one's hands is a  
solution.

The spirit of repentance must precede  
The vision of the son of God indeed.  
There is no fleshly son of God but just  
The one baptising by the spirit must  
Be promised Christ through whom eternal  
life

Comes to the world in peace and without  
strife.

The son of God in spirit is a word  
To mean Messiah to the crowd and stirred.  
Your sent one is as innocent as lamb,  
Sent long ago and yet seen where I am  
In visions still of dove and lamb and grace,  
Illuminating every path and trace.

37 The two disciples heard him speak,  
And they followed Jesus *to seek*.

38 Then Jesus turned, and seeing them  
Following, said to them, "What *gem*  
Do you seek?" They told him, "Rabbi"  
(Which is translated, teacher), "*why*,  
Where do you live?" 39 He said to them,  
"Come and see." They followed his hem  
And saw where he was staying, and  
Remained with him that day *to stand*  
(For it was about the tenth hour).

40 One of the two who heard John's *flower*,  
And followed him, was Andrew, *who*  
Was Simon Peter's brother, *too*.

41 He first found his own brother Simon,  
And said to him, "We've found, *rely man*,  
Messiah" (Christ as said in Greek).

42 And he brought him to Jesus *seek*.  
Now when Jesus looked at him, he  
Said, "You are Simon son of Jonah.  
You shall be called Cephas, *no loner*"  
(Which is translated, stone *to be*).

From rolling stones to stone foundations  
where

The keys of hell may not in vain repair,  
Stone is a name in many a tongue for fair  
And foul. I should be more pleased with the  
Simon

As name to follow sema' as a dry man.  
The son of Jonah speaks a mythic tongue  
With reference to doves already sung.

I meet the man to hear Your sweet names  
 rung  
 Upon the Sabbath day to which I've clung.  
 The reappearance of the dove so soon  
 Makes scholars stop to think and eye the  
 moon,  
 Though doves in any case no more than  
 croon.  
 Beloved, I seek Your sent one as the day  
 Inclines toward the last prayer on the way.

43 The next day Jesus wished to go  
 To Galilee, and found *no foe*  
*In* Philip, so he said to him,  
 "Come with me." 44 Now Philip was *trim*  
 From Bethsaida, the city of  
 Andrew and Peter *as above*.  
 45 Philip found Nathanael and  
 Said to him, "We have found *at hand*  
 Him of whom Moses in the law,  
 Also the prophets, wrote *in awe*,  
 Jesus of Nazareth, the son  
 Of Joseph." 46 And Nathanael said  
 To him, "Can anything *or one*  
 Good come out of Nazareth's *dun?*"  
 Philip said to him, "Come and see."  
 47 Jesus saw Nathanael *ahead*  
 Coming toward him, and he said  
 Of him, "Indeed, no deceit see  
 In this Israelite!" 48 Nathanael  
 Said to him, "How do you know *well*  
*What is in me?*" Jesus answered  
 And said to him *the following word*,  
 "Before Philip called you, when you  
 Were under the fig tree, I saw."  
 49 Nathanael answered him and said,  
 "Rabbi, You're Son of God *and led!*  
 You are the King of Israel!"  
 50 Jesus answered him and said, "*Well*,  
 Because I said to you, 'I saw  
 You under the fig tree,' *in awe*  
 Do you believe? You will see greater  
 Things than these *like a simple satyr*."  
 51 And he said to him, "Certainly  
 I say to you, later you'll see  
 The heaven open, and from God  
 The angels ascending *the sod*  
 And descending *as fast they can*  
 And staying on the Son of Man."

The common daily word for the Messiah  
 At that time was Son of God, a pariah.

But Your sent one did not deny the name  
 That called him the Messiah without  
 shame,  
 Except he gently left the word aside  
 That he knew someday would be said in  
 pride  
 And blasphemy to make of him true God.  
 He humbly stooped to take the name of  
 sod,  
 And called himself the son of man, yet so  
 He claimed to be Messiah, Christ, not slow.  
 The witness of John gave clearly that he  
 Was no son of God in the flesh to be,  
 But in the flesh His son or servant of  
 The divine will alone and divine love.

When I was just a child behind the house,  
 The glory of the neighbourhood and mouse,  
 There stood in a row all descending there  
 From greatest to the least in dark leaf rare  
 The seven fig trees grandma used to care  
 And pick preserving for herself and those  
 Grandchildren who loved figs and came  
 and chose  
 The sweet kisses of sugar, white milk and  
 The seedy lusciousness on every hand.  
 I seek in vision now what then I ate  
 With grimy hand and newly washed glass  
 plate.  
 See me, Beloved, beneath the fig tree now  
 As I prepare to seek Your sent somehow,  
 And taste a heavenly repast without hate.

## John 2

1 On the third day there was a wedding  
 In Cana of Galilee *spreading*,  
 And Jesus' mother was there too.  
 2 Both Jesus and disciples too  
 Were invited to the wedding.  
 3 And when they ran out of *one thing*,  
 Grape juice, the mother of Jesus  
 Said to him, "This will cause a fuss,  
 They have no grape juice." 4 Jesus said  
 To her, "Ma'am, that is on your head,  
 My hour has not yet come instead."  
 5 His mother told the servants, "Do  
 Whatever he may say to you."  
 6 Now there were set six water-pots  
 Of stone, according to the plots  
 Whereby the Jews do their ablutions,  
 Containing twenty *in solutions*  
 Or thirty gallons every one.

7 Jesus said to them, "*When you've done,*  
 Fill up the waterpots with water."  
 And they filled them up *like a daughter*  
*Up* to the brim. 8 And he told them,  
 "Draw *some* out now, and take *it* to  
 The master of the feast *to chew.*"  
 And they took *it.* 9 When the feast master  
 Had tasted the water set laster  
 That was made grape juice, and did not  
 Know where it came from, *never taught,*  
 (But the servants who'd drawn the water  
 Knew), the master of the feast *caught her,*  
 Summoned the bridegroom. 10 And he said  
 To him, "Every man at the head  
 Sets out the good grape juice, and when  
 The *guests* have well drunk, only then  
 The worse *grape juice.* But you have kept  
 The good grape juice till now *unswept!*"  
 11 This first of signs that Jesus did  
 In Cana of Galilee, hid  
 Not but made glory manifest  
 In him and his disciples *blessed*  
*So that they* believed in his *rest.*

Old drunks have so taken the world in store  
 That people think Your sent one gave them  
 more

Old wine to pickle up their brains in stew.  
 They point to Cana to feast what they do.  
 Grape juice that is fermented has gone bad,  
 As any child can tell who has learned sad.  
 The master of the feast let it be known  
 That fresh grape juice was what people had  
 shown

First at all weddings, and when all had  
 drunk,  
 They set out what was spoiled if they had  
 spunk.  
 The grape juice Jesus made was not an  
 hour  
 In age, so fermentation had no power.  
 Beloved, I seek Your sherbet fresh and  
 good,  
 Made momentarily anew as sherbet should.

12 After this he, *Jesus,* went down  
 To Capernaum, *to the next town,*  
 He, *and* his mother, brothers *too,*  
 And his disciples, *not a few,*  
 And they did not stay many days.  
 13 Now the Jews' Passover *for stays*  
 Was near, and Jesus went up to

Jerusalem. 14 He found *a crew*  
 In the temple, and those who sold  
 Oxen and sheep and doves, and *cold*  
 Moneychangers doing business.  
 15 When he had made a whip *no less*  
 Of cords, he drove them all out of  
 The temple, with the sheep *above*  
 And oxen, and poured out the changers'  
 Money and overturned the *strangers'*  
 Tables. 16 And he said to those who  
 Sold doves, "Take these things away! Do  
 Not make my Father's house a house  
 Of merchandise *in stall and grouse!*"  
 17 Then his disciples remembered  
 That it was written *such a word,*  
 "Zeal for Your house has consumed me."  
 18 So the Jews answered and said free  
 "What sign do you show us, since you  
 Do these things?" 19 Jesus answered too  
 And said to them, "Destroy this place  
 Of worship, and in three days' pace  
 I'll raise it up." 20 Then the Jews said,  
 "It took forty-six years to spread  
 This temple, and will You raise it  
 Up in three days *and make it fit?*"  
 21 But he spoke of his body's house,  
*And not crannies of roach and mouse.*  
 22 Therefore, when he had risen from  
 The dead, his disciples did come  
 To remember that he'd said this  
 To them, and they believed *in bliss*  
 The Scripture, the word Jesus said  
*About his body and the dead.*

Beloved, it's good You sent Your servant  
 then  
 When money changers were still honest  
 men,  
 Or almost so. If You had sent the guy  
 To churches now beneath a golden sky,  
 He would have found more reason for  
 complaint.  
 Compared with bingo that racket was saint,  
 While bingo itself is passé and childish  
 Compared with machinations that are  
 wildish  
 As preachers mix in politics and draw  
 Oil money for the pulpit and the raw.  
 He'd talk about his corpse now too as well  
 If he presumed to take on that cartel.  
 Beloved, I strike down all establishment  
 By taking only You for government.

23 When he was in Jerusalem  
 At the Passover *requiem*,  
 During the feast, many believed  
 In his name when they saw *received*  
 The signs which he did. 24 But Jesus  
 Did not trust himself to their *fuss*,  
 Because he knew all *men*, 25 and had  
 No need to be told they were bad,  
 For he knew what was in man's *fad*.

How many times did Christ refuse the  
 crown  
 And pass through all the crowds to leave  
 the town?  
 Twice Hajji Bektash also set aside  
 The opportunities of kingly pride.  
 There is integrity in no great task  
 That rulership may ever come to ask.  
 Was Joseph uncorrupted in that hell  
 Of famine? What's to say of Daniel?  
 Perhaps, but one exception makes the rule.  
 Who trusts ruler or commoner's a fool.  
 The ice cream man comes ringing out his  
 bell,  
 Not to please with his music, but in spell  
 That some will buy at higher price his  
 wares,  
 Not altruistic sharing of his shares.

### John 3

1 There was a man of Pharisees  
 Named Nicodemus, *if you please*,  
 A ruler of the Jews. 2 This man  
 Came to Jesus by night to *scan*  
 And said to him, "Rabbi, we know  
 That You're a teacher from God, so  
 No one can do these signs that You  
 Do unless God is with him *true*."  
 3 Jesus answered and said to him,  
 "Most surely I say *nothing dim*  
 To you, unless one's born again,  
 He cannot see God's kingdom then."  
 4 And Nicodemus said to him,  
 "How can a man be born when old?  
 Can he enter a second time  
 Into his mother's womb so bold  
 And be born?" 5 Jesus answered, "I'm  
 Telling you truly, unless one  
 Is born of water and the spirit,  
 He can't enter God's kingdom near it.  
 6 "That which is born of the flesh is

Flesh, and that which is born of His  
 Spirit is spirit. 7 "Do not marvel  
 That I tell you 'You must be larval.'  
 8 "The wind blows where it wishes, and  
 You hear the sound of it *at hand*,  
 But cannot tell where it comes from  
 And where it goes *when it has come*.  
 So is everyone who is born  
 Of the Spirit *and not forlorn*."

As John notes Jesus is the Son of God  
 Because he is not every way a clod,  
 But sanctifies his spirit by the way  
 He turns himself to You and to obey,  
 And thus makes Your Spirit his own to  
 sway  
 Instead of drinking at the pub each day.  
 Though Son of God is just a shoptalk term  
 To mean Messiah Christ, while they shall  
 squirm  
 In judgement who would make it tell a tale  
 Of heathen trinities not to avail,  
 The road is open for the spirit free  
 To step into divine life and freely.  
 Beloved, I bend my spirit to Your own  
 And so become Your child, though flesh  
 and bone.

9 And Nicodemus answering him,  
 "How can these things be *true and trim*?"  
 10 Jesus answered and said to him,  
 "Are you teacher of Israel,  
 And yet do not know these things *well*?"  
 11 "Most certainly, I say to you,  
 We speak what we know and we do  
 Give witness of what we have seen,  
 And you do not receive our *mesne*.  
 12 "If I have told you earthly things  
 And you do not believe, when sings  
 The heavenly how will you believe?  
 13 "No one has ascended *the sleeve*  
*Of* heaven but he who came down from  
 Heaven, *that is*, the Son of Man  
 Who is in heaven. 14 "And as *the thumb*  
*Of* Moses lifted up *as can*  
 The serpent in the wilderness,  
 Even so must the Son of Man  
 Be lifted up *and for redress*,  
 15 "That whoever believes in him  
 Should not perish *and become dim*  
 But have eternal life. 16 "For God  
 So loved the world *and the world's sod*,

He gave his only generated  
 Son, that whoever unbelated  
 Believes in him should not perish  
 But have eternal life's *fair wish*.  
 17 "For God did not send his Son to  
 The world to condemn the world's *crew*,  
 But that the world through him might be  
 Saved. 18 "He who believes in him, *see*,  
 Is not condemned, but he who does  
 Not believe is condemned as was,  
 Because he has not believed in  
 The name of the only *God's kin*  
*The generated Son of God,*  
*Which means Messiah, Christ slipshod.*  
 19 "And this is the condemnation,  
 That the light's come into the world,  
 And men loved darkness *by the tonne*  
 Rather than light, because *unfurled*  
 Their deeds were evil *ones and done*.  
 20 "For all who practice evil hate  
 The light and don't come to the *gate*  
*Of light*, lest their deeds should be known.  
 21 "But he who does the truth comes to  
 The light, that his deeds may accrue  
 Sight, that they've been done by God's  
*throne.*"

Please note, Beloved, John does not talk  
 About a cross at all to all the flock.  
 As Moses held the brazen serpent high  
 For all to see and thus express their cry  
 To You alone for help in their distress,  
 So those who turned, instead of for redress  
 For what they suffered at the Romans'  
 hands,  
 To the one You sent to uphold commands  
 And be image express that You are king  
 Of every mite and each created thing,  
 Should also live. I too, Beloved, would live  
 Within the glory that Your sent ones give.  
 I turn away from means and powers to look  
 Upon the brazen and the slender hook.

22 After these things Jesus and his  
 Disciples came into, *that is*,  
 The land of Judaea, and there  
 He stayed with them and baptised there.  
 23 John also baptised in Aenon  
 Near Salim, because there *forgone*  
 Was much water there. And they came  
 And were baptised *there in his name*.  
 24 For John had not yet been thrown in

To prison. 25 Then there rose within  
 John's disciples and the Jews there  
 A dispute on ablutions' care.  
 26 And they came to John and told him,  
 "Rabbi, he who was at the rim  
 Of Jordan with you, to whom you  
 Have testified, *giving his due*,  
 Indeed, he is baptizing too,  
 And all are coming to his *crew*!"  
 27 John answered and said then, "A man  
 Can receive nothing, *if he can*,  
 Unless it has been given him  
 From heaven. 28 "You yourselves *grow*  
*dim*,  
 Bear me witness, that I said, 'I  
 Am not the Christ,' but rather, 'I  
 Have been sent before him.' 29 "And he  
 Who has the bride is the bridegroom,  
 The bridegroom's friend's content to be  
 Standing and hearing him *in room*,  
 Rejoices greatly because of  
 The bridegroom's voice *that's raised in*  
*love*.

Therefore this joy of mine's fulfilled.  
 30 "He must increase, but I be stilled.  
 31 "He who comes from above's above  
 All, and he who's of the earth is  
 Earthly and speaks of what is his.  
 He who comes *down* from heaven *above*  
 Is above all *in power and love*.  
 32 "And what he has seen and has heard,  
 That he bears witness to in word,  
 And no one receives his witness.  
 33 "He who has received consciousness  
 Of his testimony has best  
 Assured that God is true *and blessed*.  
 34 "For he whom God has sent speaks  
 words  
 Of God, for God gives not the *birds*  
*Of the Spirit* by measure. 35 "But  
 The Father loves the Son, and cut  
 All things into his hand. 36 "He who  
 Believes in the Son has life too  
 Eternal, and he who does not  
 Believe the Son, *though he's been taught*,  
 Shall not see life, but the wrath of  
 God stays on him *instead of love.*"

In every age there is appointed one  
 To be divine proof, if You like, God's Son,  
 Recipient of divine grace and power  
 To reign over true hearts if for an hour.

In every age there are those who seek out  
Gurus to their dissension and its doubt.  
The Sufi turns to sheikh, the wife to pope,  
And thus all humankind relinquish hope.  
I turn to You, Beloved, through face of him  
Whom You have sent, even when face is  
dim.

The Master of the Age is never spent,  
But hovers in the visions of the rent  
And torn veils that rise in the baking noon.  
Beloved, I turn to You, and I turn soon.

#### John 4

1 When the lord knew the Pharisees  
Had heard that Jesus made with ease  
And baptised more disciples than  
John himself did and by his plan,  
2 Though Jesus himself did not come  
To baptise, but disciples *drum*,  
3 He left Judaea then to come  
To Galilee again *to hum*.

Baptising may go back to prophet's word  
When Elisha spoke to Naaman who heard  
And dipped himself in Jordan's anger  
stirred

The seven times with or without a bird.  
The people do demand a sign today  
As well as in that ancient time of play:  
The entrance into the group's mystery  
Was Gentile expectation and degree  
Of Jewish hopes: all longed to be made  
free.

But Jesus baptised none. Only those he  
Sent out to preach and teach and heal did  
that.

They baptised many more than John was at.  
Beloved, I see baptisms every day  
As I die beneath the breath of my way.

4 But he had to go through the land  
Of the Samaritans in band.  
5 Then he came to Samaritan town  
Called Sychar near to the renown  
Piece of ground that Jacob once gave  
To his son Joseph *tall and brave*.  
6 Now Jacob's well was there to see,  
And Jesus wearied from journey,  
Sat on the well, and it was then  
About the sixth hour, *noon again*.  
7 There came a woman of the clan  
Of Samaritans with the plan

Of drawing water. Jesus said  
To her, "Give me a drink instead."  
8 For his disciples had gone in  
The town to buy food *in the tin*.  
9 Then the Samaritan wench said  
To him, "How can a Jew be led,  
One like yourself, to ask a drink  
Of me who am a wench to link  
Samaria? For the Jews lack  
Dealings with Samaritan *track*."  
10 Jesus answered and said to her,  
"If you knew the gift of God's stir,  
And who it is that asks of you,  
'Give me a drink,' you'd ask him too  
And he'd give you the living brew."

11 The woman said to him, "Sir, you  
Have nothing to draw with in view,  
And the well's deep, from where can you  
Provide that living water too?  
12 "Are you greater than our ancestor  
Jacob, who gave us the well bester,  
And drank of it himself and all  
His children too, cattle in stall?"  
13 Jesus answered and said to her,  
Whoever drinks this water sure  
Will thirst again. 14 "But the one who  
Drinks of the water I shall give  
Shall never thirst though long to live,  
But water that I give shall be  
In him a well of water free  
Springing life to eternity."

Jesus forgot his thirst when he had chance  
To preach the living water of his grants.  
The woman too in her surprise was stung,  
And wondered that a Jew to her had sung.  
So both in their encounter meet surprise.  
Beloved, each human meeting in its guise  
Is a potential wonder in its way,  
Despite the every-day actions we play.  
I see the passers-by and hear the talk,  
They do not see me standing by the lock,  
Nor do they give a glance to me, yet I  
Still recognize the divine going by,  
The message in its echoes now again  
Of divine faces shining among men.

15 The woman said to him, "Sir, give  
Me this water, so I shall live  
Without thirst and not come back here  
To fetch water *with all my gear*."  
16 Jesus said to her, "Go and call

Your husband and come on the ball.”  
 17 The woman answered saying “I  
 Have no husband.” Jesus’ reply  
 To her was “You’ve said well indeed,  
 I have no husband. 18 “In your greed  
 You’ve had five husbands, and he whom  
 You now have is not yours in room.  
 In that you’ve told the truth for doom.”  
 19 The woman said to him, “Sir, I  
 See that you are a prophet nigh.  
 20 “Our ancestors worshipped here on  
 This mountain, and you say it’s drawn  
 To worship in Jerusalem.”

The brazen hussy does not bat an eye,  
 But meets the accusation with a why.  
 That is the typical way everyone,  
 Both saint and sinner finds the way is done.  
 We meet our differences with questioning,  
 With arguments for who is right and king  
 And who is wrong in his belief and ring.  
 The outer court, the temple mount, the  
     spring  
 Of tasks and functions in distraction sing.  
 Beloved, I ask no explanations due  
 Now that I meet You face to face and true.  
 I ask not which or what in exercise  
 Will lead the faster to pie in the skies.  
 I turn from Gerizim and Zion’s tries.

21 Jesus said to her, “Woman gem,  
 Believe me, the time comes when you  
 Shall neither in this mountain due  
 Nor yet at Jerusalem fall  
 To worship the Father *at call*.  
 22 “You worship what you do not know,  
 We know what we worship in stow,  
 For salvation is of the Jews.  
 23 “But the time comes and is to choose  
 When true worshippers shall worship  
 The Father in spirit and sip  
 The truth, for the Father seeks such  
 To worship Him and *pray as much*.  
 24 “God is spirit and those who stay  
 To worship Him must come to pray  
 In spirit and in truth *each day*. ”

Some worship still in old Jerusalem,  
 And some bow toward the heights of  
     Gerizim,  
 While those who hold themselves to be the  
     best

Bow to the god within the human breast.  
 The one You sent, Beloved, has prophesied  
 That on a day when these are set aside,  
 True worshippers will worship You in truth  
 Toward the first house now a desert booth.  
 While humankind cannot agree on where  
 The right direction is for human prayer,  
 You silently regard without a word  
 The conflicts by which human hearts are  
     stirred.  
 Shekinah does not bloom in any place  
 Now known to all the hurried populace.

Those blinded by the Grecian words that  
     tell  
 All how reality is just the spell  
 Of matter and of spirit out to quell  
 The questionings of minds who must think  
     well,  
 Assume that You are Spirit in the way,  
 Un-matter and un-making of the ray.  
 If You’re a being immaterial  
 (Contradiction of terms writ on the wall),  
 Then I ask for the evidence that there  
 Exists any being out of thin air  
 That is unmattered in the cosmic dust,  
 Displayed against the stars and without  
     rust.  
 Until proof that such can exist and be,  
 I reject atheistic Trinity.

Challenged to prove that Spirit is a thing  
 Material beneath the dovelly wing,  
 I do not rise up to the bait and fling.  
 If Spirit is a word that still refers  
 To anything with meaning among curs,  
 Then Spirit is material. If not,  
 Spirit is nothing at all in the plot.  
 The abstract itself is attached to matter  
 As character describing thin and fatter.  
 Beloved, though You’re a Spirit on the  
     mend,  
 A fatter sort of being where You wend,  
 I love You still despite glory You send.  
 The Spirit’s real only beneath the kiss  
 Of breath of life, it’s something not to miss.  
 Beloved, You’re no imaginary hiss.

25 The woman said to him, “I know  
 That the Messiah’s on the go,  
 Who is called Christ. When he has come,  
 He’ll tell us all there is in sum.”



26 Jesus said to her, "I who speak  
 To you am the one that you seek."  
 27 At this his disciples came back  
 And were surprised to see the slack,  
 Him talking with the woman there,  
 But no one had to say or dare,  
 "What are you looking for or why  
 Do you talk with her on the sly?"  
 28 The woman left her waterpot,  
 Went back into the city lot,  
 And said to the men, 29 "Come and see  
 A man who told me faithfully  
 All things I ever did. Is not  
 This the very Christ *we have sought?*"

The preachers and the teachers often come  
 And interrupt the truth right when the sum  
 Is in its glory and requires the test  
 Of choice and taking a stand with the best.  
 So with the coming of disciples bound  
 In finding bread, the woman without sound  
 Slips off forgetting her pot on the round.  
 That might have been the end of all, but she  
 Kept burning in her heart the word's decree.  
 Beloved, as I'm distracted by the way,  
 And leave the well and enter in the sway  
 Of town and street, let there be burning still  
 The words I hear from Christ upon the hill,  
 In silent springs beneath the trees the fill.

30 So they went out of the town and  
 Came where he was and in a band.  
 31 The meanwhile his disciples prayed  
 Him saying "Sir, eat the spread laid."  
 32 But he said to them, "I've had food  
 To eat that you do not know stewed."  
 33 "Therefore the disciples said to  
 Each other, "Did someone or crew  
 Bring him something to eat a few?"  
 34 Jesus told them, "My food's to do  
 The will of Him who sent me, and  
 To finish the work *I've at hand.*"

The food appears upon my plate and table  
 However many times each day I'm able  
 Out of sheer hunger find my eager way,  
 Making a meal of everything I slay.  
 As soon as hunger's suaged, I turn to see  
 Sweets to finish the repast faithfully.  
 My stomach is full fledged, and so still I  
 Come searching food before the hopeful  
 spy.

Enough of doing Your will, I shall not  
 Leave before Your heavenly kingdom is  
 taught.

When I have done the chart You give to  
 me,  
 And find the rest of Your salvation's fee,  
 I'll rejoice in the supper of the Lamb,  
 Never to hunger more, and so I am.

35 Do you not say that four months still  
 Remain before the harvest hill?  
 See, I tell you to lift your eyes  
 And look at the fields in their guise,  
 For they are white to harvest prize.

36 The one who reaps gets wages and  
 Gathers fruit to life endless and  
 Both the one who sows and the one  
 Who reaps rejoice together done.

37 And so that saying has come true,  
 One sows, another reaps the due.

38 I sent you out to reap what you  
 Had spent no labour on in crew,  
 For other men worked and you came  
 Into their labours and their claim.

I've stayed a child who once was told that  
 You

Desire me to enter Your harvest crew.  
 And yet I never found the way to go,  
 No task in service to Your own sweet  
 show.

I thought that life was short and all things  
 past.

And yet I know that as long as life lasts,  
 There may be something You have for my  
 hand,

Though I still wait like blind Milton and  
 stand.

Beloved, the harvest may be white indeed,  
 For centuries have past since that small  
 seed

Was planted in Sychar for Jesus' greed.  
 It may be white while generations pass,  
 And shall be white until the sea of glass  
 Appear before my feet, sickle in need.

39 Many of the Samaritans  
 Of that town believed on his scans  
 For the word of the woman who  
 Testified, "He told me all true."

40 So when the Samaritans came  
 To him, they begged him to lay claim

And stay with them, and he stayed there  
For two days teaching them their share.  
41 And many more believed who heard  
His own word when their hearts were  
    stirred.

42 And he said to the woman, "Now  
We do believe, not anyhow  
For what you said, but we have heard  
Ourselves and know this is the word  
Of the Christ, Saviour of the world."

Samaritans discovered in the man,  
The browned feet and the face marked by  
    the tan,  
The Saviour of the world, though few  
    before  
Could see such hope upon the Jordan's  
    shore.  
I'm not sure yet from what he saved the  
    world  
Where Roman oppression is still unfurled,  
And lust and greed and cruelty run riot.  
But any salvation's great and I'll buy it.  
Beloved, believing is a thing I see  
Around me everywhere the symmetry  
Of church and synagogue set people free.  
I only wait for more obedience  
To Your commandments. That would make  
    some sense  
While whirling in these strangers' hopeless  
    tents.

43 Now after two days were uncurled,  
He left that place and went into  
The land of Galilee in view.  
44 For Jesus himself testified,  
That a prophet is aye denied  
Honour in his own land to bide.  
45 Then when he came to Galilee,  
The Galilaeans faithfully  
Received him, having seen all things  
That he did in celebrations  
Back at Jerusalem, for they  
Also went to the feast *to pray*.

This is one time that Jesus got it wrong,  
When he said that the nature of the song  
Is to deny the good who would arise  
Upon the native soil in righteous guise.  
It seems despite his expectations he  
Was at once accepted by neighbourly.  
My own experience is rather that

I am rejected on the home plate's mat  
As well as by the strangers where I stay  
In weary decades where I came to stray.  
Beloved, I find in Your great heart the  
    room

That others would deny me to my doom,  
And there rest as the days and nights go  
    round  
Upon the sweet and warm or barren  
    ground.

46 So Jesus came again to Cana  
Of Galilee, where he was gainer  
To make the water wine. And there  
Was a certain nobleman there  
With son ill in Capernaum.  
47 When he heard that Jesus had come  
From Judaea to Galilee,  
He went to him and begged freely  
That he would come and heal his son,  
For he was at death's door and gun.  
48 Then Jesus told him, "Unless you  
See signs and wonders in your view,  
You will not believe what is true.  
49 The nobleman said to him, "Sir,  
Come before the child's death occur."  
50 Jesus said to him, "Go your way,  
Your son will live now from today."  
And the man had faith in the word  
That Jesus had spoken he heard,  
And so he went off on his way.  
51 And as he was now going down,  
His servants met him *near the town*,  
And said "Your son's well" *without frown*.  
52 Then he asked them what time it came  
The crisis past, the boy was game.  
And they said to him, "Yesterday  
At seventh hour the fever's sway  
Left him *and so until today*.  
53 So the dad knew it was the same  
Time when Jesus told him in claim,  
"Your son will live." And he believed  
And his whole family received.  
54 This was again the second sign  
Jesus did coming out in line  
From Judaea to Galilee  
For all the people there to see.

Your sent one was not living with the Jews  
As one apart, one that they failed to choose.  
That animosity is left to come  
In days of future conflict for a sum.

The leaders are always a thing apart.  
And yet here is a nobleman to start  
In love and hope to him. He's not alone.  
It is a pity that some gave him throne  
Of Your divinity and so made those  
Who came after pariah in his throws.  
Beloved, I turn for healing to Your own,  
And find him safe and sacred to the bone,  
Without a claim blasphemous or a stay  
In heresy, though truth and life and way.

### John 5

1 After this then a Jewish feast  
Came, and Jesus went up released  
To where Jerusalem increased.

The second Passover of Christ it seems  
Is mentioned here before the land of  
dreams.

I wait with sated breath in my delight,  
Filled with the joys of beauty in my sight,  
That many all around fail to see there,  
The beauties masked and veiled by human  
care.

I wait beside the pool, not for the share  
Of miracles by angels I can bear,  
But in the vigorous ecstasy where  
The ordinary water looks as bright  
With hope and beauty as the crystal light  
Of heavenly seas. Beloved, pass over me,  
Your beauties are too grand for me to see.  
I wait with covered head without a right.

2 Now there is at Jerusalem  
By the sheep *market* a pool's gem,  
Which is called in the Hebrew tongue  
Bethesda, with five porches rung.

3 In these lay a great multitude  
Of invalids: of blind and lame,  
Of withered waiting for the game  
Of the water to move in claim.

4 For an angel went and came down  
At a certain time to the town,  
To the pool and stirred up the water,  
And whoever was first alotted  
To step in after that, was made  
Well of whatever illness stayed.

I do not know if men in ancient days  
Were right or wrong in waiting for the  
ways  
Of angel steps to move the waters' maze.

The superstitions of the weak retain  
A hope on every mind and every stain.  
And yet the faith of the small and the weak  
Sometimes is honoured by the mountain  
peek.

I do not know, and further do not care.  
I rather set my eyes upon the share  
Of the one who alone has right to rule  
Within the jurisdiction of the pool.  
Beloved, fetch me or not to the pool's edge  
To grasp Your healing or to feel the ledge  
Filled with the fertile muck and flowering  
sedge.

5 A certain man was there, which had  
An illness for thirty-eight bad  
Years. 6 When Jesus saw him lie, and  
Knew that he had been now in band  
Such a long time, he said to him,  
"Will you be made both well and trim?"  
7 The ill man answered him, "Sir, I  
Have no one when the waters try  
To put me in the pool, but when  
I'm coming another again  
Steps down before me on the fly.  
8 Jesus said to him, "Get up then,  
Take your bed and walk, *at least try.*"

In human time the years number to thirty  
And eight are beyond comprehension's  
flirty.

And yet I trow I know as many here,  
As many as forty and fifty's gear.  
So pity me too on the pretty brink  
Of lake where I stay living and not shrink  
Back from obedience to word and voice  
From You or Your sent one to make  
rejoice.

Beloved, I try the sky on for a fit,  
And earth turns into the form where I sit,  
And yet my task of waiting for the day,  
Whether a Sabbath or in working's way  
Must pivot at the base and in surprise  
Sharpen my hopes against the fatal skies.

9 And straight away the man was well,  
And picked up his bed walking swell,  
And that same day was Sabbath day.

10 The Jews therefore said to the man  
Who was cured, "It's the Sabbath day,  
And it's unlawful in that way  
To carry a bed *as in plan.*"

11 He answered them, "The one who cured Me, the same man told me assured, 'Pick up your bed and walk away.'" 12 Then they asked him, "What man was that Who told you to pick up your mat And walk away?" 13 And the one healed Did not know who it was appealed, For Jesus had just disappeared Among the crowds that milled and steered. 14 Afterward Jesus came to find Him in the temple, and combined To say to him, "See you are well, But sin no more, lest it compel A worse thing on you *and confined*."

Each Sabbath day where I wait with the two Or three in the name of Your sent one's view, I find he comes again with word and touch, Commanding me to rise, take bed and crutch And leap forth in the judgement day and thrall Of glory that awakens at Your call. The priests do not surround me with the bill For desecrating Sabbath on the hill. They've left both burden of the law and that Rejoicing that the Sabbath day on mat Must bring to all who hear the Saviour's word. The two or three remaining with hearts stirred Bear off their bedding in glory and shroud To praise Your name silently or aloud.

15 The man left and told the Jews that It was Jesus who'd cured him *flat*. 16 That's why the Jews troubled Jesus And sought to kill him, for the fuss Since he did these things in the way Of the *sacred and* Sabbath day. 17 But Jesus answered them, "My Father Works until now, I too, *no bother*." 18 That's why the Jews tried more to kill him, Because he not only to fill him Had broken the Sabbath, but said God was his father and so led Him to make himself equal to God Himself and not faithful crew.

I beg to question where the son of man Made himself equal to his God in span, And in his word of grace where did he fail To honour Sabbath day for whole and hale. The judgements that the priests of every ilk Make are plagued by the greed for gold and silk.

Those who make Jesus God today and yet Pretend him to be God Almighty set No precedent, but follow in the train And word of those false men upon the plain Street of Jerusalem, who would not find The life eternal in commandments lined, But only savour of death to each one Who sits hopelessly by the troubled dun.

19 Then Jesus answered and told them, "Truly indeed I say a gem To you, the son can do nothing Of himself, but what he sees that The Father does, for where he's at, What He does the son does out flat. 20 "For the Father loves the son and Shows him all things He does to stand, And He will show him greater works Than these, so that all of you jerks Can marvel *for your hopes and quirks*.

Beloved, I see You only in the words That You spoke before Sinai to the herds, And in the flesh and blood of the one sent Embodying the message that You meant. And so I too, like Jesus did of old, Do only what I see and what I'm told To find that life indeed is in the tale, And in the word and flesh and to prevail. Beloved, I grasp the love that You sent down

In Jesus for a witness and a crown, And make that love my own and of renown.

If greater works than these I see in play Beneath the sun upon the hill in ray Exist, I submit to their gloried day.

21 "As the Father raises the dead, And quickens them, so the son led Will quicken whom he will *and sped*.

For the most part I do not ask of You, Beloved, to let me raise the dead in view.

And yet when I think of the matter more,  
 It is truly something I might implore.  
 Raise up the dead, Beloved, and if not here  
 And now, at least upon the day appear  
 Before the resurrection with the gear  
 Of every life to show one last great fear.  
 And yet, Beloved, besides the last day's  
     right,  
 Is there no possibility in sight  
 To raise the child that's lost upon the plain  
 Of Africa for lack of dust and rain?  
 The crib filled here nearby with new  
     despair  
 To find the emptiness of earthen air?

22 "For the Father judges no man,  
 But gives judgement in the son's plan.

When I was a young man in clutch and stay  
 Of theological course and the sway  
 Of my professors on that far off day,  
 I was once blighted that I said Your son  
 Came to the earth a ready man and one  
 To judge both man and womankind to see  
 What they could do or not in some degree.  
 You judge no man, I see, but You have sent  
 One to live through the things that we have  
     bent,  
 One capable of judgement and in sight  
 Beneath Your law of hope and fervent  
     right.  
 Beloved, judge me not for the things I've  
     done,  
 Nor for the thoughts and motives that have  
     won  
 My heart and hand, but by my faith, by  
     gun.

23 "So all should honour the son just  
 As they honour the Father's *crust*.  
 The one who does the son no honour  
 Does not honour the Father *goner*.  
 24 "Truly indeed, I say to you,  
 The one to hear my word is true,  
 And has faith in the One who sent  
 Me has eternal life and will  
 Not be condemned *upon the hill*,  
 But has passed from death into life.

To honour the son just like honouring God  
 Does not mean to treat like two peas in  
     pod.

It is no honour to the son to make  
 Him out to be Almighty God in wake.  
 Just as a man should honour God above,  
 So should he honour one sent in His love.  
 I honour God as God, and son as son,  
 And having done so, all the battle's won.  
 Beloved, if I do wrong to honour both  
 You and the man you sent in words that  
     quoth  
 In flesh and blood commandments not in  
     vain,  
 I take the consequences of wrong train.  
 But if not, cast a loving curse on those  
 Who deny the truth of the thing I chose.

Again I say to honour the son as  
 God when he is not God is simple jazz.  
 He must be honoured just as You, Beloved,  
 Must be honoured, but each one as he's  
     glowed.  
 To honour You as the son and a man  
 Would be blasphemous as anyone can.  
 In the same way to join the son to You  
 As God the Son is blasphemous in view.  
 Beloved, may I honour You and Jesus  
 Each in the way I should and without fuss.  
 I pray that my worship of You might be  
 Acceptable without a Trinity,  
 And that my honour of Jesus might show  
 Obedience to You as I should go.

25 "Truly indeed, I say to you,  
 The time is coming and is due,  
 When the dead shall hear the loud voice  
 Of God's son and live to rejoice.

26 "For as the Father has life in  
 Himself, so He gave from that bin  
 To the son to have life within.

John brings the welcome message that the  
     life  
 You give is not merely for this world's  
     strife,  
 But is one taught in resurrection's beam,  
 A brighter one than any that now seem.  
 Whether I am among the dead in dust,  
 Or among those alive, Beloved, I trust  
 In Your sent one, that what he promised  
     then  
 Will come to me among the choicest men.  
 He said that the last shall be first that day,  
 And surely none are more last in their pay

Than I, except the crowds caught in death's  
sway  
By poverty and hunger on the way.  
Among the privileged I am the last,  
Let resurrection then not be outcast.

Beloved, You only have life of Your own,  
Within Yourself, not caught on flesh and  
bone,  
But life original, unborrowed and  
Eternal on the universal sand.  
That life unborrowed You granted in love  
To the one that You sent down from above  
As gauge and promise that the human  
sound  
Might one day also be caught up and bound  
In Your immortal being to sing loud  
The praises of Your glory in a crowd.  
Beloved, I praise You that eternal life,  
Which is Your right alone, is split by knife  
Of grace to one who represented You,  
And through him to all beggars come in  
view.

27 "And He gave him power to instate  
Judgement also, because his rate  
Is to be son of man as well.  
28 "Do not be amazed at this, for  
The hour is coming, in which score  
All that are in the graves shall hear  
His voice, 29 "and shall come forth, appear  
Those who've done good into the spell  
Of resurrection of life, and  
Those who've done evil in the land  
To resurrection into hell.

Alright, not hell exactly in the view  
Of Dante, but to their destruction due,  
Let evil-doers rise up from the grave.  
It is a logical way to behave.  
I see that justice is not meted out  
To anyone, despite the way they shout  
That forests echo one's own words and  
neighbour  
Answers in like to every kind of labour.  
Still wickedness succeeds on earth today  
In getting every kind of wealth and pay.  
If justice is a divine thing and way,  
Then resurrection's the response to set  
On death that interrupts what people get.  
Beloved, it's just something I've never met.

30 "Of myself I can do no thing:  
As I hear, I judge, and it's just  
As I judge, because I don't sing  
My own will, but the will that must  
Come from the Father who sent me.

If the one You sent can do no thing then  
He cannot be the God Almighty's sting.  
The Trinity is proven false and vain  
By this one verse of John taken in train,  
Though John's the Gospel that is best to  
serve  
Those who would take the pagan way and  
swerve  
From Your word and Your being One  
alone.  
Beloved, I see that John can here atone.  
The things that Jesus hears from You make  
him  
A just judge on the earth and never dim.  
That trait imamic that the Shi'ite crowd  
Attributes to the holy twelve aloud  
Has precedents in multitude in store  
In Bible times, upon the golden shore.

31 "If I bear the testimony  
Of myself, my witness is not  
True. 32 "There's another that is taught  
To bear witness of me: I know  
That witness which he comes to show  
Of me is true. 33 "You sent to John,  
And he bore witness in true brawn.  
34 "But I got no witness from man:  
But these things I say in the plan  
Of your salvation *and not ban*.  
35 "He was a burning, shining light:  
And you were willing for a sight  
Of time to rejoice in his light.  
36 "But I have greater witness than  
That of John: for the works in span  
Which the Father gave me to do,  
The same works that I do, show true  
That the Father has sent me too.

The three great witnesses that Jesus is  
Your sent one still remain to do their biz:  
The first is that witness that John bore  
straight  
As soon as he saw Jesus coming late.  
The second is the word that fell like dove  
Upon his head to sing a song of love.  
The third is the mass of healing and sign

Of miracle that he did in a line.  
 Beloved, I take the works of Christ indeed  
 As evidence of love on earth in seed,  
 But ask that they not limit to that one,  
 But might be found today under the sun.  
 Wherever two or three come in his name,  
 Let resurrections burst forth from the  
 flame.

37 "And the Father Himself who sent  
 Me, has of me His witness lent.  
 You've never heard His voice in time  
 Nor seen his shape *of form or rhyme*.  
 38 "And you do not have His word staying  
 In you, for whom he has sent swaying,  
 Him you do not believe at all.  
 39 "Search the Scriptures, for in their stall  
 You think you have eternal life;  
 And they are what above all strife  
 Give witness of me, *song and fife*.

The people heard just thunder on the shore  
 Of Jordan, not the voice of God once more.  
 And so the divine witness comes to lack  
 Upon the craven heart, unshriven back.  
 And yet Jesus claims that Your word stands  
 true  
 In evidence that he has come from You.  
 It's not the detail here or there that rises  
 In some interpretation that comprises  
 A serpent or a virgin of the best.  
 It's rather the fact that Your word gives  
 rest,  
 A law of ten commandments that implies  
 A ruler set by You under the skies.  
 There's no alternative but David's son,  
 And by that reasoned faith my soul is won.

40 "And you refuse to come to me,  
 That you might have life faithfully.  
 41 "I do not get honour from men.  
 42 "But I know you, that you again  
 Do not have love of God in you.  
 43 "I've come in my Father's name due,  
 And you did not receive my view,  
 If someone comes in his own name,  
 You will receive him *like a flame*.

The dear lord Jesus certainly knows well  
 Anatomy of human magic's spell.  
 Whatever a man says of truth and grace,  
 He gets in reply just a slap in face.

But if he brings a false invention out,  
 His followers will multiply in clout.  
 That is the kingdom of the demon grown,  
 The one who makes a pretence to the  
 throne.

Beloved, I take no one come in the name  
 Of human hopes and harbours for the fame,  
 But only You alone, ever the same,  
 The One divine above creation's game.  
 I take none but You, my Beloved, and find  
 In You all that I lost in hopes entwined.

44 "How can you believe, who receive  
 Honour from each other on sleeve,  
 And do not seek honour alone  
 From God *who sits upon His throne*?

The only honour in this world of strife  
 That's true is that of witness in the life  
 Of honour from Your name, Beloved,  
 alone.

The credit that the human takes in stone  
 Is empty and is cold cut to the bone.  
 The churches and the state honour indeed  
 Their sons of lust and cruelty and greed.  
 But You honour alone obedience,  
 Adherence to commandments present  
 tense.

Beloved, let me seek honour when I do  
 The thing that I know from Your word is  
 true,  
 While many come to cut the Sabbath day  
 From worship and when they come late to  
 pray  
 Lift up an idol on the throne to sway.

45 "Do not imagine I'll accuse  
 You to the Father: he'll abuse  
 You, even Moses, whom you trust.  
 46 "For if you had believed the dust  
 Of Moses, you'd have believed me,  
 Because he wrote of me freely.  
 47 "But if you do not believe his  
 Writings, how shall you take the biz  
 To believe my words of degree?"

I do find in the writings of that man  
 Moses the name of Joshua by plan.  
 No doubt that's what he's talking about  
 here,  
 This Joshua's a prophecy at ear  
 Of coming of Your sent one down in fear

And in the love of all creation's gear.  
The logic is not easy to receive,  
That Joshua who came to the reprieve  
Of Moses is a sign of one to come  
After years more than a millennium.  
I take the ten commandments written down  
By Your hand and by Moses with a frown,  
And find that word incarnate in the man,  
And that is greater proof than any can.

### John 6

1 After these things Jesus went over  
The sea of Galilee *in trover*,  
Which is Tiberias *by name*.  
2 A great crowd followed his acclaim,  
Because they saw his wonders' fame  
Which he did for the ill *and lame*.  
3 And Jesus went up on a hill,  
And there he sat *with time to kill*  
With his disciples *listening still*.  
4 The Jewish Passover feast neared.  
5 When Jesus raised his eyes and saw  
A great crowd coming to his draw,  
He says to Philip, "Where shall we  
Buy bread to feed this company?"  
6 He said this just to test and see,  
For he himself knew then what he  
Would do. 7 Philip answered freely,  
"Two hundred pennyworth of bread  
Is not enough all should be fed."

The greatest question of existence here  
Has always been how shall the bread  
appear,  
Except of course in the Americas  
Where maize and manioc and not wheat's  
laws  
Nourish and comfort heart, body, and  
claws.  
Sweet Jesus is no different from the race  
Of eaters of the planet under grace.  
He knows the way to human heart is paved  
With sweetmeats for both righteous and  
depraved.  
Beloved, my solace is found every day  
In bread of wheat, oats, barley and the  
sway  
Of maize, and though I love better than all  
The manioc, Your word is bread in stall.  
Jesus was right to question and to say.

8 One of his disciples, Andrew,

Simon Peter's brother, said true,  
9 There is a lad here, who has five  
Barley loaves and two small fish *live*,  
But what can such a lot contrive?

I've always been a lad with loaves, though  
fish  
Was something in my family and dish  
That we did not fancy, acquire or wish.  
I am no longer pained as in the days  
Of nonage that, despite so much in praise,  
My portion was unwanted in the maze.  
I'm satisfied as years accumulate  
To be a lad with loaves that no one ate.  
Beloved, the hills remain, the Saviour's call  
Still echoes among the firs growing tall,  
The aspens and the birches, and I find  
That bread of life arises now in kind.  
Time stands still where the questioning  
words spend  
Their laughter and their wisdom on the  
bend.

10 And Jesus said "Make the men sit."  
There was a lot of grass and fit  
In the place, so the men sat down,  
About five thousand *from the town*.  
11 And Jesus took the loaves, and when  
He'd given thanks he gave the men,  
His own disciples and his friends  
Gave to those sitting on the ends,  
And of the fish too just as much  
As they could eat or even touch.  
12 When they were satisfied, he said  
To his disciples, "Take the bread  
Left over so no waste is spread."  
13 So they gathered it up and filled  
Twelve baskets with the fragments spilled  
Of the five barley loaves as left  
By all the people unbereft.

Twelve baskets, one for each of Ishmael's  
sons,  
Remained to nourish people in their tonnes.  
Twelve baskets, one for each of Jacob's  
own,  
Spread out in mimicry of Ishmael's throne,  
Remain to nourish Christian and the Jew,  
And every Gentile entering the crew.  
Twelve baskets of the judges and good  
kings,



And twelve for minor prophets on their  
wings,  
And for the twelve apostles' rancourings,  
And for the twelve Imams where the crane  
sings,  
Remind me to return to eat the word  
That first and foremost in Your sent one  
stirred,  
That I may enter in the twelves to stay  
Obedient to You, Beloved, each day.

14 Then those men when they saw the thing  
That Jesus did, said on the wing,  
"Truly this is that prophet sent  
Into the world *in mercy lent*."  
15 When Jesus noticed they would come  
And take him by force and by gum  
Make him a king, he went away  
Again into the hills to pray.

Reality of politics and grief  
Is simply that Jesus could in relief  
Avoid the cross and dying to take share  
Of kingdom right then when they came to  
bear  
Him to the throne eternal for his share.  
He chose to die simply because he failed  
To be satisfied with a love that paled  
Before the love of bread and fish unveiled.  
Beloved, I too need love like every man  
And woman, and like the Jesus I scan.  
I too need human love, just as he did,  
Unsatisfied with what You only hid.  
And yet within Your heart of love I find  
All loves fulfilled beyond the hopes of  
mind.

16 When night fell his disciples went  
Down to the sea *as they were spent*.  
17 They went into a ship to go  
Across the sea toward the glow  
Of Capernaum. It was dark  
And Jesus had not shown a spark.  
18 The sea rose by a great wind blowing.  
19 So when they had rowed and been  
rowing  
Twenty-five or thirty furlong,  
They saw Jesus walking along  
On the sea and toward the ship,  
And they were afraid *of the slip*.  
20 But he said to them, "It is I,  
So don't fear either storm or sky."

In days past folk were aware of the fright  
That threatened them by everything in  
sight.  
Today the sleepers are lulled more and  
more  
To deeper sleep by pope and priest at door.  
In days past the cry from the sinking ship  
Was common on the tongue and human lip.  
But now while death stalks city street and  
corner,  
There's only the fanatical of warner  
To lift a cry to those who pass him by,  
Because he too is without which or why.  
Beloved, I raise a whisper that the way  
Is fraught with dangers where the soldiers  
play,  
The politicians seek the better pay,  
And advertisers wonder at their sway.

21 Then they were glad to take him in  
The ship, and straight away in bin  
The ship was at the land arrived.  
22 The next day when the people strived  
To stand on the other side of  
The sea, they saw none there above  
Of any boat, except the one  
His disciples went in for fun,  
And that Jesus did not go then  
With his disciples and their men  
When they went in the boat, but his  
Disciples went alone on biz;  
23 Though other boats from Tiberias  
Neared the place where they lunched on  
grass,  
After the lord gave thanks to pass.  
24 So when the folk saw Jesus gone,  
Also his disciples were drawn,  
They also took to ships and came  
To Capernaum in the flame  
Of seeking Jesus, where he'd gone.  
25 And went the found him on that side  
Across the sea, they said to chide,  
"Master, when did you come to bide?"  
26 And Jesus told them and replied,  
"Truly indeed I say to you,  
You look for me, not for signs true,  
But because you ate loaves of bread  
And were filled up when you were fed.  
27 "Do not strive for the food that wastes,  
But for the food that stays in tastes  
As far as everlasting life,

That son of man will give on knife  
To you, for he's the one that God  
The Father has sealed *on the sod.*"

The people always crave the bread and fun,  
And so Jesus accuses them a tonne.  
They want the miracles, they want the sure  
Foundation of the fat and protein pure.  
The hankering for bread instead of flesh  
Is enough in the churchly sort of mesh  
To claim the bread turns into ration set  
For cannibal instead of what we've met.  
Beloved, let my desire grasp that bread  
shown

To be Your word and not the blood and  
bone.

Meet my trip at the table and the stair  
Of temple and seek out the book of prayer:  
The Psalm, the Law, the Prophet to beware,  
The marbled traces of the heavenly throne.

28 Then they said to him, "What shall we  
Do, so we'll work God's works freely?"

29 Jesus replied and answered them,  
"This is the work of God in hem,  
That you believe in the one He  
Has said to *lead His monarchy.*"

30 So they said to him, "What's the sign  
You show then to keep us in line  
And so we can believe you fine?  
What do you do *and what combine?*"

31 "Our ancestors ate manna there  
In the desert, as written fair,  
He gave them bread from heaven to eat."

32 Then Jesus said to them, "Indeed  
And truly I tell you and feed:

Moses did not give you that bread  
From heaven; but my Father fed  
You the true bread from heaven led.

33 "For the bread of God is the one  
Who comes down from the sky when done  
To give life to the world when one."

The people sought the metaphor  
themselves,

They dined in retrospect and filled their  
shelves

With expectation of the manna's share.

That's why Jesus said he was bread come  
fair.

The answer was implicit in the way

The folk came to pose questions on the day,

So circular is any task that will  
Take this chapter for eucharistic swill  
And claim that Jesus' true flesh fits the bill.  
I do not doubt the presence of the man  
Among the two or three, or even scan  
With bread and wine or not, but I resist  
The literal in bloody flesh as twist.  
Give me the life of word come down by  
plan.

34 "Then they said to him, "Sir, then give  
To us this bread *that we might live.*"

35 And Jesus said to them, "It's I  
Who am the bread of life to try;  
The one who comes to me shall not  
Be hungry ever in the plot,  
And the one who believes on me  
Shall never more become thirsty.

36 "But I said to you, you've seen me  
Also and did not believe me.

37 "Everything the Father gives me  
Shall come to me; and the one who  
Comes to me I will never shoo  
Away. 38 "For I came down from heaven,  
Not to do my own will *of seven*,  
But the will of Him who sent me.

39 "This is the Father's will who's sent  
Me, that of all which He has lent  
Me I should lose nothing at all,  
But raise it up again in stall  
In the last day *and at the call.*

The idea is that if a man can eat  
The very flesh of Christ, who is no beast,  
But very God, that God within the paunch  
Will make the grave the merest place to  
launch.

That pagan thought beguiles nearly elect,  
And lays low those who should have  
known unchecked.

Beloved, I take the bread of life on tongue  
In the word I've recited and I've sung  
From Psalter and from Gospel and from  
rung

Of Torah and even Qur'an on lung.

I'm ravenous to sip the tender dew

Of daily mentioning the names of You,

And see that hunger and that thirst come  
true,

Abiding in the very book and decked.

40 "And this is His will who sent me,

That everyone who sees freely  
The son and believes on him, may  
Have everlasting life one day  
And I'll raise him up the last day."

I fill my belly well from day to day  
With reading of Your word so's not to  
    stray,  
And with that filling find the word of life  
Is brought into my flesh and bone of strife.  
I fill the heart and mind, the chamber bare,  
Where my small lamp burns brightly with  
    the share  
Of sweetness from the Massoretic ware,  
The Grecian cadences, Arabic script,  
All divine utterances heavenly shipped.  
Beloved, as I fill heart and hand with zeal  
For life eternal on fortuna's wheel,  
I raze the fortresses of flesh appeal,  
Of spirit in the many things I feel,  
Turn to the last day with living to dare.

41 The Jews then murmured against him,  
Because he said, "I'm bread in vim  
Come down from heaven *to be trim.* "  
42 And they said "Is this not the son  
Of Joseph, this Jesus for fun,  
Whose father and mother we know?  
How is it he then says for show  
I've come down from heaven to glow?"

The Jews did not complain that Jesus spoke  
As though his flesh were bread upon the  
    stroke,  
As though his blood were wine brought in  
    for broke,  
But for the claim that he came down from  
    bright  
Heaven to appear before them in their  
    sight.  
They could not stomach the celestial claim,  
Cannibalism was no problem flame.  
Not bread for flesh was troubling to the  
    soul,  
But that the carpenter Joseph once stole  
Upon the midnight hour to touch the brow  
Of the boy to be sure of health and how.  
The human touch is what refused to wake  
In them before the load and laughing stake.  
Beloved, a man's enough for my heart's  
    wake.

43 So Jesus answered them and said,  
"Do not murmur among your bred.  
44 "No man can come to me, except  
The Father who sent me has swept  
Him up, and I will raise him too  
At the last day *and the last view.* "

No man can come to Jesus except You,  
Beloved, enlighten him among the crew.  
The story's so encrusted with the late  
Despairs of mystery cults come from the  
    great

And solar myths of dying god-men that  
Made fertile Canaanite-Phoenician flat.  
The doctrines that are spread about his head  
Blind all to the truth of his life instead.  
The ones who read the Gospels still are led  
To worship solar deity when fed.  
Indeed, it takes a miracle of spirit  
For anyone to know the real or near it.  
It's greater miracle indeed that waking  
The body from the dead and tomb's  
    forsaking.

45 "It's written in the prophets too,  
'And they shall all be taught of God.'  
So every one who's heard and learned  
Of the Father, comes to me earned.  
46 "Not that anyone's seen the Father,  
Except the one which is of rather  
God, he has seen the Father *spurned.*

47 "Truly indeed I say to you,  
The one who believes in me true,  
Has everlasting life in view.  
48 "I am that bread of life *come due.*  
49 "Your ancestors ate manna in  
The wilderness: they're dead in bin.  
50 "This is the bread which now comes  
    down

From heaven: any man *in town*  
May eat some and not die *in frown.* "  
51 "I'm living bread that came from  
    heaven:

If any man eat this bread's leaven,  
He shall live for ever: the bread  
That I give is my flesh instead,  
Which I give for life of the world."  
52 So the Jews fought among themselves,  
Saying "How can this man *on shelves*  
Give us his flesh to eat *like elves?* "

At last the people wake up to raise stink

About the very option on the blink  
 That they forced with their question of the  
     task  
 To prove that Jesus was the one to ask.  
 If argument that's circular is wrong,  
 Then so too is this argument in song.  
 It's no use to complain that Jesus said  
 He was the bread of life come down instead  
 Of manna, if I raise the issue spread  
 Of demanding some miracle in bread.  
 Beloved, I taste the word and find it good,  
 The Psalm, the Torah, and what Jesus could  
 Speak of the word of life, and so I go  
 Into eternal life without a show.

53 Then Jesus said to them, "Truly  
 Indeed, I tell you, except ye  
 Eat the flesh of the son of man,  
 And drink his blood, you never can  
 Have life in you *by God's own plan*.  
 54 "Whoever eats my flesh and drinks  
 My blood, has life eternal's links,  
 And I'll raise him at the last day.  
 55 "For my flesh is food truly and  
 My blood is drink truly at hand.  
 56 "The one who eats my flesh in sway  
 And drinks my blood, dwells in my way,  
 And I in him. 57 "Just in the way  
 The living Father sent me, and  
 I live by the Father's command,  
 So he that eats me, even he  
 Shall come to live *always* by me.

To eat the flesh of Christ is not to take  
 A wafer from a drunken priest in stake.  
 It's rather to live by Your great command,  
 As did the one sent by You out of hand.  
 I eat his flesh by my obedience  
 To ten commandments given in good sense.  
 I drink his blood by doing what You say.  
 It's hardly Eucharist he meant that day,  
 Because he offered his flesh right away  
 And long before the final meal before  
 The show of cross and crucifixion's gore.  
 Beloved, the word has always been to eat,  
 When the two trees stood in the garden  
     heat,  
 The manna came, and Jesus took his seat.

58 "This is the bread come down from  
     heaven,  
 Not as your ancestors with leaven

Ate manna and are dead; but he  
 Who eats this bread eternally  
 Shall live." 59 These things also said he  
 In synagogue, and as he taught  
 In Capernaum's *town and plot*.  
 60 Many of his disciples, when  
 They heard this, said "This thing again  
 Is a hard saying; who can hear?"  
 61 When Jesus knew himself that his  
 Disciples murmured at the biz,  
 He said to them, "Does this offend?  
 62 "What if you see the son of man  
 Go up again to *stand in span*  
 Where he was before and *by plan*?"  
 63 "It is the spirit quickening,  
 The flesh profits not anything:  
 The words that I speak to you are  
 The spirit and the life *by far*.

The words that Jesus speaks are flesh and  
     life,  
 The blood that I should drink before the  
     strife.  
 The words he speaks are the same that in  
     past  
 Were written in the Psalms and Law to last.  
 The recitation of the word of faith  
 Is what keeps one out of the land of wraith.  
 The flesh upon the paten profits not,  
 Nor does the alcoholic sort of plot,  
 The blasphemies of pagan stories taught.  
 And yet the word must have the spirit's way  
 Before it give the life I need today.  
 Beloved, I breathe Your spirit as I sing  
 Creation's story on the raven's wing,  
 And turn back from my fruitless  
     wandering.

64 "But there are some of you who do  
 Not believe." For then Jesus knew  
 From the beginning who was not  
 Beloved and who'd betray the plot.  
 65 And he said "That's why I tell you,  
 That no one can come in my view,  
 Except it's given to him *to see*  
 By my own Father *faithfully*.  
 66 From that time many of his own  
 Disciples went back and alone  
 Walked with him no more *gratefully*.  
 67 Then Jesus said to the twelve, "Will  
 You also go away *and spill*?  
 68 Then Simon Peter answered him,

“Sir, to whom shall we go for vim?  
You have the words of life eternal.

The good and simple Peter could rely  
On what he heard and what he would reply.  
He did not take offence that Jesus said  
He had come down from heaven like the  
bread,

Nor that he ordered all to eat his flesh  
Dripping with the blood of the slain afresh.  
He understood that what was necessary  
Was words of life eternal to the wary.

I take the words of life on tongue and heart  
And leave off every pagan sort of art  
Before the hopeful and the better part.  
Beloved, give me the Simon Peter way  
Of turning from what great and scornful  
say

To hear the words of life now and each  
day.

69 “We do believe among infernal  
And are sure that you are the Christ,  
The son the living God *has spliced.*”

Just as the flesh of Jesus was not meant  
To be eaten in literal blood spent,  
So Jesus is not made of divine sperm  
Somehow ejaculated with a squirm.  
Jesus is not the son of God as spilled  
By Trinitarian in pagan guild.  
But by the generation of that word  
By which all things were made and all  
occurred,

That word that rested on the man was set,  
The divine word before the worlds were  
met.

By that word dwelling within him Jesus  
Is son of God and has the life for us  
That You, Beloved, vouchsafed to him  
alone

To sit at Your right hand upon the throne.

70 “Jesus replied to them, ‘Have I  
Not chose just you twelve *to rely*,  
And one of you’s a devil’s *spy*?

71 He meant Judas Iscariot  
The son of Simon in his lot,  
For it was he who should betray,  
Being one of the twelve in sway.

As soon as any home church grows to be

As many as twelve on the sinners’ spree,  
As soon as there are more than two or  
three,

Then devil’s present in infirmary.

The presence of Your sent one is allowed  
When two or three are gathered as a crowd,  
But twelve includes a devil, that is sure,  
And that is why each church is one impure.  
Beloved, keep me in a group never more  
Than the eleven on Galilee’s shore,  
So I shall not participate in meal  
With devils who come in to spy and wheel.  
Beloved, come with Your spirit now to  
heal,

Preserve from infiltration in appeal.

### John 7

1 After these things Jesus was walking  
In Galilee, for he was balking  
From walking in Judean land,  
Because the Jewish leading band  
Lusted to kill him out of hand.

2 The Jewish Feast of Tabernacles  
Was near. 3 This his brothers *like grackles*  
Said to him, “Get away from here  
And go to Judaea with gear,

So that your disciples also  
Will see the works you do to show.

4 For no one works in secret and  
Himself seeks to make public stand.  
If you do these things, then reveal  
Yourself to all the world’s appeal.”

5 For his brothers did not believe  
In him *that they might have reprieve.*

6 Then Jesus said to them, “My time  
Has not yet come, but you would climb  
On every occasion *in crime.*

7 “The world cannot hate you, but it  
Hates me for I bear witness fit  
That its works are wicked and vile.

8 “Go up yourselves in this feast’s style.  
I shall not go up to the feast  
Yet, for my time’s not yet increased.”

9 He said these things to them, and he  
Remained behind in Galilee.

The way to be hated in this world’s just  
To point out how much evil’s in the dust  
Of those who buy and sell and those who  
trust

In governments and churches and their rust.  
In fact, the only hate I see is this.

All others love each other in the bliss  
 Of jungle law, pretence of help and kiss,  
 But Judas-like, out to make silver miss  
 If only by betraying those who fail  
 To conform to the hopeful, lawless grail.  
 Beloved, my brothers are of all mankind,  
 My sisters are all of women I find,  
 And yet I know the scorn of those who  
     fight  
 Against Your Decalogue, against the right.

10 But when his brothers went up, then  
 He also went up *among men*  
 To the feast, but not openly,  
 But as in secret not to see.  
 11 The Jewish leaders looked for him  
 At the feast and said "Where's the *grim?*"  
 12 And there was much talk about him  
 Among the crowds. Some said with vim,  
 "He is a good man," others said  
 "No, but he deceives the crowds *led.*"  
 13 But no one publicly took stand  
 For fear of Jewish leaders' band.  
 14 But in the middle of the feast,  
 Jesus went to the temple fleeced  
 And taught *the people and increased.*

Unless he changed his mind, the dear lord  
     here  
 Lied to his brothers as though without fear  
 Of You or Your commandments I've held  
     dear.  
 Which shall I choose? I might just throw  
     some dice  
 And take the even for the greater nice,  
 And take the odd for lying in his teeth.  
 Chance is as good as the most common  
     wreath.  
 Of course I could give benefit of doubt,  
 And say he changed his mind to find him  
     out.  
 So many spoke and rumours flew around,  
 And some were for and others on the  
     ground  
 Of chance or prejudice. Beloved, I take  
 The change of mind, and for Jesus' dear  
     sake  
 Remind my steps Jerusalem is found.

15 The Jews were surprised and they said  
 "How does this one know letters spread,  
 Not having been in college fed?"

16 Jesus replied saying "My teaching  
 Is not mine, but His who sent *preaching.*  
 17 "If any wish to do His will,  
 He'll know about the teaching *still,*  
 If it is of God or I speak  
 From myself *and out of my cheek.*  
 18 "The one who speaks from himself  
     seeks

His own glory. But he who peeks  
 At the glory of the One who  
 Has sent him, then this one is true,  
 Unrighteousness is not in him.  
 19 "Has not Moses given you trim  
 The Law, and yet not one of you  
 Works according to the Law true?  
 Why do you lust to kill me too?"  
 20 The crowd answered and said "Now you  
 Must have a demon. Who tries, who  
 To kill you *for the things you do?*"

Beloved, take now a lesson for the style  
 Of human governments set out to smile.  
 Behind the scenes mid-level management  
 Is set about to destroy every tent  
 Of those who do not conform to their way,  
 And yet their minions scoff as though in  
     play,

When someone speaks to expose evil rife.  
 They slit the fool with blade of sharpened  
     knife  
 And pay the police to report a life  
 Gone in the suicide records with fife.  
 The very ones who claim the law their own  
 Are exposed to the inner flesh and bone,  
 And with a sneer of triumph still pretend  
 To be peace-makers on earth and defend.

21 Jesus replied and said to them,  
 "I did one work and you in hem  
 All marvelled at the thing I do.  
 22 "Because of this Moses gave you  
 The circumcision; though it's not  
 Of Moses, but ancestors taught,  
 And on the Sabbath you will come  
 To circumcise a man or bum.  
 23 "If one gets circumcision done  
 On Sabbath so Moses' Law's won,  
 Are you angry with me because  
 I made a man whole without flaws  
 On Sabbath? 24 Do not judge by sight,  
 But by the judgement that is right.  
 25 Some Jerusalemites then said

"Is this not the one whom they're led  
To kill?" 26 And see, he speaks as bold  
And public as they have not told.  
Maybe the rulers really know  
This is the Christ *come down below*.  
27 And yet we know this one, from where  
He is. But when the Christ is there,  
No one will know what is his share."

Beloved, the argument is that the man  
Cannot be Christ, because he came in plan  
Known by all in his parentage and caste.  
But the Messiah has no fame that's past.  
So every man takes some criterion  
In quaint inspection of the things he's done,  
And measures prejudice against what's  
won,  
As though he could judge You Yourself for  
fun.

Beloved, let me take no decided point  
Of logic or my expectation's joint  
To make evaluation of all things.  
Let me take for criterion the wings  
Of Decalogue alone. The faithful guide  
Shows who and who is not beside Your  
side.

28 As he was teaching, Jesus spoke  
Aloud in the temple for stroke,  
And said "You both know me and you  
Know where I come from, it is true,  
And I have not come from myself,  
But He is true, who took from shelf  
And sent me, the One you don't know.  
29 "But I know Him, because my show  
Is from Him, and He sent my row."  
30 Then they tried to arrest him there,  
Yet no one could lay a hand bare  
On him, for his time was not there.  
31 But many of the crowd believed  
In him and said "The Christ received,  
When he comes will he do more signs  
That these which the one only deigns?"  
32 The Pharisees heard the crowd's words  
About him, and Pharisee herds  
And the chief priests sent officers,  
To catch him, if they might *like curs*.  
33 Then Jesus said to them, "A while  
I am still with you, but soon I'll  
Go back to Him who sent my style.  
34 "You'll look for me, and will not find,  
Where I am, you are not assigned."

Another great criterion at stake  
In the mouths of the rabble for the cake  
Is that a man who does enough tricks here  
Is one that's worthy for the folk to hear.  
Will the Christ do more miracles than this?  
Conclusion's right perhaps, but one could  
miss

The truth full well by focusing a kiss  
On signs and wonders come from the  
abyss.

Beloved, I do not look for resurrections,  
Nor for the miracles in their selections,  
But for the fact that Jesus' word is true  
When he speaks wonders to the chosen  
few.

His word conforms to Decalogue and so  
I know it is the better way to go.

35 Then the Jews said among themselves,  
"Where is this one going with elves  
Where we cannot find him ourselves?  
Will he turn to the Gentile folk  
And teach the Greeks doctrines he spoke?"  
36 "What is this word that he said 'You  
Will look for me, not find in view,'  
And 'Where I am, you cannot come?'"  
37 On the last day of the great feast,  
Jesus stood up and cried increased,  
Saying "If anybody thirsts,  
Let him find me and drink till bursts.  
38 "He who believes in me as said  
The Scripture, 'Out of belly bred  
Will flow rivers of living water,  
*Eternally to each that's caught her.*'  
39 But he said of the spirit so,  
Whom the believers in his show  
Might get, for holy spirit's row  
Was not yet here, because Jesus  
Had not yet been made glorious.

Search as I may, I do not find the verse  
Of Scripture to which this refers as curse  
Or blessing, in fact belly does not sound  
Among the sacred writings I have found.  
That makes me think this Gospel's really  
set

In the time before the canon was met  
In Jamna for the Jews who came to get  
The knowledge of which books were on the  
ground.

Beloved, whatever Jesus quotes I see

Is better than the sum of pageantry  
That his detractors and followers now  
Pretend to foist upon the sacred brow.  
Let living water from Ali's fair cup  
Swell stomach till my belly is filled up.

40 When they heard the message many  
Of the crowd said "This one's really  
The Prophet." 41 Others said "The Christ."  
But others said "But does the Christ  
Come out of Galilee *sufficed?*"

The people of the time waited it seems  
For both the Christ and for the man of  
dreams,  
The Prophet, the Desired, and so they stood  
In undecided groups to see which should.  
The people of the day looked for the one  
To come as a Messiah on the run,  
And for the Hemda who from former times  
Was the focus of their desires and rhymes.  
Beloved, unlike that ancient crowd, I know  
Who is that Prophet in the cunning show  
And who is the Messiah on the go.  
I hide the pair within my heart and flee  
Away from all the sects' in pageantry,  
And find in their words life from Your  
decree.

42 Has not the Scripture said that Christ  
Comes from the seed of David spliced,  
And from Bethlehem and the town  
Where David was *and did come down?*"  
43 So there was disagreement there  
In the crowd because of his share.

So often those who bolster unbelief  
With Scripture have not laboured with the  
chief  
To find the truth behind the issue met.  
They did not know, who pointed to the set  
Of Bethlehem that Jesus was born there,  
But thought he came from Galilee to spare.  
Of course today one might retort in kind,  
That Gospels were adjusted in the bind  
The such critics. There's always hook to  
find  
To hang excuses on. But to my mind,  
Come what may and do what Jesus decrees,  
The Decalogue is always here to please.  
I take the Master of that far off day,  
Join Jesus with the Decalogue and pray.

44 Some of them wanted to arrest him,  
But no dared lay hand to test him.  
45 The officers came to the priests  
And Pharisees like ranging beasts.  
And they asked them, "Why did you not  
Bring him *back to us as in plot?*"  
46 The officers replied, "No man  
Ever spoke like this one *in span.*"  
47 The Pharisees replied, "Have you  
Not been deceived too in his crew?  
48 "None of the rulers or the band  
Of Pharisees believe his hand.  
49 "But since they do not know the law,  
This crowd is cursed in hand and claw."

When Jesus spoke the truth in temple court,  
The people believed who came to resort  
There and to listen to the teaching taught.  
The rulers and the scholars in their plot  
Only were too wise in their own eyes to  
Accept the reasonable sort of view.  
The argument that those who claim to be  
The elite do not accept the decree  
Is argument still spread about the world.  
It's old as Sodom and Gomorrah furred.  
Beloved, let me not trust my wisdom's  
share,  
Nor wisdom of the practised and the fair,  
But find my refuge in Your heart alone,  
And in Your Decalogue written in stone.

50 Nicodemus said to them then,  
The one who came by night again,  
As being of the leading men,  
51 "Does our Law judge the man unless  
It hear from him first and confess  
To know what he's done, and not guess?"  
52 They answered and said to him too,  
"Are you also from Galilee?  
Search and see that no prophet's crew  
Has been raised from Galilee's lee."  
53 Each to his own house left angry.

In the most wicked of courts always one  
Raises a timid voice or thunder's gun  
For righteousness, but he is overruled.  
His function is to teach the over-schooled.  
As Perrin lifted up a voice to free  
Miguel Servett from the evil decree,  
So Nicodemus spoke up for our lord.  
If he had been heard by the gross adored,



There would have been no sacrifice for sin.  
 And yet I trust, Beloved, under such din  
 There would have been no need of  
     sacrifice,  
 No need to give a sop to Roman vice.  
 The virtue of mankind hangs on the hair  
 Of tragically ignoring those who care.

### John 8

1 Jesus went to Mount Olives then.  
 2 At dawn he went back to the den  
 Of the temple, and all the folk  
 Came to him. He sat down a stroke  
 And taught them *every dame and bloke*.  
 3 And the scribes and the Pharisees  
 Brought him a woman who in ease  
 Was taken in adulteries.  
 They stood her in the middle there.  
 4 They said to him, "Rabbi, with care  
 This woman was found in the act,  
 Committing adultery in fact.  
 5 "Now in the Law, Moses commanded  
 That such be stoned when they were  
     landed.

But you, what do you say unhanded?"

6 But they said this to trap him so  
 They might have cause to have a go  
 Accusing him. But bending down,  
 Jesus wrote with his finger brown  
 Upon the earth as with a frown  
 He did not hear the question low.  
 7 But as they kept on asking him,  
 He stood up and he said to hem,  
 "The one among you without sin,  
 Let him cast the first stone in din  
 At her to kill *and put in bin*."

8 And stooping down again, he wrote  
 Upon the earth *that he had smote*.

9 But hearing and being convicted  
 By their own consciences evicted,  
 They went out one by one, the first  
 To go the older ones and worst  
 Until the last. So Jesus stayed  
 Alone with the woman waylaid  
 And standing in the middle *frayed*.

10 And Jesus standing up saw none  
 But the woman, said to her won,  
 "Lady, where are those who came to  
 Accuse you? Did no one incur  
 A judgement against you in view?"

11 And she said "No one, sir." And then  
 Jesus said to her, "Neither then

Do I judge you. Go, sin no more."  
*And so he showed them all the door.*

Of course Jesus could not give the death  
     sentence.

That was a Roman privilege and bentence.  
 The trap was far too visible for him,  
 Who had faced more than one or two things  
     grim.

But why not state the fact? He could have  
     said

He had not jurisdiction in the spread,  
 Especially since he had not fallen down  
 To worship Satan from the temple's crown.  
 The fact is he used all the power he had  
 As son of David, king and little lad.  
 He had the right to free any brought in  
 Before his royal throne accused of sin.  
 That fact escapes the liturgist today  
 Who wants to sacrifice the bread to pay.

12 Then Jesus spoke again to them,  
 Saying "I am the world's light's gem.  
 The one who follows me will not  
 Walk in the darkness *of a plot*,  
 But will have light of life *unsought*."

13 The Pharisees said to him then,  
 "You witness of yourself *to men*,  
 So your witness is not truth *taught*."

14 Jesus replied and said to them,  
 "Though I witness by stratagem  
 Concerning myself, what I say  
 In witness is the truth in sway,  
 For I know where I've come from and  
 To where I go. You understand  
 Not at all where I've come from and  
 To what place I go *from the land*.

15 "You judge according to the flesh.  
 I judge no one *nor catch in mesh*.

16 "But even if I judge, what I  
 Judge is true, simply because I  
 Am not alone, but I and my  
 Father who sent me *from the sky*.

17 "And in your Law it has been writ  
 That two men's witness is true fit.

18 "I witness of myself for one,  
 And he who sent me when I've done,  
 The Father, bears witness of me."

19 Then they said to him, "Where's your  
     dad?"

Jesus replied, "You neither had  
 Known me nor my Father. If you

Had known me, then you'd know too  
My Father." 20 Jesus spoke these words  
Inside the treasury with herds  
Of people where he taught within  
The temple, and no one could win  
To take him, since his time had not  
Yet come for him once to be caught.

As I follow the conversation where  
The Pharisees and Jesus come to bear  
On each the other, I am saddened when  
I see that he began to speak again  
Of light as a deep truth among earth's men.  
Instead of asking what he might have told,  
They sneered and quibbled in scholastic  
fold.

So is it in this world and everywhere.  
Beloved, I turn from discourse and its rate,  
I turn from love of laughter and from hate,  
To find in contemplation of Your word  
That my heart is for ever anew stirred.  
Let that like what Jesus began to spark  
Continue in my mind to leave its mark.

21 Then Jesus said to them again,  
"I go and you will seek me then.  
And you will die in your sin's sum.

Where I go, you can never come."

22 The Jewish leaders said "Will he  
Kill himself, because he says free,  
'Where I go you can never be?'"

23 He said to them, "You're from below;  
I'm from above. You're worldly show,  
I am not from this world *below*.

24 "That's why I said you'll die in sin.  
For if you do not believe in  
My being, you'll die in your sin."

25 Then they said to him, "Who are you?"  
And Jesus told them the start true,  
"What I also have said to you.

26 "I have many things to say and  
To judge concerning where you stand,  
But the One who sent me is true,  
And what I heard from Him, I do  
Say to the world and bring to view."

27 They did not realize he spoke  
To them of the Father *in stroke*.

The quandary and questioning began  
With those who meant to slay as slaying  
can  
And went on in the early church

To define sons and gods on pagan perch.  
Who are you is a common thing to ask,  
But even simple questions can in task  
Initiate the wicked and untrue.  
So church fathers join with the ancient Jew  
In the sarcastic search in iron pew  
To bring discredit on Your sent and You.  
Beloved, I do not ask Your Jesus who  
Do you think you are to be ruling folk,  
Pretending to be David's son awoke  
With rod of iron and kiss on the boy's  
stroke.

28 Then Jesus said to them, "When you  
Lift up the son of man, then you  
Will know how I am, and from me  
Myself I do nothing to see,  
But as my Father has taught me,  
Such things as these I speak *freely*.  
29 "And He who sent me is with me.  
The Father did not leave me lone,  
For I do the things which atone  
To please Him always *when they're  
thrown*."

30 He spoke these things while many there  
Believed in him *and took his share*.

I too believe, Beloved, what Jesus spoke,  
And I find in my soul what faith awoke  
Before the witness that he is and You  
Are God alone who's please with what men  
do.

I too believe, Beloved, that when he taught  
The listeners beforehand what they'd  
brought

In crucifixion, he spoke from the thing  
That You had spoken when You made him  
king.

You sent him to the world to act alone  
According to Your word in flesh and bone,  
And so give the example to atone.

I too like every man am sent abroad  
Into this world a witness of his God  
To be obedient on the frozen sod.

31 Then Jesus told Jews who believed  
In him, "If you keep the received  
Of my word, you truly shall be  
Of my disciples *faithfully*.

32 "And you will know the truth and see  
The truth will come to set you free."

33 They answered him, "We're Abram's seed,

And we've never been or decreed  
In slavery. How then can you say  
'You will become free of the sway?'"

34 Jesus replied to them, "Truly,  
Indeed I tell you, everyone  
Who does sin is sin's slave undone.

35 "But the slave does not remain in  
The house forever, but with grin  
The son remains as long *in bin*.

36 "So if the son will set you free,  
Then you are truly free *to see*.

37 "I know that you are Abram's seed,  
But you try to kill me indeed,  
Because my word's not given room  
In you. 38 "I speak what I've seen bloom  
With my Father. And you do too  
What you have seen your father do."

39 They answered and said to him then,  
"Abraham's our father again."

Jesus said to them, "If you were  
Abraham's children, you would stir  
To do the works of Abraham.

40 "But now you try to kill my ham,  
A man who spoke the truth to you,  
Which I heard from God in His pew.  
Abraham did not make such stew.

41 "You do your father's works in crew."  
They said to him, "We were not born  
Of fornication and of scorn,  
We have one father, who's God true."

Why do the sweet Christians who claim  
that You

Make Jesus God by taking him in clue  
As son of God, not also claim the Jew  
Who says God is his father makes claim  
too

To be a deity and number person  
In trinity or infinity's worsen?  
They use the accusation of blasphemy  
As evidence that Jesus was not squeamy  
About the claims that he was God  
Almighty.

Such inconsistency is something flighty.  
Beloved, make me Your child obedient,  
And I shall sing Your praises in the tent  
Of David by the Psalms that You have sent  
To grace the Scriptures and the air in scent.

When argument failed, the critic arose

To say that Jesus' mum in harlots' throes  
Conceived him in sin. So my horror grows.  
And yet I see the same in every place.  
Few are ready to take argument's grace,  
But stoop to calling names instead, because  
It's easier than reason and its laws.  
How many still find bastard the best term  
To make their own opponent bow and  
squirm!

Beloved, sanctify my tongue for a day  
Not to call evil men who now bear sway  
According to their origins and sin.  
Let me take only reason and so win.  
That is more trenchant for words anyway.

42 Then Jesus said to them, "If God  
Were your Father, you'd love my prod,  
For I went out and have come here  
From God. For I've not come in gear  
Of myself, but that One sent me.  
43 "Why don't you know my speech and  
see?

It's because you cannot hear my  
Word. 44 "You're from your father the  
Devil,

And the lusts of your father level  
You want to do. That one was just  
A murderer from the start's bust,  
And he has not stood in the truth,  
Because in him there is no truth.  
When he speaks a lie he speaks from  
His own, because he's liar come,  
And the father of it in sum.

45 "And just because I speak the truth,  
You do not believe me *uncouth*.

46 "Who among you reproves my sin?  
But if I speak the truth to win,  
Why don't you believe *with a grin*?

47 "He who is of God hears the words  
Of God, for this reason in herds  
You do not hear, because you're not  
Of God, *but of another lot*."

Those who refuse obedience to You,  
Beloved, and forsake in the things they do  
Your ten commandments spoken in Your  
love,

Are not the sons of God standing above.  
They are the Devil's children. I beware  
Of all such people I find everywhere.  
The many churches and establishments  
Of faith are full of the spawn in their tents

Of demons come to trouble me and mine,  
And all who love Your law and forsake  
wine.

Beloved, though sin may be found in my  
hand,

And I cannot maintain my truth to stand  
As Jesus did, I still repent and come  
To claim You as my Father, though a bum.

48 Then the Jews answered him and said,  
“Do we not say well you instead  
Are a Samaritan and filled  
With a demon to be unspilled?”

49 Jesus replied, “I am not filled  
With a demon, but honour my  
Father, but you dishonour me.  
50 “But I do not seek my glory.  
There's One who seeks and judges by.

51 “Truly indeed I say to you,  
If any keep my word in view,  
He'll not see death forever, true.”

I think it wonderful Jesus Your son  
Denied that he might have a devil done  
In heart and mind and hand, but did not say  
He was no Samaritan on the way.  
He was a Jew. And yet he did not slight  
Samaritan for hope or love or light.  
Beloved, let me deny no ethnic load,  
Identities falsely plotted with goad,  
But let me be any and all that come,  
The black, the white, the Indian sort of  
bum.

Beloved, perhaps You too share that sweet  
way

Of welcoming all colours in to play,  
And casting out no ethnic herd to be  
Pariah on the earth or heavenly sea.

52 Then the Jews told him, “Now we know  
You have a demon for the show.  
Abraham died, the prophets too,  
And you say 'If any in crew  
Keeps my word, he'll not taste death's rue  
For ever.' 53 “Are you greater than  
Our father Abraham in span  
Who died? And the prophets died too.  
Whom do you make yourself in view?”

54 Jesus replied, “If I should give  
Myself the glory, I'd not live  
To benefit, but it's my Dad  
Who glorifies me, whom you're bad

To say is your God. 55 “And you've not  
Known Him; but I know him a lot,  
And if I say that I do not  
Know Him, I'll be like you, a liar.  
But I know him and keep on fire  
His word. 56 “Your father Abraham  
Leaped for joy he should see my dram,  
And he saw and rejoiced *like lamb*.  
57 Then the Jews said to him, “You're not  
Yet fifty years old in the lot,  
And have you seen Abraham's plot?”  
58 Jesus told them, “Truly indeed  
I tell you, before Abraham  
Came to be at all, there I am.”  
59 Because of this they saw the need  
To pick up stones that they might throw  
At him. But Jesus hid to go  
Out of the temple, going through  
The middle of them, left their crew.

When was it Abraham saw the day come,  
The day of Jesus, day to sing and hum?  
Perhaps it was when Pharaoh sent him out  
With wife reproved, though enriched with a  
clout.

Maybe it was when Ishmael came to light,  
Or Isaac was weaned from his mother's  
right.

It may have been when Haran out of sight  
Sent him to Canaan's land to earn a mite.  
Perhaps it was when angels stayed his hand  
And saved the son from knife upon the land  
Of fair Moriah. Do not give a clue,  
Beloved, let me still guess at all things  
new.

When I have stilled my tongue and heart,  
then say

When was the gloried and the joyful day.

## John 9

1 As he passed by, there came in view  
A man blind from his birth *in cue*.  
2 And his disciples asked him, saying  
“Master, who sinned this one in playing,  
Or his parents, so that he was  
Born blind, say now what was the cause?”

The ancient question was not as today  
Why is there evil in the world and way?  
We now assume that we deserve the best.  
In olden times they thought sufferings  
invest

To punish the deserving for their crimes.  
So now they ask how can deserving times  
Be on one blind from birth? A cunning  
thought.

Solution might be in the parents sought.  
Beloved, I do not think the world deserves  
A better fate than the ball in its curves.  
Nor do I think the sufferings in the dell  
Are punishment from Your created hell.  
Keep me, Beloved, from fair philosophy,  
And more from its more modern sophistry.

3 Jesus replied, "Neither this one  
Nor his parents sinned out of fun.

Jesus denies the ancient ticket and  
The elegant solution they had planned,  
And wittingly gives them to understand  
That unlike Paul, he thinks some men have  
manned

The law to its perfection and unbanned.  
If Joseph, Job and Daniel had no sin,  
It's not too hard these three are in the bin  
Of righteousness with them, despite the  
wait

Of blindness on the poor man's face and  
pate.

Beloved, let me not think the evil rate  
That falls on me and neighbour is the pile  
Of punishment from You to weigh the  
while.

I think instead in evil and in good,  
May I obey You law as all men should.

But that the works of God might be  
Revealed in him, 4 "it behoves me  
To work the works of Him who sent  
Me while the day is not yet spent.  
Night comes when no one's here to work.  
5 "While I'm in the world I'll not shirk  
From being the world's light and lent."

The reason Jesus gives that sufferings come  
Upon the earth is not punishment's rum,  
But without explanation of the cause.  
Indeed to give excuse for pain in paws  
Is to deny the evil of the way.  
I'd rather it not be explained a ray.  
Instead of explanation, Jesus calls  
The shot that its an opportunity,  
And where there's suffering in the crowd,  
then he

Finds room to save the sufferer from its  
thralls.

Beloved, I'm not a healer nor have I  
The wherewithal alleviating cry,  
But may my mouth give comfort where  
there's rue,  
And never to deny the thing that's true.

6 Having said these things, then he spat  
On the ground and made from the scat  
Of clay and spittle to anoint

The blind one's eyes *around the joint*.

7 And he said to him, "Go and wash  
In Siloam's pool and *well slosh*,"

The name translated means the sent.  
And so the blind man up and went  
And washed and came back seeing all.

8 The neighbours and those who before  
Had seen him being blind to core,  
Said "Is this the one who once sat  
And begged *beside the dog and cat*?"

9 Some said "This is the one", and others,  
"It's someone like him, *perhaps brothers*."  
That one said "I'm the one who sat."

10 They asked him then, "How were your  
eyes

Then opened *as by a surprise*?"

11 He answered and said "A man called  
Jesus made clay and unappalled  
Anointed my eyes and told me,  
'Go to the pool of Siloam free

And wash.' I followed the decree  
And washed and came again to see."

12 Then they said to him, "Where is he?"

He said "I don't know, *I am stalled*."

13 They brought him to the Pharisees,  
The one once blind, *if he could please*.

14 And it was on a Sabbath day  
When Jesus came to make the clay  
And opened his eyes *in that way*.

If I'd been Jesus, I'd have not made clay,  
Despite the folksy remedies that say  
To do so helps sore eyes. No, I'd betray  
No act at all upon the Sabbath day  
But only raise my eye silent to pray.  
Then I could not be blamed for any ill.  
I'd do that since I would not send a bill.  
If I'd been Jesus, I'd have healed the lot  
So secretly that none would hear the plot.  
Beloved, I too fear Pharisee instead  
Of You only. I need the Gospel spread

To fear none but You for judgement of  
dead.  
If You open my eyes to all around,  
Just wait to hear what I will say and sound.

15 The Pharisees then too again  
Asked him how it came about then  
That he could see now once again.  
And he told them, "He just put clay  
On my eyes, and I washed that way,  
And now I can see *light of day*."

16 Some Pharisees said "This man is  
Not from God, since upon the sod  
He does not keep the Sabbath day."  
Others said "How can a man who  
Is a sinner do such signs true?"  
And so they argued in that way.

The fact is that a man who does not keep  
The Sabbath day is not from God. I weep.  
But reasons are blind in the way they  
sweep

Through logic with agenda on the peep.  
Conclusion was not false for premise but  
For antithetic proposition's strut.  
Jesus simply did not break Sabbath day,  
And that assumption was the falsehood's  
stay.

Beloved, I know of many who do not  
Keep Sabbath, yet they claim they are Your  
shot.

Jesus did not deny the Sabbath, yet  
These preachers do deny and place a bet.  
Beloved, I rush to Sabbath's joy and know  
That Jesus too is standing in the row.

17 They said to the blind man once more,  
"What do you say about his store,  
Because he opened up your eyes?"  
And he said "He's a prophet wise."

18 The Jews did not believe the thing,  
That he'd been blind and then seeing,  
Until they called his parents there,  
Of the man who now saw with care.

19 They asked them saying "Is this your  
Son whom you say was blind before?  
Then how does he now see the score?"

20 His parents answered them and said  
"We know that this is our son bred,  
And that he was born blind before.

21 "But how he now sees, we don't know,  
Or who opened his eyes to show,

We do not know. He is of age,  
Ask him. He'll speak himself a page."  
22 His parents said these things because  
They feared the Jews, for the Jews laws  
Already agreed that if one  
Should confess him as the Christ done,  
He'd be cast out of synagogue.  
23 That's why his parents like a frog  
Said "He's of age, ask *demagogue*."

I guess I'd be cast out of synagogue  
Like any sort of ham or hock of hog,  
Or any sort of wet or dry of dog.  
It's not so much I'm convinced Jesus is  
The cock's crow or the hock's throw in the  
biz,

But that I am a personality  
Who always turns for underdog in spree.  
I am ashamed to admit that in score,  
Since I was once offended on the shore,  
When one Adventist leader said of me  
My wife had married me out of pity  
Because she's one to serve the underman  
Or underdog as the expression ran.  
I was offended, I've got pride in pan.

24 A second time they called the man  
Who had been blind, and said in plan,  
"Give glory to God. We know that  
This man's a sinner *where he sat*."

25 Then he replied and said "If he's  
A sinner, I don't know or tease.  
One thing I do know, I was blind,  
And now I see *front and behind*."

26 And they asked him again, "What did  
He do to you? How did he, kid,  
Open your eyes?" 27 He answered them,  
"I told you once, you did not hear.  
Why do you want to hear the gem  
Once more? Do you also desire  
To believe in him, join his quire?"

The man who's made to see becomes like  
this,  
Willing to speak to bishops not to miss  
With scorn and awful wit, without respect.  
That's why it's better to sit in neglect,  
Without Your blessing and without the  
light,

Content to follow every bishop's blight,  
And comforted in shadows of the night.  
To pray for healing and celestial sight

Is a prayer that requires forethought with care.

It's like to lead to persecution's share.

Beloved, keep me benighted in my room,  
The darling of the preachers of no doom,  
Kept sweet and humble, not to speak a word

Against the false shepherds of the false herd.

28 Then they reviled him and they said

"You're his disciple, but instead

We're Moses' disciples *well-bred*.

29 "We know God spoke by Moses, but  
This one, we do not know what gut  
Brought him from where *to here to strut*."

30 The man replied and said to them,  
"For there's a marvel here, that you  
Do not know from where he is true,  
And he opened my eyes to view.

Another marvel is that those men knew  
That You spoke to Moses before the crew,  
When he lived centuries before their view,  
And yet they could not take or misconstrue  
Whether this Jesus had come down from  
You.

I doubt they knew aught of Moses at last,  
But only treasured him because the blast  
Of what he had to answer had been stilled  
By the grave after Moses had been killed.  
The bosses love to take what they control,  
But living prophets are left on the dole.  
Beloved, by prophets living or the dead,  
Let me by Your own love and law be led,  
And let me do everything You have said.

31 "But we know God does not hear those  
Who are sinful upon their toes,  
But if anyone fears God and  
Does his will, He hears out of hand.

32 "From age to age never was heard  
That anyone, as it occurred,  
Opened the eyes of one born blind.

33 "If he was not from God behind,  
He could not do a thing in bind."

34 They answered and they said to him,  
"You were born wholly in sins dim,  
And do you teach us here with vim?"

They cast him from the synagogue,  
*As though he had been a wet dog.*

Methinks both sighted man and Pharisee  
Are wrong in their assumptions of the spree.

It does not follow that there is no sin,  
Just because You hear someone in the din.  
You may choose mercy on the outward spin.

A miracle is not good evidence  
That someone still abides within Your tents.

The Pharisee errs when he thinks the man  
Was born in sins because of blinded plan.  
Accusing You of punishment before  
The sin's an accusation on the floor  
I would not dare to make, Beloved, in score.

Beloved, the people I know think too much,  
And yet they are too thoughtless at the crutch.

35 Jesus heard they had thrown him out,  
And finding him, he asked him stout,  
"Do you believe God's son's about?"

36 And he replied and said "Who is  
He, sir, so I'll believe his biz?"

37 And Jesus said to him, "You now  
Have seen him and he anyhow

Is the one who speaks at your brow."

38 And he said "I believe, sir, true."  
He fell down in obeisance too.

Because the man falls down in worship's sting

The Trinitarian finds fruit to fling,  
And claims that Jesus is divine in wing,  
The God Almighty of which Christians sing.

The fact is the word's used for every king  
And what his subjects do in loyal ring.  
I kiss the hand of Jesus and I take  
Him for Messiah and Master in wake,  
I bow and scrape and fall flat on the ground,

But I take only You, Beloved, when found  
To be my God Almighty all around.  
You are no man and no man can be God.  
But Jesus is Your sent one on the sod.  
I follow You through him as by a rod.

39 And Jesus said "I came into  
This world for judgement, that those who  
Do not see may see, and the ones

Who see may be blinded, *by guns*.”  
40 And Pharisees with him heard this,  
And asked him, “Are we blind to miss?”  
41 And Jesus said to them, “If you  
Were blind, you’d have no sin in view.  
But now you say ‘We see!’ so you  
Remain in your own sinful pew.”

I’ve chosen blindness, my Beloved, and so  
I am a sinless one here in Your tow,  
Nor for my right and righteousness in glow,  
But by the grace that You come to bestow.  
I’ve chosen blindness, but I peek around  
And see the streams of light upon the  
ground,  
And know Your love and law come to  
resound  
Within my heart and soul, and I am bound.  
Beloved, though I choose blindness without  
sin,  
I find I’m cast out of the temple’s din,  
Out of the synagogue, the mosque and  
church,  
And all men leave me lounging in the  
lurch.  
But as I grope my way toward the true,  
I find me whirling ever around You.

### John 10

1 Truly indeed, I say to you,  
The one who does not enter through  
The door into the sheepfold true,  
But goes up by another way,  
That one’s a thief and robber *gay*.  
2 The one who enters through the door  
Is shepherd of the sheep *in store*.  
3 The keeper of the door will come  
To open to him, for the hum  
Of his voice that the sheep can hear  
Calls his own sheep by name to steer,  
And leads them out *by hand and ear*.  
4 And when he brings out his own sheep,  
He goes in front of them *to keep*,  
And the sheep follow him, for they  
Recognise his voice *in their way*.  
5 But they don’t follow strangers’ voice,  
But flee from them when they have choice,  
Because they do not recognise  
The voice of strangers *in its guise*.

I’m not sure that I want to be a sheep.  
I’d rather be a wild donkey to leap

Across the little hills and then to keep  
A rendez-vous with evening on the sands  
Of Cyprus where the monastery stands.  
A sheep’s so doleful, my Beloved, while I  
Am one adventuresome beneath the sky.  
Let me not follow You with heavy heart,  
With bleating and with complaint from the  
start.

Let me rather look skittishly and turn  
To find You vanishing where my loves  
burn,  
To find Your joyful tracks across the page  
Of scrawling Hebrew letters’ acreage  
In fields and meadows under skies that  
yearn.

6 And Jesus spoke this parable  
To them, but they did not see *full*  
What he was saying *that was wise*.  
7 Then Jesus said again to them,  
“Truly indeed, I say a gem  
To you, that I’m the sheep door here.  
8 “All who before me would appear  
Are thieves and robbers of the gear,  
But then the good sheep did not hear.  
9 “I am the door. If any man  
Comes in through me and by my plan,  
He will be saved and will go in,  
And will go out *and without sin*  
Will find the pastureland *and win*.  
10 “The thief just comes to steal and kill,  
Destroying all upon the hill.  
I came so they might live and still  
Live more abundantly *to grin*.  
11 “I am the good shepherd. The good  
Shepherd lays down his life or should  
For the sake of the sheep *that stood*.  
12 “A hired man who’s no shepherd, who  
Does not own the sheep, when in view  
Sees the wolf coming, he forsakes  
The sheep and runs away *from stakes*.  
And the wolf seizes them and scatters  
The sheep, *and that is all that matters*.  
13 “A hired man runs away, because  
He is a hired man, in his paws  
There’s no care for the sheep from claws.  
14 “I am the good shepherd, and I  
Know those who are mine, also my  
Own know me *when they come to try*.  
15 “Just as the Father knows me, I  
Also know the Father *in sky*,  
And lay down my life for the sheep.



When good Muhammad came to preach, he  
said

That Ali was the door of grace that led  
Into the city which Muhammad was.  
And after that in pain and sorrow's claws  
Imam Hussein come out to lay his head  
Upon the altar of sacrifice, bled  
And died for the folk that stood round his  
bed.

What Jesus did as one man on the earth,  
These three came once again and in their  
worth

Accomplished in a trinity the rest,  
The fold, the door, sacrifice of the best.  
Beloved, I take Your sent one on my breast  
And weep to see the anguish and the calm  
Enveloping the four beneath the palm.

16 "And I also have other sheep  
Which are not of this fold to keep.  
I also must lead those, and they  
Will hear my voice and will not stray,  
But there will be one flock one day,  
And only one shepherd in sway.

When the kind reader balks before the  
name  
Muhammad and Ali, Hussein of fame,  
Remember, my Beloved, sweet Jesus spoke  
Of other sheep he had before the stroke  
That cut him to the quick by Roman hand.  
Turn back the bias and the bigotry  
From both the Roman and the Meccan  
band,

And make the church and mosque both  
come to see  
That You called all back to the faith You  
planned  
And gave to Abraham to seek and hold.  
Beloved, wake in each breast the heart now  
cold  
To take Your sent one and step out more  
bold  
To Your obedience despite the shame  
Of epithet and the sectarian claim.

17 "That's why my Father loves me, for  
I lay down my life at the door,  
So I may take it up once more.

18 "No one takes it from me, but I  
Lay it down of myself *and cry*.

I have the power to lay it down,  
I have the power without a frown  
To take it up again, for I  
Received this order come from my  
Father." 19 And then an argument  
Arose among the Jews who spent  
Their time opposing these words sent.  
20 And many of them said "He's got  
A demon, he's insanely sot.  
Why do you listen to the rot?"  
21 And others said "But these are not  
The words of one demon-possessed.  
A demon, it must be confessed,  
Cannot open blind eyes addressed."

Both parties in the argument let by  
The crux of the matter in pun and sly.  
It's neither demon nor the healing hand  
That's evidence upon the questioned land.  
It's rather that he could lay down his life  
And take it up again before the strife,  
And with his taking give to all and more  
The right to enter in Paradise door.  
Beloved, in every argument around  
Discussing doctrines on a greener ground,  
The issue that's neglected is the one  
That is the central and the vital done.  
May I turn from the way of which and what  
And find Your loving heart is never shut.

22 It was the Feast of Dedication  
In *fair* Jerusalem, and *station*  
*Of* winter. 23 And then Jesus walked  
In the temple, in the *unlocked*  
Court of *king* Solomon *for ration*.  
24 And the Jews gathered round about  
Him saying, "How long keep in doubt?  
If You are Christ, say with a shout."

John's Gospel's writer is no Jew when  
done,  
Or he would not draw boundaries for one.  
And yet he knows throughout the book to  
show

When every festival arrives in glow.  
The feast of dedication, Hanukka  
Is what they say now at the light and draw.  
So Jesus celebrated that feast's light  
By walking in the temple in Your sight.  
Beloved, no one then thought of Christmas  
eve,

Or what a child should or should not  
believe  
About men decked out in miraculous  
As gods or santa clauses in the fuss.  
They walked as I today the winter streets  
Jerusalem provides for feastly treats.

25 Jesus replied to them, "I told  
You, and you don't believe cajoled.  
The deeds I do in my Dad's name,  
They testify about my fame.  
26 "But you do not believe, because  
You're not my own sheep in my paws,  
As I told you. 27 "My sheep hear my  
Voice and I know them, since by choice  
They follow me. 28 "And I grant them  
Eternal life so like a gem  
They'll never tarnish, none shall stand  
At all to grab them from my hand.  
29 "My Father who gave them to me  
Is greater than the company,  
So nobody can grab them out  
Of my Father's hand *with a shout*.  
30 "I and *as my without a doubt*  
Father are one *in goal and clout*."

St. John above all writers of the tale  
Of Jesus who have ever set the sail  
Remembers to bring up the victory  
Of Jesus' life over the deadly sea.  
I hear the rustling of a ready mark  
Of reason thrust upon the earthly dark:  
One cannot come back in the pleasant park  
By carrying out regulations stark.  
It takes a human hand to lead and bring  
Into the filling sanctuary ark.  
It takes a mediator on the wing  
Who's tasted death and rose again to sing.  
The victory of life and death in sum  
I sip and startled find what I become.

31 The Jews again gathered up stones  
To kill him and to break his bones.  
32 Then Jesus came to answer them,  
"I showed you many good works from  
My Father, for which work of them  
Do you stone me *by stratagem*?"  
33 The Jews answered him saying "We  
Do not stone you for good work's fee,  
But only for your blasphemy,  
Because you, who are but a man,  
Make yourself to be God in span."

34 Jesus answered them, "Has it not  
Been written in your Law some spot,  
'I said, you're elohim in lot.'  
35 "If He called those gods with whom that  
Word of God was, and with whom sat,  
And Scripture's not broken by that,  
36 "Do you say of the one the Father  
Sanctified and sent the world rather,  
'You blaspheme, because I have said  
'I am the son of God *and led*?'"

The meaning of the broad word elohim  
Is key to understanding things that seem.  
It opens up the first verses of John,  
And shows the trinity as merely pawn.  
The cry of blasphemy is too fast made:  
Only You, my Beloved, are on parade  
To show the true, and so the judgement's  
stayed  
Until You rise to make a newer dawn.  
Beloved, as I read here and there Your  
word,  
Let me not understand it like the herd  
Who drink the Roman wine and tipples  
down

Into the lanes in maze beneath the town.  
Beloved, bring Jesus' wonder and new light  
Illuminating Your word in the night.

37 "If I do not do the works of  
My Father, don't believe my *love*.  
38 "But if I do, even if you  
Do not believe me, believe true  
The works, that you may see and so  
Believe that the Father does show  
In me and I in Him *to go*."  
39 Then once again they tried to take  
Him. And he went out of their stake.  
40 And he went out again across  
The Jordan to the place where *boss*  
John was at first baptising and  
So he remained there *in that land*.  
41 And many came to him and said  
"John truly did no sign instead,  
But all the things that John has said  
About this one were truly led."  
42 And many came to believe then  
In him *beside Jordan again*.

Though Jesus is Your word again made  
flesh,  
I see it ever again shining fresh

In all the works divine on earthly mesh:  
 The patterns of the diamonds in snow  
 That lie in acres infertile to glow,  
 The twist of birch, the straight of fir, the  
     ply  
 Of pine against a lapis lazuli  
 Domed crazily incredible of cloud  
 And the deception of the wind aloud.  
 Beloved, the very works speak wordlessly  
 Across the hopes of my eternity  
 Announcing on the pages left unbare  
 The writing of divinity on air.

### John 11

1 A certain one was sick, by name  
 Lazarus of Bethany's fame,  
 From the same village from which came  
 Mary and her sister Martha.  
 2 And it was Mary who in awe  
 Anointed the lord with the oil  
 And wiped his feet with her hair's coil,  
 Whose brother Lazarus was sick.  
 3 The sisters sent a message quick  
 To him and said "Sir, do behold,  
 One whom you love is sick and cold."  
 4 Jesus heard and he said "It's not  
 Sickness to death, but for the plot  
 Of God's glory, that by it may  
 The son of God know glory's way."  
 5 And Jesus loved Martha and her  
 Sister and Lazarus *in spur*.  
 6 That's why, when he heard he was sick,  
 Indeed, he stayed in the place thick  
 Where he was for two days to stick.  
 7 Then after this he told his friends,  
 "Let's go back to Judaea's ends."

When the synoptics feel by memory  
 Or trick of statement from disciplery  
 That Jesus rarely used the word to say  
 He's son of God, I wonder at the play.  
 For the synoptics son of God just means  
 That Jesus is Messiah on the scenes,  
 A man descended from David at last  
 To reign upon the throne that was outcast.  
 But John loves the term all the more to  
     bring  
 The message that Jesus is one to sing,  
 Life-giver is the hint upon the string.  
 Beloved, You are life-giver, both to him  
 And to those he might resurrect and trim.  
 So can I take you both to be my king?

8 Disciples said to him, "Rabbi,  
 Just recently the Jews would try  
 To stone you, and now would you go  
 Back there again and dare to show?"  
 9 Jesus replied, "Are there not twelve  
 Hours in the day? If any delve  
 And walk in the day, he does not  
 Stumble, because he see a lot  
 Of light that lightens the world's plot.  
 10 "But if a man walks in the night,  
 He stumbles because then the light  
 Is not in him *nor in his sight*."  
 11 He said these things. And after this,  
 He said to them, "Our friend to miss,  
 Called Lazarus, has gone to sleep.  
 But I'll go and wake him to keep."  
 12 Then his disciples said "Sir, if  
 He's gone to sleep, he is no stiff,  
 But will recover from the tiff."  
 13 But Jesus talked about his death,  
 While they thought he spoke of the breath  
 Of slumber. 14 So then Jesus said  
 To them clearly, "The man is dead.  
 15 "And I rejoice because of you,  
 So you may have faith in what's true,  
 Since I was not there, but let's go  
 Now to him *and keep up the show*."  
 16 Then Thomas, who was called the Twin,  
 Told his fellow disciples' chin,  
 "Let's go, we also, that we may  
 Die with him in the coming fray."

My brother twin, my Thomas, be so brave,  
 But I doubt too he'd go down to the grave  
 With Jesus with such desperation's wave.  
 And yet You give him all the chance he  
     needs  
 To see the dead man rise up in the weeds  
 Well washed and wrapped and spoken for  
     in seeds.

I wonder who it was that washed the man,  
 And if it was a sister as in plan.  
 I wonder was he then embarrassed when  
 He met the two again out of the den.  
 So Thomas has no fear, embarrassment,  
 But only rushes to the washing tent  
 Too late to see the act or to prevent  
 The female desecration of the gent.

17 When Jesus came, he found him there  
 Already in the tomb for share

Of four days. 18 The town Bethany  
 Was near Jerusalem's degree,  
 Of fifteen stadia from the din.  
 19 And many of the Jews had come  
 To those around Martha to hum,  
 And Mary, that they might console  
 Them for the brother *in the hole*.  
 20 When Martha heard Jesus was coming,  
 She met him. But Mary was humming  
 At home. 21 Then Martha came to say  
 To Jesus, "Sir, if *on that day*  
 You had been here, my brother dear  
 Would not have died, *I have no fear*.  
 22 "But even now I know what you  
 May ask of God, God will give you."  
 23 Jesus told her, "Your brother will  
 Rise once again *upon the hill*."  
 24 Martha told him, "I know he will  
 Rise up again in the last day  
 When resurrection comes to stay."

Belief in resurrection day depends  
 On history of Hellenistic bends,  
 The killing of the righteous and the way  
 Of leaving apostates to rule the day.  
 So hope in retribution that must come  
 After death made the rabbi doctors hum.  
 The Pharisaic faith in jumping from  
 The grave is really also one that Your  
 Sent one digs up in hope upon the shore  
 Of what Elijah and Elisha did.  
 The life that stays in one that came and hid  
 In You and laid hand on Your grace alone  
 To give us back the tree and so atone,  
 To open Paradise beneath Your throne.

25 Jesus said "I'm the resurrection  
 And the life. Who makes my selection  
 Will live though he die *in confecton*.  
 26 And everyone who lives and who  
 Believes in me shall not die through  
 The age for ever. Now do you  
 Believe that what I say is true?"  
 27 She told him, "Yes, sir, I've believed  
 You are the Christ and so received,  
 The son of God who came into  
 The world *to bring life into view*."  
 28 After she said these things, she went  
 Away and called her sister meant  
 In secret, saying "The Rabbi  
 Is here and calls you to come nigh."  
 29 When she heard that she got right up

And came to him, 30 where with his cup  
 Jesus not in the village yet,  
 But in the place where Martha met.  
 31 Then the Jews with her in the house  
 To comfort her saw her go raus  
 So quickly getting up to go,  
 They followed her, saying in row,  
 "She's going to the tomb to grieve."  
 32 When Mary came to Jesus' sleeve  
 And saw him, she fell at his feet  
 And said to him, "Sir, if your seat  
 Had been here, my brother's defeat  
 Would not have come in death unswet."  
 33 When he saw that she wept and Jews  
 Came down with her weeping in shoes,  
 Jesus groaned in the spirit and  
 Troubled himself right there to stand.

It was quite right that Jesus groan a bit  
 When he saw Mary in her grieving's fit.  
 He only thought of his own glory when  
 He doddled on the way with his own men.  
 He wanted Lazarus to die and tear  
 The hearts of Mary and Martha a share  
 Just so he could raise up the dead and take  
 More gratitude and glory for their sake.  
 Beloved, it was right he should have regrets  
 For bringing suffering on his own life pets.  
 I'm glad I was not born to be Messiah  
 And always have to be cruel pariah,  
 Forgetful of the fact that people grieve,  
 Cut to the heart for my little reprieve.

34 And he said "Where have you put him?"  
 They told him, "Sir, come see the brim."  
 35 Then Jesus wept. 36 Then the Jews said  
 "See how he loved him!" 37 But some said  
 "Was he who opened blind eyes not  
 Able to keep his friend from plot  
 Of death?" 38 Then groaning once again,  
 Jesus came to the tomb and den,  
 A stone lay on the opening.  
 39 Jesus said "Lift the stone from spring."  
 Martha the sister of the dead  
 Said to him, "Sir, he stinks instead,  
 For it's the fourth day from the spread.  
 40 Jesus told her, "Did I not say  
 To you that if you'd give faith sway  
 You'll see God's glory *here outspread*?"

Martha's a practical sort who knows well  
 That bodies in the grave will come to smell.

The cautious character I have to spell  
Is why I'm not successful in the dell.  
Success means pushing forward every day  
To catch the business that might come your  
way.

Instead I keep my hermit's shell and pay  
No mind to chances to gain pence and  
pound.

Instead I keep my eye on all around  
That makes no cents: the ants upon the  
ground

That give an earnest example of work,  
The grasshopper that rather comes to shirk,  
The firs that sing the melodies in praise  
Of You, Beloved. Such are my simple  
days.

41 And so they lifted up the stone  
Where the dead one was laid alone.  
And Jesus lifted eyes above  
And said "Father, I thank Your love  
That You heard me. 42 I know that You  
Always hear me, but for the view  
Of the crowd standing all around,  
I say so they'll believe You're found."

43 And saying these things, he cried out  
With a loud voice, "*Lazarus stout!*  
*Come out here now without a doubt!*"

44 And the one who had died came out,  
The feet and hands still bound in sheets,  
And his face covered with the pleats  
Of a cloth. Jesus said to them,  
"Cut him loose and let go the hem."

45 Then many Jews with Mary come  
Saw what Jesus had done in sum  
And they believed he was a gem.

I might have thought him more a ghost so  
bound

In cloths and rags around the head and  
gowned.

But some men were so cool there to be  
found,

That when dead Lazarus stood on the  
ground,

They ran forward and unloosed all the  
mound

Of white that had been buried with him  
sound.

Beloved, when Your sent one calls out to  
me,

Though I may be dead on my bed to see,

Let me get up and follow in my shroud,  
Praising Your name in syllables aloud.  
Beloved, when Jesus calls in this life's  
woes,

From toils and trials, from heartaches and  
from blows,

Let me not hesitate more than one dead  
To rise up and to follow where I'm led.

46 But some went to the Pharisees,  
And told them what Jesus *with ease*  
Had done. 47 Also then the chief priests  
And Pharisees gathered the beasts  
Of a Sanhedrin and said "What  
To do, for this man is not shut  
From doing miracles in glut?

48 "If we leave him alone this way,  
All will believe in him someday,  
The Romans will come take away  
From us both place and nation's sway."

49 But one of them, Caiaphas,  
Who was the high priest that year passed,  
Said to them, "You know nothing here.

50 "You don't consider profit's gear,  
How it is better one man die  
In place of the people awry,  
And not all the nation pass by."

51 He did not say this of himself,  
But being high priest on the shelf  
That year, he prophesied Jesus  
Was soon to die for the folk's muss,

52 And not just for the nation, but  
That he also might gather shut  
Into one the children of God  
Who had been scattered on the sod.

The death of Jesus was the substitute  
For death of more to face the Roman brute.  
That pagan attitude has always been  
The first recourse of folks met by their sin.  
And yet it was true that his death alone  
Could cancel all the hopes failed to atone.  
Your kingdom in the patriarchal day,  
The judges, kings, and after goes the way  
Of destitution. All hopes of good men  
That Your kingdom might rise and rule  
again

Are failures. There is only one recourse:  
The demonstration of that Roman horse.  
All hopes of power must die, all crucified  
Before the onslaught of the human tide.

53 Then from that day they made their plan  
 How and when they might kill the man.  
 54 Then Jesus did no more appear  
 In public in the Jewish sphere,  
 But went away from there into  
 The land of a deserted view,  
 A city called by Ephraim,  
 And stayed there with some friends of him.  
 55 The Jewish Passover was near,  
 And many went up to the pier  
 Into Jerusalem from there  
 Before the Passover with care  
 To purify themselves in share.  
 56 They looked for Jesus and they said  
 To one another, standing spread  
 In the temple, "How does it seem?  
 Will he come to the feast *or dream?*"  
 57 And all the chief priests and also  
 The Pharisees gave orders low  
 That if anyone knew where he  
 Was he should so inform the see,  
 So they could capture him in spe.

The true faith's always in a secret place,  
 Found in the desert, despite Matthew's trace  
 Not to believe the voice that says that he  
 Is found a-lurking in eternity.  
 The true faith's not in institutions grand,  
 But in the humble hovels on the sand,  
 Among the teeming crowds, and yet so  
 small  
 That it would seem choked by the din and  
 gall.  
 Beloved, let me meet Jesus in the nest  
 Away from bishop's hall among the best,  
 Where tiny voices rise to praise Your  
 name,  
 And little eyes and ears welcome Your  
 fame,  
 Until the twilight turns into the night  
 To wait the morning prayer before the  
 light.

19 The Pharisees said to themselves,  
 "See that you gain nothing on shelves,  
 See how the world goes after him."

It's Pharisees started the Baptist church.  
 They're the ones who got on the racing  
 perch  
 And started competition for the names

Of members who come join them in their  
 games.

The bigger the church better is the pastor,  
 The fighting starts and that is a disaster  
 When they decide if a new roof is faster  
 Than new pews or piano foot in castor.  
 The numbers game was started by that crew  
 That was so jealous of the Jesus few.  
 But Jesus tried to tell them all he wanted  
 In congregation was just three or two.  
 But no, the Pharisees were sure he vaunted.  
 Religious murder by numbers ain't new.

20 And there were some Greeks among  
 those

Who came up to worship in rows  
 At the feast. 21 These came to Philip,  
 The one from Bethsaida a trip  
 To Galilee, and asked and said  
 "Sir, we would be to Jesus led."

22 And Philip came and told Andrew,  
 And Andrew and Philip, the two  
 Told Jesus. 23 But Jesus replied  
 To them and said "The hour of pride  
 That son of man be glorified.

24 "Truly indeed, I say to you,  
 If the grain of wheat that falls to  
 The earth does not die, it remains  
 Alone. But if it dies, it gains  
 Much fruit. 25 "The one who loves his life  
 Loses it, and who hates his life  
 In this world will keep it instead  
 To everlasting life then led.

26 "If anyone serve me, let him  
 Follow me, and where I am trim,  
 There my servant will also be.

And if anyone will serve me,  
 The Father will come honour him.

27 "And my soul's troubled, and what may  
 I say? Dad, save me from this stay?

But because of this I have come  
 Up to this time *with grief unspun.*

28 "Father, glorify Your name now."

Then a voice came from heaven somehow:

"I both glorified it and now

I'll glorify again, *I trow.*"

29 The crowd that stood and heard said that  
 The thunder ran and thundered flat.

Others said an angel said that.

If every time You speak, Beloved, the  
 crowd

Is disagreed on what they heard aloud,  
 Then the report of Sinai must be bent  
 Selecting only what the one side meant.  
 The ones who heard You say they ought to  
     keep  
 The first day Sunday were then made to  
     weep,  
 And could not get their view recorded by  
 Moses who was a biased sort of guy.  
 It is a great thing that Jesus came in  
 To correct that outrageous sort of sin,  
 For by the time a hundred years had passed  
 At least some were keeping the Sunday  
     crassed.  
 It happened first in Rome, I hear, so I  
 Guess the Greeks spread a different reply.

30 Jesus answered and said "This voice  
 Has not come down for my own choice,  
 But because of you, so rejoice.  
 31 "Now is the judgement of this world;  
 Now is this world ruler uncurled.  
 32 "And I, if I be lifted up  
 From earth, I'll draw all to my cup.  
 33 "But he said this to show by which  
 Kind of death was about to pitch  
 Him out of life into the ditch.  
 34 The crowd replied to him, "We heard  
 Out of the Law that Christ is stirred  
 To stay for ever. How can you  
 Say son of man's lifted in view?  
 Who is this son of man, be true?"

In those days it was easy on hearsay  
 To know the Torah told Messiah's way  
 Was this or that to hear the donkeys bray.  
 Whatever people thought in hopeful sigh  
 Might throw down empires beneath a brass  
     sky  
 Was well attributed to Moses' pen,  
 Or that of some other prophet again  
 Trembling with age beneath a wrinkled  
     wen.  
 Truth is the texts that promise anything  
 Like a Messiah, sufferer or king,  
 Are few and star between a franker bill,  
 No matter what, obedience to Your will.  
 Beloved, save me and greater humankind  
 By what You will, but keep me in Your  
     bind.

35 Then Jesus told them, "Yet a while

The light is with you without guile.  
 Walk while you have the light to shine,  
 So the dark does not break your vine.  
 The one who walks in dark does not  
 Know where he's going in the plot.  
 36 "While you have light, believe the light,  
 So you may become sons of light."  
 Jesus spoke these things and was gone  
 Away and hidden from their *dawn*.

The light of Christ is gone since he arose  
 Into the cloud where every good one goes:  
 Enoch, Elijah and Muhammad's pose,  
 The guided one before Abbasid nose.  
 The light of Christ is hidden from the view  
 Of all men but the chosen three or two  
 Who in his name are gathered in their pew  
 Reciting the Four Books ever anew.  
 Beloved, I walk in light that shines abroad  
 From inner temple where the ark is shod  
 To shelter day and night the tables set,  
 The fleshly tables where Your Law is met.  
 So may I be a child of light within  
 A world still darkened by its sleep and sin.

37 But his doing so many signs  
 Before them did not stop their whines  
 Who failed to believe in his lines.  
 38 So the word of Isaiah prophet  
 Might be fulfilled up to a soffit,  
 When he said "Lord, who has believed  
 Our word, and who now has received  
 The revelation of YHWH's arm?"  
 39 That's why they could not believe, since  
 Isaiah said again to wince,  
 40 "He has come to blind their eyes" and  
 "Has hardened their heart" in the land  
 "So they might not see with the eyes"  
 And "understand with the heart cries  
 "And be converted" in that wise,  
 "And I should heal them" *of their sties*.  
 41 Isaiah said these things when he  
 Saw his glory and spoke in spe.

I doubt not that Isaiah saw the light  
 And spoke of future hopes in words aright.  
 But I doubt that the very words he chose  
 Were written of Messiah's pains and throes.  
 There are no doubt some words in  
     prophecy,  
 But most of them are written in degree  
 Of those who hear Isaiah, came to see.

Fulfilment of the words happened that day  
 His hearers saw Your word in strength to  
 play,  
 And were fulfilled each time and from that  
 time  
 Your children lived according to that  
 rhyme.  
 Beloved, let glory behind every stall  
 Come out illuminating all in all,  
 And I shall rush to enter in the call.

42 And yet even from ruling class  
 Many did believe in his pass.  
 But because of the Pharisees  
 They did not confess it with ease,  
 So they would not be put out from  
 The synagogues daily to hum.  
 43 For they loved more glory of men  
 More than glory of God again.

The bitterness of John to say these words  
 Turns to a comfort as I see the herds  
 That enter church and mosque without a  
 thought  
 Of truth and light, the very things I sought.  
 It is a comfort to know that there be  
 A multitude upon the rising sea  
 Who have faith in You and Your word of  
 light,  
 But fear to separate from reigning night.  
 You know the heart and motive and You  
 take  
 Your own out of the hands of church and  
 stake  
 And set Your loved ones in Your heart  
 alone  
 To live before Your own celestial throne.  
 I stand with two or three and yet I know  
 The myriads of Your children join the row.

44 But Jesus cried and said aloud,  
 "The one who believes in me does  
 Not believe in just me who was,  
 But in the One who sent me here.  
 45 "And the one who sees me revealed  
 Sees the One who sent me appealed.  
 46 "I've come as a light to the world,  
 And everyone who's faith's unfurled  
 In me may not stay in dark curled.  
 47 "And if anyone hears my words  
 And do not believe with the herds,  
 I do not judge him, for I did

Not come to judge the world, but hid  
 That I might save the world *on skid*.  
 48 "The one who rejects me not to  
 Receive my words is judged in view  
 Of the word which I spoke and which  
 Will judge him the last day in pitch.  
 49 "For I did not speak from myself,  
 But He who sent me, Dad *on shelf*,  
 He's given me command what I  
 Should say and what to speak thereby.  
 50 "And I know that His commandment  
 Is everlasting life *and sent*.  
 Then what things I speak as Dad said  
 To me, so I speak them as led."

If Jesus does not judge one who rejects  
 His name and fame, but sees the world  
 selects  
 The purity on the last day to make  
 Even the blasphemer a child in stake,  
 I rise to praise You when the reddened sky  
 Turns all the world around me coloured by  
 The dawn a place of worship. Here I stand  
 In harmony with all the frozen land,  
 The tinselled trees, the sparkled frozen  
 snow,  
 The ice-flakes on the fields that go and go  
 In furlongs hidden finally behind  
 The wilderness of sighted and the blind.  
 The word and not the flesh is of the kind  
 To bring eternal life. I am resigned.

## John 12

1 Six days before Passover, came  
 Jesus to Bethany, the same  
 Where Lazarus was who had died,  
 The one he raised up *and untied*.  
 2 They made a supper there for him  
 And Martha served and did it trim.  
 But Lazarus was one of those  
 Reclining with him in his rows.  
 3 Then taking a pound of pure oil  
 Of costly spikenard not to spoil,  
 Mary anointed Jesus' feet  
 And wiped off his feet to complete  
 With her hair, till the whole house filled  
 With the scent of the ointment spilled.  
 4 Then Simon's son, one of his own  
 Disciples, Judas as was known  
 Iscariot, who would betray  
 Him very soon, was heard to say  
 5 "Why was this ointment not sold for



Three hundred denarii in store  
And the price given to the poor?"  
6 But he said this, not that he cared  
For the poor, but because he was  
A thief and he carried the shared  
Moneybag and filled up his claws.

This think is very slander, to accuse  
Without proof that Judas came to abuse  
Position as the treasurer to take  
Sums for himself out of the common stake.  
John ought to offer proof that it was so.  
Instead he piles this calumny to glow,  
Because he knows that we sweet Christians  
here

Would not think to defend Judas for cheer.  
But is it not enough the man must bear  
The shame of his betrayal without share  
Of such embezzlement beyond the crime?  
For shame! He truly thought the scent of  
lime

A waste of funds. Beloved, I know the guy  
Will go to hell. But let it be for why.

7 Then Jesus said "Leave her alone,  
For she's kept it for the day's groan  
Of when I shall be the grave's own.  
8 "For the poor you may always know,  
But not always have me in show."  
9 Then a great crowd of Jews heard he  
Was there. And they came not to see  
Jesus alone, but also to  
Take Lazarus again in view,  
Whom he raised from the dead *in pew*.  
10 But the chief priests took counsel that  
They might put Lazarus on mat  
To death also, 11 because through him  
Many Jews went away and trim  
Believed on Jesus *and with vim*.

The rulers are ready to set aside  
Any law for the interest and the pride  
Of state. I've seen the same in principle  
And practice in Iranian chapel.  
So Lazarus must die, though You raised  
him  
To life. Such action on Your part was dim,  
And did not take reactions set and trim  
Into consideration in Your vim.  
O my Beloved, where's Lazarus now that  
The centuries have set us on our mat?  
For all I know he's had to die here twice,

Which was neither just nor anything nice.  
Unless, of course, in resurrecting many  
You took them all to Paradise for penny.

12 On the next day, coming to feast,  
Hearing that Jesus came at least  
Into Jerusalem, a crowd  
13 Took palm branches and went allowed  
To meet him, and they cried aloud,  
"Hosanna! Blessing to the one  
Coming in the name of the Lord,  
The king of Israel adored!"  
14 And finding a donkey colt spun,  
Jesus sat on it as was writ,  
15 "Do not fear, Zion's daughter fit.  
Behold, your king comes in to sit  
Upon the foal of an ass *won*."

The royal seat in David's kingdom is  
A donkey, not a horse or mule to whiz.  
That's why the man took donkeys in his  
way

For transportation on that far-off day.  
The palm branch and the shouting raise a  
stir  
About the twitching ears as though a blur  
Could turn the air to gold, and crown a cur.  
And yet the party never will see May.  
Beloved, the king rides ever under sun,  
As though the happiness, though never  
won,  
Should never disappear for what man's  
done.  
The king is always riding in the street  
Towards the gates of Zion for a treat,  
And I look out at dusk empty, complete.

16 But his disciples did not know  
These things at the first time to go,  
But when Jesus was glorified,  
Then they remembered in their pride  
These things had been written of him,  
And that they did these things to him.  
17 Then the crowd which was with him  
when  
He called Lazarus out to men  
From the tomb and raised from the dead,  
They witnessed then of what he said.  
18 Because of this also the crowd  
Met him, because they heard aloud  
Of this sign he had done instead.

For many signs, Beloved, I raise a cry  
 In witness and a hue to answer why.  
 For many signs I wait the narrow set  
 To find a sharper name than any met.  
 The friends of Jesus are not a dense lot,  
 Despite not knowing anything in plot.  
 Time teaches all things, and the day that's  
     bright  
 Becomes but brighter each succeeding  
     night.  
 I meet the Christ among the shouting  
     crowd,  
 I meet him in the singleness and shroud,  
 I meet the seamless robe and touch his hem  
 To find the magic tsitsit and by them  
 Am transfixed on a moment to stand still  
 Before eternity upon my hill.

### John 13

1 And before the Passover Feast,  
 Jesus knowing his hour increased,  
 That he should move from this world to  
 The Father, loving his own who  
 Are in the world. He loved them to  
 The end. 2 And supper being done,  
 The Devil put in the heart won  
 Of Judas who was Simon's son,  
 Known as Iscariot, that he  
 Should betray him *by false degree*.

Some think the Devil's not a being made  
 Like other creatures here and on parade,  
 But just the evil principle that's found  
 Within the human heart when it's unbound.  
 The truth is, if that's so, the human heart  
 Is not a pretty place or pretty part.  
 I'd rather think old nick truly had horns  
 And was a trusty deil to meet my scorns.  
 I'd rather think that Judas had a soul  
 Of wonder and of faith before the toll  
 That entered suddenly and dimmed the  
     bowl.

But if it had to be but lifeless toil  
 Of wickedness upon the human soil,  
 I trow it is enough in tightened coil.

3 Jesus knew the Father gave all  
 Things into his hand and in thrall,  
 And that he came out from God, and  
 Went away to God from the land,  
 4 He rose up from the supper and  
 Set off his garments. Then he took

A towel and tucked it in the nook  
 At his waist. 5 He poured water out  
 Into the basin and was stout  
 To start to wash disciples' feet,  
 And to wipe off with towel complete  
 Around his waist. 6 And then he came  
 To Simon Peter. He for shame  
 Told him, "Sir, do you wash my feet?"  
 7 Jesus replied and said to him,  
 "What I do you perceive as dim,  
 But you will later see things trim."  
 8 Peter told him, "You never will  
 Wash my feet for ever and still."  
 Jesus replied to him, "If I  
 Do not wash you, then you will die  
 Without a part in my last try."  
 9 Then Simon Peter said to him,  
 "Lord, not my feet only *for limb*,  
 But also *my hands and my head!*"

Good Peter is a Muslim in his heart:  
 He wants to wash his head and hands to  
     start,  
 And then his feet to keep all three apart.  
 That's how the Muslim starts his daily  
     prayer  
 With his ablutions done with love and care.  
 But Peter there mistook the task then set.  
 It was not an ablution he had met,  
 But rather humble hospitality  
 That Jesus tried to instil in the free.  
 Let me accept the coming of the lord,  
 The washing of my feet by the adored,  
 Meet You with clean hands in the works I  
     may,  
 And clean feet in the paths I come to stray,  
 And clean head in the thoughts I bear away.

10 But Jesus told him then and said,  
 "He who is bathed need only wash  
*His* feet, but is completely clean,  
 And you're clean, but not all of you."  
 11 For he knew who should betray him;  
 That's why he said "You're not all trim."  
 12 So after he had washed the dew  
 Off their feet, and had taken cue  
 Of his garments, and sat back down,  
 He said to them, "Upon your crown,  
 Do you know what I've done to you?"  
 13 "You call me master and your lord,  
 And you say well: I'm so adored.  
 14 "If I your lord and master then

Have washed your feet, you in your den  
Also ought to wash the feet of  
One another *and done in love*.  
15 "I've given you example here  
To do as I have done with cheer.  
16 "Truly, indeed, I say to you,  
The servant's not greater in view  
Than his lord, neither he that's sent  
Greater than he who sent *in tent*.  
17 "If you know these things, happy are  
You if you do them *under star*.

Some find the rite of washing feet is fine  
Before the taking of the bread and wine,  
A practice I think not so bad a thing,  
And yet I'd rather go beyond the wing.  
The washing of the other's feet is not  
Enough in regulation and in plot.  
The mind of service to each one I see  
That bears upon his face divinity  
Is washing that will last eternally,  
Beyond my dissolution in the sea  
Of universe or after I have risen  
Into the skies and put off carnal prison.  
A greater lord I find in every way  
I turn between the sweet night and the day.

18 "I don't speak of you all. I know  
Whom I have chosen on the go.  
But that the Scripture might fulfil,  
The one who eats bread at my sill  
With me has lifted up his heel  
Against me. 19 "Now I tell the deal  
To you before it happens, so  
When it comes to pass, you may know,  
Believing I am he *to show*.  
20 "Truly indeed, I say to you,  
The one who receives one I send  
Receives me, and the one that's penned  
To receive me receives the One  
That sent me *to the world undone*.  
21 When Jesus had said so, then he  
Was troubled in his spirit wee,  
And testified and said "Truly,  
Indeed, I say to you that one  
Of you'll betray me *before done*."

The trouble in the loving heart of Christ  
Was not that betrayal at once enticed  
Him to feel sorry for himself before  
The trial of the sweat and blood and gore.

What weighed upon that spirit sweet and  
good  
Was that the one he loved as lover should,  
Could fall beneath the hammered stroked in  
pale,  
Satanic attack from beyond the veil.  
The troubled heart bled for the loved one  
that  
Was rushing toward the darkness and the  
vat  
Of non-existence and the silent room  
That was to be the blind man's final doom.  
Beloved, You too look on in horror when  
The good fails in the heart of better men.

22 Then the disciples looked around  
In doubt of whom he spoke the sound.  
23 Now there leaned on Jesus' breast one  
Of his disciples, whom *for fun*  
Jesus loved. 24 Simon Peter then  
Motioned to him to ask again  
Who it should be of whom he spoke.  
25 The one leaning as for a stroke  
On Jesus' breast said to him, "Sir,  
Who is the one to make such stir?"  
26 Jesus replied, "It is the bloke  
To whom I'll give a sop to croak  
When I have dipped it." And when he  
Had dipped the sop, he gave freely  
To Judas Iscariot, son  
Of the *unfortunate* Simon.

In Turkey, where I met Hajji Küresh  
Beneath the terebinthine tangled mesh  
To taste the newly sacrificial flesh  
Of little goats relieved of their life fresh,  
I sat beside the eater at the dance  
Of bride and groom and at each hungry  
glance  
Received a morsel and a sop to eat.  
I sat upon the ground where dancing feet  
Turned round and round again in timing  
fleet.  
Beloved, I take the sop and so betray  
The love I have for You from day to day.  
I taste the sweeter gift that You bestow  
And whirl about in ecstasy to show  
Me back to where I rest upon Your stay.

27 And after the sop Satan came  
Into him. Then Jesus was game  
To say to him, "What you will do,

Do quickly before all the crew.”  
28 Now no one at the table knew  
Why he spoke this to him in view.  
29 Some of them thought, since Judas had  
The bag, that Jesus told him, “Lad,  
Buy the things we need for the feast,  
Or to give to the poor at least.”

It is a worthy thing to see the lad  
Set out to do the evil job well clad  
In hopeful accolades that he's not bad.  
The positive is always better writ  
Than pessimism before final fit.  
It is a worthy thing disciples saw  
Iscariot go out without a claw,  
The door shut on his last chance under law.  
Beloved, though I am given the command  
To go betraying Your sent one at hand,  
I turn and twist and loiter at the door,  
Both loathe to step out on the darkened  
shore,  
And loathe to leave the Saviour evermore.  
I think at least about the worthy poor.

30 So when he took the sop he went  
Straight out into the night as meant.  
31 When he'd gone out, then Jesus said  
“Now is the son of man out spread  
In glory, and God in him too  
Is glorified *for all in view*.”  
32 If God is glorified in him,  
God shall also no glory dim  
Give him in himself and right off  
Shall glorify him *and not scoff*.  
33 But little children, yet a while  
I am with you. And without guile  
You shall seek me, and as I said  
To the Jews, where I am to go  
You cannot come, so now I show  
To you. 34 A new commandment I  
Give to you, that you love nearby  
One the other as I've loved you,  
That you also love each one true.  
35 By this shall all men know that you  
Are my disciples, if you love  
One the other *like hand in glove*.  
36 Then Simon Peter said to him,  
“Sir, where's it you are going trim?”  
Jesus answered him, “Where I go,  
You cannot follow me, but slow  
Afterward you will follow me.”  
37 And Peter said to him, “Sir, why

Can I not follow you nearby?  
I will lay down my life for you.”  
38 Jesus replied to him, “Will you  
Lay down your life for my sake too?  
Truly indeed, I say to you,  
The cock shall not crow till you make  
Denial three times for my sake.”

The sop is what will separate the true  
And false among disciples come anew.  
The gain beyond the moneybag is sure  
To separate the guilty from the pure.  
Beloved, I too ask Jesus where he goes,  
And whether he'll return and take repose  
Within the chambered meeting of my heart,  
Or whether he will linger there apart.  
All lives are laid down in his humble cause:  
The Jewish festivals are given pause  
To question what to do with Jesus now.  
Islamic prophet comes to teach all men  
To take him as the Christ and prophet then,  
Not rejecting, or making a god's den.

#### John 14

1 Let not your heart be troubled, you  
Believe in God, believe me too.  
2 In my Father's house there are found  
Many mansions: were it not bound,  
I would have told you. So I go  
To prepare a place for your row.  
3 And if I go prepare a place  
For you, I'll come back in a race  
To take you to myself, so where  
I am, you also may be there.

The promise is that while he is away,  
Jesus will be making ready the day  
When he will come again to find his own  
And take them to himself in flesh and bone.  
The cleansing of the sanctuary or  
The sweeping of the house up to the door  
Is the task of that High Priest by Your  
throne.

Beloved, I find around me many say  
That he is not preparing any home,  
The only temple is a church in Rome.  
While others kiss the crucifix, I stand  
Alone upon the rocky shore and sand,  
Just waiting for the touch of Jesus' hand  
To take me away from the Roman band.

4 And where I go, you know the way.

5 Thomas said to him, "Sir, I say,  
We don't know where you're going to,  
So how can we know the way through?"  
6 Jesus said to him, "I'm the way,  
The truth, and the life, no men stray  
To the Father except by me.

Jesus embodies ten commandment law,  
And so he is the way to walk in awe.  
He is the truth indeed, for nothing's more  
The truth than what You said upon the  
shore

Of Sinai on that fateful day of yore.  
He is the life. Now that is some good news.  
The keeping of the law in family pews  
Was good, the best way to succeed in life  
Until death overtake the weal and strife.  
But now the law's alive in flesh and tongue,  
A source of life to keep the old heart  
young,  
And bring the soul that sins back from the  
grave,  
The living law gives freedom to the slave,  
Eternal hope and love, without a knave.

7 If you had known me and truly,  
You should have known my Father too.  
And from now on you really do  
Know Him, and have kept Him in view.

8 Philip said to him, "Sir, show us  
The Father, and we'll make no fuss."

9 Jesus said to him, "Have I been  
So long a time with you sans sin,  
And yet you've not known me a pin,  
Philip? The one who's seen me has  
Seen the Father. What's all this jazz  
You say then, show us Father's bin?

10 "Don't you believe I'm in the Father,  
And the Father is in me, rather?  
The words I speak to you I speak  
Not of myself, but from the leak  
Of the Father who dwells in me,  
He does these works *of mine you see*.

It all comes back to words and words again.  
The life, the bread, the hope, the truth for  
men,

All lie within the words Your sent one  
speaks,

And not in rituals human heart seeks.  
The image of the Father in the son  
Is merely the commandments being done,

The Word is word and that is all there is.  
Let me not falter whirling on the whiz  
At the sound of the ten commandments  
sung,

The foot upon the altar's lowest rung.  
Beloved, You dwell in him and he in You,  
But both of You dwell in the words to do,  
The song of Sinai and the loving true  
That being flesh meant in the greater view.

11 "Believe me I'm in Father, and  
The Father is in me at hand,  
Or else believe me for the sake  
Of the works themselves in my wake.

12 "Truly indeed, I say to you,  
The one who believes in me too,  
The works I do he shall do too,  
And greater works than these he'll do,  
Because I go to my Dad's pew.

13 "Whatever you ask in my name,  
I will do, so my Father's fame  
May be glorified in the son.

Whatever I may ask? I've heard the prayer  
Of a pink Cadillac upon the stair.

If you had known what things the folk I  
know

Pray for beforehand, in the Jesus show,  
You would have stopped the mouth of  
Jesus then,

And saved the false hope of so many men.  
The help I ask for is that I may be  
Content with what You've given here to  
me,

And without some petition great or small,  
I might come in before the judgement hall  
Of heavenly throne with only praise, no  
plaint,

And penance, if I must. I'd be a saint.  
Perhaps it would be easier in time  
To ask for Cadillacs and some new rhyme.

14 "If you ask anything in my  
Name, I will do it by and by.

15 "If you love me, then come to keep  
My commandments, *and do not sleep*.

16 "And I will pray the Father, and  
He shall give you another hand  
Of comforter, and he'll abide  
With you for ever at your side.

17 "Even the spirit of truth, whom  
The world cannot receive in room,

Because it does not see him, nor  
Does it know him, but you in score  
Know him, for he dwells beside you  
And shall stay always among you.

18 "I will not leave you comfortless,  
I will come back to your address.  
19 "Yet a while and the world will see  
Me no more, but you'll see freely,  
Because I live, you'll live and be.

The thing You give when I ask anything  
Is comforter as promised on the wing,  
But that You give alone, not to the king  
Or to the charismatic paupers' ring,  
But only to those who obey commands  
As coming from Sinai and from Your  
hands.

The thing You give is spirit, though for  
bread

I may implore upon this earth of dread  
Where hunger stalks the heart and hand and  
head.

Beloved, I earnestly rush in to keep  
Your law before the gentle breezes sweep  
Me into lulling comfort of the pew  
Where blood and sacrifice exchange the  
view.

I turn from sacrifice and law to You.

20 "At that day you shall know that I  
Am in my Father and thereby  
You are in me and I in you.

21 "The one with my commandments true  
Who keeps and so observes them too,  
He is the one who loves me too,  
And the one who loves me shall be  
Loved by my Father, and I'll come  
To love him and appear in sum  
To him *and show eternally*."

Some tell me that both love and indwelling  
Of spirit in this portal where I sing  
Outweigh the law and run away from it  
Into a Paradise more light and fit.  
But John, who loves to emphasize the life  
That Your Jesus proclaims before the strife,  
Also indelibly takes in the law  
And makes of law, love and the spirit's  
claw

A faithful trinity to sound of fife.  
I take hold of that trinity and fail  
Not to keep clinging to the shiny nail,

With Your own spirit in my heart I bow  
To love and Your commandment on my  
brow.

The spirits rise and fill the slackened sail.

22 Judas, not Iscariot, said  
To him, "Sir, how is it that you  
Will show yourself before our view,  
And not before the world on cue?"

23 Jesus replied and said to him,  
"If a man love me, he'll be trim  
To keep my words: and so my Father  
Will love him, and we shall come rather  
To Him and make our dwelling place  
With Him. 24 And the one who does not  
Love me, will not keep sayings' plot  
Of mine; and the word that you hear  
Is not mine, but the Father's steer,  
The One who sent me *to come here*.

Judas is hardly heard at all, and yet  
His question is the better of some met.  
How can the thing that You provide be true  
When doubters find no room or guide in  
view?

The truth should be a thing for all to see,  
A manifest and certain destiny,  
And not a matter of dispute like crown,  
A shadow for the elite of the town.  
It's not a matter of capacity  
To see the sensitive in industry,  
But merely to keep Your word in the heart  
And let the hand do its apportioned part.  
Then faith will turn to sight as from the  
start.

Let me, Beloved, see or see not the veil,  
But only keep Your word and so assail.

25 "These things that I've spoken to you,  
I speak while I'm still here with you.

26 "But the comforter, who's the holy  
Spirit, whom the Father will roll you  
In my name, he shall teach you all  
Things, and bring all things to recall,  
Whatever I've said to you all.

Some say the Comforter's Muhammad  
come,

Some say he is the hoped for without rum,  
Some say he is the spirit that once fell  
On the apostles like the flames of hell.  
Beloved, I take the comfort of all three

Instead of Christian trebled Trinity,  
And with the arms and tokens of the best  
Find comfort in Your word and in it rest.  
And while I rest and wander through the  
lanes

Of Scripture to see what thing here  
profanes

And what does not the pleasures and the  
pains.

Knowledge or not, I grope within the dark  
And find anon the healing, livid spark  
And enter Paradise if not the park.

27 "Peace I leave with you, and my peace  
I give to you; not in release  
As the world does, do I give you.  
Let not your heart have troubled view,  
Nor let it be afraid *to do*.

The peace of Islam that Your sent one  
shows

To be the help and hope of Israel's rows  
Did not ascend the throne of Rome to cast  
The pagan idols from the ship and mast.  
It failed to live and breathe among all men.  
It slept among the humble in their den.  
The peace of Islam that Muhammad taught  
Is just as futile as a thing that's sought.  
No better than the Christian church, it fell  
Among the teachings of a burning hell.  
Beloved, save me from peace as it appears  
In this word of Islamic Christian tears,  
But let me find the path of that goes alone  
To You upon Your heavenly sort of throne.

28 "You've heard me tell you that I go  
Away, and come again to show  
To you. If you loved me, you would  
Rejoice, because I said for good  
I go to the Father, for my  
Father, He is greater than I.

29 "And now I've told you before it  
Happens, so when it comes as fit,  
You might believe it *by and by*.

30 "From now on I'll not talk so much  
With you; for the prince of this world  
Is coming, and has nought to touch  
In me, *though his flag is unfurled*.

31 "But that the world may know that I  
Love the Father, and as thereby  
The Father gave me commandment,  
Just so I do. Get up, time's spent,

And let us leave *this embankment*."

If You, Beloved, are greater than the Christ  
Who here pronounces blessings tossed and  
diced,

That means the two of You cannot be God  
Almighty and both stand upon one sod.

I praise You that impartial mood assigns  
Your being where the universe aligns.

I'd rather meet the judgement before One  
Than have to satisfy a royal tonne.

Beloved, if justice can be had on earth  
Only where One is divine without birth,  
And where You send Messiah above worth,  
Then let that justice consummate before  
The threatened peace of human sort of  
gore.

It need not be a further kind of shore.

### John 15

1 I am the true vine, and my Dad,  
He is the gardener that I've had.

2 Each branch in me that bears no fruit,  
He takes away: and so to boot  
Each branch that bears fruit, He will trim  
To make it bear more *fruit for Him*.

3 Now you are spruced up through the  
word  
That I have spoken *and you've heard*.

The fair disciples who heard Jesus speak  
Were pruned with the sharp shears or  
maybe beak

Of opposition from the Pharisee.  
Oh, they were trimmed and grimmed for all  
to see.

You are the gardener, Beloved, that's why  
You set poor Adam at the task to try.  
All fathers hope the ones that they produce  
Will carry on the family trade in use.  
Beloved, if humankind failed from the first  
To be the kind of gardener not the worst,  
It's just that our make-up, by You adorned  
Is not appropriate. It is forlorned.  
And yet the promise that You give is still  
In just another garden on the hill.

4 Abide in me, and I in you.  
As the branch cannot bear fruit due  
Of itself, except it remain  
In the vine, no more can you gain,  
Except you remain in my *train*.

5 I am the vine, you are the branches:  
 He who remains in me *for launches*,  
 And I in him, the same shall bring  
 Forth much fruit: for unless I sing  
 You can *by trying* do nothing.  
 6 If a man does not stay in me,  
 He's cast out as a branch *freely*,  
 And is withered. Men come to take  
 Them and throw them in fire to bake.  
 7 If you stay in me and my words  
 Remain in you, you'll ask *like birds*  
 Whatever you want and it shall  
 Be done for you *with seed and sal*.  
 8 Herein's my Father glorified,  
 When you bear much fruit, on my side  
 You'll be disciples *for the ride*.  
 9 As the Father has loved me, so  
 I have loved you: in my love go.  
 10 If you keep my commandments, you  
 Shall abide in my love *as due*.

Abiding in the love of Jesus is  
 To keep the ten commandments with a  
     whiz,  
 Unless some hope to point out in full biz  
 That Your commandments and those that  
     are his  
 Are different. Yours were not written well,  
 Or did not fit the place, and times and spell  
 So well as his. And so we changed the beat  
 And started keeping Sunday in the heat.  
 It's Sunday keeping shows our freedom  
     here  
 From keeping laws to which we should  
     adhere.  
 Beloved, just step aside, take a back place  
 While Mithra and a false god win the race,  
 And all rejoice the Roman sort of grace  
 That's made of crown and crosier and a  
     mace.

11 These things have I spoken to you,  
 So my joy might remain in you,  
 And that your joy might be full *too*.  
 12 This is my commandment: that you  
 Should love each other as I do.  
 13 Greater love has no man than this,  
 That a man lays down life to kiss  
 His mates. 14 You are my mates if you  
 Do everything I command you.  
 15 From now on I'll not call you slaves,  
 For servants do not know the staves

Of master, but I've called you mates,  
 For everything my Dad relates,  
 I have made appear in your gates.

I take the joy and love that Jesus gives,  
 And hope it stays as long as Jesus lives.  
 But I am cynical to find the law  
 Is now just love behind the club and claw.  
 I'd rather it be described in detail,  
 Such as not killing or stealing a whale.  
 But if the Christian world needs room to  
     rule,  
 Then I suppose I must give up the school  
 Of hope in You alone and take up tool  
 Protecting the frontiers of every fool.  
 Beloved, if Jesus told us all that You  
 Relate, then why the word of comfort's pew  
 When spirit of the truth comes in to stake  
 What we were too tame to hear in his  
     wake?

16 You did not choose me, I chose you,  
 And I ordained you to go too,  
 And bring forth fruit, and that your fruit  
 Should remain: so what you would root  
 In your petition to my Dad  
 In my name, the same you have had.  
 17 These things I command you, so you  
 Will love each other in the crew.  
 18 If the world hates you, you'll know that  
 It hated me before it spat.  
 19 If you were of the world, the world  
 Would love its own, but since you're furred  
 Not of the world, but I have chosen  
 You out of the world, the world's frozen  
 And hates you everywhere you're at.  
 20 Mind the word that I said to you,  
 The slave's not greater than the view  
 Of his lord. If they've persecuted  
 Me, they will persecute you rooted.  
 If they have kept my sayings, they  
 Will keep yours also, and at bay.  
 21 But all these things they'll do to you  
 For my name's sake, because they do  
 Not know the One who sent me too.

The fact is the world persecutes in name  
 Of the love that Jesus produced in game,  
 And so betrays the word he first would  
     shove  
 Instead of pitter pattering of love.  
 How can the Inquisition and the State



Be sure of the right persons here to hate?  
 It's only by the law You gave in crown  
 Of Sinai to be spilled about the town.  
 It's only by the law of Christ's renown.  
 The split between the name and the address  
 Is too much for the bishops to confess.  
 Lay open rather Joanna's box and  
 Let Pandemonium out on the land,  
 And see if any bishops come to stand.

22 If I'd not come and spoken to  
 Them, they would have no sin in view;  
 But now they do not have excuse  
 For their sin *and the false abuse*.  
 23 The one who hates me also hates  
 My Father. 24 If I had not done  
 Among them the works such as none  
 Other man's ever done before,  
 They would have no sin to their score.  
 But now they have seen and hated  
 Both me and my Father *on skid*.  
 24 But this comes to pass so the word  
 Might be fulfilled that's writ and stirred  
 In their law, that they hated me  
 Without a cause *unfaithfully*.  
 26 But when the Comforter has come,  
 Whom I will send to you to hum  
 From the Father, Spirit of truth,  
 Which proceeds from Father forsooth,  
 He shall testify of my *ruth*.  
 27 And you also shall testify  
 Because you've been with me *to fly*  
 From the beginning *of the try*.

According to the law of Moses such  
 A man who claimed to be God at a touch  
 Was well deserving of death without pity.  
 So by this word, Jesus rejects the gritty  
 Claim that he made himself God to  
 blaspheme.

The Christ when grasping at the straws that  
 seem  
 Falls flat before the truth on Jesus' tongue.  
 He never claimed to be Almighty strung.  
 Who make him out a man-god like the sun  
 Among the heathen all around who run,  
 Hate both the Father and begotten son.  
 I grasp the holy truth of testament,  
 And thank John for the final word he sent  
 And turn to You until You might relent.

## John 16

1 These things I've spoken to you so  
 You should not be offended, no.  
 2 They'll put you out of synagogues,  
 Indeed the time comes when the hogs  
 That kill you will think that they do  
 For God a service in their pew.

The Inquisition is a state of mind,  
 The concept that to make some deaf men  
 blind

Is pleasing to Creator of their kind.  
 The Inquisition's prophesied by Christ  
 To those by Roman parroting enticed  
 To think that You love to descend into  
 The cookie in the silver platter's view.  
 The one who still refuses to make bread  
 An idol will be stretched by rack instead.  
 Beloved, the melody of faith in wine  
 Is something grand to make a man decline  
 The reason and the revelation's track.  
 I turn and turn again to see Your back.  
 The melody resounds and it sounds fine.

3 And these things they will do to you,  
 Because they do not know *the true*,  
 The Father nor me *in my due*.

Eternal life will soon be shown to be  
 The knowledge of the one true God to see  
 In You alone, and know the one You sent,  
 Christ Jesus, who is Your son but not bent  
 To be a god almighty in the tent.  
 It follows by contrast that to believe  
 The lie that You are three when some  
 deceive

Is the cause of the killing on the sleeve  
 Of the Inquisitor not to relent.  
 Did You remember, Beloved, that the Pope  
 Ben before his election had to cope  
 With heading Inquisition's office meant?  
 Belief in Trinity is fraught with danger,  
 At least to neighbour if not to the ranger.

4 But these things I have told you, so  
 When the time comes, you'll mind the glow  
 Of what I said. And these things I  
 Did not talk of at the start. Why?  
 Because I was with you *to try*.  
 5 But now I go my way to Him  
 Who sent me, and none asks me trim,  
 "Where are you going *from this grim*?"  
 6 But because I've said this to you,

Sorrow has filled your heart *and pew*.

7 Nevertheless I tell you true,  
It is expedient for you  
For me to go away: for if  
I do not go away in skiff,  
The Comforter will not come here  
To you, but if I disappear,  
I will send him to you *with gear*,  
To ask what do with Jesus now.

The reason Jesus went away, it seems,  
Was to send something better than the  
dreams

Of the disciples fit to burst their seams.  
What comforter is better than the one  
You sent to live and die under the sun?  
The desired one of Israel is known  
As that prophet in John before the throne  
Of Herod who feared Baptists and the  
groan  
Of Jesuses before the cross and bone.  
I comfort me in David's sweeter lays,  
I comfort me in Moses and his praise,  
And in the Gospel melodies and maze,  
And last in the Qur'an to treat my days  
With pleasures to the one who reads alone.

8 And when he's come, he will reprove  
The world of sin and righteous groove,  
And of judgement *before they move*.  
9 Of sin, since they don't believe me;  
10 Of righteousness, because I'm free  
To go to my Father and you  
Will no longer see me in crew;  
11 Of judgement, because this world's  
prince  
Is judged, *condemned and made to wince*.

How did the fair Muhammad do three  
things:  
Reprove of sin and righteousness both  
kings  
And populace, and yet of judgement met?  
He reproved all the Jews that had been set  
Against belief in the Messiah yet.  
He reproved Christians for belief the cross  
Atoned for sins, when Jesus met his Boss  
Atoning by his prayers after the loss.  
He reproved pagan Arabs with judgement  
To show this world's prince worshipped in  
the tent  
Was judged, and You alone are worthy of

Worship, obedience, and fear and love.  
This trinity of truth he brought to all,  
And made the people back against the wall.

12 I have still many things to say  
To you, but you can't bear the sway.  
13 But when the Spirit of truth's come,  
He'll guide you into the truth's sum,  
For he shall not speak of himself,  
But whatever he hears on shelf,  
That shall he speak, and he will show  
You things to come *and on the go*.

The prophecy of Muhammad is clear:  
He will speak of the things that he will hear  
By using of a very human ear.  
He'll speak, not write; he'll point to others'  
cheer,  
Not bearing witness of himself, but You  
And the one You sent before to the crew.  
And he will show what things are soon to  
come:  
The Judgement Day, a day fearful in sum.  
Beloved, I stand rejoicing that at last  
The final truth upon the earth was cast,  
And there is nothing more to seek or know  
Except the beauty of that word to show.  
The three-fold truth Muhammad came to  
give  
Makes up the melody I have to live.

14 He shall glorify me: for he  
Shall receive of mine and shall be  
There to show you of my *decree*.  
15 Everything the Father has now  
Is mine: that's why I said somehow  
That he shall take of mine and show  
It to you *in the afterglow*.

I wonder that sweet Christians find the way  
Muhammad spoke and did to go astray,  
When he so carefully in word and deed  
Glorified Jesus Christ who came to bleed?  
The things Muhammad brought forth from  
the store  
Belonged to Jesus Christ who came before,  
And he just polished them to shine and  
glow  
So everyone could believe them and know.  
Beloved, the argument of names is crass,  
I hear and see it come and go and pass,  
But the meat and the meaning and the grass

And flowers and blooms and fruit are left  
in mass.

Beloved, I seek beyond the prophets' names  
To find the truth behind the passing games.

16 A little while, and you shall not  
See me: and again in the plot  
A little while and you'll see me,  
Because I go to Father's see.

17 Then some disciples quietly  
Murmured, "What's this he says to us,  
A little while without a curse  
And you will not see me, again  
A little while, and among men  
You shall see me, because I go  
To the Father *from here below*?"

18 That's why they said "What is this that  
He says, a little while, down pat  
We cannot understand him flat."

19 Now Jesus knew they wanted to  
Ask him and said to them, "You do  
Enquire among yourselves of what  
I said, a little while and shut  
You shall not see me, and again,  
A little while, and among men  
You shall see me appear again?"

20 "Truly indeed, I say to you,  
That you'll weep and lament in crew,  
But the world shall rejoice and stew,  
And you shall be in sorrow too,  
But then your sorrow shall be turned  
Into great joy *to see them burned*."

21 "A woman when she is in labour  
Has sorrow, because without neighbour  
Her time has come. But soon as labour  
Delivers her her child, she minds  
No more the anguish that she finds,  
For joy that a baby is born  
Into the world *and not forlorn*."

22 "And you now therefore have your  
grief,

But I will see you for relief,  
And your hearth shall rejoice in chief,  
And your joy shall no man make brief."

By observation only Jesus knew  
That mothers after labour in the dew  
Turn grief to joy. It's not a thing he felt  
In his own flesh set out to sweat and melt.  
If the Messiah had come in the day  
Of feminist for argument and sway,  
She would have been a women for the ray

Of pain to conquer on the sombre way.  
Beloved, the fact that Jesus did not quail  
Before each pain that comes here to  
prevail,

But only tasted some, then rushed to find  
The pain of death to conquer it and bind.  
Each man and woman on the globe is set  
To taste a unique cup, one never met.

23 In that day you shall ask me naught.  
Truly indeed, I tell you, aught  
You ask the Father in my name,  
He will be giving you the same.

24 Till now you've asked naught in my  
name,

Ask, and you shall receive the same,  
That your joy may be full *in claim*.

25 I've spoken you in proverbs such,  
That the time comes when I shall touch  
You no more in proverbs, but I'll  
Show you clearly the Father's *smile*.

26 In that day you'll ask in my name,  
And I'll not tell you that I'll pray  
The Father for you on the way.

27 For so the Father Himself loves  
You, because you have loved my shoves,  
And believed that I came from God.

28 I came out from the Father and  
Have come into the worldly land,  
Again, I leave the world and go  
Back to the Father *and His show*."

29 And his disciples said to him,  
"See now you speak plainly, not dim.

30 "Now we are sure you know all things,  
And need no man for questionings,  
By this we believe that you came  
Forth from God *and have played no game*."

31 And Jesus answered them, "Do you  
Now believe the things that are true?"

32 "See the time comes, indeed is here,  
That you shall be scattered in fear,  
Each man to his own, and shall leave  
Me alone, though I do not grieve  
Alone, because the Father's here  
With me, *through stick and sin and gear*."

33 "These things I've told you, so in me  
You might have peace *eternally*.  
In the world you'll have trouble, but  
Be of good cheer before the rut,  
I've overcome the world in strut."

Though Jesus told his friends that he would  
 give  
 Them peace or Islam in which they might  
 live,  
 Even the messenger come after him  
 Was not able to do that task so slim.  
 Peace is not found on earth simply because  
 Men refuse to live by Your saving laws.  
 Instead they measure out their jungle claws,  
 And bide their time in doing what is dim.  
 Beloved, I take the cheer of Christ indeed,  
 And rush into his arms with every speed  
 To find that he is not alone to take  
 The burden of Your peace for human's  
 sake,  
 But every man in whose face Your form's  
 met  
 Is gauged to be or not be the one yet.

### John 17

1 Jesus spoke these words, lifted up  
 His eye to sky *for lack of cup*,  
 And said "Father, the hour has come.  
 Now glorify Your son *with crumb*,  
 That Your son may glorify You,  
 2 "As You have given him power to do  
 Over all flesh, that he should give  
 Eternal life to *fugitive*  
 All You have given him. 3 "And this  
 Is life eternal, that *in bliss*  
 They may know You, the only true  
 God, and Jesus the Christ whom You  
 Have sent. 4 "I have glorified You  
 On earth. I have finished the work  
 You've given me *and did not shirk*.  
 5 "And now, O Father, glorify  
 Me together with Yourself by  
 The glory I had with You when  
 The world was not yet home of men.

Before the world was made, Beloved, You  
 gave  
 Your glory to Your Word, that holy slave  
 By which You made the earth and sea and  
 sand  
 And by which You gave sons of men  
 command.  
 That Word You made flesh in Messiah's  
 coming  
 That humankind might not have to guess  
 humming,  
 But might know by Your image in creation

Yourselves as Self and only God to ration.  
 Eternal life, the life all souls desire,  
 Is in the knowing, through earth, air and  
 fire,  
 Beloved, that only God and true alone  
 That You are, You are not of flesh or stone.  
 Give him, indeed, Beloved that glory which  
 Grants life eternal from first to last ditch.

6 "I have manifested Your name  
 To the men whom You, *without shame*,  
 Have given me out of the world.  
 They were Yours, You gave them *unhurled*  
 To me, and they have kept Your word.  
 7 "Now they've known that all things  
*unblurred*  
 Which You have given me are from You.  
 8 "For I have given to them the *few*  
 Words which You have given me, and they  
 Have received, and have known *that way*  
 Surely that I came forth from You,  
 And they've believed I'm sent by You.  
 9 "I pray for them. I do not pray  
 For the world but for those who stray  
 Not from Your gift to me, for they  
 Are Yours. 10 "And all of mine are Yours,  
 And Yours are mine, and *that ensures*  
 I'm glorified in them *today*.

Beloved, I thank You for the lovely word  
 You give in giving Self, the word that's  
 heard  
 As I recite the Decalogue, the Psalms,  
 The Gospel of Your Christ without alarms,  
 That word of whirling sparks up from the  
 altar  
 Of sacrifice of self, let me not falter.  
 Beloved, I thank You for the word of Christ  
 That echoes from creation and unspliced  
 To the last pages of the recitation  
 Of the Qur'an, recited in elation.  
 The word that names the nameless bless my  
 lips  
 As I recite Your lovely name in sips.  
 The Word that came forth from You must  
 return  
 And take me with it to Your heart, I yearn.

11 "Now I'm no longer in the world,  
 But these *of mine* are in the world,  
 I come to You. Holy Father,

Keep through Your name those whom You,  
 Sir,  
 Have given me, that they may be  
 One as we *are*. 12 “While I could be  
 With them in the world, I kept them  
 In Your name. Those whom You gave me  
 I’ve kept, and *truly* none of them  
 Is lost except perdition’s son,  
 That the *true* Scripture might be done.  
 13 “But now I come to You, and these  
 Things I speak in the world to please  
 Them with my joy fulfilled in them.  
 14 “I’ve given them Your word, the world  
 Has hated them because they’re *pearled*,  
 Not of the world, just as I’m not  
 Of the world. 15 “Now I have not sought  
 That You remove them from the world,  
 But that You should keep them unswirled  
 With evil. 16 “They’re not of the world,  
 Just as I am not of the world.

As Your sweet, loved Messiah prayed for  
 me  
 To keep me from all evil, let it be.  
 A double dhikr! Here my name is found  
 Not only on Your lips, Beloved, but bound  
 To lip and heart of Christ himself, indeed,  
 I shall no greater boon require or need.  
 If I am the name that You and he say  
 Remembering and loving every day,  
 Let me then not forget to call upon  
 Your name, Beloved, each day from dawn  
 to dawn.  
 For this the world may hate me and the  
 word  
 That You have given, but I’m unperturbed.  
 Beyond idolatries, above excess,  
 I simply bow beneath Your power to bless.

17 “Sanctify them by Your truth. Your  
 Word is the truth for evermore.  
 18 “As You sent me into the world,  
 I’ve also sent them in the world.  
 19 “And for their sakes I sanctify  
 Myself, that they also may fly  
 To the truth that can sanctify.

The Word that became Christ I cannot  
 touch  
 Except within the sound recited much  
 Of Scripture from beginning and to end.  
 The lovely melodies uprise and blend.

These are the tabernacles and restored  
 Of David and of David’s righteous Lord.  
 I sing the blessed verses once again  
 And in their singing rise above all men  
 To heights of ecstasy and depths of love  
 Until I find in You the passions of  
 That truth alone that knows to sanctify  
 The heart and hand to do Your loved will  
 by.

You sent the blessed Jesus in the world  
 And since then every word is truth  
 empearled.

20 “I do not pray for these alone,  
 But also for those who will own  
 Me through their word, 21 “that they all  
 may

Be one, as You, Father, *still stay*  
 In me, and I in You, that they  
 Also may be one in Us, that  
 The world believe You sent me *pat*.  
 22 “And the glory which You gave me  
 I’ve given them, that they may be  
 One just as we are one: 23 “I in  
 Them, and You in me, *without sin*,  
 That they may be made perfect in  
 One, and that the world may know that  
 You have sent me *from where You sat*,  
 And have loved them as You’ve loved me.

So rich these words, Beloved, I can’t  
 express  
 The depths of wonder that they must  
 confess.

You are not any Trinity alone,  
 But One who draws to Self all flesh and  
 bone.

You are not one with Your Christ set in  
 stone  
 Of trine idol at all, but just as he  
 Is one with You so may I also be  
 And every one who submits to Your will.  
 From that great union, wonderful, comes  
 still

The promise of perfection here and now  
 Within the place where You sent him to  
 plough.

Perfection is in keeping Your command  
 And knowing You are God alone and stand  
 In the same love to all on every hand.

When Chiara Lubich on a winter day

In Trent in nineteen-forty-three gave way  
 To Your call in the oneness of all love,  
 The angels sang in praise of You above.  
 The memory of Your sent one who made  
 This prayer on behalf of all the betrayed  
 By human walls of separation stayed  
 Illuminating heart after heart till  
 The revolution of oneness rose still  
 And glad upon the coldness of the hour,  
 The coldness of the church, the lack of  
 power,  
 And in the quietness of dawn brought light  
 And love and hope and truth out of the  
 night.  
 Beloved, bless human oneness in Your  
 sight.

24 "Father, I wish that they also  
 Whom You gave me may be with me  
 Where I am, that they may *in tow*  
 Behold my glory which You've given  
 In love e'er You made world *to live in*.  
 25 "O righteous Father! The world's not  
 Known You, but I've known You *untaught*,  
 And these have known that You sent me.  
 26 "And I've declared to them Your name,  
 And will declare *it just the same*,  
 That the love with which You loved me  
 May be in them, and I *to see*."

The proof of love is true indeed, but I  
 Find many claim to love abundantly  
 Who in faith fail quite soon in loving me.  
 I tell this ugly tale and with a sigh.  
 Who take the name of Jesus as their own  
 Are often first to rise and cast the stone  
 On those who humbly set aside their will  
 And submit the whole self to You until  
 They know Your truth abounding in sweet  
 grace.  
 How many prove their worth with happy  
 face,  
 But sorrow not for sin, go and transgress  
 Your promised love commandments in the  
 press.  
 Beloved, I cling to You alone and give  
 The Baptists their own choice to die or live.

### John 18

1 When he had finished saying this,  
 Jesus went out and not to miss  
 With his disciples, went across

The winter stream of Kidron's toss,  
 Where there was a garden where he  
 And his disciples entered free.  
 2 And Judas, who betrayed him, knew  
 About that place where Jesus' crew  
 Often came together in view.  
 3 Then having a cohort and crew  
 Of under-officers to do  
 From among the chief priests and the  
 Assembly of the Pharisee,  
 Judas arrived with torch and lamp  
 And weapons *against dark and damp*.

Four hundred eighty men are rather many  
 To pick up such a peaceful man or any  
 Small band of friends, not more than  
 twelve a penny.  
 Whether that means that Jesus was a  
 fighter,  
 And that the story has been cleansed of  
 blighter,  
 Or whether that shows how the Roman  
 chiefs  
 Were paranoid beyond human beliefs,  
 I do not know. But four hundred and eighty  
 In cohort seems to me a band too weighty.  
 Beloved, I see the over-kill of Rome  
 Inherited by armies here at home,  
 The bombs that blast rock-throwers to the  
 loam  
 And leave the desert scalded under sun,  
 Too helpless to rise after what is done.

4 Then knowing all the things to come  
 Upon him, Jesus went to hum  
 And said to them, "Whom do you seek?"  
 5 They answered him, "Jesus the weak  
 The Nazarene." Jesus told them,  
 "I'm he." And Judas in their hem  
 Stood also to betray, *condemn*.  
 6 But when he said to them, "It's I,"  
 In retreat they fell on the rye.

The Evangelical in Roman dress  
 Of pagan doctrine will come here, confess  
 That when Jesus said he was the one they  
 Were looking for, I am's the thing to say  
 To mean that he is God Almighty too.  
 Such nonsense is purported in the pew.  
 Beloved, the answer was divine enough,  
 Though spoken and clothed in the human  
 rough,

For in the human face You always shine  
As long as life supports the breath divine.  
The hopeful answer's heard again and now  
Beneath the crown of power, the clouded  
brow,  
The eye lighted a moment to be dimmed  
By all the armour of the fair untrimmed.

7 Again he asked them, "Whom do you  
Seek? And they said "Jesus, one who  
Is called the Nazarene anew."  
8 Jesus replied, "I told you that  
It is I, then if you out flat  
Seek me, let these ones then depart."  
9 In order to fulfil the word  
He said "Of those who gave in herd  
To me, I lost not one *that stirred.*"

Jesus is truly troubled from the start,  
Nor for his own safety, but for the part  
Of his disciples scattered to lose heart.  
He's worried that they should be freed to  
go.

If he had been Almighty, then he'd know  
Their coming and their going in the show,  
And need not have been worried here  
below.

But Jesus is a man of men to fear,  
To hope and wonder, unless You are near,  
Revealing life and death, healing the tear.  
Beloved, Your sent one is too sweet for  
words,  
Too brave to stand before the milling herds,  
Too strong to let slip power to harm the  
mill,  
Too beautiful to tread upon the hill.

10 Then Simon Peter had a sword,  
He drew it and struck the abhorred  
Slave of the high priest on the ear  
And cut his right ear off and sere.  
And the slave's name was Malchus dear.  
11 Then Jesus said to Peter then,  
"Put up your sword into its den:  
The cup which the Father has set  
To me, shall I not drink it met?"  
12 Then the cohort, commander and  
The under-officers in band  
From the Jews, seized Jesus and bound  
Him. 13 And they led him away first  
To Annas, for he was the *cursed*  
Dad-in-law of Caiaphas,

Who was high priest in that year's pass.  
14 Caiaphas was the one who  
Had given counsel to the Jew  
That it was benefiting that  
One man should perish for the fat.

If Jesus had let Peter strike again,  
He would have appeared among all brave  
men

Without a shadow of complaint to stain  
His courage and his reputation vain.  
Peter could face the cohort with a sword,  
But he will soon be faced, abashed and  
floored

By just a servant girl. Such is the way  
The human heart is bound to act each day  
When unexpectedly the die is cast  
Outside the ring read by the sly at mast.  
Beloved, let me expect the sky to fall,  
Let me expect the dark night to appal,  
And let me meet the door without a hope  
That there is ever any way to cope.

15 And Simon Peter and another  
Disciple followed Jesus-brother,  
And that disciple, he was known  
To the high priest and passed alone  
Together with Jesus in court  
Of the high priest *set down for sport.*  
16 But Peter stood outside the door.  
The other disciple what's more  
Who was known to the high priest went  
Out and spoke to the doorman sent,  
And brought Peter inside in store.  
17 The servant woman at the door  
Said to Peter, "Are you not one  
Of this man's friends, *once he'd begun?*"

He said "I'm no *son of a gun.*"  
18 The servants and the officers  
Were standing warming skins and furs  
Around a fire of coals, for it  
Was cold, and Peter, not to sit,  
Came and stood warming with the kit.  
19 The high priest questioned Jesus of  
His disciples and teaching's shove.  
20 Jesus replied to him, "I came  
Speaking in public and acclaim  
To the world, and I always taught  
In synagogue and temple plot,  
Where the Jews congregate, and I  
Spoke nothing in secret or sly.  
21 "Why do you question me? Ask then

Those who heard what I spoke to men,  
 See, they know what I said again.”  
 22 But when he said these things, one of  
 The officers with hand in glove  
 Standing by gave Jesus a blow  
 With the palm of his hand not slow,  
 And said “Do you answer the high  
 Priest in this way and to decry?”  
 23 Jesus replied to him, “If I  
 spoke wickedly, bear witness why,  
 But if well why hit me so sly?”

The only answer that can come before  
 The hand of power, the hopeless prison  
     door  
 Is to appeal to justice on the floor.  
 The ear may hear, but senses cannot take  
 The concept of justice upon the wake.  
 Justice is acting in the interests of  
 The State and Church is silken shirt and  
     glove.  
 It is no thing in absolute nor in  
 The clutches of the human sort of skin.  
 The officer is doing just his job,  
 He's there to strike down every sort of mob  
 That rises up against the hand of greed,  
 The mitre, crozier, crown or robe or tweed,  
 The voice that criticizes sin and kin.

24 Annas bound him and sent him out  
 To Caiaphas, high priest's clout.  
 25 And Simon Peter stood to warm  
 Himself among the swarm.  
 Then they said to him, “Are you not  
 Among disciples that he taught?”  
 And he denied and said “I'm not.”  
 26 One of the slaves of the high priest,  
 Being kin to the one released  
 Whose ear Peter cut off, said “Did  
 I not see you in garden hid  
 With him?” 27 Again Peter denied,  
 And straight off a cock crowed *and cried*.

Peter could learn a lesson in profile,  
 And how to keep it low and without guile.  
 It's never good to let the servant class  
 See what you're doing among all the brass.  
 If Peter had kept sword at belt and drawn  
 Into the shadows of the garden lawn,  
 No one would have thought of him as a  
     pawn  
 Among five hundred persons before dawn.

Beloved, I take my sword and uselessly  
 Brandish it everywhere I look and see  
 The riff-raff rulers make illegally  
 Law against law divine upon the tee.  
 Tell me in time to put my sword away  
 And withdraw in the shadows and the clay.

28 They led Jesus from the place where  
 Caiaphas sat to the stair  
 Of the praetorium, and it  
 Was early. And they did not sit  
 Inside praetorium unfit  
 So they might not be there defiled,  
 But could eat the Passover *piled*.  
 29 Then Pilate went to them and said  
 “What accusation has been led  
 Against this man?” 30 They answered and  
 Said to him, “If no wicked hand,  
 Then we would not have brought him in  
 To you.” 31 Then Pilate told the bin,  
 “You take him and judge by your law.”  
 Then the Jews said to him for awe,  
 “We have no right to pass a man  
 Death sentence, we do what we can.”

The State indeed is without power when it  
 Has no right to give death to those who sit  
 Beneath its judgement. The poor Jewish  
     state  
 Is clipped and clawed without a hangman's  
     rate.  
 No doubt that's why today when robbers  
     rant  
 The officers reply “We simply can't.”  
 There's always an excuse not to act for  
 The good of victims left upon the shore.  
 But when it's in the interests of the rule,  
 There's always some way to renew the  
     school.  
 Beloved, I see the doom that Pilate's in,  
 He's sunk before the duty of his kin,  
 And nothing can save Jesus when the king  
 Is ready to chop heads off everything.

32 So the word of Jesus which he  
 Said might be fulfilled in the spree,  
 Of what kind of death he would die.  
 33 Then Pilate went again to try  
 In the praetorium and called  
 Jesus and said to him appalled,  
 “Are you king of the Jews installed?”  
 34 Jesus replied to him, “Do you



Say this of your own self as true,  
 Or did another state the view?"

35 Pilate replied, "Not so, am I  
 A Jew? Your nation has come by  
 With the chief priests to hand you up  
 To me. What did you do *in cup*?"

36 Jesus replied, "My kingdom's not  
 Of this world. If my kingdom's plot  
 Were of this world, my slaves would fight  
 To keep me from the Jews in plight.  
 But now my kingdom's not from here."

37 Then Pilate said to him, "Are you  
 Really a king?" Jesus spoke too  
 In answer, "You say I'm a king.  
 For this purpose was my birthing,  
 For this I've come into the world,  
 To witness to the truth unfurled.  
 Everyone who is from the truth  
 Hears my voice *calling in its ruth*."

38 Pilate said to him, "What is truth?"  
 And when he had said this for ruth,  
 He went out once more to the Jews,  
 And said to them, "I find in views  
 No fault in him at all *to choose*."

39 But you've a custom one released  
 To you at the Passover feast.  
 Do you want me to give you now  
 The king of the Jews anyhow?

40 Then they all cried again and said  
 "Not this man, but Barabbas led!"  
 Barabbas was a robber fed.

Ah grave mistake! he did not wait to hear  
 What answer Jesus might have given to ear.  
 The governor was cynically inclined  
 And thought truth was in getting better  
 wined.

That was his truth, for all men seek it out,  
 And hardly one's willing to live with  
 doubt.

Though truth is only You, Beloved, men  
 seek

The truth in flight and in illusion's cheek.  
 I sought truth first in what I had been  
 taught

By friend and teacher, any common  
 thought.

But few pass further than the truth as  
 known

Within civilization where he's grown,  
 Tradition of the fathers and the stunt  
 Of local clown: a call to arms and grunt.

Some think that each man's truth no matter  
 how  
 Closely it mimics falsehood, makes a row,  
 Or spins a devastation on the earth,  
 Each man's own truth is of each equal  
 worth.

To say so's to say there's no truth at all,  
 But only culture relative to call  
 And claim of kinship and of nation. Such  
 Will lead the world to demand e'er so  
 much

Of those who flee oppression to another  
 Asylum. Change one's faith to suit the  
 brother

That lives next door. Beloved, search out  
 my heart

And purge it from all tolerance and art  
 That would diminish anything of that  
 Truth that You are. I bow on the prayer  
 mat.

### John 19

1 And so Pilate had Jesus whipped.  
 The soldiers plaited as they quipped  
 A crown of thorns, and put it on  
 His head, and they put on him drawn  
 A purple robe, 3 and said "Hail, King  
 Of Jews!" and struck him in their flings.

4 That's why Pilate went out again  
 And said to them, "See, from the den  
 I bring him out to you, so you  
 May know I find no fault in view."

5 Jesus came out wearing the crown  
 Of thorns, and dressed in purple gown.  
 And Pilate told them, "See the man  
*Who is to die by your foul plan!*"

6 When the chief priests and officers  
 Saw him they cried out saying slurs,  
 "Now crucify, now crucify!"

Pilate told them, "Take him away  
 And crucify him; I don't say  
 I find fault in him, *not a ray*."

7 The Jews replied, "We have a law,  
 And by our law he ought to die,  
 Because he made himself a lie,  
 The Son of God *without a flaw*."

8 When Pilate heard that saying, he  
 Was all the more afraid to be.

The term the Son of God was known to be  
 A current word for the Messiah's tree.

The ruler realized that politics  
Were running amok before holy wicks.  
The threat was clear that Pilate would be  
made

Accomplice of a rebel against staid  
Status quo of the Roman sort of glade.  
If Son of God had meant in Pilate's ear  
That Jesus claimed to be God Mighty here,  
He could have let him go to loony bin.  
That's where such claimants are put among  
kin.

Beloved, let those who read the word read  
well

Between the lines that those will go to hell  
Who make a man God by speaking a spell.

9 He went back to the judgement hall,  
And said to Jesus to appal,  
"Where are you from?" But Jesus made  
No answer to him *on parade*.

10 Then Pilate said to him, "Do you  
Not answer me? Don't you know true  
I've got the power to crucify  
Or let you go under the sky?"

11 Jesus replied, "You'd have no power  
Against me, except from the bower  
Bestowed from above, so the one  
Who put me in your hands has done  
The greater sin." 12 And from that time  
Pilate tried to release from crime,  
But the Jews cried out saying still,  
"If you let this man go, you will  
Not be the friend of Caesar. One  
Who makes himself a king has done  
Against Caesar in traitor's gun."

The deviation of the Jewish race  
In the first century, from the law's grace,  
Was not in the rejection of the law,  
But in rejection of the strand in claw  
That always went with that: from age to  
age

There always was more than the written  
page.

There was one divinely appointed sage,  
The patriarch, the judge, the king in sway  
To implement the law from day to day.  
Accommodation to the Roman fears  
By grasping law alone and giving gears  
To Rome was the survival plan they had.  
They did not realize it made them bad.

Beloved, let me take both hands for my  
tears.

13 When Pilate therefore heard that said,  
He brought out Jesus and he spread  
The judgement seat in the place called  
The Pavement, in Hebrew installed  
Gabbatha. 14 It was preparation  
Of Passover, about the station  
Of the sixth hour, and he said to  
The Jews, "Behold your king in view!"  
15 But they cried out, "Away with him,  
Away with him, crucify him."  
Pilate said to them, "Shall I now  
Crucify your king anyhow?"  
The chief priests answered, "We've no king  
But Caesar in the Roman ring."

Here the elite of Jewish state chose well  
The Roman pontiff and gave up the spell  
Of David and the prophets, Moses' call,  
The judges and the priesthood at the wall.  
No king but Caesar, that speaks loud and  
clear,

And after centuries, what Kaiser near  
Remembered the day with a grin to tell.  
Beloved, the children of the Jews are not  
Responsible for ancient leaders plot,  
Nor were the common people who loved  
still

The teacher come to grace Mount Olive's  
hill

With words conservative of ancient faith  
In Torah and the Psalms risen like wraith.  
Beloved, we have a king and always will.

16 He gave him up to them to be  
Crucified. And they took the wee  
Jesus and led him away. 17 He  
Carried his cross, he went out to  
A place called the skull, in Hebrew  
Golgotha. 18 Where they crucified  
Him and two others at his side,  
One on each hand and Jesus there  
Set in the middle *in the air*.

19 And Pilate wrote a title, and  
Put it on the cross. And the band  
Of the writing was: Jesus of  
Nazareth, the king that Jews *love*.  
20 This title many Jews there read,  
For the place where Jesus was led  
To crucifixion was near to

The city, and writ in Hebrew,  
And Greek and in the Latin too.  
21 Then said the chief priests of the Jews  
To Pilate, "Don't write king of Jews,  
But that he said I'm king of Jews."  
22 Pilate answered, "What I wrote down,  
I have written *for all the town*."

It's all a tit for tat. The priestly foes  
Had tried to threaten Pilate in his woes,  
And being forced against his will, he chose  
Revenge by writing rankling words in all  
The languages he knew upon the wall.  
Neither cared one whit for the agony,  
The bleeding flesh, the form upon the tree,  
The howling of all nature there to see  
Appalled the death of innocence in gall.  
Beloved, nothing has changed, the crosses  
still

Meet sky under the clouds on every hill,  
And those who rule still stand competing  
for  
The last word and the last number in score.  
The dying innocent pour out and spill.

23 The soldiers, when they'd crucified  
Jesus, took his garments *undyed*  
And made four portions, for each lad  
Of the soldiers a portion had.  
And also the cloak, now the cloak  
Was without seam, wove at a stroke  
From top to bottom and unbroke.  
24 They said among themselves, "Let's not  
Tear it, for the thing cast a lot,  
Whose it shall be, so that the word  
Of Scripture was fulfilled that heard,  
They parted my garments among  
Them and for my vesture thy hung  
Lots. These things the soldiers had stung.

The Psalm uses the very words, it's true,  
but still  
The soldiers did what soldiers always will.  
This is not proof of prophecy at all,  
But just another thing here to appal.  
The seamless cloak is everywhere to see,  
The object of the raffle and the spree,  
The coveted remains of those who toil  
Providing for the gluttons at the spoil.  
Beloved, the pirate sings another tune,  
And ships go down to seas in riggadoon,

But garments still are stretched and weight  
of gold  
Is singled still for everything that's sold.  
I wear the cuff for fleamart and remain  
Among the few who may be sound and  
sane.

25 There stood by the cross Jesus' mother,  
His mother's sister, and another  
Mary the wife of Cleophas,  
And Mary Magdalene *at pass*.  
26 When Jesus saw his mother there,  
And the disciple standing fair,  
The one he loved, he told his mother,  
"Woman, behold your son the other!"  
27 He spoke to the disciple then,  
"Behold your mother!" To his den  
From that time on he took again.

The cross is said to relieve mind of all  
But the business at hand and in the thrall,  
But Jesus bothered heart and soul to say  
A word in favour of his mother's way.  
What would he have done if like other ten  
The beloved John had slithered off again,  
And there was none to take his mother in,  
No friend, disciple or some other kin?  
The sons of Joseph were of course around,  
And one or two apparently then found  
The faith that lacked when life was in the  
stroke,  
And leaf was on the twig and on the oak.  
Beloved, I look around the crosses here  
And see but few who rise to take the gear.

28 After this Jesus knew all things  
Were done, and as the Scripture sings  
Fulfilment he said "Now I thirst."  
29 Now there was set a vessel full  
Of vinegar, and so they'd pull  
A sponge with vinegar and put  
It on a hyssop from the foot  
And set it to his mouth for worst.  
30 When Jesus got the vinegar,  
He said "It's finished", with a stir  
He bowed his head, gave up the ghost.  
31 The Jews therefore, since it was toast  
Of preparation, which meant that  
The bodies should not stay out flat  
Upon the cross on Sabbath day,  
For that Sabbath was a high day,  
Begged Pilate that their legs be broken,

So they could be brought down in token.  
32 Then came the soldiers and they broke  
The legs of the first robber bloke,  
And of the other crucified  
With him there on the other side.  
33 But when they came to Jesus and  
Saw he was already dead brand,  
They did not break his legs *to stand*.

It seems it was a prophecy in stake  
Made by the Psalm of David in the wake  
That no bone should be broken in the make.  
Perhaps the parallel is drawn too near  
Between the Paschal lamb and without fear.  
The death is the Passover for all time,  
And so cannot be an atonement's rhyme,  
Since Passover lamb atones for no sin,  
But just commemorates the state we're in.  
The blood upon the lintel cleanses naught,  
Despite what every Christian child is  
taught.

Atonement is a thing writ in the fall,  
Not in the spring and not upon the wall.  
The prayer atones, the spilt blood not at all.

34 But one of the soldiers thrust spear  
Into his side, and did appear  
Blood and water *upon the sand*.  
35 And he who saw it testified,  
And his witness is true and tried,  
And he knows what he says is true,  
So you may have faith in the view.  
36 These things were done, so that the  
Word

Should be fulfilled in what occurred:  
A bone of him shall not be broken.  
37 And another Scripture awoken  
Says "They shall look on him they pierce."  
38 And after this Joseph the fierce  
Of Arimathaea, who'd be  
Jesus' disciple secretly  
For fear of the Jews, begged Pilate  
To have Jesus' body in state,  
And Pilate gave him leave. He came  
And took Jesus' body in claim.  
39 And Nicodemus also came,  
The one who first came by the flame  
Of night to Jesus, and he brought  
A mixture of the herbs he wrought  
Of myrrh and aloes in the plot  
Of one hundred in pounds as sought.  
40 They took Jesus' body and wound

It in the linen cloths they'd bound  
With spices as the custom sound  
Of Jews to bury *in the ground*.  
41 In the spot he was crucified  
There was a garden, and inside  
The garden a new tomb to bide,  
Where none were ever put *to ride*.  
42 They laid Jesus there since it was  
The Preparation day by laws  
Of Jews, and since the sepulchre  
Was near to hand, not at all fur.

The burying in sheet and herb is still  
The way the Muslims on earth would fulfil  
Commandments of the law upon the hill.  
Nothing has changed at all, except the  
name

That's written on the cloth, always the same  
Among the Akhbaris, who have no shame  
To quote Ismail always. The Usulis  
Know better and write the name on the  
knees  
Of the man who is wrapped in death and  
white.

Beloved, I fear the coming of the night  
When my name is forgotten and my plight,  
Unless someone embroiders on my cloak  
The new name and the new love that  
awoke,  
The hope of everlasting life alight.

## John 20

1 The first of the week Mary came,  
Magdalene also was her name,  
Early when it was still dark to  
The sepulchre, and took in view  
The stone was taken away from  
The sepulchre. 2 She ran to come  
To Simon Peter and the other  
Disciple Jesus loved *like brother*,  
And said to them, "They took away  
The master from the tomb today,  
And we don't know where he might stay."  
3 So Peter went out long beside  
The other disciple to guide  
And came to the sepulchre spied.  
4 They ran together but the one  
Disciple able to outrun  
Peter came to the sepulchre  
Before he had the time to stir.

Refusal to sign his name does not make

John modest for modesty's, comfort's sake.  
It's merely a convention. See the lot:  
He can't refrain from mentioning in plot  
That he could run much faster than his  
friend,

And Peter was slow coming in the end.  
The Bible is a human book, I say,  
More human than the humans in its way,  
Endearing for the foibles that they may  
Keep perpetrating under light of day.  
Both men lie still in their own tombs  
tonight,

And neither of them see a speck of light,  
And neither run through the spring  
morning's air  
To seek a living lord upon the stair.

5 He stooped down, saw the linen bands  
Lie, yet he did not enter lands  
Of death. 6 Then Simon Peter came  
Behind him and went in the same  
Sepulchre, and saw the clothes lie  
In linen there *beneath the sky*.  
7 And the cloth that was round his head  
Not lying with the linen spread,  
But wrapped in its own place instead.

The preacher, who's like John, and can't  
resist  
Pretending to be better in the mist,  
Says that the cloth about the head is there  
Like serviette to show a sign on air.  
The meaning is invented just to make  
The listener think him wise and no mistake.  
The bier is no board left from meal  
unfinished,  
But that the detailed etched and  
undiminished  
Of that sight swept John decades later in  
Description of the vividness of tin.  
Beloved, I enter morning tombs each day,  
Surprised to find them empty in their way,  
With linen folded and set out to stay,  
And know the presence of Your heart in  
kin.

8 Then that other disciples too  
Went in, who came first in the dew  
To the tomb, saw and believed too.  
9 For they still did not know the word  
Of Scripture, that he would be stirred  
To rise of from the dead incurred.

10 Then the disciples went away  
Again into their house to stay.  
11 But Mary stood outside the tomb  
And wept there, as she wept in doom  
She stooped down and looked in the tomb,  
12 And saw two angels in white sit,  
One at the head, the other fit  
At the foot, where the body'd lain.  
13 And they said to her, "Woman, why  
Have you come to this place to cry?"  
She said to them, "Because they took  
My lord, I don't know where to look."

When Mary's asked why does she weep,  
She does not answer from her sleep  
Because my lover's dead and I  
Remain alone under the sky,  
But catches at the first thing near,  
The body's gone from under tear.  
How human and irrational!  
We never have wit, never shall  
To say the truth, no, nor the heart  
To spell the folly of our part,  
The destitution of the place  
Where lies the hopeless human race.  
Beloved, give over, lest You find  
You also join the outer rind.

14 When she had said so, she turned round  
And saw Jesus stand on the ground,  
And did not know Jesus was found.  
15 Jesus asked her, "Woman, why weep?  
Whom do you seek among the deep?"  
She thinking him the gardener,  
Spoke to him and said to him, "Sir,  
If you have carried him away,  
Tell me now where he came to lay,  
And I'll go and take him away."  
16 Jesus said to her, "Mary *dear*."  
She turned and said to him *with fear*  
*And joy*, "Rabboni" which is just to say  
Master. 17 Jesus said to her, "Stay,  
Do not touch me, for I have not  
Yet gone up to my Father's plot,  
But go to my brothers and say  
To them, that I go up away  
To my Father, your Father too,  
And to my God, and God of you."

What is this word that Jesus speaks?  
Why did he think Mary had cheeks  
To touch him? He was a man then,

And she a woman in the den,  
 No relative, and they were there  
 Alone in the garden and fair.  
 The law between the sexes then  
 Was just as now, do not touch men.  
 Two possibilities arise,  
 One was that they were married guys,  
 The other that they'd had affair  
 In clandestine. So choose Your dare,  
 But do not tell me monk and nun  
 Met to hug in the garden fun.

If Jesus is the Son of God, I say,  
 I like the message he speaks on the way,  
 That his Father is Mary's too and theirs  
 Who gather behind doors to say their  
 prayers.

That may explain this touching between kin  
 Without the taint of smut or other sin.

If Jesus has a God, the same as I  
 And Mary, and disciples on the sly,  
 Then he's no more a god under the sky  
 Than any other man born to ask why,  
 But by the grace You share with him to be  
 Whatever You decide eternally.  
 Beloved, God of Jesus and God of me,  
 Reveal the word again and faithfully.

18 Mary Magdalene came and told  
 The disciples that she'd been bold  
 To see the lord, and what he said  
 To her. 19 Then that same day at spread  
 Of evening, the first of the week,  
 When doors were shut so none could peek,  
 Where the disciples gathered in  
 Their fear of the Jews and their kin,  
 Came Jesus and stood among them,  
 And said to them in stratagem,  
 Salaam alaykum, peace in hem.  
 20 And when he'd said so, he showed them  
 His hands and side. Then they were glad,  
 Disciples were, to see the lad.  
 21 Then Jesus said to them again,  
 Salaam alaykum to you men,  
 As my Father has sent me, so  
 I send you too *to work below.* "

Saint Paul was not among that faithful  
 crew,

And so could say there is no work to do,  
 But only in faith say the word is true  
 That Jesus rose up from the grave on cue.

But every other man of those who knew  
 And followed him beyond the cross to view  
 His last commission, knows the tasks  
 abound

Here in the city, on the desert ground.  
 Beloved, the work is set out for my share,  
 And the reward recorded on the stair,  
 While some may stand like Milton and  
 relate

That life eternal is a mental state,  
 I strive to enter in the heavenly gate  
 Without shirk of my work on earth or air.

22 And when he'd said this, he breathed on  
 Them and said to them, "Have in drawn  
 The Holy Spirit. 23 Whose sins you  
 Release, they are remitted too,  
 And whose sins you retain, they are  
 Retained *beyond the sun and star.* "

The breath of Christ upon the men he knew  
 Gave them the right to forgive sins in crew.  
 The dervish breathed on me when I was ill  
 In hope of health and healing to the fill.  
 I whirl about the dergah floor and wait  
 The coming of the flame and wind in mate,  
 And as I whirl through my small deaths, I  
 find

Through my sips of breaths, I'm no longer  
 blind.

Beloved, the spirit by which You recall  
 The universes to Your cell and wall  
 Recedes no more beneath my chamber  
 stall,

But in its far expansion on the breeze  
 My soul arises over seven seas  
 To share the hope, to share the victories.

24 But Thomas, one of the twelve called  
 Didymus, was not there installed  
 With them when Jesus came *from far.*

25 The other disciples then said  
 To him, "We've seen the lord live led."  
 But he said to them, "Except I  
 Shall see in his hands and descry  
 The print of the nails, and put my  
 Finger in the print of the nails,  
 And thrust my hand in his side's pales,  
 I will not have faith in your tales."

26 And after eight days and again  
 His own disciples stayed in den,  
 And Thomas with them, Jesus came

Through the doors shut and stood in claim  
And said Salaam alaykum then.

27 Then he said to Thomas, "Reach out  
Your finger and see without doubt  
My hands, and reach also your hand  
And thrust it in my side as planned,  
And be not faithless, but believe.

28 And Thomas exclaimed for reprieve  
And said to him, "Good Lord, my God!"

The Trinitarian grasps at this straw  
And takes Thomas at his word said in awe  
To mean that Jesus is both Lord and God  
Of everything created on the sod.  
The Greek is not in vocative, which means  
The one addressed cannot, in all the scenes,  
Be the God the man means, though any  
other

Within the universe could be the brother.  
Beloved, if Thomas' words exclude just  
Christ

From being God Almighty, then the spliced  
In Trinity falls down before Your throne  
To recognize that You are God alone.  
If all are God to whom such words are  
spread,

Then we have millions of them having said.

29 But Jesus told him, "Thomas, since  
You have seen me, you do not wince,  
But you believe. Blessed are those since  
You have not seen, and still believe."

30 And many other signs indeed  
Jesus did in the sight and need  
Of his disciples, which are not  
Written in this book and the plot.

31 But these are written, so you might  
Believe that Jesus in his right  
Is Christ the Son of God, and so  
Believing you might have the glow  
Of life through his name *here below*."

The Christ once meant the king upon the  
throne,

The son of David reigning over stone.  
But at the touch of Jesus it expands  
To meanings greater on the far-flung sands.  
Messiah is the one who gives men life  
To live above the earthly din and strife  
And last to enter in the heavenly hall  
To live forever in angelic call.  
Beloved, let me be faithful to that king,

And so join in the living, loving ring,  
And in his name arise at last to sing.  
And as the Son of God Messiah knows  
The paths of human hearts and human  
woes,  
Let me join him among the thousands'  
rows.

## John 21

1 After these things Jesus appeared  
Again to the disciples *geared*

At the sea of Tiberias,  
And in this way he came to pass.

2 There were together Simon Peter,  
And Thomas Didymus *defeater*,  
Nathanael from *the town of Cana*  
In Galilee, and *no complainer*  
The sons of Zebedee, and two  
Other disciples *come in view*.

3 Simon Peter said to them, "I  
Am going fishing by and by."  
They said to him, "We too shall go  
Along with you to see the show."  
They went straight out into a ship,  
And that night caught nothing *to slip*.

Here at last I see why Jesus would choose  
That motley party with or without shoes.  
It's not that they're intelligent or wise,  
Nor that they're great in anybody's eyes,  
But simply that no death or disappointment  
Can dampen their activity's anointment.  
They're ready for a fishing trip as soon  
As Peter mentions it for fork or spoon.  
Beloved, enthusiasm is the word  
Well sought and etymologized and stirred.  
My lazy hand can hardly bear the blurred,  
But those men were not daunted by the  
herd.

That's why he chose them from among the  
fair,  
And sent them out to labour everywhere.

4 But when the morning was now come,  
Jesus stood on the shore to hum,  
But the disciples did not know  
That it was Jesus *there to show*.

5 Then Jesus said to them, "Now sons,  
Do you have anything for buns?"  
They answered him, "Nothing at all."

6 He said to them, "Throw out of stall  
The net on the ship's right side hull,

And you will get a catch in tonnes.”  
 So they threw the net and were not  
 Able to pull in all the draught.  
 7 So that disciple Jesus loved  
 Said to Peter, “It’s the lord *gloved*.”  
 When Simon Peter heard that it  
 Was the lord, he put on his fit  
 Fisher’s cloak, for he had been nude,  
 And jumped into the lake, the dude.

It’s always John who understands and  
 knows,  
 And always Peter that jumps in and goes.  
 Each has his own way in the tide of life,  
 Each his own way to meet the storm and  
 strife.

John recognizes Jesus for the fish  
 That jumped into the boat as by a wish.  
 I wonder how I might know that lord when  
 I look abroad to fathom souls and men.  
 Beloved, let me see in the faces near  
 Reflection of the glories that appear  
 In the divine direction and the pir.  
 Beloved, let me see Jesus in the small,  
 The weakest of the weak against the wall,  
 And feel the divine hand covering all.

8 The other disciples came in  
 A little ship, for they had been  
 Not far from land, it might have been  
 Two hundred armlengths, dragging net  
 With all the fishes they could get.  
 9 As soon as they had come to land,  
 They saw a fire of coals at hand,  
 And fish laid out and bread *on sand*.  
 10 Jesus told them, “Bring up some fish  
 Of what you caught *to fill the dish*.”  
 11 And Simon Peter went to take  
 The net to land full in the wake  
 Of big fish, one hundred fifty  
 And three in all, for the degree  
 Of so many, the net was free.

John could resist to write the works that  
 stood  
 As wonders when Jesus arose and could.  
 He’s tired of writing so he ends his book,  
 But can’t resist to beg to take a look  
 How many fish he brought up from the  
 brook.  
 A fisherman must tell his tale no matter  
 If some Messiahs from the dead are fatter.

I only wonder, if the man was God,  
 Why he had only a few on the sod,  
 And needed more and told them to bring  
 some  
 Of what they’d caught to make the  
 breakfast hum.  
 If he could do a miracle in catch,  
 Why was he then dependent on the snatch?  
 The signs he does are not peas in a pod.

12 Jesus said to them, “Come and dine.”  
 And none of the disciples fine  
 Dared ask him, “Who are you?” since they  
 Knew it was the lord *in their way*.  
 13 Then Jesus came and took the bread  
 And gave it to them, and he spread  
 The fish as well. 14 Now this remains  
 The third time that Jesus attains  
 To show himself to his friends then  
 After he rose from death and den.  
 15 When they had eaten, Jesus said  
 To Simon Peter, “Simon son  
 Of Jonas, do you love me won  
 More than these others on the run?”  
 He said to him, “Yes, sir, you know  
 That I still love you on the go.”  
 He told him, “Feed my lambs *of snow*.”  
 16 He said to him the second time,  
 “Simon, son of Jonas for crime,  
 Do you love me?” Peter said to  
 Him, “Yes, sir, you know that I do.”  
 He said to him then, “Feed my sheep.”  
 17 He told him a third time to keep,  
 “Simon, son of Jonas, do you  
 Really love me and love me true?”  
 Peter was grieved to hear the thing  
 Three times about and in a ring,  
 He said to him, “Sir you know all,  
 You know I love you.” At the call,  
 Jesus said to him, “Feed my sheep.  
 18 “Truly indeed, I say *in sweep*,  
 When you were young, you set yourself  
 And went anywhere like an elf,  
 But when you shall be old, you’ll stretch  
 Out your hands and another fetch  
 And take you where you would not go.”  
 19 He said this to prophesy which  
 Death should take him into the ditch  
 To glorify God at a pitch.  
 And when he has said this, he said  
 To him, “Follow me then instead.”



The crucifixion of St. Peter's not  
 Historical, but only legend's rot.  
 This text is too ambiguous to say  
 How Peter died to glorify Your sway.  
 They might have bound his hands instead  
 to take  
 Him to a pot of oil for St. John's sake.  
 Beloved, is every good man left to die  
 Upon a stake or beneath ashen sky?  
 No wonder men's hearts fail them and they  
 make

A beeline for the nearest king to rake  
 With fawning and with dawning wealth to  
 bake.

I too am mercenary in my way,  
 Thinking that You'll make me rich and  
 someday  
 Come justify the reasons for my stay.

20 Then Peter turned around to see  
 Behind them the disciple wee  
 Whom Jesus loved, the one who leaned  
 Upon his breast at supper weaned,  
 And said "Sir, who's betraying thee?"

21 When Peter saw him then he said  
 To Jesus, "Sir, how's this man led?"

22 Jesus said to him, "If I will  
 That he tarry again until  
 I come, what is that thing to you?  
 Follow me only keep in view."

23 Then this word went out in the folk,  
 That that disciple should not croak,  
 But Jesus did not say to him,  
 "He shall not die", but rather dim,  
 "If I will him to stay until  
 I come, what is that to your bill?"

24 This is the disciple who bears  
 Witness of these things and who cares  
 To write them down. And we know that  
 His word is true *and firmly sat.*

25 And there are many other things  
 That Jesus did, which, if in rings  
 They should be written down each one,  
 I guess the world itself that spun  
 Could not contain the books again  
 That should be written, and amen.

I come to the end of the Gospel store,  
 At least canonical before the door,  
 And find I am not satisfied to leave  
 The story of the Christ and his reprieve.  
 I've looked at it with eyes of doubt to find

A thread of certainty for eye that's blind.  
 I've looked at it with eyes of faith to see  
 The broken window on eternity.  
 And in the end I know I've just begun  
 To learn what Jesus said and did for fun.  
 Beloved, give me the life and breath to go  
 Back through the story to find here below  
 The kernel of the nut. I taste the rind,  
 The sweetbreads of the faithful and the  
 kind.

### **The Coptic Gospel of Thomas**

These are the secret sayings that  
 The living Jesus spoke and that  
 Didymus Judas Thomas wrote.  
 1 He said, "Whoever finds the note  
 Of meaning in these sayings will  
 Not see death *nor its lines fulfil.*"  
 2 Jesus said, "Let him who seeks still  
 Go on seeking until he find.  
 And when he finds he'll not be blind  
 To consternation, but astonished  
 And shall rule over all admonished."

Beloved, I love Your messenger Messiah  
 And his spokesman, namesake, and not  
 pariah,

Whose doubting built the greatest faith of  
 all

That answers to Your love and divine call.  
 Life without death is to find that great  
 knowing

That is the divine secret and its showing.  
 The first gate is the seeking that goes on,  
 The second gate is the surprise of dawn  
 Where love breaks through where duty  
 sang its song

And consternation nails the right and  
 wrong.

The third gate is astonishment at seeing  
 All things through the eye of the divine  
 being.

The fourth gate is in truth the rulership  
 Of all that was from the start at the hip.

3 Jesus said "If those who lead you  
 Say 'See, the Kingdom's *not in view*  
*But out of reach* up in the sky,'  
 Then the birds of the sky go high  
 Preceding you. If they tell you,

'It is too deep *to understand*  
 Down in the sea,' then any band  
 Of fish will go there before you.  
 Rather, the Kingdom is among  
 You, and all around you it's sung.  
 When you come to know yourselves, then  
 You'll become known *by other men*,  
 And you will realize it's you  
 Who're sons of living Father true.  
 But if you will not know yourselves,  
 You'll stay in poverty *on shelves*  
 And that poverty will be you."

The reason the dear and the tried on earth  
 Need leaders of good insight and of worth  
 Is because they must be led to the light  
 And truth that is so high it's out of sight  
 Or else so deep that only a grand saint  
 Can dive to find it and dive and not faint.  
 The goal is not a journey and a way  
 But is the air and earth of present day.  
 It's not to know another one and far,  
 But to know the divine right where we are.  
 I know there is no I, Beloved, but You,  
 And so I know You and myself and true,  
 As well as every self intimately,  
 And in that knowing You have set me free.

4 Jesus said, "The man old in days  
 Will gladly ask a child the ways,  
 A child of seven days old where  
 The place of life is *for his care*,  
 And he will live. For many who  
 Are first will become last *to do*,  
 And they will become one for two."  
 5 Jesus said "Know what's in your sight,  
 And that which is hidden *from light*  
 In you will become plain to you.  
 For there is nothing hidden that  
 Will not become clear to look at."

The knowledge of the divine I comes fast  
 Like the awareness of a fear or fright  
 Without the intervention of the past,  
 The memory, the reading, or the light.  
 The hidden is a hidden thing because  
 I look at it through tentacles and claws  
 Instead of unpretentiously as fair  
 Without a label or a name stuck there.  
 Know what's in sight and give no meaning  
 to  
 The real and existent and the true.

So I know You and that knowing is clear  
 And direct on myself as any fear.  
 Beloved, I love like child or like old man  
 Whose knowing being two is one as can.

6 His disciples questioned him and  
 Said to him, "*What do you command?*  
 Do you want us to fast? How shall  
 We pray? Shall we give alms at all?  
 What diet shall we eat withal?"  
 Jesus said "Do not tell lies, and  
 Do not do what you hate at hand,  
 For all things are plain in the sight  
 Of Heaven, for nothing hidden from light  
 Will fail to be made known at last  
 And nothing covered will stay fast  
 Without being uncovered *cast*."

The people ask what to add to the law  
 And in each age hold this or that in awe.  
 In Jesus' time it was to fast and pray  
 And give alms and be held in diet's sway.  
 Muhammad's age held to the three of  
 choice  
 But lifted pilgrimage above the diet's  
 voice.  
 The people ask the prophet what to do,  
 But in their asking assume what is true.  
 The prophet turns their gazing once aside  
 From non-essentials and the false heart's  
 pride  
 To see with honesty what comes to light  
 In simply seeking what is plain and right.  
 Pray, fast, and give alms if only that way  
 I can know You, Beloved, in me today.

7 Jesus said "Blessèd is the lion  
 That becomes man when man shall try on  
 Its flesh for meat; and cursed the man  
 The lion eats to become man."

The self in its illusion roars amain  
 And searches out its prey to eat for gain,  
 And rushes through the veils of desert night  
 Consuming every other god in sight.  
 The pale of lust and power leave stomach  
 full  
 Of nothing satisfying to the bull.  
 And so self searches for Self endlessly  
 Until she's blessed with dining  
 sumptuously  
 On the divine that always was in store,

The true before illusion's stack and roar.  
The Self may consume self and thus  
destroy  
The chance to be a true and lovely boy.  
Or self may consume Self in taking paten,  
And let illusion lie at last to fatten.

8 He said "The Kingdom's like a wise  
Fisherman who cast in such guise  
His net into the sea and drew  
It up from the sea full of *new*  
Small fish. Among them the wise fisher  
Found a fine large fish *in the swisher*.  
He threw all the small fish back in  
The sea and chose the large fish fin  
With no trouble at all. Who has  
Ears to hear, let him hear *whereas*."  
9 Jesus said, "Now the sower went,  
Took a handful *of seeds well meant*,  
And scattered them. Some fell upon  
The road; the birds came before dawn  
And gathered them up. Others fell  
On the rock, did not take root well  
In the soil, and did not produce.  
And others fell on thorns *for use*;  
They choked the seed and worms ate them.  
And others fell by stratagem  
On the good soil and bore good fruit,  
Sixty to one, or then to boot  
A hundred and twenty to loot."  
10 Jesus said "I have cast fire on  
The world, and see, I guard the dawn  
Until it blazes up *in spawn*."  
11 Jesus said "This heaven will pass  
Away, and that above alas.  
The dead are not alive, and they  
Who live will never know death's way.  
In the days when you consumed what  
Was dead, you brought it to life, not?  
When you come to dwell in the light,  
What will you do *then out of spite*?  
The day you were one you became  
Two, but when you become in name  
Two, what will you do *without shame*?"

The flesh and spirit are two meant to be  
The sprouting seeds and are the fields to  
see.  
One flesh is hard and nothing grows from  
it,  
But one flesh is of kind spirit finds fit.  
The spirit is forlorn and without fruit

Until it comes in flesh, grows up in shoot.  
The seed dies then consumed and spirit's  
gone  
Until the living blade strives up toward  
dawn.  
The green lives in the light and travels by  
The prophet's side who walks and wonders  
why.  
Beloved, the dead seed that was one in  
night  
Comes out alive in flesh and spirit bright,  
Forever two, though You are only one,  
Before and after that great day is done.

12 The disciples said to Jesus,  
"We know that you'll depart from us.  
Who is to be our leader then?"  
Jesus said to them, "Where you ken,  
You are to go to righteous James,  
For whose sake heaven and earth *have*  
*names*  
And came into being *and claims*."  
13 Jesus said to his disciples,  
"Compare me to someone *that pulls*  
And tell me now who am I like."  
Simon Peter said to him, "*Strike*,  
You're like a righteous angel *bright*."  
Matthew said to him, "You are *light*  
Like a wise philosopher *right*."  
Thomas said to him, "Master, my  
Mouth is wholly incapable  
Of saying whom you resemble,  
What you are like, *or are, or why*."  
Jesus said, "No master am I  
To you, because you've drunk the spring  
And been filled by that living thing  
That I have measured out and nigh."  
He took him and withdrew and told  
Him three things. When Thomas *was bold*,  
Returned to his friends, they asked him,  
"What did Jesus say on the limb?"  
Thomas said to them, "If I tell  
You one of the things he told well,  
You will pick up stones to stone me,  
A fire will come out of them, see,  
And burn you up *eternally*."

James is a leader after Christ, and Simon  
Found righteous angel instead of a pie-man.  
Matthew saw the Christ as a wise man is,  
Philosopher dividing hers and his.

But Thomas heard three words because he  
 did  
 Not bow to Christs, angels nor human lid,  
 But saw the divine heart the universe  
 Within the Christ gave birth and in him hid.  
 For this the secret silence is his curse.  
 Belovèd, let not me do any worse.  
 I risk the volley of the flying stones  
 That seek my life and seek to bare my  
 bones,  
 To know the three words hidden in Your  
 heart,  
 Three words once spoken and still do their  
 part.

14 Jesus said to them, "If you fast,  
 You will give rise to sin at last;  
 And if you pray, you'll be condemned;  
 And if you give alms, you'll be hemmed  
 About your own spirits with harm.  
 When you go into any farm  
 Or land or district, walk about,  
 If they receive you, eat what they  
 Set before you in grateful way,  
 And heal the sick among them, for  
 What may go in your mouth ignore,  
 It will not defile you, but that  
 Which issues from your mouth thereat  
 Is what will defile you the more."

I do not cry to know the details of  
 Ever more detailed law instead of love.  
 I fast indeed, but fast from lying tongue,  
 And pray indeed only the prayer that's sung  
 Within the hidden chamber of the heart.  
 I give alms for remiss and then I start  
 To find one hand does not know what the  
 dart  
 Of the other accomplishes by art.  
 My blindness merely grows from day to  
 day  
 As Your brightness takes my seeing away.  
 In failing of the law I rush to do  
 Some healing miracles on earth a few,  
 And so taste swine and rabbit in my teeth,  
 And take my slaying sword out of the  
 sheath.

15 Jesus said, "When you see one who  
 Was not born of woman, then do  
 Prostration on your faces and  
 Worship him. That one is your Father."

16 Jesus said "Men think, perhaps rather,  
 That it is peace I've come to cast  
 Upon the world. They're flabbergast  
 To know it is dissension I  
 Have come to cast upon the earth:  
 Fire, sword, and war for all it's worth.  
 For there will be five in a house:  
 Three will be against two *in blouse*,  
 And two against three, and the father  
 Against the son, and the son *bother*  
 Against the father. And they'll stand  
 Each one a lone *dervish for band*."

Ha! Thomas who knows secrets still not  
 told  
 To priest and rabbi is put out of fold  
 For daring to say that one who is bold  
 To be born of a woman we must scold  
 If he claims to be God and Father of  
 The lambs who prance about the cot of  
 dove  
 And serpent. Yet I hear the tone was cast  
 That angels not born of women have passed  
 Upon the earth's bounds and would like to  
 take  
 Some honour and some worship for the  
 sake  
 Of having spent a weary while in air.  
 Such antichrists are like to give a scare  
 To such as me, Belovèd, who only wait  
 To see You coming through the nearest  
 gate.

17 Jesus said "I shall give you what  
 No eye has seen, what no ear shut  
 Has heard and what no hand has touched  
 And what no human mind has clutched."

18 The disciples said to Jesus,  
 "Tell us what end will come on us."  
 Jesus said "Have you found the start  
 That you look for the end *of art*?  
 For where the beginning is set,  
 There also will the end be met.  
 Blessèd is he who'll take his place  
 In the beginning *of the race*;  
 He'll know the end and yet not death  
*Nor even run race out of breath.*"

19 Jesus said "Blessed is he who came  
 Into being before he came  
 Into being. If you become  
 My disciples and hear my words,  
 These stones will serve you *in their herds*."

For there are the five trees for you  
In Paradise untroubled all  
Year whose growing leaves do not fall.  
Whoever comes to know them will  
Not feel or know at all death's *chill*."

When Jesus starts to tell the secret of  
The universe and the eternal love,  
His followers stop his mouth with a glove  
And ask instead to hear their fortune told.  
That's why true teachers are so rare and  
sold

For tonne on tonne of glittering precious  
gold.

The dervish rather does the damning trick  
Or tells the tale of future gains as slick  
As any reader of the palm and eye.  
All scamper after what instead of why.  
Beloved, the five celestial trees look down  
On fourteen on the earth and with renown.  
To hide in evergreen is future cold  
Enough to flee to Enoch, not to scold.

20 The disciples asked Jesus, "Tell  
Us how Heaven's Kingdom shall excel."  
He said to them, "It's like a seed  
Of mustard, of seeds small indeed.  
But when it falls on the tilled soil,  
It makes a great plant to uncoil,  
Becomes a shelter for the birds  
That come down from the sky *in herds*."

21 Mary said to Jesus, "Whom are  
Your disciples like and in par?"  
He said "They are like children who  
Have settled in a field that grew  
What was not theirs. And so when come  
The owners of the field to plumb  
They'll say 'Let us have back our field.'  
They will disrobe before them, yield  
Their field and give it back to them.  
Therefore I say to you *a gem*,  
If the house owner knows the thief  
Is coming, he will start relief  
In his vigil before he comes  
And will not let him *take his sums*  
From his house and from his domain  
To carry away his goods' *gain*.  
You, then, be on your guard before  
The world. Arm yourselves with the *store*  
Of great strength lest the robbers find  
A way to come to you *behind*,  
For the troubles that you expected

Will surely appear as suspected.  
Let there be among you a man  
Of understanding. When the bran  
Ripened, he came quickly with his  
Sickle in his hand for the biz  
Of reaping it. Whoever's got  
Ears to hear, let him hear *what's taught*."

Again the questioners ignore the tale  
Of mustard seed, instead they would  
prevail,

Identifying great men of the spirit.

Ambition cuts the heart open to sear it.

The kingdom of heaven is like a seed  
Hidden in the world's field, below its  
greed,

Invisible, though all search for a church  
That's too strong to leave any in the lurch.

The kingdom is a lowly plant passed by  
The human marchers onward toward the  
sky,

But those who sing their sema' and who  
fly,

Find in its branches all the reasons why.

Let others rob and reap, Beloved, while I  
Rest in Your heart invisible and shy.

22 Jesus saw infants being suckled.

He said to his disciples *buckled*,

"These infants being suckled are  
Like those who enter Kingdom's *bar*."

They said to him, "Shall we then come  
As children into the Kingdom?"

Jesus said to them, "When you make  
The two one, and then when you make  
The inside like the outside and  
The outside like the inside *hand*,

And the above like the below,  
And when you make *the two to go*,  
The male and the female one and  
The same, so that the male not stand  
As male nor the female female;  
And when you fashion eyes *regale*  
In the place of an eye, and hand  
In the place of another hand,  
And a foot in place of a foot,  
And likeness in likeness' place put,  
Then will you enter Kingdom's *band*."

The spirit seed and earthy flesh became  
One when the sprout came up to praise  
Your name.

The infants and their milk become one too  
When they drink from the breast their  
mother's dew.

The outside and the inside become one  
When every act and word is always done,  
Not in the sight of one or other neighbour,  
But in the sight alone of You, whose labour  
Alone makes flesh and spirit come alive.  
The oneness of the soul does not contrive  
To be one thing to Roman and to Greek  
Another by the template that they seek.  
And yet, Beloved, the honest face of theft  
Upon my word is even more bereft.

23 Jesus said "I shall choose you, one  
Out of a thousand, *when it's done*,  
And two out of ten thousand, and  
They shall stand as a single one."

24 His disciples said to him, "Show  
Us the place where you are, we'll go  
In search of it if needs be found."  
He said to them, "Who has got ears,  
Let him hear *what teaching appears*.  
There's light within a man of light,  
And so lights up the whole world right.  
Not shining, it stays in the night."

25 Jesus said "Love your brother like  
Your soul, guard him *from every strike*  
Like the pupil of your eye's *might*."

26 Jesus said "You see the mote in  
Your brother's eye, (*and call it sin*),  
But you do not see the beam in  
Your own eye. When you cast the beam  
Out of your own eye, then you'll deem  
To see clearly to cast the mote  
From your brother's eye, *not by rote*."

27 *Jesus said* "If you do not fast  
As regards the world, you'll not last  
To find the Kingdom. If you do  
Not observe the Sabbath as true  
A Sabbath, you will not be able  
To see the Father, *but a fable*."

The Master prayed that we might all know  
You,

Beloved, and perhaps all of us know true,  
But there is only one time that a man  
Can see the Father, and that time began  
When evening drew nigh for the Sabbath  
rest.

The Sabbath rest is rest from all the dressed

Veils that hide the divine from human  
breast.

Let me fast from the world throughout the  
week

And thus see that great face at last I seek,  
Your face, Beloved and Father, without  
veil

As Moses and Elijah told the tale.  
Like Moses let the vision make me meek,  
And like Elijah, kindle my desire  
To enter Sabbath chariot of fire.

28 Jesus said "I took my place in  
The midst of the world, and I win  
Appearing to them in the flesh.  
I found them all drunken *and fresh*;  
I found none of them thirsty *there*.  
My soul was afflicted with care  
For the sons of men, because they  
Are blind in their hearts, sight of day  
Is lacking to them, empty they  
Came in the world, and empty too  
They seek to leave the world *and true*.  
But for the moment they are drunken.  
When they shake off their being *sunken*  
In wine, then they'll repentance do."

29 Jesus said "If the flesh came to  
Being because of spirit *true*,  
It is a wonder. But if spirit  
Came into being (*or came near it*)  
Because of the body, it's more  
A wonder than wonder before.  
Indeed, I am amazed at how  
This great wealth has settled and now  
Makes its home in poverty's *brow*."  
30 Jesus said "Where there are three gods,  
They are gods, but where there one plod  
Or two, I'm with him *where he trod*."

Where two or three gather and in the name  
Of Your sent one, such people bear no  
shame,

But are exalted ones as gods must be  
That shake off wine and veil and come to  
see.

Let me gather upon the Sabbath day  
With one or two and thus learn the right  
way.

It is a wonder that the spirit rises  
Through the obedience that some despises.  
Why can the spirit not come from the flesh  
Of any day and every day afresh?

It is a wonder that it wakens only  
Upon the dawn of Sabbaths not held lonely.  
Such days of body, miracle to rise,  
Know flights of spirit from the earth to  
skies.

31 Jesus said "No prophet's accepted  
In his own village *intercepted*;  
And no physician heals those who  
Know him *of old in what they do.*"

32 Jesus said "A city strong built  
On a high mountain cannot tilt,  
Nor can it be hidden *in silt.*"

33 Jesus said "Preach from your housetops  
That which you'll hear in your ear *stops.*

For no one lights a lamp and sets  
It under a bushel *for bets*,  
Nor does he put it in a hidden  
Place, but rather sets it *unbidden*  
Upon a lampstand so that all  
Who enter in or leave *the hall*  
Will see its light beyond *recall.*"

"Preach from your rooftops what you'll  
hear

*Resounding* in your *faithful* ear.  
For no one lights a lamp and then  
Puts it under a basket, men  
Do not put it in hidden corner.  
Rather, one puts, *not as a scorner*,  
It on a stand so all who come  
And go will see the light *or some.*"

34 Jesus said "If a blind man leads  
A blind man, they *for all their creeds*  
Will both fall in a pit *of weeds.*"

The tables of stone lie hidden and dark  
Beneath the golden mercy seat in ark.  
But they illuminate and shine before  
The golden lampstand set before the door.  
The light of true obedience grows on  
To be the spring of spirit on the dawn.

Beloved, light up my stumbling way of  
stone,

Though sapphire tablets, to approach Your  
throne.

The lamp and stone are hidden under tent,  
But here the many veils are torn and rent,  
And all the glory lies beneath the stars,  
Unseen upon the housetops for the bars.

Beloved, light up my stumbling way of  
stone,

Though sapphire tablets, to approach Your  
throne.

35 Jesus said "It's not possible  
To enter a strong man's house *full*,  
And take it by force unless he  
First binds his hands; then he will be  
Able to rob his house *for free.*"

36 Jesus said "Do not be concerned  
From morning until evening *turned*  
And from evening till morning for  
The things you'll wear *or keep in store.*"

37 His disciples said "When will you  
Become revealed to us and you  
Be seen of us *for what we do?*"

Jesus said "When you disrobe and  
Without shame take your clothes in hand  
And place them under your feet like  
Little children, some little tyke  
That stomps on them, then you will see  
The Son of the Living One be,  
And you will not *see* fearfully."

Beloved, naked I come into the place  
Of slaughter and before Your loving face,  
Face shining with such bright I cannot see,  
But fall expiring on the sapphire lee,  
Naked I come to whirl in sacrifice,  
No veils between my heart, veils that  
suffice

To clothe the shameful from the shameful  
sight.

Naked I come to sacrifice aright,  
Naked my body lies before the hand  
That washes it and sends it to the sand.  
Give me no shroud, Beloved, in my  
distress.

I do not need or want the covering dress.  
Naked I step onto the slaughter ground  
With eyes only for You in what I've found.

38 Jesus said "Many times have you  
Desired to hear these words *and true*  
Which I am saying now to you,  
And you have no one else to hear  
Them from. There will then days appear  
When you look for me and will not  
Find me *nor the lessons I've taught.*"

Beloved, You sent upon the earth each  
guide

And prophet for the humans not to slide,

And when I meet such figures they abide  
 Each only to reveal the tempted thought.  
 There is no other in their times that  
 wrought  
 Such truth on earth, no other in their towns,  
 And yet each one met crowds and crowds  
 of frowns.  
 No wonder Jesus promises the time  
 Will come when we shall search in every  
 clime  
 And find no divine guide or prophet set.  
 We've crucified or tried each one we've  
 met.  
 Beloved, I too search out the promised land  
 And find the famine scorching every band,  
 While I eat fruits directly from Your hand.

39 Jesus said "The Pharisees and  
 The scribes have taken into hand  
 The keys of knowledge hidden so.  
 They don't themselves *in knowledge* go,  
 Nor have they let those who wish to  
 Enter into knowledge, but you  
 Be just as wise as serpents are,  
 As innocent as doves *by far*."

The scribes and Pharisees are all long dead,  
 And they performed a duty for those led  
 Who wished to survive Roman ravaging  
 Of the holy land without promised king.  
 I set aside pious accommodation  
 Known now and ever since that plundered  
 nation  
 Invented ways to survive Roman rule.  
 But I remain, Beloved One, Your own fool,  
 Opposing the establishment and shaking  
 The water from my fur and no mistaking.  
 A fool dog too enthusiastic I  
 Pray You will create in me by the by  
 A serpent's heart of wisdom and a pure  
 Innocence like the dove's, then I'll be sure.

40 Jesus said "A grapevine has been  
 Planted outside the Father's *inn*,  
 But being unsound, it will be  
 Pulled up by its roots, destroyed *tree*."

The grapevine that is planted out of reach  
 Of Your divine heart is what preachers  
 preach  
 Of the faith devised by proud Constantine

Who planned to rule the world with tainted  
 wine.  
 He saw a trinity would work just fine,  
 For who could believe one is three, and  
 three  
 Is one, could be led into any fee.  
 If the accommodation Pharisee  
 Made is a sin, then what of this bold spree?  
 Who criticise the scribe that wished him  
 dead  
 That You had sent, ought to know this  
 instead,  
 That creeds from Nicaea or any barn  
 Are grapevines torn and stitched from  
 pagan yarn.  
 Let me, Beloved, find You, not what I've  
 read.

41 Jesus said "Who has something in  
 His hand will receive more *in bin*,  
 And who has nothing will be stripped  
 Of what little his hand has slipped."

How true the words that empty hands are  
 given  
 No more than emptiness yet and to live in  
 Eternal poverty, and it is true  
 That money attracts money as its due.  
 The cynical attraction is a rule  
 For faith and spirit also in the pool  
 Of trite existence. Those with priestcraft  
 who  
 Lie on the rim of nothingness resign  
 To having nothing by afternoon wine,  
 While those few bankers who pursue the  
 goal  
 Of knowing You, Beloved, unknown in  
 soul  
 And the Unknowable, find that the hand  
 Is filled beyond the knowing and  
 command.  
 I find my poverty's blasted to dine.

42 Jesus said "Become passers-by."

43 His disciples said to him, "Why,  
 Who are You, that You should say these  
 Things to us?" *Jesus said to please*,  
 "You do not realize who I am  
 From what I say to you, *poor lamb*,  
 But you've become like the Jews,  
 Who either love the tree, refuse  
 Its fruit, or love the fruit and hate



The tree.” 44 Jesus said *to the mate*,  
 “Who blasphemes against Father God  
 Will be forgiven, *though a clod*,  
 And who blasphemes against the Son  
 Will be forgiven, *when he’s done*,  
 But who blasphemes against the Holy  
 Spirit will not be, *fast or slowly*,  
 Forgiven either on the earth  
 Or in heaven, *but kept in dearth*.”

The sin against the Holy Spirit’s just  
 A comment on the main word and the  
 thrust

Of what Jesus said and meant on the day  
 He told us to be passers-by and prey  
 On what spectators on the trouncing world  
 Reveals day by day in a thing unfurled.  
 Alternative to such detachment is  
 Either to love the tree and leave the fizz  
 Or love the fruit and hate the tree and his.  
 Set me, Beloved, neither to this world’s  
 tree

Nor to the fruit of uneternity.  
 Instead I flee all things, detached, remote,  
 Clutching timorously the edge of boat,  
 Afraid the soul’s detachment will not float.

45 Jesus said “Grapes are not picked from  
 Thorns, never are figs found to come  
 From thistles, for they do not yield  
 Fruit. A good man brings forth *like field*  
 Good from his storehouse; evil men  
 Bring forth evil things from their *ken*  
 And storehouse, which is in his heart,  
 And says evil things *for his part*.  
 For out of the abundance of  
 The heart he brings forth evil love.”

The surface of this word suggests that men  
 Are born to evil or to good again,  
 And none can chance the fate of his own  
 tongue

Betraying his deeds in the songs he’s sung.  
 It is not so. The word is spoken to  
 Both those who love the tree and those who  
 do

According to the fruit. All things are  
 blessed

With crookedness in features and caressed.  
 The good storehouse is that the passer-by  
 Reaches in his detachment for the sky.  
 Out of the heart abundant that I find

When I cast out my own heart and my blind  
 Self to find home and hearth in the Self  
 taught  
 Is the true way to my own precious plot.

46 Jesus said “Among those born of  
 Women, from Adam until John  
 The Baptist, there is none so great  
 As John the Baptist that his *late*  
 Eyes should not be lowered *before*  
 Him. Yet I’ve said *and say once more*,  
 Who of you comes to be a child  
 Will be acquainted with the *styled*  
 Kingdom, and greater *far* than John.”

How is Adam one born of woman come,  
 Who had no mother or dad he was from?  
 The matter is well known, for that the rib  
 That became Eve was more than her first  
 crib.

It was the side from which Adam was taken  
 And from the sleep of androgyn to waken  
 Upon a world of married lust new shaken.  
 The longing back to union of the first  
 Is just a trick of hormones and of thirst.  
 Beloved, though men from women come  
 and they

Are born of men too in curious way,  
 The oneness of creation speaks today  
 Of what the start had hoped for in a ray.  
 Some lie blessed in the way where some  
 are cursed.

47 And Jesus said “To mount upon  
 Two horses or stretch two bows is  
 Impossible for any man.  
 For a servant to serve both his  
 Two masters is nothing he can;  
 Otherwise he’ll honour the one  
 And treat the other like the Hun.  
 No man drinks old wine and then wants  
 To drink new wine *in what he flaunts*.  
 And new wine is not put into  
 Old wineskins, lest they burst *a few*;  
 Nor is old wine put in a new  
 Wineskin, lest it spoil it. An old  
 Patch is not sewn onto the fold  
 Of a new garment, since a tear  
 Would be result *of any wear*.”

The old wine of the prophets is wine sweet  
 And yet this Jesus brings a better treat.

The prophets promised only success in  
This life if a man lived it without sin.  
Jesus is offering eternal life  
Based not on the good that do man and  
wife,

But based on the inheritance the king,  
The Son of David gains under the wing  
Of conquering death then rising to sing.  
If he can only show that it's not late  
Rehashing of the pagan sort of fate  
With heathen solar deities in rate,  
And that the Sinai message, reasons tongue  
Is still right, then it is a heavenly rung.

48 And Jesus said "If two make peace  
With each other for an increase  
In this one house, they will say to  
The mountain, 'Move away,' and true  
It will do so." 49 And Jesus said  
"Blessed are the solitary *fed*  
And the elect, for you will find  
The Kingdom. For you are the kind  
From it, and to it you'll return."

The musahiblik is a wondered thing,  
Two young men loyal in their wandering,  
Like David and like Jonathan to sing.  
If just two on earth can agree in love,  
Then they can move the mountains with a  
shove.

But that's the catch. There are no two to  
strike  
The iron with the kind of blow You like.  
Each heart is bent on something in the  
share,

A secret benefit and selfish care.  
But if there ever are two men agreed  
In innocence before Davidic seed,  
Then mountains that today seem firm and  
fast  
Will rise up, take up bed, and walk at last,  
And spoil the havens of the royal breed.

50 Jesus said "If they say to spurn,  
'Where did you come from?' say to them,  
'We came from the light, and the hem  
Where the light came into being  
On its own accord and *with wing*  
Established *itself* and was seen  
Through their image *upon the screen.*'  
If they say to you, 'Is it you?'  
Say 'We are its children, *the few,*

We are the elect of the living  
Father.' If they ask you be giving,  
'What's sign of your father in you?'  
Say to them, 'It's movement and rest.'"

The argument that's best is just to say  
The mountainside is moving in its way,  
Although you look and it still seems to  
stay.

There is no sect or label of the just  
Who rise up in their witness against dust,  
But they are light indeed, and not the  
fussed

Claimants that always step into the thrust  
Of limelight and of lemon dark to make  
A greater clamour for their own name's  
sake.

Beloved, I take hold of the sign you give,  
A bared knife on the hand by which I live,  
And find it rests in Sabbath-like refrain  
Despite the movement of the sun and rain,  
Despite the rushing of the stars to gain.

51 His disciples said to him true,  
"When will the rest of the dead blessed  
Come about, and when will the new  
World come?" He said to them, "What you  
Look forward to's already here,  
But you do not know it *for fear.*"

52 His disciples said to him then,  
"Twenty-four prophets spoke to *men*  
In Israel, and all of them spoke  
In you." He said to them for oak,  
"You have omitted the one living  
In your presence and have been giving  
Word only of the dead." 53 Then said  
His disciples to him, *they said*  
"Is circumcision good or not?"  
He said to them, "If it were spot  
Of benefit, their father would  
Beget them already made good  
By circumcision from their mom.  
Rather, true circumcision's balm  
In spirit's become wholly fit  
*And purified in every whit.*"

54 Jesus said "Blessed are the poor,  
For yours is heavenly kingdom's store."

The human selfish view of kingdom's  
wrong,  
And that is why the battlefield's a song.  
The kingdom had arrived as soon as one

Appointed to the throne had been and done.  
Jesus says he's the king and kingdom  
blessed,

And in him everyone who will has rest.  
I enter in the kingdom day by day  
When I set all aside beside the way  
And take the king as my own in the fray.  
Some wait for victory before they say  
The kingdom's here, but I, sweet One,  
agree

To the rule of Your sent one in the spree,  
While battles still rage in deathly country.  
I enter now the kingdom, if I may.

55 Jesus said "Whoever does not  
Hate his father and mother's lot  
Cannot be disciple to me.  
And who does not hate *faithfully*  
His brothers and sisters and take  
Up his cross for My way *and sake*  
Will never be worthy of me."

56 Jesus said "Whoever has come  
To understand the world *in sum*  
Has found only a corpse, and who  
Has found a corpse is surely true  
To be above the earthly crew."

57 Jesus said "The Father's kingdom  
Is like a man with good seed come.  
His enemy arrived by night  
And sowed some weeds among the right.  
The man did not let them pull up  
The weeds; instead he stayed to *sup*  
And say to them, 'I am afraid  
That your well-meaning that is laid  
To pull up weeds will also pull  
Up the wheat along with the full.'  
For on the day of harvest weeds  
Will plainly be revealed in deed,  
And they will be pulled up and burned."

Beloved, I stand among the wheat and tares  
Of life and longing, and through all its  
cares,  
Still know that You are one and on the  
throne:  
The kingdom's one as soon as the heart's  
own

Is given to the king in flesh and bone.  
Beloved, I stand among the wheat and see  
That kinship is a blessing in degree,  
But that no father, mother, brother here  
Can boast the ship without a sigh and tear.

And so I hate all things, the sweet and best,  
And in that love lay hopes and fears to rest.  
The crosses and the weeks may thrive a  
while,

The brothers rise up in a fresh new guile,  
And still the kingdom waits upon the smile.

58 Jesus said "Blessed is the *spurned*  
Man who has suffered and found life."

59 Jesus said "Take heed without strife  
Of the Living One while you live,  
Lest you die and seek, *as He'll give*,  
To see Him and not find a way."

60 Samaritan upon the way  
Carried a lamb toward Judaea.  
He said to his disciples' awe,  
"Why does that man carry the lamb?"  
They said to him, "*Without its dam*  
So that he may kill it and eat."  
He said to them, "While it's alive,  
He will not eat it *for a treat*,  
But only when he will deprive  
It of its life and it's become  
A corpse." They said to him *in sum*,  
"He cannot do so otherwise."  
He said to them *of their demise*,  
"You too, look for a place to rest,  
Lest you become a corpse at best  
And be eaten." 61 Then Jesus said,  
"Two will rest both upon one bed:  
One will die, one will live instead."

The slaughtering of lamb in Gospel word  
Is something more than covenant that's  
spurred

Among the ancients, something other than  
Propitiation in the plan of man.  
Unless the soul finds place in kingdom of  
The Father and within the land of love,  
A rest, a Sabbath rest, among the shove  
Of pagan action, all with fall in glove  
To be consumed upon the empty life  
That turns to death within the weary strife.  
Beloved, let me be no corpse in Your room,  
But with my whirling better face my doom,  
And show eternity in heart and hand  
Upon the rest that rests upon the land.

Salome said to him, "Who are  
You, as a man, that you, like star  
From the One, have come on my couch  
And eaten what my tables vouch?"

Jesus said to her, "I am he  
 Who exists from the undivided.  
 I was with some good things provided  
 By my Father *and faithfully.*"  
 "I am your follower," she said.  
 Jesus told her, "Therefore I said,  
 If he is undivided *wed*,  
 He will be filled with light, but if  
 He is divided, he's a skiff  
 To be filled with darkness *instead.*"

There's no division in the I that's You,  
 There's only one Alohim in my view.  
 Each soul that peers from eyes around the  
     world  
 Is a line to Your heart and mind unfurled.  
 The oneness of the universe displayed  
 Is just the demonstration on parade  
 That You alone are I and undismayed.  
 There's no division in the I that's found  
 Upon the new sky at the morning round,  
 Upon the slow enclosing of the ground  
 Upon the granite that makes up the sound.  
 Beloved, there's no division I can find  
 Among the sighted or among the blind,  
 And all remains responsibly unmined.

62 Jesus said "It is to those who  
 Are worthy of my mysteries true  
 That I tell of my mysteries to.  
 Do not let your left hand know what  
 Your right hand does *open or shut.*"

The mystery of Jesus is not what  
 He taught in secret behind a door shut,  
 But that his followers with the left hand  
 Should give what the right hand had never  
     planned  
 In alms of charity about the land.  
 The secret teaching of the dervish code,  
 The seventh blessing in the eighth abode  
 Is giving to the poor a steady load,  
 The feeding of the hungry at the door,  
 The keeping of provisions in their store.  
 Beloved, I seek the mysteries occult  
 And find the greater teachings and adult.

63 Jesus said "There was a rich man  
 Who had money *as all such can.*  
 He said 'I'll put money to use  
 To sow, reap, plant, and so achieve  
 To fill my storehouse with produce,

With which I shall lack no reprieve.  
 So he intended, but that night  
 He died. Who has ears hear aright."

Death greets each soul from birth until the  
     grave  
 In daily doses for both king and slave.  
 I die with every exhalation's breath,  
 I die when sleep comes over me like death.  
 Baptisms follow on, the spirit lies  
 In tombs and rooms all covered from the  
     skies.  
 And yet with the new gulp of air I find  
 My hand returns to golden sheaves to bind  
 The bread both daily and the stored up  
     kind.  
 Beloved, the storehouse of my weight and  
     strength  
 Diminishes in time and in the length  
 Of hope and desperation on the brink  
 Of golden ears and claps joined link to  
     link.

64 Jesus said "A man had received  
 Guests. And indeed when he'd conceived  
 To fix food, he sent servant out  
 To invite guests. He went to one  
 And said to him, "My master's done  
 To invite you.' He said 'I've claim  
 Against some merchants to their blame.  
 They are coming to me this night.  
 I must go and give them their plight.  
 I ask to be excused this time.'  
 He went to one more with the rhyme,  
 And said 'My master invites you.'  
 He told him, 'I've just bought a *new*  
 House and I'm very busy now.  
 I do not have time anyhow.'  
 He went to another and said  
 To him, 'My master's *laid a spread*  
 And invites you.' He said to him  
 'My friend's going, *with all the trim*,  
 To get married, and I am the one  
 To get ready the banquet fun.  
 I shall not be able to come.  
 So I ask to be excused from  
 The dinner.' He went to one more  
 And told him 'My master before  
 Invites you.' He said to him, 'I  
 Have just bought a farm, and so I  
 Am on my way to take the rent.  
 I'll not be able to consent.

May I be excused.' The servant  
 Returned and told his master, 'Those  
 Whom you invited to feast chose  
 To be excused.' The master said  
 To his servant, 'Go out instead  
 To the streets and bring back those whom  
 You happen to meet *in their room*,  
 So that they may dine.' Businessmen  
 And merchants will not come again  
 Into my Father's paradise."

The tasks that meet me through the day  
 impel

The hand to work the fingers now to sell,  
 And now to dig a storehouse and a well.  
 I get Your invitation by surprise  
 And see around me in all sorts of guise  
 Necessities and reasons why I must  
 Not leave the duties wherein I must trust.  
 And yet my love constrains me on the way,  
 The resonances of the ringing pay  
 Grow far remote, and I rise up to play.  
 Beloved, the feast, though unexpected here,  
 Is full and ready and so I appear  
 To find the jalabiyya white and sere,  
 The minstrel music dashing on my ear.

65 He said "There was a good and nice  
 Man who owned a vineyard. He leased  
 It to tenant farmers *increased*  
 So that they might work it and he  
 Might collect the produce *for free*.  
 He sent his servant to collect  
 From the tenants produce select  
 Of the vineyard. They grabbed the man  
 And beat him, nearly killed *by plan*.  
 The servant came to tell his master.  
 The master said 'Perhaps *disaster*  
 Was *they* did not recognize *him*.'  
 He sent another servant *prim*.  
 The tenants beat this one as well.  
 The owner sent his son to tell,  
 And said 'Perhaps they'll show respect  
 To my son.' They did not neglect  
 To know it was he who was heir  
 To the vineyard, they seized him there  
 And killed him. Let whom has ears hear."  
 66 Jesus said "Show me the stone which  
 The builders had thrown in the ditch.  
 That very one's the cornerstone."  
 67 Jesus said "Who believes alone  
 The All itself's deficient is

*Himself deficient and all his."*

The parables that ride the Coptic voice  
 Are just the same as Luke's for favoured  
 choice,

And yet they lack the details that rejoice  
 In armour, flattery, accusing word.  
 They're softer here, a slighter breeze has  
 stirred.

Beloved, the four estates of men are found  
 In the four Gospels that have been around,  
 But my poor poet's soul is better bound  
 In Thomas's insinuations' sound.

Instead of Pharisees and Sadducees  
 To frown before accusing word that sees  
 Through parable, I find the unities  
 Of All in All and so fall on my knees,  
 The cringing of a dervish and a hound.

68 Jesus said "Blessèd are you when  
 You're hated, persecuted men.  
 When you're pursued, they'll find no  
 place."

69 Jesus said "Blessèd are those whose face  
 Has been ravished but from within.  
 They are the ones who without sin  
 Have come to know the Father's *grin*.  
 Blessèd are those who hunger for their  
 Stomach desiring shall be filled."

The persecutors of this Gospel's page  
 Are not the outer soldiers in their rage,  
 But inner doubts and flouts of master mage.  
 The ravishings of face that Thomas knows  
 Are not the traits of power on the pose,  
 But inner eating of the heart to find  
 No sin upon the tendered and the vined.  
 The hunger of the Gospel heart is blessed,  
 Not in a metaphor among the best,  
 But as a plate of lentils and the bread  
 That caters to the fish broiled without head.  
 Beloved, the trinity of spirits here  
 Refresh the expectations of the ear  
 Until the blessed vision shall appear.

70 Jesus said "If you bring out what  
 Is in you, what you bring unshut  
 Will save you. If you do not bring  
 Out what is in you, then the sting  
 Of what you do not bring out killed  
 Will destroy you *both root and wing*."

71 Jesus said "I'll destroy this room

And none will be able to build."

When Jesus spoke of temple in the blast  
Of Matthew and of Mark set out to last,  
They said he spoke of body in the grave  
That could not be held under death as slave.  
Beyond the stone, beyond the flesh and  
bone,

There is an inner temple and a throne.  
And these are where the great destruction's  
done,

The battles shared, the victories are won.  
Beloved, destroy with every breath my  
room,

Rise and acquaint my soul with every doom  
The rays of sun and moon beneath the stars  
Are able to perform between the bars  
Of my existence on the dark of night,  
And on the rosy red of morning light.

72 One told him, "Tell my brothers' doom  
To share my dad's inheritance  
With me." He told him, "Man, what *chance*  
Made me divider *of the dance*?"

He turned to his disciples and  
Asked them, "I'm not among you *manned*  
To make divisions, am I?" 73 Then  
Jesus said "The harvest is great  
But labourers are few *in state*.  
Pray to the Lord, therefore, to send  
Workers into the harvest *end*."

The one prayer of this deepest of the host  
Of Gospels is the prayer caught in the  
boast,

To pray that workers might be sent abroad  
To harvest in the ripened fields of God.  
When Matthew makes a fourfold prayer in  
grate,

To pray for flight in winter and the state  
Of Sabbath, and for enemies come late,  
Thomas the doubter and the thoughtful  
mate

Remembers only workers on the road.  
Beloved, send workers in my chambered  
soul

To set the table with the bread and load  
Of fishes I must eat to make my goal,  
And I shall sit with You and You with me  
To find the lighter supper of the free.

74 He said "O Lord, many now stand

Around the drinking trough *at hand*  
But in the cistern's naught *but sand*."

75 Jesus said "Many at the door  
Stand, but only one *and no more*  
Will go into the bridal store."

76 Jesus said "The Father's kingdom  
Is like a merchant who *in sum*  
Had a lot of goods and who found  
A pearl. That merchant wise and sound  
Sold all his goods and bought the pearl  
Alone for himself *to uncurl*.

Seek too His sure, eternal part  
Where there's no moth to eat the heart  
And no worm to destroy *the chart*."

The pearl of price was set so long ago  
That sixty generations make a show  
Between that day and this, and yet the room  
Is still a darkened maze and doubtful tomb  
To priest and his parishioner in gloom.  
The pearl of price is rather like a man  
Beside the fishing boats upon the span  
Of Galilee, a traveller on the way  
Through the Samaritan towns in the day,  
And in Judaeon hills as night comes on,  
A singular man to which those are drawn  
Who slack the status quo of Roman yoke  
And turn to praise a merry fellow bloke.  
Beloved, the kingdom's too dear for the  
pay.

77 Jesus said "Indeed I'm the light  
Which is above them all in sight.

Indeed I am the all. From me  
Did the all come out and to me  
Did all intend. Just split a tree  
And I am there. Lift up the stone,  
And you will find me there alone."

78 Jesus said "Why have you come out  
Into the desert? To see stout  
Reed shaken by the wind? To see  
A man dressed in silk artistry  
Like your kings and your great men's fee?  
They wear the most expensive clothes  
But of the Truth none of them knows."

This Thomas Gospel strikes right on the  
stone,

And where the other gospels would atone  
By speaking of the physical alone,  
The literal material enthroned,  
The Jesus of this Gospel is aware

Of I-ness and the earth and fire and air.  
 I jump into that sea of Truth and find  
 The settled on the earth is not to bind,  
 But is the way that opens in the tree  
 And under stone and everywhere I see  
 The miracle of everyday, the right,  
 The knowledge of the One and of the light.  
 Beloved, I sacrifice the universe  
 And find Me in its entrails and its purse.

79 A woman from the crowd told him  
 "Happy the womb that gave you vim  
 And the breasts which suckled your *whim*."  
 He told her, "Happy are those who  
 Have heard the Father's word and true  
 Have kept it. There shall come the days  
 When you will say 'Happy the womb  
 That has not conceived and the room  
 Of breasts that gave no milk *for doom*.'"

Not for the coming crash of temple lost  
 And city of Jerusalem then tossed  
 Does Jesus say these words, though they're  
 embossed  
 In Luke for those who wavered at the  
 crossed,  
 But for the hearing of the Father's word  
 And for the coming out of vacant herd  
 To enter in the true and find within  
 The sweeter milk outside the earthly din,  
 The finer breast of One in unity,  
 The divine before all the rushing sea.  
 Beloved, let me be happy through the night  
 Of empty hopes and dreams and fearful  
 plight  
 To find in emptiness the fullness where  
 You are alone on throne beyond the air.

80 Jesus said "He who's recognized  
 The world has found body *comprised*,  
 But he who's found the body is  
 Greater than all the world *of fizz*."

Though Jesus in the body cannot be  
 The God Almighty of eternity,  
 The body is the place where every man  
 Finds the divine in universal span.  
 The face reflects Your face and that alone,  
 All else is the illusion of a stone.  
 The search for spirit and the higher sphere  
 Is empty as the wise know to appear,  
 But in the body though inert on ground

Is greater than in all the world is found,  
 Awareness of the I-ness and the True,  
 The recognition of Myself and You.  
 Beloved, I spin the body and I kiss  
 The God it points to before it can miss.

81 Jesus said "Let him who's got rich  
 Be king, and let him with a stitch  
 Of power renounce it *at a pitch*."  
 82 Jesus said "He who's near me's near  
 The fire, and he who's far from fear  
 Is far from the Kingdom *I rear*."

The king embodies kingdom then and now,  
 In Shakespeare's play the king of France on  
 brow  
 Has written France, and every other prince  
 Takes on the name of the land where he'd  
 wince.

Let the rich man be king, I do resign  
 Myself to every polyp in the wine.  
 Let everyone with power though of a hair  
 Renounce it to make plain the power You  
 wear.

Beloved, let kings and powers return to  
 You,  
 To Your Messiah in the weather-pew,  
 And let the fire burn brighter for my cue,  
 Until I jump into the burning wake  
 And settle in the frying pan at stake  
 And laugh at all the errors that I make.

83 Jesus said "Reflections are seen  
 By humankind but the light sheen  
 Remains hidden in the reflection  
 Of the light of Father's *confection*.  
 He will appear, but His reflection  
 Will stay hid by His light's *connexion*."

Reflections of divinity abound  
 In every face of human that is found,  
 But those reflections only hide the true  
 From all the dancing sort of human crew.  
 The light of Your reflection on the pool  
 Of human heart and eye, to any fool,  
 Looks like the passing of the moon and like  
 The sun that streams a day upon the spike  
 And sinks into the infinite of sea.  
 Beloved, remain not hidden more from me,  
 Or if You stay out of my sight, I see  
 Still everywhere the footprints that you  
 leave

On mountainside and on the birch's sleeve.  
You hide perhaps, but always ride to be.

84 Jesus said "When you see your own  
Reflection, then rejoice, *don't groan*.  
But when you see reflections that  
Came into being where you sat  
Before you, and that neither die  
Nor come to light, then you shall try!"

85 Jesus said "Adam came to be  
From a great power and a great fee,  
But he did not become worthy  
Of you. For had he been worthy,  
He should not have died *hopelessly*."

86 Jesus said "*Foxes have their holes*  
*And birds have nests in trees and poles*,  
But Son of Man has no place *blessed*  
To lay his head and take a rest."

The others thought this word was ripe and  
done

For Judas in his entrance to the won.  
But Thomas realized the greater store  
Of light upon the fox-den and its floor.  
The Son of Man, the ben Adam, remains  
Without the institutions of the plains,  
With only human heart to be the place  
Of meeting with the divine loving face.  
Beloved, I seek no temple and no pew,  
I try no priesthood for its comely view,  
No liturgy of spices and of scent  
Upon the music of unworldly went,  
And find beneath the barren sky above  
A truer temple and a finer love.

87 Jesus said "Wretched is the body  
That is dependent on a body,  
And wretched is the soul that must  
Rely of both of these *in dust*."

The two bodies that touch a single soul  
Are strange relations in the mingled goal.  
The trinity of bodies and of mist  
Of soul is something I have never kissed.  
If wretched is the body that depends  
On body and the soul that in them wends  
Relying on the both, then I am blessed  
To find a body without such a rest  
In body and a soul that takes the best  
Of one body alone into the nest.  
With body and with soul knit into one  
From the two in the breath and dust begun,

I find that wretchedness is gone and done,  
And I have passed beyond the thing I  
guessed.

88 Jesus said "Angels and the prophets  
Will come to you to give the soffits  
Of things you have. And you too give  
Them things that you have where you live  
And say to yourselves, 'When will they  
Come and take what is their own prey?'"  
89 Jesus said "Why wash the outside  
Of the cup? Have you not espied  
That he who made the inside's just  
The same one who made outside crust?"

Instead of diatribe on Pharisee,  
The washing of the cup in the decree  
Of Thomas is that You are hiding where  
The daily tasks meet humans in their care.  
How many ways there are to hear the word,  
Beloved, how many ways to be deterred  
From Truth, despite the fact that each  
breath brings

New baptisms from all the world that sings.  
Beloved, take me in prey and as I pray  
Wash inside or outside in what You say,  
And make creation's power again in sway  
From inside out and outside in to stay  
Until the growing light of the new day,  
Until the temple of the heavens rings.

90 Jesus said "Come to me, my yoke  
Is easy and my ruler's stroke  
Is light, and you will find your rest."  
91 Then they said to him, "Tell us best  
Who you are so we might believe  
In you." He told them, "You may view  
The sky and earth, but you do not  
Recognize who's before you taught,  
And you do not know how to see  
This very moment's *mystery*."

How wisely the Christ answers every quest,  
How wisely Thomas reports what is best!  
The yoke is light if just this moment poses  
The meaning of the violets and roses.  
I wander through the corridors of time  
And stumble here and there upon a rhyme,  
While overhead and underfoot the spot  
Of moment recognizes what You've taught.  
Beloved, if I should raise my head to see,  
Or dig beneath the surface a degree,



I'd find this very moment's mystery.  
Instead I whirl encumbered with the weight  
Of glory hanging over rattled pate,  
Encumbered with my welling ecstasy.

92 Jesus said "Look and you will find.  
93 "Do not give holy things to dogs,  
They'll throw them out to rust with cogs.  
And do not give to pigs your pearls,  
Because they'll trample them *like churls*."

How many glories, my Beloved, have You  
Given to me, a thousand come in view  
Each day I turn about my den and lair!  
I turn from You to You and You are there.  
How many pearls and holy things have  
come

From You to me, a dervish dog and bum!  
Throw pearls to me, Beloved, such pearls  
in sum

That I am covered with the shining scum.  
Beloved, though I am just a dervish dog,  
Who knows not value of the mist from fog,  
And wallows in the smell of dank and grog,  
I still howl for the pearls, the pearls of sight  
That burnished furnished peals of sounding  
light,

That turn the dog from keening to the night.

94 *Said* Jesus, "He who seeks shall find,  
Who knocks will have an open *mind*."

95 "If you have money, do not lend  
It out for interest, but to spend  
On someone who'll not give it back."

Allons! The Gospel of Thomas indeed,  
Like Roman and like Grecian in their seed,  
And the Qur'an, forbids usury's greed.  
The Christian of today thinks that the  
knock

Is for the spirit's teaching on the block,  
But this most spirit-filled of Gospels prays  
For knocking out of interest in our days.  
The right to life is right to fill the new  
With work to gain the daily bread and true  
Without the growing debt to scar the pew.  
The right to life is right to live without  
The interest of the banking mob's redoubt.  
The right to life is not found on this globe:  
They cast lots for the lasting seamless robe.

96 *Said* Jesus, "The Father's kingdom

Is like a women who took some  
Yeast and put it into her dough  
And made large loaves of it to go.  
Who has ears let him hear *the show*."  
97 Jesus said "The kingdom's like one  
Woman with a container done  
Full of meal. Walking on the road  
Still some distance from her abode,  
The handle broke, the meal spilled out  
Behind her on the walking route.  
She did not notice it at all  
Because she did not see the fall.  
When she got home she set it down  
And it was empty *of the brown*."

Beloved, my chambered heart is empty  
now

After the tour of churches anyhow.  
The throne where I had set my trinities,  
My idols and my perfumes in the breeze,  
Is empty and still waiting for the show  
Of You to fill the emptiness in glow.  
Beloved, the inner temple with its walls  
Of stone still shining under wicked stalls  
Late filled with raptures, songs and  
liturgies,  
Is emptied waiting for what You'd endow.  
Beloved, I walk again the road that sees  
The spilling of my bread still on the go,  
And hear the magpie now that flees and  
calls,  
And feel the sun play havoc on my brow.

98 Jesus said "The Father's kingdom  
Is like a man who would have won  
A mighty man. In his own home  
He lifted sword against the dome  
Of his own house to see if his  
Hand was strong enough in a whiz.  
And then he killed the mighty man."

99 The disciples said for his plan,  
Your brother and mother outside  
Are waiting for you to provide."  
He told them, "Those who do the will  
Of my Father will fit the bill  
To be my brothers and my mum.  
It's they who come in with aplomb  
Into my own Father's kingdom."

The spirit and the mystic power that pours  
Through Thomas and his Gospel at the  
doors

Does nothing to diminish all the stores  
Of other Gospels on the truthful shores.  
If every other saying is revised  
Expressing the inner and the disguised,  
This one remains throughout all ways and  
means,

The doing of the Father's will that leans  
Upon the kingdom with its laws and  
scenes.

Beloved, I take the will that You send  
down

And take the ten commandments for the  
town,

And find in them the mystic grace that fills  
Both head and heart and hands with inner  
stills,

The haven and the temple of the hills.

100 They showed Jesus a golden coin  
And said to him, "Come to purloin  
Are Caesar's men after the tax."

He told them, "Give Caesar *the axe*  
That is his own, and give to God  
What belongs to God on the sod  
And give me what is mine *in rod*."

Synoptics fail to mind that Jesus said  
Beyond the giving of the gold and bread  
To Caesar and to God, there's something  
spread

For him as well. I learn here to be fed.  
Beloved, let every man give to the crown  
The glory due to such men of renown,  
And let each one give to You of Your own,  
And recognize You above every throne.  
But let all men give me what's mine alone  
As well as giving Jesus snake and stone.  
Beloved, I too demand my rightful share  
Upon the golden treads of silver stair,  
And as I look toward heaven from fatal  
earth,

I settle under sun in rightful berth.

101 "Whoever does not hate his own  
Father and mother as I've shown  
Cannot be disciple of mine.

And who does not love mom and dad  
As I do cannot, it is sad,

Become a disciple of mine.

For my mother gave me the dross,  
But my true gave life without loss."

The fair commandment does not say to love  
Or hate the parent given from above,  
But how can any truly honour him  
Or her with hate making the honed heart  
dim?

The question's asked to get attention right  
From the start of the famished earthly  
night.

The hope of having truth eternally,  
The weight of what matters in progeny,  
Is vain when pinned on the genetic bill.

The true in life is found upon the hill  
That's climbed in Olivet, Gethsemane,  
And finished in the heart that is set free  
Of human obligations and the crime  
Of human institutions without rhyme.

102 Jesus said "Woe to Pharisee,  
They're like dog sleeping in the lea  
Of the manger of the ox, for  
Neither does he eat of the store  
Nor does he let the ox eat more."

Eat and let eat is honoured saying never  
Heard on the earth by any fool or clever.  
Live and let live alone resounds to sear  
The human strife and lordly human fear.  
The dog does not eat straw, and yet stands  
by

To keep the cows from coming in the sty.  
Such are all priests and gurus under sky.  
The nourishment of heaven is found among  
The two or three alone, and in the tongue  
Of the lone dervish riding on the sound  
Of Scriptures sung beyond the temple  
ground.

Beloved, though I'm a dervish dog and  
keep

A vigil on the manger of the deep  
Word, let me serve straw to the kine that  
sleep.

103 Jesus said "Happy is the man  
Who knows where the robbers have plan  
To break in, so he can get up  
And strengthen himself like a tup  
And take arms before robbers can."

I must be happy among earthly men,  
And among the celestial in their den,  
Since I know what the robbers plan for me  
And for the world set in eternity.

They plan to take the oil and corn and make  
A temple to the unvirgined in wake  
And fry commandment keepers at the  
stake.

The institutions of men never change,  
They never take a different kind of range,  
But only buy a better advertisement  
Like the red wolf in grandmother's  
disguisement.

Beloved, I flee to You from every priest  
And every pope and poet that's increased  
The power of love to support unreleased.

104 They said "Here let's pray today and  
Let us fast also as we've planned."  
Jesus said "What sin have I done  
Or who striving with me has won?  
But when the bridegroom leaves the bride,  
Then let them fast and pray and hide."  
105 Jesus said "Everyone that knows  
The father and mother that shows  
Will be called son of a whore's blows."

Indeed the dear lord Jesus knew the way  
Of human heart and institution's day.  
Any who know the source of nourishing  
In heavenly places where the angels sing  
Is called a heretic and son of whore.  
That only lasts until he is made gore.  
Jesus exclaims "What transgression have I  
Done to deserve the naked cross in sky?"  
The sin is evident: he did not stay  
To kiss the toe of the established stray.  
If anything's to learn from crucifixion  
It's that all must give up the true conviction  
And knuckle under to Papal prediction  
Or succumb to the Roman sort of stiction.

106 Jesus said, "When you make two one,  
You will become of men the son,  
And when you say 'Mountain, get lost,'  
It will move, in the sea be tossed."

Synoptics jump into the sea to take  
The mountain slide among the waves in  
wake.  
But Thomas knows the truth, the hill and  
sea  
In earth and water must be made on glee.  
The gates of such awareness and of truth  
Must overcome the wanderings of youth.

The two are joined in one, and for Your  
sake

The I-ness of my being at the stake  
Must disappear beneath the shining wave.  
The stuttering I must learn to be brave  
Beneath the baptism, the death of slave.  
Beloved, I touch the mountain where I live,  
And bend to kiss the quartzite of my sieve,  
And finally learn to take what You give.

107 Jesus said "The kingdom is like  
A shepherd who was given strike  
Over a hundred sheep. But one,  
The largest, went astray, the bum.  
He left the ninety and the nine  
Sheep and looked for the one benign  
Until he found it. Since he went  
To such trouble he told the bent  
Sheep, 'I care more indeed for you  
Than for the ninety-nine ones true.'  
108 Jesus said "Everyone who drinks  
From my mouth will become in chinks  
Like me. I myself shall become  
That one, and hidden things in sum  
Will be revealed to him to hum."

The lost sheep is not that poor drunkard left  
Among the dregs and yet one not bereft,  
But loved above all by Yourself and strain.  
It is the hidden treasure in the main  
Of every human heart, the one that's found  
Only when all else left upon the ground  
Is shut abandoned from the heavenly  
sound.

That hidden treasure, my Beloved, is You  
Set in the golden circlet of the pew  
Within the stony chamber of the heart,  
The infinite in human story's part.  
Beloved, I leave the trinkets on the lawn  
And turn into the darkness and the dawn  
With empty hand and heart to try You on.

109 Jesus said "The kingdom is like  
A man who had a hidden strike  
Of treasure in his field and did  
Not know about the treasure hid.  
After he died his son was heir.  
The son not knowing sold his share.  
The one who bought it went and ploughed  
And found the treasure disendowed.  
He started lending money out  
At interest to those he'd not flout."

110 Jesus said "Who find the world and  
 Becomes rich, let him out of hand  
 Renounce the world and so remand."  
 111 Jesus said "The heavens and earth will  
 Be rolled up and for your eyes still.  
 But who lives from the Living One  
 Will not see death when that is done."  
 Does Jesus not say "Everyone  
 Who finds himself is better spun  
 Than the world in what it has done?"  
 112 Jesus said "Woe to the flesh that  
 Depends on the soul where it sat,  
 Woe to the soul that depends on  
 The flesh at both evening or dawn."  
 113 His disciples asked him to say  
 "When will the kingdom come to stay?"  
 "It will not come by waiting it.  
 It's not a matter of the fit  
 To say 'It's here' or say 'It's there.'  
 Rather the Father's kingdom's spread  
 Out on the earth, and yet for dread  
 Men do not see it in their care."

The kingdom is among you, not within,  
 Is the message You sent without a din.  
 The man looks for himself in hour and bin,  
 But how can any man not find himself?  
 No man is lost from his own view like elf.  
 The kingdom is spread out on every breath,  
 And overwhelms both earthly life and  
 death.  
 None can escape that Self that You  
 provide,  
 None can rise up beneath the load of pride.  
 Beloved, I take the kingdom for my hand  
 Is made in the king's shape and so is  
 planned.  
 The shape of human body is the shape  
 Of the divine kingdom strutted in crepe,  
 And there's not flight from it in any cape.

114 Simon Peter said to him, "Let  
 Mary leave us for women get  
 No worthy place in life to set."  
 Jesus said "I myself shall lead  
 Her to make of a male indeed,  
 So she too may become a living  
 Spirit like you males in your giving.  
 For every woman who will make  
 Herself a male and for my sake  
 Will enter in the kingdom come  
 From heaven and that shall be the sum.

From one there must be two, from two the  
 One,  
 And in that saying everything is done.  
 There is no man or woman in the crew,  
 But all is all and all is one in You.  
 When Mary graced the meadows of the  
 sweet,  
 She did not come there for Peter's defeat,  
 Nor did she show herself in her retreat  
 To be either a woman incomplete  
 Or man to favour men in Peter's seat.  
 The kingdom is a king, and there's the rub:  
 All else is sent to sea in an old tub.  
 Beloved, I sail to heaven and come back  
 Before the wind upon my sail grows slack,  
 Before the wind in my sail grows a stack.